

Telugu, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

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This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they
are written.

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Preface

This book teaches Telugu one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It is written for someone starting from zero — who may not read a single Telugu letter — so the script is taught *inside the word lessons themselves*: each word introduces exactly the letters it needs, so you learn to read నమస్కారం *and* learn that it means “greetings” in the same few minutes. There is no alphabet drill to sit through first. (A reader who already reads Telugu simply skims the “letters in this word” notes.)

Telugu — famous as “the Italian of the East” for its open, vowel-final music — is one of the four literary **Dravidian** languages, a family entirely separate from the Indo-European one that gave us English, Latin, and Sanskrit. Like its sister Kannada, and unlike Tamil, it borrowed *heavily* from Sanskrit; so “hello” is the Sanskrit నమస్కారం (*namaskāram*), yet “yes” and “okay” are the native అవును (*avunu*) and సరే (*sarē*). Telugu also shows the family is no monolith: where its sisters say “no” with a word from the root *il-*, Telugu goes its own way with లేదు (*lēdu*). Each lesson sets the word beside its cousins across the family — English always, and Sanskrit, Hindi, and the other Dravidian languages where they illuminate — every form supplied in full, so no prior knowledge of any of them is assumed.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the Telugu out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind the alphabet. Each lesson introduces exactly the letters and sounds its own word needs, so you are reading real words from the first page rather than drilling a chart. The whole script is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

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Contents

Preface	iii
1 Greetings	1
1.1 నమస్కారం (namaskāram)	1
1.2 ధన్యవాదములు (dhanyavādamulu)	3
1.3 మ (ma)	5
1.4 ధ (dha)	7
1.5 క (ka)	8
1.6 అవును (avunu)	9
1.7 అ (a)	11
1.8 ా (ā)	13
1.9 లేదు (lēdu)	14
1.10 సరే (sarē)	16
1.11 ే (ē)	17
1.12 Practice	18
2 Introducing Yourself	21
2.1 పేరు (pēru)	21
2.2 న (na)	22
2.3 నా (nā)	24
2.4 ం (u)	25
2.5 నా పేరు ... (nā pēru ...)	26
2.6 ం (1)	27
2.7 నువ్వు / మీరు (nuvvu / mīru)	28
2.8 ్ (virama)	29
2.9 ఏమిటి (ēmiṭi)	31
2.10 ట (ṭa)	31
2.11 ఏ (ē)	33
2.12 ్ (2)	35

2.13	మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? (mī pēru ēmiṭi?)	36
2.14	ీ (i)	37
2.15	సంతోషం (santōṣam)	38
2.16	ో (ō)	39
2.17	ం (anusvara)	40
2.18	Practice	41
3	How Are You?	43
3.1	3 (3)	43
3.2	ఎలా (elā)	44
3.3	మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? (mīru elā unnāru?)	45
3.4	ఉ (u)	46
3.5	నేను (nēnu)	48
3.6	4 (4)	49
3.7	బాగా (bāgā)	50
3.8	బ (ba)	51
3.9	ర (ra)	52
3.10	పరవాలేదు (paravālēdu)	54
3.11	౫ (5)	55
3.12	Practice	56
4	Farewells	59
4.1	డప్పు (ḍappu)	59
4.2	డ (ḍa)	60
4.3	వెళ్ళు (veḷḷu)	61
4.4	౬ (6)	62
4.5	వెళ్ళి వస్తాను (veḷḷi vastānu)	63
4.6	రేపు కలుద్దాం (rēpu kaluddām)	64
4.7	ప (pa)	65
4.8	మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం (maḷḷi kaluddām)	67
4.9	౭ (7)	68
4.10	Practice	69
5	The First Verbs	71
5.1	త (ta)	71
5.2	త (ta)	73
5.3	త (ta)	74
5.4	త (ta)	75
5.5	మాట్లాడు (māṭṭlāḍu)	76
5.6	౮ (8)	77

5.7	నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను (nēnu telugu ...)	78
5.8	స (sa)	79
5.9	ష (ṣa)	81
5.10	ఉండు (uṇḍu)	83
5.11	హంస (haṃsa)	84
5.12	హ (ha)	84
5.13	పని చేయు (pani cēyu)	86
5.14	౯ (9)	87
5.15	Practice	88
6	Case Endings and Dative Subjects	91
6.1	౦ (0)	91
6.2	-కు (-ku)	92
6.3	య (ya)	94
6.4	నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు (nāku telugu vaccu)	96
6.5	(dialogue)	97
7	Numbers One to Ten	101
7.1	ఒకటి రెండు మూడు ... (okaṭi reṇḍu mūḍu ...)	101
7.2	ఐ (ai)	103
7.3	ూ (ū)	104
7.4	ఆరు ఏడు ఎనిమిది ... (āru ēḍu enimidi ...)	106
7.5	ొ (o)	107
7.6	ఒ (o)	108
7.7	ఆ (ā)	110
7.8	(dialogue)	112
8	Please	115
8.1	దయచేసి (dayacēsi)	115
8.2	-ండి (-aṇḍi)	117
8.3	చ (ca)	118
9	Sorry	121
9.1	క్షమించండి (kṣamiṇcaṇḍi)	121
9.2	ఇటుక (iṭuka)	123
9.3	ఇ (i)	123
9.4	(dialogue)	125

10	Days of the Week	127
10.1	సోమవారం మంగళవారం ... (Somavāram ...)	127
10.2	శ (śa)	129
10.3	ల (la)	131
10.4	ఐదు అచ్చులు (aidu acchulu)	133
10.5	(dialogue)	134
11	Four Core Colours	137
11.1	నలుపు తెలుపు ... (nalupu telupu ...)	137
11.2	ె (e)	138
12	Family	141
12.1	నాన్న అమ్మ అన్న ... (nānna amma anna ...)	141
12.2	ద (da)	143
12.3	(dialogue)	144
13	Head and Hand	147
13.1	తల చెయ్యి (tala ceyyi)	147
13.2	వ (va)	148
14	Seasons	151
14.1	వసంత ఋతువు వేసవి ... (vasanta ṛtuvu ...)	151
14.2	గ (ga)	153
15	Water and Rice	157
15.1	నీళ్ళు బియ్యం అన్నం (nīḷḷu biyyam annam)	157
15.2	ీ (ī)	158
16	The Traditional Months	161
16.1	చైత్రం వైశాఖం జ్యేష్ఠం ... (Caitraṁ ...)	161
16.2	ై (ai)	162
16.3	ఖ (kha)	164
17	Noon and Midnight	167
17.1	మధ్యాహ్నం అర్ధరాత్రి (madhyāhnam ardharātri)	167
17.2	ఘ (gha)	168
17.3	థ (ṭha)	170
17.4	ఆరు అక్షరాలు (āru akṣarālu)	172
17.5	ఫ (pha)	173
17.6	నాలుగు అక్షరాలు (nālugu akṣarālu)	175

18	Telling Time	177
18.1	గంట (ganṭa)	177
18.2	ళ (ḷa)	179
18.3	ఢ (ḍha)	180
18.4	శ · ష (śa · pha)	182
19	Asking Someone's Age	185
19.1	నీ వయసెంత? (nī vayasenta)	185
20	Numbers 11–20 and Weather	187
20.1	పదకొండు — ఇరవై (padakoṇḍu — iravai)	187
20.2	వాతావరణం (vātavarāṇam)	188
21	Dog and Cat	191
21.1	కుక్క, పిల్లి (kukka, pilli)	191
21.2	ఎ (e)	192
22	Green and Yellow	195
22.1	పచ్చ, పసుపు (pacca pasupu)	195
23	Day	197
23.1	రోజు (rōju)	197
23.2	ణ (ṇa)	198
24	Night	201
24.1	రాత్రి (rātri)	201
24.2	జ (ja)	203
25	Good Night	205
25.1	శుభ రాత్రి (śubha rātri)	205
25.2	భ (bha)	206
26	Morning	209
26.1	ఉదయం (udayam)	209
26.2	ఋ (ṛ)	211
27	Evening	213
27.1	సాయంత్రం (sāyantram)	213
28	Afternoon	215
28.1	మధ్యాహ్నం (madhyāhnam)	215

29	Good Morning	217
29.1	శుభోదయం (śubhōdayam)	217
30	Good Evening	219
30.1	శుభ సాయంత్రం (śubha sāyantram)	219
31	Good Afternoon	221
31.1	శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం (śubha madhyāhnam)	221
31.2	శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం — register (śubha madhyāhnam)	222
32	The Core Verbs	225
32.1	ఉండు (uṇḍu)	225
32.2	వెళ్ళు (vellu)	227
32.3	రా (rā)	228
32.4	తిను (tinu)	230
32.5	చూడు (cūḍu)	231
32.6	తెలుసు (telusu)	233
33	Four Verbs of the Mind	235
33.1	అనుకో (anukō)	235
33.2	అర్థం చేసుకో (artham cēsukō)	237
33.3	ధ (tha)	239
33.4	చదువు (caduvu)	241
33.5	రాయు (rāyu)	242
34	Four Verbs Between People	245
34.1	తీసుకో (tīsukō)	245
34.2	అడుగు (aḍugu)	247
34.3	సహాయం చేయు (sahāyam cēyu)	249
34.4	నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం (nāku telugu iṣṭam)	250
35	Family and Friends	253
35.1	కుటుంబం (kuṭumbam)	253
35.2	స్నేహితుడు (snēhituḍu)	254
36	Son and Daughter, Two Different Roots	257
36.1	కొడుకు (koḍuku)	257
36.2	కూతురు (kūturu)	258

37	Four Words on the Face	261
37.1	కన్ను (kannu)	261
37.2	చెవి (cevi)	262
37.3	ముక్కు (mukku)	263
37.4	నోరు (nōru)	264
38	The Heart, Two Ways	267
38.1	గుండె (guṇḍe)	267
38.2	హృదయం (hṛdayam)	268
39	Tea and Milk, Two Roads	271
39.1	దయచేసి టీ (dayacēsi ṭī)	271
39.2	పాలు (pālu)	272
39.3	ర్థ (ṛ)	273
40	A Meal	277
40.1	భోజనం (bhōjanam)	277
40.2	(dialogue)	278
41	Pointing, and Asking	281
41.1	ఇది (idi)	281
41.2	అది (adi)	282
41.3	ఇక్కడ (ikkaḍa)	282
41.4	అక్కడ (akkaḍa)	283
41.5	ఎవరు (evaru)	284
41.6	ఎక్కడ (ekkaḍa)	285
41.7	i- / a- / e-	285
42	Describing Things	287
42.1	పెద్ద (pedda)	287
42.2	చిన్న (cinna)	288
42.3	మంచి (manci)	288
42.4	కొత్త (kotta)	289
42.5	పాత (pāta)	290
42.6	before the noun, unchanged	290
43	More Everyday Verbs	293
43.1	రా (rā)	293
43.2	కూర్చో (kūrcō)	294
43.3	నిలచో (nilcō)	294
43.4	ఇవ్వు (ivvu)	295

44	Verbs of Seeing and Saying	297
44.1	చూడు (cūḍu)	297
44.2	అలకించు (ālakiñcu)	298
44.3	మాట్లాడు (māṭlāḍu)	298
44.4	రాయి (rāyi)	299
45	Grandparents, and the Married Pair	301
45.1	తాత (tāta)	301
45.2	అమ్మమ్మ (ammamma)	302
45.3	భర్త (bharta)	303
45.4	భార్య (bhārya)	303
46	Things You Ask For	305
46.1	పండు (paṇḍu)	305
46.2	బట్ట (baṭṭa)	306
46.3	దీపం (dīpam)	307
46.4	ఉప్పు (uppu)	307
46.5	పుస్తకం (pustakam)	308
47	The Leg and the Tooth	311
47.1	కాలు (kālu)	311
47.2	పన్ను (pannu)	312
47.3	జాట్టు (juttu)	313
47.4	వేలు (vēlu)	313
47.5	కడుపు (kaḍupu)	314
48	Naming Who Someone Is	317
48.1	గురువు (guruvu)	317
48.2	విద్యార్థి (vidyārthi)	318
48.3	వైద్యుడు (vaidyudu)	319
48.4	రైతు (raitu)	319
48.5	అతిథి (atithi)	320
49	Answering With More Than Yes	323
49.1	నిజం (nijam)	323
49.2	చాలు (cālu)	324
49.3	తప్పకుండా (tappakuṇḍā)	325
49.4	ఏమో (ēmō)	325
49.5	అలాగే (alāgē)	326

50	Taking Your Leave	329
50.1	ఇప్పుడు (ippuḍu)	329
50.2	ఎల్లుండి (elluṇḍi)	330
50.3	ప్రయాణం (prayāṇam)	331
50.4	బయలుదేరు (bayaludēru)	331
50.5	వెళ్ళిస్తాను (vellōstānu)	332
51	Courtesy Words	335
51.1	కృతజ్ఞత (kṛtajñata)	335
51.2	ఇ (ña)	336
51.3	మేలు (mēlu)	338
51.4	గౌరవం (gauravam)	338
51.5	ౌ (au)	339
51.6	ఆశీర్వాదం (āśīrvādam)	341
51.7	ఇ · ౌ (ña · au)	342
51.8	దండం (daṇḍam)	343
51.9	ఇ · ౌ (ña · au)	344
52	Welcoming a Guest	345
52.1	తలుపు (talupu)	345
52.2	కుర్చీ (kurcī)	346
52.3	ముగ్గు (muggu)	347
52.4	పువ్వు (puvvu)	348
52.5	పూలదండ (pūladaṇḍa)	348
53	The Sky	351
53.1	ఆకాశం (ākāśam)	351
53.2	సూర్యుడు (sūryuḍu)	352
53.3	చంద్రుడు (candruḍu)	353
53.4	చుక్క (cukka)	354
53.5	మబ్బు (mabbu)	355
54	The Tree	357
54.1	చెట్టు (ceṭṭu)	357
54.2	కొమ్మ (komma)	358
54.3	వేరు (vēru)	359
54.4	విత్తనం (vittanam)	359
54.5	మొక్క (mokka)	360

55	River and Road	363
55.1	నది (nadi)	363
55.2	చెరువు (ceruvu)	364
55.3	గుట్ట (guṭṭa)	365
55.4	గ్రామం (grāmam)	366
55.5	బాట (bāṭa)	366
56	In the House	369
56.1	చాప (cāpa)	369
56.2	బుట్ట (buṭṭa)	370
56.3	కత్తి (katti)	371
56.4	గిన్నె (ginne)	371
56.5	పెట్టె (peṭṭe)	372
57	More of the Body	375
57.1	మెడ (meḍa)	375
57.2	వీపు (vīpu)	376
57.3	పెదవి (pedavi)	377
57.4	గోరు (gōru)	377
57.5	ఎముక (emuka)	378
58	More Short Replies	381
58.1	కొంచెం (koñcem)	381
58.2	ఎక్కువ (ekkuva)	382
58.3	తక్కువ (takkuva)	383
58.4	వద్దు (vaddu)	384
58.5	అంతే (antē)	384
59	Weather and Ground	387
59.1	గాలి (gāli)	387
59.2	మంచు (mañcu)	388
59.3	ఇసుక (isuka)	389
59.4	బురద (burada)	389
59.5	నిప్పు (nippu)	390
60	Animals	393
60.1	గేదె (gēde)	393
60.2	మేక (mēka)	394
60.3	కోడి (kōḍi)	395
60.4	చీమ (cīma)	395

60.5	పక్షి (pakṣi)	396
61	In the Kitchen	399
61.1	పెరుగు (perugu)	399
61.2	నెయ్యి (neyyi)	400
61.3	నూనె (nūne)	401
61.4	చక్కెర (cakkera)	401
61.5	మిరప (mirapa)	402
62	Things People Make	405
62.1	దారం (dāram)	405
62.2	సూది (sūdi)	406
62.3	చీపురు (cīpuru)	407
62.4	గొడుగు (goḍugu)	407
62.5	అద్దం (addam)	408
63	Hunger, Sleep and Health	411
63.1	ఆకలి (ākali)	411
63.2	నిద్ర (nidra)	412
63.3	దగ్గు (daggu)	413
63.4	రోగం (rōgam)	413
63.5	ఆరోగ్యం (ārōgyam)	414
64	Words That Join an Answer	417
64.1	కూడా (kūdā)	417
64.2	మాత్రమే (mātramē)	418
64.3	అయితే (ayitē)	419
64.4	తరువాత (taruvāta)	420
64.5	ఇంకా (inkā)	420
65	More Good Manners	423
65.1	స్వాగతం (svāgatam)	423
65.2	మర్యాద (maryāda)	424
65.3	మనవి (manavi)	425
65.4	అనుమతి (anumati)	426
65.5	నమ్మకం (nammakam)	426
66	The Field	429
66.1	పొలం (polam)	429
66.2	వరి (vari)	430
66.3	గడ్డి (gaḍḍi)	431

66.4	కల్లం (kallam)	432
66.5	పంట (paṇṭa)	432
67	The House Itself	435
67.1	గోడ (gōḍa)	435
67.2	కప్పు (kappu)	436
67.3	గడప (gaḍapa)	437
67.4	మెట్టు (meṭṭu)	438
67.5	కిటికీ (kiṭikī)	438
68	Sound and Voice	441
68.1	శబ్దం (śabdam)	441
68.2	గొంతు (gontu)	442
68.3	పాట (pāṭa)	443
68.4	అరుపు (arupu)	444
68.5	కబురు (kaburu)	444
69	Tools	447
69.1	గొడ్డలి (goḍḍali)	447
69.2	రంపం (rampam)	448
69.3	పార (pāra)	449
69.4	సుత్తి (sutti)	449
69.5	కర్ర (karra)	450
70	Small Creatures	453
70.1	ఎలుక (eluka)	453
70.2	కప్ప (kappa)	454
70.3	దోమ (dōma)	455
70.4	ఉడుత (uḍuta)	455
70.5	సాలీడు (sālīḍu)	456
71	The Wider Family	459
71.1	మామ (māma)	459
71.2	అత్త (atta)	460
71.3	బావ (bāva)	461
71.4	మరదలు (maradalu)	462
71.5	అల్లుడు (alluḍu)	462

72	The Market	465
72.1	అంగడి (aṅgaḍi)	465
72.2	డబ్బు (ḍabbu)	466
72.3	ధర (dhara)	467
72.4	తూకం (tūkam)	467
72.5	బేరం (bēram)	468
73	Tastes	471
73.1	తీపి (tīpi)	471
73.2	పులుపు (pulupu)	472
73.3	చేదు (cēdu)	473
73.4	కారం (kāram)	473
73.5	వగరు (vagaru)	474
74	And, But, Or	477
74.1	మరియు (mariyu)	477
74.2	కానీ (kānī)	478
74.3	లేదా (lēdā)	479
74.4	ఎందుకు (enduku)	479
74.5	ఎందుకంటే (endukaṇṭē)	480
75	Today, Yesterday, When	483
75.1	ఇవాళ (ivāḷa)	483
75.2	నిన్న (ninna)	484
75.3	ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు? (eppuḍu vastāru?)	485
75.4	ముందు (mundu)	485
75.5	సంవత్సరం (saṁvatsaram)	486
76	Very Good, Very Bad	489
76.1	చాలా మంచి (cālā manci)	489
76.2	చెడ్డ (ceḍḍa)	490
76.3	మంచిది (mancidi)	491
76.4	సులభం (sulabham)	491
76.5	కష్టం (kaṣṭam)	492
77	Where You Are From	495
77.1	నుంచి (nunci)	495
77.2	పట్టణం (paṭṭaṇam)	496
77.3	దేశం (dēsam)	497
77.4	భారతదేశం (Bhāratadēsam)	497

77.5	ముప్పై (muppai)	498
78	Yes or No, and I Do Not Know	501
78.1	అవునా (avunā)	501
78.2	తెలుసా (telusā)	502
78.3	నాకు తెలియదు (nāku teliyadu)	503
78.4	అర్థం కాలేదు (artham kālēdu)	504
78.5	ఉన్నారా (unnārā)	504
79	He, She, and Whose	507
79.1	స్నేహితుడి (snēhituḍi)	507
79.2	మా (mā)	508
79.3	అతను (atanu)	509
79.4	నన్ను (nannu)	510
79.5	గారు (gāru)	510
80	Wanting, Allowing, Wishing	513
80.1	నాకు కావాలి (nāku kāvāli)	513
80.2	అని (ani)	514
80.3	వెళ్ళవచ్చు (vellavaccu)	515
80.4	లోపలికి రండి (lōpaliki raṇḍi)	516
80.5	శుభాకాంక్షలు (śubhākāṅkṣalu)	516
81	Counting in Order	519
81.1	మొదటి (modaṭi)	519
81.2	రెండవ (reṇḍava)	521
81.3	మూడవ (mūḍava)	522
81.4	నాలుగవ (nālugaṇa)	523
81.5	ఐదవ (aidava)	524
82	Sixth to Eleventh	527
82.1	ఆరవ (ārava)	527
82.2	ఏడవ (ēḍava)	528
82.3	ఎనిమిదవ (enimidava)	529
82.4	తొమ్మిదవ (tommidava)	530
82.5	పదవ (padava)	532
82.6	పదకొండవ (padakoṇḍava)	533

83	Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Passage	535
83.1	(reading)	535
83.2	(reading)	536
83.3	(reading)	537
84	When You Are Not Well	539
84.1	జ్వరం (jvaram)	539
84.2	నొప్పి (noppi)	540
84.3	అలసట (alasaṭa)	541
84.4	దాహం (dāham)	541
84.5	విశ్రాంతి (viśrānti)	542
85	Cold, Hot, and How You Feel	545
85.1	చలి (cali)	545
85.2	వేడి (vēḍi)	546
85.3	భయం (bhayam)	547
85.4	కోపం (kōpani)	547
85.5	బాధ (bādha)	548
86	Slower, Please	551
86.1	నెమ్మదిగా (nemmadiḡā)	551
86.2	ఇంకోసారి (iṅkōsāri)	552
86.3	గట్టిగా (gaṭṭiḡā)	553
86.4	ఒక్క నిమిషం (okka nimiṣam)	553
86.5	ఆగండి (āgaṇḍi)	554
87	Right, Wrong, Maybe	557
87.1	తప్పు (tappu)	557
87.2	సరిగ్గా (sarigḡā)	558
87.3	బహుశా (bahuśā)	559
87.4	అలాగా (alāḡā)	559
87.5	నిజంగా (nijaṅḡā)	560
87.6	(dialogue)	561
87.7	(dialogue)	562
88	The People Around You	563
88.1	పిల్లలు (pillalu)	563
88.2	అబ్బాయి (abbāyi)	564
88.3	అమ్మాయి (ammāyi)	564
88.4	మనిషి (maniṣi)	565

88.5	బంధువు (bandhuvu)	566
89	About Yourself	569
89.1	ఉద్యోగం (udyōgaṁ)	569
89.2	భాష (bhāṣa)	570
89.3	ఇంగ్లీషు (iṅgliṣu)	571
89.4	పెళ్ళి (pelli)	571
89.5	చిరునామా (cirunāmā)	572
90	On the Way Out	575
90.1	జాగ్రత్త (jāgratta)	575
90.2	త్వరగా (tvaragā)	576
90.3	ఇంటికి (iṁṭiki)	577
90.4	సెలవు (selavu)	577
90.5	పదండి (padaṇḍi)	578
91	Greetings People Actually Say	581
91.1	బాగున్నారా? (bāgunnārā?)	581
91.2	చాలా రోజులైంది (cālā rōjulaindi)	582
91.3	ఏంటి సంగతి? (ēṇṭi saṅgati?)	583
91.4	ఎక్కడికి? (ekkaḍiki?)	583
91.5	భోంచేశారా? (bhōṁcēsārā?)	584
91.6	(dialogue)	585
91.7	(dialogue)	586
92	At the Doctor	587
92.1	జలుబు (jalubu)	587
92.2	మందు (mandu)	588
92.3	ఆసుపత్రి (āsupatri)	588
92.4	గాయం (gāyaṁ)	589
92.5	నీరసం (nīrasaṁ)	590
93	Keeping Well	593
93.1	క్షేమం (kṣēmaṁ)	593
93.2	హాయిగా (hāyigā)	594
93.3	సుఖం (sukhaṁ)	594
93.4	సంతోషంగా (santōṣaṁgā)	595
93.5	ఒళ్ళు (ollu)	596

94	Offers, Apologies, Introductions	599
94.1	మన్నించండి (manniñcaṇḍi)	599
94.2	క్షమాపణ (kṣamāpaṇa)	600
94.3	కావాలా? (kāvālā?)	601
94.4	అవసరం (avasaram)	601
94.5	పరిచయం (paricayam)	602
95	How Do You Say It?	605
95.1	తెలుగులో (telugulō)	605
95.2	ఎలా అంటారు? (elā aṇṭāru?)	606
95.3	మెల్లగా (mellagā)	607
95.4	చూపించండి (cūpiñcaṇḍi)	607
95.5	వినిపించలేదు (vinipiñcalēdu)	608
95.6	(dialogue)	609
95.7	(dialogue)	610
96	Names, Ages, Birthdays	611
96.1	ఇంటిపేరు (iṇṭipēru)	611
96.2	ముద్దుపేరు (muddupēru)	612
96.3	వయసు (vayasu)	613
96.4	పుట్టినరోజు (puṭṭinarōju)	613
96.5	సంతకం (santakam)	614
97	Laughing, Crying, Worrying	617
97.1	నవ్వు (navvu)	617
97.2	ఏడుపు (ēḍupu)	618
97.3	విచారం (vicāram)	618
97.4	ఆందోళన (āndōḷana)	619
97.5	ఒంటరిగా (oṇṭarigā)	620
98	Nothing, Not Yet, That Will Do	623
98.1	ఏమీ లేదు (ēmī lēdu)	623
98.2	ఇంకా లేదు (iṅkā lēdu)	624
98.3	సరిపోతుంది (saripōtundi)	625
98.4	నిజమే (nijamē)	625
98.5	అదే (adē)	626
99	Welcomes, Gifts, Invitations	629
99.1	నమస్తే (namastē)	629
99.2	ఆనందం (ānandam)	630

99.3	అభినందనలు (abhinandanalu)	631
99.4	బహుమతి (bahumati)	631
99.5	ఆహ్వానం (āhvānam)	632
99.6	(dialogue)	633
99.7	(dialogue)	634
100	Right, Left, Straight ahead, Near, Far	635
100.1	కుడి (kuḍi)	635
100.2	ఎడమ (eḍama)	636
100.3	తిన్నగా (tinnagā)	636
100.4	దగ్గర (dagḡara)	637
100.5	దూరం (dūram)	638
101	Above, Below, Inside, Outside, Behind	639
101.1	పైన (paina)	639
101.2	కింద (kinda)	640
101.3	లోపల (lōpala)	640
101.4	బయట (bayāṭa)	641
101.5	వెనక (venaka)	642
102	In the middle, Street, Road, Bridge, Park	643
102.1	మధ్యలో (madhyalō)	643
102.2	వీధి (vīdhi)	644
102.3	రోడ్డు (rōḍḍu)	644
102.4	వంతెన (vantena)	645
102.5	పార్కు (pārku)	646
103	Temple, School, Library, Bank, Market	647
103.1	గుడి (guḍi)	647
103.2	బడి (baḍi)	648
103.3	గ్రంథాలయం (granthālayam)	648
103.4	బ్యాంకు (byāṅku)	649
103.5	సంత (santa)	650
104	Shore, Office, Garden, Corner, Turn	651
104.1	తీరం (tīram)	651
104.2	కార్యాలయం (kāryālayam)	652
104.3	తోట (tōṭa)	652
104.4	మూల (mūla)	653
104.5	మలుపు (malupu)	654

105	Station, Bus, Ability, Skill, Right	655
105.1	స్టేషన్ (stēṣan)	655
105.2	బస్సు (bassu)	656
105.3	సామర్థ్యం (sāmarthyam)	656
105.4	నైపుణ్యం (naipuṇyam)	657
105.5	హక్కు (hakku)	658
106	Chance, Tool, Property, Owner, Strength	659
106.1	అవకాశం (avakāśam)	659
106.2	పరికరం (parikaram)	660
106.3	ఆస్తి (āsti)	660
106.4	యజమాని (yajamāni)	661
106.5	బలం (balam)	662
107	Wish, Hope, Dream, Intention, Plan	663
107.1	కోరిక (kōrika)	663
107.2	ఆశ (āśa)	664
107.3	కల (kala)	664
107.4	ఉద్దేశం (uddēśam)	665
107.5	ప్రణాళిక (praṇālika)	666
108	To wish for, To decide, Reason, Therefore, Because of	667
108.1	కోరు (kōru)	667
108.2	నిర్ణయించు (nirṇayiṁcu)	668
108.3	కారణం (kāraṇam)	668
108.4	అందువల్ల (anduvalla)	669
108.5	వల్ల (valla)	670
109	That is exactly why, Bed, Pillow, Blanket, Curtain	671
109.1	అందుకే (andukē)	671
109.2	మంచం (mañcam)	672
109.3	దిండు (diṇḍu)	672
109.4	దుప్పటి (duppaṭi)	673
109.5	తెర (tera)	674
109.6	(dialogue)	674
109.7	(dialogue)	675
110	Lock, Key, Rope, Nail, Scissors	677
110.1	తాళం (tālam)	677
110.2	తాళంచెవి (tālamcevi)	678

110.3	తాడు (tāḍu)	678
110.4	మేకు (mēku)	679
110.5	కత్తెర (katterā)	680
111	Comb, Soap, Towel, Glasses, Clock	681
111.1	దువ్వెన (duvvena)	681
111.2	సబ్బు (sabbu)	682
111.3	తువ్వాలు (tuvvālu)	682
111.4	కళ్ళజోడు (kaḷḷajōḍu)	683
111.5	గడియారం (gaḍiyāraṁ)	684
112	Bag, Pen, Paper, Drinking glass, Spoon	685
112.1	సంచి (sañci)	685
112.2	కలం (kalam)	686
112.3	కాగితం (kāgitam)	686
112.4	గ్లాసు (glāsu)	687
112.5	చెంచా (cemcā)	688
113	Stove, Candle, Matchbox, Doll, Ball	689
113.1	పొయ్యి (poyyi)	689
113.2	కొవ్వొత్తి (kovvotti)	690
113.3	అగ్గిపెట్టె (aggipette)	690
113.4	బొమ్మ (bomma)	691
113.5	బంతి (banti)	692
114	Kite, Shirt, Sari, Dhoti, Sandals	693
114.1	గాలిపటం (gālipaṭam)	693
114.2	చొక్కా (cokkā)	694
114.3	చీర (cīra)	694
114.4	పంచె (pañce)	695
114.5	చెప్పులు (ceppulu)	696
115	Cap, Ring, Bangles, Curry, Dal	697
115.1	టోపీ (tōpī)	697
115.2	ఉంగరం (uṅgaram)	698
115.3	గాజులు (gājulu)	698
115.4	కూర (kūra)	699
115.5	పప్పు (pappu)	700

116	Sambar, Rasam, Egg, Fish, Meat	701
116.1	సాంబారు (sāmbāru)	701
116.2	రసం (rasam)	702
116.3	గుడ్డు (guḍḍu)	702
116.4	చేప (cēpa)	703
116.5	మాంసం (māṁsam)	704
117	Vegetables, Banana, Mango, Coconut, Onion	705
117.1	కూరగాయలు (kūragāyalu)	705
117.2	అరటిపండు (aratipaṇḍu)	706
117.3	మామిడిపండు (māmiḍipaṇḍu)	706
117.4	కొబ్బరి (kobbari)	707
117.5	ఉల్లిపాయ (ullipāya)	708
118	Tomato, Potato, Aubergine, Ginger, Garlic	709
118.1	టమాటా (ṭamāṭā)	709
118.2	బంగాళాదుంప (baṅgālādumpa)	710
118.3	వంకాయ (vaṅkāya)	710
118.4	అల్లం (allam)	711
118.5	వెల్లుల్లి (vellulli)	712
119	Honey, Idli, Dosa, Vada, Coffee	713
119.1	తేనె (tēne)	713
119.2	ఇడ్లీ (iḍlī)	714
119.3	దోశ (dōsa)	714
119.4	వడ (vaḍa)	715
119.5	కాఫీ (kāphī)	716
119.6	(dialogue)	716
119.7	(dialogue)	717
120	Sea, Lake, Forest, Leaf, Soil	719
120.1	సముద్రం (samudram)	719
120.2	సరస్సు (sarassu)	720
120.3	అడవి (aḍavi)	720
120.4	ఆకు (āku)	721
120.5	మట్టి (maṭṭi)	722
121	Thunder, Lightning, Storm, Wave, Hill	723
121.1	ఉరుము (urumu)	723
121.2	మెరుపు (merupu)	724

121.3	తుపాను (tupānu)	724
121.4	అల (ala)	725
121.5	కొండ (koṇḍa)	726
122	Waterfall, Island, Cow, Horse, Elephant	727
122.1	జలపాతం (jalapātam)	727
122.2	దీవి (dīvi)	728
122.3	ఆవు (āvu)	728
122.4	గుర్రం (gurram)	729
122.5	ఏనుగు (ēnugu)	730
123	Tiger, Lion, Bear, Monkey, Rabbit	731
123.1	పులి (puli)	731
123.2	సింహం (simham)	732
123.3	ఎలుగుబంటి (elugubanti)	732
123.4	కోతి (kōti)	733
123.5	కుందేలు (kundēlu)	734
124	Deer, Fox, Snake, Tortoise, Parrot	735
124.1	జింక (jiṅka)	735
124.2	నక్క (nakka)	736
124.3	పాము (pāmu)	736
124.4	తాబేలు (tābēlu)	737
124.5	చిలక (cilaka)	738
125	Pigeon, Owl, Peacock, Butterfly, Crow	739
125.1	పావురం (pāvuram)	739
125.2	గుడ్లగూబ (guḍlagūba)	740
125.3	నెమలి (nemali)	740
125.4	సీతాకోకచిలుక (sītākōkacilaka)	741
125.5	కాకి (kāki)	742
126	Duck, Pig, Donkey, Camel, Face	743
126.1	బాతు (bātu)	743
126.2	పంది (pandi)	744
126.3	గాడిద (gāḍida)	744
126.4	ఒంటె (oṇṭe)	745
126.5	ముఖం (mukham)	746

127	Tongue, Knee, Shoulder, Eyebrow, Cheek	747
127.1	నాలుక (nāḷuka)	747
127.2	మోకాలు (mōkālu)	748
127.3	భుజం (bhujam)	748
127.4	కనుబొమ్మ (kanubomma)	749
127.5	బుగ్గ (bugga)	750
128	Chin, Wrist, Elbow, Skin, Blood	751
128.1	గడ్డం (gaḍḍam)	751
128.2	మణికట్టు (maṇikaṭṭu)	752
128.3	మోచేయి (mōcēyi)	752
128.4	చర్మం (carman)	753
128.5	రక్తం (raktam)	754
129	Window curtain, Clay pot, Water pot, Cupboard, Table	755
129.1	కిటికీతెర (kiṭikītera)	755
129.2	చట్టి (caṭṭi)	756
129.3	బిందె (bindē)	756
129.4	బీరువా (bīruvā)	757
129.5	టేబుల్ (ṭēbul)	758
129.6	(dialogue)	758
129.7	(dialogue)	759
130	Television, Computer, Phone, Ticket, Paisa	761
130.1	టీవీ (ṭivī)	761
130.2	కంప్యూటర్ (kampyūṭar)	762
130.3	ఫోను (phōnu)	762
130.4	టిక్కెట్టు (ṭicketṭu)	763
130.5	పైసా (paisā)	764
131	Rupee, Bottle, Long skirt, Pocket, Belt	765
131.1	రూపాయి (rūpāyi)	765
131.2	బాటిలు (bāṭilu)	766
131.3	లంగా (laṅgā)	766
131.4	జేబు (jēbu)	767
131.5	బెల్టు (beltu)	768

132	Socks, Coat, Dhoti, Blouse, Lotus	769
132.1	సాక్సు (sāksu)	769
132.2	కోటు (kōṭu)	770
132.3	ధోతి (dhōti)	770
132.4	జాకెట్టు (jākeṭṭu)	771
132.5	తామరపువ్వు (tāmarapuvvu)	772
133	Clothes, Moustache, Tears, Boat, Train	773
133.1	గుడ్డలు (guḍḍalu)	773
133.2	మీసాలు (misālu)	774
133.3	కంటినీరు (kaṇṭinīru)	774
133.4	పడవ (paḍava)	775
133.5	రైలు (railu)	776
134	Car, Bicycle, Aeroplane, Grain, Wheat	777
134.1	కారు (kāru)	777
134.2	సైకిలు (sāikilu)	778
134.3	విమానం (vimānaṁ)	778
134.4	ధాన్యం (dhānyaṁ)	779
134.5	గోధుమలు (gōdhumalu)	780
135	Black pepper, Cumin, Tamarind, Lemon, Grapes	781
135.1	మిరియాలు (miriyālu)	781
135.2	జీలకర్ర (jīlakarra)	782
135.3	చింతపండు (cintapaṇḍu)	782
135.4	నిమ్మకాయ (nimmakāya)	783
135.5	ద్రాక్ష (drākṣa)	784
136	Guava, Sugar, Tall, Short, Heavy	785
136.1	జామపండు (jāmapaṇḍu)	785
136.2	పంచదార (pañcadāra)	786
136.3	పొడవు (poḍavu)	786
136.4	పొట్టి (poṭṭi)	787
136.5	బరువు (baruvu)	788
137	Light, Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty	789
137.1	తేలిక (tēlika)	789
137.2	మెత్తని (mettani)	790
137.3	గట్టి (gaṭṭi)	790
137.4	శుభ్రం (śubhram)	791

137.5	మురికి (murikī)	792
138	Fast, Beautiful, Deep, Wide, Narrow	793
138.1	వేగం (vēgaṁ)	793
138.2	అందమైన (andamaina)	794
138.3	లోతు (lōtu)	795
138.4	వెడల్పు (veḍalpu)	795
138.5	ఇరుకు (iruku)	796
139	Wet, Dry, Poor, Old, Famous	797
139.1	తడి (taḍi)	797
139.2	పొడి (poḍi)	798
139.3	పేద (pēda)	798
139.4	ముసలి (musali)	799
139.5	ప్రసిద్ధ (prasiddha)	800
139.6	(dialogue)	800
139.7	(dialogue)	801
140	Safe, Lie, Grey, Golden, Spoiled	803
140.1	సురక్షితం (surakṣitam)	803
140.2	అబద్ధం (abaddham)	804
140.3	బూడిద (būḍida)	804
140.4	బంగారు (baṅgāru)	805
140.5	పాడైన (pāḍaina)	806
141	Sweet, Bitter-tasting, Spicy, Courage, Lazy	807
141.1	తీయని (tīyani)	807
141.2	చేడైన (cēdaina)	808
141.3	కారమైన (kāramaina)	808
141.4	ధైర్యం (dhairyam)	809
141.5	సోమరి (sōmari)	810
142	Hard-working, Clever, Terrible, Black, White	811
142.1	కష్టపడే (kaṣṭapaḍē)	811
142.2	తెలివైన (telivaina)	812
142.3	భయంకరమైన (bhayaṅkaramaina)	813
142.4	నల్లని (nallani)	813
142.5	తెల్లని (tellani)	814

143	Red, To fly, To run, To sleep, To get up	815
143.1	ఎర్రటి (errati)	815
143.2	ఎగురు (egiru)	816
143.3	పరిగెత్తు (parigettu)	816
143.4	నిద్రపో (nidrapō)	817
143.5	లేచు (lēcu)	818
144	To cook, To cut, To break, To send, To look for	819
144.1	వండు (vaṇḍu)	819
144.2	కోయు (kōyu)	820
144.3	పగలగొట్టు (pagalagoṭṭu)	820
144.4	పంపు (pampu)	821
144.5	వెతుకు (vetuku)	822
145	To learn, To teach, To forget, To jump, To get down	823
145.1	నేర్చుకో (nērcukō)	823
145.2	నేర్పు (nēpu)	824
145.3	మరచిపో (maracipō)	824
145.4	దూకు (dūku)	825
145.5	దిగు (digu)	826
146	To reach, To put on, To call, To count, To wash	827
146.1	చేరు (cēru)	827
146.2	వేసుకో (vēsukō)	828
146.3	పిలుచు (pilucu)	828
146.4	లెక్కపెట్టు (lekkapeṭṭu)	829
146.5	కడుగు (kaḍugu)	830
147	To wipe, To tie, To sew, To win, To hide	831
147.1	తుడుచు (tuḍucu)	831
147.2	కట్టు (kaṭṭu)	832
147.3	కుట్టు (kuṭṭu)	832
147.4	గెలుచు (gelucu)	833
147.5	దాచు (dācu)	834
148	To protect, To burn, To put out, To sing, To sell	835
148.1	కాపాడు (kāpāḍu)	835
148.2	కాల్చు (kālcu)	836
148.3	ఆర్పు (ārpu)	836
148.4	పాడు (pāḍu)	837

148.5	అమ్మ (ammu)	838
149	To walk, To close, To open, To drink, To cry	839
149.1	నడుచు (naḍucu)	839
149.2	మూయు (mūyu)	840
149.3	తెరువు (teruvu)	840
149.4	తాగు (tāgu)	841
149.5	ఏడ్చు (ēḍcu)	842
149.6	(dialogue)	842
149.7	(dialogue)	843
150	A Word for Literature — Then the Letter Inside It	845
150.1	వాఙ్మయం (vāṇmayam)	845
150.2	జ (ña)	846
151	A Word for Shade — Then Its First Letter	849
151.1	ఛాయ (chāya)	849
151.2	చ (cha)	850
151.3	ఛాయ (chāya)	851
152	A Word for a Stream — Then Its First Letter	853
152.1	ఝరి (jhari)	853
152.2	ఝ (jha)	854
152.3	ఝరి (jhari)	855
153	Nobody, Never, Nowhere, Anyone, Anything	857
153.1	ఎవరూ (evarū)	857
153.2	ఎప్పుడూ (eppuḍū)	858
153.3	ఎక్కడా (ekkaḍā)	859
153.4	ఎవరైనా (evarainā)	859
153.5	ఏమైనా (ēmainā)	860
154	Recently, Already, Last, Once, To Spend (Time)	863
154.1	ఇటీవల (iṭīvala)	863
154.2	ఇప్పటికే (ippaṭikē)	864
154.3	గత (gata)	865
154.4	ఒకసారి (okasāri)	865
154.5	గడుపు (gaḍupu)	866

155	Next, From Now On, the Future, To Hope, To Look Forward To	869
155.1	వచ్చే (vaccē)	869
155.2	ఇకపై (ikapai)	870
155.3	భవిష్యత్తు (bhaviṣyattu)	871
155.4	అశించు (āśiñcu)	871
155.5	ఎదురుచూడు (edurucūḍu)	872
156	A Timetable, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Receipt	875
156.1	కాలపట్టిక (kālapaṭṭika)	875
156.2	సూచన (sūcana)	876
156.3	అద్దె (adde)	877
156.4	ప్రకటన (prakaṭana)	877
156.5	రసీదు (rasīdu)	878
156.6	(dialogue)	879
156.7	(dialogue)	879
157	To pay, To fry, To boil, To mix, To grind	881
157.1	చెల్లించు (cellīñcu)	881
157.2	వేయించు (vēyiñcu)	882
157.3	ఉడికించు (uḍikiñcu)	882
157.4	కలుపు (kalupu)	883
157.5	రుబ్బు (rubbu)	884
158	To hurry, To brush, To change, To take off, To measure	885
158.1	తొందరపడు (tondarapaḍu)	885
158.2	తొము (tōmu)	886
158.3	మార్పు (mārcu)	887
158.4	విప్పు (vippu)	887
158.5	కొలుచు (kolucu)	888
159	To squeeze, To soak, To repair, To throw away, To lose	889
159.1	పిండు (piṇḍu)	889
159.2	నానబెట్టు (nānabetṭu)	890
159.3	బాగుచేయు (bāgucēyu)	890
159.4	పారేయు (pārēyu)	891
159.5	పోగొట్టుకో (pōgotṭukō)	892

160	To earn, To explain, To translate, To remember, To agree	893
160.1	సంపాదించు (sampādiñcu)	893
160.2	వివరించు (vivariñcu)	894
160.3	అనువదించు (anuvadiñcu)	894
160.4	గుర్తుపెట్టుకో (gurtupetṭukō)	895
160.5	ఒప్పుకో (oppukō)	896
161	To dance, To celebrate, To greet, To feel shy, To be surprised	897
161.1	నాట్యం చేయు (nāṭyaṁ cēyu)	897
161.2	జరుపుకో (jarupukō)	898
161.3	పలకరించు (palakariñcu)	899
161.4	సిగ్గుపడు (siggupaḍu)	899
161.5	ఆశ్చర్యపోవు (āścaryapōvu)	900
162	To kiss, To hug, To tease, To praise, To describe	903
162.1	ముద్దుపెట్టు (muddupetṭu)	903
162.2	కొగిలించు (kaugiliñcu)	904
162.3	ఆటపట్టించు (āṭapaṭṭiñcu)	904
162.4	పొగడు (pogaḍu)	905
162.5	వర్ణించు (varṇiñcu)	906
163	To suspect, To realize, To pay attention to, To compete, To kick	907
163.1	అనుమానించు (anumāniñcu)	907
163.2	గ్రహించు (grahiñcu)	908
163.3	పట్టించుకో (paṭṭiñcukō)	909
163.4	పోటీపడు (pōṭīpaḍu)	909
163.5	తన్ను (tannu)	910
164	To grate, To strain, To dip, To tear, To wrap	911
164.1	తురుము (turumu)	911
164.2	వడకట్టు (vaḍakaṭṭu)	912
164.3	ముంచు (muñcu)	912
164.4	చింపు (cimpu)	913
164.5	చుట్టు (cuṭṭu)	914

165	To spill, To shave, To tighten, To prick, To knit	915
165.1	చిందు (cindu)	915
165.2	గొరుగు (gorugu)	916
165.3	బిగించు (bigiñcu)	916
165.4	గుచ్చు (guccu)	917
165.5	అల్లు (allu)	918
165.6	(dialogue)	918
165.7	(dialogue)	919
166	To continue, To observe, To correct, To mutter, To separate	921
166.1	కొనసాగు (konasāgu)	921
166.2	పాటించు (pāṭiñcu)	922
166.3	దిడ్డు (diddu)	923
166.4	గొణుగు (goṇugu)	923
166.5	విడిపోవు (viḍipōvu)	924
167	Headache, Diarrhoea, Tablet, Sweat, Swelling	927
167.1	తలనొప్పి (talanoppi)	927
167.2	విరేచనాలు (virēcanālu)	928
167.3	మాత్ర (mātra)	928
167.4	చెమట (cemaṭa)	929
167.5	వాపు (vāpu)	930
168	Jealousy, Pride, Enthusiasm, Peace, Patience	931
168.1	అసూయ (asūya)	931
168.2	గర్వం (garvaṁ)	932
168.3	ఉత్సాహం (utsāham)	932
168.4	శాంతి (śānti)	933
168.5	సహనం (sahanam)	934
169	Sore, Blister, Rash, Scar, Sprain	935
169.1	పుండు (puṇḍu)	935
169.2	బొబ్బ (bobba)	936
169.3	దద్దుర్లు (daddurlu)	936
169.4	మచ్చ (macca)	937
169.5	బెణుకు (beṇuku)	938

170	Time, Sometimes, Often, Date, Weekend	939
170.1	సమయం (samayaṁ)	939
170.2	అప్పుడప్పుడు (appuḍappuḍu)	940
170.3	తరచుగా (taracugā)	940
170.4	తేదీ (tēdī)	941
170.5	వారాంతం (vārāntaṁ)	942
171	Sunset, Every day, Usually, Rarely, Constantly	943
171.1	సూర్యాస్తమయం (sūryāstamayam)	943
171.2	ప్రతిరోజు (pratirōju)	944
171.3	సాధారణంగా (sādhāraṇaṅgā)	944
171.4	అరుదుగా (arudugā)	945
171.5	నిరంతరం (nirantaram)	946
172	Youth, Old age, Meanwhile, Every year, Forever	947
172.1	యవ్వనం (yavvanam)	947
172.2	వృద్ధాప్యం (vṛddhāpyam)	948
172.3	ఇంతలో (intalō)	948
172.4	ఏటా (ēṭā)	949
172.5	ఎప్పటికీ (eppaṭiki)	950
173	Veranda, Backyard, Restaurant, Beside, Post office	951
173.1	వరండా (varaṇḍā)	951
173.2	పెరడు (peraḍu)	952
173.3	హోటలు (hōṭalu)	952
173.4	పక్కన (pakkana)	953
173.5	పోస్టాఫీసు (pōstāphīsu)	954
174	On the other side, That way, This way, Cave, Valley	955
174.1	అవతల (avatala)	955
174.2	అటు (aṭu)	956
174.3	ఇటు (iṭu)	956
174.4	గుహ (guha)	957
174.5	లోయ (lōya)	958
174.6	(dialogue)	958
174.7	(dialogue)	959
175	Crowd, World, Earthquake, Dust, Smoke	961
175.1	గుంపు (gumpu)	961
175.2	ప్రపంచం (prapaṇcam)	962

175.3	భూకంపం (bhūkampam)	962
175.4	దుమ్ము (dummu)	963
175.5	పొగ (poga)	964
176	Otherwise, Even so, Through, About, Without	965
176.1	లేకపోతే (lēkapōtē)	965
176.2	అయినా (ayinā)	966
176.3	ద్వారా (dvārā)	966
176.4	గురించి (guriñci)	967
176.5	లేకుండా (lēkuṇḍā)	968
177	If by chance, Instead of, According to, Actually, Anyway	969
177.1	ఒకవేళ (okavēḷa)	969
177.2	బదులు (badulu)	970
177.3	ప్రకారం (prakāram)	970
177.4	అసలు (asalu)	971
177.5	ఏదేమైనా (ēdēmainā)	972
178	On purpose, By mistake, Never mind, Condition, Excuse	973
178.1	కావాలని (kāvālani)	973
178.2	పొరపాటున (porapāṭuna)	974
178.3	పోనీ (pōnī)	975
178.4	షరతు (ṣaratu)	975
178.5	సాకు (sāku)	976
179	Delicious, Bland, Fresh, Expensive, Cheap	977
179.1	కమ్మని (kammani)	977
179.2	చప్పని (cappani)	978
179.3	తాజా (tājā)	978
179.4	ఖరీదైన (kharīdaina)	979
179.5	చౌక (cauka)	980
180	Main, Total, Every, Pink, Orange	981
180.1	ప్రధాన (pradhāna)	981
180.2	మొత్తం (mottam)	982
180.3	ప్రతి (prati)	982
180.4	గులాబీ రంగు (gulābī raṅgu)	983
180.5	నారింజ రంగు (nāriñja raṅgu)	984

181	Great, Smell, Interesting, Wonderful, Ordinary	985
181.1	గొప్ప (goppa)	985
181.2	వాసన (vāsana)	986
181.3	ఆసక్తికరమైన (āsaktikaramaina)	986
181.4	అద్భుతమైన (adbhutamaina)	987
181.5	మామూలు (māmūlu)	988
182	Silence, Durable, Fake, Plain, Extra	989
182.1	నిశబ్దం (niśśabdami)	989
182.2	మన్నికైన (mannikaina)	990
182.3	నకిలీ (nakilī)	991
182.4	సాదా (sādā)	991
182.5	అదనపు (adanapu)	992
183	Kitchen, Bedroom, Bucket, Lid, Frying pan	993
183.1	వంటగది (vaṇṭagadi)	993
183.2	పడకగది (paḍakagadi)	994
183.3	బాల్చీ (bālcī)	994
183.4	మూత (mūta)	995
183.5	బాణలి (bāṇali)	996
183.6	(dialogue)	996
183.7	(dialogue)	997
184	Butter, Chutney, Sweet milk pudding, Cucumber, Okra	999
184.1	వెన్న (venna)	999
184.2	పచ్చడి (paccāḍi)	1000
184.3	పాయసం (pāyasam)	1000
184.4	దోసకాయ (dōsakāya)	1001
184.5	బెండకాయ (beṇḍakāya)	1002
185	Envelope, Postage stamp, Parcel, Post, Pencil	1003
185.1	కవరు (kavaru)	1003
185.2	స్టాంపు (stāmpu)	1004
185.3	పార్సెలు (pārselu)	1004
185.4	తపాలా (tapālā)	1005
185.5	పెన్సిలు (pensilu)	1006

186	Grandson, Granddaughter, Parents, Twins, Baby	1007
186.1	మనవడు (manavaḍu)	1007
186.2	మనవరాలు (manavarālu)	1008
186.3	తల్లిదండ్రులు (tallidaṇḍrulu)	1008
186.4	కవలలు (kavalalu)	1009
186.5	పాప (pāpa)	1010
187	Bee, Lizard, Insect, Sparrow, Koel	1011
187.1	తేనెటీగ (tēneṭīga)	1011
187.2	బల్లి (balli)	1012
187.3	పురుగు (purugu)	1012
187.4	పిచ్చుక (piccuka)	1013
187.5	కోకిల (kōkila)	1014
188	Prasadam, Rice-flour sweets, Festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, Bindi, Henna	1015
188.1	ప్రసాదం (prasādam)	1015
188.2	అరిసెలు (ariselu)	1016
188.3	తోరణం (tōraṇam)	1017
188.4	బొట్టు (boṭṭu)	1017
188.5	గోరింటాకు (gōriṇṭāku)	1018
189	Competition, Winner, Medal, Hobby, Novel	1021
189.1	పోటీ (pōṭī)	1021
189.2	విజేత (vijēta)	1022
189.3	పతకం (patakam)	1022
189.4	అభిరుచి (abhiruci)	1023
189.5	నవల (navala)	1024
190	Electricity, Machine, Sofa, Swing, Carpet	1025
190.1	కరెంటు (kareṇṭu)	1025
190.2	యంత్రం (yantram)	1026
190.3	సోఫా (sōphā)	1026
190.4	ఉయ్యాల (uyyāla)	1027
190.5	తివాచీ (tivācī)	1028
191	Rubber, Light bulb, Firewood, Net, Weighing scale	1029
191.1	రబ్బరు (rabbaru)	1029
191.2	బల్బు (balbu)	1030
191.3	కట్టెలు (kaṭṭelu)	1030

191.4	వల (vala)	1031
191.5	త్రాసు (trāsu)	1032
192	Wick, Latch, Paintbrush, Necklace, Braid	1033
192.1	వత్తి (vatti)	1033
192.2	గొళ్ళెం (golḷeni)	1034
192.3	కుంచె (kuñce)	1034
192.4	హారం (hāraṁ)	1035
192.5	జడ (jaḍa)	1036
192.6	(dialogue)	1036
192.7	(dialogue)	1037
193	Line, Circle, Square, Triangle, Wheel	1039
193.1	గీత (gīta)	1039
193.2	వృత్తం (vṛttam)	1040
193.3	చతురస్రం (caturasraṁ)	1040
193.4	త్రిభుజం (tribhujam)	1041
193.5	చక్రం (cakram)	1042
194	Housework, Domestic helper, Tailor, Trader, Coin	1043
194.1	ఇంటిపని (iṇṭipani)	1043
194.2	పనిమనిషి (panimanishi)	1044
194.3	దర్జీ (darjī)	1044
194.4	వ్యాపారి (vyāpāri)	1045
194.5	నాణెం (nāṇem)	1046
195	Officer, Clerk, Manager, Colleague, Meeting	1047
195.1	అధికారి (adhikāri)	1047
195.2	గుమాస్తా (gumāstā)	1048
195.3	మేనేజరు (mēnējara)	1048
195.4	సహోద్యోగి (sahōdyōgi)	1049
195.5	సమావేశం (samāvēśaṁ)	1050
196	Fee, Fine, Deadline, Responsibility, Application	1051
196.1	ఫీజు (phīju)	1051
196.2	జరిమానా (jarimānā)	1052
196.3	గడువు (gaḍuvu)	1052
196.4	బాధ్యత (bādhyata)	1053
196.5	దరఖాస్తు (darakhāstu)	1054

197	Carpenter, Writer, Problem, Solution, Opinion	1055
197.1	వడ్రంగి (vaḍraṅgi)	1055
197.2	రచయిత (racayita)	1056
197.3	సమస్య (samasya)	1056
197.4	పరిష్కారం (pariṣkāraṁ)	1057
197.5	అభిప్రాయం (abhiprāyaṁ)	1058
198	Tuition, Interview, Work shift, Uniform, Staff	1059
198.1	ట్యూషను (ṭyūṣaṇu)	1059
198.2	ఇంటర్వ్యూ (inṭarvyū)	1060
198.3	షిఫ్టు (ṣipṭu)	1060
198.4	యూనిఫారం (yūniphāraṁ)	1061
198.5	సిబ్బంది (sibbandi)	1062
198.6	(dialogue)	1062
198.7	(dialogue)	1063
	The Telugu script (reference)	1065
	Glossary	1067
	Review Questions	1133
	Answer Key	1135
	Index	1137

Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes: 👁 eyes (6) ✍ pen (6) 🗣 Hands-free start: first 1 of 12 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can greet someone in Telugu, recognize the reply, and choose an appropriate response.

The greetings and the words that oil a first conversation — and, taught through them, how to read the Telugu script and how Telugu sits inside the Dravidian family. Each word introduces the letters it needs, so you learn to read it and understand it at once: నమస్కారం · ధన్యవాదములు · అవును · లేదు · సరే.

1.1 నమస్కారం (namaskāram) — “greetings,” a making of a bow

Meet your first Telugu word. Say **namaskāram** with a small bow: “hello” or “greetings.” Now read it one small piece at a time.

The letters in this word

Telugu runs **left to right**. A consonant normally carries a built-in **a**.

- న · మ · ర = *na · ma · ra*.
- కా = క *ka* plus the long-*ā* vowel sign: *kā*.
- In స్క, స loses its vowel and stacks below క: *s + ka = ska*.
- The dot ం adds the final nasal sound *m*.

Left to right: న · మ · స్ · కా · ర · ం = *na-ma-s-kā-ram* →

నమస్కారం = **namaskāram**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

నమస్కారం came from Sanskrit **namas** (“a bow”) + **kāra** (“a making,” from *kr*, “to do”): literally “**the making of a bow.**” Telugu added its own final sound. Tamil instead kept its native greeting, *vaṇakkam*.

Across the family — the same idea, six ways:

Language	“Hello”	Source
Telugu	నమస్కారం <i>namaskāram</i>	Sanskrit
Kannada	<i>namaskāra</i>	Sanskrit — the same word
Malayalam	<i>namaskāram</i>	Sanskrit — the same word
Hindi	<i>namaste</i>	Sanskrit — the same <i>namas</i>
Tamil	<i>vaṇakkam</i>	native Dravidian
English	<i>hello</i>	Germanic

Four of the six borrowed the Sanskrit bow. **Tamil alone kept its own word** — the first sign that “Dravidian family” does not mean “same vocabulary.”

Why it’s said this way

With palms together and a small bow, *namaskāram* works as **hello or goodbye**. It is respectful without being stiff.

The letters in this word

Telugu reads **left to right**, and every consonant carries a built-in “a” (many under a little check-mark hat, the *talakaṭṭu*). న *na*, మ *ma*, ర *ra*. A **vowel sign** changes it: క *ka* + long-ā → కా *kā*. A vowel-less consonant **stacks below** the next as a conjunct: స్ tucks under *ka* → స్క *“ska.”* And the **anusvāra** ం adds a final nasal “-m.” Read న · మ · స్ · కా · ర · ం → *namaskāram*.

Your turn

- Say it: na · ma · s · kā · ram → “namaskāram”

- *Say it:* what the anusvāra ు adds (a final nasal, “-m”)
- *Say it:* “namaskāram,” with a small bow
- *Write it:* trace నమస్కారం with a finger, then copy it once

Before you move on

Read నమస్కారం. What does it mean? (“Greetings.”) What does the dot ు add? (A final nasal.) What does the whole word literally mean? (“The making of a bow.”)

1.2 ధన్యవాదములు (dhanyavādamulu) — “thank you,” utterances of “worthy”

Another Sanskrit loan — and a first look at a Telugu *ending*, the plural that turns “a thanks” into “thanks.”

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Telugu.)

- ధ = “dha” — an **aspirated** *d* (a puff of breath after it).
- న్య = “nya” — న (na) vowel-stripped and stacked with య (ya).
- వా = “vā” · ద = “da” · ము = “mu” · లు = “lu.”

Left to right: ధ · న్య · వా · ద · ము · లు = *dha-nya-vā-da-mu-lu*
→

ధన్యవాదములు = dhanyavādamulu

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The core is **Sanskrit: dhanya** (“worthy, blessed,” from *dhana*, “wealth”) + **vāda** (“a saying,” root *vad*, “to speak”) = “an utterance of [you are] worthy.” Telugu then adds its own **plural ending -mulu**, so *dhanyavāda-mulu* is literally “**worthy-sayings**,” thanks in the plural of courtesy. (You’ll also hear the shorter *dhanyavādālu*.) The Sanskrit stem is the same one inside Hindi *dhanyavād* and

Kannada *dhanyavāda*.

Across the family — the same idea, five ways:

Language	“Thanks”	Note
Telugu	<i>dhanyavādamulu</i> (ధన్యవాదములు)	Sanskrit stem + Telugu plural
Kannada	<i>dhanyavāda</i> (ಧನ್ಯವಾದ)	Sanskrit — same stem
Hindi	<i>dhanyavād</i> (धन्यवाद)	Sanskrit — same stem
Tamil	<i>nanri</i> (நன்றி)	native (“goodness”)
Malayalam	<i>nandi</i> (നന്ദി)	native — Tamil’s cousin

Telugu, Kannada, and Hindi share the Sanskrit stem; Tamil and Malayalam keep the native *nanri* / *nandi*.

Grammar Lens: Telugu builds words by gluing endings on

-*mulu* is your first taste of how Telugu (like all Dravidian languages) works: it is **agglutinative** — it stacks meaning by gluing endings onto a stem, one after another, rather than using separate little words. Here a plural rides on a borrowed Sanskrit noun. Later endings will mark case (“to,” “from,” “with”) the same way. Bank the idea: in Telugu, grammar is mostly **suffixes**.

The letters in this word

New: ధ *dha* (aspirated *d*), the conjunct న్య (*na* stacked with *ya*), then వా · ద · ము · లు. Read ధ · న్య · వా · ద · ము · లు → *dhanyavādamulu*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- dha · nya · vā · da · mu · lu → “dhanyavādamulu”
- the pieces — Sanskrit *dhanya-vāda* + Telugu plural -*mulu*
- the shorter everyday form, “dhanyavādālu”

Before you move on

Read ధన్యవాదములు. What is Sanskrit in it, and what is Telugu? (*dhanya-vāda* is Sanskrit; the plural *-mulu* is Telugu.) What does “agglutinative” mean for how Telugu builds words? (It glues endings onto a stem.)

1.3 మ — one character, and it is in the first word of the book

Say the greeting this book opened with. Then say the word for thank you. You have both of them in your mouth already.

Script you’ll notice: మ

మ — *ma*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *m*, it is **ma**.

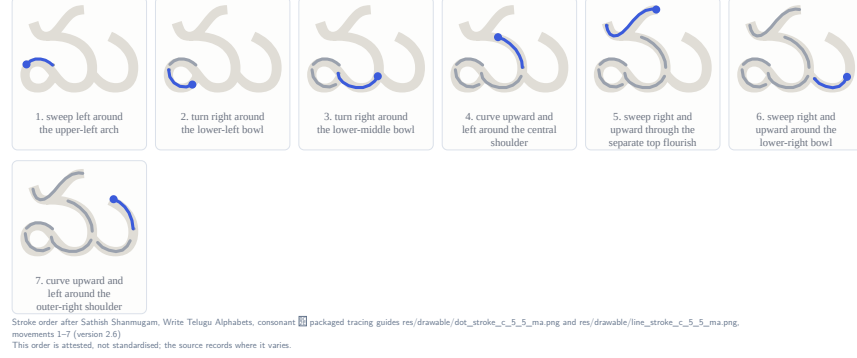
Both of the words you said a moment ago carry it:

- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (*namaskāram* — “a making of a bow”)
- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (*dhanyavādamulu* — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)

This is the character the book uses more than any other. It sits in the second syllable of the very first word you were taught, and it will be in front of you on nearly every page from here on.

Writing: మ — seven calm movements

How it is written — 7 strokes · 6 pen lifts · 7 movements



How మ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 sweeps left around the upper-left arch. Movements 2 and 3 turn right around the two lower bowls. Movement 4 rises around the central shoulder. Lift for movement 5, the separate flourish above. Movement 6 turns around the lower-right bowl, and movement 7 rises around the outer-right shoulder.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the seven clear movements instead of rushing their joins.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words, and find మ in each

నమస్కారం · ధన్యవాదములు

- *Trace it:* మ three times, saying *ma* as you finish each one
- *Look:* at the greeting again and say which syllable మ carries

Before you move on

Which character is this — మ? What sound does it carry? (*ma.*)
Name the two words in this chapter that contain it. (నమస్కారం and ధన్యవాదములు — once each.)

1.4 ధ — the character the thank-you word opens with

Before the new one: మ — what sound does it carry?

This one is at the very front of the word for thank you, where your eye lands first.

Script you’ll notice: ధ

ధ — *dha*.

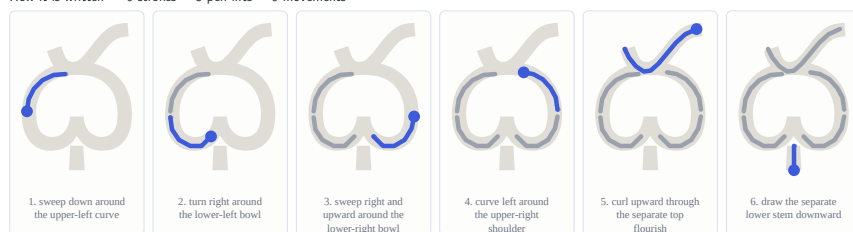
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *dh*, it is **dha**.

- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ’worthy’”)

One word so far, and it is the one this character opens. The *dh* is a single sound made at the teeth with a puff of breath after it, not the English *th* of *this*. More words with ధ arrive as the book goes on; this is where the shape gets into your eye.

Writing: ధ — six deliberate movements

How it is written — 6 strokes · 5 pen lifts · 6 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant ధ packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_4_4_dha.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_4_4_dha.png, movements 1–6 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ధ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movements 1–4 build the round body in four short curves: upper left, lower left, lower right, then upper right. Lift between each curve. Movement 5 adds the rising top flourish. Lift once more for movement 6, the short lower stem.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so preserve the six clear movements rather than trying to join the gaps.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the word below, and find ధ at its front and మ further in

ధన్యవాదములు

- *Trace it:* ధ three times, saying *dha* as you finish each one
- *Look:* at the two characters side by side and say which is which

Before you move on

Which character is this — ధ? What sound does it carry? (*dha*.)
Where in the thank-you word does it sit? (At the front.)

1.5 క — one character, met inside words you already say

Rounded, curvy letters, most crowned with a small tick or check-mark headstroke; no continuous top line. This is the first one.

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: క

క — *ka*.

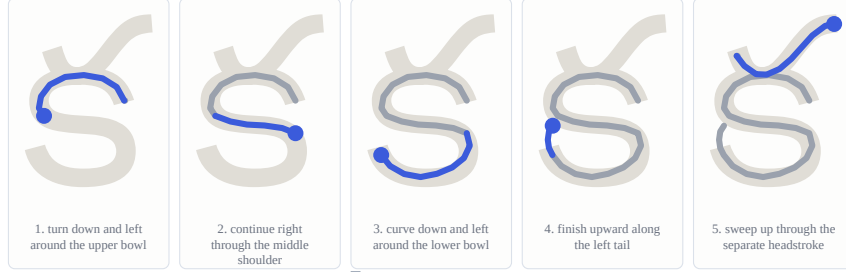
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *k*, it is **ka**.

You already say this one, and it has క inside it:

- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)

Writing: క — copy what you see

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant క packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_1_1_ka.png, movements 1–5 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How క is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on క and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find క in the ones that have it
నమస్కారం · ధన్యవాదములు
- *Trace it:* క three times, saying *ka* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find క once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — క? What sound does it carry? (*ka.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

1.6 అవును (avunu) — “yes”

After two Sanskrit loans, a **native Telugu** word: the plain “yes.”

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Telugu.)

- అ = “a” — an **independent vowel** (the word starts with a vowel, so it gets a full letter, not a hooked-on sign).
- వు = “vu” — వ (va) with the “u” **vowel sign**.
- ను = “nu” — న (na) with the “u” sign.

Left to right: అ · వు · ను = *a-vu-nu* →

అవును = **avunu** = “yes.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

అవును (*avunu*) is the everyday “**yes / it is so**,” a native Telugu word. It comes from the verb of being — literally close to “it is” — which is why the next lesson’s “no” (*kādu*, “is not”) is its exact mirror.

Grammar Lens: yes and no as “it is” / “it is not”

Telugu’s yes/no pair are really little **statements of being**: *avunu* (“it is [so]”) and *kādu* (“it is not”). This is a very Dravidian instinct — answer by asserting or denying existence, rather than with a bare particle. You’ll also hear a “yes” come back as the question’s own verb, echoed (*vaccānu*, “I came,” for “did you come?”). Bank *avunu* as the simple word.

The letters in this word

అ is the **independent vowel** “a” (word-initial). వు is *vu*, ను is *nu* (each a consonant with the “u” sign). Read అ · వు · ను → *avunu*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a · vu · nu → “avunu”
- why అ is a full letter here (the word starts with the vowel)
- “avunu” — “yes, it is so”

Before you move on

Read అవును. Native Telugu or Sanskrit loan? (Native.) At root, what kind of statement is a Telugu “yes”? (An assertion of being — “it is [so],” mirrored by *kādu*, “it is not.”)

1.7 అ — the vowel you have been saying since the first page

Before the new one: క — what sound does it carry? Say it out loud.

You said *ka*, not *k*. Hold on to that vowel at the end.

Script you’ll notice: అ

అ — *a*.

It is an **independent vowel** — a vowel that is a letter in its own right, not a mark hung on a consonant.

Every consonant lesson so far has told you the same thing: a consonant in this script is never bare, it comes with an *a* already inside it. **అ is that vowel, standing on its own.**

Here is what makes it the odd one out. Most vowels in Telugu have two forms — a letter, and a mark that rides on a consonant. This vowel has a letter and **no mark at all**, because a consonant with nothing hanging off it is already carrying it. The absence is the writing.

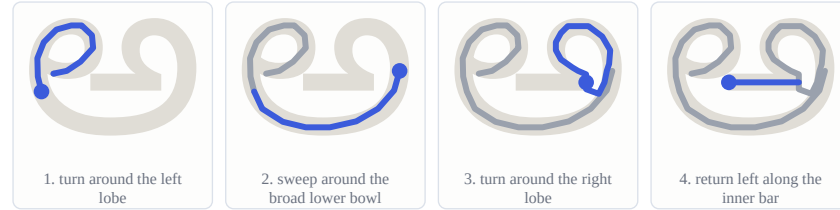
So Telugu reaches for అ in one situation: when the vowel opens a word and has no consonant in front of it to sit inside.

- అవును *avunu* — yes

That word begins on today’s character. Everything after it is consonants with their own vowels attached.

Writing: అ — copy what you see

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, independent vowel అ tracing screen, movements 1–4 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How అ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on అ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the word below and put a finger on అ at its front

అవును

- *Trace it:* అ three times, saying *a* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* క, then అ — the same vowel, once tucked inside a consonant and once out on its own

Before you move on

Which character is this — అ? What sound does it carry? (*a*.) Why does this vowel have no mark to hang on a consonant? (**Because a consonant with no mark on it is already carrying it.**) Which word from this chapter begins with it? (అవును.)

1.8 ூ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ூ — what does it do?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ூ

ூ — ā.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with ā. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ூ somewhere inside it:

- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)
- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)

Writing: ூ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ூ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ூ in the ones that have it
నమస్కారం · ధన్యవాదములు · అవును
- *Trace it:* ூ three times, saying ā as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ூ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ె? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts ā on; takes the built-in a off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

1.9 లేదు (lēdu) — “no,” where Telugu parts ways with its sisters

The partner of *avunu* — and a small surprise. Tamil, Kannada, and Malayalam all say “no” with a word built on *il-* (*illai / illa*). Telugu does **not**: it goes its own way with *lēdu*.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Telugu.*)

- లే = “lē” — ల (la) with the long-“ē” vowel sign.
- దు = “du” — ద (da) with the “u” sign.

Left to right: లే · దు = *lē-du* →

లేదు = *lēdu*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

లేదు (*lēdu*) means “**there is not, it is absent.**” It is native Dravidian, but built on a **different root** (*lē-*, absence) from the *il-* of Tamil and Kannada. Telugu also has కాదు (*kādu*), “it is **not** [that]” — so Telugu splits “no” into two:

- **lēdu** — denies **existence** (“there isn’t”): *pustakam lēdu*, “there is no book.”
- **kādu** — denies **identity** (“it isn’t [that]”): *idi pustakam kādu*, “this is not a book.”

Across the family — the same idea, five ways:

Language	“No / isn’t”	Note
Telugu	<i>lēdu</i> / <i>kādu</i> (లేదు / కాదు)	native, but a different root (<i>lē-</i> , <i>kā-</i>)
Tamil	<i>illai</i> (இல்லை)	native, root <i>il-</i>
Kannada	<i>illa</i> (ಇಲ್ಲ)	native, root <i>il-</i>
Malayalam	<i>illa</i> (ഇല്ല)	native, root <i>il-</i>
Hindi	<i>nahīnī</i> (नहीं)	Indo-European (unrelated)

Three sisters share *il-*; Telugu alone picked *lē-* / *kā-*. Same family, not a uniform one — a reminder that Dravidian has real internal branches.

Grammar Lens: two “no”s, existence vs. identity

English leans on one flat “no.” Telugu — carefully — keeps **two negatives**: *lēdu* for “there isn’t / doesn’t exist,” *kādu* for “is not [the thing you said].” Choosing between them is choosing *what* you’re denying. (This two-way negative is a Dravidian trait; Tamil has an echo of it too, but Telugu draws the line most sharply — and with a different root-word from its sisters.)

The letters in this word

లే is *lē* (ల *la* with the long-“ē” sign); దు is *du*. Read లే · దు → *lēdu*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *lē* · *du* → “*lēdu*”
- the pair — *avunu* (“yes”) / *lēdu* (“no”)
- the two no’s — *pustakam lēdu* (“no book”) vs. *idi pustakam kādu* (“this isn’t a book”)

Before you move on

Read లేదు. What does it deny — existence or identity? (Existence — “there isn’t”; *kādu* denies identity.) How does Telugu’s “no”

differ from Tamil's and Kannada's? (Different root: *lē-* / *kā-*, not the shared *il-*.)

1.10 సరి (sarē) — “okay,” the family word in Telugu dress

The easy middle between “yes” and “no”: “okay, alright, fine.” It’s the same Dravidian word you’d meet as *sari* in Tamil and Kannada — Telugu just rounds it off to *sarē*.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Telugu.*)

- స = “sa.”
- రి = “rē” — ర (ra) with the **long-“ē” vowel sign** (the same sign you met on *lē* in *lēdu*).

Left to right: స · రి = *sa-rē* →

సరి = **sarē** = “okay / alright.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

సరి (*sarē*) is native Dravidian “correct, right → okay, agreed” — the verbal nod of Telugu. It is the same family word as Kannada ಸರಿ and Tamil சரி (*sari*), worn to *sarē* in Telugu. Say it once to agree; say *sarē sarē* to mean “yes yes, fine, enough.”

Grammar Lens: one Dravidian word, three scripts

sari / *sarē* is a clean demonstration of family closeness: essentially one word, one meaning, dressed in three different scripts — Tamil, Kannada, Telugu. As you learn to read each, spotting a shared word shift its shape but not its sense is the quickest way to feel the relationship (and the whole reason to learn these four side by side).

The letters in this word

స is *sa*; రే is *rē* (ర *ra* with the long-“ē” sign you just met on *lē*). Read
స · రే → *sarē*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sa* · *rē* → “*sarē*”
- the everyday triple — *avunu* (yes) · *lēdu* (no) · *sarē* (okay)
- “*sarē sarē*” — “alright, alright”

Before you move on

Read సరే. What does it mean, and what is its Tamil/Kannada twin? (“Okay, agreed”; *sari*.) Which vowel sign does *rē* share with *lēdu*? (The long-“ē” sign.)

1.11 ే — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ే — what does it do?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ే

ే — ē.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ē*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ే somewhere inside it:

- లేదు *lēdu* — no / there isn’t (*lēdu*)
- సరే *sarē* — okay / alright (*sarē*)

Writing: ే — copy what you see

Put your pen on ే and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ే in the ones that have it

లేదు · సరే · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ే three times, saying ē as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ే once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ే? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts ē on; takes the built-in a off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

1.12 Chapter 1 — a five-word recap

Five words, and a first handful of Telugu letters read straight off the page. Let's gather only what you have already learned and make it feel easy.

The exchange — read them back

Sound each out, left to right, before checking:

Read		Meaning	Origin
నమస్కారం	<i>namaskāram</i>	hello / greetings	Sanskrit
ధన్యవాదములు	<i>dhanyavādamulu</i>	thank you	Sanskrit stem + Telugu plural
అవును	<i>avunu</i>	yes	native
లేదు	<i>lēdu</i>	no / there isn't	native (root <i>lē-</i> , not <i>il-</i>)
సరే	<i>sarē</i>	okay	native (= <i>sari</i>)

The letters that did it: consonants carry a built-in “a” (many under the little *talakattu* hat); a **vowel sign** swaps that vowel (అ ā, ఁ u, ఌ ē); a **virama** lets a consonant **stack below** the next as a conjunct (స్క్ర); a dot **anusvāra** (ం) adds a final nasal; and a word-initial vowel gets a **full letter** (అ).

The now-familiar pattern: the two **greeting/politeness** words are Sanskrit; the three **everyday grammar** words are native — though Telugu’s “no” (*lēdu*) takes a *different* native root from its sisters’ *il-*.

Why it’s said this way

Telugu has a warm departure exchange built around going and coming back. It belongs in the later chapter where you learn those actions one at a time. For now, repeating the greeting is enough when you part.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all five — namaskāram · dhanyavādamulu · avunu · lēdu · sarē
- greet and thank — “namaskāram!” ... “dhanyavādamulu.”

Before you move on

Read all five aloud. Which two are Sanskrit, which three native? (Sanskrit: *namaskāram*, *dhanyavādamulu*. Native: *avunu*, *lēdu*, *sarē*.) How does Telugu’s “no” differ from its sisters’? (Different root — *lē-* / *kā-*, not *il-*.) Which word means “okay”? (*sarē*.) Next chapter starts introducing yourself, one short possession form at a time.

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 👁️ eyes (4) ✍️ pen (10) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 18 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can introduce myself in Telugu, give my name, and understand the other person’s name.

A first real exchange — give your name, ask for someone else’s, say you are glad to meet them. Built the same way as the greetings: each piece taken apart, its letters and its root, then assembled. నా పేరు అరుణ్. / మీ పేరు ఏమిటి?

2.1 పేరు (pēru) — “name,” the native Dravidian word

“Name” — native Dravidian, even in Sanskrit-loving Telugu.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Telugu.) ప (pa) + ే (the ē-sign) → పే (pē); రు (ru). Read పే · రు → pēru.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

పేరు (pēru, “name”) is **native Dravidian**, from Proto-Dravidian *pēr — the same word as Tamil *peyar* and Malayalam *pēr*, and a cousin of Kannada *hesaru* (which softened *p* → *h*). It is *not* Sanskrit *nāma* (Hindi *nām*, English *name*). Even Telugu — the most Sanskritised of the Dravidian tongues — kept its home-grown word for “name.”

Across the family — the same idea, six ways:

Language	“Name”	Source
Telugu	పేరు <i>pēru</i>	native Dravidian (*pēr)
Tamil	<i>peyar</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root
Malayalam	<i>pēr</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root
Kannada	<i>hesaru</i>	Dravidian (*pesar, <i>p</i> → <i>h</i>)
Hindi	<i>nām</i>	Sanskrit (Indo-European)
English	<i>name</i>	Indo-European

Four Dravidian tongues, one inherited word — even Kannada’s *hesaru*, once you know the old *p* went soft. Only the last two rows come from somewhere else.

The letters in this word

ప (*pa*) + ే (the *ē*-sign) → పే (*pē*); రు (*ru*). Read పే · రు → *pēru*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “pēru”
- its Dravidian cousins — *pēru* / *peyar* / *pēr*

Before you move on

Is పేరు native or a Sanskrit loan, and what Tamil word is its twin?
(Native Dravidian, **pēr*; Tamil *peyar*.)

2.2 స — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ే — what does it do?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: న

న — *na*.

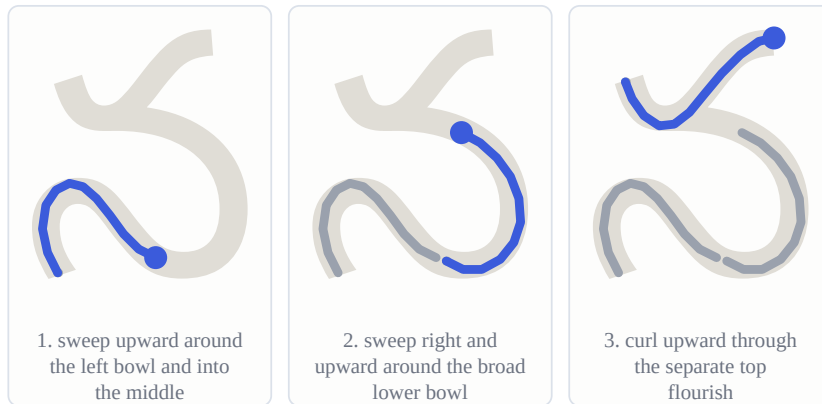
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *n*, it is **na**.

You already say these, and every one of them has న somewhere inside it:

- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)
- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
- అవును *avunu* — yes (avunu)

Writing: న — three gentle sweeps

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant న packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_4_5_na.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_4_5_na.png, movements 1–3 (version 2.6)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How న is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 sweeps up around the left bowl and into the middle. Lift, then movement

2 travels right around the broad lower bowl and rises along its outer edge. Lift once more for movement 3, the small rising flourish above.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the three clear movements instead of closing the small gaps.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find న in the ones that have it

నమస్కారం · ధన్యవాదములు · లేదు

- *Trace it:* న three times, saying *na* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find న once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — న? What sound does it carry? (*na.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

2.3 నా (nā) — “my”

“My” — native Dravidian, no European cousin.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Telugu.*) న (na) + ా (long ā) → నా (nā).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

నా (nā) means “my.” It belongs to Telugu’s native Dravidian first-person family, not to the Indo-European family behind English *I/my*. You will meet the related word for “I” in its own lesson; today you only need *nā*.

The letters in this word

న (na) + ా (long ā) → నా (nā).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nā”
- *nā* once with its meaning, “my”

Before you move on

What does నా mean? (“My.”) Is it native Dravidian or an Indo-European loan? (Native Dravidian.)

2.4 ం — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: న — what does it do? And one from further back: క?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ం

ం — *u*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *u*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ం somewhere inside it:

- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
- అవును *avunu* — yes (avunu)
- లేదు *lēdu* — no / there isn’t (lēdu)
- పేరు *pēru* — name

Writing: ு — copy what you see

Put your pen on ு and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ு in the ones that have it
ధన్యవాదములు · అవును · నమస్కారం
- *Trace it:* ு three times, saying *u* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ு once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ு? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *u* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

2.5 నా పేరు ... (nā pēru ...) — “my name is...,” with no “is”

Assemble the two atoms — and note, as in Tamil and Kannada, no word for “is.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- nā (my) + pēru (name) + your name.

నా పేరు ... = “my name ...” → “**my name is...**”

Nā pēru Arun. → “My name is Arun.”

Grammar Lens: the zero copula

There is **no verb**. Telugu sets “my name” beside “Arun” and lets the “is” be understood — the **zero copula** of the Dravidian family. *Nā pēru Arun* = literally “my name Arun.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nā pēru ...” with your name
- notice — no word for “is”

Before you move on

Give your name in Telugu. (*Nā pēru ...*) What does Telugu leave out that English needs? (The verb “is” — zero copula.)

2.6 ఓ — the Telugu numeral for 1

Before the new one: ఓ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఏ?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: ఓ

Telugu writes its numbers twice. The digits you already use — 1, 2, 3 — are everywhere in modern Telugu, on price tags and phone screens. Beside them the language keeps **its own ten numerals**, and they have never gone away: they number the pages of Telugu books, they date the almanac, and they are painted on buses and doorplates.

ఓ is **one**.

You do not need a Telugu word for it yet. A numeral is read as a quantity, not as a sound, which is why this ladder can start here: the shape can be learned months before the word for it arrives.

Writing: ఠ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ఠ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

ఠ

- *Trace it:* ఠ three times, saying “1” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for ఠ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ఠ? What amount does it stand for? (ఠ and 1 mean the same thing.)

2.7 నువ్వు / మీరు (nuvvu / mīru) — “you,” familiar and respectful

“You” — respect made the same way as Tamil, Kannada, and French.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Telugu.) నువ్వు (nuvvu); మీరు (mīru) = మీ (mī) + రు (ru).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

నువ్వు (*nuvvu*, familiar “you”) traces to Proto-Dravidian ***nīn** — the same native root as Tamil *nī* and Kannada *nīnu*. మీరు (*mīru*) is the respectful/plural “you.”

Grammar Lens: respect by the plural

nuvvu (familiar) vs. *mīru* (respectful, and literally plural) — the same politeness-by-plural as Tamil *nīṅgal*, Kannada *nīvu*, and French *vous*. For a first meeting, **mīru**.

The letters in this word

నువ్వు (*nuvvu*); మీరు (*mīru*, మీ *mī* + రు *ru*).

Your turn

- *Say it*: “nuvvu” (familiar), “mīru” (respectful)

Before you move on

How does Telugu make “you” respectful, and which languages share the trick? (By the plural — *mīru*; Tamil *nīṅgal*, Kannada *nīvu*, French *vous*.)

2.8 ీ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ు — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ీ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ీ

ీ — *no sound of its own — it takes one away.*

It is a **vowel-killer**. Every consonant in this script arrives with an *a* already inside it — that is what an abugida is. This mark takes the *a* back,

leaving the bare consonant. It is how the script writes two consonants in a row.

You already say these, and every one of them has ీ somewhere inside it:

- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)
- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
- నువ్వు / మీరు *nuvvu / mīru* — you (familiar / respectful)

Writing: ీ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ీ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ీ in the ones that have it

నమస్కారం · ధన్యవాదములు · అవును

- *Trace it:* ీ three times, and each time say what it does: **it kills the built-in a**
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ీ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ీ? What does it do to the consonant it sits on? (**Takes away the built-in a.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

2.9 ఏమిటి (ēmiṭi) — “what”

The last piece of the question: “what.”

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Telugu.*) ఏ (independent long ē) + మి (mi) + టి (ṭi, retroflex) → ēmiṭi.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ఏమిటి (ēmiṭi, “what”) is native Dravidian, on the interrogative stem *yā-/e- — the same Dravidian question-root as Tamil *eṇṇa* and Kannada *ēnu*, heading Telugu’s question family: *ēmiṭi* (what), *evaru* (who), *ekkaḍa* (where), *enduku* (why).

The letters in this word

ఏ (independent long ē) + మి (mi) + టి (ṭi, retroflex) → ēmiṭi.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ēmiṭi”
- the question family — ēmiṭi, evaru, ekkāḍa

Before you move on

What Dravidian stem heads ఏమిటి and the other Telugu question-words? (*yā-/e-, same as Tamil *eṇṇa*, Kannada *ēnu*.)

2.10 ట — the curled t, in the question from this chapter

Say the word for *what*. Listen to the consonant in the middle and notice where your tongue goes for it.

Script you'll notice: ట

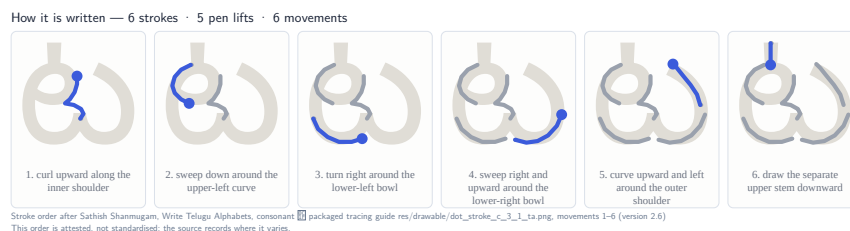
ట — *ṭa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *ṭ*, it is **ṭa**.

- ఏమిటి *ēmiṭi* — what (ēmiṭi)

The tongue curls back to the roof of the mouth for this one. English has a single *t* and lets the mouth decide where to put it; Telugu has two, and they are different letters. The dot under the *ṭ* in the romanization is the only warning you get there — on the page the two shapes are nothing alike, which is easier.

Writing: ట — six deliberate movements



How ట is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movement 1 curls up the inner shoulder. Movements 2–5 travel around the broad outer body in four sections. Finish with movement 6, the separate short stem above.

This is one attested school-style order. Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the six directions clear and let the rounded shape grow from them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the word below and find ట in it

ఏమిటి

- *Trace it:* ట once, following all six numbered movements
- *Copy:* ట twice without tracing, saying *ṭa* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* where your tongue goes for it, against where it goes for a plain *t*

- *Look:* back at the greeting chapter and find మ and ధ once each

Before you move on

Which character is this — ట? What sound does it carry? (*ta.*)

Which word from this chapter contains it? (ఏమిటి.)

2.11 ఏ — the sign you know, as a letter

Two from before: ి — what does it do to the consonant it sits on? And అ — why does that one need no mark?

Today the two ideas meet.

Script you'll notice: ఏ

ఏ — ē.

It is an **independent vowel** — a vowel that is a letter in its own right, not a mark hung on a consonant.

You have read ి, the long-ē sign, since the first chapter. It rides on a consonant and needs one to exist. **ఏ is that same vowel with nothing in front of it.**

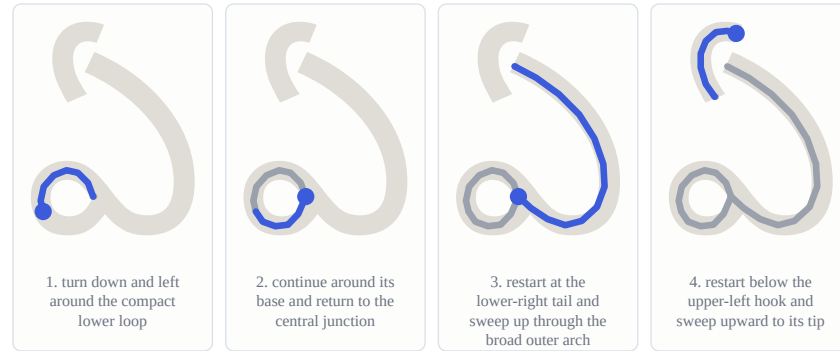
This is the pattern behind every vowel in the script. A vowel has two written forms — a sign for when a consonant carries it, a letter for when the vowel opens the word. అ was the odd one out because its sign is the absence of any sign at all; ఏ is the ordinary case, and from here you can expect the pair everywhere.

- ఏమిటి *ēmiti* — what?

The question word you have been saying opens on today's letter, and the *i* inside it is carried by a sign. One word, both forms.

Writing: య — copy what you see

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, independent vowel య packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_v_10_ae.png, movements 1–4 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How య is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on య and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the word below and find య at its front

యమిటి

- *Trace it:* య three times, saying ē as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which form of a vowel goes at the front of a word, the sign or the letter

Before you move on

Which character is this — డ? What sound does it carry? (ē.) When does Telugu write the letter డ rather than the sign ి? (**When the vowel has no consonant in front of it.**) And which vowel met so far has a letter but no sign? (అ.)

2.12 ట — the Telugu numeral for 2

Before the new one: ి — what does it do? And one from further back: డ?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you'll notice: ట

ట is **two**.

Two numerals now, and that is enough for the first real reading skill: telling them apart. A digit is never met alone on a page — it is met in a row of other digits, and the work is picking the one you want out of the row.

Writing: ట — **copy what you see**

Put your pen on ట and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

౧ · ట

- *Trace it:* ట three times, saying “2” as you finish each one

- *Look:* for ౨ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ౨? What amount does it stand for? (౨ is 2, and ౧ beside it is 1.)

2.13 మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? (mī pēru ēmiṭi?) — “what’s your name?”

Assemble the question — your + name + what — still no “is.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- మీ (*mī*, “your”) = the possessive of *mīru* (“you,” respectful).

మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? = literally “**your name what?**” =
“what’s your name?”

Three words, **no verb** — the zero copula holds for questions too.

Grammar Lens: answer, and the familiar version

Answer with the sentence you built: **Nā pēru Arun.** The familiar “your” is *nī* (from *nuvvu*): *nī pēru ēmiṭi?*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “mī pēru ēmiṭi?”
- ask, then answer — “mī pēru ēmiṭi?” / “nā pēru ...”

Before you move on

What does మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? literally say, and what’s missing vs. English? (“Your name what?”; no “is” — zero copula.)

2.14 ీ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ు — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ూ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ీ

ీ — *i*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *i*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ీ somewhere inside it:

- మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? *mī pēru ēmiṭi?* — what is your name?
- ఏమిటి *ēmiṭi* — what

Writing: ీ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ీ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ీ in the ones that have it
 ఏమిటి · మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? · నమస్కారం
- *Trace it:* ీ three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ీ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ీ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *i* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

2.15 సంతోషం (santōṣam) — “joy,” and “pleased to meet you”

The warm close — and, as in Kannada, a Sanskrit word.

You’ll want to know: the full phrase

The full form is మిమ్మల్ని కలిసినందుకు సంతోషం (*mimmalni kalisinanduku santōṣam*) — “joy at having met you.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

సంతోషం (*santōṣam*, “joy, gladness”) is **Sanskrit** — *sam-* (“fully”) + *toṣa* (“satisfaction”) — the *same* loan Kannada uses (*santōṣa*). Both reach for Sanskrit where Tamil keeps its native *magilcci*. Telugu — the most Sanskritised of the four Dravidian tongues — does so most readily of all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “santōṣam”
- the split — Telugu/Kannada *santōṣa(m)* (Sanskrit) vs. Tamil *magilcci* (native)

Before you move on

Is సంతోషం native or borrowed, and what does the contrast with Tamil show? (Sanskrit; Telugu borrows Sanskrit — here for “pleased” — where Tamil keeps native *magilcci*.)

2.16 ె — a sign, not a letter

Before the new one: ె — what does it do to the consonant it sits on?

This one does the same job with a different vowel.

Script you'll notice: ె

ె — $\bar{o}$.

It is a **sign**, not a letter. A Telugu consonant arrives with an *a* already inside it, and a sign is how you swap that *a* for something else. On its own it says nothing; hung on a consonant it turns that consonant's vowel into a long $\bar{o}$.

- సంతోషం *santōṣam* — happiness, gladness (santōṣam — “a being well pleased”)

Look at the middle of that word: the త carries the sign, and *ta* becomes *tō*.

Writing: ె — copy what you see

Put your pen on ె and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed. Then write it again attached to a consonant, the way it actually appears.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the word below and find the consonant carrying ె
సంతోషం
- *Trace it:* ె three times, saying $\bar{o}$ as you finish each one
- *Say it:* what the sign does to the consonant underneath it
- *Look:* at ఏమిటి again and name the curled letter in it

Before you move on

Is ூ a letter or a sign? (A sign.) What does it do? (It swaps the consonant's built-in *a* for a long *ō*.) Can it stand on its own? (No.)

2.17 ூ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ூ — what does it do? And one from further back: ூ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ூ

ூ — *a nasal, ridden on the syllable before it.*

It is a **nasal**, written as a mark rather than as a letter. It rides on the syllable before it and turns the end of it nasal.

You already say these, and every one of them has ூ somewhere inside it:

- సంతోషం — joy / pleased to meet you
- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)

Writing: ூ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ூ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ె in the ones that have it

నమస్కారం · సంతోషం · ధన్యవాదములు

- *Trace it:* ె three times, humming the nasal at the end of the syllable as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ె once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ె? What does it add to the syllable before it? (**A nasal.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

2.18 Chapter 2 — the introduction, whole

No new words. Everything you have met in this chapter, said once through as the exchange it was always for.

The exchange — the dialogue

Telugu	English
నా పేరు మీరా. (<i>nā pēru Mira</i>)	My name is Mira.
మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? (<i>mī pēru ēmiṭi</i>)	What’s your name?
నా పేరు అను. (<i>nā pēru Anu</i>)	My name is Anu.
సంతోషం. (<i>santōṣam</i>)	Pleased to meet you.

Every atom traced:

- **pēru** ← Dravidian **pēr* (*not name*; twin of Tamil *peyar*)
- **nā** ← *nēnu* (“I”)
- **ēmiṭi** ← Dravidian question-stem **yā-/e-*
- **santōṣam** ← **Sanskrit** (Telugu borrows for “pleased”; Tamil keeps native *magilcci*)

The Telugu habit: the **zero copula** (no “is”).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- your own introduction — “nā pēru ...”
- ask it back — “mī pēru ēmiṭi?”

Before you move on

Give your name, ask someone else’s, say you’re pleased. (*Nā pēru ...* / *Mī pēru ēmiṭi?* / *Santōṣam.*) Which word is Sanskrit, not native? (*santōṣam.*)

Next chapter: *elā unnāru?* (“how are you?”) and answering with *bāgunnānu* — the responding cycle.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 👁️ eyes (5) ✍️ pen (6) 🗣️ Hands-free start: none of the 12 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask how someone is in Telugu, answer naturally, and return the question.

After the name comes the exchange everyone actually has — and, for the first time, a Telugu verb “to be.” మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? / నేను బాగున్నాను, ధన్యవాదములు.

3.1 3 — the Telugu numeral for 3

Before the new one: ౧౦ — what does it do? And one from further back: ౧?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: 3

3 is three.

Three of the ten. Read the row below left to right and say the values out loud in your own language — **one, two, three**. Saying the value rather than a Telugu word is not a shortcut around the language; it is what a numeral is for.

Writing: ౩ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ౩ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

౧ · ౨ · ౩

- *Trace it:* ౩ three times, saying “3” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for ౩ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ౩? What amount does it stand for? (౩ is 3.)

3.2 ఎలా (elā) — “how,” another of the e-questions

You met ఏమిటి (*ēmiti*, “what”) in Chapter 2. Here is its sibling — and, like all of Telugu’s question-words, it begins with e-.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Telugu.*) ఎ (independent short e) + లా (*lā, la* + the long-ā sign) → ఎలా (*elā*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ఎలా (*elā*, “how”) is native Dravidian, on the interrogative base ఎ- (*e-*) you already met in *ēmiṭi*. Telugu gathers nearly all its questions under this *e-*: *ēmiṭi* (what), *elā* (how), *evaru* (who), *ekkaḍa* (where), *eppuḍu* (when), *enduku* (why). It is the same Dravidian question-root that heads Tamil’s *eppaḍi* and Kannada’s *ēnu* — a family older than the Sanskrit words that Telugu otherwise borrows so freely.

The letters in this word

ఎ (independent short *e*) + లా (*lā*) → ఎలా (*elā*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*elā*”
- the *e-* question family — *ēmiṭi*, *elā*, *evaru*, *ekkaḍa*, *eppuḍu*

Before you move on

What base do Telugu’s question-words share, and which cousins head their own? (The interrogative *e-*; Tamil’s *eppaḍi*, Kannada’s *ēnu*.)

3.3 మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? (*mīru elā unnāru?*)

The everyday “how are you?” — and the verb “to be” that carries it.

The letters in this word

The new word is ఉన్నారు (*unnāru*, “you are/exist”): from the verb *uṇḍu* (“to be, to exist, to stay”) + the respectful-you ending -ఱు (*-āru*). Note the doubled న్న (*nn*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? = మీరు (*mīru*, “you,” respectful) + ఎలా (*elā*, “how”) + ఉన్నారు (*unnāru*, “are”) — “you how are?”, the verb **last**, as

in every Telugu sentence. The verb is *uṇḍu*, “to be / to exist / to stay” — native Dravidian, and the workhorse behind “how are you,” “I’m well,” and (you’ll see in Chapter 5) “I live.”

Grammar Lens: the verb carries “you”

The ending -*āru* (-*āru*) already means “you (respectful),” so *mīru* can be dropped: *elā unnāru?* is a complete “how are you?” To a friend (*nuvvu*), the ending changes: *నువ్వు ఎలా ఉన్నావు?* (*nuvvu elā unnāvu?* — *-āvu* for the familiar “you”). Match the “you” to the verb-ending, as Telugu always does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the respectful question — *mīru elā unnāru?*
- the familiar version — *nuvvu elā unnāvu?*
- the verb and its meaning (*uṇḍu* — “to be / exist / stay”)

Before you move on

What verb powers “how are you?”, and how does the ending change for a friend? (*Uṇḍu*, “to be”; *-āru* → *-āvu* for the familiar *nuvvu*.)

3.4 ఉ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ౩ — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ౨?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ఉ

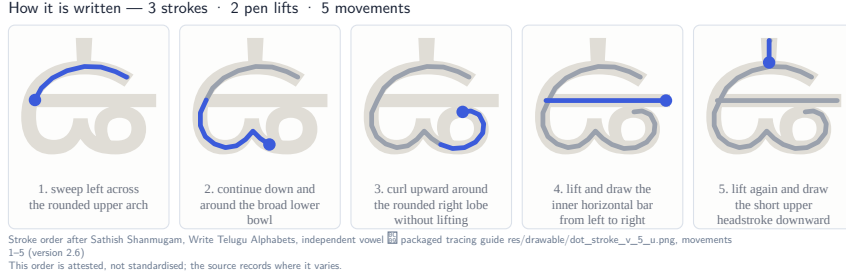
ఉ — *u*.

It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *u* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

You met it on the page before this one, standing at the front of a word:

- మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? — how are you? (respectful)

Writing: ఉ — copy what you see



How ఉ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ఉ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ఉ in the ones that have it

మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ఉ three times, saying *u* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ఉ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఉ? What sound does it carry? (*u*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

3.5 నేను (nēnu) — “I,” the Dravidian first person

To answer “how are you?” you first need “I.” In Chapter 2 you learned *nā* (“my”); here is its owner.

The letters in this word

నే (nē, *na* + long-*ē* sign) + ను (nu) → నేను (nēnu).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

నేను (nēnu, “I”) ← Proto-Dravidian ***yān** / ***nēn** — native, and (unlike Hindi’s *maini*, cousin of English *me*) **not** related to the European “I/me” family. Its possessive is the నా (nā, “my”) you already met: nēnu “I,” nā “my.” For all that Telugu borrows Sanskrit vocabulary elsewhere, its most basic pronouns stayed Dravidian to the core — the grammar’s foundations never changed hands.

Grammar Lens: “I” you can drop

Telugu verbs carry the person in their ending — *unnānu* already means “I am” — so *nēnu* is often left out. You still learn it first, because the answer to *elā unnāru?* begins with it.

The letters in this word

నే (nē) + ను (nu) → నేను (nēnu).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nēnu”
- the pair — *nēnu* (I), *nā* (my)
- is it related to English *me*? (No — native Dravidian)

Before you move on

What is *nēnu*’s possessive, and is Telugu’s “I” cousin to English *me*? (*Nā*, “my”; no — it is native Dravidian, unlike the borrowed Sanskrit nouns around it.)

3.6 ఓ — the Telugu numeral for 4

Before the new one: ఱ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఱ?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you'll notice: ఓ

ఓ is **four**.

From here the row is deliberately shuffled. A digit you can only read in counting order is a digit you cannot read; the test is whether you know it when it turns up out of sequence.

Writing: ఓ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ఓ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

ఓ · ౨ · ౩ · ౦

- *Trace it:* ఓ three times, saying “4” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for ఓ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ఓ? What amount does it stand for? (ఓ is 4.)

One more, from much earlier: ఱ — what does it do?

3.7 బాగా (bāgā) — “well,” and how to answer

The word that answers “how are you?” — and one Telugu says all the time.

The letters in this word

బా (bā, ba + long ā) + గా (gā, ga + long ā) → బాగా (bāgā).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

బాగా (bāgā, “well, nicely, very”) comes from బాగు (bāgu, “goodness, well-being”). It is the everyday “well/good/very much”: *bāgā undi* (“it’s good”), *bāgā ceppāru* (“well said”). To answer “how are you,” fuse it with the *unḍu* verb:

నేను బాగున్నాను (nēnu bāgunnānu) — “I am well” (bāgā + unnānu, “I am,” run together).

The whole exchange:

— *mīru elā unnāru?* (“How are you?”) — *nēnu bāgunnānu, dhanyavādamulu.* (“I’m well, thank you.”)

The letters in this word

బా (bā) + గా (gā) → బాగా (bāgā).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “bāgā”
- the full reply — *nēnu bāgunnānu*
- add thanks (from Chapter 1) — *dhanyavādamulu*

Before you move on

Give the full reply to *mīru elā unnāru?*. (*Nēnu bāgunnānu* — bāgā “well” fused with *unnānu* “I am.”)

3.8 బ — the letter your answer starts with

Say how you are. Then say the one word inside that answer that means “well.” It starts on your two lips, closed and then opened.

Script you’ll notice: బ

బ — *ba*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *b*, it is **ba**.

The word from the warm-up opens with it:

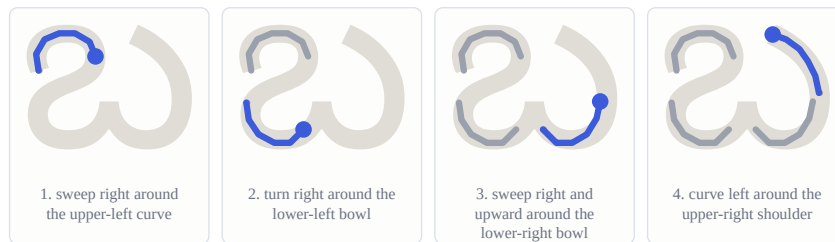
- బాగా *bāgā* — well, fine
- బాగున్నాను *bāgunnānu* — I am well

Both start with బ carrying the long-*ā* sign you have been reading since the greeting. The shape underneath that sign is today’s character.

Telugu gives *b* a letter of its own, and Tamil does not. Tamil writes one letter, ப, for the sound at the front of *pattu* (“ten”) and for the sound in the middle of தம்பி *tambi* (“younger brother”), and lets the place in the word decide which one you say. Telugu, Kannada and Hindi each keep బ / బ / ब apart from their *p* letter and spell the difference out. That is one of the sharpest splits between the two halves of this family, and you are meeting it on a page from chapter three.

Writing: బ — four calm movements

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant బ packaged tracing guides
 res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_5_3_ba.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_5_3_ba.png, movements 1–4 (version 2.6)
 This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How బ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 rises around the upper-left curve. Lift, then movement 2 turns around the lower-left bowl. Movement 3 sweeps right and rises around the lower-right bowl. Lift once more; movement 4 curves left around the upper-right shoulder.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the four calm movements and the small spaces between them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words, and find బ at the front of each

బాగా · బాగున్నాను

- *Trace it:* బ three times, saying *ba* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* whether the mark leaning on బ in both words is the same one

Before you move on

Which character is this — బ? What sound does it carry? (*ba*.)
Which word in this chapter begins with it? (బాగా — and its longer answer form బాగున్నాను.) Does Tamil have a separate letter for this sound? (No — it writes ూ and lets the place in the word decide.)

3.9 ఠ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఠ — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ఠఠ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ఠ

ఠ — *ra*.

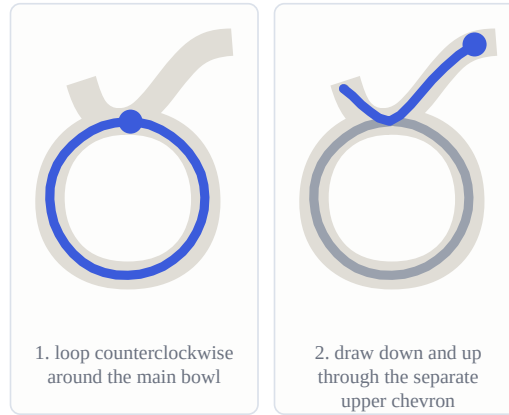
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *r*, it is **ra**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ఠ somewhere inside it:

- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)
- సరే *sarē* — okay / alright (sarē)
- పేరు *pēru* — name
- నువ్వు / మీరు *nuvvu / mīru* — you (familiar / respectful)

Writing: ఓ — two calm movements

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 mov



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant ఓ animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_ఓ in version 3.8.05 (3805)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ఓ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 loops counterclockwise around the main bowl. Lift; movement 2 travels down and up through the separate upper chevron, from left to right.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the two movements clear and make the short lift between them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ఓ in the ones that have it

నమస్కారం · సరే · ధన్యవాదములు

- *Trace it:* ర three times, saying *ra* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ర once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ర? What sound does it carry? (*ra.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.
One more, from much earlier: ఱ — what does it do?

3.10 పరవాలేదు (paravālēdu) — “no problem”

When someone thanks you — or apologises — this is the easy, gracious reply, and it is built on a word you met in Chapter 1.

The letters in this word

Two joined words: పరవా (*paravā*, “harm, concern”) + లేదు (*lēdu*, “there is not”) → పరవాలేదు (*paravālēdu*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

పరవాలేదు literally means “**there is no harm**” — *paravā* (“harm, concern”) + *లేదు* (*lēdu*, “is-not / there-is-not”), the Chapter-1 negative. It serves as “it’s okay / no worries / never mind / you’re welcome.” The key atom, *లేదు* (*lēdu*), is where Telugu goes its own way: Tamil, Kannada, and Malayalam all say *illa(i)* for “is-not,” but **Telugu alone** uses *లేదు* (*lēdu*) — so Tamil’s “no problem” is *paravāyillai*, and Telugu’s is *paravālēdu*, the same idea built on each language’s own “not.” One phrase shows both the Dravidian bond and the one place Telugu breaks from its sisters.

Grammar Lens: లేదు, Telugu’s “is-not”

Lēdu negates existence: *ḍabbu lēdu* (“there’s no money”), *ēmī lēdu* (“it’s nothing”). It is the negative twin of ఉంది (*undi*, “there is”) and of the *unḍu* verb behind “how are you.” Learn *undi* / *lēdu* together — “there is” and “there is not.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “paravālēdu”
- what it literally means (“there is no harm”)
- the Telugu “is-not” that sets it apart from Tamil (*lēdu*, vs. Tamil *illai*)

Before you move on

What does *paravālēdu* literally say, and how does its “not” differ from Tamil’s? (“There is no harm”; Telugu uses *lēdu* where Tamil/Kannada/Malayalam use *illa(i)*.)

3.11 ఌ — the Telugu numeral for 5

Before the new one: ఌ — what does it do? And one from further back: ౩?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: ఌ

ఌ is five.

Half the set. Everything the book has shown you so far is on the row below, in no order at all.

Writing: ఌ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ఌ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

౫ · ౩ · ౧ · ౪ · ౨

- *Trace it:* ౫ three times, saying “5” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for ౫ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ౫? What amount does it stand for? (౫ is 5.)

One more, from much earlier: ౫ — what does it do?

3.12 Chapter 3 — The how-are-you exchange

No new words. The whole responding cycle, from atoms you now own.

The exchange

Read the whole cycle off the page first — Telugu, then the sound, then the sense:

Telugu		English
మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు?	<i>mīru elā unnāru</i>	How are you?
నేను బాగున్నాను, ధన్యవాదములు.	<i>nēnu bāgunnānu, dhanyavādamulu</i>	I’m well, thank you.
పరవాలేదు.	<i>paravālēdu</i>	No problem / you’re welcome.

A few of these characters have not had their own lesson yet. They are here to be **recognised**, not decoded — the romanization beside each line is what you read from. The letters catch up in the chapters ahead.

Say these aloud:

- “How are you?” (respectful) — *mīru elā unnāru?*
- “I’m well, thank you.” — *nēnu bāgunnānu, dhanyavādamulu.*

- “No problem / you’re welcome.” — *paravālēdu*.
- the familiar version of the question — *nuvvu elā unnāvu?*

What you’ve built — the atoms

Say these aloud:

- the *e*- question-word for “how” (*elā*)
- “I” and the verb “to be” (*nēnu*, *uṇḍu*)
- the “there is / there is not” pair (*undi* / *lēdu*)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Roots you now carry:

- *elā* ← the interrogative *e*- (native Dravidian, like Tamil *eppaḍi*)
- *nēnu* ← Proto-Dravidian (unrelated to English *me*); possessive *nā*
- *bāgā* ← *bāgu* “goodness”; *nēnu bāgunnānu* “I’m well”
- *lēdu* — Telugu’s “is-not,” where its sisters use *illa(i)*

Before you move on

A stranger asks *mīru elā unnāru?* — give a full, polite reply, and answer their thanks. (*Nēnu bāgunnānu*, *dhanyavādamulu* — and to thanks, *paravālēdu*.)

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) 👁 eyes (5) ✍ pen (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 10 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can end a Telugu conversation politely and choose a farewell that fits the situation.

Telugu, like every Dravidian language, does not say a plain “goodbye.” It promises to return: వెళ్ళి వస్తాను — “having gone, I come back.”

4.1 డప్పు (ḍappu) — a drum

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You’ll want to know: డప్పు

డప్పు — ḍappu — “a drum”.

Say it: ḍappu. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, డ, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ḍappu
- ḍappu, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a drum”? (డప్పు, *dappu*.)

4.2 డ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఌ — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ఉ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: డ

డ — *ḍa*.

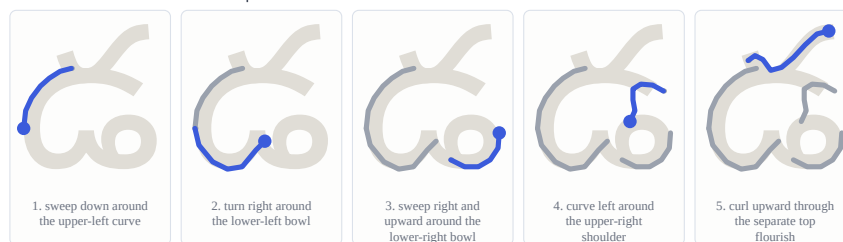
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *ḍ*, it is **ḍa**.

You met it on an earlier page, in the middle of a word you already say:

- మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? — how are you? (respectful)

Writing: డ — five deliberate movements

How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant డ packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_3_3_da.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_3_3_da.png, movements 1-5 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How డ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movement 1 sweeps down around the upper-left curve. Movement 2 turns right around the lower-left bowl. Movement 3 restarts and sweeps right and upward around the lower-right bowl. Movement 4 curves left around the upper-right shoulder. Movement 5 finishes with the separate top flourish.

This is one attested school-style order. Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the five movements distinct and let the round shape grow from them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find డ in the ones that have it

మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* డ three times, saying *ḍa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find డ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — డ? What sound does it carry? (*ḍa*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.
One more, from much earlier: న — what does it do?

4.3 వెళ్ళు (*veḷḷu*) — “go,” and vaccu (come)

Two everyday verbs — and together they make the Telugu goodbye.

The letters in this word

వె (*ve*) + ళ్ళు (*ḷḷu*, a doubled retroflex శ *ḷ*) → వెళ్ళు (*veḷḷu*). Its partner: *vaccu* (“come”) with a doubled *cc*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

వెళ్ళు (*veḷḷu*, “to go”) and *vaccu* (“to come”) are native Dravidian verbs. As commands they are whole words: *veḷḷu!* (“go!”), *rā!* (“come!”). You need both, because Telugu — like every Dravidian language — does not say a plain “goodbye.” It says “I go, and I **come back**.”

The letters in this word

వె (*ve*) + ళ్ళు (*ḷḷu*, doubled retroflex శ *ḷ*) → వెళ్ళు. Its partner is *vaccu* (“come”).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “vəḷḷu” (go) and “vaccu” (come)
- why you need both to say goodbye (Telugu’s farewell is “I’ll go and come back”)

Before you move on

What do *vəḷḷu* and *vaccu* mean, and why will you need them both to part? (“Go” and “come”; the Telugu goodbye is “I’ll go and come back.”)

4.4 ఓ — the Telugu numeral for 6

Before the new one: ఙ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఌ?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: ఓ

ఓ is six.

Six is where the second half begins, and where a warning belongs: **ఓ is not the 6 you write, and it is not an E**. It is its own character, and the only way it becomes readable is by meeting it often enough that the resemblance stops mattering.

Writing: ఓ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ఓ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

౬ · ౨ · ౩

- *Trace it:* ౬ three times, saying “6” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for ౬ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ౬? What amount does it stand for? (౬ is 6.)

One more, from much earlier: ౬ — what does it do?

4.5 వెళ్లి వస్తాను (vellī vastānu) — “I’ll go and come back”

The everyday Telugu goodbye — a promise, not a parting.

The letters in this word

వెళ్లి (*vellī*, “having gone”) is *vellu* + the “-i” that means “having ...d.” వస్తాను (*vastānu*, “I come/will come”) is from *vaccu* (“come”) + “I.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

వెళ్లి వస్తాను = వెళ్లి (*vellī*, “having gone”) + వస్తాను (*vastānu*, “I come”) — literally “**having gone, I come [back]**,” i.e. “I’ll go and come back.” A Telugu speaker never signs off with a bare “I’m leaving” — that sounds final. Instead they promise return. It is the same “go-and-come-back” farewell you meet across the Dravidian south (Tamil *pōy varugirēn*, Kannada *hōgi baruttēne*, Malayalam *pōyi varāmi*) and echoing into the Indo-Aryan tracks (Bengali *āshi*). The warm reply is వెళ్లి రండి (*vellī raṇḍi*, “go and come [back]”).

Across the family — the same idea, five ways:

Language	“go and come back” (goodbye)
Telugu	<i>velli vastānu</i>
Tamil	<i>pōy varugirēn</i>
Kannada	<i>hōgi baruttēne</i>
Malayalam	<i>pōyi varāṁ</i>
Bengali (Indo-Aryan)	<i>āshi</i> (“I come”)
The whole south — and, in Bengali, well beyond it — prefers a promise of return to a blunt farewell. The languages are not all related; the habit travelled anyway.	

Grammar Lens: the “having ...d” participle

Velli is Telugu’s way of chaining actions: “having gone, (then) I come.” Like its sisters, Telugu strings verbs with one in the participle form and the last one fully conjugated.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the goodbye — *velli vastānu*
- its literal meaning (“having gone, I come” → “I’ll come back”)
- the warm reply — *velli raṇḍi*

Before you move on

What does the Telugu goodbye literally promise, and how do you answer? (“I’ll go and come back”; reply *velli raṇḍi*, “go and come back”.)

4.6 రేపు కలుద్దాం (rēpu kaluddām) — “see you tomorrow”

A goodbye with a date on it.

The letters in this word

రీ (rē) + పు (pu) → రీపు (rēpu). కలుద్దాం (kaluddām) = kalu (“meet”) + -ddām (“let’s”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

రీపు (rēpu, “tomorrow”) is native Dravidian. కలుద్దాం (kaluddām, “let’s meet”) is from కలు (kalu, “to meet, to join”) — so the phrase is “**tomorrow, let’s meet,**” the Telugu “see you tomorrow.” The -దాం (-ddām) ending is Telugu’s “let’s _____” — a first-person-plural invitation: *velldām* (“let’s go”), *tindām* (“let’s eat”).

The letters in this word

రీ (rē) + పు (pu) → రీపు. కలుద్దాం (kaluddām) = kalu (“meet”) + -ddām (“let’s”).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “rēpu kaluddām”
- “tomorrow” and “to meet” (rēpu, kalu)
- the “let’s _____” ending (-ddām)

Before you move on

What are the two pieces of rēpu kaluddām, and what does -ddām mean? (Rēpu “tomorrow” + kalu “meet”; -ddām = “let’s _____.”)

4.7 ప — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ట — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ఓ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ప

ప — *pa*.

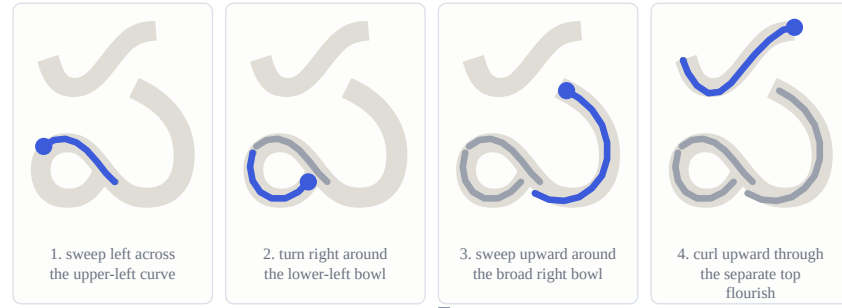
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *p*, it is **pa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ప somewhere inside it:

- పేరు *pēru* — name
- పరవాలేదు *paravālēdu* — it's okay / no problem / you're welcome
- రేపు కలుద్దాం *rēpu kaluddām* — see you tomorrow

Writing: ప — four calm curves

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant ప packaged tracing guides
res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_5_1_pa.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_5_1_pa.png, movements 1–4 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ప is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 sweeps left across the upper part of the small bowl. Lift, then movement 2 turns around its lower half. Movement 3 makes the broad bowl on the right. Lift once more for movement 4, the small rising flourish above.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the four clear movements instead of closing the small gaps.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ప in the ones that have it

పేరు · పరవాలేదు · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ప three times, saying *pa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ప once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ప? What sound does it carry? (*pa.*)

Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: ఠ — what amount does it stand for?

4.8 మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం (maḷḷi kaluddām) — “we’ll meet again”

The open-ended, warm goodbye — no date, just a promise.

The letters in this word

మళ్ళీ (*maḷḷi*): note the doubled retroflex శ్చ (*ḷḷ*), the same sound as in *veḷḷu*.
కలుద్దాం (*kaluddām*, “let’s meet”) you just learned.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం = మళ్ళీ (*maḷḷi*, “again”) + కలుద్దాం (*kaluddām*, “let’s meet”) — “**we’ll meet again.**” Both words are native Dravidian: *maḷḷi* (“again,” from *maral*, “to return”) and *kalu* (“to meet”). Where Tamil’s “we’ll meet again” (*mīṇḍum sandippōm*) reaches for the Sanskrit loan *sandi* to say “meet,” Telugu keeps the native *kalu* — a small reminder that these sisters make the same phrase from different stock.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “maḷḷi kaluddām”
- “again” and “let’s meet” (*maḷḷi*, *kaluddām*)

Before you move on

What does the phrase mean, and which Dravidian verb does Telugu use for “meet” here? (“We’ll meet again”; the native *kalu* — where Tamil used the Sanskrit loan *sandi*.)

4.9 ూ — the Telugu numeral for 7

Before the new one: ు — what does it do? And one from further back: ు?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: ూ

ూ is **seven**.

ు and ూ sit next to each other in value and are easy to swap on a first reading. Look at the pair below until you can say which is which without counting up to it.

Writing: ూ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ూ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

ూ · ు · ు

- *Trace it:* ూ three times, saying “7” as you finish each one

- *Look:* for ౭ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ౭? What amount does it stand for? (౭ is 7, ౬ is 6.)

One more, from much earlier: ౯ — what does it do?

4.10 Chapter 4 — The farewells

No new words. Three ways to part — none of them a blunt “goodbye.”

The exchange — the farewells

All three, side by side — none of them a blunt “goodbye”:

Telugu		English
—	<i>velli vastānu</i>	I’ll go and come back. (the goodbye)
—	<i>veli raṇḍi</i>	Go and come back. (the reply)
రేపు కలుద్దాం.	<i>rēpu kaluddām</i>	See you tomorrow.
—	<i>malli kaluddām</i>	We’ll meet again.

Three of these stay in romanization for now: their doubled *l* and their *e*-sign have not had their own lessons yet, and a line you cannot decode is not a line to read from. The letters catch up in the chapters ahead.

Say these aloud:

- the everyday goodbye — *velli vastānu* (“I’ll go and come back”)
- the warm reply — *veli raṇḍi* (“go and come back”)
- “see you tomorrow” — *rēpu kaluddām*
- “we’ll meet again” — *malli kaluddām*

What you’ve built — the atoms

Say these aloud:

- the two verbs (*vellu* go, *vaccu* come)
- “tomorrow,” “again,” “let’s meet” (*rēpu*, *mall̄i*, *kaluddām*)
- the “let’s ____” ending (*-ddām*)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Roots you now carry:

- *vell̄i vastānu* — “having gone, I come”; the Dravidian promise-of-return goodbye
- *rēpu* “tomorrow” + *kalu* “meet” (native, where Tamil borrowed *sandi*)
- *mall̄i* ← *maral* “to return”

Before you move on

Why does Telugu never say a plain “I’m leaving,” and what does its everyday goodbye promise instead? (It sounds too final; *vell̄i vastānu* promises “I’ll go and come back.”)

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Modes: ⇄ **voice** (1) 👁 **eyes** (5) ✍ **pen** (9) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** none of the 15 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can build short present-tense Telugu sentences with the chapter’s first verbs.

Until now, “to be” and “to be-not.” Now verbs that act, and Telugu’s sentences begin to move: నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను — stem + tense + person, stacked.

5.1 త — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ౭ — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: డ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: త

త — *ta*.

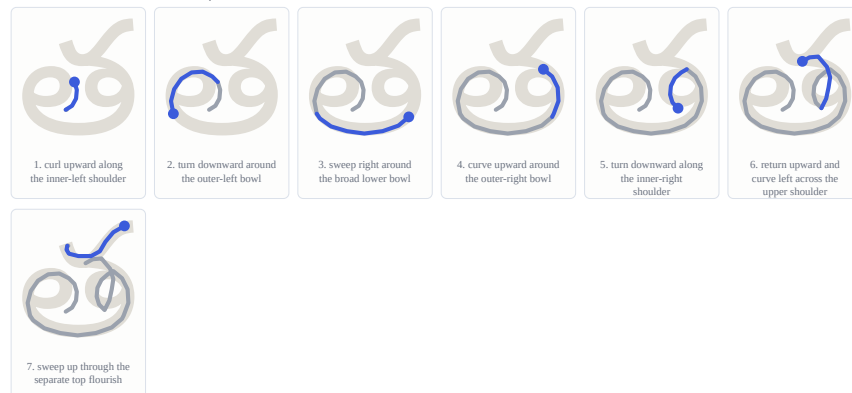
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *t*, it is **ta**.

You already say these, and every one of them has త somewhere inside it:

- సంతోషం — joy / pleased to meet you
- వెళ్లి వస్తాను *velli vastānu* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)

Writing: త — observe, then trace

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 7 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_4_1_ta.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_4_1_ta.png, movements 1–7 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How త is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. The first pen-down run uses six small movements: curl up inside the left shoulder, turn down around the left bowl, sweep right around the broad bottom, curve up around the right bowl, turn down inside it, then curve left across the upper shoulder. Lift once. The second run sweeps up through the separate top flourish.

Trace the same route slowly. The numbers divide a long connected body into manageable turns; they do not ask you to lift until the top flourish.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find త in the ones that have it

సంతోషం · వెళ్ళి వస్తాను · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* త three times, saying *ta* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find త once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — త? What sound does it carry? (*ta.*)

Name one word you already say that contains it.

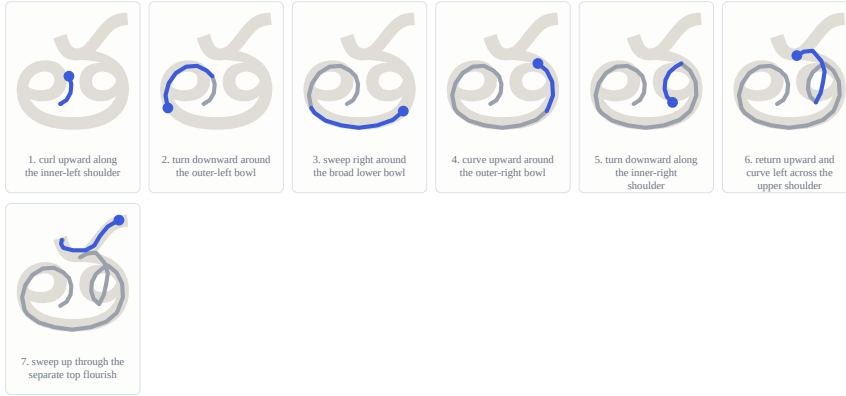
One more, from much earlier: త — what amount does it stand for?

5.2 త — copy it where it lives

Find త inside సంతోషం — *santōṣaṁ* — and put your finger on it.

Writing — guided copy

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 7 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant త packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_4_1_ta.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_4_1_ta.png.
movements 1-7 (version 2.0)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How త is written, stroke by stroke

The model stays on the page. Copy త once on its own, then copy it a second time **with the letter that follows it in the word**, keeping the two the same size and the same distance apart as the printed pair.

That second copy is the whole lesson. A letter traced alone teaches your hand one shape; a letter copied beside its neighbour teaches it where the shape has to stop, and a hand that has only ever drawn letters alone writes them too large and too far apart the first time it writes a word.

Look back at the model as often as you want. Nothing is hidden today.

Before you move on

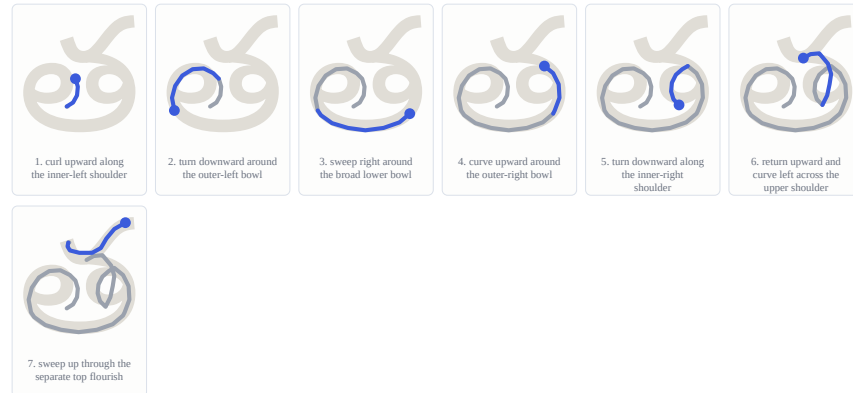
Hold your two copies next to the printed word. Is the gap you left the same one the book left? That gap is not spacing — it is the difference between two letters and one word.

5.3 త — write it with the model covered

Look at త once and say *ta*. Then cover it, and every other త on the page.

Writing — delayed copy

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 7 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_4_1_ta.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_4_1_ta.png, movements 1-7 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How త is written, stroke by stroke

With the model covered, wait ten seconds, then write త once from memory.

Ten seconds is not long and is not meant to be. It is long enough that your hand cannot be tracing a shape it can still see, and short enough that a letter you met a minute ago is still there to be found.

Only after the letter is finished, uncover the model and compare. Repair **one** thing — the first that differs — and leave the rest.

Before you move on

The thing to look at is not whether your letter is beautiful. It is whether it is the **same letter**, and in this script that usually comes down to one curve closing where the model's closes, or staying open where the model's stays open. A hand drawing from memory rounds off what it is unsure about.

5.4 త — the letter from the sound

Cover every త on the page. Nothing to copy and nothing to uncover.

Writing — dictation



How త is written, stroke by stroke

Say *ta* aloud, or play it, and write the letter that carries it. Once.

This is a different job from the last lesson even though the letter is the same. A delayed copy asks your hand to remember a shape. Dictation asks it to turn a **sound** into a shape, which is the thing writing is actually for, and the two do not always arrive together.

Before you move on

Uncover the model and compare — and then notice what you were asked to write.

Not *t*. **ta**. The vowel is already inside the letter and nobody wrote it, which is the fact about this script that the first three lessons showed you and this one makes you act on. Hearing *ta* and writing one shape is the whole difference between an alphabet and what you are learning.

5.5 మాట్లాడు (māṭlāḍu) — “to speak,” your first full verb

So far, “to be.” Here is a verb that *does* something — and it shows how Telugu builds “I do X.”

The letters in this word

మా (mā) + ట్లా (ṭlā) + డు (ḍu) → మాట్లాడు (māṭlāḍu).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

మాట్లాడు (māṭlāḍu, “to speak, to talk”) is native Dravidian, built on మాట (māṭa, “word, speech”). To say “**I speak**,” Telugu adds a two-part ending to the stem — tense + person:

māṭlāḍ- (speak) + -t- (present/future) + -ānu (“I”) →
మాట్లాడతాను (māṭlāḍatānu), “I speak / I will speak.”

The -తాను (-ānu) ending *is* “I,” so *nēnu* is rarely needed. Change the ending, change the person: māṭlāḍtāḍu (he), māṭlāḍtundi (she/it), māṭlāḍtāru (they / you-respectful).

Grammar Lens: stem + tense + person

Every Telugu verb is built this way — a stem, a tense-marker, a person-ending, stacked and glued. Learn the pattern once and every verb follows it. (Telugu, like Tamil, marks no gender in the first person: māṭlāḍatānu is the same for a man or a woman.)

The letters in this word

మా (mā) + ట్లా (ṭlā) + డు (ḍu) → మాట్లాడు.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “māṭlāḍu” (speak)
- “I speak” — māṭlāḍatānu
- the word “speech” inside it (māṭa)

Before you move on

Build “I speak” from *māṭlāḍu*, and name the noun it’s built on.
(*Māṭlāḍatānu*; *māṭa*, “word / speech.”)

5.6 ఓ — the Telugu numeral for 8

Before the new one: ఌ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఋ?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: ఓ

ఓ is **eight**.

Eight of ten. Read the row below and say each value aloud before moving on — the pause matters more than the speed.

Writing: ఓ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ఓ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

ఓ · ౩ · ౭ · ౧

- *Trace it:* ఓ three times, saying “8” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for ఓ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ౮? What amount does it stand for? (౮ is 8.)

One more, from much earlier: ి — what does it do?

5.7 నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను (nēnu telugu māṭṭlāḍatānu) — “I speak Telugu”

Your first full, moving sentence — and it names one of India’s most musical languages.

The letters in this word

తెలుగు (*telugu*): తె (*te*) + లు (*lu*) + గు (*gu*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను = నేను (*nēnu*, “I”) + తెలుగు (*telugu*, “Telugu,” the object) + మాట్లాడతాను (*māṭṭlāḍatānu*, “speak”) — “**I Telugu speak**,” the verb last as always. The name తెలుగు (*telugu*) is native, of debated origin (often linked to *tenugu*, and to the land *Trilinga*); its vowel-rich sound and habit of ending most words in a vowel earned it the old nickname “the Italian of the East.” It is the language of the *Kāvya* poets and, today, of some eighty million speakers.

Grammar Lens: no gender on “I speak”

Māṭṭlāḍatānu is the same whether a man or a woman says it — Telugu, like Tamil, marks **no gender in the first or second person** (only the third: *-āḍu* he, *-undi* she/it). This is unlike Hindi, where even “I speak” changes for the speaker’s gender (*boltā/boltī*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nēnu telugu māṭṭlāḍatānu”
- the old nickname for Telugu and why (“the Italian of the East” — vowel-rich, most words end in a vowel)

- does “I speak” change for a man vs. a woman? (No — no 1st-person gender)

Before you move on

Say “I speak Telugu,” and give Telugu’s old nickname. (*Nēnu telugu māṭlāḍatānu*; “the Italian of the East.”)

5.8 స — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఊ — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ప?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: స

స — *sa*.

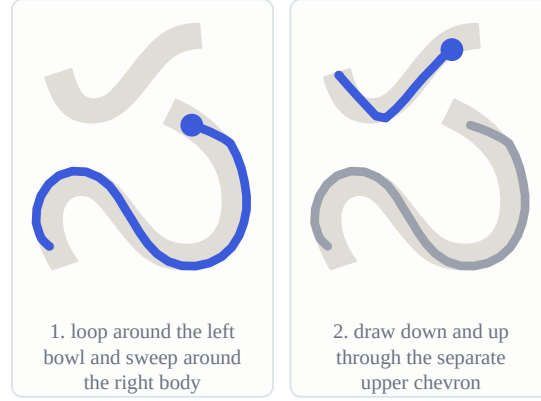
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *s*, it is **sa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has స somewhere inside it:

- నమస్కారం *namaskāram* — hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)
- సరే *sarē* — okay / alright (sarē)
- వెళ్లి వస్తాను *velli vastānu* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)

Writing: స — two calm movements

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 mov



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant స animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_స in version 3.8.05 (3805)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How స is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the guide once before your hand moves. స arrives in **two calm movements**, with one lift between them:

1. Loop around the left bowl, then keep sweeping around the broad right body.
2. Lift once, then draw down and up through the separate chevron above.

Trace the filmstrip slowly. Let the long first movement settle before you lift for the small upper mark. Then copy the whole shape once without rushing.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find స in the ones that have it

సమస్కారం · సరే · ధన్యవాదములు

- *Trace it:* స three times, saying *sa* as you finish each one

- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find స once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — స? What sound does it carry? (*sa*.)
 Name one word you already say that contains it.
 One more, from much earlier: ం — what does it do?

5.9 స — the second of the s letters

Before the new one: స — what sound does it carry, and which word from chapter two opens with it?

That word carries a second s-shape as well, further along. Today's character is the second one.

Script you'll notice: స

స — *sa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *s*, it is **sa**.

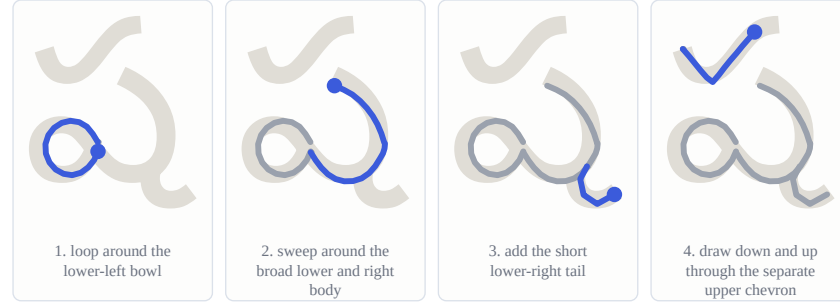
- సంతోషం *santōṣam* — joy; and the way you say you are pleased to meet somebody (*santōṣam* — “gladness”)

Look at that word end to end. It opens on స and closes on స, with the *o* sign between them. **Two different s-shapes inside one short word**, and until now you could read the first and not the second.

Your tongue makes them in two different places. For స the tip touches the ridge behind your teeth. For స it curls back along the roof of your mouth, the same backward curl you already make for ం. The romanization marks the difference with one dot under the letter — *s* against *ṣ* — which is easy to miss in print and impossible to miss on the page, where they are two unlike shapes.

Writing: ష — four calm movements

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant ష animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_ష in version 3.8.05 (3805)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ష is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the guide once before your hand moves. ష arrives in **four calm movements**, with a small lift between each one:

1. Loop around the small bowl at the lower left.
2. Sweep around the broad lower and right body.
3. Add the short tail at the lower right.
4. Lift once more, then draw down and up through the separate chevron above.

Trace the filmstrip slowly. Let each movement finish before you lift. Then write ష beside ష and notice how different the two silhouettes feel.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the word below and put a finger on each of its two s-shapes in turn

సంతోషం

- *Trace it:* ష three times, saying *ṣa* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which of the two has your tongue curled back

Before you move on

Which character is this — ష? What sound does it carry? (*ṣa*.)
Which end of సంతోషం does it sit at? (**The far end** — స opens the word, ష closes it.) Which other letter puts your tongue in the same curled place? (ట.)

5.10 ఉండు (uṇḍu) — “to be, to stay, to live”

You have already used this verb — in “how are you.” Now meet it in its own right, and use it to say where you live.

The letters in this word

ఉ (independent *u*) + ండు (*ṇḍu*, with the retroflex cluster ండ) → ఉండు (*uṇḍu*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ఉండు (*uṇḍu*, “to be, to exist, to stay, to live”) is native Dravidian and does an enormous amount of work. It is the verb behind Chapter 3’s *unnāru* (“you are”) and *bāgunnānu* (“I’m well”) — and it also means “to reside”: *nēnu Hyderābād̥lō uṇṭānu* (“I live in Hyderabad”). One verb covers “be,” “stay,” and “live.”

Grammar Lens: “in” comes after the noun

Hyderābād̥lō = *Hyderabad* + -లో (*-lō*, “in”). The little word for “in” is glued to the **end** of the noun — Telugu uses **postpositions** (really, case-suffixes) where English uses prepositions. “Hyderabad-in I stay,” the verb last.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “uṇḍu”
- “I live in Hyderabad” — *nēnu Hyderābād̥lō uṇṭānu*
- where “in” (*-lō*) sits — glued to the end of the noun

Before you move on

Name three things the one verb *unḍu* can mean, and say where “in” goes. (“To be / to stay / to live”; *-lō* “in” attaches to the **end** of the noun.)

5.11 హంస (haṁsa) — a swan

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You’ll want to know: హంస

హంస — *haṁsa* — “a swan”.

Say it: *haṁsa*. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, హ, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *haṁsa*
- *haṁsa*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a swan”? (హంస, *haṁsa*.)

5.12 హ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: స — what does it do? And one from further back: ఔ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: హ

హ — *ha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *h*, it is **ha**.

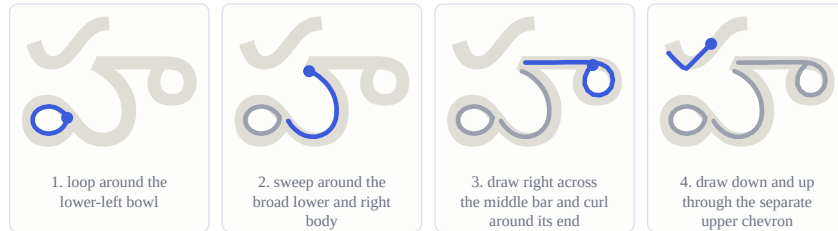
You met it on the page before this one, at the front of a place name:

- హైదరాబాద్ *Hyderābād* — the city from the sentence about where you live

Look at where that word came from. *Hyderābād* reached Telugu through Persian and Urdu, and that is the pattern: in the words this book has given you so far, హ sits almost entirely on borrowings — from Persian, from Urdu, from Sanskrit. It is a letter you will meet again on the very next page, in a word for help that came in from Sanskrit.

Writing: హ — four calm movements

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu in version 3.8.05 (3805)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How హ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the guide once before your hand moves. హ arrives in **four calm movements**, with a small lift between each one:

1. Loop around the small bowl at the lower left.
2. Sweep around the broad lower and right body.
3. Draw right across the middle bar and curl around its far end.
4. Lift once more, then draw down and up through the separate chevron above.

Trace the filmstrip slowly. Let every movement finish before you lift, then copy the whole shape once without rushing.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find హా in the ones that have it

హైదరాబాద్ · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* హా three times, saying *ha* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find హా once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — హా? What sound does it carry? (*ha*.)

Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: ౩ — what amount does it stand for?

5.13 పని చేయు (pani cēyu) — “to work”

The last verb of the chapter — and, like Hindi’s *karnā* and Tamil’s *sey*, it is a “do” verb that builds a hundred others.

The letters in this word

పని (*pani*, “work”): ప (*pa*) + ని (*ni*). చేయు (*cēyu*, “do”): చే (*cē*) + యు (*yu*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

చేయు (*cēyu*, “to do, to make”) is a core native Dravidian verb, and Telugu — like Hindi with *karnā* and Tamil with *sey* — builds compound verbs by putting a noun in front of it:

- పని చేయు (*pani cēyu*) = “work-do” = “**to work**” (*pani*, “work”)
- వంట చేయు (*vaṇṭa cēyu*) = “to cook”
- సహాయం చేయు (*sahāyaṁ cēyu*) = “to help” (*sahāyaṁ* ← Sanskrit)

So “I work” is నేను పని చేస్తాను (*nēnu pani cēstānu*) — *cēy-* + tense + “I.” Master *cēyu* and a whole grammar of “do-verbs” opens up — and notice *sahāyaṁ cēyu* (“to help”) pairs a **Sanskrit** noun with the **native** *cēyu*: Telugu’s two vocabularies working together in a single verb.

Grammar Lens: noun + చేయ = a new verb

This “noun + *cēyu*” pattern is the exact twin of Hindi’s “noun + *karnā*” and Tamil’s “noun + *sey*.” Three languages — two of them from unrelated families — all hit on the same trick: an all-purpose “do” verb with nouns bolted on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “pani *cēyu*” (to work)
- “I work” — *nēnu pani cēstānu*
- the Hindi and Tamil twins of this trick (*karnā*, *sey*)

Before you move on

How does Telugu turn “work” into “to work,” and what verbs work the same way in Hindi and Tamil? (*Pani* + *cēyu* = “work-do”; Hindi *karnā*, Tamil *sey*.)

5.14 ట — the Telugu numeral for 9

Before the new one: ష — what does it do? And one from further back: త?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: ట

ట is **nine**.

That is nine of the ten, and the last one is the one that makes the rest useful.

Writing: ట — copy what you see

Put your pen on ట and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

౯ · ౮ · ౬ · ౭ · ౩

- *Trace it:* ౯ three times, saying “9” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for ౯ on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — ౯? What amount does it stand for? (౯ is 9.)

One more, from much earlier: ఉ — what does it do?

5.15 Chapter 5 — The first verbs

No new words. Three verbs, one engine — build real sentences about yourself.

Your turn: build the sentences

Three sentences about yourself, read off the page before you say them:

Telugu		English
నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను.	<i>nēnu telugu māṭṭlāḍatānu</i>	I speak Telugu.
నేను హైదరాబాద్లో ఉంటాను.	<i>nēnu Hyderābādloḥ uṇṭānu</i>	I live in Hyderabad.
—	<i>nēnu paṇi cēstānu</i>	I work.

One of these stays in romanization for now: its *c* has not had its own lesson yet, and a line you cannot decode is not a line to read from. The

others are read straight off the page; the romanization is there to check against.

Say these aloud:

- “I speak Telugu” — *nēnu telugu māṭlāḍatānu*
- “I live in Hyderabad” — *nēnu Hyderābādlo uṇṭānu*
- “I work” — *nēnu pani cēstānu*
- “he speaks” vs. “she speaks” — *māṭlāḍtāḍu / māṭlāḍtundi*

What you’ve built — the engine

Say these aloud:

- the three stacked pieces of every Telugu verb (stem + tense + person)
- the ending that means “I” (*-ānu*)
- where Telugu marks gender — and where it doesn’t (3rd person only)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Roots you now carry:

- *māṭlāḍu* “to speak” ← *māṭa* “word”
- *uṇḍu* “to be / stay / live”; *-lō* “in” attaches to the noun’s end
- *cēyu* “to do” → *pani cēyu* “to work” (the twin of Hindi’s *karnā*, Tamil’s *sey*)
- *telugu* — “the Italian of the East,” vowel-rich

Before you move on

In one breath, say your language, your city, and your work in Telugu. (*Nēnu telugu māṭlāḍatānu. Nēnu ... lō uṇṭānu. Nēnu pani cēstānu.*)

Chapter 6

Case Endings and Dative Subjects

Modes: ☞ voice (2) 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (2) ☞ **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that I know Telugu the way Telugu itself says it — “to me Telugu comes,” with no subject and the dative -ku.

Say నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు against నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను, then line up the four Dravidian datives -ku · -ukku · -ge · -ikku.

6.1 ౦ — the Telugu numeral for 0

Before the new one: ౯ — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: ౮?

One numeral this time, and it is read the way every numeral is read: as an amount.

Script you’ll notice: ౦

౦ is **zero**, and it closes the set.

It is a ring, and you have seen that ring before: ౦, the sunna, is drawn the same way. On the page the difference is where it sits — the sunna rides after a letter inside a word, the zero stands in a row of numerals. Context, not shape, tells you which one you are looking at.

With ౦ in hand the other nine become worth something, because Telugu numerals use **place value exactly the way your own digits do**. ౧ then ౦ is ten. ౨ then ౦ is twenty. Three digits make hundreds. Nothing new

has to be learned for that — the system is one you already own, wearing different characters.

Writing: O — copy what you see

Put your pen on O and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this row and say the value of each numeral in it, left to right

౦౦ · ౨౦ · ౯౯ · ౧౦౦

- *Trace it:* O three times, saying “0” as you finish each one
- *Look:* for O on any page of a Telugu book, calendar or doorplate you can find

Before you move on

Which numeral is this — O? What amount does it stand for? (O is 0, and ౦౦ is ten.)

One more, from much earlier: ఓ — what amount does it stand for?

6.2 -కు (-ku) — “to, for”

Your first **case ending**. English puts “to” in **front** as its own word. Telugu sticks it on the **back** — and that difference is the biggest structural fact about the language.

You'll want to know: Adding it on

word	+ -ku	meaning
పేరు <i>pēru</i> — name	పేరుకు <i>pēruku</i>	to/for the name
పని <i>pani</i> — work	పనికి <i>paniki</i>	for work

Notice the suffix appears as **-కు** *-ku* or **-కి** *-ki* depending on the vowel before it. Same suffix, adjusted to fit — the seam still shows.

And with “I”, which changes its body first:

నేను *nēnu* (“I”) → నాకు *nāku* (“to me”)

Nēnu becomes *nā-* before the ending. Nouns don’t do this; they just take the suffix.

Grammar Lens: Why this matters

	Telugu -ku	a Latin ending like -īs
pins down the case?	yes — dative, always	no — <i>-īs</i> is dative or ablative
carries number?	no — a separate suffix does	yes — plural, baked in
carries declension class?	no	yes — 1st/2nd only
can you see the seam?	yes: <i>pēru + ku</i>	no — one fused lump

Telugu **stacks**: each suffix means one thing and sits in a fixed order, so you can point at every piece of a long word. Latin **fuses** — *-īs* is case *and* plural *and* declension, indivisible, and it doesn’t even settle *which* case. Telugu’s *-ku* is never ambiguous.

That’s what “**agglutinative**” means, and it’s why Telugu words grow long without growing hard: they are **built**, not memorised.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*pēru ... pēruku*”
- “*nēnu ... nāku*” — “I” ... “to me”
- “*paniki*” — “for work,” from Ch. 5’s పని

- the principle — “one suffix, one meaning, visible seam”

Before you move on

What does **-కు** mean? (“**To**” or “**for**.”) Where does it go? (**On the end** of the noun.) What is “to me”? (**నాకు** *nāku* — *nēnu* shrinks to *nā*- first.) Why does it sometimes appear as **-కి**? (It **adjusts to the preceding vowel** — same suffix.) How does that differ from Latin? (Latin **fuses** case+number+declension into one ending — and *-is* doesn’t even fix *which* case; Telugu’s carries **one** meaning, unambiguously, with the **seam visible**.) Next: the sentence where Telugu leaves out the subject entirely.

6.3 య — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: **౦** — what amount does it stand for? And one from further back: **స**?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: య

య — *ya*.

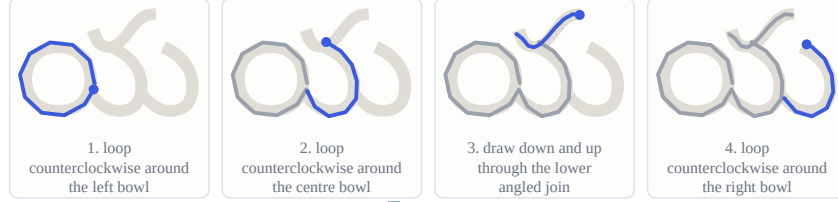
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *y*, it is **ya**.

You already say these, and every one of them has య somewhere inside it:

- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
- పని చేయు *pani cēyu* — to work (lit. “work-do”)

Writing: య — four calm movements

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant య animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_య in version 3.8.05 (3805)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How య is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 loops counterclockwise around the left bowl. Movement 2 makes the centre bowl in the same direction. Movement 3 travels down and up through the lower angled join. Lift between movements; movement 4 loops around the right bowl.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the four clear movements instead of rushing their joins.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find య in the ones that have it

ధన్యవాదములు · సమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* య three times, saying *ya* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find య once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — య? What sound does it carry? (*ya.*)

Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: ధ — what does it do?

6.4 నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు — “I know Telugu”

Chapter 5 taught you how to say “I speak Telugu.” Now say “I **know** Telugu.” Telugu won’t let you use *nēnu* — and the verb it uses instead will surprise you.

You’ll want to know: The sentence

నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు. *nāku telugu vaccu*. literally: “**to-me** Telugu comes.”

piece

నాకు <i>nāku</i>	“to me” — the dative from the last lesson
తెలుగు <i>telugu</i>	Telugu (Ch. 5)
వచ్చు <i>vaccu</i>	“comes” — the very verb you learned in Ch. 4

Two things at once. **You are not the subject** — *nēnu* is gone, moved into the dative, and what’s left unmarked is *telugu*. And the verb is literally “**to come**”: a language you know is a thing that **comes to you**.

Grammar Lens: Why: things that happen *to* you

Telugu sorts experiences from actions. Speaking is something you **do**, so Ch. 5 used *nēnu*. But knowing, liking, wanting, being hungry — these **arrive** at you. Telugu marks that by putting the person in the **dative**.

English frames it as	Telugu frames it as
I know Telugu	Telugu comes to me
I like it	it is pleasing to me
I am cold	cold is to me

English keeps one fossil of exactly this: “**methinks**” — *me* is a dative, “it seems **to me**.” Telugu made it the rule.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

language	“I know [the language]”	the dative
Telugu	<i>nāku telugu vaccu</i>	-ku
Tamil	<i>enakku tamīl teriyum</i>	-ukku
Kannada	<i>nanage kannada gottu</i>	-ge
Malayalam	<i>enikku malayālam ariyām</i>	-ikku

One construction across four languages, with four suffixes that are visibly the **same suffix** — *-ku* / *-ukku* / *-ge* / *-ikku*. The Dravidian family showing its bones, just as *blanc/bianco/branco* did for Romance.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*nāku telugu vaccu*”
- the contrast — “*nēnu telugu māṭṭādatānu*” (I speak) ... “*nāku telugu vaccu*” (comes to me)
- the literal — “to-me Telugu comes”
- the four cousins — “*-ku · -ukku · -ge · -ikku*”

Before you move on

What does నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు literally say? (“**To-me** Telugu **comes**.”) Which verb is doing the work, and where did you meet it? (వచ్చు “to come” — Chapter 4.) What has English got that Telugu hasn’t? (A nominative “**I**” — *nēnu* is replaced by the dative *nāku*.) Why the dative? (Knowing **happens to** you.) Which English word keeps the same idea? (**Methinks**.)

6.5 The opening five, again — three jobs

Close the book on everything so far. From memory: the word that opens a conversation, and the word that closes a piece of business.

You'll want to know: sort them by the job, not by the order they arrived

This far on, the question is no longer *what does each word mean* but *which one do I reach for*. Three jobs cover all five:

job	the word
open or close the whole exchange	నమస్కారం <i>namaskāram</i>
answer a question	అవును <i>avunu</i> · లేదు <i>lēdu</i>
close one turn and move on	సరే <i>sarē</i> · ధన్యవాదములు <i>dhanyavādamulu</i>

The second row is the one to feel: అవును and లేదు are the two ways a Telugu answer can go.

What you've built — what each word was carrying

Each of the five arrived with a point attached. Recall the point, not the sentence it came in:

- నమస్కారం — hello **and** goodbye in one word, respectful without being stiff.
- ధన్యవాదములు — its *-mulu* is an ending glued to a stem, which is how Telugu does most of its grammar.
- అవును — a small statement of being, “it is so,” not a bare particle.
- లేదు — one of **two** negatives: *lēdu* denies that a thing is there, కాదు *kādu* that it is the thing you named.
- సరే — one Dravidian word wearing three scripts.

Your turn: choose, then say

Say these aloud:

- someone asks whether you speak Telugu — one word back
- someone asks whether the tea is there — deny that it is
- the word for thanks, all five syllables, unhurried
- hello, then goodbye — the same word both times

Before you move on

Which word does both hello and goodbye? (నమస్కారం.) Which two negatives does Telugu keep apart? (లేదు, *not there*; కాదు, *not that*.) What is the *-mulu* an example of? (**An ending glued onto a stem.**) Which of the five would a Kannada speaker know on sight? (సరే.)

Chapter 7

Numbers One to Ten

Modes: 👁 eyes (3) ✍ pen (5) 🖐 Hands-free start: none of the 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can count from one to ten in Telugu, including the numbers that wander furthest from their Dravidian cousins.

Count ఒకటి through పది, say the two Telugu builds fresh — enimidi and tommidi — and hear seven's three fates in ēlu, ēḷu and ēḍu.

7.1 ఒకటి, రెండు, మూడు, నాలుగు, ఐదు — one to five

Four of these five are old Dravidian friends. The very first one is Telugu going its own way.

You'll want to know: The five

	numeral	word	said
1	౧	ఒకటి	<i>okaṭi</i>
2	౨	రెండు	<i>reṇḍu</i>
3	౩	మూడు	<i>mūḍu</i>
4	౪	నాలుగు	<i>nālugu</i>
5	౫	ఐదు	<i>aidu</i>

The symbols ౧ ౨ ౩ ౪ ౫ are Telugu's own digits.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

One is where Telugu leaves the family. Its cousins agree — Tamil *onru*, Kannada *ondu*, Malayalam *onnu*, all from an old *on-* — but Telugu says **okaṭi**, a different formation altogether. It’s the number to memorise fresh rather than reason across from Tamil.

From two onward, the family closes ranks again:

	Tamil	Telugu
2	<i>iraṇṭu</i>	reṇḍu
3	<i>mūnru</i>	mūḍu
4	<i>nānku</i>	nālugu
5	<i>aintu</i>	aidu

Reṇḍu has simply dropped the opening vowel of *iraṇṭu*; *mūḍu* is *mūnru* with its cluster smoothed to a single **ḍ**. Same numbers, a Telugu polish.

Script you’ll notice: A Telugu shape to notice

Nearly every Telugu word here ends in **-u** (*reṇḍu*, *mūḍu*, *nālugu*) — the language’s strong preference for open, vowel-final syllables. Even where Tamil ends hard, Telugu tends to round the word off with a vowel.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “okaṭi, reṇḍu, mūḍu, nālugu, aidu”
- the maverick — “okaṭi”, NOT the *onru*/ondu/onnu of its cousins
- the family — “iraṇṭu → reṇḍu”, the opening vowel dropped

Before you move on

Count to five in Telugu. (*Okaṭi*, *reṇḍu*, *mūḍu*, *nālugu*, *aidu*.) Which number does Telugu form unlike the rest of the family, and what do the others say? (**One** — Telugu *okaṭi* vs *onru* / *ondu* / *onnu*.) How does *reṇḍu* relate to Tamil *iraṇṭu*? (The opening vowel was dropped.) What vowel do most Telugu words here end in? (**-u**.) Next: six to ten.

7.2 ఐ — one letter for a vowel that moves

Before the new one: డ — what sound, and where in a word does Telugu use the letter rather than the sign?

Count to five out loud. The last number opens on today's character.

Script you'll notice: ఐ

ఐ — *ai*.

It is an **independent vowel** — a vowel that is a letter in its own right, not a mark hung on a consonant.

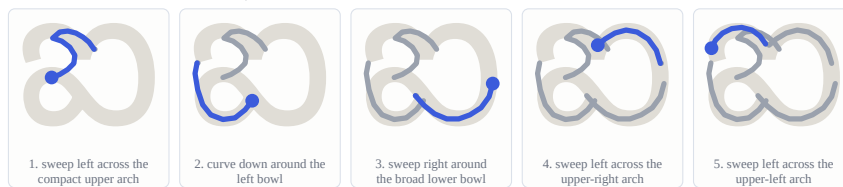
- ఐదు *aidu* — five

Say *aidu* slowly and listen to the opening. Your mouth does not hold one position: it starts low and slides up toward *i*. Two sounds in one movement, which is what the romanization's two letters are trying to show.

Telugu writes that whole movement with one character. English needs a digraph or a silent letter for the same job — *aisle*, *height*, *my* — and picks a different trick each time. Here the slide has a shape of its own, and it looks nothing like the డ you met a chapter ago even though the romanizations share a letter.

Writing: ఐ — copy what you see

How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, independent vowel ఐ packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_v_11_ai.png, movements 1-5 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ఐ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ఐ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed. Then write డ beside it and look at the two.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the number below and find ఐ at its front

ఐదు

- *Trace it:* ఐ three times, saying *ai* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* *ēmiti* and *aidu* one after the other, and say which opening moves

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఐ? What sound does it carry? (*ai*.)
Which number begins with it? (ఐదు.) Does your mouth hold one position for it or two? (**Two** — it slides.)

7.3 ు — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: య — what does it do? And one from further back: హ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ు

ు — *ū*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already know its short partner. ఁ puts a quick *u* on a consonant; ు puts a **held** one on it — the same vowel, kept twice as long. Telugu

counts that length as the difference between two different words, so the two signs are two different characters and not two ways of writing one.

Say *mu*, then say *mū* and let the vowel run on. That extra length is all the second mark is asking for.

You already say this one, and the held vowel is sitting in the middle of it:

- మూడు *mūḍu* — three, from the numbers you counted out

Writing: ు — copy what you see

Put your pen on ు and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one holds its vowel and which one does not

మూడు · రెండు

- *Trace it:* ు three times, saying *ū* and holding it as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ు once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ు? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to, and how is it different from ు? (**A held *ū*; ు is the short one.**)
One more, from much earlier: ు — what amount does it stand for?

7.4 ఆరు, ఏడు, ఎనిమిది, తొమ్మిది, పది — six to ten

The top of the count is where Telugu is least like its cousins — two of these you simply learn on their own.

You’ll want to know: The five

	numeral	word	said
6	ఁ	ఆరు	<i>āru</i>
7	౭	ఏడు	<i>ēḍu</i>
8	౮	ఎనిమిది	<i>enimidi</i>
9	౯	తొమ్మిది	<i>tommidi</i>
10	౧౦	పది	<i>padi</i>

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Six is an easy cousin (Tamil *āru* → Telugu *āru*). **Seven** is more interesting: Tamil *ēlu* carries the rare **l** (the *zh* of *Tamil*); Kannada hardened it to **ḷ** (*ēḷu*); **Telugu went further still** and turned it into a plain **ḍ** — *ēḍu*. One inherited sound, three fates across the three scripts.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here Telugu strays furthest from its cousins —

	Tamil	Malayalam	Telugu
8	<i>eṭṭu</i>	<i>eṭṭu</i>	enimidi
9	<i>onpatu</i>	<i>onpatu</i>	tommidi

You can’t reach *enimidi* and *tommidi* from Tamil by regular sound-change the way you can *reṇḍu* from *iraṇṭu*: *tommidi* is a different word entirely, and *enimidi* — though it shares the ancient *eṇ*-root behind *eṭṭu* — has drifted too far to derive. So unlike 2–7, learn these two **fresh**.

Ten comes partly back into the fold — Telugu *padi* is a worn-down relative of the *pat*- in Tamil *pattu* (and the *-patu* hiding inside *tommidi* and Tamil *onpatu*, “one-to-ten”).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “āru, ēḍu, enimidi, tommidi, padi”
- seven’s three fates — “Tamil ēḷu, Kannada ēḷu, Telugu ēḍu”
- the two you learn fresh — “enimidi, tommidi”

Before you move on

Count six to ten in Telugu. (*Āru, ēḍu, enimidi, tommidi, padi.*) What became of Tamil’s **ḷ** (in *ēḷu*) by the time it reached Telugu *ēḍu*? (It hardened all the way to **ḍ**.) Which two numbers can’t you derive from Tamil by regular correspondence? (**Eight and nine** — learn *enimidi, tommidi* fresh.) How does *padi* relate to Tamil *pattu*? (A worn-down relative of the same *pat*- “ten”.)

7.5 ె — the short one of the pair

Before the new one: ె — is it a letter or a sign, and what does it do?

Count from six to ten out loud. One of those numbers needs today’s sign.

Script you’ll notice: ె

ె — *o*.

It is a **sign**, like the long ె you have already met, and it carries the **short** *o* where that one carries the long *ō*.

- తొమ్మిది *tommidi* — nine (tommidi)

Telugu keeps short and long vowels apart as separate signs, and the difference changes words. English writes one *o* and leaves the length to the ear; here the page tells you, which is one less thing to guess at.

Writing: ె — copy what you see

Put your pen on ె and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed. Then write it attached to a consonant, the way it actually appears.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the number below and find the consonant carrying ூ

తొమ్మిది

- *Trace it:* ூthree times, saying *o* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which of ூand ூis the long one
- *Look:* at సంతోషం and find the long one riding its consonant

Before you move on

Is ூa letter or a sign? (A sign.) Which number from this chapter uses it? (తొమ్మిది, nine.) Which of the two *o* signs is longer? (ొ)

7.6 ఒ — the sign from a page ago, standing alone

A page ago you met ூ, the short-*o* sign, inside తొమ్మిది. Say that number.

Now count from one. The first number opens on the same vowel, and it has no consonant to hang the sign on.

Script you'll notice: ఒ

ఒ — *o*.

It is an **independent vowel** — a vowel that is a letter in its own right, not a mark hung on a consonant.

- ఒకటి *okaṭi* — one

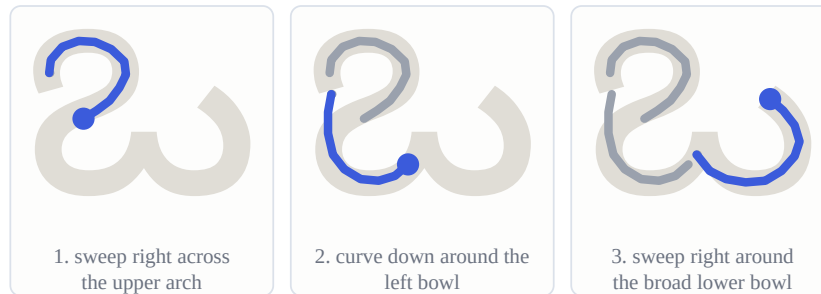
This is the clearest pair you will get. ీ and ు are the same vowel: the first rides on a consonant, the second stands where no consonant does. You met the sign one lesson ago inside *tommidi*; here is the letter, at the front of *okati*, in the same chapter and the same list of numbers.

Hold the two next to each other and the whole system is visible in one line:

the vowel is carried	the vowel starts the word
తొమ్మిది — the sign ీ rides on త	ఒకటి — the letter ు stands alone

Writing: ు — copy what you see

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, independent vowel ీ packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_v_12_o.png, movements 1–3 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ు is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ు and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed. Then write ీ beside it and look at the two.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two numbers and say which one carries the letter ఒ and which the sign ా

ఒకటి · తొమ్మిది

- *Trace it:* ఒ three times, saying *o* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the numbers one to five, and name the one that opens on a vowel letter

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఒ? What sound does it carry? (*o*.)
Which number begins with it? (ఒకటి.) And what is the difference between ఒ and ా? (**None in the sound** — one stands alone, the other rides on a consonant.)

7.7 ఆ — the long one, beside the short one that needs no sign

Two from the first chapter: అ, and the sign ా. Say what each of them does.

Today's character is the missing corner of that square.

Script you'll notice: ఆ

ఆ — *ā*.

It is an **independent vowel** — a vowel that is a letter in its own right, not a mark hung on a consonant.

- ఆరు *āru* — six

With this one the *a* vowels are complete, and they make a square worth drawing:

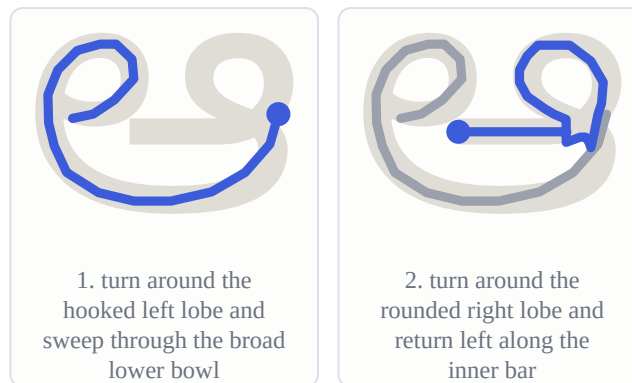
	short	long
carried by a consonant	nothing at all	ా
starting a word	అ	ఆ

Three of those four cells you have had since chapter one. **The top-left cell is the one that surprises people:** short *a* on a consonant is written with no mark, which is why **క** is *ka* and not *k*. Every other cell gets a shape.

Look at the two letters side by side — **అ** and **ఆ**. The long one is the short one with a stroke added on the right, and that stroke has the same shape as the sign **౧౨**. Length shows up on the page as *more ink*, in both columns of the square.

Writing: అ — copy what you see

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 mov



Stroke order after Hojaswani LUCIDA and Physics classes, practice Telugu letters with strokes (అ letter), 00:00–00:10 (YouTube, 15 September 2024)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How అ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on **అ** and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed. Then write **అ** beside it and find the difference.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and say which opens on అ and which on ఆ
అవును · ఆరు
- *Trace it:* ఆ three times, saying ā as you finish each one
- *Say it:* avunu and āru, holding the opening vowel of the second one longer

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఆ? What sound does it carry? (ā.)
Which number begins with it? (ఆరు.) Which cell of the square has
no shape in it at all? (**Short a carried by a consonant** — the
consonant alone says it.)

7.8 The name exchange again — built from four pieces

Two words, from memory: the one for *name*, and the one for *my*.

You'll want to know: four pieces, and everything they build

The question you learned and its answer are made of the same four pieces:
piece

పేరు <i>pēru</i>	name
నా <i>nā</i> · మీ <i>mī</i>	my · your
ఏమిటి <i>ēmiti</i>	what?
నువ్వు <i>nuvvu</i> · మీరు <i>mīru</i>	you, close · you, respectful

Two side by side give the answer, నా పేరు ... The respectful one in front
and the question word behind give the question, మీ పేరు ఏమిటి?

Grammar Lens: the two things the name exchange was really teaching

Two points sit under those four pieces:

- **No word for *is*.** *Nā pēru Arun* is “my name Arun,” and the link stays unsaid in every sentence of this shape.

- **Respect rides on the plural.** మీరు is a plural doing the work of politeness — the move Tamil *nīṅgal* and French *vous* also make.

The familiar *your* goes with the familiar *you*: నీ పేరు ఏమిటి?

Script: three letters that open numbers

ఒ · ఐ · ఆ

Three vowel letters come back with the counting. Each opens a number you now say, and each is a whole letter rather than a sign for one reason: nothing is carrying the vowel.

letter	the number it opens
ఒ <i>o</i>	ఒకటి — one
ఐ <i>ai</i>	ఐదు — five
ఆ <i>ā</i>	ఆరు — six

Your turn: the exchange, both ways

Say these aloud:

- ask a stranger their name, then answer with your own — no “is”
- the one word for “pleased to meet you”
- the same question to a child — one letter of *mā* changes

Before you move on

Which word does నా పేరు ... leave out? (Is.) Which *you* goes to a stranger, and what is it really? (మీరు — a plural doing politeness.) One word for “pleased to meet you”? (సంతోషం.) Which three numbers open on a whole vowel letter? (ఒకటి · ఐదు · ఆరు.)

Chapter 8

Please

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 👁️ eyes (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 2 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say please in Telugu, and use the polite -aṇḍi verb ending speakers actually reach for.

Build దయచేసి out of daya (“compassion”) + cēsi (“having done”), then make the everyday polite request instead: కూర్చోండి, “please sit.”

8.1 దయచేసి (dayacēsi) — please (having done compassion)

Telugu’s “please” carries a whole small sentence inside it: “having **done** (me) a compassion.”

You’ll want to know: The word

దయచేసి = **please**, literally “**having done kindness / compassion.**” Two pieces:

- దయ (*daya*) = **compassion, kindness, grace** — from Sanskrit **daya**.
- చేసి (*cēsi*) = “**having done,**” from the verb చేయు (*cēyu*) “to do.”

So *dayacēsi* is *having done (a) kindness* — you ask by crediting the listener with the grace you hope they’ll show.

It is the twin of **Tamil** *tayavu seytu* (“do the kindness”) — both use a “do” verb — and cousins with **Kannada** *dayaviṭṭu* (“having placed compassion”). Further off, **Arabic** *min faḍlik* (“from your grace”) and **Hindi** *krpayā* (from *krpā*, “compassion”) ask in the very same spirit.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

daya + a light verb, four ways:

- Telugu దయచేసి *dayacēsi* — compassion + **having done**
- Tamil தயவுசெய்து *tayavu seytu* — kindness + **do**
- Kannada ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *dayaviṭṭu* — compassion + **having placed**
- Malayalam ദയവായി *dayavāyi* — compassion + **as / having become**

Script you’ll notice: Sound & structure point

The middle syllable **చే** is *ca* wearing the **long-ē** sign -**ే** (the counterpart of the short-e sign -**ె**), giving *cē*; then **సి** is *sa* + the *i* sign (-**ి**). Telugu marks a vowel’s length and quality by the little sign riding on the consonant — the consonant stays put, the vowel-sign changes the tune.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “daya” — compassion — then “cēsi,” having done
- the whole word — “dayacēsi” = please
- the two pieces again, slowly — “daya” then “cēsi”

Before you move on

What is the Telugu word for please? (దయచేసి *dayacēsi*.) What do its pieces mean? (“**Compassion**” *daya* + “**having done**” *cēsi*.) Which cousins ask the same way? (**Tamil, Kannada, Malayalam** with *daya* — plus **Arabic** *faḍl*, **Hindi** *krpā*.) Which sign sits on the middle syllable? (**The long-ē sign -ే**, making చ into చే.)

8.2 -ండి (-aṇḍi) — where Telugu actually keeps “please”

You now have దయచేసి for *please*. Now the honest part: most of the time, a Telugu speaker asking politely does not say it.

You’ll want to know: The ending does the work

Telugu politeness rides on the **respectful command ending -ండి (-aṇḍi)**. It is not a separate word you add — it is a **tail on the verb**, and it is already “please.”

respectful form

కూర్చొండి <i>kūrcōṇḍi</i>	please sit
చెప్పండి <i>ceppaṇḍi</i>	please tell me

Each of these is a verb with -ండి on the end, and each is already polite — no extra word required. There is a shorter form of every one of them, used with a friend or a child; you will meet those verbs properly later, so take the -ండి forms as wholes for now. The short form is not rude, it is *close*, and using it with a stranger is the mistake. Leaving out దయచేసి is not.

Why it’s said this way

The standalone దయచేసి is **formal or emphatic**. It is not the everyday “please” — it is the one you reach for to *warm a request further*, on top of an ending that is already polite:

- కూర్చొండి — please sit. Complete, polite, ordinary.
- దయచేసి కూర్చొండి — *do* please sit. Warmer, more insistent, more formal.

So the two stack. What they do not do is substitute: దయచేసి in front of the *short* form reads as oddly as “kindly sit down, mate.”

English keeps politeness in a word you add; Telugu keeps it in the shape of the verb. A learner hunting for a word to translate *please* will reach for దయచేసి far too often and still sound abrupt — because the abruptness was never in the missing word. It was in the ending.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kūrcōṇḍi” — that ending is already “please sit”
- “ceppaṇḍi” — please tell me
- both words together, warmer — “dayacēsi kūrcōṇḍi”

Before you move on

What carries “please” in ordinary Telugu speech? (**The ending** -ండ్రి *-aṇḍi*, on the verb.) Is కూర్చోండ్రి already polite without దయచేసి? (**Yes** — the ending is the politeness.) When do you add దయచేసి? (To make a request **warmer or more formal**, on top of -ండ్రి.) What is wrong with putting దయచేసి in front of the short form? (The **short** ending undercuts the polite word.)

8.3 చ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ం — what does it do? And one from further back: ం?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: చ

చ — *ca*.

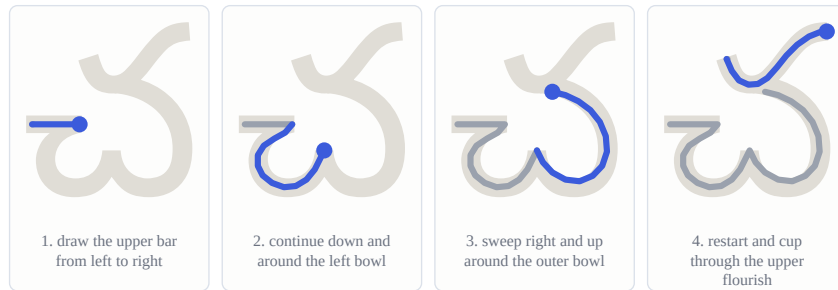
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *c*, it is **ca**.

You already say these, and every one of them has చ somewhere inside it:

- పని చేయు *pani cēyu* — to work (lit. “work-do”)
- నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు *nāku telugu vaccu* — ‘I know Telugu’
- దయచేసి *dayacēsi* — please (dayacēsi

Writing: చ — copy what you see

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_2_1_cha.png, movements 1–4 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How చ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on చ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find చ in the ones that have it
దయచేసి · నమస్కారం
- *Trace it:* చ three times, saying *ca* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find చ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — చ? What sound does it carry? (*ca*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.
One more, from much earlier: డ — what does it do?

Chapter 9

Sorry

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 👁️ eyes (2) ✍️ pen (1) 🖱️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can apologise in Telugu and ask someone to forgive me, using the same respectful ending.

Say క్షమించండి, unpack it as kṣamiñcu plus the respectful -aṇḍi already met in kūrṇcōṇḍi, and trace it to Sanskrit kṣamā.

9.1 క్షమించండి — sorry

You already know దయచేసి and its respectful -ండి ending (*kūr-cōṇḍi*, “please sit”). Telugu’s “sorry” hands you that very ending again, riding a brand-new verb.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- క్షమా (*kṣamā*) = “**forgiveness, patience**” — the Sanskrit noun, borrowed whole.
- -ించు (*-iñcu*) = a **verb-making suffix**: *kṣamā* + *-iñcu* → క్షమించు (*kṣamiñcu*), “**to forgive**.” (The same pattern gives *prārambhiñcu*, “to begin,” from Sanskrit *prārambha*.)
- -ండి (*-aṇḍi*) = the **respectful imperative** ending — exactly the one you already met on *kūrṇcōṇḍi* “please sit” and *ceppaṇḍi* “please tell me.”

So క్షమించండి is “**please forgive**” — the same polite mold you already

know, filled with a new verb.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- Telugu క్షమించండి *kṣamiṇcaṇḍi* — Sanskrit *kṣamā* + **-iṇcu** (verb) + **-aṇḍi** (imperative)
- Kannada ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ *kṣamisi* — Sanskrit *kṣamā* + **-isu** (verb) + **-i** (imperative)
- Malayalam ക്ഷമിക്കണം *kṣamikkanaṁ* — Sanskrit *kṣama* + **-ikkuka** (verb) + **-aṇaṁ** (necessitative)
- Tamil மன்னிக்கவும் *mannikkavum* — its **own** native root *manni*, not Sanskrit at all

Why it's said this way

క్షమించండి is a real, everyday “sorry / please forgive me” — not stiffly formal — though in quick, casual exchanges Telugu speakers just as often reach for the borrowed English “**sorry.**”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kṣamā” — the Sanskrit noun, forgiveness
- the verb — “kṣamiṇcu,” to forgive — then “kṣamiṇcaṇḍi,” please forgive
- the ending you already know — “-aṇḍi,” same as *kūrcōṇḍi*

Before you move on

What is క్షమించండి built from? (**Sanskrit** *kṣamā* + the verb-making suffix **-iṇcu** + the respectful ending **-aṇḍi**, which you already met on *kūrcōṇḍi*.) Which cousins also verb-ify *kṣamā*, and which doesn't? (**Kannada and Malayalam** do too; **Tamil** uses its own root *manni*.) What's the casual alternative? (**Borrowed English** “**sorry.**”)

9.2 ఇటుక (iṭuka) — a brick

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: ఇటుక

ఇటుక — *iṭuka* — “a brick”.

Say it: *iṭuka*. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, ఇ, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *iṭuka*
- *iṭuka*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a brick”? (ఇటుక, *iṭuka*.)

9.3 ఇ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ష — what does it do? And one from further back: ఓ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ఇ

ఇ — *i*.

It is an **independent vowel** — a vowel that is a letter in its own right, not a mark hung on a consonant.

This is the pair that makes Telugu writing click. You already read ఌ, the *i* sign: it rides on a consonant and needs one to exist. ఇ is the same vowel with nothing in front of it, and that is exactly when Telugu reaches for it — at the front of a word, or on a piece of a word quoted on its own.

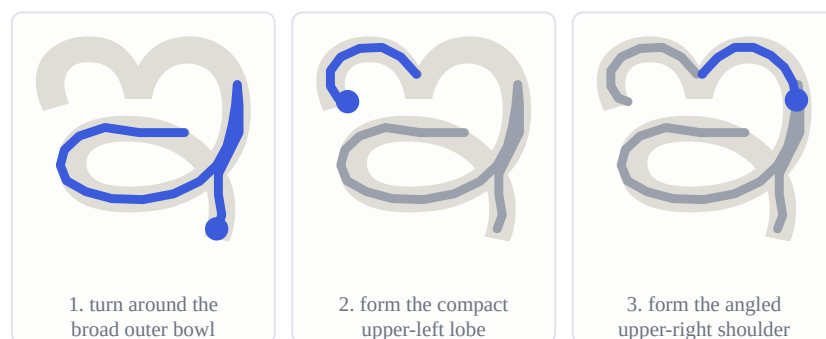
Every vowel in this script has both forms. Meeting the pair once is worth more than meeting either alone, because from here on you can predict the rule: **sign after a consonant, letter when the vowel starts.**

You met it on the page before this one, on a suffix quoted by itself:

- -ఇంచు *-incu* — the ending that turns a borrowed noun into a Telugu verb

Writing: ఇ — copy what you see

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Hojaswani LUCIDA and Physics classes, practice Telugu letters with strokes, independent vowel ఇ decomposition, 00:00–00:05 (YouTube, 14 September 2024)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ఇ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ఇ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one carries the letter ఇ and which carries the sign ీ

-ఇంచు · ఏమిటి

- *Trace it:* ఇ three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ఇ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఇ? When does Telugu write the letter ఇ rather than the sign ీ? (**When the vowel has no consonant in front of it.**)

One more, from much earlier: ఓ — what amount does it stand for?

9.4 How are you, again — and the word that answers క్షమించండి

Someone has said క్షమించండి to you. One word back — the one that tells them it does not matter. You have had it since the greetings.

You'll want to know: పరవాలేదు does three jobs at once

పరవాలేదు *paravālēdu* covers all of these in ordinary speech:

what English says

it's okay	after an apology
no problem	after a request
you're welcome	after thanks

Look at its tail. -లేదు is the *lēdu* you already carry, the negative of existence, and *paravā* is the bother — so the word is “**there is no bother.**” That is why one word answers an apology, a request and a thank-you alike.

Grammar Lens: the ending is already carrying the person

That question and its answer hide the same point:

- మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? — -ఱు already means *you, respectful*, so ఎలా ఉన్నారు? is a whole question on its own.
- నేను బాగున్నాను — -ను already means *I*, so నేను can drop too.

To someone close the ending moves with the pronoun: నువ్వు ఎలా

ఉన్నావు?

Script: బ, the letter your answer starts with

బ

బాగా and బాగున్నాను both open on బ *ba* under the long-ā sign. Telugu keeps *b* apart from its *p* letter; Tamil writes one shape for both and lets the position decide.

Your turn: the whole small exchange

Say these aloud:

- ask a stranger how they are, then drop the pronoun and ask again
- answer that you are well
- apologise, then thank someone — and give the same one-word reply to both

Before you move on

What hides inside పరవాలేదు? (లేదు — “no bother.”) Which three English replies does it cover? (**It’s okay · no problem · you’re welcome.**) Why can మీరు and నేను drop out? (**The ending already names the person.**) Which letter opens your answer? (బ.)

Chapter 10

Days of the Week

Modes: 🗣️ voice (2) 👁️ eyes (1) ✍️ pen (2) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name any day of the week in Telugu, including the Sunday that is counted rather than named for a planet.

Run Somavāram through Śanivāram, then name Sunday ఆదివారం, “the first day” — positional like Arabic’s numbered days, not planetary.

10.1 సోమవారం to ఆదివారం — Telugu’s week, with a twist on Sunday

Like Kannada, Telugu’s week runs on Sanskrit deity-names — but its Sunday breaks the “planet” pattern entirely, in a way even Kannada’s doesn’t.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Telugu	deity/planet	day
సోమవారం (<i>Somavāram</i>)	Moon (Soma)	Monday
మంగళవారం (<i>Maṅgaḷavāram</i>)	Mars (Maṅgala)	Tuesday
బుధవారం (<i>Budhavāram</i>)	Mercury (Budha)	Wednesday
గురువారం (<i>Guruvāram</i>)	Jupiter (Guru/ Bṛhaspati)	Thursday
శుక్రవారం (<i>Śukravāram</i>)	Venus (Śukra)	Friday
శనివారం (<i>Śanivāram</i>)	Saturn (Śani)	Saturday
ఆదివారం (<i>Ādivāram</i>)	— not a planet at all	Sunday

Why it's said this way

Five days match the familiar planet-deity pattern — but ఆదివారం (*Ādivāram*) doesn't name the Sun at all. ఆది (*ādi*) is Sanskrit for “**the beginning, the first**.” So Telugu's Sunday literally means “**the first day**” — a **positional** name, like Arabic's numbered weekdays, sitting right next to six planet-names that don't work that way. Even within one single week, a language can mix completely different naming strategies.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “Somavāram, Maṅgaḷavāram, Budhavāram, Guruvāram, Śukravāram, Śanivāram” — Monday through Saturday
- the odd one — “Ādivāram” — not a planet, “the first day”
- the parallel — like Arabic's numbered days, one Telugu day is positional too

Before you move on

What does ఆదివారం literally mean, and is it a planet-name? (“**The first day**” — *ādi* “beginning” — **not** a planet-name, unlike the other six.) What ending do the other six Telugu weekdays share? (-వారం *-vāram*, Sanskrit “day,” each paired with a planet-deity.)

10.2 శ — the third s, and the last one

You have two s-shapes already: స, and the curled one you met beside it. Say which of the two puts your tongue further back.

Two of the day names from this chapter carry a third one.

Script you’ll notice: శ

శ — *śa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *ś*, it is *śa*.

- శుక్రవారం *śukravāram* — Friday
- శనివారం *śanivāram* — Saturday

Both open on today’s character. **The two ends of the week you have been reciting begin with a letter you could not yet read.**

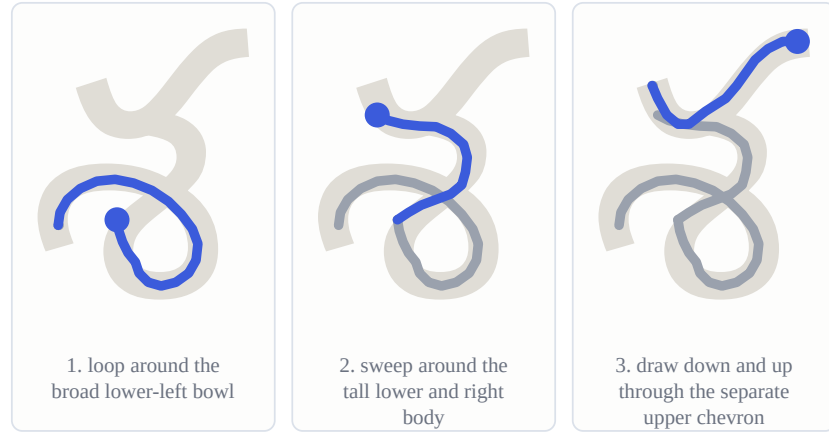
Now you have the whole set:

letter	romanized	where the tongue goes
స	<i>sa</i>	tip behind the teeth
ష	<i>ṣa</i>	curled back along the roof
శ	<i>śa</i>	flat against the front of the roof

Telugu, Kannada and Hindi keep all three apart on the page. Tamil’s own alphabet has none of them and adds borrowed shapes for Sanskrit words — same family, opposite decision.

Writing: శ — three calm movements

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant శ animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_శ in version 3.8.05 (3805)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How శ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 loops around the broad lower-left bowl. Lift, then movement 2 sweeps around the tall lower and right body. Lift once more for movement 3, the separate chevron above.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the three movements clear instead of closing the two pen lifts. Then write స and ష beside it.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the two day names below and find శ at the front of each

శుక్రవారం · శనివారం

- *Trace it:* శ three times, saying *śa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* at సంతోషం and say which two of the three s letters are in it

Before you move on

Which character is this — శ? What sound does it carry? (*śa.*)
 Which two days of the week begin with it? (శుక్రవారం and శనివారం.)
 How many separate s letters does Telugu print? (**Three** — స, ష, శ.)

10.3 ల — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఇ — what does it do? And one from further back: య?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ల

ల — *la.*

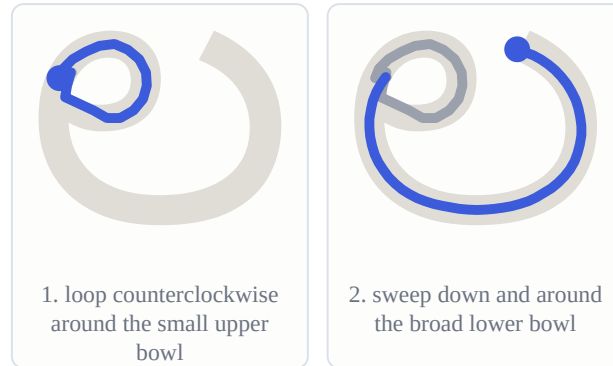
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *l*, it is **la**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ల somewhere inside it:

- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
- లేదు *lēdu* — no / there isn’t (lēdu)
- పరవాలేదు *paravālēdu* — it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome
- రేపు కలుద్దాం *rēpu kaluddām* — see you tomorrow

Writing: ల — two calm movements

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 mov



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant ల animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_ల in version 3.8.05 (3805)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ల is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 loops counterclockwise around the small upper bowl. Lift, then movement 2 sweeps down and around the broad lower bowl.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the two movements clear instead of closing the pen lift.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ల in the ones that have it

ధన్యవాదములు · లేదు · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ల three times, saying *la* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ల once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — అ? What sound does it carry? (*la.*)

Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: ష — what does it do?

10.4 ఐదు అచ్చులు — five vowel letters, from cold

Close the lessons before this one. Say the word for yes and the number six, and name the character each of them opens on.

Script: the five, and the one question behind them

అ · ఆ · ఏ · ఐ · ఒ

Five letters, and **every one of them is on the page for the same reason:** a vowel turned up at the front of a word with no consonant to sit inside.

letter	sound	the word it opens
అ	<i>a</i>	అవును — yes
ఆ	<i>ā</i>	ఆరు — six
ఏ	<i>ē</i>	ఏమిటి — what?
ఐ	<i>ai</i>	ఐదు — five
ఒ	<i>o</i>	ఒకటి — one

Look down the right-hand column. **Three of the five open a number you can already count with, and the other two open two of the commonest words in the book.** None of these is an exotic letter kept for later; they were on your pages from chapter one, and only now do you have the shapes for them.

The question to ask of any vowel in Telugu is the same each time: *is a consonant carrying it?* If yes, a sign. If no, a letter.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words and name the vowel letter each one begins with

ఒకటి · ఆరు · అవును · ఏమిటి

- *Say it:* which two of the five are the short and long pair

- *Say it:* which one of the five is a vowel your mouth has to move through
- *Trace it:* each of the five once, saying its sound

Before you move on

Which of the five opens the number one? (ఒ.) Which opens the number five? (ఐ.) Which pair differs only in length? (అ and ఆ.) And what has to be true of a vowel before Telugu writes it as a letter? (**Nothing is carrying it** — no consonant in front.)

10.5 The three goodbyes again, now that you can name the day

From memory: the ordinary Telugu goodbye. Then say what it means word for word, which is not “goodbye” at all.

You’ll want to know: none of the three says “goodbye”

You have three ways to leave, and every one of them promises a return:

what you say	what it says
వెళ్ళి వస్తాను <i>velli vastānu</i>	having gone, I come
రేపు కలుద్దాం <i>rēpu kaluddām</i>	tomorrow, let us meet
మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం <i>mallī kaluddām</i>	again, let us meet

Telugu has no comfortable word for a plain, final parting. The polite thing is to name the return, and the three above are three sizes of it — the next hour, the next day, some day.

Grammar Lens: the “having ...ed” link

వెళ్ళి is not a finished verb — it is *having gone*, waiting for a second verb to complete it. Telugu chains actions this way: every verb but the last takes the *having ...ed* shape, and the last one carries the person and the time.

వెళ్ళి వస్తాను = *having gone* + *I come*. The -తాను at the end is the same “I” ending you met on మాట్లాడతాను.

Your turn: pick the right size of return

Say these aloud:

- leaving a shop you will pass again this week
- leaving a class that meets again tomorrow
- leaving someone you may not see for a year
- the plain verb for *to go*, then the *having gone* form

Before you move on

What do all three farewells have in common? (**Each one promises a return.**) What does వెళ్ళి వస్తాను say literally? (**Having gone, I come.**) Which part of it carries the “I”? (**The -తాను ending.**) And which of the three would you use with someone you see tomorrow? (రేపు కలుద్దాం.)

Chapter 11

Four Core Colours

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name four basic colours in Telugu — black, white, red, and blue.

Say నలుపు, తెలుపు, ఎరుపు — Telugu’s own three — then నీలం, blue, which Telugu borrowed rather than inherited.

11.1 నలుపు, తెలుపు, ఎరుపు, నీలం — the pattern completes itself

By now the shape should feel familiar: native colors for black, white, and red — and one shared Sanskrit word for blue. Telugu confirms it a fourth time.

You’ll want to know: Three native colors

- నలుపు (*nalupu*) = “**black**” — native Dravidian.
- తెలుపు (*telupu*) = “**white**” — native Dravidian.
- ఎరుపు (*erupu*) = “**red**” — native Dravidian.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

నీలం (*nīlam*) = “**blue**” — the identical Sanskrit नील (*nīla*) loan that also sits in Tamil (*nīlam*), Malayalam (*nīla*), Kannada (*nīli*), and Hindi (*nīlā*). Four Dravidian languages plus Hindi, all independently

keeping their own native black/white/red, and all reaching for the **exact same** borrowed word the moment it comes to blue.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nalupu, telupu, erupu” — black, white, red
- “nīlam” — blue, the word the four Dravidian languages and Hindi all share
- the whole pattern, one more time — native, native, native, **borrowed**

Before you move on

What’s the pattern across Tamil, Malayalam, Kannada, and Telugu’s basic colors? (**Black, white, and red are native Dravidian words in every one of them; blue is a shared Sanskrit loan (nīla) in every one of them.**)

11.2 ె — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ె — what does it do? And one from further back: ె?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ె

ె — *e*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *e*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ె somewhere inside it:

- వెళ్ళు *vellu* — to go (and వచ్చు, to come)

- వెళ్లి వస్తాను *velli vastānu* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)
- నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు *nāku telugu vaccu* — ‘I know Telugu’
- ఒకటి రెండు మూడు నాలుగు ఐదు *okaṭi reṇḍu mūḍu nālugu aidu* — one to five

Writing: ె — copy what you see

Put your pen on ె and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ె in the ones that have it

వెళ్ళు · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ె three times, saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ె once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ె? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *e* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: ూ — what amount does it stand for?

Chapter 12

Family

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 👁️ eyes (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my parents and my brothers and sisters in Telugu, choosing the right word for older or younger.

Name నాన్న and అమ్మ, then the four age-graded siblings అన్న · తమ్ముడు · అక్క · చెల్లి, with చెల్లి being Telugu’s own.

12.1 నాన్న, అమ్మ, and four sibling words — Telugu’s own twist

Telugu also sorts siblings by relative age. Its words for “father” and “younger sister,” though, go their own way.

You’ll want to know: Parents — one matches, one is Telugu’s own

- నాన్న (*nānna*) = “**father**” — **Telugu’s own word**, unlike Tamil/Kannada’s *appā/appa*.
- అమ్మ (*amma*) = “**mother**” — matches Tamil/Kannada’s *ammā/amma* closely.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Telugu	meaning	compare Tamil/ Kannada
అన్న (anna)	older brother	<i>aṇṇan/aṇṇa</i> — near match
తమ్ముడు (tammudu)	younger brother	<i>tambi/tamma</i> — near match
అక్క (akka)	older sister	<i>akkā/akka</i> — near match
చెల్లి (celli)	younger sister	<i>tangai/tangi</i> — Telugu's own word here

So the *system* — four words, split by relative age rather than just gender — is shared across Tamil, Kannada, and Telugu. But the exact words aren't identical everywhere: Telugu keeps its own నాన్న for father and చెల్లి for “younger sister,” even while three of the six words line up closely with its cousins.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nānna, amma” — father, mother
- “anna, tammudu” — older/younger brother
- “akka, celli” — older/younger sister — celli is Telugu's own

Before you move on

Which two Telugu family words are its own, rather than matching Tamil/Kannada? (నాన్న *nānna*, “father,” and చెల్లి *celli*, “younger sister.”) Does Telugu still split siblings by age the same way? (**Yes** — the four-way age-before-gender system is shared across the whole Dravidian family, even where the exact words differ.)

12.2 డ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ె — what does it do? And one from further back: ఑?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: డ

డ — *da*.

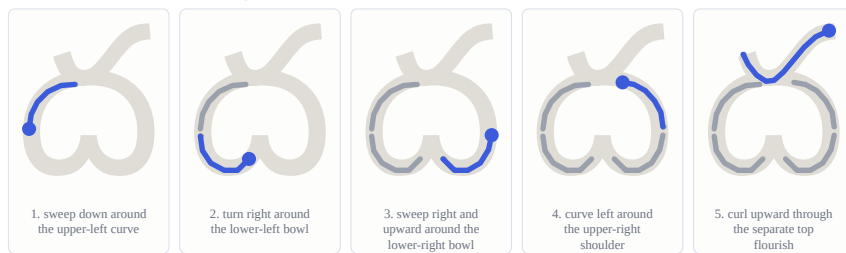
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *d*, it is **da**.

You already say these, and every one of them has డ somewhere inside it:

- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
- లేదు *lēdu* — no / there isn’t (lēdu)
- పరవాలేదు *paravālēdu* — it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome
- రేపు కలుద్దాం *rēpu kaluddām* — see you tomorrow

Writing: డ — five deliberate movements

How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant డ packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_4_3_dha.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_4_3_dha.png, movements 1–5 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How డ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movements 1–4 build the round body in four short curves: upper left, lower left, lower

right, then upper right. Lift between each curve. Movement 5 adds the rising top flourish.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so preserve the five clear movements rather than trying to join the gaps.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ద in the ones that have it

ధన్యవాదములు · లేదు · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ద three times, saying *da* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ద once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ద? What sound does it carry? (*da.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.
One more, from much earlier: త — what does it do?

12.3 The first three verbs again — one engine, and its negative

The first three plain verbs, in any order: *to speak, to stay, to work*. Say them before reading on.

You'll want to know: the three verbs, side by side

plain verb	the “I” form
మాట్లాడు <i>māṭlāḍu</i> — speak	మాట్లాడతాను <i>māṭlāḍatānu</i>
ఉండు <i>uṇḍu</i> — be, stay, live	ఉంటాను <i>uṇṭānu</i>
పని చేయు <i>pani cēyu</i> — work	పని చేస్తాను <i>pani cēstānu</i>

Read the right-hand column downwards and listen to the last three sounds of each. -ాను every time. Three different verbs, one ending, and it is the ending that means *I*.

Grammar Lens: stem, then time, then person

Every Telugu verb you meet from here is built in that order: the **stem** says what happens, the next piece says **when**, the last piece says **who**. It is the same gluing-on you met on the end of ధన్యవాదములు, applied to actions rather than nouns.

Because the *who* sits at the end, నేను is optional — and because the *when* sits in the middle, changing the time never disturbs the person.

What you've built — ఉండు and its negative

ఉండు is the verb of *being there*, and Telugu keeps a dedicated word for its denial: లేదు, *there is not*. Learn the two as a pair rather than as a verb and a stray word.

That pairing is what makes పరవాలేదు readable rather than memorised: *paravā* is the bother, -లేదు says there is none. A word you took whole when you learned to answer *how are you* turns out to be a sentence built on this verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- I speak Telugu — then drop the pronoun and say it again
- where you live, using the *stay* verb
- that you work
- someone apologises for being late — give the one-word reply

Before you move on

What ending do all three “I” forms share? (-నాను.) In what order does a Telugu verb stack its pieces? (**Stem, then time, then person.**) Which word denies ఉండు? (లేదు.) And what is పరవాలేదు made of? (*Paravā*, the bother, plus -లేదు — there is none.)

Chapter 13

Head and Hand

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the head and the hand in Telugu.

Say తల, plainly matching its cousins, and చెయ్యి — the same Dravidian root as kai, reshaped by sound change past easy recognition.

13.1 తల, చెయ్యి — head and hand

Head matches its cousins plainly. Hand looks, at first glance, like Telugu went its own way — but look closer, and it’s the same word after all, just heavily reshaped.

You’ll want to know: The words

- తల (*tala*) = “**head**” — native Dravidian, matching Tamil *talai*, Malayalam *thala*, and Kannada *tale* closely and plainly.
- చెయ్యి (*ceyyi*) = “**hand**” — also native Dravidian, and **the very same root** as Tamil/Malayalam/Kannada’s *kai*: Proto-Dravidian *kay-*. Telugu’s own regular sound change turned that ancient **k-** into **c-**, and reshaped the rest of the word alongside it — so *ceyyi* only *looks* unrelated to *kai*. It’s a cognate in disguise, not a different word.

So all four Dravidian languages actually **agree** on both “head” and “hand” at the root level — Telugu’s hand-word has simply drifted further in sound than its cousins have, thanks to a sound change that reshaped many Telugu words the same way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “tala” — head, matching its cousins plainly
- “ceyyi” — hand, the SAME root as kai, reshaped by sound change
- the lesson — looks different, is actually the same word

Before you move on

Does Telugu’s word for “head” match its cousins? (**Yes** — *tala*, like Tamil/Malayalam/Kannada.) Is its word for “hand,” *ceyyi*, truly a different word from *kai*? (**No** — it’s the **same Proto-Dravidian root** *kay-*, reshaped by Telugu’s own regular *k*→*c* sound change — a cognate in disguise, not an unrelated word.)

13.2 వ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: చ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఇ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: వ

వ — *va*.

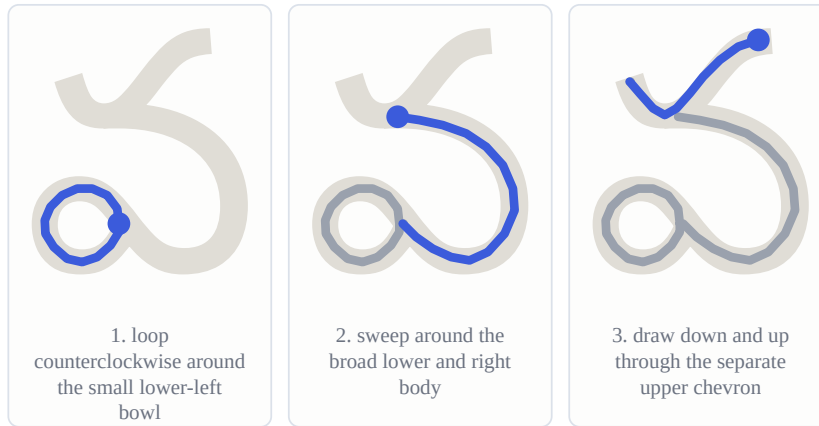
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *v*, it is **va**.

You already say these, and every one of them has వ somewhere inside it:

- ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu* — thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
- అవును *avunu* — yes (avunu)
- నువ్వు / మీరు *nuvvu / mīru* — you (familiar / respectful)
- పరవాలేదు *paravālēdu* — it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome

Writing: వ — three calm movements

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant వ animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_వ in version 3.8.05 (3805)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How వ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 loops counterclockwise around the small lower-left bowl. Lift, then movement 2 sweeps around the broad lower and right body. Lift once more for movement 3, the separate chevron above.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the three movements clear instead of closing the two pen lifts.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find వ in the ones that have it

ధన్యవాదములు · అవును · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* వ three times, saying *va* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find వ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — **Ƶ**? What sound does it carry? (*va.*)

Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: **Ɔ** — what amount does it stand for?

Chapter 14

Seasons

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the four seasons in Telugu, including the rains that anchor the year.

Say వేసవి (*cousin of Kannada's bēṣige*), వానాకాలం and శీతాకాలం from native roots, then the doubly-Sanskrit వసంత ఋతువు.

14.1 వసంత ఋతువు, వేసవి, వానాకాలం, శీతాకాలం — the pattern completes itself

Telugu closes out the Dravidian season words the same way Kannada did: native words for summer/rain/cold, and a spring-word borrowed twice over from Sanskrit.

You'll want to know: The words

Telugu	meaning	source
వసంత ఋతువు (<i>vasanta ṛtuvu</i>)	“spring”	both <i>vasanta</i> and ఋతువు <i>ṛtuvu</i> (“season”) are Sanskrit, like Kannada’s pair
వేసవి (<i>vēsavi</i>)	“summer”	native Dravidian — cousin of Kannada’s <i>bēsige</i>
వానాకాలం (<i>vānākālam</i>)	“rainy season”	వాన <i>vāna</i> (“rain,” native) + <i>kālam</i> (“time,” itself Sanskrit-derived but long assimilated)
శీతాకాలం (<i>śītākālam</i>)	“winter/cold season”	<i>śīta</i> (“cold”) leans Sanskrit-flavored here, unlike Tamil/ Kannada’s fully native cold-words

Why it’s said this way

Telugu’s *vēsavi* and Kannada’s *bēsige* are close enough in shape to be genuine cousins — the same native Dravidian summer-word wearing two languages’ sound changes. And once again, it’s వానాకాలం (*vānākālam*, the rains) that actually organizes Andhra/Telangana’s agricultural year, not a clean four-way Western split — the same honest point its neighbours make.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “vēsavi” — summer, cousin of Kannada’s *bēsige*
- “vānākālam” — the rains, the real central season
- “śītākālam” — the cold season
- the double Sanskrit loan — “vasanta ṛtuvu,” like Kannada

Before you move on

What's the relationship between Telugu's *vēsavi* and Kannada's *bēsige*? (**Cousins** — the same native Dravidian summer-word.) Which Dravidian languages borrow BOTH halves of their spring-word from Sanskrit (the season-name AND the word for “season” itself)? (**Kannada and Telugu** — *vasanta ṛtu(vu)* — unlike Tamil/Malayalam's single *vasantham* loan plus the long-assimilated *kaalam*.)

14.2 గ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: వ — what does it do? And one from further back: ల?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: గ

గ — *ga*.

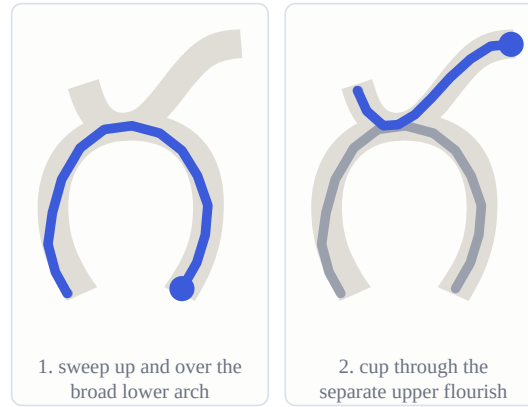
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *g*, it is **ga**.

You already say these, and every one of them has గ somewhere inside it:

- బాగా *bāgā* — well, fine — and the reply ”నేను బాగున్నాను
- నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను — I speak Telugu
- నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు *nāku telugu vaccu* — 'I know Telugu'
- ఒకటి రెండు మూడు నాలుగు ఐదు *okaṭi reṇḍu mūḍu nālugu aidu* — one to five

Writing: ధ — copy what you see

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant ధ packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_1_3_ga.png, movements 1–2 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ధ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ధ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ధ in the ones that have it

బాగా · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ధ three times, saying *ga* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ధ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — 𐌵? What sound does it carry? (*ga.*)

Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: 𐌶 — what does it do?

Chapter 15

Water and Rice

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask for water in Telugu and tell raw rice apart from cooked rice.

Say నీళ్లు — matching Tamil and Kannada — then separate బియ్యం, Telugu’s own word for raw rice, from అన్నం, the cooked rice on the plate.

15.1 నీళ్లు, బియ్యం, అన్నం — water and rice

Water closes out 3-against-1 against Malayalam. Rice, though, turns out to have its own twist here.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

నీళ్లు (*nīḷḷu*) = “**water**” — matching Tamil’s *nīr* and Kannada’s *nīru*. Malayalam’s *vellam* is the odd one out among all four Dravidian languages for water, not Telugu.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- బియ్యం (*biyyam*) = “**rice**” (raw grain) — **Telugu’s own word**, unlike the shared *ari/arisi/akki* found in Malayalam, Tamil, and Kannada.
- అన్నం (*annam*) = “**cooked rice**” (the meal) — matching Kannada’s *anna* closely, both likely Sanskrit-influenced.

So the pattern flips between water and rice: for **water**, Telugu joins the majority (Tamil/Kannada) against Malayalam; for **raw rice**, Telugu is itself the odd one out against the other three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nīllu” — water, matching Tamil/Kannada
- “biyyam” — raw rice, Telugu’s own word
- “annam” — cooked rice, matching Kannada’s anna

Before you move on

Which language is the odd one out for water, and which for raw rice? (**Malayalam** is the odd one out for water (*vellam*); **Telugu** is the odd one out for raw rice (*biyyam*, unlike the shared *ari/arisi/akki* elsewhere).)

15.2 ీ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ు — what does it do? And one from further back: ృ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ీ

ీ — ī.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with ī. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ీ somewhere inside it:

- నువ్వు / మీరు *nuvvu* / *mīru* — you (familiar / respectful)
- మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? — what’s your name?

- మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? — how are you? (respectful)
- మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం *maḷḷi kaluddām* — we'll meet again

Writing: ీ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ీ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ీ in the ones that have it

నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ీ three times, saying ī as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ీ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ీ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts ī on; takes the built-in a off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: హ — what does it do?

Chapter 16

The Traditional Months

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the twelve traditional Telugu months and say when Ugadi, the new year, falls.

Recite Caitrami through Phālgunāmi, place Ugadi at Chaitra Śuddha Pādyaṃi, and note the family split: Telugu and Kannada share Hindi's calendar, Tamil and Malayalam do not.

16.1 చైత్రం to ఫాల్గుణం — completing the split

The pattern across all four Dravidian languages is now complete: Telugu, like Kannada, shares its calendar with Hindi rather than building its own.

You'll want to know: The twelve months

The year runs in three four-month groups:

- చైత్రం, వైశాఖం, జ్యేష్ఠం, ఆషాఢం — *Caitrami, Vaiśākhami, Jyēṣṭhami, Āṣāḍhami*.
- శ్రావణం, భాద్రపదం, ఆశ్వయుజం, కార్తీకం — *Śrāvaṇami, Bhādrapadamī, Āśvayujamī, Kārtikamī*.
- మార్గశిరం, పుష్యం, మాఘం, ఫాల్గుణం — *Mārgaśīrami, Puṣyamī, Māghamī, Phālgunāmi*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

This closes out a genuine, clean split across the four Dravidian languages: **Tamil** and **Malayalam** each built their **own** solar calendar (nakshatra-named and zodiac-named, respectively) — while **Kannada** and **Telugu** instead share the **same pan-Indian Sanskritic lunisolar calendar** as Hindi’s Vikram Samvat. Telugu’s New Year, **Ugadi**, falls on the very same day as Kannada’s — *Chaitra Śuddha Pādyami*, the first day of Chaitra’s bright fortnight.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the twelve — “Caitraṁ, Vaiśākhaṁ, Jyēṣṭhaṁ, Āṣāḍhaṁ, Śrāvaṇaṁ, Bhādrapadaṁ, Āśvayujaṁ, Kārtikaṁ, Mārgaśiraṁ, Pūṣyaṁ, Māghaṁ, Phālgunaṁ”
- “Ugadi — Chaitra Śuddha Pādyami”
- the whole family split — Tamil/Malayalam their own; Kannada/Telugu shared with Hindi

Before you move on

How does the four-language Dravidian calendar picture split? (**Tamil and Malayalam** each have their **own** solar calendar; **Kannada and Telugu** share the **same pan-Indian lunisolar calendar** as Hindi.) What is Telugu’s New Year, and when does it fall? (**Ugadi**, on *Chaitra Śuddha Pādyami* — the same day as Kannada’s Ugadi.)

16.2 ీ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ీ — what does it do? And one from further back: ు?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ೀ

ೀ — *ai*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

This one is a **diphthong** — two vowels run together into one sound, *a* gliding into *i*. Say *ai* as in English *aisle* and you have it.

Look at what it is made of. You already read ು, the short *e* sign; ೀ is that mark with a second stroke added above it. The month names you just learned carry it twice.

You already say these, and both have ೀ inside them:

- ೀೞಂ *Caitram* — the first of the twelve months
- ೀೞಾಖಂ *Vaiśākhami* — the second

Writing: ೀ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ೀ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these three, and find the two that carry ೀ

ೀೞಂ · ೀೞಾಖಂ · ೀೞು

- *Trace it:* ೀ three times, saying *ai* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ೀ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఌ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to? (*ai*, **two vowels glided into one.**)
One more, from much earlier: ఋ — what amount does it stand for?

16.3 ఖ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఌ — what does it do? And one from further back: వ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ఖ

ఖ — *kha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *kh*, it is **kha**.

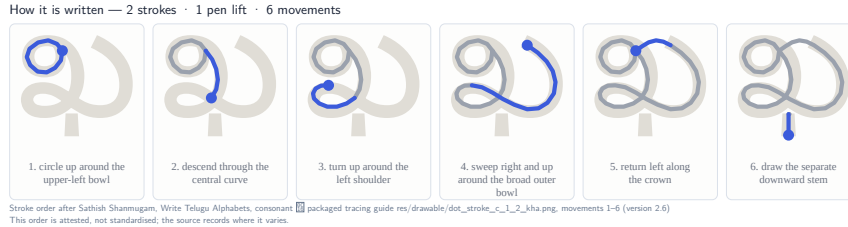
The very first character this book asked you to trace was క, *ka*. This is that letter with a **puff of breath after it**. The mouth does not move: the back of the tongue lands in the same place. What changes is that the breath is let out before the vowel starts.

Say *ka*, then say it again and push a small hiss of air out behind it. Telugu writes those as two different letters because it hears them as two different letters — and once you know this pair you can expect the others, because most of the consonants in this alphabet come with a breathed partner.

You already say this one, and the breathed letter is inside it:

- వైశాఖం *Vaiśākhami* — the second of the twelve months

Writing: ఖ — copy what you see



How ఖ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ఖ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one has ఖ and which has క

వైశాఖం · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ఖ three times, saying *kha* and letting the breath out as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ఖ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఖ? What sound does it carry, and how is it different from క? (*kha* — the same mouth, with a puff of breath let out after it.)

One more, from much earlier: ఌ — what amount does it stand for?

Chapter 17

Noon and Midnight

Modes:  voice (1)  eyes (2)  pen (3)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say noon and midnight in Telugu and explain why one is “middle” and the other “half.”

Say మధ్యాహ్నం and అర్ధరాత్రి, then separate madhya (“middle”) from ardha (“half”) — two different Sanskrit roots where Kannada uses one.

17.1 మధ్యాహ్నం, అర్ధరాత్రి — the same noon word, a different midnight word

Telugu and Kannada share the exact same Sanskrit word for noon — but then quietly part ways on midnight.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

మధ్యాహ్నం (*madhyāhnam*) = “**noon, midday**” — the same Sanskrit *tatsama* compound as Kannada’s *madhyāhna*: మధ్య (*madhya*, “**middle**”) + అహ్న (*ahna*, “**day**”), plus Telugu’s own -ం (*anusvāra*) ending. Same root, same meaning, same everyday register in both languages.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

అర్ధరాత్రి (*ardharātri*) = “**midnight**” — but here Telugu reaches for a **different** Sanskrit root: అర్ధ (*ardha*, “**half**”), not *madhya* (“middle”).

Paired with ರಾತ್ರಿ (*rātri*, “night”), it literally means “**half-night**” — structurally the same shape as Hindi’s colloquial *ādhī rāt* (“half night”) and Latin’s transparent *media nox* pattern, but built from Sanskrit’s own dedicated “half” word rather than “middle.”

Grammar Lens: Be honest: two different “middle-ish” ideas, side by side

Don’t assume *madhya* and *ardha* are the same word wearing different clothes — they’re genuinely **separate Sanskrit roots** (“middle” vs. “half”) that happen to land on the same meaning here, the way English “midday” and “half the day gone” would both point at noon without sharing a root. Telugu’s noon word keeps Kannada’s “middle” logic; its midnight word switches to “half” logic instead.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “madhyāhnam” — noon, same root as Kannada
- “ardharātri” — midnight, literally “half-night”
- the contrast — “madhya” (middle) for noon, “ardha” (half) for midnight — two different Sanskrit roots

Before you move on

Does Telugu’s noon word match Kannada’s? (**Yes** — both *madhyāhna(m)*, from *madhya*, “middle.”) Does Telugu’s midnight word use the same root? (**No** — *ardharātri* uses **ardha**, “half,” a different Sanskrit root.) What does *ardharātri* literally mean? (“**Half-night**” — the same shape as Hindi’s *ādhī rāt*.)

17.2 ఖ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఖ — what does it do? And one from further back: గ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ఘ

ఘ — *gha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *gh*, it is **gha**.

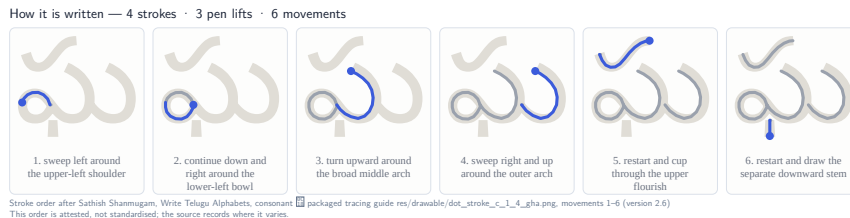
The same trick as last time, one row down. గ is *ga*; ఘ is *ga* with the breath let out behind it.

That is now two breathed pairs — క/ఖ and గ/ఘ — and they behave identically. When you meet a Telugu letter you do not know, it is worth asking first whether it is a letter you *do* know wearing extra breath.

You already say this one, and the breathed letter is inside it:

- మాఘం *Māgham* — the eleventh of the twelve months

Writing: ఘ — copy what you see



How ఘ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ఘ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one has ఘ and which has గ

మాఘం · బాగా

- *Trace it:* ఘ three times, saying *gha* and letting the breath out as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ఘ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఘ? What sound does it carry, and which plain letter is it built on? (*gha*, built on *g*.)
One more, from much earlier: య — what does it do?

17.3 థ — the curled t, with the breath let out

Before the new one: ట — what sound does it carry, and where does your tongue go for it?

Today’s character is that one with a puff of air after it.

Script you’ll notice: థ

థ — *tha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *th*, it is **ṭha**.

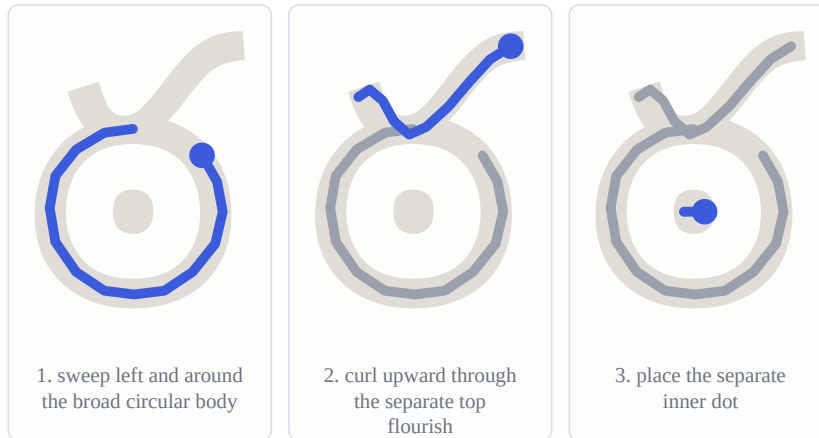
- జ్యేష్ఠం *gyēṣṭham* — Jyeshtha, the third month of the year (jyēṣṭham — “the eldest”)

ట and థ are the same tongue position with and without the **breath**, the pair this script marks and English does not. The romanization writes them *ṭ* and *ṭha*, which is a difference of two letters for a difference you can hear; on the page they are two separate shapes, and that is the more reliable signal.

This one is rare. It is worth a page because a month name needs it, and a reader who meets an unfamiliar shape in a familiar list has no way to tell whether the word or the printing is at fault.

Writing: థ — three deliberate movements

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant థ packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_3_2_ta.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_3_2_ta.png, movements 1–3 (version 2.6)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How థ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movement 1 sweeps around the broad circular body. Movement 2 curls upward through the separate top flourish. Finish by placing the inner dot as movement 3. Then write ట beside it and look at the two.

This is one attested school-style order. Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the three movements distinct and let the round shape grow from them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the month name below and find థ near its end

జ్యేష్ఠం

- *Trace it:* థ once, following all three numbered movements
- *Copy:* థ twice without tracing, saying *tha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which of ట and థ has the breath after it

Before you move on

Which character is this — థ? What sound does it carry? (*tha*.)
What is the only difference between it and ట? (The breath after it.)

17.4 ఆరు అక్షరాలు — six characters, from cold

Close the lessons before this one. Say the greeting and the thank-you word, and name the character each of them carries that you met most recently.

Script: the six, side by side

మ · ధ · ట · థ · ణ · త

Four are letters and two are signs. **A letter can stand where a word begins; a sign has to hang on a letter**, and telling which is which is the first question to ask of an unfamiliar shape.

letters	signs
మ ధ ట త	థ ణ

Your turn

- *Look*: at these words and name every character in them you have been taught

నమస్కారం · ధన్యవాదములు · ఏమిటి · తొమ్మిది

- *Say it*: which of the six is the one you have seen most often
- *Say it*: which two of the six cannot start a word
- *Trace it*: each of the four letters once, saying its sound

Before you move on

Which two of the six are signs rather than letters? (థ and ణ)
Which pair is one tongue position with and without the breath? (ట and త.) Which of the two o signs is the long one? (ణ)

17.5 ఫ — ప, with the breath let out

A page ago you met ట and ఠ — one tongue position, with and without a puff of air after it. Say both.

Now say ప. Today's character does to ప what ఠ did to ట.

Script you'll notice: ఫ

ఫ — *pha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *ph*, it is **pha**.

- ఫాల్గుణం *phālgunam* — Phalguna, the twelfth month of the year

Hold a hand in front of your mouth. Say ప: the air stays put. Say ఫ: the air comes out. That puff is the whole difference, and Telugu gives it a shape of its own rather than leaving you to guess from the neighbours.

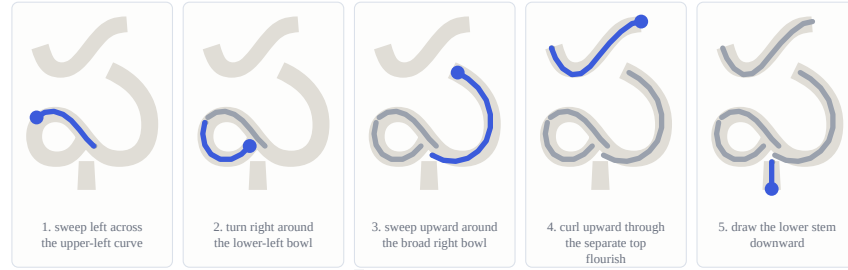
no breath	breath
ట	ఠ
ప	ఫ

Read the romanization carefully here: *ph* is one sound with air behind it, not the *f* that the same two English letters make in *phone*. Two letters on the romanized line, one character on the Telugu line, one puff in the mouth.

This character is rare on these pages. It earns a lesson because the last of the twelve months needs it, and an unfamiliar shape inside a list you already know by heart leaves a reader unable to tell whether the word or the printing is at fault.

Writing: ఫ — five calm movements

How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shannugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant ఫ packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_5_2_pha.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_5_2_pha.png, movements 1-5 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ఫ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 sweeps left across the upper part of the small bowl. Lift, then movement 2 turns around its lower half. Movement 3 makes the broad bowl on the right. Lift for movement 4, the small rising flourish above, then lift once more and draw movement 5, the short straight stem below.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the five clear movements instead of closing the small gaps.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the month name below and find ఫ at its front

ఫాల్గుణం

- *Trace it:* ఫ three times, saying *pha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* ప and ఫ one after the other with a hand in front of your mouth

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఫ? What sound does it carry? (*pha.*)
Which month begins with it? (ఫాల్గుణం.) Name the other pair in this book that differs only by the breath. (ట and థ.)

17.6 నాలుగు అక్షరాలు — four characters, from cold

Close the lessons before this one. Say how you are, and say the two days at the end of the week. Name the character each of those answers starts on.

Script: the four, and what each one stands next to

బ · ప · శ · ష

Not one of these four arrived on its own. Each stands beside a character you had already been reading for chapters, and what it adds is a single change you can hear:

already yours	new	what changed
ప <i>pa</i>	బ <i>ba</i>	the voice switched on
ప <i>pa</i>	ఫ <i>pha</i>	a puff of air came after it
స <i>sa</i>	ష <i>ṣa</i>	the tongue curled back
స <i>sa</i>	శ <i>śa</i>	the tongue went flat against the front of the roof

Two of the four hang off ప and two off స. A reader who holds those two anchors in mind has four fewer shapes to memorise cold, because each of the four is one adjustment away from something already known.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words and name every character in them you have been taught

బాగా · సంతోషం · శనివారం · ఫాల్గుణం

- *Say it:* which of the four you have seen most often on these pages
- *Say it:* which two of the four are s-sounds
- *Trace it:* each of the four once, saying its sound

Before you move on

Which of the four differs from ప by a puff of air? (ఫ.) Which differs from ప by the voice alone? (బ.) Which of ష and శ has the tongue curled back? (ష.) And how many s letters does Telugu print in all, counting the one you had before these two? (**Three.**)

Chapter 18

Telling Time

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 👁️ eyes (1) ✍️ pen (2) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 4 lessons.

***By the end of this chapter:** I can tell someone the time on the hour in Telugu, in the singular and the plural.*

Say గంట — hour, and also “bell” — then ఒక గంట for one o’clock and రెండు గంటలు for two, taking the plural -lu.

18.1 గంట — matching Kannada and Hindi’s “bell” word exactly

Telugu completes a clean three-way match: Hindi, Kannada, and now Telugu all use the same Sanskrit “bell” word for “hour.”

You’ll want to know: గంట — bell AND hour, a third time

గంట (*ganṭa*) = “**hour**” — and, exactly like Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā* and Kannada’s *gaṇṭe*, it means “**bell, clapper**” just as commonly, from the same Sanskrit घण्टा (*ghaṇṭā*). Same word, same bell-strikes-the-hour logic, three languages in a row.

Why it’s said this way

So on this concept, the split isn’t “Hindi vs. all four Dravidian languages” — **Hindi, Kannada, and Telugu** all share the Sanskrit *ghaṇṭā* (“bell”) root. **Tamil** most likely goes its own way with a native Dravidian word instead (though even specialists don’t call this fully

settled). **Malayalam** is the genuinely surprising one: its cognate word, *mani*, is ALSO Sanskrit-derived per its own dictionaries — just from a **different** Sanskrit word, *maṇi* (“gem”), not *ghaṇṭā*. So three of these four languages likely trace their hour-word to Sanskrit, just not all to the *same* Sanskrit word — worth remembering that a Sanskrit/native split isn’t fixed per language, and isn’t always a clean binary either.

Grammar Lens: telling the time

ఒక గంట. — “One o’clock.” (*oka gaṇṭa*, “one hour/bell”)
 రెండు గంటలు. — “Two o’clock.” (*reṇḍu gaṇṭalu* — *gaṇṭa*
 takes its plural form, *gaṇṭalu*, once the count passes one)

Notice Telugu’s *gaṇṭa* pluralizes to *gaṇṭalu* for “two o’clock” onward — a small grammatical wrinkle Kannada’s *gaṇṭe* didn’t show you.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “gaṇṭa” — hour, also “bell”
- “oka gaṇṭa” — one o’clock
- “reṇḍu gaṇṭalu” — two o’clock, plural *gaṇṭalu*

Before you move on

What Sanskrit word do గంట, Kannada’s *gaṇṭe*, and Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā* all share? (घण्टा, *ghaṇṭā*, “bell.”) Which Dravidian language most likely does NOT use this Sanskrit word for “hour”? (**Tamil** — most likely a native Dravidian word instead.) Does Malayalam’s cognate word skip Sanskrit entirely too? (**No** — it’s Sanskrit-derived too, per its own dictionaries, just from a *different* Sanskrit word, *maṇi*, “gem.”) What happens to *gaṇṭa* for “two o’clock”? (It **pluralizes** to *gaṇṭalu*.)

18.2 శ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఘ — what does it do? And one from further back: ి?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: శ

శ — *la*.

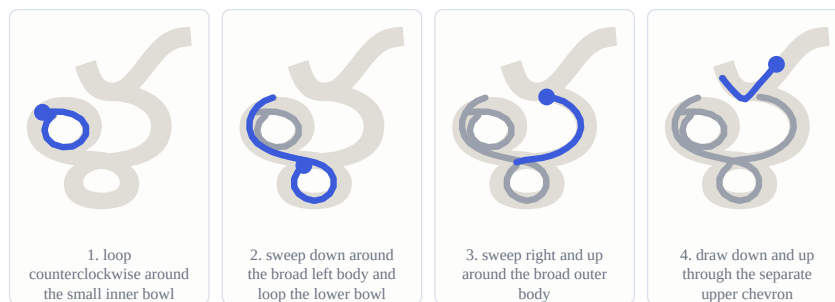
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *l*, it is **la**.

You already say these, and every one of them has శ somewhere inside it:

- వెళ్ళు *vellu* — to go (and వచ్చు, to come)
- వెళ్ళి వస్తాను *velli vastānu* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)
- మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం *malli kaluddām* — we’ll meet again
- సోమవారం మంగళవారం బుధవారం గురువారం శుక్రవారం శనివారం ఆదివారం — the seven weekdays

Writing: శ — four calm movements

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after AppChant, Telugu Alphabets Writing, consonant శ animated path guide encoded by LettersPointsTelugu::getAllPointsArrayForLetterTelugu_శ in version 3.8.05 (3805)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How శ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the guide once before your hand moves. శ arrives in **four calm movements**, with a small lift between each one:

1. Loop counterclockwise around the small inner bowl.
2. Sweep down around the broad left body and loop the lower bowl.
3. Sweep right and up around the broad outer body.
4. Lift once more, then draw down and up through the separate chevron above.

Trace the filmstrip slowly. Let every movement finish before you lift, then copy the whole shape once without rushing.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find శ in the ones that have it

వెళ్ళు · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* శ three times, saying *la* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find శ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — శ? What sound does it carry? (*la*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.
One more, from much earlier: ా — what does it do?

18.3 ఢ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: శ — what does it do? And one from further back: ా?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ఢ

ఢ — *dha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *dh*, it is **dha**.

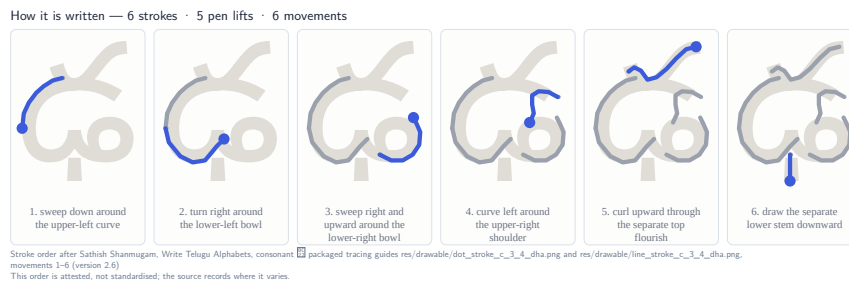
The third breathed pair, and this one asks for two things at once. డ is *ḍa*, the *d* made with the tongue curled back to the roof of the mouth. ఢ is that letter with the breath let out after it.

So the curl stays and the breath is added. The dot under the romanized *ḍ* marks the curl; the *h* beside it marks the breath. Both marks, both jobs.

You already say this one, and the breathed letter is inside it:

- ఆషాఢం *Āṣāḍhami* — the fourth of the twelve months

Writing: ఢ — six deliberate movements



How ఢ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movement 1 sweeps down around the upper-left curve. Movement 2 turns right around the lower-left bowl. Movement 3 restarts and sweeps right and upward around the lower-right bowl. Movement 4 curves left around the upper-right shoulder. Movement 5 draws the separate top flourish. Movement 6 finishes with the separate lower stem.

This is one attested school-style order. Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the six movements distinct and let the round shape grow from them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one has ఢ and which has డ

ఆషాఢం · ఉండు

- *Trace it:* ఢ three times, saying *ḍha* with the tongue curled back as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ఢ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఢ? What sound does it carry, and which plain letter is it built on? (*ḍha*, built on ఢ — the curled-back *d*, with breath added.)

One more, from much earlier: చ — what does it do?

18.4 శ · ష — two letters, one reason

Without looking back: name the two days of the week that open on the same letter, and say which letter it is.

Script: both are here to keep a difference visible

శ · ష

These two arrived chapters apart and for the same reason. Each is the shape Telugu spends so that a difference you can hear is a difference you can see.

letter	what it splits off
శ <i>śa</i>	a third s, beside ష and its curled neighbour
ష <i>ṣha</i>	ష with the breath let out after it

A script that skipped either one would still be readable — the reader would work the sound out from the word. Telugu declines to make the reader do that.

Your turn

- *Look:* at శుక్రవారం and శనివారం, and put a finger on the shared letter
- *Say it:* ష, then ష, with a hand in front of your mouth — feel which one moves it
- *Trace it:* each of the two once, saying its sound

Before you move on

Which letter opens both Friday and Saturday? (శ.) What does ష do to ష? (**Lets the breath out after it.**) And what do the two

letters have in common? (**Each exists so a heard difference is also a written one.**)

Chapter 19

Asking Someone's Age

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask someone how old they are in Telugu and give my own age in return.

Ask నీ వయసెంత? and answer నా వయసు ఇరవై — a complete verbless exchange about age.

19.1 నీ వయసెంత? — matching Kannada's simple possessive exactly

Telugu matches Kannada closely here — same Sanskrit word, same verbless grammar, just fused together by ordinary Telugu vowel sandhi.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

వయస్సు (*vayasu*) = “age” — the exact same Sanskrit वयस् (*vayas*, “age, vigor, strength,” PIE cousin of Latin *vīs*) that Kannada also carries.

Grammar Lens: fused by sandhi, still verbless

నీ వయసెంత? — “How old are you?” — literally “**your age how-much?**” (*nī vayas-enta?* — from *nī vayasu* + *enta*, “how much,” fused by regular vowel sandhi into *vayasenta*.)
నా వయస్సు ఇరవై. — “I am twenty years old.” — literally “**my age [is] twenty.**” (*nā vayasu iravai.*)

Same shape as Kannada: a plain possessive (“your/my age”) sitting next to the number, **no verb at all**. The only wrinkle is surface-level: everyday spoken Telugu often **fuses** *vayasu* + *enta* into one word, *vayasenta*, the same kind of vowel sandhi you’d see fusing any two Telugu words in fast speech — the underlying grammar is identical to Kannada’s, just written closer together.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “vayasu” — age
- “nī vayasenta?” — how old are you?
- “nā vayasu iravai” — I am twenty, “my age [is] twenty”

Before you move on

Is Telugu’s వయస్సు the same Sanskrit word as Kannada’s *vayassu*? (**Yes** — both from *vayas*, PIE cousin of Latin *vīs*.) What happens to *vayasu* + *enta* in “nī vayasenta?”? (They **fuse** by ordinary vowel sandhi.) Does Telugu use a verb to state age, like Kannada? (**No** — same verbless possessive shape.)

Chapter 20

Numbers 11–20 and Weather

Modes: ⇌ voice (2) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what the weather is doing in Telugu and count past ten up to twenty.

Say వాతావరణం — a pure Sanskrit *vāta* + *āvaraṇa*, “the covering of air” — and report the weather with వర్షం పడుతోంది, “rain is falling.”

20.1 పదకొండు, ఇరవై — the same pattern, worn down one step further

You just watched Kannada’s twenty split cleanly into “two” + “ten.” Telugu most likely comes from the exact same pattern — but centuries of extra erosion have worn it past the point of being visible today.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Telugu’s teens echo పది (*padi*, “ten”) plus each digit — పదకొండు (*padakonḍu*, 11), పన్నెండు (*pannenḍu*, 12), and onward through పందొమ్మిది (*paṇḍommidi*, 19) — the same “digit + ten-echo” compounding Kannada builds.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ఇరవై (*iravai*, “twenty”) most likely continues the **same** pan-Dravidian pattern as Kannada’s *ippattu* — an old **iru-/*renḍu* (“two”) root fused with an old “ten” root — but here’s the honest difference:

centuries of sound change have worn *iravai* down far enough that it no longer visibly splits into “two” and “ten” on the surface, the way Kannada’s *ippattu* still does today. Telugu’s own word for “two,” రెండు (*renḍu*), doesn’t obviously show up inside *iravai* anymore — treat this as the most likely comparative-Dravidian account rather than a transparent, easily re-derivable compound.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “padakoṇḍu, pannoṇḍu” — 11, 12
- “padi” — ten
- “iravai” — twenty, most likely the same “two-tens” idea as Kannada, just worn down further

Before you move on

How are Telugu’s teens built? (పది (ten) + a digit, compounded.) Does ఇరవై visibly split into “two” + “ten” today, the way Kannada’s *ippattu* does? (No — it most likely continues the same pan-Dravidian pattern, but erosion has worn away the visible split.) What’s Telugu’s word for “two”? (రెండు, *renḍu*.)

20.2 వాతావరణం — “the covering of air,” pure Sanskrit this time

Kannada’s weather word mixed a Persian loan with a Sanskrit one. Telugu’s is different again — a single, unmixed Sanskrit compound.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

వాతావరణం (*vātāvaraṇam*) = “weather, atmosphere” — built entirely from Sanskrit:

- వాత (*vāta*, “wind, air”) — the same Sanskrit root behind వాయువు (*vāyuvu*, “wind,” and the wind-god Vāyu).

- ఆవరణ (*āvaraṇa*, “covering, layer, enclosure”).

So *vātāvaraṇam* literally means “**the covering of air**” — the layer of air surrounding everything, i.e., the atmosphere/weather. Unlike Kannada’s *havāmāna* (Persian *hava* + Sanskrit *māna*), **both** pieces here are Sanskrit — no Perso-Arabic loan involved at all.

Grammar Lens: వర్షం పడుతోంది — “rain is falling”

వర్షం పడుతోంది. — “It’s raining.” — literally “**rain is falling**.” (*varṣaṇi paḍutōndi*.) — వర్షం (*varṣaṇi*, “rain”) is the same Sanskrit root, *varṣā*, you’ll see again in the Dravidian arc.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “vātāvaraṇam” — weather, “the covering of air”
- “vāta” — wind/air, “āvaraṇa” — covering
- “varṣaṇi paḍutōndi” — it’s raining, “rain is falling”

Before you move on

What are the two Sanskrit pieces of వాతావరణం, and what does the whole word literally mean? (వాత, “air,” + ఆవరణ, “covering” — “**the covering of air**.”) Is either piece a Persian/Arabic loan, like part of Kannada’s word? (**No** — both pieces are Sanskrit.) What word does Telugu use for “rain”? (వర్షం, *varṣaṇi*.)

Chapter 21

Dog and Cat

Modes:  voice (1)  pen (1)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a dog and a cat in Telugu.

Say కుక్క, which genuinely breaks from the family’s shared naayi root, and పిల్లి, most likely the Dravidian source behind Hindi’s billī.

21.1 కుక్క, పిల్లి — the odd one out, and the word that most likely closes the loop

Kannada just gave you a rock-solid native dog-word. Telugu breaks from that pattern — but its cat-word may be the single most important word in this whole arc.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

కుక్క (*kukka*, “dog”) does **not** clearly continue the same నాయి-family root shared by Kannada, Malayalam, and Tamil. Its origin is honestly debated: some linguists propose it’s **onomatopoeic**, imitating the sound of a bark; others propose a borrowing from **Sanskrit** कुक्कुर (*kukkura*, itself a similarly-shaped word for dog). Neither is settled — but either way, Telugu’s everyday dog-word genuinely doesn’t match its closest cousins.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

పిల్లి (*pilli*, “cat”) is a real, documented **Proto-Dravidian** root, ***pillV** — with cognates surviving as **rarer**, **alternate** words for cat

in both Tamil and Kannada. Here’s why this word matters for the **whole** arc: Sanskrit’s word for cat, **बिडाल** (*biḍāla*) — the word behind Hindi’s **बिल्ली** (*billī*), which you met as “most likely” borrowed from Dravidian, without a confirmed specific source — most likely traces back to **this exact root**. So Telugu’s everyday word for “cat” is most likely the closest living relative of the very word Sanskrit borrowed, tying together Latin’s *cattus*/Arabic’s *qitt* story on one side and Hindi’s *billī* story on the other, all in one word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kukka” — dog, genuinely different from its Dravidian cousins
- “pilli” — cat, most likely the source behind Hindi’s *billī*

Before you move on

Does కుక్క continue the same root as Kannada’s *nāyī*? (**No** — genuinely different, debated between onomatopoeia and a Sanskrit loan.) What is పిల్లి most likely the source of? (**Sanskrit’s** **बिडाल**, *biḍāla* — and so Hindi’s **बिल्ली**, *billī*.)

21.2 ఎ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: డ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఖ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ఎ

ఎ — *e*.

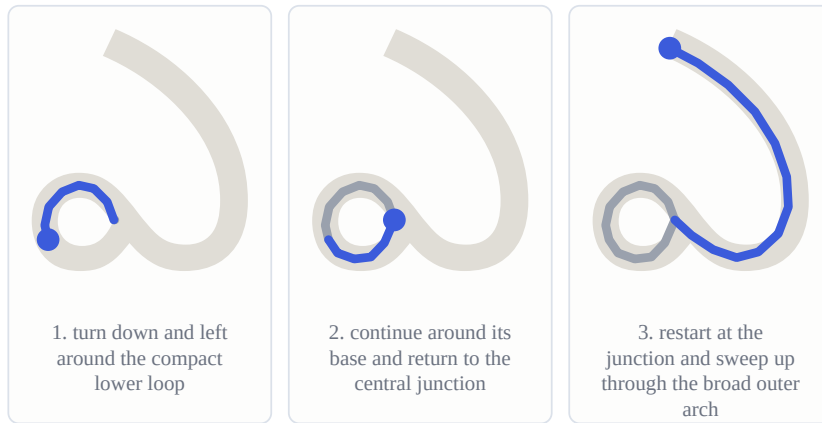
It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *e* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

You already say these, and every one of them has ఎ somewhere inside it:

- ఎలా — how
- మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? — how are you? (respectful)
- ఆరు ఏడు ఎనిమిది తొమ్మిది పది — six to ten
- నలుపు తెలుపు ఎరుపు నీలం — black, white, red, blue

Writing: ఎ — copy what you see

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, *Write Telugu Alphabets*, independent vowel ఎ packaged tracing guide [res/drawable/dot_stroke_v_9_e.png](#), movements 1–3 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ఎ is written, stroke by stroke

Use **two pen-down runs**. Start at the central junction. Turn down and left around the compact lower loop, then continue around its base until you return to that junction. Lift once. Restart at the junction and sweep through the broad outer arch, climbing to the high left tip.

That is three numbered movements: **1–2 stay joined; 3 restarts after the lift**. The order follows Sathish Shanmugam’s *Write Telugu Alphabets* tracing guide and is fitted here to the printed Noto Sans Telugu shape. Telugu schools do vary in how they teach the hand, so learn this as one sourced order rather than the only possible way anyone writes ఎ.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ఎ in the ones that have it

ఎలా · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* ఎ three times — lower loop, lift, broad outer arch — saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ఎ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఎ? What sound does it carry? (*e*.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: ఇ — what does it do?

Chapter 22

Green and Yellow

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name green and yellow in Telugu, on top of the four colours I already had.

*Say పచ్చ and పసుపు and show they are doublets of one Proto-Dravidian *pac- root — where Kannada’s yellow broke away as a Sanskrit loan.*

22.1 పచ్చ, పసుపు — two colors, one Dravidian root

In Kannada, green stayed native but yellow got borrowed from Sanskrit. Telugu tells a tighter story: its green word and its yellow word turn out to be **doublets of the same root**, wearing two different faces.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

పచ్చ (pacca, “green”) comes from **Proto-Dravidian *pac-** — the same root already behind Tamil’s பச்சை (paccai) and Kannada’s ಹಸಿರು (hasiru, via Old Kannada pasir). No surprise here; this is the same pan-Dravidian green family from the last lesson.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

పసుపు (pasupu, “yellow, turmeric”) is, remarkably, **also** a direct descendant of that **same** Proto-Dravidian ***pac-** root — a true **doublet** of pacca itself, not a separate borrowing the way Kannada’s

haladi was. Tamil even keeps a matching cognate, பசுப்பு (*pacuppu*), sitting alongside its own *paccai*. So where Kannada split green and yellow into two unrelated families (native Dravidian vs. a Sanskrit turmeric-loan), Telugu kept **both** colors inside the same native word-family — *pacca* and *pasupu* are, at root, doublets of the same word, one settling on “green” and the other on “yellow, turmeric-colored.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “పచ్చ” — green, from Proto-Dravidian *pac-*
- “పసుపు” — yellow/turmeric, a true doublet of *pacca*, same root
- the contrast with Kannada — Telugu kept both colors in one native family; Kannada’s yellow broke away as a Sanskrit loan

Before you move on

Are పచ్చ and పసుపు two unrelated words, or doublets of the same root? (**Doublets** — both from Proto-Dravidian **pac-*.) Does Telugu’s yellow word follow the same pattern as Kannada’s *haladi* (a Sanskrit loan)? (**No** — Telugu kept its yellow word native, unlike Kannada.) What Tamil word is *pasupu*’s direct cognate? (பசுப்பு, *pacuppu*.)

Chapter 23

Day

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “day” in Telugu and choose between the everyday Persian loan and its formal Sanskrit alternate.

Say రోజు, a genuine Persian loan from *rōz*, and set it against the formal దినము — the mirror image of Kannada’s plain *dina*.

23.1 రోజు (rōju) — “day,” a genuine Persian surprise

You might expect Telugu’s word for “day” to be Sanskrit, like Kannada’s *dina*, or native Dravidian. It’s neither — it’s Persian.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

రోజు (rōju) — “day” — is Telugu’s everyday, ordinary word for “a day.” Here’s the real surprise: it’s **borrowed from Classical Persian** روز (rōz) — the same root, ultimately, as the Persian day names hiding in words like “Nowruz” (“new day”). Persian *rōz* itself traces to a Proto-Indo-European root, **lewk-* (“bright”) — a **completely different** PIE root from the **dyew-* family behind Latin’s *diēs*, Hindi’s *din*, and Kannada’s *dina*. Both roots independently mean something like “shining, bright” — but they are **not** cousins; this is convergent meaning, not shared ancestry.

Why it's said this way

Telugu also has దినము (**dinamu**) — the same Sanskrit **tatsama** word as Kannada's *dina*. But here's the honest twist: unlike Kannada, where *dina* is the plain, everyday word, Telugu's దినము is the more **formal, literary** alternate — *rōju* does the everyday work instead. Telugu's formal/everyday split runs the **opposite direction** from Kannada's.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “rōju” — “day,” a genuine Persian loanword
- the honest surprise — from Persian *rōz*, PIE *lew-*, *NOT the same root as diēs/din/dina*
- the reversed pattern — *dinamu* is Telugu's FORMAL word, unlike Kannada's plain *dina*

Before you move on

What language does Telugu's everyday రోజు (*rōju*) come from? (**Persian** — *rōz*.) Is Persian *rōz*'s PIE root the same as Latin *diēs*/Hindi *din*/Kannada *dina*'s root? (**No** — a completely different PIE root, **lew-*, “bright,” vs. **dyew-* — related in meaning, not in ancestry.) Is Telugu's Sanskrit word, దినము (*dinamu*), the everyday word or the formal one? (**The formal one** — the opposite of Kannada, where *dina* is plain and everyday.)

23.2 ణ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ణ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఘ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ణ

ణ — *ṇa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *ṇ*, it is **ṇa**.

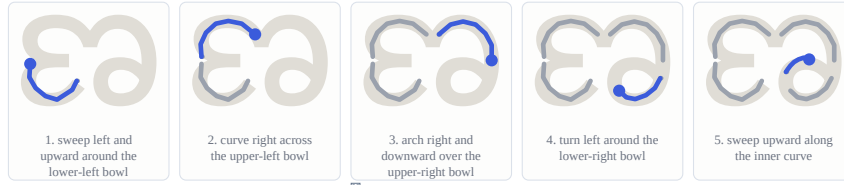
There is a second *n* in this alphabet, and you met it long ago: **న**, the *na* of *nēnu* and *namaskāram*. For **న** the tongue touches the back of the teeth. For **ణ** it curls back and touches the roof of the mouth. Telugu hears the two as different letters and writes them as different letters — the same split you have already seen between **ల** and **ళ**, and between **ద** and **డ**. The dot under the romanized *ṇ* is how this book marks the curled-back one.

You already say these, and every one of them has **ణ** somewhere inside it:

- వాతావరణం *vātāvaraṇam* — weather
- శ్రావణం *Śrāvaṇam* — the fifth of the twelve months
- ఫాల్గుణం *Phālgunaṇam* — the twelfth

Writing: ణ — five deliberate movements

How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_3_5_na.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_3_5_na.png, movements 1–5 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ణ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movement 1 sweeps left and upward around the lower-left bowl. Movement 2 curves right across the upper-left bowl. Movement 3 arches right and downward over the upper-right bowl. Movement 4 turns left around the lower-right bowl. Movement 5 finishes along the inner curve.

This is one attested school-style order. Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the five movements distinct and let the paired round shapes grow from them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one has **ణ** and which has **న**

వాతావరణం · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* **ణ** three times, saying *ṇa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find **ణ** once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — **ణ**? What sound does it carry, and where is the tongue for it? (*ṇa*, with the tongue curled back to the roof of the mouth — not **న**, which touches the teeth.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: **ల** — what does it do?

Chapter 24

Night

Modes: 🔄 voice (1) ✍ pen (1) 🔄 Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “night” in Telugu and recognise it inside the midnight word I already knew.

Say రాత్రి, find it again inside అర్ధరాత్రి, and note the three native words — *rēyi*, *māpu*, *irulu* — it pushed aside.

24.1 రాత్రి (rātri) — “night,” this time matching the expected pattern

Last lesson’s *rōju* broke every expectation. This one is more straightforward — but still worth checking honestly, not assuming.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

రాత్రి (rātri) — “**night**” — is a Sanskrit **tatsama** word, already hiding inside అర్ధరాత్రి (*ardharātri*, “midnight,” Chapter 17). Unlike *rōju*’s Persian surprise, *rātri* really **is** Telugu’s ordinary, everyday word for “night” — matching Kannada’s own pattern this time, not breaking it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Telugu **does** have native words here — but be honest: it’s a **messier** picture than Kannada’s clean two-word story, not a tidy mirror of it.

- రేయి (rēyi) — attested in older Telugu literature; most sources

treat it as inherited Dravidian, though some grammars instead link it to *rātri* itself, so its native status is less than fully settled.

- మాపు (*māpu*) — its **primary** sense is actually “**evening, dusk**” (as in రేపుమాపు, “morning and evening”), with “night” only a secondary, extended sense — not a clean synonym for *rātri*.
- ఇరులు (*irulu*) — a genuine cognate of Kannada’s ಇರುಳು (*irulu*), but its primary modern sense is “**darkness**,” archaic even in that use.

All three have been effectively pushed aside by the Sanskrit loan — but unlike Kannada’s single native competitor, Telugu’s “native” side is split across three words in three different, overlapping senses.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “rātri” — “night,” already met inside ardharātri
- rēyi, māpu, irulu — three native words, three overlapping senses, all pushed aside
- the contrast with last lesson — day broke the pattern, night matches it

Before you move on

Where have you already met రాత్రి before this lesson? (అర్ధరాత్రి, *ardharātri*, “midnight.”) Does *rātri* follow the same “Sanskrit-as-everyday” pattern as Kannada’s *rātri*, or does it break the pattern the way *rōju* did for “day”? (**It matches** — *rātri* really is Telugu’s everyday word.) Does Telugu’s native-word story cleanly mirror Kannada’s single-word *irulu*? (**No** — it’s messier: three words, రేయి/మాపు/ఇరులు, in three overlapping senses, not one clean replacement.)

24.2 జ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఙ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఞ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: జ

జ — *ja*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *j*, it is **ja**.

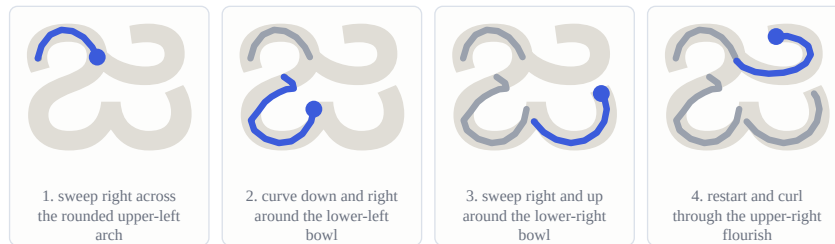
You already say these, and every one of them has జ somewhere inside it:

- రోజు *rōju* — day, the word that came in from Persian
- జ్యేష్ఠం *Jyēṣṭham* — the third of the twelve months
- ఆశ్వయుజం *Āśvayujam* — the seventh

Rōju is worth a second look. Its first letter is the ధ you traced inside *namaskāram*. Its last is జ — this new letter carrying the *u* sign you met early on. The vowel sign in the middle is one this book has not stopped on yet, so the word is not wholly yours on the page. Two of its three pieces are, and that is new today.

Writing: జ — copy what you see

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant packaged tracing guide
res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_2_3_ja.png, movements 1–4 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How జ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on జ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find జ in the ones that have it

రోజు · నమస్కారం

- *Trace it:* జ three times, saying *ja* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find జ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — జ? What sound does it carry? (*ja*.)
Read రోజు aloud, letter by letter, and then as one word.
One more, from much earlier: ె — what does it do?

Chapter 25

Good Night

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good night in Telugu.

Say శుభ రాత్రి — “auspicious night” — pairing the రాత్రి already learned with śubha, while knowing many speakers code-switch to English here.

25.1 శుభ రాత్రి (śubha rātri) — the standard translation, honestly checked against real speech

You have both pieces already: *rātri* from last lesson, and one more Sanskrit word. But this lesson’s honest twist is about who actually says the result out loud.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

శుభ రాత్రి (śubha rātri) — “good night” — literally “auspicious night.” Both pieces are Sanskrit **tatsama**: రాత్రి (*rātri*, “night,” already met) plus శుభ (*śubha*, “auspicious,” from root śubh, “to be beautiful,” ultimately PIE **kewb^h-*).

Why it’s said this way

Here’s a genuinely interesting wrinkle, hedged appropriately: some sources describe modern Telugu speakers, especially casually, often **code-switching to English “good night”** rather than saying శుభ

రాత్రి aloud — treating it more as the standard written/dictionary translation than an everyday spoken phrase. Be careful with this claim, though: the evidence for it comes mainly from informal language-learning blogs and forum posts, not rigorous sociolinguistic sources, and the same “code-switch to English for casual farewells” pattern plausibly shows up across other South Asian languages too — it isn’t clearly something unique to Telugu, just something the available sources happened to mention for Telugu specifically. Either way, *śubha rātri* itself is perfectly correct and understood Telugu, whatever its actual spoken frequency turns out to be.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubha rātri” — “good night,” literally “auspicious night”
- śubha’s own root — śubh, “to be beautiful” → “auspicious”
- the honest twist — the standard translation, but many speakers code-switch to English instead

Before you move on

What does శుభ రాత్రి literally mean? (“**Auspicious night.**”) Is *śubha rātri* actually the phrase most Telugu speakers say aloud for “good night”? (**Often not** — many code-switch to English “good night” in casual speech; *śubha rātri* is the standard written/ formal translation.) Does this mean *śubha rātri* is wrong or ungrammatical? (**No** — perfectly correct, just less commonly spoken than expected.)

25.2 భ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: జ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఙ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: భ

భ — *bha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *bh*, it is **bha**.

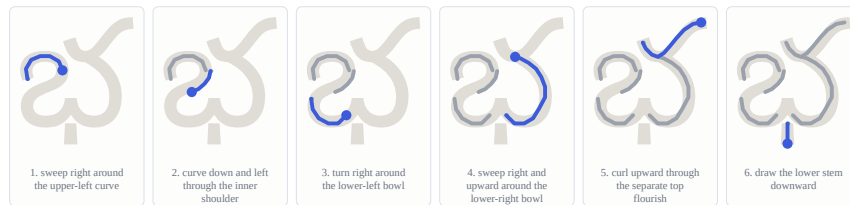
Say బ (*ba*), then say it again and let a puff of breath out on top of it. That second thing is భ. By now the pattern should arrive before the letter does: you have met క/ఖ, గ/ఘ and డ/ఢ, and this is the fourth pair of the same kind. The *h* in the romanization *bha* is that puff, not a separate sound.

You already say these, and every one of them has భ somewhere inside it:

- శుభ రాత్రి *śubha rātri* — good night, from the chapter before this one
- భాద్రపదం *Bhādrapadam* — the sixth of the twelve months
- ప్రారంభించు *prārambhīncu* — to begin

Writing: భ — six calm movements

How it is written — 6 strokes · 5 pen lifts · 6 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shammugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant భ packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_5_4_bha.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_5_4_bha.png. movements 3–6 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How భ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movement 1 rises around the upper-left curve; movement 2 comes down and left through its inner shoulder. Movement 3 turns around the lower-left bowl. Movement 4 rises around the broad lower-right bowl. Lift for movement 5, the separate flourish above, then draw movement 6, the short straight stem below.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the six clear movements instead of rushing their joins.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find భ in the ones that have it

శుభ రాత్రి · నమస్కారం

- *Say it:* *ba*, then *bha*, and hear the breath arrive
- *Trace it:* భ three times, saying *bha* as you finish each one

Before you move on

Which character is this — భ? What does it carry that బ does not? (*bha* — the same *b* with a puff of breath after it.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: డ — what does it do?

Chapter 26

Morning

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “morning” in Telugu with the same word that sits inside the morning greeting.

Say ఉదయం, Telugu’s broadest morning word, note the real native competitors poddu and vēkuva, and see that Kannada splits this job across two unrelated words.

26.1 ఉదయం (udayam) — the same Sanskrit root, a different job than in Kannada

Last lesson’s రోజు was a genuine Persian surprise. This lesson’s word for “morning” goes the other way — straight Sanskrit, doing double duty in a way its Kannada cousin doesn’t.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ఉదయం (udayam) — “**morning**” — is a Sanskrit **tatsama**: from ఉదయ (udaya, “**rise, appearance**”) plus Telugu’s own -ము (-mu) nominal suffix. This is Telugu’s most common, general everyday word for “morning” — but be honest: it doesn’t have the field entirely to itself. పొద్దు/పొద్దున (poddu/podduna) is genuine **Proto-Dravidian** vocabulary — cognate with Tamil **pozhudu** and Kannada **hottu** — and does real everyday work too (“పొద్దున్నే లేచాను,” “I woke up in the morning”). వేకువ (vēkuva, “dawn, early morning”) is labeled **colloquial**, not archaic or purely poetic. ఉదయం is the broadest, most

general word — but not an uncontested one.

Why it's said this way

Here's the honest cross-language twist. Kannada also has this **exact** Sanskrit root, ఉదయ (udaya) — but only inside its **greeting**, ಶುಭೋದಯ (śubhōdaya, “good morning”). Kannada's actual everyday **noun** for “morning” is a completely unrelated **native** word, ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge, “the shining”). Telugu doesn't split the job that way: ఉదయం covers both the everyday noun AND, in శుభోదయం, the greeting root — one word, doing what Kannada spreads across two unrelated ones. And unlike రోజు (last lesson's genuine Persian surprise for “day”), Telugu's morning word holds no such twist — straightforwardly Sanskrit, start to finish.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “udayam” — “morning,” Sanskrit tatsama, the broadest word, though poddu/podduna and vēkuva are real native alternatives too
- the cross-language twist — Kannada's ఉదయ root only shows up in ITS greeting; Telugu uses ఉదయం for both the noun and the greeting
- the contrast with రోజు — no Persian surprise here, just straightforward Sanskrit

Before you move on

Is ఉదయం the ONLY word Telugu speakers use for “morning”? (**No** — it's the broadest, most common one, but పొద్దు/పొద్దున and వేకువ, both genuinely native, do real everyday work too.) Does Kannada's everyday morning-noun share ఉదయం's root? (**No** — Kannada's బెళగ్ಗೆ is native; the shared root, udaya, shows up only inside Kannada's GREETING, శుభೋదయ.) Does ఉదయం hold a surprise the way రోజు did? (**No** — straightforwardly Sanskrit throughout.)

26.2 ఋ — one character, met inside a word you already say

Before the new one: భ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఎ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ఋ

ఋ — *r̥*.

It is an **independent vowel** — the shape a vowel takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word. You have met that pairing twice already, at ఉ and at ఎ.

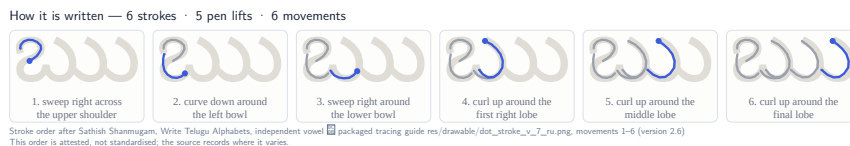
What makes this one worth a page of its own is what the vowel is. It is an *r* doing a vowel's work: a whole syllable with no other vowel in it, the way English lets *l* carry the second half of *bottle*. Telugu took the letter from Sanskrit along with the words that need it, and modern speakers give it the sound *ru*.

You already say this one, and it has ఋ at the front of its second word:

- వసంత ఋతువు *vasanta rtuvu* — the spring season

ఋ is one of the rarest letters in the alphabet: outside Sanskrit borrowings it has almost nowhere to appear. Meeting it once, on a word you can already say, is enough for now.

Writing: ఋ — copy what you see



How ఋ is written, stroke by stroke

Put your pen on ఋ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real

variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one opens with ఋ

ఋతువు · ఉదయం

- *Trace it:* ఋ three times, saying *r̥* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* *vasanta r̥tuvu*, and name the letter its second word starts with

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఋ? What kind of thing is it — a consonant, a vowel sign, or an independent vowel? (**An independent vowel**, sounded *ru*.) Name the word you already say that contains it.

One more, from much earlier: వ — what does it do?

Chapter 27

Evening

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “evening” in Telugu.

Say సాయంత్రం, from sāyam plus a time-suffix, and follow its PIE

**seh₁- root across to Latin sērus, French soir and Italian sera.*

27.1 సాయంత్రం (sāyantram) — a distant cousin of French “soir”

This lesson’s word for “evening” reaches back to a PIE root that also surfaces — in a completely different language, on a completely different continent’s language family.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

సాయంత్రం (sāyantram) — “evening” — is a Sanskrit **tatsama**: from సాయం (sāyam, “in the evening”) plus a Sanskrit **-tana** suffix that turns time-adverbs into adjectives — the same suffix pattern behind Sanskrit **divātana** (“of the day”) and **sanātana** (“eternal, lasting”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here’s the striking part, checked directly against primary sources rather than assumed: సాయం itself traces to **Proto-Indo-European *seh₁-** (“long, lasting”) — and this is **explicitly** documented as “distantly related to **Latin sērus**” (“late”), itself confirmed independently to trace to the very same **seh₁-* root (via Proto-Italic

sēros*). *sērus* is worth a closer look: it's the Latin root well attested as the source of **French soir and **Italian sera** — French and Italian's own everyday “evening” words. That makes సాయంత్రం and **soir/sera** genuine distant cognates — one route through Sanskrit tatsama borrowing into Telugu, one route through centuries of Vulgar Latin erosion into French and Italian, both ultimately the same Proto-Indo-European idea of something “long, lasting” stretching into “late in the day.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “sāyantram” — “evening,” sāyam + the -tana time-suffix
- the deep root — PIE *seh₁-*, “long, lasting”
- the cross-family cognate — the same root behind French **soir** and Italian **sera**, via Latin *sērus*

Before you move on

What is సాయంత్రం built from? (సాయం, “in the evening,” + a Sanskrit “-tana” time-adjective suffix.) What PIE root does సాయం trace to? (**seh₁-*, “long, lasting.”) What two Romance words are genuine distant cognates of సాయంత్రం, and through which Latin word? (**French soir** and **Italian sera** — both through Latin *sērus*, “late,” which traces to the same **seh₁-* root.)

Chapter 28

Afternoon

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can use Telugu’s noon word to talk about the afternoon, and reach for the classical term when I need to be precise.

Reuse మధ్యాహ్నం for the stretch between noon and evening, then contrast it with ఆపరాహ్నం, the more formal, more precise later-afternoon word.

28.1 మధ్యాహ్నం — the same “noon” word, now also “afternoon”

You already know మధ్యాహ్నం means “noon” — precisely, “middle of the day.” This lesson’s honest twist: the word doesn’t stay that precise in modern use.

Why it’s said this way

మధ్యాహ్నం (**madhyāhnam**) is the exact word from Chapter 17, still literally “middle” + “day” — but a source fetched directly (not just a search summary) confirms it now covers “**the time between noon and evening**” in modern usage — a genuine widened sense, not just the precise midday instant its etymology points to. This mirrors Hindi’s दोपहर (clearly, well- confirmed widened from “noon” to “afternoon”) and, more thinly Kannada’s own ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (a hedged, single-source impression of the same kind of stretch).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Telugu also has అపరాహ్నం (*aparāhnam*), from the same classical **five-part Sanskrit day division** already found behind Kannada’s అపరాహ్న — *prāta/udaya* (sunrise), *saṅgava*, *madhyāhna* (noon), *aparāhna* (“later afternoon” specifically), *sāyāhna* (evening). Be honest about the sourcing here, echoing the same hedge already applied to Kannada’s *aparāhna*: thin, informal evidence — a native-speaker forum discussion, general dictionary usage notes — points toward మధ్యాహ్నం **winning colloquially**, with అపరాహ్నం staying the more **formally precise** term. Real, but not corpus-linguistics-grade sourcing — treat it the same cautious way Kannada’s own equivalent finding was treated, not as fully settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “madhyāhnam” — the same word from Chapter 17, “middle of the day”
- the confirmed widening — now also covers “the time between noon and evening”
- “aparāhnam” — the more precise classical word for later afternoon, staying the more formal term per thin but real evidence

Before you move on

Is మధ్యాహ్నం a new word, or the same one from Chapter 17? (**The same word** — “middle” + “day.”) Does modern usage confirm మధ్యాహ్నం covers only the exact instant of noon? (**No** — a directly-fetched source confirms it now covers “the time between noon and evening” too.) Is it confirmed whether అపరాహ్నం or widened మధ్యాహ్నం is more common today? (**Thin but real evidence** points to మధ్యాహ్నం winning colloquially, అపరాహ్నం staying formally precise — not fully settled, but not silent either.)

Chapter 29

Good Morning

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good morning in Telugu.

Say శుభోదయం — śubha + ఉదయం — and weigh the single low-authority claim that it is out of trend against నమస్కారం, the safer everyday bet.

29.1 శుభోదయం (śubhōdayam) — a claim worth real skepticism, not a settled fact

You already have ఉదయం. This lesson’s honest twist is about a dramatic-sounding claim — and about being skeptical of it, even though it came from a source fetched directly.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

శుభోదయం (śubhōdayam) — “good morning” — is built from శుభ (“good”) plus ఉదయం (already met, Chapter 26). Grammatically and etymologically, this is the straightforward, traditional Telugu “good morning.”

Why it’s said this way

Here’s the twist, and the honesty this time cuts against the source itself: one directly-fetched page describes శుభోదయం as **out of trend**, displaced by **English** “good morning,” with children taught the

English phrase from **preschool**. That’s a vivid, quotable claim — but “fetched directly” doesn’t make a source authoritative. This is the **same genre** of Telugu/Kannada/Hindi-learning content blog already found **overstated** for Hindi’s सुप्रभात and Kannada’s own ಶುಭೋದಯ (a single uncredentialed listicle, no sociolinguistic methodology, no citations) — treat this claim the same skeptical way, not as settled. Genuinely worth separating from that dramatic claim: సుప్రభాతం (*suprabhātam*) also exists — built on ప్రభాత (*prabhāta*), a **completely different** Sanskrit root from ఉదయ (*udaya*). This is **not** the same root behind Kannada’s ಶುಭೋದయ, which itself uses *udaya* — don’t conflate the two Sanskrit “morning” roots. A third option, ప్రొద్దుటి వందనాలు (“morning greetings,” built on పొద్దు, Chapter 26’s genuine native competitor to ఉదయం), also exists but isn’t confirmed common either. నమస్కారం is the safer bet for everyday use — matching the same నమస్కార/नमस्ते pattern already found doing the real everyday work for both Kannada and Hindi.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubhōdayam” — “good morning,” śubha + udayam
- the honest twist — one low-authority source claims it’s out of trend, displaced by English; treat with real skepticism
- నమస్కారం — the safer everyday-greeting bet

Before you move on

What is శుభోదయం built from? (శుభ + ఉదయం.) Is the claim that శుభోదయం has been displaced by English a confirmed, well-sourced fact? (**No** — it comes from one low-authority content-blog source, the same genre already found overstated for Hindi/Kannada; treat it skeptically, not as settled.) Does సుప్రభాతం share ఉదయం’s root, or Kannada’s ಶುಭೋದయ’s root? (**Neither** — its own root, ప్రభాత/*prabhāta*, is a genuinely different Sanskrit word.)

Chapter 30

Good Evening

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good evening in Telugu.

Say శుభ సాయంత్రం, backed by two independent sources as genuinely common in both formal and casual speech, with నమస్కారం as an alternative rather than a replacement.

30.1 శుభ సాయంత్రం (śubha sāyantram) — a claim that actually holds up on checking

Last lesson’s morning greeting rested on one dramatic, shaky source. This one is different — and the difference itself is worth noticing.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

శుభ సాయంత్రం (śubha sāyantram) — “good evening” — pairs శుభ (“good”) with సాయంత్రం (already met, Chapter 27 — the word whose PIE root, *seh*₁-, turned out to be a genuine distant cognate of Latin’s *sērus*, and so of French *soir* and Italian *sera*).

Why it’s said this way

Here’s the honest contrast worth drawing explicitly: last lesson’s శుభోదయం rested on **one** dramatic, low-authority source claiming it had been displaced by English entirely. This time, **two** independently

fetches sources — not just search-engine summaries — **agree**: శుభ సాయంత్రం is genuinely, commonly used, in **both** formal and informal contexts, appropriate for greeting people after work or arriving at an evening gathering. Neither source flags it as archaic or displaced. This doesn't mean these sources are beyond question — they're still the same general genre of language-learning content that has needed hedging before — but **being independently cross-corroborated** is a real, meaningful difference in evidence quality from a single dramatic claim, and it's worth being just as honest about a claim holding up as about one that doesn't. నమస్కారం, as before, remains a genuine time-independent alternative — but nothing here suggests it has **displaced** this greeting the way English reportedly displaced శుభోదయం.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubha sāyantram” — “good evening,” śubha + sāyantram
- the honest contrast — this claim is cross-corroborated by two sources, unlike last lesson's single dramatic one
- నమస్కారం — a time-independent alternative, not a replacement here

Before you move on

What word does శుభ సాయంత్రం pair with, and what's that word's own striking cross-language story? (సాయంత్రం — a genuine distant PIE cognate of Latin sērus/French soir/Italian sera.) Is the “genuinely commonly used” claim for శుభ సాయంత్రం as thinly sourced as శుభోదయం's “displaced by English” claim was? (**No** — two independent sources agree here, versus one dramatic claim last lesson — a real difference in evidence quality.)

Chapter 31

Good Afternoon

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good afternoon in Telugu and judge whether it fits the setting I am in.

Say శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం where the setting is formal or workplace-timed, and fall back on నమస్కారం, the time-independent everyday greeting.

31.1 శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం (śubha madhyāhnam) — good afternoon

You already know శుభ from the morning and evening greetings and మధ్యాహ్నం from the parts-of-day lessons. Put them together.

You'll want to know: శుభ + మధ్యాహ్నం

శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం (śubha madhyāhnam) means “good afternoon.” The second word originally centres on “midday” or “noon,” but you learned in Chapter 28 that modern use widens it into the stretch between noon and evening.

Telugu could instead have built the phrase on అపరాహ్నం (aparāhnam), the more classically precise word for later afternoon. It did not. Kannada made the same choice in ಶುభ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (śubha madhyāhna): both languages chose the everyday “noon, widened” word from two available classical terms.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubha madhyāhnam” — “good afternoon,” śubha + madhyāhnam
- the word choice — built on మధ్యాహ్నం, not అపరాహ్నం, matching Kannada’s exact same choice
- Kannada ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ్ನ — the same word-building choice

Before you move on

Is శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం built on మధ్యాహ్నం or అపరాహ్నం? (మధ్యాహ్నం — the “noon, widened” word.) Which sister language made the same choice? (Kannada, in శుభ మధ్యాహ్న.)

31.2 శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం — register and evidence

You can now build శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం. The next question is when it sounds natural—and how strongly the available evidence answers that question.

Why it’s said this way

Two independently fetched language-learning sources confirm that శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం is a real, correctly formed greeting for **formal or workplace** use around noon and early afternoon.

Keep the claims separate, though. Talkpal explicitly ranks the greeting as **less common** in everyday conversation than morning or evening greetings. Preply independently supports its timing and formal register, but does not make that frequency comparison. So there are two sources for “real and formal,” but only one for “less common.” A second source must not be counted as evidence for a claim it never made.

Why it’s said this way

- శుభోదయం — the morning lesson found one low-authority claim of displacement by English; treat that dramatic claim skeptically.
- శుభ సాయంత్రం — two sources supported common formal and

informal use.

- శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం — real and workplace-timed, with narrower support for its lower everyday frequency.

The three phrases do not need one uniform usage story. For a time-independent everyday greeting, నమస్కారం remains the safer choice.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two-source claim — real, formal, and workplace-timed
- the one-source claim — less common than morning or evening
- నమస్కారం — the time-independent everyday alternative

Before you move on

Do both sources rank శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం as less common? (No. Both support its formal use; only Talkpal makes the frequency comparison.) What is the safer all-day greeting? (నమస్కారం.)

Chapter 32

The Core Verbs

Modes: ⇄ voice (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can build a Telugu verb as stem plus tense plus person, say why one form covers both “I go” and “I will go”, give a polite command with -aṇḍi, and explain why ఉండు has to borrow its negative and తెలుసు has no person at all.

Say నాకు తెలుసు, name the three slots that built uṇṭānu, veḷṭānu and cūṣṭānu, separate it from Chapter 6’s నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు — fact against skill — and recall that ఉండు switches to lē- to be negated.

32.1 ఉండు (uṇḍu) — “to be,” and the negative that is a different verb

Thirty-one chapters of words. Now the engine room. Telugu glues a verb together one piece at a time, seams showing, and this first verb carries the machine.

You’ll want to know: ఉండు

ఉండు — uṇḍu — to be, to exist, to stay

Chapter 5 met it as “to live somewhere.” Here it is the verb-machine itself: ఉండ్- (the stem) + -త- (tense) + -ను (“I”) → ఉంటాను (uṇṭānu), “I stay, I will be.”

One form is already in your mouth: ఉన్నాను (unnānu), “I am — right now,” the shape hiding inside bāgunnānu and mīru elā unnāru?

Telugu is alone in this word. Tamil says இரு (*iru*), Kannada ಇರು (*iru*), Malayalam ഇരിക്കുക (*irikkuka*) — one verb, three sisters. Telugu went its own way, as it did with *lēdu*.

The letters in this word

ఉ is the standing vowel *u*. ండు is the retroflex cluster *ṇḍ* with the *u* sign — tongue tip curled back, then released. Both shapes are familiar from Chapter 5.

Grammar Lens: Telugu’s “be” cannot be made negative

There is no negative of *uṇḍu*. To say something is **not** there, Telugu drops the verb and picks up a second one, లే- (*lē-*) — the root behind Chapter 1’s *lēdu*. It takes the very same person-endings:

who	is	is not
I	<i>unnānu</i>	<i>lēnu</i>
he	<i>unnāḍu</i>	<i>lēḍu</i>
it	<i>undi</i>	<i>lēdu</i>

So *lēdu* was never a bare word for “no.” It is the **it**-form of a full verb, and you can now run it through its persons.

This is where Telugu parted from its sisters. Tamil negates *iru* with இல்லை (*illai*), Kannada with ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*), Malayalam with ഇല്ല (*illa*) — one shared root, *il-*. Telugu dropped it and grew *lē-* instead.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “uṇḍu” — be, exist, stay
- the three pieces in order — “uṇḍ ... ta ... ānu” → “uṇṭānu”
- the pair you must switch verbs for — “unnānu ... lēnu”
- the three sisters’ one verb — “iru ... iru ... irikkuka”

Before you move on

What are the three pieces of *uṇṭānu*? (**Stem, tense, person** — *uṇḍ-*, *-ta-*, *-ānu*.) How do you say “I am not there”? (లేను, *lēnu* — a different verb entirely.) So what kind of word is *lēdu*? (**The it-form**

of the negative verb *lē-*.) Which root do the other three sisters use, and does Telugu? (*il-*; Telugu does **not**.) Next: the same machine, tense piece swapped.

32.2 వెళ్ళు (*veḷḷu*) — “to go,” and a tense Telugu refuses to split

You have the three pieces — stem, tense, person. Change only the middle one. That is the whole of Telugu tense, and it has one setting fewer than you would expect.

You’ll want to know: వెళ్ళు

వెళ్ళు — *veḷḷu* — to go

Chapter 4 gave it to you as a bare command, *veḷḷu!*, “go!” Threaded up it is వెళ్తాను (*veḷtānu*), and its past is వెళ్లాను (*veḷḷānu*), “I went.”

Telugu keeps a second go-verb beside it. The family’s inherited word for going is *pō-*, and Telugu has it as పోవు (*pōvu*), పోతాను (*pōtānu*) — the same verb as Tamil போ (pō), Malayalam പോകുക (*pōkuka*) and Kannada ಹೋಗು (*hōgu*). So Telugu did not lose the family’s word; it gave the everyday job to *veḷḷu*, a verb of its own whose deeper history is best left open.

The letters in this word

వె is *va* with the short-*e* sign. ళ్ళు is the retroflex శ్ (*ḷ*) doubled and held — *veḷ-ḷu*, a real catch in the middle. The same doubling is in *nḷḷu*, Chapter 15’s water.

Grammar Lens: one piece for “I go” and “I will go”

when	Telugu	the middle piece
now, or later	<i>veḷtānu</i>	<i>-ta-</i>
already	<i>veḷḷānu</i>	<i>-ā-</i>
this minute	<i>veḷtunnānu</i>	<i>-tunnā-</i>

Be honest about the first row: వెళ్తాను means “I go” **and** “I will go.” Telugu does not separate habit from future — one piece does both, and context decides. Tamil keeps them apart (*pōgīrēn* against *pōvēn*); Telugu merged them.

Having merged them, Telugu needed a way to say “right this minute,” and built one out of last lesson’s verb. వెళ్తున్నాను (*veḷtunnānu*) is *veḷ-* plus ఉన్నా-, the very *unnānu* that means “I am,” welded on: literally “going-am-I.” The be-verb did not stay a word. It became a piece of every other verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “veḷḷu” — go — then “veḷtānu”
- the two meanings of one form — “I go” and “I will go”
- the three times — “veḷtānu ... veḷḷānu ... veḷtunnānu”
- the be-verb hiding in the third — “unnānu ... veḷtunnānu”

Before you move on

How many things does *veḷtānu* mean? (**Two** — “I go” and “I will go”; Telugu merges habit and future.) What is glued inside *veḷtunnānu*? (ఉన్నా-, the be-verb — “going-am-I.”) Does Telugu have the family’s old go-root at all? (**Yes** — *pōvu*, cousin of *pō*, *pōkuka*, *hōgu*; *veḷḷu* just took the everyday work.) Next: a verb you call by one shape and build on another.

32.3 రా (rā) — “come!”, and the stem it is not built on

Veḷḷu threads its pieces on without a fuss: the word you call it by is the word you build on. Its partner refuses — and the goodbye you learned in Chapter 4 has been hiding the reason.

You’ll want to know: రా

రా — *rā* — come!

One syllable: ర (ra) with the long-ā sign. It is a whole command on its own, the plainest thing one Telugu speaker can say to another.

Every sister has this verb, and every sister’s command-shape drifted somewhere different: Tamil **வர** (*vā*), Kannada **ಬಾ** (*bā*), Malayalam **വരുക** (*varuka*), Telugu **రా** (*rā*). A *v*, a *b*, an *r* — one old Dravidian come-word, worn three ways, not three separate verbs.

Grammar Lens: the word you call it by is not the word you build on

Try to thread endings onto *rā*- and you get nothing anyone says. They attach to **వచ్చు** (*vaccu*) instead, which appears as *vast*- once the tense piece arrives:

- **వస్తాను** (*vastānu*) — “I come, I will come”
- **వచ్చాను** (*vaccānu*) — “I came”
- **వస్తున్నాను** (*vastunnānu*) — “I am coming right now”

The third one is last lesson’s trick again: the be-verb *unnā*- welded onto the stem. Learn this verb as a pair, then — **రా**, and **వచ్చు**. Telugu is not odd here; Tamil pairs *vā* with *varu*- and Kannada pairs *bā* with *baru*-, and the building-stems stayed far closer to each other than the commands did.

You have said *vastānu* already. Chapter 4’s farewell **వెళ్లి వస్తాను** (*velli vastānu*) — “I’ll go and come back” — is *velli* and *vaccu* standing side by side, and that second word is exactly the form above. Chapter 6 used the bare stem too, in *nāku telugu vaccu*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the command — “*rā*!”
- the pair to learn together — “*rā* ... *vaccu*-”
- “*vastānu* ... *vaccānu* ... *vastunnānu*”
- the farewell you now understand — “*velli vastānu*”

Before you move on

Which shape do the endings attach to for “come”? (వచ్చు, *vaccu*-, never *rā*-.) Say “I will come.” (*Vastānu*.) Which two verbs are standing in *velli vastānu*? (వెళ్ళు and వచ్చు — go, and come back.) Are Tamil *vā*, Kannada *bā* and Telugu *rā* three different verbs? (No — one old come-word, reshaped three ways.) Next: a verb Telugu kept where Tamil replaced it.

32.4 తిను (tinu) — “to eat,” the root Telugu kept

Three verbs in, and every one has been Telugu’s own choice. This one is the opposite: the oldest eat-word the family has, still doing plain everyday work.

You’ll want to know: తిను

తిను — *tinu* — to eat

తి is the dental *ta* with the *i* sign; ను is *nu*, the same shape that ends *nēnu*. Threaded up: తింటాను (*tiṇṭānu*), “I eat, I will eat,” and తిన్నాను (*tinṇānu*), “I ate.”

The inherited Dravidian root is **tin-**, and the family kept it: Kannada ತಿನ್ನು (*tinnu*), Malayalam തിന്നുക (*tinnuka*), Tamil தின் (*tin*). But Tamil narrowed its own to chewing and snacking and put an assembled compound, சாப்பிடு (*sāppiḍu*), in the everyday slot. Telugu did no such thing. *Tinu* is still simply the word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Build a noun straight off the root and you get తిండి (*tiṇḍi*) — “food, grub.” Native, transparent, and blunt: it is what you feed people, not what you invite them to.

For the invitation Telugu reaches across to Sanskrit: భోజనం (*bhōjanam*, “a meal”) and ఆహారం (*āhāram*, “food”). Both are **tatsama** loans, taken in whole, and both outrank *tiṇḍi* in politeness without displacing it.

That is Telugu’s Sanskrit habit in miniature, and it is worth naming plainly. The verbs at the centre of living — be, go, come, eat — stayed Dravidian. The formal and ceremonial vocabulary layered on top came

from Sanskrit. You met the same split in Chapter 1, where the greeting *namaskāram* is Sanskrit while *avunu* and *sarē* are native. Telugu borrowed far more of that top layer than Tamil ever did; it did not borrow the floor.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “tinu” — eat — then “tiṇṭānu ... tinnānu”
- the root the whole family kept — “tinu ... tinnu ... tinnuka”
- the native noun and the borrowed one — “tiṇḍi ... bhōjanam”
- the four verbs so far — “uṇṭānu ... veḷṭānu ... vastānu ... tiṇṭānu”

Before you move on

Did Telugu keep the inherited eat-root? (Yes — *tinu*, plain and everyday, where Tamil demoted *tin* and built *sāppiḍu*.) Which word for food is native, and which is borrowed? (తిండి *tiṇḍi* is native and blunt; భోజనం *bhōjanam* is Sanskrit and polite.) What is the pattern? (Native verbs at the core, Sanskrit vocabulary layered on top — as with *avunu* against *namaskāram*.) Next: a verb, and the polite ending that fits every verb in this chapter.

32.5 చూడు (cūḍu) — “to see,” and the polite ending that fits every verb

Four bare commands so far — *uṇḍu*, *vellu*, *rā*, *tinu* — and every one is blunt. This verb brings the ending that makes them polite.

You’ll want to know: చూడు

చూడు — *cūḍu* — to see, to look

Threaded up: చూస్తాను (*cūstānu*), “I see, I will see,” and చూశాను (*cūśānu*), “I saw.”

Here the sisters scatter completely. Tamil says **பார்** (*pār*), Kannada **ನೋಡು** (*nōḍu*), Malayalam **കാണുക** (*kāṇuka*), Telugu **చూడు** (*cūḍu*). Four languages, four unrelated everyday verbs.

And yet the family’s oldest seeing-root is right there in all four, sitting in a noun you can point at: **కన్ను** (*kannu*, “eye”) — Tamil **கண்** (*kaṇ*), Kannada **ಕಣ್ಣು** (*kaṇṇu*), Malayalam **കണ്ണ്** (*kaṇṇ*). Telugu still builds on it: **కనిపించు** (*kanipin̄cu*), “to appear, to be visible.” Four everyday verbs, one shared eye.

The letters in this word

చూ is **చ** (*ca*) with the **long-ū** sign — the drawn-out partner of the short *u* ending every verb in this chapter. Hold it: *cū*, not *cu*. **డు** is retroflex *ḍa* with that short *u*.

Grammar Lens: -అండి, the respectful command, on any stem

Chapter 8 gave you **కూర్చండి** (*kūrcōṇḍi*), “please sit.” Chapter 9 gave you **క్షమించండి** (*kṣamin̄caṇḍi*), “forgive me.” That shared **-అండి** (*-aṇḍi*) is not baked into those two words. It is a slot, and every verb in this chapter can fill it:

- **చూడండి** (*cūḍaṇḍi*) — please look
- **రండి** (*raṇḍi*) — please come
- **తినండి** (*tin̄aṇḍi*) — please eat
- **వెళ్ళండి** (*vellaṇḍi*) — please go

Bare stem for a child or a close friend; stem plus *-aṇḍi* for everyone else. The respect is built the way Chapter 2 built it: *mīru* is a plural standing in for one person, and *-aṇḍi* is that plural now sitting on the verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “cūḍu” — see, look — then “cūstānu”
- the four sisters’ four verbs — “cūḍu ... pār ... nōḍu ... kāṇuka”
- the eye they all share — “kannu ... kaṇ ... kaṇṇu ... kaṇṇ”

- all four polite commands — “cūḍaṇḍi ... raṇḍi ... tinaṇḍi ... vellāṇḍi”

Before you move on

Do the four sisters share an everyday verb for seeing? (**No** — *cūḍu*, *pār*, *nōḍu*, *kāṇuka*, all different.) What do they share instead? (**The eye** — *kannu*, *kaṇ*, *kaṇṇu*, *kaṇṇ*.) Make “please eat” and “please come.” (*Tinaṇḍi*; *raṇḍi*.) Where have you met that politeness before? (**In మీరు** — a plural used for one person, now on the verb.) Next: a verb with no room for a person at all.

32.6 తెలుసు (telusu) — “to know,” the verb with no room for a person

Five verbs, and every one ended on *-ānu*, the piece that means “I.” The last verb of the chapter has no such piece — and Chapter 6 already handed you the sentence it makes.

You’ll want to know: తెలుసు

తెలుసు — *telusu* — it is known

Not “to know” in the English sense. It comes from తెలియు (*teliyu*), “to become clear, to be apparent” — a thing *telusu*-es to you the way a shape resolves out of fog. Its negative is తెలియదు (*teliyadu*), “it is not known.”

Tamil has the exact cousin, தெரி (*teri*). The other two sisters picked different words — Kannada ಗೊತ್ತು, *gottu*, Malayalam അറിയാം, *ariyām* — but all four build the sentence the same way, which is the point of this lesson.

Grammar Lens: no person on the verb, so the person moves

నాకు తెలుసు. — *nāku telusu* — “I know.”

తెలుసు never changes shape. Only the little dative word in front of it moves:

the knower	the sentence
I	<i>nāku telusu</i>
you	<i>nīku telusu</i>
he	<i>ataniki telusu</i>

Five verbs put the person in the last piece, which is why *nēnu* could be

dropped. Here there is no such piece, so the dative word is the one thing you **cannot** drop. Telugu treats knowing as something that **happens to** you, not something you do — and Tamil builds it identically, *enakkut teriyum*.

Now the distinction Chapter 6 could not yet draw. నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు uses *vaccu*, “comes” — Telugu **comes to** you, and that is a **skill**, a language you can actually use. నాకు తెలుసు is a **fact** you hold. Two dative sentences, two verbs, two kinds of knowing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “telusu” — it is known — from “teliyu”, to become clear
- “nāku telusu” — I know
- three knowers, one verb — “nāku ... nīku ... ataniki telusu”
- the five that carried the person — “uṇṭānu, veḷṭānu, vastānu, tiṇṭānu, cūstānu”

Before you move on

What does *telusu* mean underneath “know”? (**It is clear, it is apparent** — from *teliyu*.) Which piece is missing from it? (**The person** — so the knower sits in the dative instead.) Say “I know.” (*Nāku telusu*.) What is the difference from *nāku telugu vaccu*? (**Vaccu marks a skill**, *telusu* marks a fact.) Name the three slots one last time, with a verb in them. (**Stem, tense, person** — *veḷ* + *-ta-* + *-ānu*.) And what has no negative of its own? (ఉండు — Telugu switches to *lē-*.)

Chapter 33

Four Verbs of the Mind

Modes: 👁 eyes (4) ✍ pen (1) 🖐 Hands-free start: first 2 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I think, I understand, I read and I write in Telugu with the same three slots, build the -కో ending that hands an action back to its doer, say “I understood” with no నేను in it, and tell this chapter’s native verbs from the Sanskrit words layered beside them.

Say నేను తెలుగు రాస్తాను, run the chapter’s four verbs in the present, count them up from ఆరు to పది, take వ్రాయు back to the Dravidian line-drawing root behind Tamil వ్రా and Kannada ಬರೆ, and name which of the four words came from Sanskrit.

33.1 అనుకో (anukō) — “to think,” which is saying it to yourself

Nāku telusu — “I know” — and that verb had no room for a person. This one takes the person back, and carries a second verb on its end.

You’ll want to know: అనుకో

అనుకో — *anukō* — to think; to suppose

Threaded up: అనుకుంటాను (*anukuntānu*), “I think,” and అనుకున్నాను (*anukunnānu*), “I thought.” That -ంటాను is the ending you already made in తింటాను (*tiṇṭānu*): stem, tense, then the -ānu that means “I.”

The letters in this word

అ is the standing vowel *a*, used when a word begins on that sound. ను is *na* with the *u* sign, the shape that ends *nēnu*. క్ is క (*ka*) with the long-*ō* sign: hold it, *kō*.

Grammar Lens: -క్, the ending that hands the verb back

కొను (*konu*) is a verb of its own — “to take, to get.” Bolted onto the back of another verb it stops being a word and becomes an ending, -కొను, worn down to -క్ in speech. What it adds is small and everywhere: *do the thing, and keep it*.

So అను (“say”) plus -క్ is **say it, and keep it** — say it to nobody but yourself.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

అను (*anu*), “to say,” is Proto-Dravidian **aHn-*, and every sister kept it: Tamil என் (*en*), Kannada ಅನ್ನು (*annu*), Malayalam എన్నുക (*ennuka*).

Beside it Telugu keeps a borrowed thinker: ఆలోచించు (*ālōciṇcu*), “to consider” — ఆలోచిస్తాను (*ālōcistānu*). Its Sanskrit noun ఆలోచన (*ālōcana*) is glossed two ways at once: “reflecting” and “seeing.”

Sanskrit made thinking a kind of looking, as English did in *reflect*.

The split Chapter 32 named over *tiṇḍi* and *bhōjanam* holds: plain verb native, formal word Sanskrit.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two pieces, then the word — “anu ... *kō* ... anukō”
- “anukunṭānu”, I think — then “anukunnānu”, I thought
- the ending you already had — “tiṇṭānu ... anukunṭānu”
- the family’s say-verb — “anu ... *en* ... annu ... ennuka”
- native and borrowed — “anukunṭānu ... *ālōcistānu*”

Before you move on

What are the two pieces of *anukō*, and what does the second do? (అను “say” plus -కో, which hands the action back to the doer.) Say “I think,” and name the verb ending the same way. (*Anukunṭānu*; తిను.) Which sisters keep the say-verb, and what is *ālōcana* glossed as? (All three; “reflecting” and “seeing”.) Which think-word is borrowed? (అలోచించు — as *bhōjanam* was beside *tiṇḍi*.)

33.2 అర్థం చేసుకో (artham cēsukō) — “to understand,” making the meaning yours

Anukunṭānu — I think — and the -కో on its back meant *and keep it*. That ending now arrives on a verb you have owned since Chapter 5.

You’ll want to know: అర్థం చేసుకో

అర్థం చేసుకో — *artham cēsukō* — to understand

Three pieces, all already yours: అర్థం (*artham*, “meaning”), చేయు (*cēyu*, “to do”), and the -కో of the last lesson. Word for word it says **make the meaning your own**.

నేను అర్థం చేసుకుంటాను. — *nēnu artham cēsukunṭānu* — “I understand.”

The letters in this word

ర్థ is a **conjunct** — ర (*ra*) stacked above థ (*tha*), one block for two consonants with no vowel between. ం is the **anusvāra** that closes *namaskāram*, and చే opens *cēyu*.

Grammar Lens: the other way to say it, with no “I” in it

నాకు అర్థమైంది. — *nāku arthamaīndi* — “I understood.”
Literally: “to me it became meaning.”

Three dative sentences now, and one design:

the sentence	what it says
<i>nāku telugu vaccu</i>	Telugu comes to me
<i>nāku telusu</i>	it is clear to me
<i>nāku arthamaṇḍi</i>	it became meaning to me
No <i>nēnu</i> in any of them: the person sits in the dative because understanding, like knowing, arrives. Both shapes are good Telugu and do not feel alike — <i>nēnu artham cēsukunṭānu</i> is work you did, <i>nāku arthamaṇḍi</i> is a thing that landed.	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

అర్థం is Sanskrit अर्थ (*artha*), and Telugu took the whole of it: అర్థము means “**meaning**” and “**money, wealth**” in one entry — which is why Kauṭilya’s manual of statecraft is the *Arthaśāstra*. Its opposite: అపార్థం (*apārtham*), “a meaning taken wrong.”

Now the seam. Chapter 20’s వాతావరణం was Sanskrit throughout — *vāta* plus *āvaraṇa*. This is not that. Only the noun crossed over; the doing is Telugu’s own *cēyu* wearing Telugu’s own *-kō*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three pieces — “artham ... cēyu ... kō”
- “nēnu artham cēsukunṭānu” — I understand
- the three dative sentences — “nāku telugu vaccu ... nāku telusu ... nāku arthamaṇḍi”
- the two verbs built with *-kō* — “anukunṭānu ... artham cēsukunṭānu”
- “artham ... apārtham”

Before you move on

Take *artham cēsukō* apart and give the literal sense. (**Meaning + do + for yourself.**) Say “I understood” without *nēnu*, then name the other two sentences built that way. (*Nāku arthamaṇḍi*; *nāku telugu vaccu*, *nāku telusu*.) Why is the person in the dative?

(Understanding arrives at you.) What two things does *artham* mean, and how is this compound unlike *vātāvaraṇam*? (Meaning and wealth; *vātāvaraṇam* is Sanskrit throughout, here only the noun is.)

33.3 థ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ఋ — what does it do? And one from further back: ణ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: థ

థ — *tha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *th*, it is **tha**.

The *h* in *tha* is a puff of breath — the fifth pair of that kind, after క/ఖ, గ/ఘ, ఙ/ఞ and బ/భ. The plain letter here is త. Say *ta*, then say it again and let the breath out after it: that is థ.

It is not the *th* of English *this* or *thin*. The tongue stays where it goes for త, against the back of the teeth; only the breath is added.

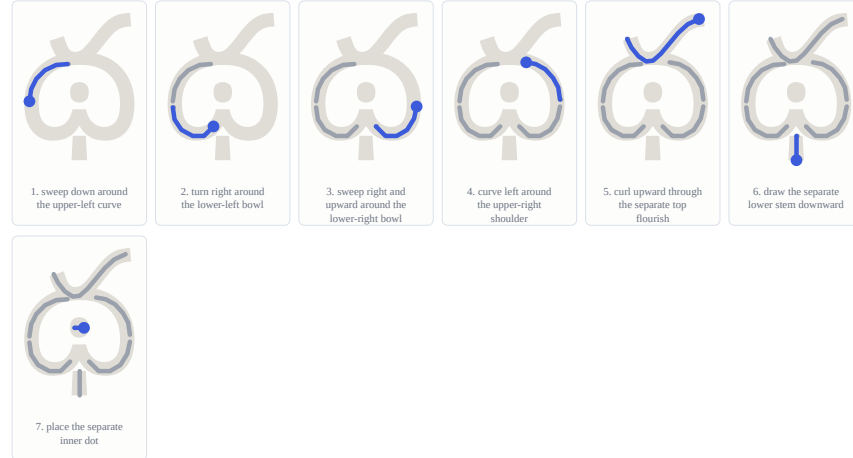
You already say these, and both have థ inside them:

- అర్థం *artham* — meaning, the word inside *artham* *cēsukō*
- అపార్థం *apārtham* — a misunderstanding, meaning gone wrong

In both, థ carries ఠ stacked on top of it — the ఠ block you met when you learned to understand things.

Writing: థ — seven deliberate movements

How it is written — 7 strokes · 6 pen lifts · 7 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant థ packaged tracing guides res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_4_2_tha.png and res/drawable/line_stroke_c_4_2_tha.png, movements 1-7 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How థ is written, stroke by stroke

Watch the numbered filmstrip once before your pen moves. Movements 1–4 build the round body in four short curves: upper left, lower left, lower right, then upper right. Lift between each curve. Movement 5 adds the rising top flourish. Lift again for movement 6, the short lower stem, and once more for movement 7, the dot inside.

Trace the same route slowly. This is one attested school-style order fitted to the printed shape here; Telugu handwriting varies, so preserve the seven clear movements rather than trying to join the gaps.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one has థ and which has త

అర్థం · తెలుగు

- *Say it:* *ta*, then *tha*, and hear the breath arrive
- *Trace it:* థ three times, saying *tha* as you finish each one

Before you move on

Which character is this — థ? What does it carry that త does not? (*tha* — the same *t* with a puff of breath after it, and not the English *th*.)

One more, from much earlier: ధ — what does it do?

33.4 చదువు (caduvu) — “to read,” which is also “an education”

Nāku arthamaindi — it became meaning to me. Say it once.
Now the verb for the work that gets you there.

You’ll want to know: చదువు

చదువు — *caduvu* — to read; to study

నేను తెలుగు చదువుతాను. — *nēnu telugu caduvutānu* — “I read Telugu.”

Telugu does not split reading from studying, and it builds no separate noun either: చదువు unchanged is “**education, studies**” — what a family means when it says a child’s *caduvu* is going well.

The sisters scatter here as completely as they did over seeing: Tamil పடி (*paḍi*), Kannada ಓದು (*ōdu*), Malayalam വായിക്കുക (*vāyikkuka*), Telugu చదువు. Four unrelated everyday verbs for one act.

The letters in this word

చ is *ca*, the letter that opens *cūḍu*. దు is ద (*da*) with the *u* sign, and వు is వ (*va*) with the same sign. Three light syllables, each ending in that short *u*.

Grammar Lens: one stem, three middle vowels

when

Telugu

now, or later

caduvutānu

already

cadivānu

asked politely

cadavaṇḍi

cadu-, *cadi-*, *cada-*. The middle vowel moves, and nothing else does.

Chapter 32 gave you the harsh version of this with ు: there the word you call the verb by was not the word the endings attach to, and they went to *vaccu-* instead. This is the mild version — one stem, three vowels, plainly the same word. Expect the wobble; do not expect a second verb.

The respectful -అంఢి arrives exactly as it did on *cūḍaṇḍi*: చదవంఢి (*cadavaṇḍi*), “please read.” The ending never changes; only the stem in front of it does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nēnu telugu caduvutānu” — I read Telugu
- the three middle vowels — “caduvutānu ... cadivānu ... cadavaṇḍi”
- the two polite commands — “cūḍaṇḍi ... cadavaṇḍi”
- the four sisters’ four verbs — “caduvu ... paḍi ... ṍdu ... vāyikkuka”
- the chapter so far — “anukunṭānu, artham cēsukunṭānu, caduvutānu”

Before you move on

What two English verbs does *caduvu* cover, and what is its noun? (**Read** and **study**; the **same word** — an education.) Say “I read Telugu,” then “please read.” (*Nēnu telugu caduvutānu; cadavaṇḍi.*) What moves between *caduvutānu*, *cadivānu* and *cadavaṇḍi*, and which verb warned you about a second stem? (**The middle vowel**; ు, whose endings went to *vaccu-*.) Do the four sisters share a read-verb? (**No** — *caduvu*, *paḍi*, *ṍdu*, *vāyikkuka*.)

33.5 రాయ (rāyu) — “to write,” which began as drawing a line

Caduvutānu, *cadivānu*, *cadavaṇḍi* — one stem, three middle vowels. The chapter’s last verb is the other half of that one.

You'll want to know: రాయు

రాయు — *rāyu* — to write

నేను తెలుగు రాస్తాను. — *nēnu telugu rāstānu* — “I write Telugu.”

The past is రాశాను (*rāśānu*). Dictionaries often print the headword as వ్రాయు (*vrāyu*): not a different verb, just the older spelling, with a *v* gone quiet in speech.

The letters in this word

రా is ర (*ra*) — Chapter 32's whole command *rā* — with the long-*ā* sign, and యు is య (*ya*) with the *u* sign. In వ్రాయు a వ is stacked in front.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

That silent *v* is the evidence. వ్రాయు goes back to a Dravidian **warV-*, “to draw a line,” and the sisters kept the *v* Telugu buried: Tamil வரை (*varai*), Malayalam വരയ്ക്കുക (*varaykkuka*), Kannada ಬರೆ (*bare*) with a *b*. Every one still means **draw** as readily as **write**. Telugu's noun keeps the shape: రాత (*rāta*), “handwriting” — and, in speech, what is written for you.

One honest note: Tamil's everyday write-verb is எழுது (*elutu*), not *varai*. The sisters share the root without agreeing which word does the daily work — the picture *caduvu* left you with.

Grammar Lens: ten verbs, and one machine

Chapter 32 handed you ఆరు (*āru*) verbs. Four more makes పది (*padi*), ten — and not one needed a new machine. Stem, tense, person: the three slots were already yours. That is what agglutination buys. What they added is a shape and a habit. The shape is -శ్, which hands the action back to its doer. The habit is Telugu's oldest: *caduvu*, *rāyu* and *anu* are native, while *ālōcana* and *arthamī*, laid on top, are Sanskrit — *tiṇḍi* beside *bhōjanamī*, one chapter on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nēnu telugu rāstānu” — then “rāśānu”

- the spellings and the sisters — “rāyu ... vrāyu ... varai ... bare”
- the chapter’s four — “anukunṭānu, artham cēsukunṭānu, caduvutānu, rāstānu”
- the count — “āru”, then “padi”
- two dative sentences — “nāku telusu ... nāku arthamaindi”

Before you move on

Say “I write Telugu,” name the older spelling, and say what the root meant first. (*Nēnu telugu rāstānu*; వ్రాయు; **to draw a line** — Tamil *varai*, Kannada *bare*.) Run this chapter’s four verbs, then count them with Chapter 32’s. (*Anukunṭānu, artham cēsukunṭānu, caduvutānu, rāstānu*; **padi** — *āru* plus four.) What does -**క** do, and which two carry it? (**Hands the action back to the doer**; *anukō, artham cēsukō*.) Which words here are Sanskrit? (అర్థం and *ālōcana*, with the plain verbs native — *tiṇḍi* against *bhōjanam*.)

Chapter 34

Four Verbs Between People

Modes: 👁 eyes (4) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I take, I ask and I help in Telugu, say నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం knowing there is no verb in it, place it beside the three other dative sentences I have built, and name the branch of Dravidian Telugu actually belongs to.

Say నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం and unpack it as “to me, Telugu, a liking” with no verb at all; line it up against నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు, నాకు తెలుసు and నాకు అర్థమైంది; choose between the native నచ్చు and ఇష్టపడు, whose పడు is the falling of వర్షం పడుతోంది; and trace ఇష్టం to the Indo-European root behind English ask.

34.1 తీసుకో (tīsukō) — “to take,” the third verb you do for yourself

The last four verbs happened inside your head; these four happen between you and somebody else. Say *caduvutānu* and *rāstānu*, and name what *vrāyu*’s root first meant.

You’ll want to know: తీసుకో

తీసుకో — *tīsukō* — to take

Underneath it is తీయు (*tīyu*), “to pull out,” and then the -కో you have met twice: pull it out, **and keep it**.

తీసుకుంటాను (*tīsukunṭānu*), “I take”; తీసుకున్నాను (*tīsukunnānu*), “I took” — *tiṇṭānu*’s ending on a different stem. Two whole sentences, from Chapter 15:

నేను నీళ్ళు తీసుకుంటాను. — *nēnu nīḷḷu tīsukunṭānu* — “I take water.”

నేను బియ్యం తీసుకుంటాను. — *nēnu biyyam tīsukunṭānu* — “I take rice.”

The letters in this word

తీ is the dental త (ta) with the long-ī sign — *tinu*’s letter, held longer. సు is స (sa) plus u; కో is *anukō*’s *kō*.

Grammar Lens: three verbs, one ending

the verb	what the -కో adds
<i>anukō</i>	say it — to yourself
<i>artham cēsukō</i>	make the meaning — yours
<i>tīsukō</i>	pull it out — for yourself

The respectful -అండి goes on this one too: తీసుకోండి (*tīsukōṇḍi*), “please take” — what a Telugu host says while pushing a dish towards you.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

కొను (*konu*) is still a verb on its own: “to take, to get, to buy.” Its cousins are exact — Tamil கொள் (*kol*) and Malayalam കൊള്ളുക (*kolluka*), both “to hold, to take.”

What those two did with it is the good part: they welded it onto the backs of other verbs as an ending, with the very meaning Telugu gives it. So the shape you learned two lessons ago is not a Telugu quirk. It is Dravidian machinery, and *tīsukō* is the verb it started from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “tīyu ... *kō*” → “tīsukō”
- “nēnu nīḷḷu tīsukunṭānu” — then with “biyyam”, rice
- the three with the ending — “anukō ... artham cēsukō ... tīsukō”
- what a host says — “tīsukōṇḍi”
- the cousins — “konu ... *kol* ... *kolluka*”

Before you move on

Take *tīsukō* apart, say “I take water,” and name the other two verbs with that ending. (తీయు plus -కో; *nēnu nīḷḷu tīsukunṭānu*; *anukō* and *arthani cēsukō*.) Which verb did the ending come from, and which sisters have it? (కొను; Tamil *kol*, Malayalam *koḷḷuka* — both use it as an ending too.) How do you offer someone food? (తీసుకోండి.)

34.2 అడుగు (*aḍugu*) — “to ask,” and the branch Telugu really sits on

Tīsukunṭānu — and its ending belonged to the whole family.
This next verb belongs to almost nobody.

You’ll want to know: అడుగు

అడుగు — *aḍugu* — to ask; to request

అడుగుతాను (*aḍugutānu*), “I ask”; అడిగాను (*aḍigānu*), “I asked”; అడగండి (*aḍagaṇḍi*), “please ask.” *aḍu-*, *aḍi-*, *aḍa-*: the middle vowel wanders as *caduvu*’s did, and the polite -అండి rides on unbothered.

One warning: Telugu has a **second** అడుగు, “a foot, a step” — same spelling, different root, nothing to do with asking.

The letters in this word

అ is the standing vowel *a*, as in *anukō*; డు is the retroflex డ (*ḍa*) plus *u*, the *ḍu* ending *cūḍu*; గు is గ (*ga*) plus *u*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The four literary sisters share no ask-verb: Tamil கேள் (*kēḷ*) and Kannada ಕೇಳು (*kēḷu*), which also mean “hear”; Malayalam ചോദിക്കുക (*cōdikkuka*); and Telugu అడుగు, which keeps hearing separate in విను (*vinu*). The Dravidian dictionary’s firmest match for *aḍugu* is in none of them: it is **Parji** *aḍ-*, a small language of central India.

That is the clue to something worth naming outright. **Telugu is not in the same branch as Tamil, Kannada and Malayalam.** Those three are **South Dravidian**; Telugu heads **South-Central**

Dravidian, with Gondi, Konda, Kui, Kuvi, Pengo and Manda. So the pattern was no run of accidents: *lēdu* against the sisters' *il-*, *uṇḍu* against their *iru*, *enimidi* and *tommidi* where *eṭṭu* and *onpatu* will not reach.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

For the noun Telugu reaches for Sanskrit: ప్రశ్న (*praśna*), “a question,” from प्रच्छ (*prach*) — an Indo-European root, and the root of Latin *precārī*, which English took as **pray**. Native verb, borrowed noun: *tiṇḍi* and *bhōjanam*, a third time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three vowels — “aḍugutānu ... aḍigānu ... aḍagaṇḍi”
- the same wobble — “caduvutānu ... cadivānu ... cadavaṇḍi”
- four sisters, four verbs — “aḍugu ... kēḷ ... kēḷu ... cōdikkuka”
- Telugu’s own branch — “Gondi, Konda, Kui”
- what it explains — “lēdu ... uṇḍu ... enimidi, tommidi”
- the borrowed noun and its cousin — “praśna ... pray”

Before you move on

Say “I ask,” “I asked,” “please ask,” and name the other verb that wanders its middle vowel. (*Aḍugutānu*, *aḍigānu*, *aḍagaṇḍi*; చదువు.) Do the four literary sisters share an ask-verb? (**No** — *aḍugu*, *kēḷ*, *kēḷu*, *cōdikkuka*.) Which branch is Telugu on, who is on it, and name two things that explains. (**South-Central Dravidian**, with Gondi, Konda and Kui; *lēdu* against *il-*, *uṇḍu* against *iru*, *enimidi* and *tommidi*.) Where is *praśna* from? (**Sanskrit**, from the root behind English **pray**.)

34.3 సహాయం చేయు (sahāyaṁ cēyu) — “to help,” which is a going-together

Aḍagaṇḍi — please ask. Say it, and name where *prāsna* came from. The verb that answers is one Chapter 5 walked past.

You’ll want to know: సహాయం చేయు

సహాయం చేయు — *sahāyaṁ cēyu* — **to help**

Chapter 5 listed it once, as an example of what *cēyu* does with a noun in front. Take it properly now.

నేను మీకు సహాయం చేస్తాను. — *nēnu mīku sahāyaṁ cēstānu* — “I help you.”

The person helped goes in the **dative**: *mīku*, “to you,” Chapter 6’s -కు at ordinary work. Politely: సహాయం చేయండి (*sahāyaṁ cēyaṇḍi*). Speech shortens the noun to సాయం (*sāyaṁ*).

The letters in this word

స is *sa*; హ is హ (*ha*) with the long-ā sign; యం is య (*ya*) closed by the anusvāra.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

సహాయం is Sanskrit सहाय (*sahāya*), and it comes apart cleanly: सह (*saha*), “with,” plus आय (*āya*), “a going.” A helper is **one who goes with you**. Both halves are Indo-European — *saha* is the “one, together” root behind **same** and **similar**, and *āya* is the go-root Latin carries as *ire*, which English took whole in **exit** and **transit**.

The build is Chapter 8’s: a borrowed noun in front of the native చేయు, as దయచేసి was made from *daya*. Kannada and Malayalam borrowed *sahāya* too; **Tamil did not**, keeping its own உதவி (*udavi*) — yet for *please* all four reached for *daya*. Borrowing happens **word by word**.

Why it’s said this way

Dictionaries record సహాయం and సాయం side by side, *sāyaṁ* the shorter and more casual. What no source consulted here states is that *sāyaṁ* is a worn-down *sahāyaṁ*. It seems obvious. Obvious is not a citation.

Chapter 31 drew the same line over a greeting: two sources for “real and formal,” one for “less common,” kept apart.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nēnu mīku sahāyaṁ cēstānu” — I help you
- shorter, then polite — “sāyaṁ cēstānu ... sahāyaṁ cēyaṇḍi”
- the halves — “saha ... āya” — then “exit ... transit”
- two nouns, one verb — “daya cēsi ... sahāyaṁ cēyu”
- the sister that kept its own — “udavi”
- the chapter — “tīsukunṭānu, aḍugutānu, sahāyaṁ cēstānu”

Before you move on

Say “I help you,” name the case the helped person takes, and take *sahāya* apart. (*Nēnu mīku sahāyaṁ cēstānu*; the **dative** -కు; सह “with” plus आय “a going” — **exit** and **transit** carry the go-half.) Which other word is built on *cēyu* that way, and which sister kept its own? (దయచేసి; **Tamil**, with *udavi*.) What may you *not* say about *sāyaṁ*? (**That it comes from *sahāyaṁ*** — that derivation is not sourced here.)

34.4 నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం — “I like Telugu,” with no verb in it

Sahāyaṁ cēstānu — a going with somebody. Say it, then *tī-sukunṭānu*. This last sentence has no verb.

You’ll want to know: The sentence

నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం. *nāku telugu iṣṭaṁ*. — “to me — Telugu — a liking.”

ఇష్టం is a **noun**: “a liking, a wish,” and Telugu supplies no *is*, having never needed one. Only the front piece moves — *nāku, nīku, ataniki*. తెలుసు behaved so too: there the verb had no room for a person; here there is no verb.

The letters in this word

ఇ is the standing vowel *i*; ష్ట is the conjunct ష (*ṣa*) over ట (*ṭa*).

Grammar Lens: the fourth dative sentence, and two ways round it

Four sentences, one idea: *nāku telugu vaccu*, a **skill**; *nāku telusu*, a **fact**; *nāku arthamaṇḍi*, a meaning that **landed**; *nāku telugu iṣṭam*, a **taste**. Chapter 6’s dative subject was no curiosity: it is how Telugu files what happens **to** you.

A native verb does it too — నచ్చు (*naccu*), “to be pleasing”: నాకు ఇది నచ్చింది (*nāku idi naccindi*). Tamil நச்ச and Kannada ನಚ್ಚ are the same verb: *iṣṭam* displaced nothing.

One shape takes an ordinary subject: ఇష్టపడు (*iṣṭapaḍu*), నేను ఇష్టపడతాను — *iṣṭam* plus పడు (*paḍu*), “to fall,” Chapter 20’s verb in వర్షం పడుతోంది. Liking is something you **fall into**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ఇష్టం is Sanskrit इष्ट (*iṣṭa*), “desired,” from इष् (*iṣ*) — an Indo-European root whose English descendant is **ask**. So this chapter carried two asking-roots, not one: *prach* behind *pray*, *iṣ* behind *ask*. Telugu’s అడుగు is cousin to neither: its relatives are Gondi and Kui.

Spanish *me gusta*, Italian *mi piace*, Hindi *muḥe pasand hai*, Bengali *āmār bhālo lāge*, Tamil *enakkut tamil piḍikkum* — and now *nāku telugu iṣṭam*. **Six languages, three unrelated families, one design**, with Chapter 6’s Dravidian seam showing: **-ku, -ukku, -ge, -ikku**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*nāku telugu iṣṭam*” — “to me, Telugu, a liking”
- three likers — “*nāku ... nīku ... ataniki telugu iṣṭam*”

- the four datives — “vaccu ... telusu ... arthamaindi ... iṣṭam̐”
- native, then falling — “naccindi ... iṣṭapaḍatānu”
- the chapter — “tīsukunṭānu, aḍugutānu, cēstānu, iṣṭam̐”
- the endings — “-ku · -ukku · -ge · -ikku”

Before you move on

Say “I like Telugu,” say how many verbs it holds, and name the four datives. (*Nāku telugu iṣṭam̐*; **none**; *vaccu* a **skill**, *telusu* a **fact**, *arthamaindi* a **landing**, *iṣṭam̐* a **taste**.) Which native verb does the same job, and what hides inside *iṣṭapaḍu*? (నచ్చు; పడు, the falling of *varṣam̐ paḍutōndi*.) Which English word is *iṣṭam̐*’s cousin, and is it *praśna*’s? (**Ask**; **no**, that is **pray** — and **six** languages in **three** families build liking so.)

Chapter 35

Family and Friends

Modes: 🗣️ voice (2) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my family as a group in Telugu and name a friend, and say which of the two words is a Sanskrit loan and which is Telugu's own native word.

Say ఇది నా కుటుంబం and ఇతను నా స్నేహితుడు, trace కుటుంబం and స్నేహితుడు back to Sanskrit, and set స్నేహితుడు beside the native, DEDR-attested నేస్తం.

35.1 కుటుంబం (kuṭumbam) — “family,” the word the household words never needed

Nāku telugu iṣṭamī closed the last chapter on a sentence built from nothing but nouns. This chapter opens on the plainest nouns of all: the words for the people you would actually say that sentence to.

You'll want to know: కుటుంబం

కుటుంబం — *kuṭumbam* — family

ఇది నా కుటుంబం. — *idi nā kuṭumbamī*. — “This is my family.”

నా, “my,” has been yours since one of the very first words you learned.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

కుటుంబం is Sanskrit कुटुम्ब (kuṭumba), “family, household,” carried into Telugu whole — the same kind of tatsama loan as నమస్కారం and సంతోషం.

Your earlier family-words lesson gave you six words: నాన్న, అమ్మ, and the four age-graded siblings అన్న/తమ్ముడు, అక్క/చెల్లి. Every one is native Dravidian, and not one of them means “family” — each names a single specific person. Telugu never inherited a plain word for the group itself, so when it needed one, it reached for Sanskrit. The people came first, and stayed native; the collective came later, and came borrowed — the same split you already met between *tinu* and *bhōjanam*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “idi nā kuṭumbam” — this is my family
- the six named people, then the borrowed group word — “nānna, amma, anna, tammudu, akka, celli ... kuṭumbam”
- “nāku telugu iṣṭam” — once more, no verb in it

Before you move on

Say “this is my family.” (*Idi nā kuṭumbam*.) Is *kuṭumbam* native Dravidian or a loan? (**A Sanskrit loan**, like *namaskāram* and *santōṣam*.) Name the six family words from that earlier lesson. (*Nānna, amma, anna, tammudu, akka, celli*.) Which of those six means “family” as a group? (**None of them** — that’s exactly the gap *kuṭumbam* fills.)

35.2 స్నేహితుడు (snēhituḍu) — “friend,” and the native word beside it

Kuṭumbam named the people you’re related to. This word names the people you choose.

You'll want to know: స్నేహితుడు

స్నేహితుడు — *snēhituḍu* — **friend** (male; స్నేహితురాలు, *snēhiturālu*, for a female friend)

ఇతను నా స్నేహితుడు. — *itanu nā snēhituḍu*. — “This is my friend.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

స్నేహితుడు is built on Sanskrit स्नेह (*sneha*), “affection, love” — the same kind of tatsama loan as *kuṭumbam* itself, plus a Telugu agentive ending. Telugu also has a **native** word for friendship: నేస్తం (*nēstam*), catalogued in the Dravidian Etymological Dictionary alongside the related forms *neyyamu*, *neyyami*, and *neyyari* — all clustered around friendship, love, and tenderness. *Nēstam* is real and still heard, but the everyday choice for “friend” is the borrowed one, *snēhituḍu* — the same pattern already found with *sahāyami cēyu*, where the everyday verb is built on a Sanskrit noun too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “itanu nā snēhituḍu” — this is my friend
- the borrowed word and the native one — “snēhituḍu ... nēstam”
- family, then friend — “kuṭumbam ... snēhituḍu”

Before you move on

Say “this is my friend.” (*Itanu nā snēhituḍu*.) Is *snēhituḍu* native or borrowed? (**A Sanskrit loan**, from *sneha*, “affection.”) What is Telugu’s own native word for friendship, and is it the everyday choice? (నేస్తం, *nēstam* — real, but **not** the everyday choice; that’s the borrowed word.)

Chapter 36

Son and Daughter, Two Different Roots

Modes: ⇌ voice (2) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say son and daughter in Telugu, and show that they trace to two different Proto-Dravidian roots rather than one shared root.

Line up కొడుకు and కూతురు against their two separate Proto-Dravidian roots, trace కొడుకు's own root sideways to కోడలు (“daughter-in-law”), and trace కూతురు's root across the family to Kannada's word for infant.

36.1 కొడుకు (koḍuku) — “son,” and the unexpected word it shares a root with

Kuṭumbani, family; *snēhituḍu*, friend. Now the two words for your own children — and Telugu does not build them the tidy way you might expect.

You'll want to know: కొడుకు

కొడుకు — *koḍuku* — son

వాడి కొడుకు వయసెంత? — *vāḍi koḍuku vayasenta?* — “How old is his son?” — the verbless age question you already know, asked about someone else's child.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

కొడుకు is inherited from Proto-Dravidian ***kōz-**, “young, tender.” You might expect “daughter,” Telugu’s other child-word, to share that same root with a different ending — that is exactly the shape Kannada’s *magu/maga/ magalu* takes. Telugu does not do that. The very same ***kōz-** root instead gives Telugu కొడలు (*kōḍalu*), “daughter-in-law” — the woman a son marries, not the daughter a parent has. So *koḍuku* and *kōḍalu* are true cognates, one root apart; *koḍuku* and *kūturu* — son and daughter — are not related to each other at all. The next lesson takes up *kūturu*’s own, separate root.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “koḍuku” — son
- “vāḍi koḍuku vayasenta?” — how old is his son?
- the unexpected cognate — “koḍuku ... kōḍalu” — son, daughter-in-law
- three words for people — “kuṭumbam ... snēhituḍu ... koḍuku”

Before you move on

Say “son.” (*Koḍuku.*) What Proto-Dravidian root does it come from, and what other Telugu word shares that exact root? (***kōz-**, “young, tender” — shared with కొడలు, “daughter-in-law,” not with “daughter” itself.) Ask “how old is his son?” (*Vāḍi koḍuku vayasenta?*)

36.2 కూతురు (*kūturu*) — “daughter,” on a root all its own

Koḍuku’s root turned up again inside a completely different Telugu word. This word’s root does something even less expected: it turns up inside a different **language**.

You'll want to know: కూతురు

కూతురు — *kūturu* — daughter

నా కూతురు. — *nā kūturu.* — “My daughter.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

కూతురు is inherited from Proto-Dravidian ***kūnttu** — a root with **no connection** to *koḍuku*'s ***kōḷ-**. Telugu's two child-words are not a matched pair; they are two separate inheritances that happen to sit side by side in the same sentence.

Kūturu's cousin is not in Telugu at all. Kannada ಕೂಸು (*kūsu*), “**infant, maiden**,” answers to the very same root. So the word a Telugu speaker uses for “my daughter” and the word a Kannada speaker uses for “the baby” are, underneath, one and the same — a reminder that a cognate does not have to keep the same *sense* as it crosses a language boundary, only the same root.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*nā kūturu*” — my daughter
- son, then daughter — “*koḍuku ... kūturu*” — two unrelated roots
- the cross-language cousin — “*kūturu ... kūsu*” — daughter, infant
- friend, son, daughter — “*snēhituḍu ... koḍuku ... kūturu*”

Before you move on

Say “my daughter.” (*Nā kūturu.*) Does *kūturu* share a root with *koḍuku*? (**No** — two separate Proto-Dravidian roots.) What word in another Dravidian language answers to *kūturu*'s own root, and what does it mean there? (**Kannada ಕೂಸು *kūsu*, “infant, maiden.”**)

Chapter 37

Four Words on the Face

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my eye, ear, nose and mouth in Telugu, and say which three the family agrees on and which one Telugu's word does not obviously match.

Name కన్ను, చెవి, ముక్కు and నోరు; close the loop Chapter 32 left open on కన్ను; and say why నోరు, unlike the other three, shows no visible trace of the shared vāy root Tamil, Malayalam and Kannada all carry.

37.1 కన్ను (kannu) — “eye,” a word you’ve already met once

Head and hand, taught earlier, gave you your first two body words. This chapter gives you four more — starting with one this book has secretly used before.

You’ll want to know: కన్ను

కన్ను — *kannu* — eye

నా కన్ను. — *nā kannu.* — “My eye.”

Three body words now, with two from that earlier lesson: *tala*, *ceyyi*, *kannu* — and *koḍuku*, “son,” still fresh, one lesson back.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

కన్ను already appeared earlier, inside the *cūḍu* lesson’s own etymology note for చూడు — as proof that Tamil *pār*, Kannada *nōḍu*, Malayalam *kāṇuka*, and Telugu *cūḍu*, four completely unrelated everyday see-verbs, all sit beside the very same ancient eye-word: Telugu *kannu*, Tamil *kaṇ*, Kannada *kaṇṇu*, Malayalam *kaṇṇ*. That chapter named the word without ever teaching it. This lesson closes the loop. Like *tala* (“head”) and *ceyyi* (“hand,” a cognate reshaped almost past recognition) before it, *kannu* is native Dravidian, and here the whole family agrees on it plainly — no reshaping required.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nā kannu” — my eye
- the four sisters’ shared eye — “kannu ... kaṇ ... kaṇṇu ... kaṇṇ”
- three body words — “tala ... ceyyi ... kannu”
- son, daughter, eye — “koḍuku ... kūturu ... kannu”

Before you move on

Say “my eye.” (*Nā kannu*.) Which earlier lesson already used this exact word, and what did it prove? (**The *cūḍu* lesson’s** etymology note — that all four Dravidian sisters share one eye-root behind four unrelated see-verbs.) Name the two body words from that earlier lesson. (తల, *tala*, and చెయ్యి, *ceyyi*.)

37.2 చెవి (cevi) — “ear,” matching Tamil almost letter for letter

Kannu matched its cousins closely but not exactly. This word matches even more closely.

You'll want to know: చెవి

చెవి — *cevi* — ear

నా చెవి. — *nā cevi.* — “My ear.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

చెవి is native Dravidian, and it answers Tamil செவி (*cevi*) almost syllable for syllable — a plainer, closer match than *kannu* found with Tamil *kaṇ* just one lesson ago. Two body words in a row, both native, both recognizably the same family — but “close cousin” is not “identical twin”: each word drifts by its own amount, and *cevi* simply happened to drift less.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*nā cevi*” — my ear
- the near-match — “*cevi ... cevi*”
- eye, then ear — “*kannu ... cevi*”
- daughter, then ear — “*kūturu ... cevi*”

Before you move on

Say “my ear.” (*Nā cevi.*) Which Dravidian cousin’s word for ear matches *cevi* most closely? (**Tamil** *cevi* — almost syllable for syllable.) Did *kannu* match its cousins that closely? (**Not quite** — one vowel apart from Tamil’s *kaṇ*.)

37.3 ముక్కు (mukku) — “nose,” an inherited word with a second word’s fingerprints on it

Eye and ear both descend cleanly from their Proto-Dravidian roots. This word descends too — but not quite cleanly.

You'll want to know: ముక్కు

ముక్కు — *mukku* — nose

నా ముక్కు. — *nā mukku.* — “My nose.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ముక్కు descends from Proto-Dravidian ***mūnk(k)u**, and it is a real cognate of Kannada *mūgu*, Malayalam *mūkkū*, and Tamil *mūkku*. But comparative Dravidian scholarship flags Telugu's own reflex as **irregular**: the consonant in the middle of the word is probably not a clean, regular descendant of **mūnk(k)u* alone. It looks contaminated by a separate Dravidian root, ***mok-**, “face” — as if two related words leaned on each other and left a mark. *Cevi* showed a word that drifted very little; *mukku* shows one that drifted in a specific, traceable way, nudged by its neighbour.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nā mukku” — my nose
- the cousins — “mukku ... mūgu ... mūkkū ... mūkku”
- three body words so far — “kannu ... cevi ... mukku”

Before you move on

Say “my nose.” (*Nā mukku.*) Is *mukku* a regular or an irregular reflex of its Proto-Dravidian root? (**Irregular** — likely contaminated by the separate root **mok-*, “face.”) Which two body words so far were plain, regular matches with their cousins? (కన్ను and చెవి.)

37.4 నోరు (nōru) — “mouth,” the word that breaks the chapter's pattern

Eye, ear, nose — three native words, three visible matches with the family, one plainer than the next. The fourth face word does not keep that streak going.

You'll want to know: నోరు

నోరు — *nōru* — **mouth**

నా నోరు. — *nā nōru.* — “My mouth.”

Four body words done: *kannu*, *cevi*, *mukku*, *nōru*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil and Malayalam both say **வாய்/vāyi** (*vāy*), “mouth,” and Kannada’s **ಬಾಯಿ** (*bāyi*) answers it through a regular sound law that turns a Tamil word-initial *v-* into Kannada *b-*. Three sisters, one shared root, one visible law.

నోరు does not obviously belong to that set. It shows no trace of *vāy*, and no source consulted here states what its own deeper Proto-Dravidian root actually is — so nothing is invented for it, the same discipline applied earlier to *vellu*’s own unresolved history. After three straight matches — *kannu* plain, *cevi* nearly exact, *mukku* traceably contaminated but still clearly related — *nōru* is the one face word where this book cannot show you the family resemblance, only note honestly that it is not there to show.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nā nōru” — my mouth
- the shared root Telugu sits outside of — “vāy ... bāyi ... nōru”
- all four face words — “kannu ... cevi ... mukku ... nōru”

Before you move on

Name all four face words. (కన్ను, చెవి, ముక్కు, నోరు.) Which three Dravidian sisters share one root and one sound law for “mouth,” and does Telugu’s word visibly belong with them? (**Tamil, Malayalam, and Kannada**, on *vāy*; **no** — *nōru* shows no trace of it, and its own root is not confirmed by any source consulted here.)

Chapter 38

The Heart, Two Ways

Modes: ⇐ voice (1) 👁 eyes (1) ⇐ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my heart in Telugu two ways, the everyday native word and the literary Sanskrit loan, and trace the Sanskrit one to the same Proto-Indo-European root as the English word heart.

Say నా గుండె and నా హృదయం నీది, set the everyday native word beside the literary Sanskrit loan, and trace హృదయం to the same PIE root as English heart, Latin cor and Greek kardía.

38.1 గుండె (guṇḍe) — “heart,” the everyday native word

Four face words done, one of them an honest gap. This chapter gives you a fifth body word — and then, unusually, a second word for the very same thing.

You’ll want to know: గుండె

గుండె — *guṇḍe* — heart

నా గుండె. — *nā guṇḍe*. — “My heart.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

గుండె is inherited from Proto-Dravidian ***kuṇṭV**, and it is cognate with Kannada’s own native heart-word, గుಂಡిగి (*guṇḍige*) — plainly

the same root, wearing a different Telugu and Kannada shape. *Guṇḍe* is the plain, physical, everyday word: the organ beating in your chest. The next lesson gives Telugu's *other* word for heart — not a synonym so much as a different register entirely.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nā guṇḍe” — my heart
- the Kannada cognate — “guṇḍe ... guṇḍige”
- five body words — “kannu ... cevi ... mukku ... nōru ... guṇḍe”

Before you move on

Say “my heart.” (*Nā guṇḍe.*) Is *guṇḍe* native or borrowed? (**Native Dravidian**, from Proto-Dravidian **kuṇṭV.*) Which language carries a matching native heart-word? (**Kannada**, *guṇḍige.*)

38.2 హృదయం (hṛdayam) — “heart,” and a genuine cousin of the English word

Guṇḍe is the heart beating in your chest. This word is the heart Telugu reaches for in a poem, a speech, or a love letter.

You’ll want to know: హృదయం

హృదయం — *hṛdayam* — **heart** (literary, emotional register)

నా హృదయం నీది. — *nā hṛdayam nīdi.* — “My heart is yours.”

The letters in this word

హృ is హ (*ha*) carrying the **vocalic-r vowel sign** ృ — the *dependent* form of the same vowel taught earlier as the *independent* letter ఋ, standing alone at the front of ఋతువు. Same vowel, two shapes: one when it opens a word, another when it rides on a consonant. దయం closes with the familiar అనుస్వారం.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

హృదయం is Sanskrit हृदय, built on हृद् (*hṛd*), “heart.” That Sanskrit root and the English word **heart** are not a coincidence of sound — both descend from the same reconstructed Proto-Indo-European root, ***kērd-**. Latin’s **cor** (genitive *cordis*, the source of English *cordial* and *courage*) and Greek’s **kardía** (behind *cardiac*) come from that exact same root. Four languages, one ancient word.

Telugu keeps *hṛdayam* beside native *guṇḍe* the same way it keeps Sanskrit *bhōjanam* beside native *tiṇḍi*: the plain, physical word stays Dravidian; the word for ceremony, poetry, and feeling is layered on top from Sanskrit.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nā hṛdayam nīdi” — my heart is yours
- the four cousins — “hṛd ... heart ... cor ... kardía”
- native, then literary — “guṇḍe ... hṛdayam”
- all six body words now — “kannu ... cevi ... mukku ... nōru ... guṇḍe ... hṛdayam”

Before you move on

Say “my heart is yours.” (*Nā hṛdayam nīdi.*) Is *hṛdayam* a real Indo-European cousin of English “heart,” or just a coincidence of sound? (**A real cousin** — both from PIE **kērd-*, alongside Latin *cor* and Greek *kardía*.) Which is the everyday, physical word for heart, and which is literary? (గుండె everyday; హృదయం literary.)

Chapter 39

Tea and Milk, Two Roads

Modes: ☞ voice (2) ✍ pen (1) ☞ Hands-free start: first 2 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can politely ask for tea or milk in Telugu, and say which word travelled by sea and which one three Dravidian cousins share under one regular sound law.

Ask దయచేసి టీ and దయచేసి పాలు, follow టీ along its sea route through Hokkien and Malay against the overland chai route, then place పాలు beside Tamil and Malayalam's matching pāl against Kannada's own p-to-h shift.

39.1 దయచేసి టీ (dayacēsi ṭī) — “tea, please,” a word that sailed rather than walked

Two ways to say heart, done. దయచేసి — please, taught earlier — is about to earn its keep again, in front of the drink you'd politely ask for first.

You'll want to know: టీ

టీ — ṭī — tea

దయచేసి టీ. — dayacēsi ṭī. — “Tea, please.”

Day to day, Telugu politeness usually rides on the -అండి verb ending already named as the everyday carrier — but a bare request for a drink, with no verb at all, is exactly where దయచేసి itself does the work instead.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

తీ is a direct loan from English **tea**. English’s own word traces to **Hokkien** (Southern Min Chinese) **tê**, carried west by Dutch and English sea trade through **Malay** *teh* and into Europe — the **sea** route.

That is the opposite road from the word most of Telugu’s neighbours use. Hindi, Kannada, and Marathi all say some form of **chai**, which travelled **overland**: Mandarin **chá**, into Persian چای (*chāy*), and from Persian into North and South India alike. One drink, two Chinese dialects, two trade routes, two families of words — and Telugu’s coastal contact with English trade left it holding the sea-word, **తి**, where its landlocked neighbours picked up the land-word instead.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “dayacēsi **తి**” — tea, please
- the sea route — “tê ... teh ... tea ... **తి**”
- the land route it is not — “chá ... chāy ... chai”

Before you move on

Say “tea, please.” (*Dayacēsi **తి***.) Did **తి** travel by land or by sea, and through which languages? (**By sea** — Hokkien *tê*, Malay *teh*, English *tea*.) Which word, common in Hindi, Kannada, and Marathi, took the overland road instead, and through which languages? (**Chai** — Mandarin *chá*, Persian *chāy*.)

39.2 పాలు (pālu) — “milk,” where Kannada is the odd one out, not Telugu

తి showed Telugu going its own way against most of its neighbours. This word shows the opposite: Telugu sits with the majority, and one cousin stands alone.

You’ll want to know: ಪಾಲು

ಪಾಲು — *pālu* — milk

ದಯವೇಸಿ ಪಾಲು. — *dayacēsi pālu*. — “Milk, please.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಪಾಲು descends, unchanged, from Proto-Dravidian ***pāl** — matching Tamil பால் (*pāl*) and Malayalam പാൽ (*pāl*) exactly. Kannada alone says ಹಾಲು (*hālu*), because Kannada carries a **regular sound law** that turns a word-initial Dravidian *p*- into *h*-: the same law that turns Tamil பத்து (*pattu*, “ten”) into Kannada ಹತ್ತು (*hattu*). Telugu, Tamil, and Malayalam all keep the original *p*-; only Kannada shifted it. So the pattern this chapter has been building — Telugu sometimes matching its neighbours, sometimes standing apart — flips one more time: here it is **Kannada** standing apart, not Telugu.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “dayacēsi pālu” — milk, please
- the three that match — “pālu ... pāl ... pāl”
- the one that shifted — “pālu ... hālu”
- tea, then milk — “ತೆ ... ಪಾಲು”

Before you move on

Say “milk, please.” (*Dayacēsi pālu*.) Which three Dravidian languages keep the original *p*- in “milk,” and which one shifts it to *h*-? (**Telugu, Tamil, and Malayalam** keep *p*-; **Kannada** alone shifts to *h*-, *hālu*.) Name one other word pair that shows the same Kannada sound law. (**Tamil pattu, Kannada hattu** — “ten.”)

39.3 ್ಯ — one character, met inside a word you already say

Before the new one: ಢ — what does it do? And one from further back: ಜ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ృ

ృ — *r*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *r*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

This is the second shape of a vowel you already traced whole. Back at the seasons you met ఋ, the independent letter that opens ఋతువు. When the same vowel has to ride on a consonant instead of opening a word, it sheds that standing shape and becomes this mark. One vowel, two shapes, chosen by where in the word it falls — exactly the arrangement you know from ఉ and ఁ, and from ఎ and ఌ.

You already say this one:

- హృదయం *hṛdayam* — heart, the word for poems rather than for chests

Take it apart: హ, the letter from the borrowings, carrying ృ. Not *ha* any more, and not *hru* with a vowel added — the built-in *a* has been swapped out, and what is left is **hr**.

Writing: ృ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ృ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look*: at these two, and say which one carries the sign and which carries the standing letter

హృదయం · ఋతువు

- *Trace it:* ృ three times, saying *r* as you finish each one
- *Look:* at హృ, and name its two pieces

Before you move on

Which character is this — ృ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to, and what does it take off? (**Puts *r* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Which standing letter is its partner? (ఋ.)

One more, from much earlier: ీ — what does it do?

Chapter 40

A Meal

Modes: ⇐ voice (1) 👁 eyes (1) ⇐ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I am having a meal in Telugu, using the word an earlier chapter already used and never explained.

Say భోజనం చేద్దాం, explain భోజనం against everyday తిండి the way Chapter 32 first set them side by side, and apologise for a late meal with Chapter 9's క్షమించండి.

40.1 భోజనం (bhōjanam) — “a meal,” a word this book named before it ever taught it

Tea, then milk. This chapter’s last word is not a drink — it is the meal you would sit down to with both.

You’ll want to know: భోజనం

భోజనం — *bhōjanam* — a meal

భోజనం చేద్దాం. — *bhōjanam cēddāmi*. — “Let’s eat” (literally, “let’s do a meal”).

The *tinu* lesson already used this exact word, in passing, as the polite counterpart of native తిండి — without ever teaching it properly. This lesson finally does.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

భోజనం is Sanskrit भोजन, built on भुज् (*bhuj*), “to enjoy, to partake of, to eat.” It sits above native తిండి the same way దయచేసి sits above the everyday -అండి ending: a formal Sanskrit layer over a plain Dravidian floor. కన్ను, “eye,” was a word this book had already used once, unglossed, inside an etymology note — this lesson does the very same thing for భోజనం, which was named earlier without ever being taught. If a meal runs late, Telugu reaches for the apology word taught earlier: భోజనం ఆలస్యం అయింది, క్షమించండి — “the meal is late, sorry” — the same respectful -అండి ending that first met you on దయచేసి’s own everyday alternative.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “bhōjanam cēddām” — let’s eat
- native, then borrowed — “tiṇḍi ... bhōjanam”
- the apology — “bhōjanam ālasyam ayindi, kṣamiṇcaṇḍi”
- the chapter — “tī ... pālu ... bhōjanam”

Before you move on

Say “let’s eat.” (*Bhōjanam cēddām.*) Which earlier lesson already used *bhōjanam*, without teaching it as its own word? (**The *tīnu* lesson.**) Apologise for a late meal, using the word you learned earlier. (*Bhōjanam ālasyam ayindi, kṣamiṇcaṇḍi.*)

40.2 The table words, second pass — and how to ask for them

Three words, from memory and without the page: tea, milk, and the word for a meal.

You'll want to know: three words, three different journeys

The three sit together on a table and came from three different places:

word	where it came from
టీ <i>tī</i>	borrowed, and by sea rather than by the overland road
పాలు <i>pālu</i>	the family's own — the whole Dravidian group shares it
భోజనం <i>bhōjanam</i>	Sanskrit, and formal in tone because of it

భోజనం is the one to weigh. It is not the everyday word for food; it is the polite noun for **a meal**, the sit-down kind, and its tone is the reason it belongs beside *please* rather than beside a shopping list.

Grammar Lens: two ways to put “please” on a request

Asking for any of the three uses what దయచేసి and the -ండి ending settled:

- The -ండి ending on the verb is where ordinary Telugu keeps *please*. A request with it is already polite.
- దయచేసి is the extra warmth on top — formal, or emphatic, and not the everyday word English speakers expect it to be.

So దయచేసి టీ is a warm, slightly formal ask, and the same request made with a -ండి verb and no దయచేసి is the ordinary polite one. Neither is rude.

Your turn: ask for each

Say these aloud:

- tea, please — the two-word form you learned with it
- the same ask with milk in place of tea
- the word for a meal, and notice it sounds more formal than the other two
- which of the three a host would offer you first

Before you move on

Which of the three words is the family's own? (పాలు.) Which arrived from Sanskrit, and what does that do to its tone? (భోజనం — it makes it **formal**.) Where does everyday Telugu keep *please*? (In the -ండ్లి ending on the verb.) And what is దయచేసి for? (Extra warmth, or formality, on top of an ending that is already polite.)

Chapter 41

Pointing, and Asking

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🖐️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

***By the end of this chapter:** I can point at something in Telugu and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.*

Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.

41.1 ఇది (idi) — this one — the thing near me

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You’ll want to know: ఇది

ఇది — *idi* — this one — the thing near me.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is అది *adi*, which you will meet in a moment. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **i-** for near — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ఇది” three times, pointing at something different each time

- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *idi*? (this one — the thing near me.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**i-** — near.)

41.2 అది (adi) — that one — the thing over there

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: అది

అది — *adi* — that one — the thing over there.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ఇది *idi*, which you will meet just now. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **a-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “అది” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *adi*? (that one — the thing over there.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**a-** — far.)

41.3 ఇక్కడ (ikkada) — here — where I am

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಇಕ್ಕಡ

ಇಕ್ಕಡ — *ikkada* — here — where I am.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಅಕ್ಕಡ *akkaḍa*, which you will meet in a moment. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **i-** for near — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಇಕ್ಕಡ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *ikkada*? (here — where I am.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**i-** — near.)

41.4 ಅಕ್ಕಡ (akkaḍa) — there — where I am not

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಅಕ್ಕಡ

ಅಕ್ಕಡ — *akkaḍa* — there — where I am not.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಇಕ್ಕಡ *ikkada*, which you will meet just now. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **a-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “అక్కడ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *akkada*? (there — where I am not.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (a- — far.)

41.5 ఎవరు (evaru) — who? — asking about a person

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You’ll want to know: ఎవరు

ఎవరు — *evaru* — who? — asking about a person.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ఎక్కడ *ekkada*, which you will meet in a moment. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — e- for ask — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ఎవరు” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *evaru*? (who? — asking about a person.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (e-

— ask.)

41.6 ఎక్కడ (ekkaḍa) — where? — asking about a place

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ఎక్కడ

ఎక్కడ — *ekkaḍa* — where? — asking about a place.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ఎవరు *evaru*, which you will meet just now. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **e-** for ask — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ఎక్కడ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *ekkaḍa*? (where? — asking about a place.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**e-** — ask.)

41.7 i- / a- / e- — six words, one machine

Say the six words from this chapter out loud, in order. Listen to how they begin.

Grammar lens: one slot changes

You did not learn six words. You learned **three beginnings** and reused them.

meaning	word
near	ఇక్కడ <i>ikkaḍa</i>
far	అక్కడ <i>akkaḍa</i>
question	ఎక్కడ <i>ekkaḍa</i>

Telugu keeps the whole tail identical: ఇక్కడ, అక్కడ, ఎక్కడ — only the first vowel moves.

Change the front, and the meaning walks from **near** to **far** to a **question**. Nothing else in the word moves.

The same three beginnings run the thing-words too: ఇది *idi* and అది *adi* start exactly like the first two rows. This chapter did not teach you the matching question word for things — that one arrives later, and when it does you will already know what it has to start with.

This is worth more than the six words are. When you meet a new word in this family later, you will not have to be taught all three of it — you will be taught one and work out the others.

Your turn

- *Say it*: the near word, then the far word, then the question word
- *Say it*: them again for place, not for things
- *Notice*: the part that did NOT change

Before you move on

Which beginning means near? (**i-**) Far? (**a-**) And which one turns the word into a question? (**e-**)

Chapter 42

Describing Things

Modes: 🗣️ voice (6) 🖱️ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can point at something in Telugu and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.

Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.

42.1 పెద్ద (pedda) — big

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: పెద్ద

పెద్ద — *pedda* — big.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “పెద్ద” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *pedda*? (**big.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.2 చిన్న (cinna) — small

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: చిన్న

చిన్న — *cinna* — small.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met పెద్ద *pedda* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “చిన్న” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *cinna*? (**small.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.3 మంచి (manci) — good

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: మంచి

మంచి — *manci* — good.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met చిన్న *cinna* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “మంచి” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *manci*? (**good.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.4 కొత్త (kotta) — new

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: కొత్త

కొత్త — *kotta* — new.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met మంచి *manci* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “కొత్త” three times, pointing at something different each time

- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *kotta*? (**new.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.5 పాత (pāta) — old — of a thing, not of a person

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: పాత

పాత — *pāta* — old — of a thing, not of a person.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met కొత్త *kotta* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “పాత” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *pāta*? (**old — of a thing, not of a person.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.6 before the noun, unchanged — five words, one rule

Say the five words from this chapter out loud, then say each one in front of a noun you already know.

Grammar lens: where an adjective goes

You did not learn five separate words. You learned **where an adjective goes**, and five words that go there.

meaning	word
big	పెద్ద <i>pedda</i>
small	చిన్న <i>cinna</i>
good	మంచి <i>manci</i>

They sit in front of the noun and stay exactly as they are.

This is worth more than the five words are. Every noun you already know — your name, the house, the water, the day — can now take any of them in front, and every adjective you meet from here goes in the same place.

Your turn

- *Say it*: each of the five in front of a noun you already know
- *Say it*: two of them with the same noun, one after the other
- *Notice*: whether the adjective changed shape when the noun did

Before you move on

Where does an adjective go in this language? (**In front of the noun.**) Does it change shape to match the noun? (unchanged.)

Chapter 43

More Everyday Verbs

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can tell someone to come, sit, stand and give in Telugu.

Complete TE-C43-give and say all four verbs in order.

43.1 ర (rā) — come

A short run of everyday verbs, one at a time.

You'll want to know: ర

ర (rā) — “come”.

The bare command, and one of the shortest words in the language: a single syllable that is a complete sentence.

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- rā
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway

Before you move on

What does ൠ mean? (“come”.) Say it once more.

43.2 ൠ (kūrcō) — sit

Before the new one: what did *rā* mean?

You’ll want to know: ൠ

ൠ (*kūrcō*) — “sit”.

A command you will hear on entering any home, usually before anything else is said.

What you’ve built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kūrcō*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *rā*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ൠ mean? (“sit”.) Say it once more.

43.3 ൠ (nilcō) — stand

Before the new one: what did *kūrcō* mean?

You'll want to know: నిల్చో

నిల్చో (*nilcō*) — “stand”.

Its pair. Telugu, like the other Dravidian languages, makes the bare stem do the work of a command with nothing added.

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nilcō*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *kūrcō*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does నిల్చో mean? (“stand”.) Say it once more.

43.4 ఇవ్వు (*ivvu*) — give

Before the new one: what did *nilcō* mean?

You'll want to know: ఇవ్వు

ఇవ్వు (*ivvu*) — “give”.

The everyday ‘give’. Softening it is done with a separate politeness word rather than by changing the verb.

What you've built

One more everyday action. That closes the run: four everyday actions, each met on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ivvu*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *nilcō*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ఇవ్వు mean? (“give”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 44

Verbs of Seeing and Saying

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can tell someone to look, listen, speak and write in Telugu.

Complete TE-C44-write and say all four verbs in order.

44.1 చూడు (cūḍu) — look

Four verbs for taking things in and putting them out, one at a time.

You'll want to know: చూడు

చూడు (cūḍu) — “look”.

Also 'to see' and 'to look after', the same three-way stem as its Kannada cousin *nōḍu* — the languages are close enough that the pattern travels.

What you've built

One more. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- cūḍu
- it once more, slowly

Before you move on

What does చూడు mean? (“look”). Say it once more.

44.2 ఆలకించు (ālakiñcu) — listen

Before the new one: what did *cūḍu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఆలకించు

ఆలకించు (*ālakiñcu*) — “listen”.

‘Listen attentively’ — a step above simply hearing. Telugu keeps listening and asking separate, where Kannada merges them into one stem.

What you’ve built

One more. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ālakiñcu*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *cūḍu*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ఆలకించు mean? (“listen”). Say it once more.

44.3 మాట్లాడు (māṭlāḍu) — speak

Before the new one: what did *ālakiñcu* mean?

You’ll want to know: మాట్లాడు

మాట్లాడు (*māṭlāḍu*) — “speak”.

From *māṭa*, ‘word’, plus *āḍu*, ‘to play’ — the same construction as Kannada’s *māṭāḍu*, built from the same two pieces.

What you've built

One more. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *māṭlāḍu*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *ālakin̄cu*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does మాట్లాడు mean? (“speak”.) Say it once more.

44.4 రాయి (rāyi) — write

Before the new one: what did *māṭlāḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: రాయి

రాయి (*rāyi*) — “write”.

The everyday ‘write’. Telugu and Kannada each kept their own Dravidian stem here rather than borrowing a shared one.

What you've built

That closes the run: look, listen, speak, write.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *rāyi*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *māṭlāḍu*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does **ၵၢၦၴ** mean? (“write”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 45

Grandparents, and the Married Pair

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name four more family and people words in this language.

Complete TE-C45-wife and say all four words in order.

45.1 తాత (tāta) — grandfather

Before the new one: what did *rāyi* mean?

You'll want to know: తాత

తాత (tāta) — “grandfather”.

It has the same small, repeatable shape as the *nānna* and *amma* you met in the family lesson. Sanskrit carries a *tāta* too, meaning ‘father’ or simply ‘dear one’; Telugu moved the word up a generation. Children use it for any kindly old man, not only their own grandfather.

What you’ve built

The first of four family words. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tāta*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *rāyi*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does తాత mean? (“grandfather”.) Say it once more.

45.2 అమ్మమ్మ (ammamma) — grandmother, the mother’s mother

Before the new one: what did *tāta* mean?

You’ll want to know: అమ్మమ్మ

అమ్మమ్మ (*ammamma*) — “grandmother”, and specifically your mother’s mother.

Say it slowly and you can hear what it is made of: *amma* twice over, mother of mother. Telugu keeps the two grandmothers apart, and the father’s mother is *nāyanamma*, assembled the same way on *nāyana*, ‘father’. Nothing here is borrowed; every piece came from the family lesson.

What you’ve built

Two of four, and a word you could have decoded before you were taught it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ammamma*
- it once more, slowly, hearing the two halves
- it after *tāta*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does అమ్మమ్మ mean? (“grandmother”, the mother’s mother.)
Say it once more.

45.3 భర్త (bharta) — husband

Before the new one: what did *ammamma* mean?

You’ll want to know: భర్త

భర్త (bharta) — “husband”.

Sanskrit, and it opens cleanly: the root *bhr̥*, ‘to bear, to carry, to support’, plus the ending that names the one who does it. So the word says ‘the one who supports’. That root is old enough to have relatives far outside India — Latin *fero*, ‘I carry’, and English *bear* both continue it.

What you’ve built

Three of four. The last word comes from the very same root.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bharta*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *ammamma*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does భర్త mean? (“husband”.) Say it once more.

45.4 భార్య (bhārya) — wife

Before the new one: what did *bharta* mean?

You'll want to know: భార్య

భార్య (*bhārya*) — “wife”.

The same root *bhr̥* as the last word, with a different ending: ‘she who is to be supported’. Two words, one root, and between them a picture of the household as Sanskrit’s grammarians framed it rather than as anyone lives in it now. That is worth hearing plainly, because the shape of the pair is the reason it is easy to remember.

What you’ve built

That closes the run: grandfather, grandmother, husband, wife.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bhārya*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *bharta*, and name the root they share

Before you move on

What does భార్య mean? (“wife”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 46

Things You Ask For

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five everyday things I might ask someone for in Telugu, and say which of them Telugu has always had and which arrived from elsewhere.

Complete TE-C46-book and demonstrate the chapter promise.

46.1 పండు (paṇḍu) — a fruit

Before the new run of words: what did *bhārya* mean?

You'll want to know: పండు

పండు (*paṇḍu*) — “a fruit”.

పండు is also a verb: *to ripen*. The fruit is named for what happened to it — the ripened thing — and Telugu never troubled to invent a second noun. Say *paṇḍu* of a mango on the table and you mean the fruit; say it of the tree's crop and you mean it is coming ripe.

Kannada writes the same inherited word ಹಣ್ಣು (*haṇṇu*). That *p-* at the front turning into *h-* is a regular Kannada sound law, and it has already turned up once, on పాలు beside ಹాలు. Watch for it again.

What you've built

The first of five things you might ask someone for.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *paṇḍu*
- it once more, slowly
- *paṇḍu*, then *dayacēsi paṇḍu ivvaṇḍi* — “please give a fruit”

Before you move on

What does పండు mean? (“a fruit”.) Say it once more.

46.2 బట్ట (baṭṭa) — cloth

Before the new one: what did *paṇḍu* mean?

You’ll want to know: బట్ట

బట్ట (*baṭṭa*) — “cloth”.

బట్ట is the plain word for cloth: the bolt on the shelf, the washing on the line, the rag in your hand.

Sanskrit has *paṭṭa*, “a strip of cloth, a bandage”, and here the borrowing most likely ran the unusual way — out of Dravidian and into Sanskrit, rather than the other direction this book has shown so often. The same strip reached English by a different road: Hindi *paṭṭī*, a wrapping, is the soldier’s *puttee*.

What you’ve built

Two: a fruit and a cloth.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *baṭṭa*
- it once more, slowly
- *paṇḍu*, then *baṭṭa*, and ask for each one with *dayacēsi*

Before you move on

What does బట్ట mean? (“cloth”.) Say it once more.

46.3 దీపం (dīpaṁ) — a lamp

Before the new one: what did *baṭṭa* mean?

You’ll want to know: దీపం

దీపం (*dīpaṁ*) — “a lamp”.

దీపం is the small clay lamp with oil and a wick. Its Sanskrit root *dīp* means “to blaze”, so the word names the burning rather than the vessel.

Put దీప together with a word meaning “a row” and you get *dīpāvali*, “a row of lamps” — the festival English spells Diwali. The ending is the tatsama neuter -ం, the same shape already carried by హృదయం and భోజనం.

What you’ve built

Three: a fruit, a cloth, a lamp.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *dīpaṁ*
- it once more, slowly
- all three, then name the one that came in from Sanskrit

Before you move on

What does దీపం mean? (“a lamp”.) Say it once more.

46.4 ఉప్పు (uppu) — salt

Before the new one: what did *dīpaṁ* mean?

You'll want to know: ఉప్పు

ఉప్పు (*uppu*) — “salt”.

Proto-Dravidian had ***uppu**, and the whole family kept it almost untouched: Tamil உப்பு, Kannada ಉಪ್ಪು, Malayalam ഉപ്പ്. A word this ordinary gives nobody a reason to replace it.

Notice the doubled **ప్ప** in the middle. Telugu likes a consonant twice inside a short word — కుక్క, పిల్లి, కన్ను all do it — and the doubling is not decoration: it is the difference between one word and another.

What you've built

Four. Three of them inherited, one borrowed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *uppu*
- it once more, slowly
- all four in order, then say which one has not changed in three thousand years

Before you move on

What does ఉప్పు mean? (“salt”.) Say it once more.

46.5 పుస్తకం (pustakam) — a book

Before the new one: what did *uppu* mean?

You'll want to know: పుస్తకం

పుస్తకం (*pustakam*) — “a book”.

Sanskrit *pustaka* is the source, but the trail behind it leaves India altogether. Middle Persian *post* meant “hide, skin” — the thing written on before paper.

So the Telugu word for a book carries an animal skin folded up inside it, and it arrived by the same north-western road as రోజు, which turned out to

be Persian too. Two of these five walked in from outside; three were always here.

What you've built

Five things you might ask for: a fruit, a cloth, a lamp, salt, a book.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pustakam*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then sort them into the inherited and the borrowed

Before you move on

What does పుస్తకం mean? (“a book”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 47

The Leg and the Tooth

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five more parts of the body in Telugu, and say which of them held their old shape and which wore down past recognition.

Complete TE-C47-stomach and demonstrate the chapter promise.

47.1 కాలు (kālu) — leg, foot

Before the new run: what did *pustakam* mean, and what did *uppu* mean?

You’ll want to know: కాలు

కాలు (kālu) — “leg, foot”.

Proto-Dravidian *kāl, and every sister kept it nearly whole: Tamil கால், Kannada ಕಾಲು, Malayalam കാൽ.

Set that beside చెయ్యి, the hand-word, which wore down so far that its family resemblance is hard to see at all. Two body-words of the same age; one held its shape and one did not, and nothing about the meaning predicts which.

కాలు covers the whole limb, foot and leg together. When precision is wanted, Sanskrit’s పాదం names the foot alone.

What you’ve built

The first of five more body words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kālu*
- it once more, slowly
- *kālu*, then *tala*, so the top and the bottom sit together

Before you move on

What does కాలు mean? (“leg, foot”.) Say it once more.

47.2 పన్ను (pannu) — a tooth

Before the new one: what did *kālu* mean?

You’ll want to know: పన్ను

పన్ను (*pannu*) — “a tooth”.

Proto-Dravidian ***pal**. Tamil kept பல்; Kannada has ಹಲ್ಲು, with that *p-* to *h-* law working again exactly where the last chapter said to watch for it. Telugu took a third road, the *-l-* coming out as *-n-* and doubling.

An honest warning: పన్ను is also the word for a tax. Nothing joins the tooth to the tax but an accident of sound. Telugu has a fair number of these pairs, and context is the only fix — which is what context is for.

What you’ve built

Two: a leg and a tooth.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pannu*
- it once more, slowly
- *kālu*, then *pannu*, and say which of the two also names something you pay

Before you move on

What does పన్ను mean? (“a tooth”.) Say it once more.

47.3 జుట్టు (juṭṭu) — hair (of the head)

Before the new one: what did *pannu* mean?

You’ll want to know: జుట్టు

జుట్టు (*juṭṭu*) — “hair (of the head)”.

జుట్టు is the hair on a head taken as one thing — the mass, not the strand. For a single hair Telugu reaches for a different noun, వెంట్రుక.

English leans on number for the same distinction — “a hair” against “hair” — while Telugu simply reaches for a different noun. జుట్టు also names the knot or tuft tied at the back of the head, which is most likely where the word started.

What you’ve built

Three: a leg, a tooth, hair.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *juṭṭu*
- it once more, slowly
- *juṭṭu*, then *tala*, and say which one sits on the other

Before you move on

What does జుట్టు mean? (“hair (of the head)”.) Say it once more.

47.4 వేలు (vēlu) — a finger

Before the new one: what did *juṭṭu* mean?

You'll want to know: వేలు

వేలు (*vēlu*) — “a finger”.

Proto-Dravidian ***viral**. Tamil kept **விரல்** entire; Kannada has **ಬೆರಳು**; Telugu dropped the *-r-* and came out with **వేలు**. On the page the three look barely related, and they are the same word.

It is still working inside compounds: **బొటనవేలు**, the thumb, is the stubby one of the set.

What you've built

Four. Note that చెయ్యి and వేలు are separate roots — Telugu does not build the finger out of the hand.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *vēlu*
- it once more, slowly
- *vēlu*, then *ceyyi*, and say which one has five of the other

Before you move on

What does వేలు mean? (“a finger”.) Say it once more.

47.5 కడుపు (kaḍupu) — the stomach, the belly

Before the new one: what did *vēlu* mean?

You'll want to know: కడుపు

కడుపు (*kaḍupu*) — “the stomach, the belly”.

కడుపు is the unfussy everyday word, and it carries the commonest way of saying you have eaten enough: *kaḍupu niṇḍindi*, “the stomach has filled”.

It also says, gently and without ever being explicit, that a woman is expecting. Sanskrit's ఉదरो exists in Telugu and stays where the clinical register lives.

What you've built

Five more body words: a leg, a tooth, hair, a finger, a belly. With తల, చెయ్యి, కన్ను, ముక్కు, నోరు and చెవి behind them, you can point at most of a person.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kaḍupu*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then add *tala* and *ceyyi* and say the seven as one list

Before you move on

What does కడుపు mean? (“the stomach, the belly”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 48

Naming Who Someone Is

Modes: ⇐ voice (4) 👁 eyes (1) ⇐ Hands-free start: first 2 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what someone’s role is in Telugu — teacher, student, doctor, farmer, guest — and name the root that two of those words share.

Complete TE-C48-guest and demonstrate the chapter promise.

48.1 గురువు (guruvu) — a teacher

Before the new run: what did *kaḍupu* mean, and what did *vēlu* mean?

You’ll want to know: గురువు

గురువు (*guruvu*) — “a teacher”.

Sanskrit *guru* means “heavy”. The teacher is the weighty one — the one whose word carries weight — and Telugu added its own -వు to make గురువు.

You have already said the word without being told. గురువారం, Thursday, is Guru’s day: the guru there is Jupiter, the heaviest wanderer the naked eye can find and the teacher of the gods. Latin named the same weekday for Jove, which is the same planet under another name.

What you’ve built

The first of five roles.

Your turn

- *Say it: guruvu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: guruvu, then guruvāram, and say what the two have in common*
- *Recall: say paṇḍu, then read పాండు and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does గురువు mean? (“a teacher”.) Say it once more.

48.2 విద్యార్థి (vidyārthi) — a student

Before the new one: what did *guruvu* mean?

You’ll want to know: విద్యార్థి

విద్యార్థి (*vidyārthi*) — “a student”.

Two Sanskrit pieces welded: *vidyā*, knowledge, and *arthin*, one who seeks. A student is a knowledge-seeker, and the word says so on its face.

vidyā grows from the root *vid*, “to know” — the same ancient root behind English *wit* and *wisdom*, and behind Latin *vidēre*, “to see”. Knowing and seeing were one word long before either language existed.

What you’ve built

Two: a teacher and a student.

Your turn

- *Say it: vidyārthi*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: guruvu, then vidyārthi, and say which one seeks and which one weighs*
- *Recall: read పండ్లు, then say pannu*

Before you move on

What does విద్యార్థి mean? (“a student”.) Say it once more.

48.3 వైద్యుడు (vaidyudu) — a doctor, a physician

Before the new one: what did *vidyārthi* mean?

You’ll want to know: వైద్యుడు

వైద్యుడు (*vaidyudu*) — “a doctor, a physician”.

Look at the middle of it. *vaidya* is built on the very *vid* sitting inside విద్యార్థి: a physician is one versed in the knowledge, the knowledge in question being ఆయుర్వేద, the science of long life.

The ending -ుడు is not Sanskrit’s but Telugu’s own, marking a masculine person — the same -ుడు already carried by స్నేహితుడు.

What you’ve built

Three roles, and two of them share a root.

Your turn

- Say it: *vaidyudu*
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: *vidyārthi*, then *vaidyudu*, and name the syllable they share
- Recall: say *dīpamī*, then read జాట్టు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does వైద్యుడు mean? (“a doctor, a physician”.) Say it once more.

48.4 రైతు (raitu) — a farmer

Before the new one: what did *vaidyudu* mean?

You'll want to know: రైతు

రైతు (*raitu*) — “a farmer”.

రైతు came the long way round. Arabic *ra^ciyyah* meant a flock, then the people a ruler answers for. Persian and Urdu carried it into India as *ra^ciyat*, the subject, the tenant; the revenue clerks of the Deccan wrote it on their rolls; and Telugu kept it for the person who works the land.

That is a second arrival from the north-west, after రోజు (*rōju*) and పుస్తకం. The words that travel are the words that follow paperwork and trade.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: raitu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: raitu, then rōju, and say what road the two have in common*
- *Recall: read ఉప్పు, then say vēlu*

Before you move on

What does రైతు mean? (“a farmer”.) Say it once more.

48.5 అతిథి (atithi) — a guest

Before the new one: what did *raitu* mean?

You'll want to know: అతిథి

అతిథి (*atithi*) — “a guest”.

a-tithi — “one without a *tithi*”, without a date on the calendar. The guest is defined by not being expected.

The old formula అతిథి దేవో భవ, “let the guest be a god to you”, is built on exactly that: you cannot prepare for a god who arrives unannounced, so you keep the house ready instead. What a Telugu house actually does when the అతిథి arrives has a chapter of its own, at the end of this book.

What you've built

Five roles: a teacher, a student, a doctor, a farmer, a guest.

Your turn

- *Say it: atithi*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: all five, then say *nā pēru* and your own name, and ask *mīru evaru?**
- *Recall: say *pustakam*, then read కడుపు and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does అతిథి mean? (“a guest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 49

Answering With More Than Yes

Modes: 🗣️ voice (3) 👁️ eyes (2) 🖐️ Hands-free start: first 3 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can answer in Telugu with more than yes and no — true, enough, certainly, perhaps, just so — and see the three-vowel grid running under అది, ఇక్కడ and ఎలా.

Complete TE-C49-alright and demonstrate the chapter promise.

49.1 నిజం (nijam) — true; the truth

Before the new run: what did *atithi* mean?

You’ll want to know: నిజం

నిజం (*nijam*) — “true; the truth”.

Sanskrit *nija* meant “one’s own, innate” — what belongs to a thing by its nature. Telugu moved it one step: what belongs to a thing by nature is what is really so, and నిజం became the truth.

Alone it answers a doubt: *nijam*, “true”. With a question on the end it becomes perhaps the commonest interjection in the language: *nijamā?*, “really?”

What you’ve built

The first of five answers that are neither అవును nor లేదు.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nijamī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *nijamī*, then *nijamā?*, and say which one asks
- *Recall:* say *kālu*, then read గురువు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does నిజం mean? (“true; the truth”.) Say it once more.

49.2 చాలు (cālu) — enough, that will do

Before the new one: what did *nijamī* mean?

You’ll want to know: చాలు

చాలు (*cālu*) — “enough, that will do”.

చాలు is a verb — “it suffices” — used as a complete answer. Held over a glass being filled it stops the pouring; said of an argument it ends it.

చాలా, the everyday word for “very” and “a lot”, is the same root wearing a different ending. Sufficiency and abundance sit one letter apart, which is a fair account of how the two ideas are related anywhere.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cālu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *cālu*, then *nijamī*, and say which one you would use to stop someone pouring
- *Recall:* read పన్ను, then say *vidyārthi*

Before you move on

What does చాలు mean? (“enough, that will do”.) Say it once more.

49.3 తప్పకుండా (tappakuṇḍā) — certainly, without fail

Before the new one: what did *cālu* mean?

You’ll want to know: తప్పకుండా

తప్పకుండా (*tappakuṇḍā*) — “certainly, without fail”.

Take it apart: తప్పు, “to miss, to slip, to go wrong”, plus -కుండా, the ending meaning “without doing”. తప్పకుండా is *without missing*.

The ending is worth having on its own, because it attaches to any verb stem: *ceppakuṇḍā*, without telling; *tinakuṇḍā*, without eating. One suffix, and every verb you own gains a negative.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- Say it: *tappakuṇḍā*
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: *tappakuṇḍā*, then *cālu*, and say which one is a promise
- Recall: say *juttu*, then read వైద్యుడు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does తప్పకుండా mean? (“certainly, without fail”.) Say it once more.

49.4 ఏమో (ēmō) — perhaps, who knows

Before the new one: what did *tappakuṇḍā* mean?

You'll want to know: ఏమో

ఏమో (*ēmō*) — “perhaps, who knows”.

ఏమో is a shrug made into a word: perhaps, it may be so, who knows.

Look at the front of it and you will find the questioning ఏ- that already stands in ఏమిటి, “what”. ఏమో is that question with the asking taken out and only the uncertainty left behind.

It also hangs on the end of a whole sentence, where English would need a separate clause: *vastāḍēmō*, “he may come”. A language with a settled, unembarrassed word for not knowing is telling you something about its manners.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēmō*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ēmō*, then *tappakuṇḍā*, and say which one commits you
- *Recall:* read వేలు, then say *raitu*

Before you move on

What does ఏమో mean? (“perhaps, who knows”.) Say it once more.

49.5 అలాగే (*alāgē*) — just so, alright then

Before the new one: what did *ēmō* mean?

You'll want to know: అలాగే

అలాగే (*alāgē*) — “just so, alright then”.

అలా means “in that way”; -గే is the small emphatic tail that makes it “just so”. అలాగే is the yes you give to an instruction — not “that is correct” but “it shall be as you said”.

Now look at the front of it. అ- points far, and already carries అది, “that one”, and అక్కడ, “there”. ఇ- points near: ఇది, ఇక్కడ, and so ఇలా, “in this

way”. ఎ- asks: ఎక్కడ, ఎలా. Three vowels, one grid, and అలాగే is simply the far corner of it with an ending stuck on.

What you’ve built

Five answers, and a three-way grid you can now see running under అది, ఇక్కడ and ఎలా.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *alāgē*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then say *alāgē* as a reply to *dayacēsi kūrco*
- *Recall:* say *kaḍupu*, then read అతిథి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does అలాగే mean? (“just so, alright then”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Taking Your Leave

Modes:  voice (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can take my leave in Telugu the way a Telugu speaker actually does, and say why the flat “I am going” is the one thing never said at a door.

Complete TE-C50-farewell and demonstrate the chapter promise.

50.1 ఇప్పుడు (ippuḍu) — now

Before the new run: what did *alāgē* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఇప్పుడు

ఇప్పుడు (*ippuḍu*) — “now”.

The grid from the last chapter has a time row, and this is its near corner. -ప్పుడు is the time-piece; put a pointing vowel in front of it and the word makes itself.

ఇప్పుడు is “this time” — now. అప్పుడు is “that time” — then. ఎప్పుడు is “which time” — when? You already owned the vowels; the row costs you one word.

What you’ve built

Now — and a shape that gives you two more words for free.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ippudu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ippudu*, then *ippudu vellu* — “go now”
- *Recall:* say *guruvu*, then read నిజం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఇప్పుడు mean? (“now”.) Say it once more.

50.2 ఎల్లుండి (ellundi) — the day after tomorrow

Before the new one: what did *ippudu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఎల్లుండి

ఎల్లుండి (*ellundi*) — “the day after tomorrow”.

One settled noun for the day after tomorrow. English needs four words and still sounds unsure of itself; Telugu, like its sisters, simply has the word.

There is an older tomorrow hiding at the front of it. ఎల్లి once meant tomorrow, and though రేపు took that job in everyday speech, ఎల్లి is still in service inside ఎల్లుండి, doing its old work one day further out.

What you’ve built

Two: now, and the day after tomorrow.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ellundi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ippudu*, then *ellundi*, and say which one is further off
- *Recall:* read విద్యార్థి, then say *cālu*

Before you move on

What does ఎల్లుండి mean? (“the day after tomorrow”.) Say it once more.

50.3 ప్రయాణం (prayāṇam) — a journey

Before the new one: what did *elluṇḍi* mean?

You’ll want to know: ప్రయాణం

ప్రయాణం (*prayāṇam*) — “a journey”.

Sanskrit *pra-yāṇa*: the root *yā*, “to go”, with *pra-*, “forth”. A journey is a going-forth, and the word is transparent to anyone holding the pieces.

The ending is the -ం you have now sorted three times: the tatsama neuter, as on దీపం, హృదయం and భోజనం. When a Telugu noun ends in -ం and names an abstraction, Sanskrit is usually behind it.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- Say it: *prayāṇam*
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: *prayāṇam*, then *dīpam*, and name the ending they share
- Recall: say *vaidyudu*, then read తప్పకుండా and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ప్రయాణం mean? (“a journey”.) Say it once more.

50.4 బయలుదేరు (bayaludēru) — to set out, to start off

Before the new one: what did *prayāṇam* mean?

You'll want to know: బయలుదేరు

బయలుదేరు (*bayaludēru*) — “to set out, to start off”.

Native, and a picture rather than an abstraction. బయలు is open ground, the outside; దేరు is to rise, to come forth. To set out is to come out into the open.

Set it beside ప్రయాణం (*prayāṇam*) and you have two languages building the same idea from opposite ends: Sanskrit from the going, Telugu from the doorstep.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* bayaludēru
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* bayaludēru, then prayāṇam, and say which of the two is inherited
- *Recall:* read రైతు, then say *ēmō*

Before you move on

What does బయలుదేరు mean? (“to set out, to start off”.) Say it once more.

50.5 వెళ్ళొస్తాను (*vellostānu*) — I'll go and come back — the everyday goodbye

Before the new one: what did *bayaludēru* mean?

You'll want to know: వెళ్ళొస్తాను

వెళ్ళొస్తాను (*vellostānu*) — “I'll go and come back — the everyday goodbye”.

Two verbs you already have, welded at the seam: వెళ్ళి, “having gone”, and వస్తాను, “I will come”. వెళ్ళొస్తాను is *I'll go and come back*, and it is what is said at the door.

What is not said is the flat “I am going”. Leaving without the returning half is what is said of the dead, and the rule holds right across the South. The politeness here is not decoration laid over the grammar; it is the grammar. The reply comes back in the same shape: వెళ్ళి రండి — “go, and come”.

What you’ve built

Five: ఇప్పుడు, ఎల్లండి, ప్రయాణం, బయలుదేరు, and a goodbye that refuses to be one.

Your turn

- *Say it: vellōstānu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: vellōstānu*, then the reply *velli raṇḍi*, and say why neither half stands alone
- *Recall: say atithi*, then read అలాగే and say what it means

Before you move on

What does వెళ్ళొస్తాను mean? (“I’ll go and come back — the everyday goodbye”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Courtesy Words

Modes:  voice (5)  eyes (1)  pen (3)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 9 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can be polite in Telugu beyond thank you — gratitude, a good turn, respect, a blessing, a salutation — and name the piece that two of those words share.

Complete TE-C51-salutation and demonstrate the chapter promise.

51.1 కృతజ్ఞత (kṛtajñata) — gratitude

Before the new run: what did *vellostānu* mean?

You'll want to know: కృతజ్ఞత

కృతజ్ఞత (*kṛtajñata*) — “gratitude”.

kṛta, “done”, plus *jñā*, “knowing”: knowing what was done for you. That is the whole of gratitude in two Sanskrit syllables, and Telugu took it entire.

Set it beside ధన్యవాదములు, the thank-you from the first pages of this book, which is “utterances of 'worthy'”. One word thanks by calling the giver worthy. The other thanks by admitting the debt is remembered. They are not the same gesture, and Telugu keeps both.

What you've built

A second word for thanks, with a different picture inside it.

Your turn

- *Say it: kṛtajñata*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: kṛtajñata*, then *dhanyavādamulu*, and say which one remembers a debt
- *Recall: say nijami*, then read ఇప్పుడు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does కృతజ్ఞత mean? (“gratitude”.) Say it once more.

51.2 ఇ — one character, met inside a word you already say

Before the new one: య — what does it do? And one from further back: భ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it since the page before this one, without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ఇ

ఇ — ña.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not ñ, it is **ña**.

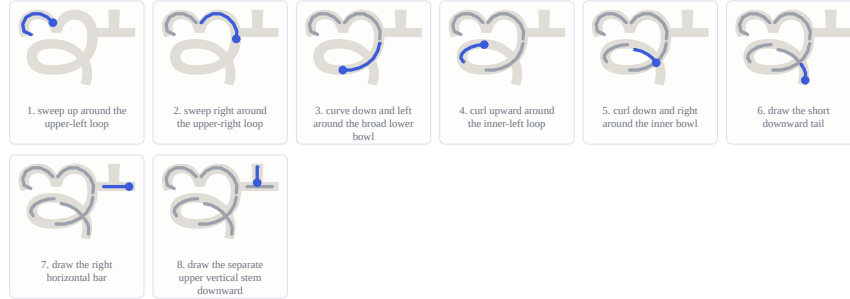
It is a nasal, made where య is made — the middle of the tongue against the roof of the mouth, the sound in the middle of Spanish *señor*. In modern Telugu you will almost never meet it standing on its own. Where it lives is inside one stacked block, and you met that block a moment ago:

- కృతజ్ఞత kṛtajñata — gratitude

The block is జ్ఞ: జ with ఇ stacked under it, joined by the virama. Telugu does not say that block the way its two letters would suggest. Spelled *jña*, it comes out of the mouth closer to **gnya** — so *kṛtajñata* is heard as *kṛtagnyata*. Both facts are true at once, and this is one of the places where Telugu’s spelling remembers Sanskrit while Telugu’s mouth has moved on.

Writing: ఇ — eight deliberate movements

How it is written — 8 strokes · 7 pen lifts · 8 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant ఇ packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_2_5_na.png, movements 1-8 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ఇ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movements 1 and 2 trace the two upper loops. Movements 3–6 build the lower bowl, its inner turns and the short tail. Draw the right bar as movement 7, then finish with the separate upper stem as movement 8.

This is one attested school-style order. Telugu handwriting varies, so keep the eight directions clear and let the rounded shape grow from them.

Your turn

- *Look:* at కృతజ్ఞత, and find the block that has ఇ under it

కృతజ్ఞత · ధన్యవాదములు

- *Trace it:* ఇ once, following all eight numbered movements
- *Copy:* ఇ twice without tracing, saying ña as you finish each one
- *Say it:* kṛtajñata the way it is said — kṛtagñyata

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఇ? Which letter does it usually sit under, and what does that pair sound like? (**Under జ, in the block జ్ఞ, said gnya.**)

One more, from much earlier: ీ — what does it do?

51.3 మేలు (mēlu) — a good turn, a benefit

Before the new one: what did *kṛtajñata* mean?

You’ll want to know: మేలు

మేలు (*mēlu*) — “a good turn, a benefit”.

Inherited, and short. మేల్ meant “above”; the good is what is above. From it Telugu draws మేలు, a benefit or a good turn done to someone, and also the plain comparative sense of “better”.

So *idi mēlu* says “this one is higher” and lets the height do the judging — which is what English does too, in *superior*, without anyone noticing any more.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēlu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: mēlu, then manci, and say which one is a thing done and which is a quality*
- *Recall: read చాలు, then say elluṇḍi*

Before you move on

What does మేలు mean? (“a good turn, a benefit”.) Say it once more.

51.4 గౌరవం (gauravam) — respect

Before the new one: what did *mēlu* mean?

You’ll want to know: గౌరవం

గౌరవం (*gauravam*) — “respect”.

gaurava is the abstract noun of *guru* — the very word met one chapter ago as the teacher. Respect is weightiness: to hold someone in గౌరవం is to grant that what they say has mass.

Telugu marks the same idea in its grammar as well as its vocabulary. మీరు rather than నువ్వు, and the -అండి hung on the end of a verb, are గౌరవం turned into endings. A language can be polite in its words or in its shapes, and this one does both.

What you've built

Three, and one of them is a word you already knew wearing a different suit.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gauravamī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *gauravamī*, then *guruvu*, and name the syllable they share
- *Recall:* say *tappakuṇḍā*, then read ప్రయాణం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does గౌరవం mean? (“respect”.) Say it once more.

51.5 ె — one character, met inside a word you already say

Before the new one: ఇ — what does it do? And one from further back: ఋ?

One character this time — and you have been saying it since the page before this one, without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ె

ౌ — *au*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *au*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

Au is one vowel that moves while you hold it: it starts where *a* starts and slides toward *u*, the way the middle of English *now* does. Say it as one sound, not as two.

You already say this one:

- గౌరవం *gauravani* — respect

Take it apart: గ, the letter you traced long before this, carrying ఌ. Not *ga* any more — **gau**. Then ళ, వ, and the anusvāra ం that has been closing words since *namaskāram*. Every piece of *gauravani* now has a name, and this mark was the last one missing.

Writing: ఌ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ఌ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look*: at these two, and say which one carries ఌ

గౌరవం · గురువు

- *Say it*: *ga*, then *gau*, and hear the vowel move
- *Trace it*: ఌ three times, saying *au* as you finish each one

Before you move on

Which character is this — ఌ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to, and what does it take off? (**Puts *au* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name the word you already say that

contains it.

One more, from much earlier: ఖ — what does it do?

51.6 ఆశీర్వాదం (āśīrvādam) — a blessing

Before the new one: what did *gauravamī* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఆశీర్వాదం

ఆశీర్వాదం (āśīrvādam) — “a blessing”.

āśīs, a wish or a prayer, plus *vāda*, an utterance: a blessing is a wish said out loud.

The ceremony behind it is still in daily use. You bend and touch an elder’s feet, and what comes back is ఆశీర్వాదం — a hand on the head — at a birthday, before an examination, at a wedding, and at every departure.

Notice *vāda* sitting there. It is the same piece inside ధన్యవాదములు, “utterances of ‘worthy’”. Twice now this language has counted a thing said as a thing given.

What you’ve built

Four courtesy words, and two of them are utterances by name.

Your turn

- *Say it: āśīrvādam*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: āśīrvādam, then dhanyavādamulu, and name the piece they share*
- *Recall: read ఏమో, then say bayaludēru*

Before you move on

What does ఆశీర్వాదం mean? (“a blessing”.) Say it once more.

51.7 ఇ · ౌ — the two you were saying before you could see them

Cover the two words this chapter taught for *gratitude* and for *respect*. From memory, say which character sits inside each one.

Script: a letter you rarely see alone, and a sign that replaces what it lands on

ఇ · ౌ

These two are opposites in how they behave, which is the thing worth holding:

character	how it behaves
ఇ <i>ñā</i>	a consonant, almost never standing alone — it lives stacked under ఇ
ౌ <i>au</i>	a vowel sign, never standing alone — it replaces the <i>a</i> inside a consonant

In కృతజ్ఞత the stack జ్ఞ is spelled *jñā* and comes out of the mouth closer to *gnya*. In గౌరవం the గ stops being *ga* the moment the sign lands on it and becomes *gau*.

One is a shape you will hardly ever see by itself; the other changes a shape you see constantly. Neither adds a sound beside the letter — one hides inside a block, the other overwrites what was already there.

Your turn

- *Look:* at కృతజ్ఞత and find the two-letter stack
- *Look:* at గౌరవం and name the letter underneath the sign
- *Say it:* *ga*, then *gau* — one sound sliding, not two sounds in a row
- *Trace it:* the stack once, and the sign once

Before you move on

Where does ఇ live in modern Telugu? (**Stacked under ఇ**, as జ్ఞ.) How is that stack spelled, and how is it said? (**Spelled *jñā***, said **closer to *gnya***.) What does ౌ do to the letter it lands on?

(Replaces the *a* inside it with *au*.) And which word of this chapter carries each? (కృతజ్ఞత and గౌరవం.)

51.8 దండం (daṇḍam) — a salutation, “my respects”

Before the new one: what did *āśīrvādam* mean?

You’ll want to know: దండం

దండం (*daṇḍam*) — “a salutation, “my respects””.

దండం is what you say with the palms together — my respects — offered to an elder, a temple, a photograph on the wall. Children are taught to say it long before anyone explains it.

Sanskrit *daṇḍa* is a staff, a stick. The full form of the gesture, *daṇḍa-praṇāma*, is the prostration where the body lies down straight as a staff. Telugu kept the word and let the body straighten most of the way up.

Hold on to దండ; it comes back in the next chapter carrying flowers.

What you’ve built

Five courtesy words: కృతజ్ఞత, మేలు, గౌరవం, ఆశీర్వాదం, దండం. Thanks, a good turn, respect, a blessing, and the greeting you make with your hands.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *daṇḍam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *daṇḍam*, then *namaskāram*, and say which one you would give a grandparent
- *Recall:* say *alāgē*, then read వెళ్ళొస్తాను and say what it means

Before you move on

What does దండం mean? (“a salutation, “my respects””). Say it once more.

51.9 ຊ ັ — from the sound, with nothing to copy

Cover both courtesy words and the page before this one. Nothing to copy and nothing to uncover.

Writing — dictation

Say *gau* aloud and write it: the letter ຶ, then the sign that makes it *gau*. Once.

Then say *gnya* aloud and write the block it is spelled with. This is the harder of the two, because your ear is being asked for one thing and your hand for another — the mouth says *gnya* and the page wants ັ.

Before you move on

Uncover the two words and compare. Then notice what each of the two asked of you. The sign was a matter of hearing one sliding vowel and putting one mark in the right place. The stack was not a matter of hearing at all — the sound your mouth makes and the letters the page keeps have drifted apart, and only the spelling remembers where the word came from.

Chapter 52

Welcoming a Guest

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the five things a Telugu welcome puts between the street and the guest, from the mark on the ground to the garland.

Complete TE-C52-garland and demonstrate the chapter promise.

52.1 తలుపు (talupu) — a door

Before the last run: what did *daṇḍam* mean, and what did *gauravam* mean?

You'll want to know: తలుపు

తలుపు (*talupu*) — “a door”.

తలుపు is the leaf: the panel that swings and shuts. The opening it fills is a different word — వాకిలి in everyday speech, ద్వారం in the formal Sanskrit register. Telugu keeps the hole and the thing that fills it apart, which English manages only when it is being careful.

తలుపు is inherited. That ద్వారం sits beside it doing no daily work is the usual arrangement here: the old word carries the load, the borrowed one keeps the ceremony.

What you've built

The first of five things standing between the street and a guest.

Your turn

- *Say it: talupu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: talupu, then ikkada talupu undi — “there is a door here”*
- *Recall: say ippudu, then read కృతజ్ఞత and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does తలుపు mean? (“a door”.) Say it once more.

52.2 కుర్చీ (kurcī) — a chair

Before the new one: what did *talupu* mean?

You’ll want to know: కుర్చీ

కుర్చీ (*kurcī*) — “a chair”.

Arabic *kursī* is a seat, a throne — the word standing in the Qur’ān’s Throne Verse. Persian took it, Urdu carried it across the Deccan, and Telugu has కుర్చీ.

The word came because the thing came. A house welcoming a guest before the chair arrived offered a పీట, a low wooden plank set on the floor, and many still do. Borrowed furniture brings borrowed nouns with it.

One trap: కుర్చీ and కూర్చో, “sit”, look like a pair and are not. The verb is inherited, the noun is Arabic, and the resemblance is an accident. Sound alone never proves a relation.

What you’ve built

Two: a door and a chair.

Your turn

- *Say it: kurcī*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: kurcī, then kūrcō, and say why the two are not related*

- *Recall:* read ఎల్లుండి, then say *mēlu*

Before you move on

What does కుర్చీ mean? (“a chair”.) Say it once more.

52.3 ముగ్గు (muggu) — the rice-flour design drawn at the doorstep

Before the new one: what did *kurcī* mean?

You’ll want to know: ముగ్గు

ముగ్గు (*muggu*) — “the rice-flour design drawn at the doorstep”.

ముగ్గు is the design put on the ground outside the door, in rice flour, before the sun is up. It is walked over all day and drawn again the next morning.

The flour is the point. It is laid where ants and birds will find it, so the welcome begins by feeding something smaller than a guest. Tamil calls the same act கோலம், Kannada ರಂಗೋಲಿ. The word is local; the practice is not.

What you’ve built

Three: the door, the chair, and the mark on the ground in front of both.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *muggu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *muggu*, then *talupu*, and say which one is outside the other
- *Recall:* say *prayāṇam*, then read గౌరవం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ముగ్గు mean? (“the rice-flour design drawn at the doorstep”.) Say it once more.

52.4 పువ్వు (puvvu) — a flower

Before the new one: what did *muggu* mean?

You'll want to know: పువ్వు

పువ్వు (*puvvu*) — “a flower”.

Proto-Dravidian ***pū**, and the family kept it: Tamil பூ, Malayalam പൂ, Kannada ಹೂವು.

There is that *p-* to *h-* once more on the Kannada side — the third time in this book, after పాలు beside ಹాలు and పండు beside ಹಣ್ಣು. A sound law you have watched work three times has stopped being a claim; it is a pattern you can predict with, and predicting is the only test a sound law ever gets.

The plural stem is పూల-, which is about to matter.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- Say it: *puvvu*
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: *puvvu*, then *paṇḍu*, and say what the two share at the front
- Recall: read బయలుదేరు, then say *āśīrvādaṁ*

Before you move on

What does పువ్వు mean? (“a flower”.) Say it once more.

52.5 పూలదండ (pūladaṇḍa) — a flower garland

Before the new one: what did *puvvu* mean?

You'll want to know: పూలదండ

పూలదండ (*pūladaṇḍa*) — “a flower garland”.

పూల, flowers, and దండ — the same దండ that gave you దండం, the salutation, one chapter back. Sanskrit *danḍa* is a staff, and by extension a row. A పూలదండ is a row of flowers, strung.

So the greeting and the garland are one word used twice. You say దండం with your hands; you put పూలదండ round a neck. Both of them come from a straight line.

And that closes the welcome: the ముగ్గు on the ground, the తలుపు opened, the కుర్చీ offered, and a పూలదండ of పువ్వులు for the అతిథి who sent no word ahead.

What you've built

Five: తలుపు, కుర్చీ, ముగ్గు, పువ్వు, పూలదండ. A guest can now be met at the door and seated.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pūladanḍa*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then say *namaskāraṁ* as you would at the door to an *atithi*
- *Recall:* say *veḷlostānu*, then read దండం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does పూలదండ mean? (“a flower garland”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

The Sky

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five things overhead in Telugu, and say which of them Telugu borrowed and which it has always had.

Complete TE-C53-cloud and demonstrate the chapter promise.

53.1 ఆకాశం (ākāśam) — the sky

Before the new one: what did *pūladaṇḍa* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఆకాశం

ఆకాశం (*ākāśam*) — “the sky”.

ఆకాశం came from Sanskrit *ākāśa*, built on a piece meaning “to shine, to be seen”. So the sky is named for being the open, lit place where a thing can be visible at all, rather than for being a lid over the world.

Telugu also holds an inherited word for the same overhead space, నింరి, which owes Sanskrit nothing. The two sit side by side: ఆకాశం does the ordinary work and turns up in newspapers and weather talk, while నింరి keeps to songs and poetry. A borrowed word taking the daily shift and leaving the old one the ceremony is an arrangement you have watched before, with the door.

ākāśa travelled, too. Traders carried it east, and Malay and Indonesian still say *angkasa* for the sky.

What you've built

The space that the rest of this chapter hangs in.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ākāśam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ākāśam*, then *namaskāram*, as you would greet somebody outdoors
- *Recall:* say *kṛtajñata*, then read తలుపు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఆకాశం mean? (“the sky”.) Say it once more.

53.2 సూర్యుడు (sūryuḍu) — the sun

Before the new one: what did *ākāśam* mean?

You'll want to know: సూర్యుడు

సూర్యుడు (*sūryuḍu*) — “the sun”.

Sanskrit *sūrya* is the sun. Telugu took the word and hung -డు on the end, the ending it puts on a man's name and on the words for men doing work — the same -డు that stands at the end of రైతు's formal cousin and of వైద్యుడు.

That ending is doing something real here. సూర్యుడు is the sun as a person: the one who drives, who is greeted, who is asked for things. Telugu has a plainer inherited word for the thing in the sky, పొద్దు, which you already have, and పొద్దు is what you use to say the sun came up.

So one language keeps two suns: పొద్దు for the light, సూర్యుడు for the god.

What you've built

Two: the sky, and the brightest thing in it.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūryudu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: sūryudu, then poddu, and say which one of them can be prayed to*
- *Recall: read మేలు, then say kurcī*

Before you move on

What does సూర్యుడు mean? (“the sun”.) Say it once more.

53.3 చంద్రుడు (candruḍu) — the moon

Before the new one: what did *sūryudu* mean?

You’ll want to know: చంద్రుడు

చంద్రుడు (*candruḍu*) — “the moon”.

Sanskrit *candra* means “shining, bright”, and it carries the same -డు that సూర్యుడు carries. Two borrowed lights, and Telugu made people of both.

The inherited word here is నెల, which you already have as the word for a month. One shape for the moon and for the stretch of time it measures — the moon is the oldest calendar there is, and Telugu keeps that fact inside a single word.

candra went a long way west as well. It shares an ancestor with the Latin piece that gives English *candle* and *incandescent*: a very old root for burning white.

What you’ve built

Three, and two of them named as people.

Your turn

- *Say it: candruḍu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*

- *Say it:* *candruḍu*, then *sūryuḍu*, and say what the two share at the end
- *Recall:* say *gauravamī*, then read ముగ్గు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does చంద్రుడు mean? (“the moon”.) Say it once more.

53.4 చుక్క (cukka) — a star; a dot

Before the new one: what did *candruḍu* mean?

You’ll want to know: చుక్క

చుక్క (*cukka*) — “a star; a dot”.

చుక్క is inherited, and it means a star and a dot and a drop of liquid, all with one shape. Anything small and round and separate is a చుక్క.

That is why it matters for the ముగ్గు. The design at the doorstep is laid out first as a grid of చుక్కలు, dots of rice flour set at even spacing, and the lines are then drawn around and between them. A woman who says she is putting down చుక్కలు in the morning is not talking about the sky.

The borrowed word for a star is నక్షత్రం, and it is what an astrologer uses. చుక్క is what a child points at.

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cukka*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *cukka*, then *muggu*, and say how the two are connected on the ground
- *Recall:* read ఆశీర్వాదం, then say *puvvu*

Before you move on

What does చుక్క mean? (“a star; a dot”.) Say it once more.

53.5 మబ్బు (mabbu) — a cloud

Before the new one: what did *cukka* mean?

You’ll want to know: మబ్బు

మబ్బు (*mabbu*) — “a cloud”.

మబ్బు is inherited and quite plain: the grey thing between you and the సూర్యుడు.

It stretched, the way weather words do. మబ్బు also describes a dull, heavy, half-asleep feeling, and a person who is slow to catch on. English went the same way with *cloudy* and *foggy*, from opposite ends of the earth and with no contact at all. When two unrelated languages reach for the same picture, the picture is doing the work rather than the borrowing.

With that, the sky is furnished.

What you’ve built

Five: ఆకాశం, సూర్యుడు, చంద్రుడు, చుక్క, మబ్బు. You can now say what is overhead.

Your turn

- *Say it: mabbu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: all five in order, then say which two of them end the same way*
- *Recall: say danḍam, then read పూలదండ and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does మబ్బు mean? (“a cloud”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

The Tree

Modes: 🗣 voice (5) 🗣 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a tree and its parts in Telugu, from the seed it started as to the branch at the top.

Complete TE-C54-seedling and demonstrate the chapter promise.

54.1 చెట్టు (ceṭṭu) — a tree

Before the new one: what did *mabbu* mean?

You’ll want to know: చెట్టు

చెట్టు (ceṭṭu) — “a tree”.

చెట్టు is inherited and old. The Dravidian family kept the shape but shuffled the meaning: Tamil’s *ceṭi* is a bush or a shrub, a small woody thing, while Telugu raised the same word to the full-grown tree and left the bush to other words.

A meaning that moves up or down the scale like that is the commonest kind of drift there is. The word holds its place in the family; what it points at slides.

వూసు is another Telugu word for a tree, older-sounding and now mostly literary. చెట్టు is what anybody says.

What you’ve built

The thing the rest of this chapter is made of.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ceṭṭu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ceṭṭu*, then *puvvu*, and say which one grows on the other
- *Recall:* say *talupu*, then read అకాశం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does చెట్టు mean? (“a tree”.) Say it once more.

54.2 కొమ్మ (komma) — a branch

Before the new one: what did *ceṭṭu* mean?

You’ll want to know: కొమ్మ

కొమ్మ (*komma*) — “a branch”.

కొమ్మ is the branch, the arm the చెట్టు puts out sideways.

It stands very close to కొమ్ము, the horn of an animal, and the closeness is not an accident: both are the thing that grows out and forks. A tree wearing horns is a fair description of a tree in winter.

కొమ్మ turns up in old poetry meaning a young woman, by way of the slenderness of a branch. That sense has gone quiet, but it is why the word looks odd inside a love poem.

What you’ve built

Two: the tree and what it puts out.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *komma*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *komma*, then *ceṭṭu*, and say which is part of which
- *Recall:* read కుర్చీ, then say *sūryudu*

Before you move on

What does కొమ్మ mean? (“a branch”.) Say it once more.

54.3 వేరు (vēru) — a root

Before the new one: what did *komma* mean?

You’ll want to know: వేరు

వేరు (*vēru*) — “a root”.

వేరు is the root under the చెట్టు. It also means “separate, apart, other” — వేరు as an answer means “that is a different thing”.

One shape, two jobs, and they are not far apart when you think about what a root does: it is the part that is set aside, buried, kept out of the daylight and out of the reckoning.

Telugu is comfortable letting a word carry a solid thing and an abstract idea at once. You had one working two jobs a moment ago, with చుక్క.

What you’ve built

Three: what is up, what is out, and what is under.

Your turn

- *Say it: vēru*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: vēru, then komma, and say which end of the చెట్టు each one is at*
- *Recall: say muggu, then read చంద్రుడు and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does వేరు mean? (“a root”.) Say it once more.

54.4 విత్తనం (vittanani) — a seed

Before the new one: what did *vēru* mean?

You'll want to know: విత్తనం

విత్తనం (*vittanani*) — “a seed”.

విత్తనం is the seed, and it is built on విత్తు, “to sow”. The word for the thing comes out of the word for the act, which is the ordinary direction of travel: people had been sowing for a long time before anybody needed a name for what they held.

Sanskrit's *bīja* was borrowed in as *bījamī*, and it does the abstract work — the seed of an idea, the germ of a quarrel. విత్తనం stays in the sack.

The whole chapter is inside this word. A విత్తనం becomes a చెట్టు with a వేరు below and a కొమ్మ above.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- Say it: *vittanani*
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: *vittanani*, then *ceṭṭu*, and say which one comes first
- Recall: read పువ్వు, then say *cukka*

Before you move on

What does విత్తనం mean? (“a seed”.) Say it once more.

54.5 మొక్క (mokka) — a young plant

Before the new one: what did *vittanani* mean?

You'll want to know: మొక్క

మొక్క (*mokka*) — “a young plant”.

మొక్క is what the విత్తనం becomes before it earns the name చెట్టు: a seedling, a sapling, anything small and green and rooted.

The line between మొక్క and చెట్టు is about woodiness rather than height. A tomato plant stays a మొక్క at any size, because it stays soft. A చెట్టు has bark.

Do not tie it to మొక్క, “to bow, to make a vow”, which sounds close. Telugu has a good many pairs like that, and a resemblance on its own settles nothing.

What you’ve built

Five: చెట్టు, కొమ్మ, వేరు, విత్తనం, మొక్క. A tree, its parts, and its beginning.

Your turn

- *Say it:* mokka
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then say them again as a life story, starting with the seed
- *Recall:* say *pūladanḍa*, then read మబ్బు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does మొక్క mean? (“a young plant”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

River and Road

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the water, the ground and the road around a Telugu village, and ask my way with them.

Complete TE-C55-path and demonstrate the chapter promise.

55.1 నది (nadi) — a river

Before the new one: what did *mokka* mean?

You'll want to know: నది

నది (*nadi*) — “a river”.

Sanskrit *nadī* is the river, and it is built on a piece meaning “to sound, to roar”. A river is named for the noise it makes, which tells you the people who named it were listening for water before they could see it.

Telugu clipped the long final vowel and says నది. The inherited Telugu word is ఏరు, a stream, and it survives in place names up and down the country long after it stopped being said on its own.

నది is the word you want when asking a stranger which way the water is.

What you've built

The first thing you would ask the way to.

Your turn

- *Say it: nadi*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: nadi, then dayacēsi, and put the two together as a question*
- *Recall: say ākāśani, then read చెట్టు and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does నది mean? (“a river”.) Say it once more.

55.2 చెరువు (ceruvu) — a village tank, a reservoir

Before the new one: what did *nadi* mean?

You’ll want to know: చెరువు

చెరువు (*ceruvu*) — “a village tank, a reservoir”.

A చెరువు is not a natural lake. It is a dug and banked tank that catches the rain and holds it through the dry months, and a great many Telugu villages were laid out around one before they were laid out around anything else.

So the word carries an argument about how the country was settled: the నది is where the water goes, the చెరువు is where it was made to stay. Kings had them dug and put their names on the bunds, and the names are still there.

Indian English calls this a “tank”, which is why the translation can sound strange until you have stood on the bund of one.

What you’ve built

Two waters: one that moves, one that was kept.

Your turn

- *Say it: ceruvu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: ceruvu, then nadi, and say which one people made*

- *Recall:* read సూర్యుడు, then say *komma*

Before you move on

What does చెరువు mean? (“a village tank, a reservoir”.) Say it once more.

55.3 గుట్ట (guṭṭa) — a low hill

Before the new one: what did *ceruvu* mean?

You’ll want to know: గుట్ట

గుట్ట (*guṭṭa*) — “a low hill”.

గుట్ట is inherited, and it means the small rocky rise that the Deccan is covered in — a heap of boulders rather than a peak. It also means a heap of anything: a గుట్ట of grain, a గుట్ట of clothes.

That double sense is honest about the landscape. These hills look piled rather than pushed up, and a speaker naming one is naming a pile.

The borrowed పర్వతం is the big mountain, the one in a poem. Nobody calls the rise behind their village a పర్వతం.

What you’ve built

Three: water that moves, water that stays, and ground that stands up.

Your turn

- *Say it:* guṭṭa
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* guṭṭa, then ceruvu, and say which of the two you would climb
- *Recall:* say candruḍu, then read వేరు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does గుట్ట mean? (“a low hill”.) Say it once more.

55.4 గ్రామం (grāmam) — a village

Before the new one: what did *guṭṭa* mean?

You'll want to know: గ్రామం

గ్రామం (*grāmam*) — “a village”.

Sanskrit *grāma* began as the word for a moving band of people, a travelling group, and settled into meaning the place they settled in. The word sat down when the people did.

Telugu's own word is *ūru*, and it is the one used in speech: it is in half the place names on the map and it is what you say to a neighbour. గ్రామం is the official register — the word on a form, in a land record, on a signboard.

So a Telugu speaker holds two villages, one for the revenue office and one for home.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: grāmam*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: grāmam, then ceruvu, and say which one a village is built around*
- *Recall: read చుక్క, then say vittanam*

Before you move on

What does గ్రామం mean? (“a village”.) Say it once more.

55.5 బాట (bāṭa) — a path, a way

Before the new one: what did *grāmam* mean?

You'll want to know: బాట

బాట (*bāṭa*) — “a path, a way”.

బాట is the inherited word for a way, a track, the line worn by feet going the same way twice. దారి does much the same work; బాట is the more physical of the two, the ground itself.

It goes abstract as easily as English “path” does. బాట పట్టు is to take up a way of living, and a person can be on somebody else's బాట.

You can now ask your way properly: దయచేసి, which గ్రామం, which బాట, which side the నది is on.

What you've built

Five: నది, చెరువు, గుట్ట, గ్రామం, బాట. Enough to be given directions with.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bāṭa*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then ask a stranger the way to the నది using *dayacēsi*
- *Recall:* say *mabbu*, then read మొక్క and say what it means

Before you move on

What does బాట mean? (“a path, a way”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

In the House

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five ordinary things inside a Telugu house and thank somebody for handing me one.

Complete TE-C56-box and demonstrate the chapter promise.

56.1 చాప (cāpa) — a mat

Before the new one: what did *bāṭa* mean?

You'll want to know: చాప

చాప (cāpa) — “a mat”.

A చాప is woven from palm leaf or reed, rolled up against a wall by day and unrolled to sit or sleep on.

It belongs beside the కుర్చీ you already have. Where the chair is a borrowed thing with a borrowed name, the చాప is old and the word is inherited, and a house that has both will often put the చాప down for the people who are comfortable on the floor and keep the కుర్చీ for the guest who is not.

Offering somebody a చాప is an invitation to stay a while. It is a slower gesture than pointing at a chair.

What you've built

The first thing a floor gets.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cāpa*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *cāpa*, then *kurcī*, and say which of the two gets rolled up
- *Recall:* say *ceṭṭu*, then read నది and say what it means

Before you move on

What does చాప mean? (“a mat”.) Say it once more.

56.2 బుట్ట (buṭṭa) — a basket

Before the new one: what did *cāpa* mean?

You’ll want to know: బుట్ట

బుట్ట (*buṭṭa*) — “a basket”.

బుట్ట is inherited: the woven basket that carries vegetables home, holds flowers for the morning, and sits on a head on the way to market.

Weaving words tend to be old, and they tend to stay put while the trade words move around them. A బుట్ట and a చాప come off the same hands and the same palm leaf, which is why the two words feel like family even though they are not.

పూల బుట్ట is the flower basket — పువ్వు’s పూల- shape doing its work again.

What you’ve built

Two: something to sit on, something to carry with.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *buṭṭa*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *buṭṭa*, then *cāpa*, and say what the two are made of
- *Recall:* read కొమ్మ, then say *ceruvu*

Before you move on

What does బుట్ట mean? (“a basket”.) Say it once more.

56.3 కత్తి (katti) — a knife

Before the new one: what did *buṭṭa* mean?

You’ll want to know: కత్తి

కత్తి (*katti*) — “a knife”.

కత్తి is the knife and, in older use, the sword. Size did not divide them; the blade did.

It is inherited, and it is spread right across the family — Tamil, Kannada and Malayalam all have a word of the same shape for a cutting blade. Tools that a household could make for itself keep their names for a very long time.

కత్తి also does the work English gives to “sharp” when talking about people: కత్తిలాంటి is knife-like, said of somebody quick.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: katti*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: katti, then buṭṭa, and say which one you would cut a పండు with*
- *Recall: say vēru, then read గుట్ట and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does కత్తి mean? (“a knife”.) Say it once more.

56.4 గిన్నె (ginne) — a cooking vessel, a bowl

Before the new one: what did *katti* mean?

You'll want to know: గిన్నె

గిన్నె (*ginne*) — “a cooking vessel, a bowl”.

గిన్నె is the round metal vessel that food is cooked and served in — the everyday one, brass or steel, with no lid worth mentioning.

Telugu splits its containers finely. A గిన్నె is not a కుండ, the fired clay pot, and it is not a పళ్ళెం, the flat plate. English pushes all three towards “pot” and “dish” and loses the difference between what holds heat, what holds water and what holds a meal.

When a kitchen has a name for each shape, the names are telling you which shapes the kitchen actually uses.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ginne*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ginne*, then *katti*, and say which one goes on the fire
- *Recall:* read విత్తనం, then say *grāmami*

Before you move on

What does గిన్నె mean? (“a cooking vessel, a bowl”.) Say it once more.

56.5 పెట్టె (petṭe) — a box

Before the new one: what did *ginne* mean?

You'll want to know: పెట్టె

పెట్టె (*petṭe*) — “a box”.

పెట్టె comes straight out of పెట్టు, “to put”: the box is the put-place. Telugu builds a good many of its household words this way, from the thing you do to the thing you do it in.

Then the railways arrived and పెట్టె picked up a second job — a railway carriage is a పెట్టె, a box that people are put in. A word for putting things away ended up on the side of a train.

The house is furnished now: a చాప on the floor, a బుట్ట by the door, a కత్తి and a గిన్నె in the kitchen, and a పెట్టె for what is not needed today.

What you've built

Five: చాప, బుట్ట, కత్తి, గిన్నె, పెట్టె. You can name what a room holds, and say ధన్యవాదాలు when one is handed to you.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pette*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then take one from somebody and say *dhanyavādālu*
- *Recall:* say *mokka*, then read బాట and say what it means

Before you move on

What does పెట్టె mean? (“a box”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

More of the Body

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five more parts of the body in Telugu and say which one hurts.

Complete TE-C57-bone and demonstrate the chapter promise.

57.1 మెడ (meḍa) — the neck

Before the new one: what did *peṭṭe* mean?

You'll want to know: మెడ

మెడ (*meḍa*) — “the neck”.

మెడ is inherited and short, which is what you expect of a body word: the parts people point at got their names early and kept them.

It is where a పూలదండ goes, so you already had the place before you had the word.

మెడ వంచు, to bend the neck, is to give in. The gesture and the phrase mean the same thing in a great many languages, because the gesture came first.

What you've built

The place a garland already went.

Your turn

- *Say it: meḍa*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: meḍa, then pūladanḍa, and put one on the other*
- *Recall: say nadi, then read చాప and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does మెడ mean? (“the neck”.) Say it once more.

57.2 వీపు (vīpu) — the back

Before the new one: what did *meḍa* mean?

You’ll want to know: వీపు

వీపు (*vīpu*) — “the back”.

వీపు is the back — the flat of it, the part you carry a load on and a child rides on.

It sits with the other inherited body words you have: కాలు, పన్ను, వేలు, and now మెడ above it. The head is a different matter, since Telugu leans on borrowed words in the higher registers there, but the trunk and the limbs are almost entirely old stock.

That pattern is worth noticing. The words a language borrows tend to be for things it acquired; the body was not acquired.

What you’ve built

Two more, both of them old.

Your turn

- *Say it: vīpu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: vīpu, then meḍa, and say which is above the other*
- *Recall: read చెరువు, then say buṭṭa*

Before you move on

What does వీపు mean? (“the back”.) Say it once more.

57.3 పెదవి (pedavi) — a lip

Before the new one: what did *vīpu* mean?

You’ll want to know: పెదవి

పెదవి (*pedavi*) — “a lip”.

పెదవి is the lip. Telugu keeps it separate from నోరు, the mouth as an opening, which you already have: the పెదవి is the rim, the నోరు is the hole.

పెదవి విరుచు — to twist the lip — is the Telugu way of saying somebody sneered. The face does the talking, and the language just reports it.

It is the part that shapes the sounds you have been making all along. Every ప in this book has been made with two పెదవులు.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: pedavi*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: pedavi*, then say *puvvu* slowly and notice what your పెదవులు do at the start
- *Recall: say gutṭa*, then read కత్తి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does పెదవి mean? (“a lip”.) Say it once more.

57.4 గోరు (gōru) — a fingernail, a claw

Before the new one: what did *pedavi* mean?

You'll want to know: గోరు

గోరు (*gōru*) — “a fingernail, a claw”.

గోరు is the nail on a finger and the claw on an animal, with no line drawn between them. One word for the hard thing at the end of the digit, whoever it belongs to.

It goes on the end of వేలు, which you already have. వేలి గోరు is the fingernail said in full, when the plain word would be unclear.

గోరువెచ్చని, “nail-warm”, is the Telugu word for lukewarm water — the temperature you test by dipping a fingertip. A measurement made with the body, before there were thermometers.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gōru*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *gōru*, then *vēlu*, and say which one grows out of the other
- *Recall:* read గ్రామం, then say *ginne*

Before you move on

What does గోరు mean? (“a fingernail, a claw”.) Say it once more.

57.5 ఎముక (emuka) — a bone

Before the new one: what did *gōru* mean?

You'll want to know: ఎముక

ఎముక (*emuka*) — “a bone”.

ఎముక is the bone, inherited, and it covers the whole family of them.

It carries the same weight English gives it: ఎముకలు విరిగేలా, “until the bones break”, is how you describe work that took everything a body had. The bone stands for the last thing left when the rest is gone.

That closes the body words. మెడ, వీపు, పెదవి, గోరు and ఎముక join కాలు, పన్ను, వేలు and the rest, and between them you can tell a doctor where it hurts.

What you've built

Five: మెడ, వీపు, పెదవి, గోరు, ఎముక. Enough to answer a వైద్యుడు with.

Your turn

- *Say it: emuka*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: all five in order, then point at your మెడ and say *nāku noppi**
- *Recall: say *bāṭa*, then read పెట్టె and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does ఎముక mean? (“a bone”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

More Short Replies

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say how much I want, refuse politely, and close a conversation in Telugu.

Complete TE-C58-thats-all and demonstrate the chapter promise.

58.1 కొంచెం (koñcem) — a little, a bit

Before the new one: what did *emuka* mean?

You’ll want to know: కొంచెం

కొంచెం (*koñcem*) — “a little, a bit”.

కొంచెం is “a little”, and it does far more work in Telugu than its size suggests. It softens whatever comes after it.

Ask for something plainly and you are demanding; put కొంచెం in front and you are asking. కొంచెం నీళ్లు is a request for water that leaves the other person room. The word is a quantity in the dictionary and a manner in the mouth.

Telugu shares this habit with a good many languages. English does it with “just” and “a bit”, and both of those have stopped measuring anything too.

What you’ve built

A word that makes the next one polite.

Your turn

- *Say it: koñcem*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: koñcem, then koñcem pālu, and hear how much softer it is than pālu alone*
- *Recall: say cāpa, then read మెడ and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does కొంచెం mean? (“a little, a bit”.) Say it once more.

58.2 ఎక్కువ (ekkuva) — more, a great deal

Before the new one: what did *koñcem* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఎక్కువ

ఎక్కువ (*ekkuva*) — “more, a great deal”.

ఎక్కువ is built on ఎక్కు, “to climb, to go up”. The quantity is a movement: more is what has gone up.

Set it against కొంచెం, which you had a moment ago, and you have the two ends of a plate of food. కొంచెం is what you say when you would like the serving to stop; ఎక్కువ is what you say when it was too much.

It doubles as “too much” without changing shape, so tone and face carry the difference. ఎక్కువ మాట్లాడు can be praise or a complaint depending on how it is said.

What you’ve built

Two: a little, and a lot.

Your turn

- *Say it: ekkuva*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: ekkuva, then koñcem, and say them as a pair*

- *Recall:* read బుట్ట, then say *vīpu*

Before you move on

What does ఎక్కువ mean? (“more, a great deal”.) Say it once more.

58.3 తక్కువ (takkuva) — less, too little

Before the new one: what did *ekkuva* mean?

You’ll want to know: తక్కువ

తక్కువ (*takkuva*) — “less, too little”.

తక్కువ is built on తక్కు, “to fall short”, exactly the way ఎక్కువ is built on climbing. Two words, one shape of construction, opposite directions.

A matched pair like this is worth holding on to, because it lets you guess. Once the -కువ ending on both has registered, you can meet a Telugu word for the first time and have some idea what it is doing.

తక్కువ చేసి మాట్లాడు, to speak somebody less, is to belittle them. The arithmetic goes straight into the manners.

What you’ve built

Three, and two of them are a pair.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *takkuva*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *takkuva*, then *ekkuva*, and say which one climbs
- *Recall:* say *katti*, then read పెదవి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does తక్కువ mean? (“less, too little”.) Say it once more.

58.4 వద్దు (vaddu) — no, I don't want it

Before the new one: what did *takkuva* mean?

You'll want to know: వద్దు

వద్దు (*vaddu*) — “no, I don't want it”.

వద్దు is the refusal of a thing offered. It is not the same as కాదు, which denies that something is so; వద్దు turns down an offer.

It answers కావాలి, “I want it”, and the two of them run every meal in a Telugu house. A hand over the plate and వద్దు is a complete sentence.

It softens the moment you put కొంచెం's cousin in front of it, or the -అండి ending on the end: వద్దండి is the same refusal with the door left open.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaddu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: vaddu, then vaddaṇḍi, and say which one you would use with a stranger*
- *Recall: read గిన్నె, then say gōru*

Before you move on

What does వద్దు mean? (“no, I don't want it”.) Say it once more.

58.5 అంతే (antē) — that's all; that's just it

Before the new one: what did *vaddu* mean?

You'll want to know: అంతే

అంతే (*antē*) — “that's all; that's just it”.

అంతే is అంత, “that much”, with a small -వీ on the end that means “just, exactly”. So the word says “exactly that much” — and it ends a list, a story or an argument.

It has a second life as agreement. Somebody explains why a thing went wrong and you say అంతే: that is precisely it, nothing further to add. The same word closes a sale and closes a discussion.

It is a good word to leave a chapter on. కొంచెం, ఎక్కువ, తక్కువ, వద్దు — and then అంతే.

What you’ve built

Five: కొంచెం, ఎక్కువ, తక్కువ, వద్దు, అంతే. You can now say how much, and when to stop.

Your turn

- *Say it: antē*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: all five in order, then refuse a second helping with vaddu, antē*
- *Recall: say peṭṭe, then read ఎముక and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does అంతే mean? (“that’s all; that’s just it”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Weather and Ground

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the weather and what is underfoot in Telugu, and use it as a reason to go home.

Complete TE-C59-fire and demonstrate the chapter promise.

59.1 గాలి (gāli) — wind, air

Before the new one: what did *antē* mean?

You'll want to know: గాలి

గాలి (gāli) — “wind, air”.

గాలి is inherited, and it covers both the wind that blows and the air that is simply there. Telugu does not split them.

It reaches further than weather. గాలి is breath, and it is rumour — గాలి వార్త is a story with nothing holding it up, blown in from somewhere. Air, breath and hearsay under one word is a chain a great many languages make, and it usually starts with breathing.

A గాలి getting up in the evening is the ordinary reason given for cutting a visit short.

What you've built

The first reason to start saying goodbye.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gāli*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *gāli*, then *vellōstānu*, and use the one as a reason for the other
- *Recall:* say *meḍa*, then read కొంచెం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does గాలి mean? (“wind, air”.) Say it once more.

59.2 మంచు (mañcu) — mist, dew, snow

Before the new one: what did *gāli* mean?

You’ll want to know: మంచు

మంచు (*mañcu*) — “mist, dew, snow”.

మంచు is the cold wet thing in the air: mist on a winter morning, dew on the ground, and snow where there is any. One word for all three states, which suits a country that meets the third of them rarely.

This is worth sitting with. A language draws its lines where its speakers need them. Telugu splits its cooking vessels three ways and lumps mist, dew and snow together; a language spoken where snow falls would do the opposite.

మంచు కురుస్తోంది is “it is misting” on the coast and “it is snowing” in the hills, with no change to the word.

What you’ve built

Two: what moves, and what settles.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mañcu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *mañcu*, then *gāli*, and say which of the two you can see
- *Recall:* read వీపు, then say *ekkuva*

Before you move on

What does మంచు mean? (“mist, dew, snow”.) Say it once more.

59.3 ఇసుక (isuka) — sand

Before the new one: what did *mañcu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఇసుక

ఇసుక (*isuka*) — “sand”.

ఇసుక is inherited and unremarkable, and that is the point: it is the ground beside every నది in the Telugu country.

The sand of a riverbed is where cattle are watered, where lorries come at night to dig, and where a village argument about who owns the river tends to start. A plain word can carry a lot of local weather.

ఇసుకలో నీళ్ళు, water in sand, is what you say about effort that soaks away.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: isuka*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: isuka, then nadi, and say where you would find one beside the other*
- *Recall: say pedavi, then read తక్కువ and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does ఇసుక mean? (“sand”.) Say it once more.

59.4 బురద (burada) — mud

Before the new one: what did *isuka* mean?

You'll want to know: బురద

బురద (*burada*) — “mud”.

బురద is mud — what ఇసుక becomes when the rain has been at it.

It does the same second job that mud does in English. బురద చల్లు, to throw mud, is to slander somebody, and the picture is exact enough that you can guess the phrase before you are told it.

బురద is also the honest reason a visit ends early in the wet months. The బాట between the గ్రామం and the నది turns to it.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: burada*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: burada, then isuka, and say what turns one into the other*
- *Recall: read గోరు, then say vaddu*

Before you move on

What does బురద mean? (“mud”.) Say it once more.

59.5 నిప్పు (nippu) — fire, a live coal

Before the new one: what did *burada* mean?

You'll want to know: నిప్పు

నిప్పు (*nippu*) — “fire, a live coal”.

నిప్పు is inherited, and it is the fire you can point at: the live coal, the burning thing in the hearth. అగ్ని, borrowed from Sanskrit, is fire as an idea and as a god, the one that carries offerings.

So Telugu keeps a working fire and a ceremonial one, in the same way it keeps a పొద్దు and a సూర్యుడు. That split has turned up so often in these chapters that you can start expecting it: the old word does the work, the borrowed one does the ceremony.

నిప్పు is what a house is banked down around at night, and putting it out is the last thing done before sleep. A good place to say వెళ్ళొస్తాను.

What you've built

Five: గాలి, మంచు, ఇసుక, బురద, నిప్పు. Weather enough to take your leave on.

Your turn

- *Say it: nippu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: all five in order, then say gāli ekkuva, and take your leave with vellōstānu*
- *Recall: say emuka, then read అంతే and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does నిప్పు mean? (“fire, a live coal”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Animals

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five common animals in Telugu, and greet the house that keeps them.

Complete TE-C60-bird and demonstrate the chapter promise.

60.1 గేదె (gēde) — a buffalo

Before the new one: what did *nippu* mean?

You’ll want to know: గేదె

గేదె (*gēde*) — “a buffalo”.

గేదె is the water buffalo — black, unhurried, and the animal most of the పాలు in a Telugu household actually come from. The cow gets the songs; the గేదె fills the pot.

The word is inherited, and the animal is so ordinary that arriving at a village house often means being met by one before anybody comes out to say నమస్కారం.

A గేదె standing in a చెరువు with only its nose above the water is the picture the word carries. That is where it spends the hottest part of the day.

What you’ve built

The first animal.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gēde*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *gēde*, then *pālu*, and say which one gives the other
- *Recall:* say *koñcem*, then read గాలి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does గేదె mean? (“a buffalo”.) Say it once more.

60.2 మేక (mēka) — a goat

Before the new one: what did *gēde* mean?

You’ll want to know: మేక

మేక (*mēka*) — “a goat”.

మేక is the goat: small, loud, and kept by households that cannot keep a గేదె. Where the buffalo wants water and grazing, the మేక wants almost nothing and will eat what is left.

The word is inherited and it is old. Its shape sits close to the Tamil and Kannada words for the same animal, which is what happens to the names of animals people have kept for a very long time.

A మేక will strip a bush bare and move on, which is why a గ్రామం keeps them at its edge rather than in its lanes.

What you’ve built

Two: one for milk, one for anything.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mēka*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *mēka*, then *gēde*, and say which one wants the చెరువు
- *Recall:* read ఎక్కువ, then say *mañcu*

Before you move on

What does మేక mean? (“a goat”.) Say it once more.

60.3 కోడి (kōḍi) — a hen

Before the new one: what did *mēka* mean?

You’ll want to know: కోడి

కోడి (*kōḍi*) — “a hen”.

కోడి is the domestic fowl, hen or cock alike; the word does not divide them, and when the difference matters a second word goes in front.

It is inherited and it is everywhere in the family, close in shape to the Tamil, Kannada and Malayalam words for the same bird — one of those words that travelled with the animal and has not moved since.

The కోడి is also the village clock. It wakes a house before ఉదయం is properly under way, which is why nobody there has ever needed a గంట.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōḍi*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: kōḍi, then mēka, and say which one wakes you*
- *Recall: say takkuva, then read ఇసుక and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does కోడి mean? (“a hen”.) Say it once more.

60.4 చీమ (cīma) — an ant

Before the new one: what did *kōḍi* mean?

You'll want to know: చీమ

చీమ (*cīma*) — “an ant”.

చీమ is the ant. After a గేదె and a కోడి it is a jump in scale worth making, because the same plain word-making covers whatever lives in a house, however small it is.

The word is inherited. Telugu has a stock comparison about a చీమ carrying many times its own weight, and it is the ordinary way to praise somebody small who works hard.

A line of చీమలు across a floor usually ends at a పండు somebody left out.

What you've built

Four: the biggest and the smallest so far.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cīma*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *cīma*, then *gēde*, and say which one is easier to miss
- *Recall:* read వద్దు, then say *burada*

Before you move on

What does చీమ mean? (“an ant”.) Say it once more.

60.5 పక్షి (pakṣi) — a bird

Before the new one: what did *cīma* mean?

You'll want to know: పక్షి

పక్షి (*pakṣi*) — “a bird”.

పక్షి is the general one: any bird at all, the కోడి included. It came in from Sanskrit, and beside it Telugu keeps its own పిట్ట for the small ones about a garden.

That is a split this book has met before — an inherited word doing the everyday work and a borrowed one carrying the wider idea, the same shape

as నిప్పు beside అగ్ని. Once you start expecting it, half the vocabulary sorts itself.

Five animals now, from the గేదె at the gate to the చీమ under it, and a నమస్కారం for whoever keeps them.

What you've built

Five: గేదె, మేక, కోడి, చీమ, పక్షి. Enough to greet a house and name what lives in it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* pakṣi
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then say *namaskāram* to whoever keeps them
- *Recall:* say *antē*, then read నిప్పు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does పక్షి mean? (“a bird”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

In the Kitchen

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five everyday things in a Telugu kitchen, and swap names with the person cooking.

Complete TE-C61-chilli and demonstrate the chapter promise.

61.1 పెరుగు (perugu) — curd

Before the new one: what did *pakṣi* mean?

You'll want to know: పెరుగు

పెరుగు (*perugu*) — “curd”.

పెరుగు is set curd: పాలు left overnight with a spoonful of yesterday's పెరుగు stirred in. It closes almost every meal in a Telugu house, and a *bhōjanam* without it is thought unfinished.

The word is inherited, and Telugu uses the same shape for what curd does and for what anything does when it grows. Curd is milk that grew.

A గేదె's పాలు set thicker than a cow's, which is one reason a village that keeps buffaloes is in no hurry to change.

What you've built

The first thing in the kitchen.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *perugu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *perugu*, then *pālu*, and say which one comes first
- *Recall:* say *gāli*, then read గీదె and say what it means

Before you move on

What does పెరుగు mean? (“curd”.) Say it once more.

61.2 నెయ్యి (neyyi) — ghee

Before the new one: what did *perugu* mean?

You’ll want to know: నెయ్యి

నెయ్యి (*neyyi*) — “ghee”.

నెయ్యి is clarified butter, and it is what పెరుగు becomes after churning and heating. Three things out of one: పాలు, పెరుగు, నెయ్యి.

The word is inherited and very old. Its root runs across the whole family for the same fat, which suits a food that has been made the same way for longer than any of these languages have been separate.

A spoonful of నెయ్యి over rice is both a taste and a courtesy. It is what a house puts in front of an *atithi* first.

What you’ve built

Two, and the second is made out of the first.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *neyyi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *neyyi*, then *perugu*, and say which one is poured
- *Recall:* read మంచు, then say *mēka*

Before you move on

What does నెయ్యి mean? (“ghee”.) Say it once more.

61.3 నూనె (nūne) — oil

Before the new one: what did *neyyi* mean?

You’ll want to know: నూనె

నూనె (*nūne*) — “oil”.

నూనె is oil pressed from seeds — groundnut, sesame, sunflower — and it is what a kitchen cooks with on the days it is not cooking with నెయ్యి.

The word is inherited, and Telugu keeps it firmly apart from నెయ్యి. One comes from an animal and one comes from a విత్తనం, and no cook mixes the two up.

నూనె also works outside the kitchen. It is what goes into a దీపం, and a house that has run out of it sits in the dark.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: nūne*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: nūne, then neyyi, and say which one a దీపం takes*
- *Recall: say isuka, then read కోడి and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does నూనె mean? (“oil”.) Say it once more.

61.4 చక్కెర (cakkera) — sugar

Before the new one: what did *nūne* mean?

You'll want to know: చక్కెర

చక్కెర (*cakkerā*) — “sugar”.

చక్కెర is sugar, and the word is a traveller. Sanskrit *śarkarā* meant “grit, gravel” — the stuff arrived in grains — and the same word went west through Persian and Arabic and Latin until English got “sugar” out of it. The Telugu shape and the English one are cousins with a very long road between them.

Telugu also keeps బెల్లం, the unrefined block of palm or cane sugar, for everything traditional. చక్కెర is the white refined thing that came later.

A pinch of చక్కెర goes into dishes an English kitchen would leave savoury, and it goes in to round off the salt rather than to make anything sweet.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cakkerā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *cakkerā*, then *perugu*, and say which one is stirred into the other
- *Recall:* read బురద, then say *cīma*

Before you move on

What does చక్కెర mean? (“sugar”.) Say it once more.

61.5 మిరప (mirapa) — a chilli

Before the new one: what did *cakkerā* mean?

You'll want to know: మిరప

మిరప (*mirapa*) — “a chilli”.

మిరప is the chilli, and it is the newest thing in this kitchen by several thousand years. The plant crossed from the Americas on Portuguese ships and reached the coast about four hundred years ago.

The word is older than the plant it names. It belonged to black pepper first, and when the new pod arrived and took over the job of making food hot, the name went with the job rather than staying with the plant.

Andhra cooking is built on it now, and a kitchen there measures itself by how much మిరప it can carry. Five things, and the person at the stove will ask your పేరు before the meal is over.

What you've built

Five: పెరుగు, నెయ్యి, నూనె, చక్కెర, మిరప. Enough to name what a kitchen holds while somebody asks you your పేరు.

Your turn

- *Say it:* mirapa
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then say *nā pēru* and your own name
- *Recall:* say *nippu*, then read పక్షి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does మిరప mean? (“a chilli”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Things People Make

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five things a Telugu household makes or keeps, and ask politely for one of them.

Complete TE-C62-mirror and demonstrate the chapter promise.

62.1 దారం (dāraṁ) — thread

Before the new one: what did *mirapa* mean?

You’ll want to know: దారం

దారం (*dāraṁ*) — “thread”.

దారం is thread — spun cotton, fine enough to sew with and strong enough to tie a knot that holds. It is the first thing in this chapter and the smallest.

The word came in from Sanskrit, where it belongs to a family about tearing and drawing out. Thread is what you draw out of a mass of cotton.

దారం does ceremonial work too. The thread tied round a wrist at a festival is a దారం, and once it is on it stays there until it falls off by itself.

What you’ve built

The first thing a house makes for itself.

Your turn

- Say it: *dāraṁ*

- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *dārami*, then *dayacēsi*, and ask for it politely
- *Recall:* say *gēde*, then read పెరుగు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does దారం mean? (“thread”.) Say it once more.

62.2 సూది (sūdi) — a needle

Before the new one: what did *dārami* mean?

You’ll want to know: సూది

సూది (*sūdi*) — “a needle”.

సూది is a needle. It arrived from Sanskrit *sūcī*, and Telugu wore the middle sound down to a *d* — a change the language makes often enough that the two shapes line up easily once you know to expect it.

A సూది is useless without a దారం, and a దారం is only a tangle without a సూది. That is about as neat a pair as this book has come across.

The same word does the వైద్యుడు’s work: an injection is a సూది, and somebody at a clinic who uses the word is not talking about mending a బట్ట.

What you’ve built

Two, and neither is much use without the other.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sūdi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *sūdi*, then *dārami*, and say which one goes through the other
- *Recall:* read మేక, then say *neyyi*

Before you move on

What does సూది mean? (“a needle”.) Say it once more.

62.3 చీపురు (cīpuru) — a broom

Before the new one: what did *sūdi* mean?

You’ll want to know: చీపురు

చీపురు (*cīpuru*) — “a broom”.

చీపురు is the broom: a bundle of coconut-leaf ribs bound tight at one end, used bent at the waist rather than standing upright.

The word is inherited. Sweeping is the first work of the morning in a Telugu house, done before the ముగ్గు goes down at the doorstep.

A చీపురు is treated with a little care because of that. It is not stood on its bristles, it is not stepped over, and it is not lent out lightly.

What you’ve built

Three, and this one starts the day.

Your turn

- *Say it: cīpuru*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: cīpuru, then muggu, and say which one comes first*
- *Recall: say kōḍi, then read నూనె and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does చీపురు mean? (“a broom”.) Say it once more.

62.4 గొడుగు (goḍugu) — an umbrella

Before the new one: what did *cīpuru* mean?

You’ll want to know: గొడుగు

గొడుగు (*goḍugu*) — “an umbrella”.

గొడుగు is an umbrella, and in Telugu it answers the sun as much as the rain — which is the commoner use of it on a hot morning.

The word is inherited. Long before cloth and wire there was a గొడుగు of palm leaf, and the ceremonial one held over a deity or over a bride is still made and named the same way.

It settles two things already met: గాలి will turn it inside out and మంచు will not, so a గొడుగు goes out in one kind of weather and stays at home in the other.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- Say it: *godugu*
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: *godugu*, then *gāli*, and say what one does to the other
- Recall: read చీమ, then say *cakkerā*

Before you move on

What does గొడుగు mean? (“an umbrella”.) Say it once more.

62.5 అద్దం (addam) — a mirror

Before the new one: what did *godugu* mean?

You'll want to know: అద్దం

అద్దం (*addam*) — “a mirror”.

అద్దం is a mirror. Of the five things here it is the only one a household buys rather than makes, and the only one wearing a borrowed name — from Sanskrit *ādarśa*, “what shows back”.

The other four come out of whatever grows nearby: a దారం out of cotton, a చీపురు out of leaf ribs, a గొడుగు out of palm and cane, and a సూది out of a scrap of metal from the smith at the edge of the గ్రామం. An అద్దం needs a factory.

Asking for one is where దయచేసి earns its keep. అద్దం ఇవ్వండి on its own lands like an instruction; with దయచేసి in front it lands like a request.

What you've built

Five: దారం, సూది, చీపురు, గొడుగు, అద్దం. Enough to ask for what you need with దయచేసి in front of it.

Your turn

- *Say it: addam*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: all five in order, then say dayacēsi addam ivvaṇḍi*
- *Recall: say pakṣi, then read మిరప and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does అద్దం mean? (“a mirror”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

Hunger, Sleep and Health

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say in Telugu that I am hungry, sleepy or unwell, and ask after somebody else’s health.

Complete TE-C63-health and demonstrate the chapter promise.

63.1 ఆకలి (ākali) — hunger

Before the new one: what did *addamī* mean?

You’ll want to know: ఆకలి

ఆకలి (*ākali*) — “hunger”.

ఆకలి is hunger. Telugu does not say “I am hungry” — it says నాకు ఆకలి, “to me, hunger”, the same shape as నాకు తెలుసు and నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు. Hunger is something that happens to you.

The word is inherited, and it is among the first a child in a Telugu house learns to say — usually loudly, and usually before *bhōjanam* is anywhere near ready.

ఆకలిగా ఉందా? is a real greeting in a house you are close to. It gets asked before మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? has a chance.

What you’ve built

The first thing to say about yourself.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ākali*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *nāku ākali*, then ask *mīru elā unnāru?*
- *Recall:* say *perugu*, then read దారం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఆకలి mean? (“hunger.”) Say it once more.

63.2 నిద్ర (nidra) — sleep

Before the new one: what did *ākali* mean?

You’ll want to know: నిద్ర

నిద్ర (*nidra*) — “sleep”.

నిద్ర is sleep, and it takes the same shape as ఆకలి: నాకు నిద్ర వస్తోంది, “sleep is coming to me”. You do not do it; it arrives.

The word came from Sanskrit *nidrā* and settled without changing. Beside it Telugu keeps నిదుర, the softer everyday form, and the two are one word wearing different clothes.

నిద్ర also makes a polite reason for leaving late in the evening, and it works the way గాలి worked earlier. Nobody argues with it.

What you’ve built

Two, and both of them come to you.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nidra*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *nidra*, then *ākali*, and say which one you have now
- *Recall:* read నెయ్యి, then say *sūdi*

Before you move on

What does నిద్ర mean? (“sleep”.) Say it once more.

63.3 దగ్గు (daggu) — a cough

Before the new one: what did *nidra* mean?

You’ll want to know: దగ్గు

దగ్గు (*daggu*) — “a cough”.

దగ్గు is a cough. It is inherited, and it is a sound turned into a word, which is how a good many of these words start out.

Like ఆకలి and నిద్ర it comes to you rather than from you: నాకు దగ్గు, and nobody needs telling any more than that.

Telugu keeps దగ్గు for the whole thing at once — the single cough, the fit of coughing, and the illness sitting behind both — where English reaches for three phrases. A మంచు morning in the hills fills a house with it.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: daggu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: daggu, then nidra, and say which one keeps you from the other*
- *Recall: say nūne, then read చీపురు and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does దగ్గు mean? (“a cough”.) Say it once more.

63.4 రోగం (rōgam) — a disease

Before the new one: what did *daggu* mean?

You'll want to know: రోగం

రోగం (*rōgani*) — “a disease”.

రోగం is illness in general: not the దగ్గు you have this week, but the thing a వైద్యుడు puts a name to.

It is Sanskrit, from a root about breaking — an illness is something breaking in you — and Telugu took the word whole, the way it took *hrdayani*.

రోగి is the person who has one. A వైద్యుడు's whole working day is spent between those two words, and so is a good deal of ordinary conversation about relatives.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rōgani*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *rōgani*, then *daggu*, and say which one is the smaller trouble
- *Recall:* read చక్కెర, then say *godugu*

Before you move on

What does రోగం mean? (“a disease”.) Say it once more.

63.5 ఆరోగ్యం (*ārōgyani*) — health

Before the new one: what did *rōgani* mean?

You'll want to know: ఆరోగ్యం

ఆరోగ్యం (*ārōgyani*) — “health”.

ఆరోగ్యం is health, and it is the word before it with a small piece stuck on the front. The piece means “not”, and రోగ is the illness: health here is what is left when the illness is gone.

That is a real difference in outlook and worth a moment. English health is something to be built up. ఆరోగ్యం is a subtraction.

మీ ఆరోగ్యం ఎలా ఉంది? is what a house asks an *atithi* who has been ill. It is more particular than మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు?, and it expects a real answer.

What you've built

Five: ఆకలి, నిద్ర, దగ్గు, రోగం, ఆరోగ్యం. Enough to say what is wrong and to ask after somebody else.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ārōgyam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then ask *mī ārōgyam elā undi?*
- *Recall:* say *mirapa*, then read అర్థం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఆరోగ్యం mean? (“health”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

Words That Join an Answer

Modes:  voice (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can add to a Telugu answer, limit it, put it in order, or say it is not finished.

Complete TE-C64-still and demonstrate the chapter promise.

64.1 కూడా (kūdā) — also

Before the new one: what did *ārōgyam* mean?

You'll want to know: కూడా

కూడా (*kūdā*) — “also”.

కూడా goes after the thing it is adding, not before it. నేను కూడా is “me too”; పెరుగు కూడా is “the curd as well”.

English can drop “also” almost anywhere in a sentence and let the stress carry the meaning. Telugu puts కూడా straight after whatever it includes, and that placement does the work the stress would have done.

It is a small word that softens a great deal. Adding కూడా to an answer turns a flat అవును into agreement with the person who asked.

What you've built

The first joining word.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kūḍā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *nēnu kūḍā*, then *perugu kūḍā*, and say what each one adds
- *Recall:* say *dāraṁ*, then read అకలి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does కూడా mean? (“also”.) Say it once more.

64.2 మాత్రమే (mātramē) — only

Before the new one: what did *kūḍā* mean?

You’ll want to know: మాత్రమే

మాత్రమే (*mātramē*) — “only”.

మాత్రమే is the other half of కూడా. Where కూడా opens an answer out, మాత్రమే shuts it: పెరుగు మాత్రమే is “curd and nothing else”. It stands in the same place, straight after the thing it is about.

It is built on Sanskrit *mātra*, “a measure” — the same piece English carries in metre and in diameter. Saying మాత్రమే is saying “this much and no further”.

With a small quantity in front it does polite work. కొంచెం మాత్రమే, “only a little”, accepts what is offered without taking much of it.

What you’ve built

Two, and they pull opposite ways.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mātramē*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *perugu kūḍā*, then *perugu mātramē*, and say which one takes more

- *Recall:* read సూది, then say *nidra*

Before you move on

What does మాత్రమే mean? (“only”.) Say it once more.

64.3 అయితే (ayitē) — in that case

Before the new one: what did *mātramē* mean?

You’ll want to know: అయితే

అయితే (*ayitē*) — “in that case”.

అయితే picks up what the other person has just said and turns on it: సరే, అయితే వెళ్ళిస్తాను — “alright, in that case I’ll be off”.

It is put together out of the piece Telugu uses for “it happened” plus the little ending that means “if”, so what it literally says is “if it is so”. English “well then” and “in that case” both land in the same spot.

At the head of an answer, on its own, అయితే is one of the most useful things a learner can carry. It buys a moment, and it shows the other person you were listening.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ayitē*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *sarē*, then *ayitē*, and put the two together
- *Recall:* say *cīpuru*, then read చీపురు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does అయితే mean? (“in that case”.) Say it once more.

64.4 తరువాత (taruvāta) — after that, later

Before the new one: what did *ayitē* mean?

You'll want to know: తరువాత

తరువాత (*taruvāta*) — “after that, later”.

తరువాత puts two things in order: *bhōjanam taruvāta*, “after the meal”. It goes after the thing it follows, exactly like కూడా and మాత్రమే before it — a habit worth noticing, because it holds for a great many of these small words.

The word is inherited. Standing alone at the front of a sentence it means “later”, and it is the gentle way to put something off: తరువాత, not now, and no reason offered.

తరువాత is also how a story gets kept moving. A listener who says it is asking you to go on.

What you've built

Four, and this one is about order.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *taruvāta*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *bhōjanam taruvāta*, then just *taruvāta*, and say how the two differ
- *Recall:* read గొడుగు, then say *rōgam*

Before you move on

What does తరువాత mean? (“after that, later”.) Say it once more.

64.5 ఇంకా (inkā) — still, yet

Before the new one: what did *taruvāta* mean?

You'll want to know: ఇంకా

ఇంకా (*inkā*) — “still, yet”.

ఇంకా says the thing is not finished. ఇంకా ఉంది is “there is still some”; ఇంకా రాలేదు is “she hasn’t come yet”.

It is the natural answer to అంతే. Where అంతే closes a list off, ఇంకా says there is more of it coming, and the two make a pair the way కూడా and మాత్రమే do.

Five small words, and not one of them names a thing. కూడా, మాత్రమే, అయితే, తరువాత, ఇంకా are what turn a set of separate answers into a conversation.

What you’ve built

Five: కూడా, మాత్రమే, అయితే, తరువాత, ఇంకా. Enough to add to an answer, limit it, order it, or keep it open.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *inkā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then answer *antē?* with *inkā undi*
- *Recall:* say *addani*, then read ఆరోగ్యం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఇంకా mean? (“still, yet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

More Good Manners

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🖱️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can welcome somebody in Telugu, make a request, ask their leave, and thank them.

Complete TE-C65-trust and demonstrate the chapter promise.

65.1 స్వాగతం (svāgatam) — a welcome

Before the new one: what did *inkā* mean?

You'll want to know: స్వాగతం

స్వాగతం (*svāgatam*) — “a welcome”.

Keep this well apart from పరవాలేదు. పరవాలేదు is what you say after somebody thanks you. స్వాగతం is what you say when they walk in. English hands the one word “welcome” both jobs; Telugu does not.

It is Sanskrit, and it comes apart neatly: *su-* “well” and *āgata* “come” — “well come”, which is what the English word is too, arrived by an entirely separate road.

A house says it with the door open and a *gauravani* behind it. The ముగ్గు at the step is the same sentence without any words in it.

What you've built

The first thing said at a door.

Your turn

- *Say it: svāgatam*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: svāgatam*, then *paravālēdu*, and say which one answers a thank-you
- *Recall: say ākali*, then read కూడా and say what it means

Before you move on

What does స్వాగతం mean? (“a welcome”.) Say it once more.

65.2 మర్యాద (maryāda) — good manners

Before the new one: what did *svāgatam* mean?

You’ll want to know: మర్యాద

మర్యాద (*maryāda*) — “good manners”.

మర్యాద is the doing half of *gauravam*. Respect is what you feel for somebody; మర్యాద is what you do about it — standing up, offering the కుర్చీ, serving the *atithi* before yourself.

The word is Sanskrit and its first sense was a boundary line. Manners as a line you do not step over is a picture worth keeping hold of.

మర్యాదగా is how it usually reaches a person: మర్యాదగా మాట్లాడు, “speak with manners”, which sounds sterner in English than it does in Telugu. It is closer to “be decent about it”.

What you’ve built

Two: what you feel and what you do.

Your turn

- *Say it: maryāda*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: maryāda*, then *gauravam*, and say which one somebody can watch you doing

- *Recall:* read నిద్ర, then say *mātramē*

Before you move on

What does మర్యాద mean? (“good manners”.) Say it once more.

65.3 మనవి (manavi) — a polite request

Before the new one: what did *maryāda* mean?

You’ll want to know: మనవి

మనవి (*manavi*) — “a polite request”.

మనవి is a request made from below — not దయచేసి set in front of an instruction, but the whole thing framed as a submission. ఒక మనవి, “one request”, is said before the request itself arrives.

Where the word came from is not something any source consulted here settles, so nothing is invented for it. What is certain is the register it sits in, and that is the part a learner needs.

A మనవి goes to somebody who can say no: an official, an elder, a host. The word does half the softening before you have said what you want.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *manavi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *manavi*, then *dayacēsi*, and say which one is the whole request
- *Recall:* say *daggu*, then read అయితే and say what it means

Before you move on

What does మనవి mean? (“a polite request”.) Say it once more.

65.4 అనుమతి (anumati) — permission

Before the new one: what did *manavi* mean?

You'll want to know: అనుమతి

అనుమతి (*anumati*) — “permission”.

అనుమతి is permission — what a మనవి is hoping to be given. అనుమతి ఇవ్వండి, “give permission”, is the formal shape of it; in a house it usually comes out as a nod.

It is Sanskrit: *anu-* “along with” and *mati* “a mind”. Permission is somebody’s mind going along with yours, which is a kinder picture than the English word offers.

Asking leave before you go is where it is most used, and it sits naturally in front of వెళ్ళొస్తాను. With అనుమతి first, leaving stops being something you announce and becomes something you are given.

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *anumati*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *anumati*, then *vellōstānu*, and take your leave properly
- *Recall:* read రోగం, then say *taruvāta*

Before you move on

What does అనుమతి mean? (“permission”.) Say it once more.

65.5 నమ్మకం (nammakam) — trust

Before the new one: what did *anumati* mean?

You'll want to know: నమ్మకం

నమ్మకం (*nammakam*) — “trust”.

నమ్మకం is trust, and it is the one word here that is Telugu's own. It is built on నమ్మ, “to believe”, with the ending that turns an action into the thing itself.

The four before it are Sanskrit and they are all about form: a welcome, manners, a request, permission. నమ్మకం is what the form is for. A house that does all four and is still not trusted has been doing something else.

The word also carries “belief” in the religious sense, and Telugu is content to let one word hold both. Trusting a person and believing a thing are the same act pointed in two directions.

What you've built

Five: స్వాగతం, మర్యాద, మనవి, అనుమతి, నమ్మకం. Enough to bring somebody in, ask something of them, and say ధన్యవాదములు when they agree.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nammakam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then say *dhanyavādamulu* to whoever gave you the last one
- *Recall:* say *ārōgyam*, then read ఇంకా and say what it means

Before you move on

What does నమ్మకం mean? (“trust”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

The Field

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a Telugu field and what comes off it, and take my leave when the work is done.

Complete TE-C66-harvest and demonstrate the chapter promise.

66.1 పొలం (polam) — a field

Before the new one: what did *nammakam* mean?

You'll want to know: పొలం

పొలం (*polam*) — “a field”.

పొలం is a field under cultivation — not open ground, but somebody's, with a boundary and a name and a రైతు who walks it every morning.

The word is inherited. A గ్రామం is measured by its పొలం far more than by its houses, and directions in the country are given by whose పొలం you pass rather than by any బాట.

Going out to the పొలం before ఉదయం and coming back after సాయంత్రం is the shape of the day the rest of this chapter describes.

What you've built

The ground everything else here stands on.

Your turn

- *Say it: polam*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: polam, then grāmam, and say which one feeds the other*
- *Recall: say kūḍā, then read స్వాగతం and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does పొలం mean? (“a field”.) Say it once more.

66.2 పరి (vari) — paddy, rice still in the field

Before the new one: what did *polam* mean?

You’ll want to know: పరి

పరి (*vari*) — “paddy”, rice while it is still standing.

Telugu counts rice three times over and this is the first of them: పరి in the పొలం, బియ్యం once it is husked, అన్నం once it is cooked. Three words, three states, and none of them will stand in for another.

The word is inherited and it names the plant. English has one word for the lot and has to borrow “paddy” from Malay to get the same distinction; Telugu had it from the start.

A పరి పొలం under water with the seedlings just pushed in is the picture the coast is built on, and what is being pushed in is the మొక్క from earlier in this book.

What you’ve built

Two: the ground and what is standing in it.

Your turn

- *Say it: vari*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: vari, then say which of బియ్యం and అన్నం comes next*

- *Recall:* read మాత్రమే, then say *maryāda*

Before you move on

What does వరి mean? (“paddy, rice still in the field”.) Say it once more.

66.3 గడ్డి (gaḍḍi) — grass

Before the new one: what did *vari* mean?

You’ll want to know: గడ్డి

గడ్డి (*gaḍḍi*) — “grass”.

గడ్డి is grass, and in a village it mostly means fodder — what gets cut at the edge of the పొలం and carried back for the గేదె and the మేక.

The word is inherited. It covers straw as well, meaning what is left of the వరి once the grain is off, so one word runs all the way from the living plant to the dry stalk stacked beside the house.

గడ్డి does insulting work too. Calling something గడ్డి is calling it worthless, which is what tends to happen to a word that means “the part nobody eats”.

What you’ve built

Three, and this is what the animals get.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gaḍḍi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *gaḍḍi*, then *gēde*, and say which one is carried to the other
- *Recall:* say *ayitē*, then read మనవి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does గడ్డి mean? (“grass”.) Say it once more.

66.4 కల్లం (kallam) — a threshing floor

Before the new one: what did *gaḍḍi* mean?

You'll want to know: కల్లం

కల్లం (*kallam*) — “a threshing floor”.

కల్లం is the threshing floor: a flat patch of ground beaten hard and swept clean, where the cut *వరి* is separated from its *గడ్డి*.

The word is inherited. A కల్లం belongs to the గ్రామం rather than to one house, and the order in which families take their turn on it is settled by custom rather than by asking — the kind of arrangement a village is full of.

It gets swept with a చీపురు before anything is laid down on it, and that sweeping is taken about as seriously as the ముగ్గు at a doorstep.

What you've built

Four: where the year's work gets finished.

Your turn

- *Say it: kallam*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: kallam, then cīpuru, and say which one is used on the other*
- *Recall: read తరువాత, then say anumati*

Before you move on

What does కల్లం mean? (“a threshing floor”.) Say it once more.

66.5 పంట (paṇṭa) — a harvest

Before the new one: what did *kallam* mean?

You'll want to know: పంట

పంట (*paṇṭa*) — “a harvest”.

పంట is the harvest — the crop standing and the crop taken in, both at once. It is inherited, and it is what this whole chapter has been walking towards: పొలం, వరి, గడ్డి, కల్లం, and then పంట.

Telugu uses it well outside the field. A good year at anything is a మంచి పంట, and somebody talking about how their children turned out will reach for the word without meaning anything about rice at all.

When the పంట is in and the కల్లం is swept, the day and the season finish together, and there is nothing left to do but say వెళ్ళొస్తాను.

What you've built

Five: పొలం, వరి, గడ్డి, కల్లం, పంట. A year's work in five words, and a good place to take your leave.

Your turn

- *Say it:* paṇṭa
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then take your leave with vellōstānu
- *Recall:* say inkā, then read నమ్మకం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does పంట mean? (“a harvest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

The House Itself

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the parts a Telugu house is built from, and greet the people inside it.

Complete TE-C67-window and demonstrate the chapter promise.

67.1 గోడ (gōḍa) — a wall

Before the new one: what did *paṇṭa* mean?

You'll want to know: గోడ

గోడ (*gōḍa*) — “a wall”.

గోడ is a wall: the built side of a room. A village house puts up four of them in mud or in brick, and everything after that — the తలుపు, the కుర్చీ pushed back against one of them — is placed by where they stand.

The word is inherited, and it does the same figurative work English asks of a wall. Somebody who will not listen is a గోడ, and a family with nothing hidden has no గోడ inside it.

Whitewashing the గోడ before a festival is its own small season in a Telugu house. A guest who arrives to a fresh one has been told they were expected, and the right thing to say at that moment is నమస్కారం.

What you've built

One. What a house is measured by before anything is put inside it.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōḍa*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: gōḍa, then namaskāram, as though greeting somebody at a freshly painted one*
- *Recall: say svāgatam, then read పొలం and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does గోడ mean? (“a wall”.) Say it once more.

67.2 కప్పు (kappu) — a roof

Before the new one: what did *gōḍa* mean?

You’ll want to know: కప్పు

కప్పు (*kappu*) — “a roof”.

కప్పు is the roof — the thing that covers. It comes from the same stem as the everyday word for covering something over, so a lid on a గిన్నె and the roof over a room are one idea in Telugu.

Village roofs were గడ్డి over beams for centuries and are tile or concrete now. The material changed and the word did not, which is usually a sign of a very old one.

To be under somebody’s కప్పు is to be their guest, and it binds the person underneath as much as the person above. నమస్కారం comes first, and everything else follows it.

What you’ve built

Two: గోడ and కప్పు. Sides, and a lid.

Your turn

- *Say it: kappu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*

- *Say it:* *gōḍa*, then *kappu*, and say which one holds up the other
- *Recall:* read మర్యాద, then say *vari*

Before you move on

What does కప్పు mean? (“a roof”.) Say it once more.

67.3 గడప (gaḍapa) — a threshold

Before the new one: what did *kappu* mean?

You’ll want to know: గడప

గడప (*gaḍapa*) — “a threshold”.

గడప is the threshold: the raised strip of stone or wood under the తలుపు that you step over on the way in.

It is the most watched piece of a Telugu house. The ముగ్గు is drawn just outside it, water is thrown across it at ఉదయం, and nobody steps on it if they can help it.

Because it marks in from out, గడప also does the work of the word household. Asking whose గడప somebody comes from is asking about their family, not about their doorstep.

What you’ve built

Three. The line you cross to be inside.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gaḍapa*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *gaḍapa*, then *muggu*, and say which one is drawn beside the other
- *Recall:* say *manavi*, then read గడ్డి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does గడప mean? (“a threshold”.) Say it once more.

67.4 మెట్టు (metṭu) — a step

Before the new one: what did *gaḍapa* mean?

You’ll want to know: మెట్టు

మెట్టు (*metṭu*) — “a step”.

మెట్టు is a step — one of a flight, cut in stone or built up in mud.

Telugu counts them and remembers them. The steps down to a చెరువు are named in some villages, and a house with a మెట్టు at its గడప is a house standing a little above the street.

The word carries rank as well. A person who has risen has climbed a మెట్టు, which is how a stair turns into a career with nobody explaining it.

What you’ve built

Four. Something to climb before you cross.

Your turn

- *Say it: metṭu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: metṭu, then gaḍapa, in the order your feet meet them*
- *Recall: read అనుమతి, then say kallam*

Before you move on

What does మెట్టు mean? (“a step”.) Say it once more.

67.5 కిటికీ (kiṭikī) — a window

Before the new one: what did *metṭu* mean?

You'll want to know: కిటికీ

కిటికీ (*kitikī*) — “a window”.

కిటికీ is a window. It is a borrowing, ultimately from Portuguese, and it arrived carrying the shape of window it names: a framed opening in a గోడ, rather than the small unglazed gap older houses left for గాలి.

Telugu kept the borrowed word and the older habit side by side. A కిటికీ is opened at ఉదయం, shut against the sun in the middle of the day, and opened again by సాయంత్రం.

A house with a గోడ, a కప్పు, a గడప, a మెట్టు and a కిటికీ is a whole house. Whoever is standing at any one of them is somebody you can greet.

What you've built

Five: గోడ, కప్పు, గడప, మెట్టు, కిటికీ. A house you could walk up to and greet.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kitikī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *namaskāram* at the last one
- *Recall:* say *nammakami*, then read పంట and say what it means

Before you move on

What does కిటికీ mean? (“a window”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

Sound and Voice

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the sounds a Telugu house makes, and give my name aloud in a message.

Complete TE-C68-message and demonstrate the chapter promise.

68.1 శబ్దం (śabdāṁ) — a sound

Before the new one: what did *kiṭikiṭi* mean?

You'll want to know: శబ్దం

శబ్దం (*śabdāṁ*) — “a sound”.

శబ్దం is a sound — any sound at all, from a తలుపు closing to thunder over a పొలం.

It is Sanskrit, borrowed early and borrowed whole. It covers the smallest noise and the largest with no change: a చుక్క of water landing, or the crack that comes before rain.

A room with no శబ్దం in it is not called quiet in Telugu so much as empty, and people say exactly that about a house whose children have grown up and gone.

What you've built

One. The most general thing an ear can take in.

Your turn

- *Say it: śabdami*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: śabdami, then kiṭikī, and say which one comes in through the other*
- *Recall: say polami, then read గోడ and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does శబ్దం mean? (“a sound”.) Say it once more.

68.2 గొంతు (gontu) — a voice

Before the new one: what did *śabdami* mean?

You’ll want to know: గొంతు

గొంతు (*gontu*) — “a voice”.

గొంతు is a voice, and it is also the throat that makes one — the front of the మెడ you already know. Telugu lets the two meanings sit in the single word.

Somebody loud has a big గొంతు and somebody who sings well has a sweet one. A person who speaks up for people who cannot is said to have lent them their గొంతు.

Losing it is ordinary. After a night of దగ్గు a villager will say the గొంతు has gone, and mean the throat and the sound at once.

What you’ve built

Two: శబ్దం and గొంతు. Sound in general, and the sound a person makes.

Your turn

- *Say it: gontu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: gontu, then śabdami, and say which one is the wider word*

- *Recall:* read పరి, then say *kappu*

Before you move on

What does గొంతు mean? (“a voice”.) Say it once more.

68.3 పాట (pāṭa) — a song

Before the new one: what did *gontu* mean?

You’ll want to know: పాట

పాట (*pāṭa*) — “a song”.

పాట is a song. Watch the middle letter. పాత, with a plain letter, is the word for old that you already have; పాట is a song. One has the tongue behind the teeth and the other has it curled back.

The word is inherited and it is everywhere: work songs at the కల్లం, lullabies, film songs a whole state can hum. A Telugu speaker will name a పాట faster than a book.

Anything repeated past patience becomes a పాట as an insult, in the way English reaches for the same old song.

What you’ve built

Three. And a పాత పాట is an old song, which is a phrase you have now earned.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pāṭa*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *pāta*, then *pāṭa*, and hear the one letter between them
- *Recall:* say *gaḍḍi*, then read గడప and say what it means

Before you move on

What does పాట mean? (“a song”.) Say it once more.

68.4 అరుపు (arupu) — a shout

Before the new one: what did *pāṭa* mean?

You'll want to know: అరుపు

అరుపు (*arupu*) — “a shout”.

అరుపు is a shout: a cry raised on purpose, loud enough to carry the width of a పొలం.

It is inherited, built on the everyday word for shouting, and it is not rude in itself. Calling somebody in from work is an అరుపు, and so is the cry that warns a గ్రామం.

It turns rude only when there is a person on the far end of it. Somebody who was shouted at will say they got an అరుపు, and everybody hears the difference without being told.

What you've built

Four. Sound, voice, song, and now sound sent a distance.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *arupu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *arupu*, then *gontu*, and say which one is louder
- *Recall:* read కల్లం, then say *meṭṭu*

Before you move on

What does అరుపు mean? (“a shout”.) Say it once more.

68.5 కబురు (kaburu) — a message, news

Before the new one: what did *arupu* mean?

You'll want to know: కబురు

కబురు (*kaburu*) — “a message, news”.

కబురు is a message: word sent, or news arriving.

It came into Telugu from Arabic by way of Persian, and it was worn in so long ago that it stopped feeling borrowed. It is the word for what an అరుపు is for — getting something to somebody who is not there.

Sending కబురు is a fixed pair of words in the countryside, and the greeting at the head of a message is part of the message. Names travel this way too: a కబురు usually opens by saying whose it is.

What you've built

Five: శబ్దం, గొంతు, పాట, అరుపు, కబురు. Sound, and the whole way it gets from one person to another.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaburu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then your own name, as the opening line of a కబురు
- *Recall:* say *paṇṭa*, then read కిటికీ and say what it means

Before you move on

What does కబురు mean? (“a message, news”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Tools

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five Telugu tools and ask politely to borrow one.

Complete TE-C69-stick and demonstrate the chapter promise.

69.1 గొడ్డలి (godḍali) — an axe

Before the new one: what did *kaburu* mean?

You’ll want to know: గొడ్డలి

గొడ్డలి (*godḍali*) — “an axe”.

గొడ్డలి is an axe — an iron head on a wooden handle, for cutting a చెట్టు down or splitting firewood at the గడప.

The word is inherited and old. Its first piece turns up in other Telugu words about striking, so the name says plainly what the thing does.

Asking for one is the ordinary polite request: దయచేసి, and then the word. The person hands it over handle first, and nobody throws a గొడ్డలి.

What you’ve built

One. Heavy, and handed over rather than thrown.

Your turn

- Say it: *godḍali*

- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *dayacēsi*, then *godḍali*, in that order
- *Recall:* say *gōḍa*, then read శబ్దం and say what it means

Before you move on

What does గొడ్డలి mean? (“an axe”.) Say it once more.

69.2 రంపం (rampam) — a saw

Before the new one: what did *godḍali* mean?

You’ll want to know: రంపం

రంపం (*rampam*) — “a saw”.

రంపం is a saw. Where the గొడ్డలి breaks wood apart, the రంపం takes it apart along a line.

It is a borrowing, and it came in with the trade rather than ahead of it: the long two-man saw and its name reached the carpenter’s shed together.

The noise is half the word. Telugu calls a rasping sound a రంపం sound, and somebody who repeats a complaint until you give way is running a రంపం over your చెవి.

What you’ve built

Two. Both of them cut; only one cuts straight.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rampam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *godḍali*, then *rampam*, and say which one leaves a straight edge
- *Recall:* read కప్పు, then say *gontu*

Before you move on

What does రంపం mean? (“a saw”.) Say it once more.

69.3 పార (pāra) — a spade

Before the new one: what did *rampamī* mean?

You’ll want to know: పార

పార (*pāra*) — “a spade”.

పార is a spade — a broad iron blade on a handle, for digging and for shifting బురద or ఇసుక.

It is the tool of the రైతు out of season: clearing a channel, banking up the edge of a పొలం, cutting a way for water to run.

The word is inherited and it stays narrow. It does not stretch into anything figurative at all, which by itself says how firmly it belongs to the ground.

What you’ve built

Three. The first one here you push rather than swing.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāra*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: pāra, then rampamī, and say which one you push*
- *Recall: say gaḍapa, then read పాట and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does పార mean? (“a spade”.) Say it once more.

69.4 సుత్తి (sutti) — a hammer

Before the new one: what did *pāra* mean?

You'll want to know: సుత్తి

సుత్తి (*sutti*) — “a hammer”.

సుత్తి is a hammer: an iron head on a short handle, for driving things in and for beating things straight.

Telugu turned it into a word about people. Somebody who makes the same point until you give in is doing సుత్తి, and telling them to stop the సుత్తి is telling them to stop going on.

In a city that second sense is now the commoner one, which is worth knowing before somebody uses it about you.

What you've built

Four. The one whose second meaning you are likelier to hear.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sutti*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *sutti*, then *godḍali*, and say which one has a short handle
- *Recall:* read మెట్టు, then say *arupu*

Before you move on

What does సుత్తి mean? (“a hammer”.) Say it once more.

69.5 కర్త (karra) — a stick

Before the new one: what did *sutti* mean?

You'll want to know: కర్త

కర్త (*karra*) — “a stick”.

కర్త is a stick — a length of wood, cut or picked up, for everything the other four are too particular for.

It is inherited and completely ordinary: a walking stick for a తాత, a herding stick behind a మేక, the handle still waiting for a గొడ్డలి head.

It is also the right thing to ask for first. దయచేసి and a కర్త costs nobody anything, and by the time you want the సుత్తి you already know how to ask.

What you've built

Five: గొడ్డలి, రంపం, పాఠ, సుత్తి, కర్ర. Enough to ask for anything in a shed.

Your turn

- *Say it:* karra
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *dayacēsi* and the one you would borrow first
- *Recall:* say *kit̥ik̥i*, then read కబురు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does కర్ర mean? (“a stick”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 70

Small Creatures

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five small Telugu creatures and answer yes or no about them.

Complete TE-C70-spider and demonstrate the chapter promise.

70.1 ఎలుక (eluka) — a mouse, a rat

Before the new one: what did *karra* mean?

You'll want to know: ఎలుక

ఎలుక (*eluka*) — “a mouse, a rat”.

ఎలుక is a mouse, and the same word does for a rat. Telugu does not split them the way English does; when the size matters, a word for size is added.

It is inherited. Any house with బియ్యం in it has an ఎలుక story, and the పిల్లి you already know earns its keep here.

Asked whether there is one about, most people say అవును before they have thought about it, and లేదు only after going to look.

What you've built

One. And the first thing anybody asks about a house.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eluka*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *eluka*, then *avunu*, then *lēdu*
- *Recall:* say *śabdami*, then read గొడ్డలి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఎలుక mean? (“a mouse, a rat”.) Say it once more.

70.2 కప్ప (kappa) — a frog

Before the new one: what did *eluka* mean?

You’ll want to know: కప్ప

కప్ప (*kappa*) — “a frog”.

కప్ప is a frog. Set it beside కప్పు, the roof, and you have a pair worth saying twice: one small vowel at the end is the whole difference.

It is inherited and it belongs to the rains. The first కప్ప heard after dark is how a గ్రామం knows the season turned, before anybody looks at a calendar.

Telugu uses it for somebody whose world is small — a కప్ప in a well, which is a picture a dozen unrelated languages reached for on their own.

What you’ve built

Two. And the roof is still కప్పు.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kappa*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *kappu*, then *kappa*, and say which one is the roof
- *Recall:* read గొంతు, then say *rampam*

Before you move on

What does కప్ప mean? (“a frog”.) Say it once more.

70.3 దోమ (dōma) — a mosquito

Before the new one: what did *kappa* mean?

You’ll want to know: దోమ

దోమ (*dōma*) — “a mosquito”.

దోమ is a mosquito. The word is inherited, and it is said with feeling.

A దోమ is the reason for the net over a bed, for smoke at dusk, and for half the complaints of a hot సాయంత్రం.

It is also the standard small annoyance. Somebody waving away a threat calls it a దోమ, and somebody who could not sleep blames one.

What you’ve built

Three. The smallest of them and the loudest complaint.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōma*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: dōma, then kappa, and say which one you hear at night*
- *Recall: say pāṭa, then read పాఠ and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does దోమ mean? (“a mosquito”.) Say it once more.

70.4 ఉడుత (uduta) — a squirrel

Before the new one: what did *dōma* mean?

You'll want to know: ఉడుత

ఉడుత (*uduta*) — “a squirrel”.

ఉడుత is a squirrel — the striped palm squirrel that runs along the top of a గోడ and out onto any కొమ్మ it can reach.

It is inherited. The three stripes down its back carry a story that every Telugu household can tell, and the animal is let alone because of it.

An ఉడుత's help is a set phrase for a small contribution offered honestly. Whoever says it is calling their own share tiny and means to give it anyway.

What you've built

Four. The one nobody chases off.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uduta*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *uduta*, then *eluka*, and say which one is welcome
- *Recall:* read అరుపు, then say *sutti*

Before you move on

What does ఉడుత mean? (“a squirrel”.) Say it once more.

70.5 సాలీడు (*sālīḍu*) — a spider

Before the new one: what did *uduta* mean?

You'll want to know: సాలీడు

సాలీడు (*sālīḍu*) — “a spider”.

సాలీడు is a spider — the one in the corner where the గోడ meets the కప్పు.

It is inherited, and it is built on the old Telugu word for a weaver, so the name says what the creature does. The thread a person works with is దారం, which you already have.

Ask whether one has been swept out and the answer is a plain అవును or లేదు, which is where five small creatures have got you.

What you've built

Five: ఎలుక, కప్ప, దోమ, ఉడుత, సాలీడు. Everything small enough to share a house with.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sālīdu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *avunu* for the ones in your house and *lēdu* for the rest
- *Recall:* say *kaburu*, then read కర్మ and say what it means

Before you move on

What does సాలీడు mean? (“a spider”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

The Wider Family

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the family a Telugu marriage adds, and ask after each of them.

Complete TE-C71-son-in-law and demonstrate the chapter promise.

71.1 మామ (māma) — an uncle; a father-in-law

Before the new one: what did *sālīḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: మామ

మామ (*māma*) — “an uncle; a father-in-law”.

మామ is a mother's brother, and it is also a father-in-law. Telugu keeps one word for both because for a very long time they were often the same man.

That is the whole of it: a man's sister's daughter was the expected match for his son, so the uncle a child grew up with became the father-in-law they married into.

Asking after a మామ's ఆరోగ్యం is the first thing said after నమస్కారం in a house you have married into.

What you've built

One. And the reason Telugu needs fewer family words than you expect.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māma*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *māma*, then *ārōgyam*, as one question
- *Recall:* say *godḍali*, then read ఎలుక and say what it means

Before you move on

What does మామ mean? (“an uncle; a father-in-law”.) Say it once more.

71.2 అత్త (atta) — an aunt; a mother-in-law

Before the new one: what did *māma* mean?

You’ll want to know: అత్త

అత్త (*atta*) — “an aunt; a mother-in-law”.

అత్త is the మామ’s counterpart: a father’s sister, and a mother-in-law.

The same reasoning folds them together. She is the woman a child calls అత్త while growing up and the woman they answer to after marrying, and one word covers both lives.

It is inherited and it is among the oldest words in the family. The neighbouring languages all keep something very close to it.

What you’ve built

Two: మామ and అత్త, and they usually arrive as a pair.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *atta*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *māma*, then *atta*, and say which one is the mother-in-law
- *Recall:* read రంపం, then say *kappa*

Before you move on

What does అత్త mean? (“an aunt; a mother-in-law”.) Say it once more.

71.3 బావ (bāva) — a brother-in-law; a male cousin

Before the new one: what did *atta* mean?

You’ll want to know: బావ

బావ (bāva) — “a brother-in-law; a male cousin”.

బావ is a sister’s husband, a wife’s brother, and the మామ’s son — the cousin you might have married.

So the word covers a bond that is close, level and a little teasing. Two men who call each other బావ can joke in a way an అన్న and a తమ్ముడు cannot.

City Telugu now uses it for a friend, roughly where English says mate. That irritates some people and has stopped nobody.

What you’ve built

Three. The first one standing on level ground with you.

Your turn

- Say it: bāva
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: bāva, then māmā, and say which one is older
- Recall: say pāra, then read దోమ and say what it means

Before you move on

What does బావ mean? (“a brother-in-law; a male cousin”.) Say it once more.

71.4 మరదలు (maradalu) — a sister-in-law; a female cousin

Before the new one: what did *bāva* mean?

You'll want to know: మరదలు

మరదలు (*maradalu*) — “a sister-in-law; a female cousin”.

మరదలు is the బావ's counterpart on the other side: a wife's younger sister, a younger brother's wife, and the మామ's daughter — the cousin you might have married.

So it carries the same easy, teasing register that బావ does. A బావ and a మరదలు can joke across a room in a way an అన్న and a చెల్లి cannot, and Telugu films have lived off that for eighty years.

It is inherited, and it belongs to the same reckoning as the rest of this chapter: the person a marriage hands you was very often somebody the family already had a word for.

What you've built

Four. The one who matches బావ.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maradalu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *bāva*, then *maradalu*, and say which of the two is the woman
- *Recall:* read సుత్తి, then say *uḍuta*

Before you move on

What does మరదలు mean? (“a sister-in-law; a female cousin”.) Say it once more.

71.5 అల్లుడు (alluḍu) — a son-in-law

Before the new one: what did *maradalu* mean?

You'll want to know: అల్లుడు

అల్లుడు (*alludu*) — “a son-in-law”.

అల్లుడు is a daughter's husband — the మామ's word for the young man on the far side of the match.

He is treated as a guest for life. An అల్లుడు on a visit is fed first, seated first and asked after first, and the household's own people wait their turn.

Which is what the chapter has been building to: మామ, అత్త, బావ, మరదలు, అల్లుడు. Ask each of them how they are and you have done the whole visit properly.

What you've built

Five: మామ, అత్త, బావ, మరదలు, అల్లుడు. A marriage's worth of new people to ask after.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *alludu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *ārōgyam*, asking after the last of them
- *Recall:* say *karra*, then read సాలీడు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does అల్లుడు mean? (“a son-in-law”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 72

The Market

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can buy something in a Telugu shop, ask the price, and thank the seller.

Complete TE-C72-bargain and demonstrate the chapter promise.

72.1 అంగడి (aṅgaḍi) — a shop

Before the new one: what did *alluḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: అంగడి

అంగడి (*aṅgaḍi*) — “a shop”.

అంగడి is a shop — one counter, one family behind it, and everything a గ్రామం needs on the shelves.

It is inherited, and it is the older and homelier of the two words available. City Telugu will as often reach for a borrowed word for a store, but the అంగడి is the one at the end of the బాట.

You are known in an అంగడి. Nobody there opens with a price; they open by asking whether your household is well.

What you've built

One. The place the rest of this chapter happens in.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aṅgaḍi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *aṅgaḍi*, then *grāmami*, and say which one sits inside the other
- *Recall:* say *eluka*, then read మామ and say what it means

Before you move on

What does అంగడి mean? (“a shop”.) Say it once more.

72.2 డబ్బు (ḍabbu) — money

Before the new one: what did *aṅgaḍi* mean?

You’ll want to know: డబ్బు

డబ్బు (*ḍabbu*) — “money”.

డబ్బు is money. You have said it once already without being told what it was: డబ్బు లేదు, there is no money, turned up early as an example of how లేదు denies that a thing exists. Here is the word itself.

It is a borrowing, from the name of a small copper coin, and it travelled across the region on the coin’s back.

It is blunt and it is not rude. Asking whether somebody has డబ్బు today is an ordinary question in an అంగడి where the account is settled by the month.

What you’ve built

Two. And one of them you had already used once.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḍabbu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ḍabbu*, then *lēdu*, as the phrase you already knew
- *Recall:* read కప్ప, then say *atta*

Before you move on

What does డబ్బు mean? (“money”.) Say it once more.

72.3 ధర (dhara) — a price

Before the new one: what did *ḍabbu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ధర

ధర (*dhara*) — “a price”.

ధర is a price — what a thing costs, said out loud.

It is Sanskrit, from a sense of what holds a thing up, which is a fair picture of value. Telugu uses it for one thing’s price and for prices in general: when people say the ధర has gone up, they mean everything has.

Asking is direct and expected. Nobody in an అంగడి minds the question, and asking before you pick a thing up is politer than asking after.

What you’ve built

Three. The question you are allowed to ask first.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhara*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: dhara, then ḍabbu, in the order they come up*
- *Recall: say dōma, then read బావ and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does ధర mean? (“a price”.) Say it once more.

72.4 తూకం (tūkam) — weight

Before the new one: what did *dhara* mean?

You'll want to know: తూకం

తూకం (*tūkani*) — “weight”.

తూకం is weight — what the scales say, and also the act of weighing.

Almost everything in an అంగడి is sold by it: బియ్యం, ఉప్పు, చక్కెర, మిరప. The ధర you are quoted is a ధర for a తూకం, so the two words travel together.

It carries fairness as well. Somebody who speaks with తూకం is somebody whose words are measured, and short తూకం is a serious accusation.

What you've built

Four. What the ధర is attached to.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tūkani*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *tūkani*, then *dhara*, as one question in a shop
- *Recall:* read ఉడుత, then say *maradalu*

Before you move on

What does తూకం mean? (“weight”.) Say it once more.

72.5 బేరం (*bērami*) — a bargain, haggling

Before the new one: what did *tūkani* mean?

You'll want to know: బేరం

బేరం (*bērami*) — “a bargain, haggling”.

బేరం is the haggle — the back and forth between the ధర asked and the ధర paid, and also the deal that comes out of it.

It is expected in an open market crowd and out of place in a fixed-price అంగడి, and telling those two apart is most of what a newcomer gets wrong.

However the బేరం ends, it ends with ధన్యవాదములు, and in a small అంగడి it ends with both sides fairly sure they did well out of it.

What you've built

Five: అంగడి, డబ్బు, ధర, తూకం, బేరం. Enough to buy something and thank the person who sold it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bēram*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then close with *dhanyavādamulu*
- *Recall:* say *sālīdu*, then read అల్లుడు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does బేరం mean? (“a bargain, haggling”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 73

Tastes

Modes: ⇌ voice (5) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the tastes of a Telugu meal and take my leave when it is finished.

Complete TE-C73-astringent and demonstrate the chapter promise.

73.1 తీపి (tīpi) — sweet, sweetness

Before the new one: what did *bērami* mean?

You'll want to know: తీపి

తీపి (*tīpi*) — “sweet, sweetness”.

తీపి is sweetness — the taste, and the quality of anything that has it.

It is inherited. చక్కెర gives it in a kitchen and a పండు gives it on a చెట్టు, and a person described as తీపి is being called good company.

Telugu counts its tastes rather than gesturing at them, and తీపి is the one every count opens with.

What you've built

One. The taste every count opens with.

Your turn

- Say it: *tīpi*
- Say it: it once more, slowly

- *Say it:* *tīpi*, then *cakkerā*, and say which one is the taste
- *Recall:* say *māma*, then read అంగడి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does తీపి mean? (“sweet, sweetness”.) Say it once more.

73.2 పులుపు (pulupu) — sour, sourness

Before the new one: what did *tīpi* mean?

You’ll want to know: పులుపు

పులుపు (*pulupu*) — “sour, sourness”.

పులుపు is sourness — tamarind, lime, పెరుగు left a day too long.

It is inherited and it is not a complaint. A Telugu meal wants పులుపు in it on purpose; the everyday tamarind stew is built around exactly this taste.

Said of a face it means what it means in English, and it is said most often of children who have just been told no.

What you’ve built

Two: తీపి and పులుపు, and a meal wants both of them.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pulupu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *tīpi*, then *pulupu*, and say which one is in curd
- *Recall:* read అత్త, then say *ḍabbu*

Before you move on

What does పులుపు mean? (“sour, sourness”.) Say it once more.

73.3 చేదు (cēdu) — bitter, bitterness

Before the new one: what did *pulupu* mean?

You’ll want to know: చేదు

చేదు (*cēdu*) — “bitter, bitterness”.

చేదు is bitterness — neem leaf, some greens, most medicine.

It is inherited, and Telugu does not treat it as a fault. Bitter is eaten deliberately at the opening of the year and at the opening of a meal, on the understanding that it does you good.

It carries over into speech unchanged. చేదు news is bad news, and a చేదు truth is one you are told anyway.

What you’ve built

Three. The one eaten on purpose.

Your turn

- *Say it: cēdu*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: cēdu, then t̄ipi, and say which one is eaten first*
- *Recall: say bāva, then read ధర and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does చేదు mean? (“bitter, bitterness”.) Say it once more.

73.4 కారం (kāraṁ) — pungency, heat

Before the new one: what did *cēdu* mean?

You’ll want to know: కారం

కారం (*kāraṁ*) — “pungency, heat”.

కారం is heat — the bite of మిరప, and by an easy extension the chilli powder itself.

Ask for something with తక్కువ కారం and you will be understood anywhere, though in one or two households you will be heard as having said something mildly insulting.

It is inherited. Do not read it into the end of నమస్కారం, which is a different word altogether, Sanskrit, and means a making.

What you've built

Four. And the one you may want తక్కువ of.

Your turn

- Say it: *kārami*
- Say it: it once more, slowly
- Say it: *kārami*, then *takkuva* and *kārami* together
- Recall: read మరదలు, then say *tūkami*

Before you move on

What does కారం mean? (“pungency, heat”.) Say it once more.

73.5 వగరు (vagaru) — astringent

Before the new one: what did *kārami* mean?

You'll want to know: వగరు

వగరు (*vagaru*) — “astringent”.

వగరు is astringency — the dry, puckering taste of an unripe పండు, of raw banana, of తీపి left to stand.

English has no everyday word for it and Telugu has had one for as long as it has been written down. Once you can name it you begin noticing it, which is most of what a word is for.

With ఉప్పు, which you already have, that is the full set a Telugu cook thinks in: తీపి, పులుపు, చేదు, కారం, వగరు and salt. A meal carrying all of them is finished, and so is the visit — వెళ్ళొస్తాను.

What you've built

Five: తీపి, పులుపు, చేదు, కారం, వగరు. The tastes a Telugu meal is built from, and the last of them names what nothing else does.

Your turn

- *Say it: vagaru*
- *Say it: it once more, slowly*
- *Say it: all five in order, then take your leave with vellōstānu*
- *Recall: say alluḍu, then read బేరం and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does వగరు mean? (“astringent”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 74

And, But, Or

Modes: ⇐ voice (4) 👁 eyes (1) ⇐ Hands-free start: first 4 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can join two Telugu words or two Telugu clauses, and I can ask why and answer it.

Complete TE-C74-because and demonstrate the chapter promise.

74.1 మరియు (mariyu) — and

Before the new one: what did *vagaru* mean?

You'll want to know: మరియు

మరియు (*mariyu*) — “and”.

Telugu's everyday speech often joins two things by simply saying them one after the other, or by hanging a small -ఉ on the end of each. మరియు is the written, spoken-carefully form, and it is the one a list on a page will use.

Put it between two nouns you already have: నీళ్ళు మరియు పాలు — “water and milk”.

What you've built

The first way you have had to put two things in one sentence.

Your turn

- Say it: mariyu

- *Say it: mariyu*, once more
- *Say it: join two words you know with mariyu*
- *Recall: say dayacēsi*, then say *mariyu*
- *Recall: say aṅgaḍi*, then read తీపి and say what it means

Before you move on

What does మరియు mean? (“and”.) Say it once more.

74.2 కానీ (kānī) — but

Before the new one: what did *mariyu* mean?

You’ll want to know: కానీ

కానీ (kānī) — “but”.

కానీ turns a sentence around. Where మరియు adds, కానీ takes back: it warns the listener that what comes next does not match what came before.

నాకు టీ ఇష్టం, కానీ పాలు వద్దు — “I like tea, but no milk.” This one word is what lets you disagree politely instead of only saying లేదు.

What you’ve built

Two clauses, and a way to set the second against the first.

Your turn

- *Say it: kānī*
- *Say it: kānī*, once more
- *Say it: say something you like, then kānī, then something about it you do not*
- *Recall: say kṣamin̄caṇḍi*, then say *kānī*
- *Recall: read డబ్బు*, then say *pulupu*

Before you move on

What does కానీ mean? (“but.”) Say it once more.

74.3 లేదా (lēdā) — or

Before the new one: what did *kānī* mean?

You’ll want to know: లేదా

లేదా (*lēdā*) — “or”.

You have met its first half already: లే- is the same root behind లేదు, “there isn’t”. లేదా is literally the *or-else* of that root — “failing that”.

టీ లేదా పాలు? — “tea or milk?” That is the whole of an offered choice, and you can now make one.

What you’ve built

A choice you can put to somebody.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *lēdā*
- *Say it:* *lēdā*, once more
- *Say it:* offer a choice between two drinks you know, using *lēdā*
- *Recall:* say *anukō*, then say *lēdā*
- *Recall:* say *dhara*, then read చేదు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does లేదా mean? (“or.”) Say it once more.

74.4 ఎందుకు (enduku) — why?

Before the new one: what did *lēdā* mean?

You'll want to know: ఎందుకు

ఎందుకు (*enduku*) — “why?”.

Another word off the ఎ- question row you already know: ఎక్కడ “where”, ఎవరు “who”, and now ఎందుకు “why”. The row keeps its shape and you keep getting the words free.

It goes where its answer goes, not at the front: మీరు ఎందుకు వెళ్ళారు? — “why do you go?”

What you've built

The question the next word answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: enduku*
- *Say it: enduku, once more*
- *Say it: ask enduku about something somebody just told you*
- *Recall: say aḍugu, then say enduku*
- *Recall: read తూకం, then say kārami*

Before you move on

What does ఎందుకు mean? (“why?”.) Say it once more.

74.5 ఎందుకంటే (*endukaṇṭē*) — because

Before the new one: what did *enduku* mean?

You'll want to know: ఎందుకంటే

ఎందుకంటే (*endukaṇṭē*) — “because”.

Look at it: it *is* ఎందుకు with అంటే glued on — “if you ask why”. Telugu answers the question by repeating it and then continuing, which is the gluing habit of your very first lesson doing real work.

నేను వెళ్ళాను, ఎందుకంటే పని ఉంది — “I’ll go, because there is work.”

Grammar Lens: the reason clause comes second

Telugu can put the reason first, as పని ఉంది కాబట్టి నేను వెళ్తాను. With ఎందుకంటే it goes second, after the thing being explained, exactly where English puts it. Use ఎందుకంటే while that ordering is still the one you think in.

What you've built

A reason, attached to the thing it explains.

Your turn

- *Say it: endukaṇṭē*
- *Say it: endukaṇṭē*, once more
- *Say it:* answer an *enduku* question with *endukaṇṭē* and one word you know
- *Recall:* say *ganṭa*, then say *endukaṇṭē*
- *Recall:* say *bērami*, then read వగరు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఎందుకంటే mean? (“because”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 75

Today, Yesterday, When

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say today, yesterday and before in Telugu, ask when something happens, and name a year.

Complete TE-C75-year and demonstrate the chapter promise.

75.1 ఇవాళ (ivāḷa) — today

Before the new one: what did *endukaṇṭē* mean?

You'll want to know: ఇవాళ

ఇవాళ (*ivāḷa*) — “today”.

The farewells gave you రేపు, “tomorrow”, inside రేపు కలుద్దాం. The day you are actually standing in had no name until now.

It begins with the same ఇ- as ఇక్కడ and ఇది: the near one, the one right here. ఇవాళ is the near day.

What you've built

The day you are in.

Your turn

- Say it: *ivāḷa*
- Say it: *ivāḷa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *ivāḷa*, then *rēpu*, and say which is nearer
- *Recall:* say *bhōjanam*, then say *ivāḷa*
- *Recall:* say *tīpi*, then read మరియు and say what it means

Before you move on

What does ఇవాళ mean? (“today”.) Say it once more.

75.2 నిన్న (ninna) — yesterday

Before the new one: what did *ivāḷa* mean?

You’ll want to know: నిన్న

నిన్న (*ninna*) — “yesterday”.

With ఇవాళ and రేపు you now have the three days every conversation stands on, and నిన్న is the only one that looks backward.

It is native Dravidian and short, with the doubled న్న you have seen in ఉన్నాను.

What you’ve built

Three days: నిన్న, ఇవాళ, రేపు.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ninna*
- *Say it:* *ninna*, once more
- *Say it:* say the three days in order: *ninna*, *ivāḷa*, *rēpu*
- *Recall:* say *vātāvaraṇam*, then say *ninna*
- *Recall:* read పులుపు, then say *kānī*

Before you move on

What does నిన్న mean? (“yesterday”.) Say it once more.

75.3 ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు? (eppuḍu vastāru?) — when will you come?

Before the new one: what did *ninna* mean?

You'll want to know: ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు?

ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు? (*eppuḍu vastāru?*) — “when will you come?”. The new word in it is ఎప్పుడు, “when?”.

The last gap in the ఎ- question row: ఎక్కడ where, ఎవరు who, ఎందుకు why, and now ఎప్పుడు when. The row is complete.

The three days you just learned are its answers, and మీరు in front of it makes the question respectful.

What you've built

The question the three days answer.

Your turn

- *Say it: eppuḍu*
- *Say it: eppuḍu, once more*
- *Say it: ask eppuḍu, then answer it with ivāḷa*
- *Recall: say rātri, then say eppuḍu vastāru?*
- *Recall: say cēdu, then read లేదా and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు? mean? (“when will you come?”.) Say it once more.

75.4 ముందు (mundu) — before, in front

Before the new one: what did *eppuḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: ముందు

ముందు (*mundu*) — “before”.

You already have తరువాత, “after that”. ముందు is its other half, and until now you could only order events one way.

Like most Telugu relation words it follows its noun: భోజనం ముందు — “before the meal”. It also means “in front” in space, which is the same idea pointed at a room instead of a day.

What you've built

Both ends of an order: ముందు and తరువాత.

Your turn

- Say it: *mundu*
- Say it: *mundu*, once more
- Say it: say *mundu*, then *taruvāta*, and put a meal between them
- Recall: say *mariyu*, then *udayam*, then say *mundu*
- Recall: read కారం, then say *enduku*

Before you move on

What does ముందు mean? (“before, in front”.) Say it once more.

75.5 సంవత్సరం (*sanivatsaram*) — a year

Before the new one: what did *mundu* mean?

You'll want to know: సంవత్సరం

సంవత్సరం (*sanivatsaram*) — “a year”.

A Sanskrit tatsama, wearing the same -ం ending you have seen on ఉదయం and భోజనం. Telugu also says ఏడు for a year of age, but సంవత్సరం is the plain calendar word.

You now have the hour (గంట), the day (రోజు), the month (నెల) and the year — the whole ladder of Telugu time.

What you've built

The largest unit of time you can name.

Your turn

- *Say it: samivatsarami*
- *Say it: samivatsarami, once more*
- *Say it: say gaṇṭa, then rōju, then samivatsarami, smallest to largest*
- *Recall: say kānī, then sāyantram, then say samivatsarami*
- *Recall: say vagaru, then read ఎందుకంటే and say what it means*

Before you move on

What does సంవత్సరం mean? (“a year”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 76

Very Good, Very Bad

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that something is very good, bad, easy or difficult in Telugu, and make an adjective the whole comment.

Complete TE-C76-difficult and demonstrate the chapter promise.

76.1 చాలా మంచి (cālā manci) — very good

Before the new one: what did *saṁvatsarami* mean?

You'll want to know: చాలా మంచి

చాలా మంచి (cālā manci) — “very good”. The new word in it is చాలా, “very, a lot”.

Until now every adjective you had was flat: పెద్ద was big and there was no bigger. చాలా is the dial.

It stands in front of what it strengthens: చాలా పెద్ద “very big”, చాలా కొత్త “very new”. It also works on its own for “a lot”, where కొంచెం was “a little”.

What you've built

A degree, on any adjective you have.

Your turn

- Say it: cālā

- *Say it:* *cālā*, once more
- *Say it:* put *cālā* in front of *manci*, then in front of *pedda*
- *Recall:* say *lēdā*, then *madhyāhnam*, then say *cālā manci*

Before you move on

What does చాలా మంచి mean? (“very good”.) Say it once more.

76.2 చెడ్డ (ceḍḍa) — bad

Before the new one: what did *cālā* mean?

You’ll want to know: చెడ్డ

చెడ్డ (*ceḍḍa*) — “bad”.

మంచి, “good”, has stood without an opposite ever since the adjectives chapter. చెడ్డ is the opposite.

It sits in front of its noun and does not change, exactly as మంచి does. Do not reach for చేదు from the last chapter: that is *bitter*, a taste, and it does not judge anything.

What you’ve built

Both ends of the judgement: మంచి and చెడ్డ.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ceḍḍa*
- *Say it:* *ceḍḍa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manci*, then *ceḍḍa*, then *cālā ceḍḍa*
- *Recall:* say *enduku*, then *śubhodayam*, then say *ceḍḍa*

Before you move on

What does చెడ్డ mean? (“bad”.) Say it once more.

76.3 మంచిది (mancidi) — it is a good one

Before the new one: what did *cedḍa* mean?

You'll want to know: మంచిది

మంచిది (*mancidi*) — “it is a good one”.

You could already say మంచి పుస్తకం, “a good book”. You could not yet say that the book *is* good, because a Telugu adjective cannot end a sentence by itself.

Add -ది and it becomes a thing: మంచి + ది = “a good one”. పుస్తకం మంచిది — “the book is a good one”, which is how Telugu says “the book is good”.

Grammar Lens: -ది turns a describing word into a naming word

Telugu will not let a bare adjective be the predicate. -ది makes it one — a pronoun-like ending meaning “the one that is”. మంచిది “a good one”, చెడ్డది “a bad one”, కొత్తది “a new one”. For a person the ending is -వాడు or -ఆమె instead. Learn -ది now and every adjective you already have can finish a sentence.

What you've built

An adjective that can be the whole comment.

Your turn

- Say it: *mancidi*
- Say it: *mancidi*, once more
- Say it: say *manci pustakam*, then *pustakam mancidi*
- Recall: say *endukaṇṭē*, then *rāyu*, then say *mancidi*

Before you move on

What does మంచిది mean? (“it is a good one”.) Say it once more.

76.4 సులభం (sulabham) — easy

Before the new one: what did *mancidi* mean?

You'll want to know: సులభం

సులభం (*sulabham*) — “easy”.

Sanskrit సు- (“well”) plus లభ (“got”): what is easily got. The same సు- is the శు- of శుభోదయం, softened.

తెలుగు సులభం — “Telugu is easy.” A -ం noun like this needs no -ది; it is already a naming word.

What you've built

A verdict you can pass on a task.

Your turn

- Say it: *sulabham*
- Say it: *sulabham*, once more
- Say it: say *telugu sulabham*, then add *cālā* in front of *sulabham*
- Recall: say *ivāḷa*, then *tīśukō*, then say *sulabham*

Before you move on

What does సులభం mean? (“easy.”) Say it once more.

76.5 కష్టం (kaṣṭam) — difficult; trouble

Before the new one: what did *sulabham* mean?

You'll want to know: కష్టం

కష్టం (*kaṣṭam*) — “difficult”, and also “trouble, hardship”.

The pair to సులభం, and a Sanskrit tatsama shared right across India.

It carries more weight than English “difficult”: కష్టం said alone about someone's situation means real hardship, not an awkward crossword.

What you've built

Both ends of a task: సులభం and కష్టం.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṣṭam*
- *Say it: kaṣṭam*, once more
- *Say it: say sulabham, then kaṣṭam, then cālā kaṣṭam*
- *Recall: say ninna, then kuṭumbam, then say kaṣṭam*

Before you move on

What does కష్టం mean? (“difficult; trouble”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 77

Where You Are From

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say which town and country I am from in Telugu, count past twenty, and give my age.

Complete TE-C77-thirty and demonstrate the chapter promise.

77.1 నుంచి (nunci) — from

Before the new one: what did *kaṣṭam* mean?

You'll want to know: నుంచి

నుంచి (*nunci*) — “from”.

You already have -కు, “to”, and -లో, “in”. నుంచి is the third of the set and the one an introduction needs.

Like them it follows its noun: గ్రామం నుంచి — “from the village”.

Grammar Lens: the third relation word

Three now sit behind a noun and do three different jobs: -లో puts you inside, -కు sends you toward, నుంచి takes you out of. Telugu has no words in front of nouns at all; everything a preposition would do in English is done by a piece glued to the back.

What you've built

The direction you came out of.

Your turn

- *Say it: nunci*
- *Say it: nunci*, once more
- *Say it: say grāmamī nunci*, then *grāmānīki* — out of, and into
- *Recall: say eppuḍu vastāru?*, then *snēhituḍu*, then say *nunci*

Before you move on

What does నుంచి mean? (“from”.) Say it once more.

77.2 పట్టణం (paṭṭaṇam) — a town

Before the new one: what did *nunci* mean?

You’ll want to know: పట్టణం

పట్టణం (*paṭṭaṇam*) — “a town”.

You already have గ్రామం, the village. పట్టణం is the larger settlement, the one with the shops and the bargaining in it.

నేను పట్టణం నుంచి — “I am from a town.” That sentence needs no verb, exactly like నా పేరు.

What you’ve built

Somewhere to be from.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭṭaṇam*
- *Say it: paṭṭaṇam*, once more
- *Say it: say grāmamī*, then *paṭṭaṇamī*, and say which is bigger
- *Recall: say mundu*, then *koḍuku*, then say *paṭṭaṇamī*

Before you move on

What does పట్టణం mean? (“a town”.) Say it once more.

77.3 దేశం (dēśam) — a country

Before the new one: what did *paṭṭaṇam* mean?

You'll want to know: దేశం

దేశం (*dēśam*) — “a country”.

Sanskrit tatsama, and the same word behind Hindi *desh*. It scales the ladder up once more: గ్రామం, పట్టణం, దేశం.

ఏ దేశం? — “which country?” is a question you will be asked in the first minute of any exam interview.

What you've built

The largest place you can be from.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēśam*
- *Say it: dēśam*, once more
- *Say it: say grāmaṁ, paṭṭaṇam, dēśam*, smallest to largest
- *Recall: say samvatsaram, then kūṭuru, then say dēśam*

Before you move on

What does దేశం mean? (“a country”.) Say it once more.

77.4 భారతదేశం (Bhāratadēśam) — India

Before the new one: what did *dēśam* mean?

You'll want to know: భారతదేశం

భారతదేశం (*Bhāratadēśam*) — “India”.

Your first Telugu proper name, and you can already read half of it: భారత plus the దేశం you learned a moment ago.

నేను భారతదేశం నుంచి — “I am from India.” Swap in the name of wherever you are actually from and the sentence still works.

What you've built

A place with a name, in a sentence that says you came from it.

Your turn

- *Say it: Bhāratadēśam*
- *Say it: Bhāratadēśam*, once more
- *Say it: say nēnu Bhāratadēśam nunci*, then say it with your own country instead
- *Recall: say cālā manci*, then *cevi*, then say *Bhāratadēśam*

Before you move on

What does భారతదేశం mean? (“India”.) Say it once more.

77.5 ముప్పై (muppai) — thirty (and the tens above it)

Before the new one: what did *Bhāratadēśam* mean?

You'll want to know: ముప్పై

ముప్పై (*muppai*) — “thirty”.

Your counting stopped at ఇరవై, twenty. The tens above it are built the same way, from the units you already know:

ముప్పై 30, నలభై 40, యాభై 50, అరవై 60, డెబ్బై 70, ఎనభై 80, తొమ్మిది 90, వంద 100. Every one but వంద ends in the same -వై twenty does.

Grammar Lens: an age, at last

You have long been able to ask నీ వయసెంత? and unable to answer it, because the numbers stopped at twenty and no word for a year existed. With the tens and with సంవత్సరం, the answer is now sayable: నాకు ముప్పై సంవత్సరాలు — “I am thirty”, literally “to me, thirty years”. Note the dative నాకు: an age is something that has arrived at you, like every other Telugu experience.

What you've built

Numbers past twenty: an age, a price, a year.

Your turn

- *Say it: muppai*
- *Say it: muppai*, once more
- *Say it*: count the tens aloud: *iravai*, *muppai*, *nalabhai*
- *Recall*: say *cedda*, then *kannu*, then say *muppai*

Before you move on

What does ముప్పై mean? (“thirty (and the tens above it).”) Say it once more.

Chapter 78

Yes or No, and I Do Not Know

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask a Telugu yes-or-no question, say I do not know, say I did not understand, and ask whether somebody is there.

Complete TE-C78-is there and demonstrate the chapter promise.

78.1 అవునా (avunā) — is it so?

Before the new one: what did *muppai* mean?

You'll want to know: అవునా

అవునా (*avunā*) — “is it so?”.

Every question you have asked so far needed a question *word*. This one needs none: take అవును, “yes”, and add -అ.

That -అ is the whole yes-or-no machine. Hang it on the end of any statement and it becomes a question.

Grammar Lens: -అ makes any statement a question

మీరు వెళ్తారు “you go” becomes మీరు వెళ్తారా? “do you go?”. తెలుగు కష్టం becomes తెలుగు కష్టమా?. Nothing moves and no word is added: the last vowel lengthens into అ and the sentence is a question. This is the commonest question type in any listening paper, and it is one ending.

What you've built

A question with no question word in it.

Your turn

- *Say it: avunā*
- *Say it: avunā, once more*
- *Say it: say avunu, then avunā, and hear the difference*
- *Recall: say mancidi, then mukku, then say avunā*

Before you move on

What does అవునా mean? (“is it so?”.) Say it once more.

78.2 తెలుసా (telusā) — do you know?

Before the new one: what did *avunā* mean?

You'll want to know: తెలుసా

తెలుసా (telusā) — “do you know?”

The first thing you will do with the new ending. You already have తెలుసు, “it is known”; add -అ and you are asking.

మీకు తెలుగు తెలుసా? — “do you know Telugu?” The knower sits in the dative మీకు, the way it did when you first met తెలుసు.

What you've built

A real question, built from a word you already had.

Your turn

- *Say it: telusā*
- *Say it: telusā, once more*
- *Say it: ask mīku telugu telusā?*
- *Recall: say sulabhami, then nōru, then say telusā*

Before you move on

What does తెలుసా mean? (“do you know?”.) Say it once more.

78.3 నాకు తెలియదు (nāku teliyadu) — I do not know

Before the new one: what did *telusā* mean?

You’ll want to know: నాకు తెలియదు

తెలియదు (*teliyadu*) — “it is not known”, which is Telugu for “I don’t know”.

This is the answer to the last word, and it is probably the sentence you will need most often of anything in this book.

It is not తెలుసు with లేదు after it. Telugu negates an ordinary verb from the inside, with -అదు on the stem: తెలియ- + -దు.

Grammar Lens: how Telugu says a verb did not happen

The two negatives of your first lesson, లేదు and కాదు, deny **existence** and **identity**. An ordinary action is denied differently — with an ending on the verb itself: వెళ్ళాను “I go” becomes వెళ్ళును “I don’t go”; వస్తాను becomes రాను. The ending carries the negative and no separate word is used. తెలియదు is that pattern on తెలియ-.

What you’ve built

The most useful sentence in the chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *teliyadu*
- Say it: *teliyadu*, once more
- Say it: answer *māku telugu telusā?* with *teliyadu*
- Recall: say *kaṣṭam*, then *guṇḍe*, then say *nāku teliyadu*

Before you move on

What does నాకు తెలియదు mean? (“I do not know”.) Say it once more.

78.4 అర్థం కాలేదు (artham̐ kālēdu) — I did not understand

Before the new one: what did *teliyadu* mean?

You’ll want to know: అర్థం కాలేదు

అర్థం కాలేదు (*artham̐ kālēdu*) — “I did not understand”.

You already have నాకు అర్థమైంది, “I understood” — literally “to me it became meaning”. This is the same sentence with the becoming denied: కా- “become” plus లేదు.

Say it, and the person you are talking to will slow down. That is the whole point of a repair phrase.

What you’ve built

A way out of the moment you lose the thread.

Your turn

- Say it: *artham̐ kālēdu*
- Say it: *artham̐ kālēdu*, once more
- Say it: say *nāku arthamaindi*, then *artham̐ kālēdu*
- Recall: say *nunci*, then *hṛdayam̐*, then say *artham̐ kālēdu*

Before you move on

What does అర్థం కాలేదు mean? (“I did not understand”.) Say it once more.

78.5 ఉన్నారా (unnārā) — is he or she there?

Before the new one: what did *artham̐ kālēdu* mean?

You'll want to know: ఉన్నారా

ఉన్నారా (*unnārā*) — “is he or she there?”.

ఉండు in its respectful -ఆరు form, with the new -ఆ on the end. Three pieces you already had.

It is what you say at a door or into a telephone: గురువు ఉన్నారా? — “is the teacher there?”

What you've built

A question you can ask at somebody's door.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *unnārā*
- *Say it:* *unnārā*, once more
- *Say it:* ask whether the teacher is there
- *Recall:* say *paṭṭaṇam*, then *pālu*, then say *unnārā*

Before you move on

What does ఉన్నారా mean? (“is he or she there?”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 79

He, She, and Whose

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can talk about a third person in Telugu, mark a noun as an owner or an object, and address somebody respectfully.

Complete TE-C79-garu and demonstrate the chapter promise.

79.1 స్నేహితుడి (snēhituḍi) — the friend's

Before the new one: what did *unnārā* mean?

You'll want to know: స్నేహితుడి

స్నేహితుడి (*snēhituḍi*) — “the friend's”.

నా and నీ let you own things as *I* and *you*. Nothing let a named person own anything.

A Telugu noun becomes an owner by changing its own ending: స్నేహితుడు → స్నేహితుడి. స్నేహితుడి పేరు — “the friend's name”.

Grammar Lens: the noun changes shape before it does a job

Watch the shape of the noun, not just the ending. స్నేహితుడు stands on its own; స్నేహితుడి is the form that owns something. The ending does not land on the dictionary form — the noun leans toward it first, and you have already seen the same lean in నేను becoming నాకు. Look for it in front of -కు and -లో as well.

What you've built

Possession by somebody other than you or me.

Your turn

- *Say it: snēhituḍi*
- *Say it: snēhituḍi*, once more
- *Say it: say nā pēru*, then *snēhituḍi pēru*
- *Recall: say dēśam*, then *mariyu*, then *cūḍu*, then say *snēhituḍi*

Before you move on

What does స్నేహితుడి mean? (“the friend’s”.) Say it once more.

79.2 మా (mā) — our (not including you)

Before the new one: what did *snēhituḍi* mean?

You'll want to know: మా

మా (*mā*) — “our”, and మన (*mana*) — “our” as well.

Telugu splits a word English does not. మా leaves the listener out: my family, not yours. మన takes the listener in: our country, yours and mine.

మా ఇల్లు is my household. మన దేశం is the country we share. Choosing wrong is the mistake an examiner hears first.

What you've built

Two kinds of *our*, and the difference between them.

Your turn

- *Say it: mā*
- *Say it: mana*
- *Say it: say mā kuṭumbam*, then *mana dēśam*
- *Recall: say Bhāratadēśam*, then *kānī*, then *rā*, then say *mā*

Before you move on

What does మా mean? (“our (not including you).”) Say it once more.

79.3 అతను (atanu) — he (and ఆమె, she)

Before the new one: what did *mā* and *mana* mean?

You’ll want to know: అతను

అతను (*atanu*) — “he”, ఆమె (*āme*) — “she”, వాళ్ళు (*vāḷḷu*) — “they”.

Until now you could speak about yourself and to one other person. You could not speak *about* anybody, which is half of what an exam asks you to do.

All three start on the అ- of అది and అక్కడ: the far one, the one not here. అతను is literally “that man”.

Grammar Lens: the third person is where Telugu marks gender

You were told Telugu marks no gender on **I** or **you**, and that is still true. The third person is the exception: అతను వెళ్తాడు “he goes” ends in -అడు, ఆమె వెళ్తుంది “she goes” ends in -ఉంది, and వాళ్ళు వెళ్తారు “they go” takes the same -అరు you already use for మీరు. Three endings, and the verb tells you who without the pronoun.

What you’ve built

Somebody to talk about.

Your turn

- Say it: *atanu*
- Say it: *āme*
- Say it: say *atanu*, *āme*, *vāḷḷu*
- Recall: say *muppai*, then *lēdā*, then *caduvu*, then say *atanu*

Before you move on

What does అతను mean? (“he (and ఆమె, she).”) Say it once more.

79.4 నన్ను (nannu) — me (as the object)

Before the new one: what did *atanu* mean?

You'll want to know: నన్ను

నన్ను (*nannu*) — “me”, when I am the one something is done to.

నేను is the *I* that does. నన్ను is the *me* that is done to: అతను నన్ను అడిగాడు — “he asked me”.

The ending is -ను, and its partner -ని does the same on other nouns: స్నేహితుడిని అడిగాను, “I asked the friend”.

Grammar Lens: people get marked, things usually do not

స్నేహితుడిని చూశాను — “I saw the friend”, with -ని on the person.
పుస్తకం చూశాను — “I saw the book”, with nothing on the thing. Telugu marks a human object and leaves an inanimate one bare, which is very close to what Spanish does with its personal *a*. Mark people; leave objects alone.

What you've built

A pronoun on the receiving end.

Your turn

- Say it: *nannu*
- Say it: *nannu*, once more
- Say it: say *nēnu*, then *nannu*, and say which one is asked
- Recall: say *avunā*, then *enduku*, then *vellu*, then say *nannu*

Before you move on

What does నన్ను mean? (“me (as the object)”). Say it once more.

79.5 గారు (gāru) — the respectful suffix on a name

Before the new one: what did *nannu* mean?

You'll want to know: గారు

గారు (*gāru*) — the respect you attach to a name.

It is not a word you say alone. It rides on the end of a name or a role: రాము గారు, గురువు గారు, అమ్మ గారు.

You have had మీరు from your first introduction for respect in the pronoun. గారు is respect in the *address*, and leaving it off where it belongs is heard as rudeness, not neutrality.

What you've built

A way to say somebody's name that does not sound blunt.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāru*
- *Say it: gāru, once more*
- *Say it: say guruvu gāru, then ammagāru*
- *Recall: say telusā, then endukaṇṭē, then rōju, then say gāru*

Before you move on

What does గారు mean? (“the respectful suffix on a name”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 80

Wanting, Allowing, Wishing

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🖱️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what I want in Telugu, report what I think, give or refuse permission, invite somebody in, and offer congratulations.

Complete TE-C80-congratulations and demonstrate the chapter promise.

80.1 నాకు కావాలి (nāku kāvāli) — I want it

Before the new one: what did *gāru* mean?

You'll want to know: నాకు కావాలి

నాకు కావాలి (*nāku kāvāli*) — “I want it”. The new word in it is కావాలి, “is wanted”.

You already have వద్దు, “no, I don’t want it”, which left you able to refuse a thing and unable to ask for one. కావాలి is the missing half.

నాకు టీ కావాలి — “I want tea.” The wanter sits in the dative నాకు, exactly like the knower of తెలుసు and the liker of ఇష్టం. It is the same Telugu design a fourth time.

What you’ve built

A request, and the opposite of వద్దు.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāvāli*
- *Say it: kāvāli*, once more
- *Say it: say nāku tī kāvāli*, then refuse it with *vaddu*
- *Recall: say nāku teliyadu*, then *ivāḷa*, then *telusu*, then say *nāku kāvāli*

Before you move on

What does నాకు కావాలి mean? (“I want it”.) Say it once more.

80.2 అని (ani) — that (reporting what was said or thought)

Before the new one: what did *kāvāli* mean?

You’ll want to know: అని

అని (*ani*) — the little word that closes a quotation.

You already have అనుకో, “to think”, with nothing it could think *about*. అని is what attaches a thought or a sentence to the verb.

It comes **after** what is being reported, not before it: తెలుగు సులభం అని అనుకుంటాను — “I think that Telugu is easy”, literally “Telugu-is-easy *that* I-think”.

Grammar Lens: Telugu quotes forwards, not backwards

English opens with *that* and then reports. Telugu reports and then closes with అని. The quoted sentence keeps its own shape completely — nothing inside it changes — and అని is the seam. Every reported thought, every reported question and every reported instruction in Telugu is built this way, so this one syllable opens the whole of indirect speech.

What you’ve built

A second clause, hanging off a verb of thinking or saying.

Your turn

- *Say it: ani*
- *Say it: ani*, once more
- *Say it: say telugu sulabham ani anukuntānu*
- *Recall: say artham kālēdu*, then *ninna*, then *uṇḍu*, then say *ani*

Before you move on

What does అని mean? (“that (reporting what was said or thought).”) Say it once more.

80.3 వెళ్ళవచ్చు (vellavaccu) — you may go

Before the new one: what did *ani* mean?

You’ll want to know: వెళ్ళవచ్చు

వచ్చు (*vaccu*) — “may”, “is allowed to”, and also “can”.

It is the same వచ్చు you met as “to come”, doing a second job: what *comes* to you is what you may do.

వెళ్ళవచ్చు — “you may go”. వెళ్ళవచ్చా? — “may I go?”, with the -ఆ of the last chapter. To refuse, the answer is వద్దు.

What you’ve built

Permission: asking for it, giving it, refusing it.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaccu*
- *Say it: vaccu*, once more
- *Say it: ask vellavaccā?*, then allow it, then refuse it
- *Recall: say unnārā*, then *eppuḍu vastāru?*, then *tinu*, then say *vellavaccu*

Before you move on

What does వెళ్ళవచ్చు mean? (“you may go”.) Say it once more.

80.4 లోపలికి రండి (lōpaliki raṇḍi) — please come in

Before the new one: what did *vaccu* mean?

You’ll want to know: లోపలికి రండి

రండి (*raṇḍi*) — “please come”.

రా was the blunt “come” you say to a friend. Add the respectful -అండి and it becomes what you say at your own door to anybody.

With స్వాగతం it is the whole of a Telugu welcome: రండి, స్వాగతం.

What you’ve built

An invitation, in the register you would actually use it in.

Your turn

- Say it: *raṇḍi*
- Say it: *raṇḍi*, once more
- Say it: say *raṇḍi*, then *svāgatani*, then *kūrcōṇḍi*
- Recall: say *snēhituḍi*, then *mundu*, then *ivvu*, then say *lōpaliki raṇḍi*

Before you move on

What does లోపలికి రండి mean? (“please come in”.) Say it once more.

80.5 శుభాకాంక్షలు (śubhākāṅkṣalu) — congratulations, good wishes

Before the new one: what did *raṇḍi* mean?

You'll want to know: శుభాకాంక్షలు

శుభాకాంక్షలు (*śubhākāṅkṣalu*) — “good wishes”, which is Telugu for “congratulations”.

You have been building it for six chapters without knowing. శుభ is the *auspicious* of శుభోదయం and శుభ రాత్రి; ఆకాంక్ష is a wish; -లు is the plural ending you met in your very first lesson.

జన్మదిన శుభాకాంక్షలు is “happy birthday”. Said alone it covers a wedding, an examination passed, a new house — anything worth marking.

What you've built

The last thing this book teaches you to say, and the kindest.

Your turn

- *Say it: śubhākāṅkṣalu*
- *Say it: śubhākāṅkṣalu*, once more
- *Say it: say śubhōdayam, then śubhākāṅkṣalu, and hear the śubha in both*
- *Recall: say mā, then samivatsaram, then ikkaḍa, then say śubhākāṅkṣalu*

Before you move on

What does శుభాకాంక్షలు mean? (“congratulations, good wishes”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 81

Counting in Order

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say first to fifth in Telugu, and make an ordinal from any number by dropping its final vowel and adding -va.

The five said in order, with only modati learned as a word and the other four made by the ending.

81.1 మొదటి (modaṭi) — first

A new kind of counting starts here, so the recalls come first, at the four growing distances this book measures.

- *Recall:* say *śubhākāṅkṣalu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *atanu* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *goḍḍali* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *atta* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *padakoṇḍu* and *iravai* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *kukka* and *pilli* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: మొదటి

మొదటి (*modaṭi*) — “first”.

ఒకటి, రెండు, మూడు answer **how many**. This word answers **which one in the line**, and Telugu keeps a second set of words for that job.

It goes straight in front of what it counts: మొదటి రోజు (*modaṭi rōju*), the first day; మొదటి పుస్తకం (*modaṭi pustakam*), the first book. Nothing changes on the noun.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

There is no ఒకటి in మొదటి, and there was never going to be. It is built on మొదలు (*modalu*), “**a beginning**” — so *modaṭi* means “of the beginning”, not “one-th”. You will also meet the bare మొదట (*modaṭa*), “at first”.

That is worth noticing because ఒకటి was already the maverick of the cardinals: Tamil says *onru*, Kannada *ondu*, Malayalam *onnu*, and Telugu alone says *okaṭi*. Now the number **one** turns out to be doubly on its own — the sisters do not share its cardinal, and Telugu does not build its ordinal on it either.

From two upward it is a different story, and the next lesson is where the rule starts.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *modaṭi*
- *modaṭi rōju* — the first day
- *okaṭi* is how many, *modaṭi* is which one

Before you move on

What does మొదటి mean? (**First** — which one in the line.) What word is it built on? (మొదలు, a beginning — **not** ఒకటి.) Say “the first day”. (మొదటి రోజు.)

81.2 రెండవ (reṇḍava) — second, and the swap behind all the rest

Recalls before the second ordinal, at the four measured distances.

- *Recall: say modati* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall: say nannu* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall: say rampani* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall: say bāva* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall: say the letter e* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall: say pacca and pasupu* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: రెండవ

రెండవ (reṇḍava) — “second”.

రెండవ రోజు (reṇḍava rōju) — the second day.

Grammar Lens: cardinal, minus its last vowel, plus -వ

Say them together and you can hear the join: రెండు → రెండవ.

Take the number you already have, take its final vowel off, and put -వ (-va) on the end. That is the whole of it, and it holds for every number from two upward. Nine ordinals for the price of one ending.

Telugu is doing here what the last lesson said it would not do for **one**: *modati* had no number to build on, and every ordinal from here does.

In speech you will also hear రెండో (reṇḍō), the same word ending in a long *ō* instead of -వ. It is the everyday spoken form; -వ is what you will see written.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *reṇḍava*

- the swap — *reṇḍu* → *reṇḍava*
- *reṇḍava rōju* — the second day

Before you move on

How is an ordinal made from two upward? (**Take the number, drop its final vowel, add -వ.**) Say the second day. (రెండవ రోజు.) And what will you hear instead in speech? (రెండో.)

81.3 మూడవ (mūḍava) — third

Recalls first, then the third.

- *Recall: say reṇḍava* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall: say gāru* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall: say pāra* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall: say maradalu* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall: say the letter ṇa* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall: say the letter ja* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: మూడవ

మూడవ (*mūḍava*) — “third”.

మూడు → మూడవ. The long *ū* stays long; only the ending changes.

మూడవ వారం (*mūḍava vāram*) — the third week.

Two numbers in a row have now taken the same ending, which is what a rule looks like from inside: not a statement, but the second time you were not surprised. The spoken form is మూడో (*mūḍō*), exactly as *reṇḍō* was.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mūḍava*
- the swap — *mūḍu* → *mūḍava*
- *mūḍava vāram* — the third week

Before you move on

Say the third. (మూడవ.) What happened to the long *ū*? (**Nothing** — only the ending changed.) And the spoken form? (మూడో.)

81.4 నాలుగవ (nālugaṇa) — fourth

Recalls first, then the fourth.

- *Recall*: say *mūḍava* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall*: say *nāku kāvāli* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall*: say *sutti* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *alluḍu* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall*: say *śubha rātri* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall*: say *śubha sāyantram* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: నాలుగవ

నాలుగవ (nālugaṇa) — “fourth”.

నాలుగు → నాలుగవ. Four syllables, and the swap is the same one: the final *u* goes, -వ arrives.

నాలుగవ సంవత్సరం (nālugaṇa sanivatsaram) — the fourth year.

This is the longest of the ten and it is no harder than the shortest, which is the practical point of a regular ending. Once you can count, you can order.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nālugaṇa*
- the swap — *nālugu* → *nālugaṇa*
- *nālugaṇa samivatsaram* — the fourth year

Before you move on

Say the fourth. (నాలుగవ.) What is the ending? (-వ, after the final vowel goes.) And say “the fourth year”. (నాలుగవ సంవత్సరం.)

81.5 ఐదవ (aidava) — fifth

Recalls first, then the fifth, which closes the chapter.

- *Recall*: say *nālugaṇa* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall*: say *ani* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall*: say *karra* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *aṅgaḍi* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall*: say *śubha madhyāhnam* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall*: say *when to use śubha madhyāhnam* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You’ll want to know: ఐదవ

ఐదవ (*aidava*) — “fifth”.

ఐదు → ఐదవ. The opening ఐ is untouched — it is a single letter in Telugu, not two — and only the final **u** is traded for -వ.

ఐదవ రోజు (*aidava rōju*) — the fifth day.

That is one to five in order. Say *modaṭi*, *reṇḍava*, *mūḍava*, *nālugaṇa*, *aidava*, and notice that only the first one had to be learned as a word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *aidava*
- the five in order — *modaṭi*, *reṇḍava*, *mūḍava*, *nālugaṇa*, *aidava*
- *aidava rōju* — the fifth day

Before you move on

Say the five in order. (***Modaṭi*, *reṇḍava*, *mūḍava*, *nālugaṇa*, *aidava*.**) How many of them had to be learned as separate words? (**One** — *modaṭi*.) And what did the other four need? (**The number, and -ṣ.**)

Chapter 82

Sixth to Eleventh

Modes: ⇄ voice (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can count in order all the way to tenth in Telugu and beyond it, because the ending that makes an ordinal does not stop at ten.

The ending taken past ten, which shows it was never a fact about the numbers one to ten but about numbers.

82.1 ఆరవ (ārava) — sixth

Recalls open the chapter, at the four measured distances.

- *Recall:* say *aidava* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *modaṭi* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *vellavaccu* — **R2**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *eluka* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ḍabbu* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *arthamī cēsukō* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *the letter tha* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: ఆరవ

ఆరవ (*ārava*) — “sixth”.

ఆరు → ఆరవ, and this is the shortest ordinal in the ten: three syllables, two of them the number itself.

ఆరవ రోజు (*ārava rōju*) — the sixth day.

The numbers six to ten were the ones the first numbers lesson called Telugu's wandering half, the place where it drifts furthest from Tamil and Kannada. The ordinal ending does not care. Whatever shape the cardinal arrived in, -వ goes on it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ārava*
- the swap — *āru* → *ārava*
- *ārava rōju* — the sixth day

Before you move on

Say the sixth. (ఆరవ.) What was traded for the ending? (**The final u of ఆరు.**) And does the ending change for the wandering half of the numbers? (**No** — it is the same -వ.)

82.2 ఏడవ (*ēḍava*) — seventh

Recalls first, then the seventh.

- *Recall*: say *ārava* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall*: say *reṇḍava* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall*: say *lōpaliki raṇḍi* — **R2**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall*: say *kappa* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *dhara* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance

- *Recall*: say *sahāyamī cēyu* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall*: say *nāku telugu iṣṭamī* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: ఏడవ

ఏడవ (*ēḍava*) — “seventh”.

ఏడు → ఏడవ. Hold the *ē* long — the letter ఏ is the long one, and its short partner ఎ is a different letter and a different word.

ఏడవ వారం (*ēḍava vāramī*) — the seventh week.

Seven weeks is a useful thing to be able to say and a good place to hear that the ordinal is doing work no cardinal can do: ఏడు వారం would be seven weeks, a quantity. ఏడవ వారం is the seventh one, a position.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ēḍava*
- the swap — *ēḍu* → *ēḍava*
- *ēḍu vāramī* is seven weeks; *ēḍava vāramī* is the seventh

Before you move on

Say the seventh. (ఏడవ.) Which vowel opens it, the long or the short one? (**The long ఏ.**) And what is the difference between ఏడు వారం and ఏడవ వారం? (**Seven weeks against the seventh week.**)

82.3 ఎనిమిదవ (enimidava) — eighth

Recalls first, then the eighth.

- *Recall*: say *ēḍava* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall*: say *mūḍava* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall*: say *śubhākāṅkṣalu* — **R2**, a second word from the same distance

- *Recall*: say *dōma* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *tūkani* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall*: say *dayacēsi tī* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall*: say *the vowel sign r* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: ఎనిమిదవ

ఎనిమిదవ (*enimidava*) — “eighth”.

ఎనిమిది → ఎనిమిదవ, and here the vowel that goes is an **i**, not a **u**. Every ordinal so far has traded a final *u*; this one and the next trade a final *i*, because that is what their cardinals happen to end in.

Which is the useful way to hold the rule: it is not “drop the *u*”, it is **drop whatever vowel is at the end**. The ending does not know which vowel it replaced.

Note the short ఎ at the front, against the long ఏ of the last lesson.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *enimidava*
- the swap — *enimidi* → *enimidava*, an *i* this time
- short ఎ here, long ఏ in *ēḍava*

Before you move on

Say the eighth. (ఎనిమిదవ.) Which vowel came off this time? (**An i**, not a *u*.) And how is the rule best held? (**Drop whatever final vowel is there.**)

82.4 తొమ్మిదవ (tommidava) — ninth

Recalls first, then the ninth.

- *Recall*: say *enimidava* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall*: say *nāluga* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall*: say *uḍuta* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *bērami* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall*: say *idi* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall*: say *adi* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: తొమ్మిదవ

తొమ్మిదవ (*tommidava*) — “**ninth**”.

తొమ్మిది → తొమ్మిదవ. The doubled *mm* in the middle is held, exactly as it is in the cardinal — the ending is added at the far end of the word and touches nothing on its way.

తొమ్మిదవ రోజు (*tommidava rōju*) — the ninth day.

Second *i*-ending in a row, and the same trade. One more and the ten are closed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tommidava* — hold the *mm*
- the swap — *tommidi* → *tommidava*
- *tommidava rōju* — the ninth day

Before you move on

Say the ninth. (తొమ్మిదవ.) What happens to the doubled *mm*? (**Nothing** — it is held, as in the cardinal.) And which vowel came off? (**The final i.**)

82.5 పదవ (padava) — tenth

Recalls first, then the tenth, which closes the series.

- *Recall: say tommidava — R1*, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall: say aidava — R2*, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall: say sālīḍu — R3*, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall: say tīpi — R3*, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall: say akkaḍa — R4*, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall: say evaru — R4*, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: పదవ

పదవ (*padava*) — “tenth”.

పది → పదవ. Two syllables become three, and the trade is the same one you have now made nine times.

పదవ సంవత్సరం (*padava samivatsarami*) — the tenth year.

That is the ten. Say them in order — *modaṭi*, *reṇḍava*, *mūḍava*, *nālu-gava*, *aidava*, *ārava*, *ēḍava*, *enimidava*, *tommidava*, *padava* — and count what you actually had to learn: **one word and one ending**. Latin needed ten separate words for the same stretch, and English still does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *padava*
- the ten in order, *modaṭi* to *padava*
- *padava samivatsarami* — the tenth year

Before you move on

Say the ten in order. (*Modaṭi* through *padava*.) How much had to be learned as separate words? (**One** — *modaṭi*.) And say “the tenth year”. (పదవ సంవత్సరం.)

82.6 పదకొండవ (padakoṇḍava) — the ending does not stop at ten

Recalls first, and then the last thing the chapter has to give.

- *Recall*: say *padava* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall*: say *āraṇa* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall*: say *māma* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *pulupu* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall*: say *ekkaḍa* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall*: say the *i-* / *a-* / *e-* pattern — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

Grammar Lens: every number you have, and every one you meet

పదకొండవ (*padakoṇḍava*) — “eleventh”.

పదకొండు → పదకొండవ. Nothing new: the same final vowel goes, the same -వ arrives.

That is the point of this last lesson. The ending was never a fact about the numbers one to ten; it is a fact about **numbers**. Take any Telugu number you know and it works:

number	ordinal
పదకొండు (11)	పదకొండవ
ఇరవై (20)	ఇరవయ్యవ

So there is no second list to learn above ten, and no list to learn below it either except the single word మొదటి. One irregular word, one

ending, and every position on the number line is sayable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *padakoṇḍava*
- the swap on a bigger number — *padakoṇḍu* → *padakoṇḍava*
- *modaṭi* is the only word; *-va* is the rest

Before you move on

Say the eleventh. (పదకొండవ.) How many separate ordinal words does Telugu have to be learned? (**One** — *modaṭi*.) And what makes all the others? (**The number, minus its final vowel, plus -వ.**)

Chapter 83

Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Passage

Modes:  voice (2)  eyes (1)  Hands-free start: none of the 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read a Telugu word downwards as well as along, read a sentence with no word for is, and hold a whole passage about one room without translating it word by word.

Twenty-five words about one room, carried by ఉంది and లేదు, with respect marked in the verb where the teacher gets ఉన్నారా and the farmer does not.

83.1 (reading) — six words, read down as well as along

Every word below you have written. Not one is new.

What is new is that nobody says them first.

Read this

పుస్తకం తలుపు కుర్చీ నది గాలి దీపం

Read down the list once, without stopping.

Again — and look at పుస్తకం and కుర్చీ. Something in each of them sits below the line rather than on it.

What to know first

Telugu stacks a consonant underneath its neighbour instead of putting it alongside. So a word can be two syllables wide and three levels deep.

A reader has to look down a word as well as along it, and that is the habit this list is for. నది and గాలి have nothing below; పుస్తకం has two things.

Six words, and the tall ones are not longer — they are deeper.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)

Which way does a Telugu word grow when it gets complicated?
(**Downwards.**)

83.2 (reading) — six lines, and no word for *is*

The last lesson gave you words. These put them into sentences.

Nothing here is new.

Read this

ఇది పుస్తకం. ఇది తలుపు. కుర్చీ ఇక్కడ. పుస్తకం సులభం. నిజం.
ఇవాళ.

Read down once, without stopping.

Again — and look for the verb in the first four lines.

What to know first

There is none. ఇది పుస్తకం is *this book* with nothing between them, and it is a complete sentence: *this is a book*.

Telugu does not say *is*. Two words placed together are already a statement, and a reader has to stop waiting for the word that joins them.

The last two lines are one word each and still complete. That is the same rule taken as far as it goes.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, in order, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)

What joins ఇది and పుస్తకం? (**Nothing** — and that is the sentence.)

83.3 (reading) — the first passage

Six words, then six lines. Now nine of them together, all about one room.

Twenty-five words, and not one of them is new.

Read this

ఇది పుస్తకం. పుస్తకం సులభం. ఇది తలుపు. కుర్చీ ఇక్కడ ఉంది.
దీపం ఇక్కడ ఉంది. గురువు ఇక్కడ ఉన్నారా? రైతు ఇక్కడ లేడు.
రెండవ పుస్తకం ఇక్కడ ఉంది. ఇవాళ చాలా సులభం.

Read it once without stopping. Do not translate as you go — let the sentences arrive.

Now read it again, and notice that every line is about the same place.

What to know first

That is not a stylistic choice. A language that has not yet taught you a word for *is* can still say ఉంది — *it exists here* — and లేదు — *it does not*. So the first passage a Telugu reader can hold is a room described from one spot: everything is here, or it is not.

ఉన్నారా? is the same word made into a question and made respectful at once, which is why the teacher gets it and the farmer does not. Telugu marks respect in the verb, and you have now read it doing so.

This is the first whole passage the book has asked you to hold at once, and it works because everything in it was paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the passage aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

What two words carry the whole passage? (ఉంది and లేదు — here, and not here.)

Why does the teacher get ఉన్నారా? (Respect lives in the verb.)

Chapter 84

When You Are Not Well

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 👁️ eyes (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: none of the 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that I have a fever, that something hurts, that I am tired or thirsty, and ask someone to rest.

Complete TE-C84-rest: name what is wrong and tell a tired or feverish friend to rest.

84.1 జ్వరం (jvaram) — a fever

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a disease, then the Telugu for health.

You'll want to know: జ్వరం

జ్వరం (*jvaram*) — “a fever”.

నాకు జ్వరం వచ్చింది — “I have a fever”, literally “to me a fever has come”.

Look at the shape. The person sits in the dative నాకు and the fever *arrives*, on the same come-verb as నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు. In Telugu an illness is something that comes to you.

What you've built

Your first word for what is wrong, on the pattern you already use for knowing Telugu.

Your turn

- *Say it: jvarami*
- *Say it: jvarami*, once more
- *Say it: say nāku jvarami vaccindi*, I have a fever
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a disease, then the Telugu for health, then say jvarami again*

Before you move on

What does జ్వరం mean? (“A fever”.) Say it once more.

84.2 నొప్పి (noppi) — a pain, an ache

Before the new one: say the Telugu for health, then the Telugu for a fever.

You’ll want to know: నొప్పి

నొప్పి (*noppi*) — “a pain, an ache”.

Put a body part in front of it and you have the complaint: తల నొప్పి (*tala noppi*), a headache, and కడుపు నొప్పి (*kadupu noppi*), a stomach ache. Both body words are ones you already own.

What you’ve built

One word that turns every body part you know into something you can complain about.

Your turn

- *Say it: noppi*
- *Say it: noppi*, once more
- *Say it: say tala noppi*, then *kadupu noppi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for health, then the Telugu for a fever, then say noppi again*

Before you move on

What does నొప్పి mean? (“A pain, an ache”.) Say it once more.

84.3 అలసట (alasaṭa) — tiredness

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a fever, then the Telugu for a pain.

You’ll want to know: అలసట

అలసట (alasaṭa) — “tiredness”.

నాకు అలసటగా ఉంది — “I feel tired”, literally “to me it is tired-ly”.

The ending -గా turns the noun into a manner, and ఉంది says “it is”. This frame, నాకు ... గా ఉంది, is how Telugu says many of the things English says with *I am*.

What you’ve built

The frame నాకు ... గా ఉంది, which the next words keep using.

Your turn

- *Say it: alasaṭa*
- *Say it: alasaṭa, once more*
- *Say it: say nāku alasaṭagā undi, I feel tired*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a fever, then the Telugu for a pain, then say alasaṭa again*

Before you move on

What does అలసట mean? (“Tiredness”.) Say it once more.

84.4 దాహం (dāhami) — thirst

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a pain, then the Telugu for tiredness.

You'll want to know: దాహం

దాహం (*dāhami*) — “thirst”.

నాకు దాహంగా ఉంది — “I am thirsty”. Same frame as tiredness, a new noun in the middle.

And you can already ask for the cure: నాకు నీళ్ళు కావాలి, “I want water”.

What you've built

Thirst, and the request that answers it.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāhami*
- *Say it: dāhami, once more*
- *Say it: say nāku dāhamigā undi, then ask for water*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a pain, then the Telugu for tiredness, then say dāhami again*

Before you move on

What does దాహం mean? (“Thirst”.) Say it once more.

84.5 విశ్రాంతి (viśrānti) — rest

Before the new one: say the Telugu for tiredness, then the Telugu for thirst.

You'll want to know: విశ్రాంతి

విశ్రాంతి (*viśrānti*) — “rest”.

విశ్రాంతి తీసుకోండి — “please take some rest”, what you say to someone with a fever or a long day behind them. The polite ending -అండి is the one you already put on *raṇḍi*.

What you've built

Something to say to the person who is unwell, not only about yourself.

Your turn

- *Say it: viśrānti*
- *Say it: viśrānti*, once more
- *Say it: say viśrānti tīśukōṇḍi* to a tired friend
- *Recall: say the Telugu for tiredness, then the Telugu for thirst, then say viśrānti again*

Before you move on

What does విశ్రాంతి mean? (“Rest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 85

Cold, Hot, and How You Feel

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that I feel cold or hot, and that I am afraid, angry or sad.

Complete TE-C85-sorrow: say how you feel, from the weather to the heart.

85.1 చలి (cali) — cold, the cold

Before the new one: say the Telugu for thirst, then the Telugu for rest.

You'll want to know: చలి

చలి (cali) — “cold, the cold”.

ఇవాళ చలిగా ఉంది — “it is cold today”. నాకు చలిగా ఉంది — “I feel cold”.

The same frame again: with నాకు it is your body, without it it is the day.

What you've built

The first word that works for both the weather and the body.

Your turn

- Say it: cali
- Say it: cali, once more

- *Say it:* say *ivāḷa caligā undi*, then *nāku caligā undi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for thirst, then the Telugu for rest, then say *cali* again

Before you move on

What does చలి mean? (“Cold, the cold”.) Say it once more.

85.2 వేడి (vēḍi) — heat; hot

Before the new one: say the Telugu for rest, then the Telugu for the cold.

You’ll want to know: వేడి

వేడి (*vēḍi*) — “heat”, and before a noun, “hot”.

ఇవాళ చాలా వేడిగా ఉంది — “it is very hot today”. వేడి నీళ్లు — “hot water”.
It is the pair of చలి, and it slots into the same frame.

What you’ve built

Cold and hot, as a pair, in one frame.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vēḍi*
- *Say it:* *vēḍi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vēḍi nāḷu*, then *ivāḷa calā vēḍigā undi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for rest, then the Telugu for the cold, then say *vēḍi* again

Before you move on

What does వేడి mean? (“Heat; hot”.) Say it once more.

85.3 భయం (bhayam) — fear

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the cold, then the Telugu for heat.

You'll want to know: భయం

భయం (bhayam) — “fear”.

నాకు భయంగా ఉంది — “I am afraid”. The frame that carried tiredness and cold now carries a feeling, with nothing else changed.

What you've built

The first feeling, in a frame you can already build.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhayam*
- *Say it: bhayam, once more*
- *Say it: say nāku bhayamigā undi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for the cold, then the Telugu for heat, then say bhayam again*

Before you move on

What does భయం mean? (“Fear”.) Say it once more.

85.4 కోపం (kōpam) — anger

Before the new one: say the Telugu for heat, then the Telugu for fear.

You'll want to know: కోపం

కోపం (kōpam) — “anger”.

నాకు కోపం వచ్చింది — “I got angry”, literally “to me anger came”. Anger arrives the way a fever did, on the come-verb, and the person it happens to sits in the dative.

What you've built

A feeling that comes to you, like a fever.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōpani*
- *Say it: kōpani*, once more
- *Say it: say nāku kōpani vaccindi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for heat, then the Telugu for fear, then say kōpani again*

Before you move on

What does కోపం mean? (“Anger.”) Say it once more.

85.5 బాధ (bādha) — sorrow, distress

Before the new one: say the Telugu for fear, then the Telugu for anger.

You'll want to know: బాధ

బాధ (bādha) — “sorrow, distress”.

నాకు బాధగా ఉంది — “I feel sad”. It also covers the ache behind worry, so it answers మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? honestly on a bad day.

What you've built

An honest answer to how are you, when the answer is not బాగా.

Your turn

- *Say it: bādha*
- *Say it: bādha*, once more
- *Say it: say nāku bādhagā undi*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for fear, then the Telugu for anger, then say *bādhā* again

Before you move on

What does బాధ mean? (“Sorrow, distress”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 86

Slower, Please

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask someone to speak slowly or loudly, to say it once more, or to wait a minute.

Complete TE-C86-wait: keep a conversation going when you cannot follow it.

86.1 నెమ్మదిగా (nemmadiḡā) — slowly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for anger, then the Telugu for sorrow.

You’ll want to know: నెమ్మదిగా

నెమ్మదిగా (nemmadiḡā) — “slowly”.

నెమ్మదిగా మాట్లాడండి — “please speak slowly”. You have the verb from your first chapters and the polite ending from *randi*.

Notice the -గా at the end: the same ending that made *alasaṭagā* and *caligā*.

What you’ve built

The request a beginner needs most.

Your turn

- Say it: *nemmadiḡā*

- *Say it:* *nemmadigā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nemmadigā mātlāḍaṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for anger, then the Telugu for sorrow, then say *nemmadigā* again

Before you move on

What does నెమ్మదిగా mean? (“Slowly”.) Say it once more.

86.2 ఇంకోసారి (*inkōsāri*) — once more

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sorrow, then the Telugu for slowly.

You’ll want to know: ఇంకోసారి

ఇంకోసారి (*inkōsāri*) — “once more, one more time”.

ఇంకోసారి చెప్పండి — “please say it once more”. సారి is “a time, an occasion”, and ఇంకో is “another”.

What you’ve built

A way to hear it again without saying you did not understand.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *inkōsāri*
- *Say it:* *inkōsāri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inkōsāri ceppaṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for sorrow, then the Telugu for slowly, then say *inkōsāri* again

Before you move on

What does ఇంకోసారి mean? (“Once more”.) Say it once more.

86.3 గట్టిగా (gaṭṭigā) — loudly; firmly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for slowly, then the Telugu for once more.

You'll want to know: గట్టిగా

గట్టిగా (gaṭṭigā) — “loudly”, and also “firmly, tightly”.

కొంచెం గట్టిగా మాట్లాడండి — “please speak a little louder”. కొంచెం softens it, as it softens any request.

What you've built

Slowly and loudly: the two fixes for a sentence you could not catch.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaṭṭigā*
- *Say it: gaṭṭigā, once more*
- *Say it: say koṇcem gaṭṭigā māṭṭāḍaṇḍi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for slowly, then the Telugu for once more, then say gaṭṭigā again*

Before you move on

What does గట్టిగా mean? (“Loudly; firmly.”) Say it once more.

86.4 ఒక్క నిమిషం (okka nimīṣaṁ) — one minute, a moment

Before the new one: say the Telugu for once more, then the Telugu for loudly.

You'll want to know: ఒక్క నిమిషం

ఒక్క నిమిషం (okka nimīṣaṁ) — “one minute”, said the way English says “a moment”.

నిమిషం is “a minute”, and ఒక్క is “a single one”, a close relative of ఒకటి, the “one” you count with.

What you’ve built

A way to buy time while you find the word.

Your turn

- *Say it: okka nimishani*
- *Say it: okka nimishani, once more*
- *Say it: say okka nimishani*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for once more, then the Telugu for loudly, then say okka nimishani again*

Before you move on

What does ఒక్క నిమిషం mean? (“One minute, a moment”.) Say it once more.

86.5 ఆగండి (āgaṇḍi) — please wait

Before the new one: say the Telugu for loudly, then the Telugu for one minute.

You’ll want to know: ఆగండి

ఆగండి (āgaṇḍi) — “please wait”, or “please stop”.

It is the verb ఆగు with the polite -అండి. ఆగండి, ఒక్క నిమిషం — “wait, one minute”.

What you’ve built

Wait, slower, louder, once more: enough to hold a conversation you cannot yet follow.

Your turn

- *Say it: āgaṇḍi*
- *Say it: āgaṇḍi, once more*
- *Say it: say āgaṇḍi, okka nimisham*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for loudly, then the Telugu for one minute, then say āgaṇḍi again*

Before you move on

What does ఆగండి mean? (“Please wait; please stop”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 87

Right, Wrong, Maybe

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that something is wrong or exactly right, answer with maybe, and react with really? and I see.

Complete TE-R87-second-pass-replies: the chapter replies and the requests that keep a conversation going, from cold.

87.1 తప్పు (tappu) — a mistake; wrong

Before the new one: say the Telugu for one minute, then the Telugu for please wait.

You'll want to know: తప్పు

తప్పు (tappu) — “a mistake”, and as a reply, “wrong”.

క్షమించండి, నా తప్పు — “sorry, my mistake”.

You have met it before without seeing it: తప్పకుండా, “certainly”, is built on the verb behind this word, “to slip, to miss”. Certainly is *without slipping*.

What you've built

A word for a mistake, and the word for certainly finally explained.

Your turn

- Say it: tappu
- Say it: tappu, once more

- *Say it:* say *kṣamin̄caṇḍi*, *nā tappu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for one minute, then the Telugu for please wait, then say *tappu* again

Before you move on

What does తప్పు mean? (“A mistake; wrong”.) Say it once more.

87.2 సరిగ్గా (sariggā) — exactly, properly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for please wait, then the Telugu for a mistake.

You’ll want to know: సరిగ్గా

సరిగ్గా (*sariggā*) — “exactly, properly”.

Said alone, సరిగ్గా! is “exactly!”. It shares its start with సరే, “okay”: both lean on సరి, “right, even”.

What you’ve built

Wrong and exactly right, as a pair.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sariggā*
- *Say it:* *sariggā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sariggā!* to agree strongly
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for please wait, then the Telugu for a mistake, then say *sariggā* again

Before you move on

What does సరిగ్గా mean? (“Exactly, properly”.) Say it once more.

87.3 బహుశా (bahuśā) — probably, perhaps

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a mistake, then the Telugu for exactly.

You'll want to know: బహుశా

బహుశా (bahuśā) — “probably, perhaps”.

బహుశా రేపు — “probably tomorrow”. Compare ఏమో: *ēmō* shrugs, “who knows”, while *bahuśā* makes a guess.

What you've built

A guess, next to the shrug you already had.

Your turn

- *Say it: bahuśā*
- *Say it: bahuśā, once more*
- *Say it: say bahuśā rēpu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a mistake, then the Telugu for exactly, then say bahuśā again*

Before you move on

What does బహుశా mean? (“Probably, perhaps.”) Say it once more.

87.4 అలాగా (alāgā) — is that so? I see

Before the new one: say the Telugu for exactly, then the Telugu for probably.

You'll want to know: అలాగా

అలాగా (alāgā) — “is that so?”, “I see”.

It sits one vowel away from అలాగీ, “alright then”. *Alāgā* receives news; *alāgē* agrees to a plan. Say both and hear the difference in the last vowel.

What you've built

A way to show you are listening.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *alāgā*
- *Say it:* *alāgā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alāgā*, then *alāgē*, and hear the last vowel change
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for exactly, then the Telugu for probably, then say *alāgā* again

Before you move on

What does అలాగ mean? (“Is that so? I see”.) Say it once more.

87.5 నిజంగా (nijamgā) — really, truly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for probably, then the Telugu for I see.

You'll want to know: నిజంగా

నిజంగా (*nijamgā*) — “really, truly”.

నిజం is “the truth”, and -గా turns it into a manner, as it did for *nem-madigā*. As a question, నిజంగా? is “really?”.

What you've built

Five replies: wrong, exactly, probably, I see, really.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nijamgā*
- *Say it:* *nijamgā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nijamgā?* with a rising voice
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for probably, then the Telugu for I see, then say *nijamgā* again

Before you move on

What does నిజంగా mean? (“Really, truly.”) Say it once more.

87.6 Keeping a conversation going — a second pass

Someone speaks fast and quietly. Ask for three things: slowly, louder, once more.

Grammar Lens: the ending -గా

word	built from
నెమ్మదిగా	slow + -గా
గట్టిగా	firm + -గా
సరిగ్గా	right + -గా
నిజంగా	truth + -గా

One ending, four manners. It is the same -గా that made *nāku caligā undi*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ask someone to wait one minute
- you made a mistake; say sorry and own it
- agree strongly, then guess “probably tomorrow”
- react to news with “I see”, then with “really?”

Before you move on

Slowly? (నెమ్మదిగా.) Once more? (ఇంకోసారి.) Louder? (గట్టిగా.) One minute? (ఒక్క నిమిషం.) Please wait? (ఆగండి.) My mistake? (నా తప్పు.) Exactly? (సరిగ్గా.) Probably? (బహుశా.) I see? (అలాగా.) Really? (నిజంగా.)

87.7 How are you, honestly — a second pass

You are not well today. Say that you have a fever, that your head aches, and that you are tired.

Grammar Lens: two ways a feeling reaches you

it comes to you

it is so, to you

నాకు జ్వరం వచ్చింది
నాకు కోపం వచ్చింది

నాకు అలసటగా ఉంది
నాకు భయంగా ఉంది

Both keep the person in the dative నాకు. One says the thing arrived; the other says how it is with you now. చలి and బాధ take the right-hand frame too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- you are thirsty; ask for water
- it is cold today; then, it is very hot today
- tell a friend with a stomach ache to rest
- a friend says they are sad; react with “really?”, then “I see”

Before you move on

A fever? (జ్వరం.) A pain? (నొప్పి.) Tiredness? (అలసట.) Thirst? (దాహం.) Rest? (విశ్రాంతి.) Cold, and heat? (చలి, వేడి.) Fear, anger, sorrow? (భయం, కోపం, బాధ.) Really? (నిజంగా.) I see? (అలాగా.)

Chapter 88

The People Around You

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can talk about children, a boy or a girl, a person, and a relative when people introduce themselves.

Complete TE-C88-relative: introduce the people around you.

88.1 పిల్లలు (pillalu) — children

Before the new one: say the Telugu for I see, then the Telugu for really.

You'll want to know: పిల్లలు

పిల్లలు (*pillalu*) — “children”.

మీకు పిల్లలు ఉన్నారా? — “do you have children?”, literally “to you, are there children?”. The -లు at the end is the plural you met in your very first lesson.

What you've built

The question that follows a name in almost every first conversation.

Your turn

- Say it: *pillalu*
- Say it: *pillalu*, once more

- *Say it:* ask *mīku pillalu unnārā?*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for I see, then the Telugu for really, then say *pillalu* again

Before you move on

What does పిల్లలు mean? (“Children”.) Say it once more.

88.2 అబ్బాయి (abbāyi) — a boy; a son

Before the new one: say the Telugu for really, then the Telugu for children.

You’ll want to know: అబ్బాయి

అబ్బాయి (*abbāyi*) — “a boy”, and in a family, “a son”.

మా అబ్బాయి — “our boy”, which is how a parent says “my son” out loud.

What you’ve built

A word for a boy that doubles as the everyday word for a son.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *abbāyi*
- *Say it:* *abbāyi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mā abbāyi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for really, then the Telugu for children, then say *abbāyi* again

Before you move on

What does అబ్బాయి mean? (“A boy; a son”.) Say it once more.

88.3 అమ్మాయి (ammāyi) — a girl; a daughter

Before the new one: say the Telugu for children, then the Telugu for a boy.

You'll want to know: అమ్మాయి

అమ్మాయి (*ammāyi*) — “a girl”, and in a family, “a daughter”.

It is built like అబ్బాయి, and it opens on the same sound as అమ్మ, “mother”. మా అమ్మాయి — “our girl”, “my daughter”.

What you've built

Boy and girl as a pair, each also a word for a child of the family.

Your turn

- Say it: *ammāyi*
- Say it: *ammāyi*, once more
- Say it: say *mā abbāyi*, then *mā ammāyi*
- Recall: say the Telugu for children, then the Telugu for a boy, then say *ammāyi* again

Before you move on

What does అమ్మాయి mean? (“A girl; a daughter”.) Say it once more.

88.4 మనిషి (*maniṣi*) — a person

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a boy, then the Telugu for a girl.

You'll want to know: మనిషి

మనిషి (*maniṣi*) — “a person, a human being”.

మంచి మనిషి — “a good person”, with the మంచి you already have. The plural changes shape: మనుషులు (*manuṣulu*), “people”.

What you've built

A word for anyone at all, and your first plural that changes its stem.

Your turn

- *Say it: maniṣi*
- *Say it: maniṣi*, once more
- *Say it: say manci maniṣi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a boy, then the Telugu for a girl, then say *maniṣi* again

Before you move on

What does మనిషి mean? (“A person, a human being”.) Say it once more.

88.5 బంధువు (bandhuvu) — a relative

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a girl, then the Telugu for a person.

You’ll want to know: బంధువు

బంధువు (*bandhuvu*) — “a relative”.

అతను మా బంధువు — “he is our relative”, with no word for *is*, the same way నా పేరు ... needs none.

What you’ve built

Children, a boy, a girl, a person, a relative: the people an introduction reaches for.

Your turn

- *Say it: bandhuvu*
- *Say it: bandhuvu*, once more
- *Say it: say atanu mā bandhuvu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a girl, then the Telugu for a person, then say *bandhuvu* again

Before you move on

What does బంధువు mean? (“A relative”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 89

About Yourself

Modes:  voice (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask and answer about a job, the languages someone speaks, whether they are married, and an address.

Complete TE-C89-address: the questions that come after a name.

89.1 ఉద్యోగం (udyōgam) — a job

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a person, then the Telugu for a relative.

You'll want to know: ఉద్యోగం

ఉద్యోగం (udyōgam) — “a job”.

మీ ఉద్యోగం ఏమిటి? — “what is your job?”. It is built exactly like మీ పేరు ఏమిటి?, with the job where the name was.

What you've built

The second question of an introduction, on the frame of the first.

Your turn

- Say it: udyōgam
- Say it: udyōgam, once more
- Say it: ask mī udyōgam ēmiti?

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a person, then the Telugu for a relative, then say *udyōgaṇi* again

Before you move on

What does ఉద్యోగం mean? (“A job”.) Say it once more.

89.2 భాష (bhāṣa) — a language

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a relative, then the Telugu for a job.

You’ll want to know: భాష

భాష (*bhāṣa*) — “a language”.

మీకు ఏ భాషలు వచ్చు? — “which languages do you know?”. The knower sits in the dative, as in నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు: a language is something that comes to you.

What you’ve built

A way to ask what someone speaks, in the frame you learned for Telugu itself.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *bhāṣa*
- *Say it*: *bhāṣa*, once more
- *Say it*: ask *mīku ē bhāṣalu vaccu?*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a relative, then the Telugu for a job, then say *bhāṣa* again

Before you move on

What does భాష mean? (“A language”.) Say it once more.

89.3 ఇంగ్లీషు (iṅglīṣu) — English

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a job, then the Telugu for a language.

You'll want to know: ఇంగ్లీషు

ఇంగ్లీషు (*iṅglīṣu*) — “English”, the language.

నాకు ఇంగ్లీషు వచ్చు, తెలుగు కొంచెం వచ్చు — “I know English, and a little Telugu”.

What you've built

An honest answer to which languages do you know.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṅglīṣu*
- *Say it: iṅglīṣu*, once more
- *Say it: say nāku iṅglīṣu vaccu, telugu koṇcem vaccu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a job, then the Telugu for a language, then say iṅglīṣu again*

Before you move on

What does ఇంగ్లీషు mean? (“English”.) Say it once more.

89.4 పెళ్ళి (peḷḷi) — a wedding, marriage

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a language, then the Telugu for English.

You'll want to know: పెళ్ళి

పెళ్ళి (*peḷḷi*) — “a wedding”, and “marriage”.

మీకు పెళ్ళి అయిందా? — “are you married?”, literally “has a wedding happened to you?”. The person sits in the dative again, and the marriage is something that happened.

What you've built

A question you will be asked early and often, and the word it turns on.

Your turn

- *Say it: pelli*
- *Say it: pelli*, once more
- *Say it: ask mīku pelli ayindā?*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a language, then the Telugu for English, then say pelli again*

Before you move on

What does పెళ్ళి mean? (“A wedding, marriage”.) Say it once more.

89.5 చిరునామా (cirunāmā) — an address

Before the new one: say the Telugu for English, then the Telugu for a wedding.

You'll want to know: చిరునామా

చిరునామా (cirunāmā) — “an address”.

మీ చిరునామా ఏమిటి? — “what is your address?”. The same frame as the name and the job: మీ ... ఏమిటి?

What you've built

Job, languages, marriage, address: the questions that come after a name.

Your turn

- *Say it: cirunāmā*
- *Say it: cirunāmā*, once more
- *Say it: ask mī cirunāmā ēmiṭi?*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for English, then the Telugu for a wedding, then say *cirunāmā* again

Before you move on

What does చిరునామా mean? (“An address”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 90

On the Way Out

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can tell someone to take care and to come soon, say I am going home, suggest we leave, and take my leave politely.

Complete TE-C90-lets go: leave a visit well.

90.1 జాగ్రత్త (jāgratta) — care, caution

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a wedding, then the Telugu for an address.

You'll want to know: జాగ్రత్త

జాగ్రత్త (jāgratta) — “care, caution”.

జాగ్రత్తగా వెళ్ళండి — “go carefully”, what a host says at the door, where English says “take care”. The -గా is the ending that makes a manner.

What you've built

The kindest thing to say to someone leaving.

Your turn

- Say it: jāgratta
- Say it: jāgratta, once more

- *Say it:* say *jāgrattagā vellāṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a wedding, then the Telugu for an address, then say *jāgratta* again

Before you move on

What does జాగ్రత్త mean? (“Care, caution.”) Say it once more.

90.2 త్వరగా (tvaragā) — quickly, soon

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an address, then the Telugu for care.

You’ll want to know: త్వరగా

త్వరగా (*tvaragā*) — “quickly”, and at a parting, “soon”.

త్వరగా రండి — “come back soon”. The respectful **raṇḍi** you already have.

What you’ve built

An invitation to return, built from pieces you own.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tvaragā*
- *Say it:* *tvaragā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tvaragā raṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an address, then the Telugu for care, then say *tvaragā* again

Before you move on

What does త్వరగా mean? (“Quickly, soon.”) Say it once more.

90.3 ఇంటికి (inṭiki) — home, to the house

Before the new one: say the Telugu for care, then the Telugu for soon.

You'll want to know: ఇంటికి

ఇంటికి (inṭiki) — “home”, as in “going home”.

It is ఇల్లు, “a house”, with the -కి “to” ending on it, and the house word changes shape to take it. నేను ఇంటికి వెళ్తాను — “I am going home”.

What you've built

A reason to leave that needs no apology.

Your turn

- *Say it: inṭiki*
- *Say it: inṭiki*, once more
- *Say it: say nēnu inṭiki veltānu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for care, then the Telugu for soon, then say inṭiki again*

Before you move on

What does ఇంటికి mean? (“Home, to the house”.) Say it once more.

90.4 సెలవు (selavu) — leave, a holiday

Before the new one: say the Telugu for soon, then the Telugu for home.

You'll want to know: సెలవు

సెలవు (selavu) — “leave”, both a holiday and permission to go.

ఇవాళ సెలవు — “today is a holiday”. At a formal parting, సెలవు alone asks leave to go, the way English once said “by your leave”.

What you've built

A holiday, and the most formal way out of a room.

Your turn

- *Say it: selavu*
- *Say it: selavu*, once more
- *Say it: say ivāḷa selavu*, then take your leave with *selavu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for soon, then the Telugu for home, then say selavu again*

Before you move on

What does సెలవు mean? (“Leave, a holiday”.) Say it once more.

90.5 పదండి (padaṇḍi) — let's go

Before the new one: say the Telugu for home, then the Telugu for leave.

You'll want to know: పదండి

పదండి (*padaṇḍi*) — “let's go”, said to the group you are leaving with.

It carries the respectful -అండి like **raṇḍi** and **āgaṇḍi**, so it stays polite even when it hurries people along.

What you've built

Take care, come soon, I am going home, farewell, let's go: a whole exit.

Your turn

- *Say it: padaṇḍi*
- *Say it: padaṇḍi*, once more
- *Say it: say padaṇḍi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for home, then the Telugu for leave, then say padaṇḍi again*

Before you move on

What does పదండి mean? (“Let’s go”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 91

Greetings People Actually Say

Modes:  voice (7)  Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can greet someone the way Telugu speakers greet each other day to day: are you well, long time, what's new, where to, have you eaten.

Complete TE-R91-second-pass-greetings: everyday greetings and partings, from cold.

91.1 బాగున్నారా? (bāgunnārā?) — are you well?

Before the new one: say the Telugu for leave, then the Telugu for let's go.

You'll want to know: బాగున్నారా?

బాగున్నారా? (bāgunnārā?) — “are you well?”.

It is the answer you already give, బాగున్నాను, turned into a question: the respectful ending -నారు and the question mark -అ you know from అవునా?

What you've built

The greeting most people open with, built from your own answer.

Your turn

- Say it: bāgunnārā?
- Say it: bāgunnārā?, once more

- *Say it:* ask *bāgunnārā?*, then answer *bāgunnānu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for leave, then the Telugu for let's go, then say *bāgunnārā?* again

Before you move on

What does బాగున్నారా? mean? (“Are you well?”.) Say it once more.

91.2 చాలా రోజులైంది (cālā rōjulaindi) — it has been a long time

Before the new one: say the Telugu for let's go, then the Telugu for are you well.

You'll want to know: చాలా రోజులైంది

చాలా రోజులైంది (cālā rōjulaindi) — “it has been a long time”, literally “many days have become”.

చాలా and రోజు are both yours already; -లు makes the days plural.

What you've built

The greeting for someone you have not seen in a while.

Your turn

- *Say it:* cālā rōjulaindi
- *Say it:* cālā rōjulaindi, once more
- *Say it:* say cālā rōjulaindi!
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for let's go, then the Telugu for are you well, then say cālā rōjulaindi again

Before you move on

What does చాలా రోజులైంది mean? (“It has been a long time”.) Say it once more.

91.3 ఏంటి సంగతి? (*ēṇṭi saṅgati?*) — what’s new?

Before the new one: say the Telugu for are you well, then the Telugu for it has been a long time.

You’ll want to know: ఏంటి సంగతి?

ఏంటి సంగతి? (*ēṇṭi saṅgati?*) — “what’s new?”, literally “what’s the matter?”, but warm.

ఏంటి is the everyday spoken form of ఏమిటి. Use it with friends, not with a stranger.

What you’ve built

A friendly opener, and the spoken shape of a word you learned formally.

Your turn

- *Say it: ēṇṭi saṅgati?*
- *Say it: ēṇṭi saṅgati?*, once more
- *Say it: ask a friend ēṇṭi saṅgati?*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for are you well, then the Telugu for it has been a long time, then say ēṇṭi saṅgati? again*

Before you move on

What does ఏంటి సంగతి? mean? (“What’s new?”.) Say it once more.

91.4 ఎక్కడికి? (*ekkaḍiki?*) — where to?

Before the new one: say the Telugu for it has been a long time, then the Telugu for what’s new.

You’ll want to know: ఎక్కడికి?

ఎక్కడికి? (*ekkaḍiki?*) — “where to?”.

It is ఎక్కడ, “where”, with the -కి “to” ending. Asked of a neighbour on the street it is a greeting, not a demand; ఇంటికి, “home”, is a full answer.

What you've built

A street greeting, and its answer from the last chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ekkaḍiki?*
- *Say it:* *ekkaḍiki?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *ekkaḍiki?*, then answer *inṭiki*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for it has been a long time, then the Telugu for what's new, then say *ekkaḍiki?* again

Before you move on

What does ఎక్కడికి? mean? (“Where to?.”) Say it once more.

91.5 భోంచేశారా? (bhōñcēsārā?) — have you eaten?

Before the new one: say the Telugu for what's new, then the Telugu for where to.

You'll want to know: భోంచేశారా?

భోంచేశారా? (*bhōñcēsārā?*) — “have you eaten?”

It is భోజనం చేశారా?, “have you done the meal?”, worn short in speech. Asked around a mealtime it is a greeting and a kindness; ఆ, అయింది — “yes, done” — is enough of an answer.

What you've built

Five greetings people actually use, one of them about food.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bhōñcēsārā?*
- *Say it:* *bhōñcēsārā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *bhōñcēsārā?*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for what's new, then the Telugu for where to, then say *bhōñcēsārā?* again

Before you move on

What does భోంచేశారా? mean? (“Have you eaten?.”) Say it once more.

91.6 Hello and goodbye, the everyday way — a second pass

You meet a neighbour you have not seen in a long time, around lunch. Say three things.

Grammar Lens: the ending -కి, “to”

word	built from
ఇంటికి	house + -కి
ఎక్కడికి?	where + -కి

The same -కి as నాకు: a direction, to a place or to a person.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ask a friend what's new, then ask where they are going
- answer that you are going home
- at the door, tell your host to take care and to come soon
- take your leave formally, then hurry your group along

Before you move on

Are you well? (బాగున్నారా?) Long time? (చాలా రోజులైంది.) What's new? (ఏంటి సంగతి?) Where to? (ఎక్కడికి?) Have you eaten? (భోంచేశారా?) Take care? (జాగ్రత్త.) Soon? (త్వరగా.) Home? (ఇంటికి.) Leave? (సెలవు.) Let's go? (పదండి.)

91.7 After the name — a second pass

You have given your name. Ask the next two questions: the job, and the address.

Grammar Lens: one frame, many questions

ask about you

మీ ఉద్యోగం ఏమిటి?

మీ చిరునామా ఏమిటి?

ask what happened to you

మీకు పెళ్ళి అయిందా?

మీకు ఏ భాషలు వచ్చు?

మీ asks about something of yours; మీకు asks what is so, or what came, to you. The children question is the right-hand kind: మీకు పిల్లలు ఉన్నారా?

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- say you know English and a little Telugu
- introduce your son and your daughter
- say he is a good person, and our relative
- a neighbour asks where to, and whether you have eaten; answer both

Before you move on

Children? (పిల్లలు.) A boy, a girl? (అబ్బాయి, అమ్మాయి.) A person? (మనిషి.) A relative? (బంధువు.) A job? (ఉద్యోగం.) A language? (భాష.) English? (ఇంగ్లీషు.) A wedding? (పెళ్ళి.) An address? (చిరునామా.)

Chapter 92

At the Doctor

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I have a cold, a wound or feel weak, and talk about medicine and the hospital.

Complete TE-C92-weakness: tell a doctor what is wrong.

92.1 జలుబు (jalubu) — a cold, a runny nose

Before the new one: say the Telugu for where to, then the Telugu for have you eaten.

You'll want to know: జలుబు

జలుబు (*jalubu*) — “a cold”, the kind with a runny nose.

నాకు జలుబు చేసింది — “I have caught a cold”, literally “a cold has done to me”. Telugu keeps this apart from చలి, the cold of the weather.

What you've built

The illness, next to the weather word you already have.

Your turn

- Say it: *jalubu*
- Say it: *jalubu*, once more
- Say it: say *nāku jalubu cēsindi*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for where to, then the Telugu for have you eaten, then say *jalubu* again

Before you move on

What does జలుబు mean? (“A cold, a runny nose”.) Say it once more.

92.2 మందు (mandu) — medicine

Before the new one: say the Telugu for have you eaten, then the Telugu for a cold.

You’ll want to know: మందు

మందు (*mandu*) — “medicine”.

మందు వేసుకోండి — “please take the medicine”. Telugu *puts on* a medicine, where English *takes* it.

What you’ve built

The cure, and the verb Telugu uses for taking it.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mandu*
- *Say it*: *mandu*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mandu vēsukōṇḍi*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for have you eaten, then the Telugu for a cold, then say *mandu* again

Before you move on

What does మందు mean? (“Medicine”.) Say it once more.

92.3 ఆసుపత్రి (āsupatri) — a hospital

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a cold, then the Telugu for medicine.

You'll want to know: ఆసుపత్రి

ఆసుపత్రి (*āsupatri*) — “a hospital”.

ఆసుపత్రి ఎక్కడ? — “where is the hospital?”, with the ఎక్కడ you already ask places with.

What you've built

A place to ask the way to when it matters most.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āsupatri*
- *Say it:* *āsupatri*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *āsupatri ekkada?*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a cold, then the Telugu for medicine, then say *āsupatri* again

Before you move on

What does ఆసుపత్రి mean? (“A hospital”.) Say it once more.

92.4 గాయం (*gāyam*) — a wound, an injury

Before the new one: say the Telugu for medicine, then the Telugu for a hospital.

You'll want to know: గాయం

గాయం (*gāyam*) — “a wound, an injury”.

గాయం అయింది — “I have been hurt”, literally “a wound has happened”. Like a wedding, an injury is something that happens.

What you've built

A way to say you are hurt.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāyaṁi*
- *Say it: gāyaṁi*, once more
- *Say it: say gāyaṁi ayindi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for medicine, then the Telugu for a hospital, then say *gāyaṁi* again

Before you move on

What does గాయం mean? (“A wound, an injury”.) Say it once more.

92.5 నీరసం (nīrasaṁ) — weakness, lethargy

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a hospital, then the Telugu for a wound.

You’ll want to know: నీరసం

నీరసం (*nīrasaṁ*) — “weakness, lethargy”, the drained feeling after a fever.

నాకు నీరసంగా ఉంది — “I feel weak”, in the frame of అలసటగా and దాహంగా.

What you’ve built

A cold, medicine, a hospital, a wound, weakness: enough for a visit to the doctor.

Your turn

- *Say it: nīrasaṁi*
- *Say it: nīrasaṁi*, once more
- *Say it: say nāku nīrasaṁgā undi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a hospital, then the Telugu for a wound, then say *nīrasaṁi* again

Before you move on

What does నీరసం mean? (“Weakness, lethargy”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 93

Keeping Well

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask whether someone is keeping well, say I am comfortable and happy, and name aches in the body.

Complete TE-C93-body: good news and bad news about how you are.

93.1 క్షేమం (kṣēmam) — wellbeing, safety

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a wound, then the Telugu for weakness.

You'll want to know: క్షేమం

క్షేమం (kṣēmam) — “wellbeing, safety”.

క్షేమంగా ఉన్నారా? — “are you keeping well?”, a warmer, more formal cousin of బాగున్నారా?, heard from elders and read at the top of letters.

What you've built

A respectful way to ask after someone.

Your turn

- Say it: kṣēmam
- Say it: kṣēmam, once more
- Say it: ask kṣēmamigā unnārā?

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a wound, then the Telugu for weakness, then say *kṣēmaṁ* again

Before you move on

What does క్షేమం mean? (“Wellbeing, safety”.) Say it once more.

93.2 హాయిగా (hāyigā) — comfortably, pleasantly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for weakness, then the Telugu for wellbeing.

You’ll want to know: హాయిగా

హాయిగా (*hāyigā*) — “comfortably, pleasantly”.

హాయిగా ఉంది — “it is pleasant”, said of a cool breeze, a good rest, an easy day.

What you’ve built

A word for when things are good.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *hāyigā*
- *Say it*: *hāyigā*, once more
- *Say it*: say *hāyigā undi*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for weakness, then the Telugu for wellbeing, then say *hāyigā* again

Before you move on

What does హాయిగా mean? (“Comfortably, pleasantly”.) Say it once more.

93.3 సుఖం (sukham) — comfort, ease

Before the new one: say the Telugu for wellbeing, then the Telugu for comfortably.

You'll want to know: సుఖం

సుఖం (*sukham*) — “comfort, ease, contentment”.

సుఖంగా ఉన్నారా? — “are you comfortable?”, a host’s question. Its opposite is the కష్టం you already have: ease against difficulty.

What you’ve built

Ease, set against a word you know for its opposite.

Your turn

- *Say it: sukham*
- *Say it: sukham*, once more
- *Say it: ask sukhamigā unnārā?*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for wellbeing, then the Telugu for comfortably, then say sukham again*

Before you move on

What does సుఖం mean? (“Comfort, ease”.) Say it once more.

93.4 సంతోషంగా (*santōṣamigā*) — happily, gladly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for comfortably, then the Telugu for comfort.

You'll want to know: సంతోషంగా

సంతోషంగా (*santōṣamigā*) — “happily, gladly”.

It is సంతోషం, the “pleased” of your first introductions, with -గా. సంతోషంగా alone answers a request: “gladly”.

What you’ve built

An old word put to a new job with the ending you know.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *santōṣamīgā*
- *Say it:* *santōṣamīgā*, once more
- *Say it:* answer a request with *santōṣamīgā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for comfortably, then the Telugu for comfort, then say *santōṣamīgā* again

Before you move on

What does సంతోషంగా mean? (“Happily, gladly”.) Say it once more.

93.5 ఒళ్ళు (oḷḷu) — the body

Before the new one: say the Telugu for comfort, then the Telugu for gladly.

You’ll want to know: ఒళ్ళు

ఒళ్ళు (oḷḷu) — “the body”.

ఒళ్ళు నొప్పులు — “body aches”, with the plural of నొప్పి. What a fever leaves behind.

What you’ve built

Well, comfortable, at ease, glad, and the body that aches when you are not.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *oḷḷu*
- *Say it:* *oḷḷu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oḷḷu noppulu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for comfort, then the Telugu for gladly, then say *oḷḷu* again

Before you move on

What does ఒళ్ళు mean? (“The body”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 94

Offers, Apologies, Introductions

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can beg pardon, apologise, offer something, decline politely, and say I am glad of an introduction.

Complete TE-C94-introduction: the courtesies around a first visit.

94.1 మన్నించండి (manniñcaṇḍi) — please pardon me

Before the new one: say the Telugu for gladly, then the Telugu for the body.

You'll want to know: మన్నించండి

మన్నించండి (manniñcaṇḍi) — “please pardon me”.

It does the work of క్షమించండి, and is the gentler, native word beside it. Either answers a mistake; మన్నించండి is the one to use with an elder.

What you've built

A second apology, softer than the first.

Your turn

- Say it: manniñcaṇḍi
- Say it: manniñcaṇḍi, once more

- *Say it:* say *manniñcaṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for gladly, then the Telugu for the body, then say *manniñcaṇḍi* again

Before you move on

What does మన్నించండి mean? (“Please pardon me”.) Say it once more.

94.2 క్షమాపణ (kṣamāpaṇa) — an apology

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the body, then the Telugu for pardon me.

You’ll want to know: క్షమాపణ

క్షమాపణ (*kṣamāpaṇa*) — “an apology”, the noun.

క్షమాపణ చెప్పండి — “say sorry”. It comes from the same root as క్షమించండి: to forgive, and to ask forgiveness.

What you’ve built

The apology as a thing you can give.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kṣamāpaṇa*
- *Say it:* *kṣamāpaṇa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kṣamāpaṇa ceppaṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for the body, then the Telugu for pardon me, then say *kṣamāpaṇa* again

Before you move on

What does క్షమాపణ mean? (“An apology”.) Say it once more.

94.3 కావాలా? (kāvālā?) — do you want it?

Before the new one: say the Telugu for pardon me, then the Telugu for an apology.

You'll want to know: కావాలా?

కావాలా? (kāvālā?) — “do you want it?”.

It is కావాలి, “is wanted”, with the question -ఆ. టీ కావాలా? — “would you like tea?”. The answer is కావాలి or వద్దు, both yours already.

What you've built

An offer, and both of its answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāvālā?*
- *Say it: kāvālā?*, once more
- *Say it: ask tī kāvālā?*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for pardon me, then the Telugu for an apology, then say kāvālā? again*

Before you move on

What does కావాలా? mean? (“Do you want it?.”) Say it once more.

94.4 అవసరం (avasaram) — need, necessity

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an apology, then the Telugu for do you want it.

You'll want to know: అవసరం

అవసరం (avasaram) — “need”.

అవసరం లేదు — “there is no need”, the polite way to refuse help, with the లేదు of your first chapter.

What you've built

A way to refuse kindly.

Your turn

- *Say it: avasarami*
- *Say it: avasarami*, once more
- *Say it: say avasarami lēdu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an apology, then the Telugu for do you want it, then say *avasarami* again

Before you move on

What does అవసరం mean? (“Need, necessity”.) Say it once more.

94.5 పరిచయం (paricayam) — an introduction, acquaintance

Before the new one: say the Telugu for do you want it, then the Telugu for need.

You'll want to know: పరిచయం

పరిచయం (*paricayam*) — “an introduction, an acquaintance”.

మీతో పరిచయం సంతోషం — “glad to have met you”, literally “the acquaintance with you is a joy”. A fuller form of the సంతోషం you said at your first meeting.

What you've built

Pardon, an apology, an offer, a refusal, and a fuller pleased-to-meet-you.

Your turn

- *Say it: paricayani*
- *Say it: paricayam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *mīto paricayam santōṣam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for do you want it, then the Telugu for need, then say *paricayam* again

Before you move on

What does పరిచయం mean? (“An introduction, acquaintance”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 95

How Do You Say It?

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask how to say something in Telugu, ask to be shown, ask someone to speak gently, and say I could not hear.

Complete TE-R95-second-pass-asking: courtesies and questions about the language, from cold.

95.1 తెలుగులో (telugulō) — in Telugu

Before the new one: say the Telugu for need, then the Telugu for an introduction.

You'll want to know: తెలుగులో

తెలుగులో (telugulō) — “in Telugu”.

It is తెలుగు with -లో, “in”, the ending you met on ఉండు. Any language takes it: ఇంగ్లీషులో, “in English”.

What you've built

A way to name the language you want an answer in.

Your turn

- Say it: telugulō
- Say it: telugulō, once more

- *Say it:* say *telugulō*, then *inglišulō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for need, then the Telugu for an introduction, then say *telugulō* again

Before you move on

What does తెలుగులో mean? (“In Telugu”.) Say it once more.

95.2 ఎలా అంటారు? (*elā aṇṭāru?*) — how do you say it?

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an introduction, then the Telugu for in Telugu.

You’ll want to know: ఎలా అంటారు?

ఎలా అంటారు? (*elā aṇṭāru?*) — “how does one say it?”.

దీన్ని తెలుగులో ఎలా అంటారు? — “how do you say this in Telugu?”. అను, “to say”, is the verb inside అని and అనుకో.

What you’ve built

The one question that lets a learner learn from anyone.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *elā aṇṭāru?*
- *Say it:* *elā aṇṭāru?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *telugulō elā aṇṭāru?*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an introduction, then the Telugu for in Telugu, then say *elā aṇṭāru?* again

Before you move on

What does ఎలా అంటారు? mean? (“How do you say it?”.) Say it once more.

95.3 మెల్లగా (mellagā) — gently, softly, slowly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for in Telugu, then the Telugu for how do you say it.

You'll want to know: మెల్లగా

మెల్లగా (*mellagā*) — “gently, softly”, and “slowly”.

It overlaps with నెమ్మదిగా. మెల్లగా leans to softness: a quiet voice, a careful hand.

What you've built

A second slowly, with softness in it.

Your turn

- *Say it: mellagā*
- *Say it: mellagā, once more*
- *Say it: say mellagā mātlāḍaṇḍi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for in Telugu, then the Telugu for how do you say it, then say mellagā again*

Before you move on

What does మెల్లగా mean? (“Gently, softly, slowly”.) Say it once more.

95.4 చూపించండి (cūpiṅcaṇḍi) — please show me

Before the new one: say the Telugu for how do you say it, then the Telugu for gently.

You'll want to know: చూపించండి

చూపించండి (*cūpiṅcaṇḍi*) — “please show me”.

It is built on చూడు, “see”: to show is to *make someone see*. When a word will not come, point and say చూపించండి.

What you've built

A request for when words run out.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūpiñcaṇḍi*
- *Say it: cūpiñcaṇḍi*, once more
- *Say it: say cūpiñcaṇḍi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for how do you say it, then the Telugu for gently, then say cūpiñcaṇḍi again*

Before you move on

What does చూపించండి mean? (“Please show me”.) Say it once more.

95.5 వినిపించలేదు (vinipiñcalēdu) — I could not hear it

Before the new one: say the Telugu for gently, then the Telugu for please show me.

You'll want to know: వినిపించలేదు

వినిపించలేదు (*vinipiñcalēdu*) — “I could not hear it”, literally “it did not make itself heard”.

It ends in the లేదు you know. Pair it with a fix: వినిపించలేదు, గట్టిగా చెప్పండి.

What you've built

In Telugu, how do you say, gently, show me, I could not hear: a learner's toolkit.

Your turn

- *Say it: vinipiñcalēdu*
- *Say it: vinipiñcalēdu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *vinipiñcalēdu*, *gaṭṭigā ceppaṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for gently, then the Telugu for please show me, then say *vinipiñcalēdu* again

Before you move on

What does వినిపించలేదు mean? (“I could not hear it”.) Say it once more.

95.6 Asking about the language — a second pass

Point at something and ask how to say it in Telugu.

Grammar Lens: two kinds of polite

you ask	you answer
మన్నించండి టీ కావాలా?	పరవాలేదు అవసరం లేదు

An apology is met with “no bother”; an offer is refused with “no need”. Both answers end in లేదు.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- beg pardon of an elder, then say you owe them an apology
- offer tea; then refuse help politely
- say you are glad to have met someone
- say you could not hear; ask them to speak gently, then to show you

Before you move on

Pardon me? (మన్నించండి.) An apology? (క్షమాపణ.) Do you want it? (కావాలా?) No need? (అవసరం లేదు.) An introduction? (పరిచయం.) In Telugu? (తెలుగులో.) How do you say it? (ఎలా అంటారు?) Gently? (మెల్లగా.) Show me? (చూపించండి.) I could not hear? (వినిపించలేదు.)

95.7 From ill to well — a second pass

You are ill. Say you have a cold, you feel weak, and your body aches.

Grammar Lens: ill and well in one frame

not well

well again

నాకు నీరసంగా ఉంది

హాయిగా ఉంది

జలుబు చేసింది

క్షేమంగా ఉన్నారా?

The -గా ఉంది frame carries both halves: the weakness and the ease.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ask where the hospital is; say you have been hurt
- tell a friend to take the medicine
- a week later: ask an elder if they are keeping well, and a guest if they are comfortable
- agree gladly; then, when a word fails, ask to be shown, or say you could not hear

Before you move on

A cold? (జలుబు.) Medicine? (మందు.) A hospital? (ఆసుపత్రి.) A wound? (గాయం.) Weakness? (నీరసం.) Wellbeing? (క్షేమం.) Comfortably? (హాయిగా.) Ease? (సుఖం.) Gladly? (సంతోషంగా.) The body? (ఒళ్ళు.)

Chapter 96

Names, Ages, Birthdays

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can give a surname and a nickname, ask an age, talk about a birthday, and sign my name.

Complete TE-C96-signature: the details of a name, from surname to signature.

96.1 ఇంటిపేరు (inṭipēru) — a surname, the family name

Before the new one: say the Telugu for please show me, then the Telugu for I could not hear it.

You'll want to know: ఇంటిపేరు

ఇంటిపేరు (inṭipēru) — “a surname”, literally “the house name”.

It is ఇంటి, “of the house”, and పేరు, “name”. In Telugu the house name comes FIRST, before the given name, so a form that asks for a first name is asking the wrong question.

What you've built

The family name, and where it goes.

Your turn

- Say it: inṭipēru

- *Say it:* *in̩tipēru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nā in̩tipēru ...*, then your given name
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for please show me, then the Telugu for I could not hear it, then say *in̩tipēru* again

Before you move on

What does ఇంటిపేరు mean? (“A surname, the family name”.) Say it once more.

96.2 ముద్దుపేరు (muddupēru) — a nickname, a pet name

Before the new one: say the Telugu for I could not hear it, then the Telugu for a surname.

You’ll want to know: ముద్దుపేరు

ముద్దుపేరు (*muddupēru*) — “a nickname, a pet name”.

ముద్దు is “a kiss, affection”, so a nickname is an *affection name*: the one family uses.

What you’ve built

The name the family uses.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *muddupēru*
- *Say it:* *muddupēru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nā muddupēru ...*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for I could not hear it, then the Telugu for a surname, then say *muddupēru* again

Before you move on

What does ముద్దుపేరు mean? (“A nickname, a pet name”.) Say it once more.

96.3 వయసు (vayasu) — age

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a surname, then the Telugu for a nickname.

You’ll want to know: వయసు

వయసు (*vayasu*) — “age”.

You have asked it already, inside నీ వయసెంత?. Now the word stands alone: మీ వయసు ఎంత? — “what is your age?”, the respectful form.

What you’ve built

The word you have been using inside a question, taken out.

Your turn

- *Say it: vayasu*
- *Say it: vayasu, once more*
- *Say it: ask mī vayasu enta?*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a surname, then the Telugu for a nickname, then say vayasu again*

Before you move on

What does వయసు mean? (“Age”.) Say it once more.

96.4 పుట్టినరోజు (puṭṭinarōju) — a birthday

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a nickname, then the Telugu for age.

You'll want to know: పుట్టినరోజు

పుట్టినరోజు (*puṭṭinarōju*) — “a birthday”, literally “the day one was born”.

రోజు is the day you know. On the day, say పుట్టినరోజు శుభాకాంక్షలు — “happy birthday”, with the good wishes you already have.

What you've built

A day to name, and a wish to make on it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *puṭṭinarōju*
- *Say it:* *puṭṭinarōju*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puṭṭinarōju śubhākāṅkṣalu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a nickname, then the Telugu for age, then say *puṭṭinarōju* again

Before you move on

What does పుట్టినరోజు mean? (“A birthday”.) Say it once more.

96.5 సంతకం (santakam) — a signature

Before the new one: say the Telugu for age, then the Telugu for a birthday.

You'll want to know: సంతకం

సంతకం (*santakam*) — “a signature”.

ఇక్కడ సంతకం చేయండి — “please sign here”. A signature is something you *do*, with the చేయు of పని చేయు.

What you've built

Surname, nickname, age, birthday, signature: every box on a form.

Your turn

- *Say it: santakamī*
- *Say it: santakamī*, once more
- *Say it: say ikkaḍa santakamī cēyaṇḍi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for age, then the Telugu for a birthday, then say santakamī again*

Before you move on

What does సంతకం mean? (“A signature”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 97

Laughing, Crying, Worrying

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can talk about laughing and crying, say I am worried or regretful, and say I am alone.

Complete TE-C97-alone: say how you are when the answer is complicated.

97.1 నవ్వు (navvu) — a laugh, a smile

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a birthday, then the Telugu for a signature.

You'll want to know: నవ్వు

నవ్వు (navvu) — “a laugh”, and “a smile”: Telugu uses one word for both.
నవ్వుండి — “smile!”, with the polite ending, what a photographer says.

What you've built

A laugh and a smile, in one word.

Your turn

- Say it: navvu
- Say it: navvu, once more
- Say it: say navvundi

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a birthday, then the Telugu for a signature, then say *navvu* again

Before you move on

What does నవ్వు mean? (“A laugh, a smile”.) Say it once more.

97.2 ఏడుపు (ēḍupu) — crying, tears

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a signature, then the Telugu for a laugh.

You’ll want to know: ఏడుపు

ఏడుపు (ēḍupu) — “crying”.

నాకు ఏడుపు వచ్చింది — “I felt like crying”, literally “crying came to me”, on the pattern of కోపం వచ్చింది.

What you’ve built

Crying, which comes to you like anger does.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ēḍupu
- *Say it:* ēḍupu, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāku ēḍupu vaccindi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a signature, then the Telugu for a laugh, then say *ēḍupu* again

Before you move on

What does ఏడుపు mean? (“Crying, tears”.) Say it once more.

97.3 విచారం (vicāraṁ) — regret, sorrow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a laugh, then the Telugu for crying.

You'll want to know: విచారం

విచారం (*vicāram*) — “regret, sorrow”.

బాధ is pain; విచారం is the sorrow of looking back. విచారంగా ఉంది — “I am sorry about it”, “I regret it”.

What you've built

A sorrow about something that has happened.

Your turn

- Say it: *vicāram*
- Say it: *vicāram*, once more
- Say it: say *vicāramigā undi*
- Recall: say the Telugu for a laugh, then the Telugu for crying, then say *vicāram* again

Before you move on

What does విచారం mean? (“Regret, sorrow”.) Say it once more.

97.4 ఆందోళన (*āndōḷana*) — anxiety, worry

Before the new one: say the Telugu for crying, then the Telugu for regret.

You'll want to know: ఆందోళన

ఆందోళన (*āndōḷana*) — “anxiety, worry”.

ఆందోళన పడకండి — “don't worry”. Telugu *falls into* worry: పడు is “to fall”.

What you've built

A way to tell someone not to worry.

Your turn

- *Say it:* āndōḷana
- *Say it:* āndōḷana, once more
- *Say it:* say āndōḷana paḍakaṇḍi
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for crying, then the Telugu for regret, then say āndōḷana again

Before you move on

What does ఆందోళన mean? (“Anxiety, worry”.) Say it once more.

97.5 ఒంటరిగా (oṇṭarigā) — alone

Before the new one: say the Telugu for regret, then the Telugu for worry.

You’ll want to know: ఒంటరిగా

ఒంటరిగా (oṇṭarigā) — “alone”.

నేను ఒంటరిగా ఉన్నాను — “I am alone”. The -గా ending again, on a word for “single, on one’s own”.

What you’ve built

Laughing, crying, regret, worry, alone: a fuller answer to how are you.

Your turn

- *Say it:* oṇṭarigā
- *Say it:* oṇṭarigā, once more
- *Say it:* say nēnu oṇṭarigā unnānu
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for regret, then the Telugu for worry, then say oṇṭarigā again

Before you move on

What does **ဆံတဲက** mean? (“Alone”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 98

Nothing, Not Yet, That Will Do

Modes:  voice (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can answer with nothing, not yet, that will do, that's true, and that's the one.

Complete TE-C98-thatone: five short answers that close a question.

98.1 ఏమీ లేదు (ēṁī lēdu) — nothing, it's nothing

Before the new one: say the Telugu for worry, then the Telugu for alone.

You'll want to know: ఏమీ లేదు

ఏమీ లేదు (ēṁī lēdu) — “nothing”, “it's nothing”.

The answer to ఏమైంది?, “what happened?”, when you would rather not say. It ends on the లేదు you have had since your first chapter.

What you've built

An answer that closes a question kindly.

Your turn

- Say it: ēṁī lēdu
- Say it: ēṁī lēdu, once more
- Say it: say ēṁī lēdu

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for worry, then the Telugu for alone, then say *ēmī lēdu* again

Before you move on

What does ఏమీ లేదు mean? (“Nothing, it’s nothing”.) Say it once more.

98.2 ఇంకా లేదు (*inkā lēdu*) — not yet

Before the new one: say the Telugu for alone, then the Telugu for nothing.

You’ll want to know: ఇంకా లేదు

ఇంకా లేదు (*inkā lēdu*) — “not yet”.

Two words you own, ఇంకా, “still”, and లేదు, “there isn’t”. *Have you eaten?* — ఇంకా లేదు.

What you’ve built

An answer from two old words.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *inkā lēdu*
- *Say it:* *inkā lēdu*, once more
- *Say it:* answer *bhōñcēsārā?* with *inkā lēdu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for alone, then the Telugu for nothing, then say *inkā lēdu* again

Before you move on

What does ఇంకా లేదు mean? (“Not yet”.) Say it once more.

98.3 సరిపోతుంది (saripōtundi) — that will do, it is enough

Before the new one: say the Telugu for nothing, then the Telugu for not yet.

You'll want to know: సరిపోతుంది

సరిపోతుంది (*saripōtundi*) — “that will do”, “it is enough”, and of clothes, “it fits”.

It starts on సరి, “right, even”, like సరే and సరిగ్గా.

What you've built

A third word on the same right-even root.

Your turn

- *Say it: saripōtundi*
- *Say it: saripōtundi*, once more
- *Say it: say saripōtundi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for nothing, then the Telugu for not yet, then say saripōtundi again*

Before you move on

What does సరిపోతుంది mean? (“That will do, it is enough”.) Say it once more.

98.4 నిజమే (nijamē) — that's true

Before the new one: say the Telugu for not yet, then the Telugu for that will do.

You'll want to know: నిజమే

నిజమే (*nijamē*) — “that's true”, “quite right”.

It is నిజం with -వీ, the ending that says *exactly this*. Where నిజంగా? asks, నిజమే agrees.

What you've built

Agreement, from the word for truth.

Your turn

- *Say it: nijamē*
- *Say it: nijamē*, once more
- *Say it: say nijamē*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for not yet, then the Telugu for that will do, then say nijamē again*

Before you move on

What does నిజమే mean? (“That’s true”.) Say it once more.

98.5 అదే (adē) — that’s the one, the same

Before the new one: say the Telugu for that will do, then the Telugu for that’s true.

You’ll want to know: అదే

అదే (adē) — “that’s the one”, “the same one”.

It is అది, “that”, with the same -ఏ. When someone finally names what you meant, అదే!

What you've built

Nothing, not yet, that will do, true, that’s the one: five ways to close a question.

Your turn

- *Say it: adē*
- *Say it: adē*, once more
- *Say it: say adē!*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for that will do, then the Telugu for that's true, then say *adē* again

Before you move on

What does అదే mean? (“That’s the one, the same”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 99

Welcomes, Gifts, Invitations

Modes:  voice (7)  Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can greet with namaste, say I am delighted to see someone, congratulate, and talk about gifts and invitations.

Complete TE-R99-second-pass-welcome: short answers and a warm welcome, from cold.

99.1 నమస్తే (namastē) — namaste, hello

Before the new one: say the Telugu for that’s true, then the Telugu for that’s the one.

You’ll want to know: నమస్తే

నమస్తే (namastē) — “namaste”, said with the palms together.

It sits beside నమస్కారం, your first word. Both bow: నమస్తే is “a bow to you”, heard all across India; నమస్కారం is the fuller Telugu form.

What you’ve built

A second hello, shared with most of India.

Your turn

- Say it: namastē
- Say it: namastē, once more

- *Say it:* say *namastē*, then *namaskārami*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for that's true, then the Telugu for that's the one, then say *namastē* again

Before you move on

What does నమస్తే mean? (“Namaste, hello”.) Say it once more.

99.2 ఆనందం (*ānandam*) — delight, joy

Before the new one: say the Telugu for that's the one, then the Telugu for namaste.

You'll want to know: ఆనందం

ఆనందం (*ānandam*) — “delight, joy”.

మిమ్మల్ని చూసి ఆనందంగా ఉంది — “I am delighted to see you”. Stronger than సంతోషం, and in the frame you know.

What you've built

A warmer word for glad.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ānandam*
- *Say it:* *ānandam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mimmalni cūsi ānandamgā undi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for that's the one, then the Telugu for namaste, then say *ānandam* again

Before you move on

What does ఆనందం mean? (“Delight, joy”.) Say it once more.

99.3 అభినందనలు (abhinandanalu) — congratulations, compliments

Before the new one: say the Telugu for namaste, then the Telugu for delight.

You'll want to know: అభినందనలు

అభినందనలు (*abhinandanalu*) — “congratulations”, “compliments” on something done well.

శుభాకాంక్షలు wishes someone well for what is coming; అభినందనలు praises what they have done. A passed exam gets both.

What you've built

Praise for what is done, beside wishes for what comes.

Your turn

- *Say it: abhinandanalu*
- *Say it: abhinandanalu*, once more
- *Say it: say abhinandanalu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for namaste, then the Telugu for delight, then say abhinandanalu again*

Before you move on

What does అభినందనలు mean? (“Congratulations, compliments”.)
Say it once more.

99.4 బహుమతి (bahumati) — a gift, a prize

Before the new one: say the Telugu for delight, then the Telugu for congratulations.

You'll want to know: బహుమతి

బహుమతి (*bahumati*) — “a gift”, and “a prize”.

మీకు ఒక బహుమతి — “a gift for you”, with the dative మీకు.

What you've built

Something to bring when you visit.

Your turn

- *Say it: bahumati*
- *Say it: bahumati*, once more
- *Say it: say mīku oka bahumati*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for delight, then the Telugu for congratulations, then say bahumati again*

Before you move on

What does బహుమతి mean? (“A gift, a prize”.) Say it once more.

99.5 ఆహ్వానం (āhvānam) — an invitation

Before the new one: say the Telugu for congratulations, then the Telugu for a gift.

You'll want to know: ఆహ్వానం

ఆహ్వానం (āhvānam) — “an invitation”.

పెళ్ళికి ఆహ్వానం — “an invitation to the wedding”, with -కి, “to”. It is the reason for most of the visits this book has taught you to make.

What you've built

Namaste, delight, congratulations, a gift, an invitation: the way into a visit.

Your turn

- *Say it: āhvānam*
- *Say it: āhvānam*, once more
- *Say it: say peḷḷiki āhvānam*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for congratulations, then the Telugu for a gift, then say *āhvānani* again

Before you move on

What does ఆహ్వానం mean? (“An invitation”.) Say it once more.

99.6 A warm welcome and short answers — a second pass

A friend arrives at your door. Greet them with palms together, and say you are delighted.

Grammar Lens: the ending -ఏ, “exactly this”

word	built from
నిజమే	truth + -ఏ
అదే	that + -ఏ

The -ఏ points: *this truth and no other, that one exactly.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- hand over a gift; congratulate your friend
- say the wedding invitation came
- someone asks what happened: it’s nothing. Have you eaten? Not yet
- agree that it’s true; say that will do; and “that’s the one!”

Before you move on

Nothing? (ఏమీ లేదు.) Not yet? (ఇంకా లేదు.) That will do? (సరిపోతుంది.) That’s true? (నిజమే.) That’s the one? (అదే.)
Namaste? (నమస్టే.) Delight? (ఆనందం.) Congratulations? (అభినందనలు.) A gift? (బహుమతి.) An invitation? (ఆహ్వానం.)

99.7 Who you are and how you are — a second pass

Give your surname first, then your nickname, then ask someone their age.

Grammar Lens: a name in two parts

word	literally
ఇంటిపేరు	house name
ముద్దుపేరు	affection name
పుట్టినరోజు	born day
Each is built from pieces you know, and the house name goes first.	

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- wish someone a happy birthday; hand them a gift
- ask them to sign here
- tell a friend to smile; then say you felt like crying
- tell a worried friend not to worry; say you regret it; say you are alone
- say an invitation came

Before you move on

A surname? (ఇంటిపేరు.) A nickname? (ముద్దుపేరు.) Age? (వయసు.)
 A birthday? (పుట్టినరోజు.) A signature? (సంతకం.) A laugh? (నవ్వు.)
 Crying? (ఏడుపు.) Regret? (విచారం.) Worry? (ఆందోళన.) Alone?
 (ఒంటరిగా.)

Chapter 100

Right, Left, Straight ahead, Near, Far

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say right, left, straight ahead, near and far.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 100: I can say right, left, straight ahead, near and far.

100.1 కుడి (kuḍi) — right (not left)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a gift, a prize, then the Telugu for an invitation.

You'll want to know: కుడి

కుడి — *kuḍi* — “right (not left)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kuḍi*
- Say it: *kuḍi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kudī*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a gift, a prize, then the Telugu for an invitation, then say *kudī* again

Before you move on

What does కుడి mean? (“Right (not left).”) Say it once more.

100.2 ఎడమ (eḍama) — left (not right)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an invitation, then the Telugu for right.

You’ll want to know: ఎడమ

ఎడమ — *eḍama* — “left (not right).”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eḍama*
- *Say it:* *eḍama*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eḍama*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an invitation, then the Telugu for right, then say *eḍama* again

Before you move on

What does ఎడమ mean? (“Left (not right).”) Say it once more.

100.3 తిన్నగా (tinnagā) — straight ahead

Before the new one: say the Telugu for right, then the Telugu for left.

You'll want to know: తిన్నగా

తిన్నగా — *tinnagā* — “straight ahead”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tinnagā*
- *Say it: tinnagā*, once more
- *Say it: say tinnagā*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for right, then the Telugu for left, then say tinnagā again*

Before you move on

What does తిన్నగా mean? (“Straight ahead”.) Say it once more.

100.4 దగ్గర (daggara) — near

Before the new one: say the Telugu for left, then the Telugu for straight ahead.

One slot changes: ఇక్కడ, అక్కడ, ఎక్కడ. Here, there, where?

You'll want to know: దగ్గర

దగ్గర — *daggara* — “near”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: daggara*
- *Say it: daggara*, once more

- *Say it:* say *daggara*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for left, then the Telugu for straight ahead, then say *daggara* again

Before you move on

What does దగ్గర mean? (“Near”.) Say it once more.

100.5 దూరం (dūraṁ) — far; distance

Before the new one: say the Telugu for straight ahead, then the Telugu for near.

You’ll want to know: దూరం

దూరం — *dūraṁ* — “far; distance”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dūraṁ*
- *Say it:* *dūraṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dūraṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for straight ahead, then the Telugu for near, then say *dūraṁ* again

Before you move on

What does దూరం mean? (“Far; distance”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 101

Above, Below, Inside, Outside, Behind

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say above, below, inside, outside and behind.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 101: I can say above, below, inside, outside and behind.

101.1 పైన (paina) — above, on top

Before the new one: say the Telugu for near, then the Telugu for far; distance.

You'll want to know: పైన

పైన — *paina* — “above, on top”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *paina*
- Say it: *paina*, once more

- *Say it:* say *paina*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for near, then the Telugu for far; distance, then say *paina* again

Before you move on

What does పైన mean? (“Above, on top”.) Say it once more.

101.2 కింద (kinda) — below, underneath

Before the new one: say the Telugu for far; distance, then the Telugu for above.

You’ll want to know: కింద

కింద — *kinda* — “below, underneath”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kinda*
- *Say it:* *kinda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kinda*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for far; distance, then the Telugu for above, then say *kinda* again

Before you move on

What does కింద mean? (“Below, underneath”.) Say it once more.

101.3 లోపల (lōpala) — inside

Before the new one: say the Telugu for above, then the Telugu for below.

You'll want to know: లోపల

లోపల — *lōpala* — “inside”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lōpala*
- *Say it: lōpala*, once more
- *Say it: say lōpala*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for above, then the Telugu for below, then say lōpala again*

Before you move on

What does లోపల mean? (“Inside”.) Say it once more.

101.4 బయట (bayāṭa) — outside

Before the new one: say the Telugu for below, then the Telugu for inside.

You'll want to know: బయట

బయట — *bayāṭa* — “outside”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bayāṭa*
- *Say it: bayāṭa*, once more
- *Say it: say bayāṭa*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for below, then the Telugu for inside, then say *bayata* again

Before you move on

What does బయట mean? (“Outside”.) Say it once more.

101.5 వెనక (venaka) — behind

Before the new one: say the Telugu for inside, then the Telugu for outside.

You’ll want to know: వెనక

వెనక — *venaka* — “behind”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: venaka*
- *Say it: venaka*, once more
- *Say it: say venaka*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for inside, then the Telugu for outside, then say *venaka* again

Before you move on

What does వెనక mean? (“Behind”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 102

In the middle, Street, Road, Bridge, Park

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say in the middle, a street, a road, a bridge and a park.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 102: I can say in the middle, a street, a road, a bridge and a park.

102.1 మధ్యలో (madhyalō) — in the middle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for outside, then the Telugu for behind.

You'll want to know: మధ్యలో

మధ్యలో — *madhyalō* — “in the middle”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *madhyalō*
- Say it: *madhyalō*, once more

- *Say it:* say *madhyalō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for outside, then the Telugu for behind, then say *madhyalō* again

Before you move on

What does మధ్యలో mean? (“In the middle”.) Say it once more.

102.2 వీధి (vīdhi) — a street

Before the new one: say the Telugu for behind, then the Telugu for in the middle.

You’ll want to know: వీధి

వీధి — *vīdhi* — “a street”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vīdhi*
- *Say it:* *vīdhi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vīdhi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for behind, then the Telugu for in the middle, then say *vīdhi* again

Before you move on

What does వీధి mean? (“A street”.) Say it once more.

102.3 రోడ్డు (rōḍḍu) — a road

Before the new one: say the Telugu for in the middle, then the Telugu for a street.

You'll want to know: రోడ్డు

రోడ్డు — *rōḍḍu* — “a road”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rōḍḍu*
- *Say it: rōḍḍu, once more*
- *Say it: say rōḍḍu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for in the middle, then the Telugu for a street, then say rōḍḍu again*

Before you move on

What does రోడ్డు mean? (“A road”.) Say it once more.

102.4 వంతెన (vantena) — a bridge

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a street, then the Telugu for a road.

You'll want to know: వంతెన

వంతెన — *vantena* — “a bridge”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vantena*
- *Say it: vantena, once more*
- *Say it: say vantena*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a street, then the Telugu for a road, then say *vantena* again

Before you move on

What does పంతెన mean? (“A bridge”.) Say it once more.

102.5 పార్కు (pārku) — a park

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a road, then the Telugu for a bridge.

You’ll want to know: పార్కు

పార్కు — *pārku* — “a park”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pārku*
- *Say it:* *pārku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pārku*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a road, then the Telugu for a bridge, then say *pārku* again

Before you move on

What does పార్కు mean? (“A park”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 103

Temple, School, Library, Bank, Market

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a temple, a school, a library, a bank and a market.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 103: I can say a temple, a school, a library, a bank and a market.

103.1 గుడి (guḍi) — a temple

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bridge, then the Telugu for a park.

You'll want to know: గుడి

గుడి — *guḍi* — “a temple”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *guḍi*
- Say it: *guḍi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *guḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bridge, then the Telugu for a park, then say *guḍi* again

Before you move on

What does గుడి mean? (“A temple”.) Say it once more.

103.2 బడి (baḍi) — a school

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a park, then the Telugu for a temple.

You’ll want to know: బడి

బడి — *baḍi* — “a school”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *baḍi*
- *Say it:* *baḍi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a park, then the Telugu for a temple, then say *baḍi* again

Before you move on

What does బడి mean? (“A school”.) Say it once more.

103.3 గ్రంథాలయం (granthālayam) — a library

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a temple, then the Telugu for a school.

You'll want to know: గ్రంథాలయం

గ్రంథాలయం — *granthālayam* — “a library”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: granthālayam*
- *Say it: granthālayam*, once more
- *Say it: say granthālayam*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a temple, then the Telugu for a school, then say granthālayam again*

Before you move on

What does గ్రంథాలయం mean? (“A library.”) Say it once more.

103.4 బ్యాంకు (byāṅku) — a bank

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a school, then the Telugu for a library.

You'll want to know: బ్యాంకు

బ్యాంకు — *byāṅku* — “a bank”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: byāṅku*
- *Say it: byāṅku*, once more
- *Say it: say byāṅku*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a school, then the Telugu for a library, then say *byāṅku* again

Before you move on

What does బ్యాంకు mean? (“A bank.”) Say it once more.

103.5 సంత (santa) — a market

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a library, then the Telugu for a bank.

You’ll want to know: సంత

సంత — *santa* — “a market”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *santa*
- *Say it:* *santa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *santa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a library, then the Telugu for a bank, then say *santa* again

Before you move on

What does సంత mean? (“A market.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 104

Shore, Office, Garden, Corner, Turn

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a shore, an office, a garden, a corner and a turn.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 104: I can say a shore, an office, a garden, a corner and a turn.

104.1 తీరం (tīram) — a shore, a coast

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bank, then the Telugu for a market.

You'll want to know: తీరం

తీరం — *tīram* — “a shore, a coast”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tīram*
- Say it: *tīram*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tīraṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bank, then the Telugu for a market, then say *tīraṁ* again

Before you move on

What does తీరం mean? (“A shore, a coast”.) Say it once more.

104.2 కార్యాలయం (kāryālayam) — an office

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a market, then the Telugu for a shore.

You’ll want to know: కార్యాలయం

కార్యాలయం — *kāryālayam* — “an office”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kāryālayam*
- *Say it:* *kāryālayam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāryālayam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a market, then the Telugu for a shore, then say *kāryālayam* again

Before you move on

What does కార్యాలయం mean? (“An office”.) Say it once more.

104.3 తోట (tōṭa) — a garden

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a shore, then the Telugu for an office.

You'll want to know: తోట

తోట — *tōṭa* — “a garden”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōṭa*
- *Say it: tōṭa*, once more
- *Say it: say tōṭa*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a shore, then the Telugu for an office, then say tōṭa again*

Before you move on

What does తోట mean? (“A garden”.) Say it once more.

104.4 మూల (mūla) — a corner

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an office, then the Telugu for a garden.

You'll want to know: మూల

మూల — *mūla* — “a corner”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūla*
- *Say it: mūla*, once more
- *Say it: say mūla*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an office, then the Telugu for a garden, then say *mūla* again

Before you move on

What does మూల mean? (“A corner”.) Say it once more.

104.5 మలుపు (malupu) — a turn, a bend

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a garden, then the Telugu for a corner.

You’ll want to know: మలుపు

మలుపు — *malupu* — “a turn, a bend”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *malupu*
- *Say it:* *malupu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malupu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a garden, then the Telugu for a corner, then say *malupu* again

Before you move on

What does మలుపు mean? (“A turn, a bend”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 105

Station, Bus, Ability, Skill, Right

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a station, a bus, ability, a skill and a right.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 105: I can say a station, a bus, ability, a skill and a right.

105.1 స్టేషన్ (ṣṭēṣan) — a station

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a corner, then the Telugu for a turn.

You'll want to know: స్టేషన్

స్టేషన్ — ṣṭēṣan — “a station”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṣṭēṣan
- Say it: ṣṭēṣan, once more
- Say it: say ṣṭēṣan

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a corner, then the Telugu for a turn, then say *stēṣan* again

Before you move on

What does స్టేషన్ mean? (“A station”.) Say it once more.

105.2 బస్సు (bassu) — a bus

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a turn, then the Telugu for a station.

You’ll want to know: బస్సు

బస్సు — *bassu* — “a bus”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bassu*
- *Say it:* *bassu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bassu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a turn, then the Telugu for a station, then say *bassu* again

Before you move on

What does బస్సు mean? (“A bus”.) Say it once more.

105.3 సామర్థ్యం (sāmarthyam) — ability

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a station, then the Telugu for a bus.

You'll want to know: సామర్థ్యం

సామర్థ్యం — *sāmarthyam* — “ability”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāmarthyam*
- *Say it: sāmarthyam*, once more
- *Say it: say sāmarthyam*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a station, then the Telugu for a bus, then say sāmarthyam again*

Before you move on

What does సామర్థ్యం mean? (“Ability”.) Say it once more.

105.4 నైపుణ్యం (naipunyaṁ) — a skill

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bus, then the Telugu for ability.

You'll want to know: నైపుణ్యం

నైపుణ్యం — *naipunyaṁ* — “a skill”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naipunyaṁ*
- *Say it: naipunyaṁ*, once more
- *Say it: say naipunyaṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bus, then the Telugu for ability, then say *naipunyaṇi* again

Before you move on

What does నైపుణ్యం mean? (“A skill”.) Say it once more.

105.5 హక్కు (hakku) — a right

Before the new one: say the Telugu for ability, then the Telugu for a skill.

You’ll want to know: హక్కు

హక్కు — *hakku* — “a right”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *hakku*
- *Say it:* *hakku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hakku*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for ability, then the Telugu for a skill, then say *hakku* again

Before you move on

What does హక్కు mean? (“A right”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 106

Chance, Tool, Property, Owner, Strength

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a chance, a tool, property, an owner and strength.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 106: I can say a chance, a tool, property, an owner and strength.

106.1 అవకాశం (avakāśam) — a chance, an opportunity

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a skill, then the Telugu for a right.

You'll want to know: అవకాశం

అవకాశం — *avakāśam* — “a chance, an opportunity”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *avakāśam*
- Say it: *avakāśam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *avakāśam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a skill, then the Telugu for a right, then say *avakāśam* again

Before you move on

What does అవకాశం mean? (“A chance, an opportunity”.) Say it once more.

106.2 పరికరం (parikaram) — a tool

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a right, then the Telugu for a chance.

You’ll want to know: పరికరం

పరికరం — *parikaram* — “a tool”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *parikaram*
- *Say it:* *parikaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parikaram*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a right, then the Telugu for a chance, then say *parikaram* again

Before you move on

What does పరికరం mean? (“A tool”.) Say it once more.

106.3 ఆస్తి (āsti) — property

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a chance, then the Telugu for a tool.

You'll want to know: ఆస్తి

ఆస్తి — *āsti* — “property”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āsti*
- *Say it: āsti*, once more
- *Say it: say āsti*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a chance, then the Telugu for a tool, then say āsti again*

Before you move on

What does ఆస్తి mean? (“Property”.) Say it once more.

106.4 యజమాని (yajamāni) — an owner

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a tool, then the Telugu for property.

You'll want to know: యజమాని

యజమాని — *yajamāni* — “an owner”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yajamāni*
- *Say it: yajamāni*, once more
- *Say it: say yajamāni*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a tool, then the Telugu for property, then say *yajamāni* again

Before you move on

What does యజమాని mean? (“An owner”.) Say it once more.

106.5 బలం (balam) — strength

Before the new one: say the Telugu for property, then the Telugu for an owner.

You’ll want to know: బలం

బలం — *balam* — “strength”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *balam*
- *Say it:* *balam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *balam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for property, then the Telugu for an owner, then say *balam* again

Before you move on

What does బలం mean? (“Strength”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

Wish, Hope, Dream, Intention, Plan

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a wish, hope, a dream, an intention and a plan.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 107: I can say a wish, hope, a dream, an intention and a plan.

107.1 కోరిక (kōrika) — a wish

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an owner, then the Telugu for strength.

You'll want to know: కోరిక

కోరిక — *kōrika* — “a wish”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kōrika*
- Say it: *kōrika*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kōrika*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an owner, then the Telugu for strength, then say *kōrika* again

Before you move on

What does కౌరిక mean? (“A wish.”) Say it once more.

107.2 ఆశ (āśa) — hope

Before the new one: say the Telugu for strength, then the Telugu for a wish.

You’ll want to know: ఆశ

ఆశ — *āśa* — “hope”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āśa*
- *Say it:* *āśa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āśa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for strength, then the Telugu for a wish, then say *āśa* again

Before you move on

What does ఆశ mean? (“Hope.”) Say it once more.

107.3 కల (kala) — a dream

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a wish, then the Telugu for hope.

You'll want to know: కల

కల — *kala* — “a dream”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kala*
- *Say it: kala*, once more
- *Say it: say kala*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a wish, then the Telugu for hope, then say kala again*

Before you move on

What does కల mean? (“A dream”.) Say it once more.

107.4 ఉద్దేశం (uddēśam) — an intention

Before the new one: say the Telugu for hope, then the Telugu for a dream.

You'll want to know: ఉద్దేశం

ఉద్దేశం — *uddēśam* — “an intention”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uddēśam*
- *Say it: uddēśam*, once more
- *Say it: say uddēśam*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for hope, then the Telugu for a dream, then say *uddēśani* again

Before you move on

What does ఉద్దేశం mean? (“An intention”.) Say it once more.

107.5 ప్రణాళిక (praṇālīka) — a plan

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a dream, then the Telugu for an intention.

You’ll want to know: ప్రణాళిక

ప్రణాళిక — *praṇālīka* — “a plan”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *praṇālīka*
- *Say it:* *praṇālīka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *praṇālīka*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a dream, then the Telugu for an intention, then say *praṇālīka* again

Before you move on

What does ప్రణాళిక mean? (“A plan”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

To wish for, To decide, Reason, Therefore, Because of

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to wish for, to decide, a reason, therefore and because of.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 108: I can say to wish for, to decide, a reason, therefore and because of.

108.1 కోరు (kōru) — to wish for, to ask for

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an intention, then the Telugu for a plan.

You'll want to know: కోరు

కోరు — *kōru* — “to wish for, to ask for”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kōru*
- Say it: *kōru*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kōru*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an intention, then the Telugu for a plan, then say *kōru* again

Before you move on

What does కోరు mean? (“To wish for, to ask for”.) Say it once more.

108.2 నిర్ణయించు (nirṇayiñcu) — to decide

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a plan, then the Telugu for to wish for.

You’ll want to know: నిర్ణయించు

నిర్ణయించు — *nirṇayiñcu* — “to decide”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nirṇayiñcu*
- *Say it:* *nirṇayiñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nirṇayiñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a plan, then the Telugu for to wish for, then say *nirṇayiñcu* again

Before you move on

What does నిర్ణయించు mean? (“To decide”.) Say it once more.

108.3 కారణం (kāraṇam) — a reason

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to wish for, then the Telugu for to decide.

You'll want to know: కారణం

కారణం — *kāraṇam* — “a reason”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāraṇam*
- *Say it: kāraṇam*, once more
- *Say it: say kāraṇam*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to wish for, then the Telugu for to decide, then say kāraṇam again*

Before you move on

What does కారణం mean? (“A reason”.) Say it once more.

108.4 అందువల్ల (anduvalla) — therefore

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to decide, then the Telugu for a reason.

You'll want to know: అందువల్ల

అందువల్ల — *anduvalla* — “therefore”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anduvalla*
- *Say it: anduvalla*, once more
- *Say it: say anduvalla*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to decide, then the Telugu for a reason, then say *anduvalla* again

Before you move on

What does అందువల్ల mean? (“Therefore”.) Say it once more.

108.5 వల్ల (valla) — because of

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a reason, then the Telugu for therefore.

You’ll want to know: వల్ల

వల్ల — *valla* — “because of”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *valla*
- *Say it:* *valla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *valla*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a reason, then the Telugu for therefore, then say *valla* again

Before you move on

What does వల్ల mean? (“Because of”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 109

That is exactly why, Bed, Pillow, Blanket, Curtain

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that is exactly why, a bed, a pillow, a blanket and a curtain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 109: I can say that is exactly why, a bed, a pillow, a blanket and a curtain.

109.1 అందుకే (andukē) — that is exactly why

Before the new one: say the Telugu for therefore, then the Telugu for because of.

You'll want to know: అందుకే

అందుకే — *andukē* — “that is exactly why”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *andukē*
- Say it: *andukē*, once more

- *Say it:* say *andukē*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for therefore, then the Telugu for because of, then say *andukē* again

Before you move on

What does అందుకే mean? (“That is exactly why”.) Say it once more.

109.2 మంచం (mañcam) — a bed

Before the new one: say the Telugu for because of, then the Telugu for that is exactly why.

You’ll want to know: మంచం

మంచం — *mañcam* — “a bed”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mañcam*
- *Say it:* *mañcam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mañcam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for because of, then the Telugu for that is exactly why, then say *mañcam* again

Before you move on

What does మంచం mean? (“A bed”.) Say it once more.

109.3 దిండు (diṇḍu) — a pillow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for that is exactly why, then the Telugu for a bed.

You'll want to know: దిండు

దిండు — *diṇḍu* — “a pillow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diṇḍu*
- *Say it: diṇḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say diṇḍu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for that is exactly why, then the Telugu for a bed, then say diṇḍu again*

Before you move on

What does దిండు mean? (“A pillow”.) Say it once more.

109.4 దుప్పటి (duppaṭi) — a blanket

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bed, then the Telugu for a pillow.

You'll want to know: దుప్పటి

దుప్పటి — *duppaṭi* — “a blanket”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: duppaṭi*
- *Say it: duppaṭi*, once more
- *Say it: say duppaṭi*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bed, then the Telugu for a pillow, then say *duppaṭi* again

Before you move on

What does దుప్పటి mean? (“A blanket”.) Say it once more.

109.5 తెర (tera) — a curtain, a screen

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a pillow, then the Telugu for a blanket.

You’ll want to know: తెర

తెర — *tera* — “a curtain, a screen”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tera*
- *Say it:* *tera*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tera*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a pillow, then the Telugu for a blanket, then say *tera* again

Before you move on

What does తెర mean? (“A curtain, a screen”.) Say it once more.

109.6 Places, can and want — a first pass

Say the words for a blanket and a curtain.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- right, left, straight ahead, near, far; distance
- above, below, inside, outside, behind
- in the middle, a street, a road, a bridge, a park
- a temple, a school, a library, a bank, a market
- a shore, an office, a garden, a corner, a turn

Before you move on

Right? (కుడి, *kudī*.) Left? (ఎడమ, *eḍama*.) Straight ahead? (తిన్నగా, *tinnagā*.) Near? (దగ్గర, *daggara*.) Far; distance? (దూరం, *dūram*.) Above? (పైన, *paina*.) Below? (కింద, *kinda*.) Inside? (లోపల, *lōpala*.) Outside? (బయట, *bayāṭa*.) Behind? (వెనక, *venaka*.) In the middle? (మధ్యలో, *madhyalō*.) A street? (వీధి, *vīdhi*.) A road? (రోడ్డు, *rōḍḍu*.) A bridge? (వంతెన, *vantena*.) A park? (పార్కు, *pārku*.) A temple? (గుడి, *guḍi*.) A school? (బడి, *baḍi*.) A library? (గ్రంథాలయం, *granthālayam*.) A bank? (బ్యాంకు, *byāṅku*.) A market? (సంత, *santa*.) A shore? (తీరం, *tīram*.) An office? (కార్యాలయం, *kāryālayam*.) A garden? (తోట, *tōṭa*.) A corner? (మూల, *mūla*.) A turn? (మలుపు, *malupu*.)

109.7 Want, why and the house — a second pass

Say the words for a station and a bus.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a station, a bus, ability, a skill, a right
- a chance, a tool, property, an owner, strength
- a wish, hope, a dream, an intention, a plan
- to wish for, to decide, a reason, therefore, because of
- that is exactly why, a bed, a pillow, a blanket, a curtain

Before you move on

A station? (స్టేషన్, *stēṣan.*) A bus? (బస్సు, *bassu.*) Ability? (సామర్థ్యం, *sāmarthyam.*) A skill? (నైపుణ్యం, *naipunya.*) A right? (హక్కు, *hakku.*) A chance? (అవకాశం, *avakāśam.*) A tool? (పరికరం, *parikaram.*) Property? (ఆస్తి, *āsti.*) An owner? (యజమాని, *yajamāni.*) Strength? (బలం, *balam.*) A wish? (కోరిక, *kōrika.*) Hope? (ఆశ, *āśa.*) A dream? (కల, *kala.*) An intention? (ఉద్దేశం, *uddēśam.*) A plan? (ప్రణాళిక, *praṇālika.*) To wish for? (కోరు, *kōru.*) To decide? (నిర్ణయించు, *nirṇayañcu.*) A reason? (కారణం, *kāraṇam.*) Therefore? (అందువల్ల, *anduvalla.*) Because of? (వల్ల, *valla.*) That is exactly why? (అందుకే, *andukē.*) A bed? (మంచం, *mañcam.*) A pillow? (దిండు, *diṇḍu.*) A blanket? (దుప్పటి, *duppaṭi.*) A curtain? (తెర, *tera.*)

Chapter 110

Lock, Key, Rope, Nail, Scissors

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a lock, a key, a rope, a nail and scissors.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 110: I can say a lock, a key, a rope, a nail and scissors.

110.1 తాళం (tāḷam) — a lock

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a blanket, then the Telugu for a curtain, a screen.

You'll want to know: తాళం

తాళం — tāḷam — “a lock”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: tāḷam
- Say it: tāḷam, once more
- Say it: say tāḷam

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a blanket, then the Telugu for a curtain, a screen, then say *tāḷamī* again

Before you move on

What does తాళం mean? (“A lock”.) Say it once more.

110.2 తాళంచెవి (tāḷamīcevi) — a key

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a curtain, a screen, then the Telugu for a lock.

You’ll want to know: తాళంచెవి

తాళంచెవి — *tāḷamīcevi* — “a key”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tāḷamīcevi*
- *Say it:* *tāḷamīcevi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tāḷamīcevi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a curtain, a screen, then the Telugu for a lock, then say *tāḷamīcevi* again

Before you move on

What does తాళంచెవి mean? (“A key”.) Say it once more.

110.3 తాడు (tāḍu) — a rope

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lock, then the Telugu for a key.

You'll want to know: తాడు

తాడు — *tāḍu* — “a rope”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāḍu*
- *Say it: tāḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say tāḍu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a lock, then the Telugu for a key, then say tāḍu again*

Before you move on

What does తాడు mean? (“A rope”.) Say it once more.

110.4 మేకు (mēku) — a nail (to hammer)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a key, then the Telugu for a rope.

You'll want to know: మేకు

మేకు — *mēku* — “a nail (to hammer)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēku*
- *Say it: mēku*, once more
- *Say it: say mēku*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a key, then the Telugu for a rope, then say *mēku* again

Before you move on

What does మేకు mean? (“A nail (to hammer)”). Say it once more.

110.5 కత్తెర (katterā) — scissors

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a rope, then the Telugu for a nail.

You’ll want to know: కత్తెర

కత్తెర — *katterā* — “scissors”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *katterā*
- *Say it:* *katterā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *katterā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a rope, then the Telugu for a nail, then say *katterā* again

Before you move on

What does కత్తెర mean? (“Scissors”). Say it once more.

Chapter 111

Comb, Soap, Towel, Glasses, Clock

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a comb, soap, a towel, glasses and a clock.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 111: I can say a comb, soap, a towel, glasses and a clock.

111.1 దువ్వెన (duvvena) — a comb

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a nail, then the Telugu for scissors.

You'll want to know: దువ్వెన

దువ్వెన — *duvvena* — “a comb”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: duvvena*
- *Say it: duvvena, once more*
- *Say it: say duvvena*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a nail, then the Telugu for scissors, then say *duvvena* again

Before you move on

What does దువ్వెన mean? (“A comb”.) Say it once more.

111.2 సబ్బు (sabbu) — soap

Before the new one: say the Telugu for scissors, then the Telugu for a comb.

You’ll want to know: సబ్బు

సబ్బు — *sabbu* — “soap”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sabbu*
- *Say it:* *sabbu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sabbu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for scissors, then the Telugu for a comb, then say *sabbu* again

Before you move on

What does సబ్బు mean? (“Soap”.) Say it once more.

111.3 తువ్వాలు (tuvvālu) — a towel

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a comb, then the Telugu for soap.

You'll want to know: తువ్వాలు

తువ్వాలు — *tuvvālu* — “a towel”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuvvālu*
- *Say it: tuvvālu*, once more
- *Say it: say tuvvālu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a comb, then the Telugu for soap, then say tuvvālu again*

Before you move on

What does తువ్వాలు mean? (“A towel”.) Say it once more.

111.4 కళ్ళజోడు (*kallajōḍu*) — glasses, spectacles

Before the new one: say the Telugu for soap, then the Telugu for a towel.

You'll want to know: కళ్ళజోడు

కళ్ళజోడు — *kallajōḍu* — “glasses, spectacles”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kallajōḍu*
- *Say it: kallajōḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say kallajōḍu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for soap, then the Telugu for a towel, then say *kaḷḷajōḍu* again

Before you move on

What does కళ్ళజోడు mean? (“Glasses, spectacles”.) Say it once more.

111.5 గడియారం (gaḍiyāram) — a clock, a watch

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a towel, then the Telugu for glasses.

Name the first Telugu month, చైత్రం, and the last, ఫాల్గుణం. Then say ఆదివారం, the day of the beginning.

You’ll want to know: గడియారం

గడియారం — *gaḍiyāram* — “a clock, a watch”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gaḍiyāram*
- *Say it:* *gaḍiyāram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gaḍiyāram*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a towel, then the Telugu for glasses, then say *gaḍiyāram* again

Before you move on

What does గడియారం mean? (“A clock, a watch”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 112

Bag, Pen, Paper, Drinking glass, Spoon

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bag, a pen, paper, a drinking glass and a spoon.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 112: I can say a bag, a pen, paper, a drinking glass and a spoon.

112.1 సంచి (sañci) — a bag

Before the new one: say the Telugu for glasses, then the Telugu for a clock.

You'll want to know: సంచి

సంచి — *sañci* — “a bag”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *sañci*
- Say it: *sañci*, once more

- *Say it:* say *sañci*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for glasses, then the Telugu for a clock, then say *sañci* again

Before you move on

What does సంచి mean? (“A bag”.) Say it once more.

112.2 కలం (kalam) — a pen

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a clock, then the Telugu for a bag.

You’ll want to know: కలం

కలం — *kalam* — “a pen”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kalam*
- *Say it:* *kalam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a clock, then the Telugu for a bag, then say *kalam* again

Before you move on

What does కలం mean? (“A pen”.) Say it once more.

112.3 కఱితం (kāgitam) — paper

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bag, then the Telugu for a pen.

Read the lines aloud as one run: ఇది పుస్తకం. కుర్చీ ఇక్కడ ఉంది.

You'll want to know: కాగితం

కాగితం — *kāgitam* — “paper”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāgitam*
- *Say it: kāgitam*, once more
- *Say it: say kāgitam*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a bag, then the Telugu for a pen, then say kāgitam again*

Before you move on

What does కాగితం mean? (“Paper”.) Say it once more.

112.4 గ్లాసు (glāsu) — a drinking glass

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a pen, then the Telugu for paper.

You'll want to know: గ్లాసు

గ్లాసు — *glāsu* — “a drinking glass”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: glāsu*
- *Say it: glāsu*, once more
- *Say it: say glāsu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a pen, then the Telugu for paper, then say *glāsu* again

Before you move on

What does గ్లాసు mean? (“A drinking glass”.) Say it once more.

112.5 చెంచా (cemcā) — a spoon

Before the new one: say the Telugu for paper, then the Telugu for a drinking glass.

You’ll want to know: చెంచా

చెంచా — *cemcā* — “a spoon”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cemcā*
- *Say it:* *cemcā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cemcā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for paper, then the Telugu for a drinking glass, then say *cemcā* again

Before you move on

What does చెంచా mean? (“A spoon”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 113

Stove, Candle, Matchbox, Doll, Ball

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a stove, a candle, a matchbox, a doll and a ball.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 113: I can say a stove, a candle, a matchbox, a doll and a ball.

113.1 పొయ్యి (poyyi) — a stove

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a drinking glass, then the Telugu for a spoon.

You'll want to know: పొయ్యి

పొయ్యి — *poyyi* — “a stove”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *poyyi*
- Say it: *poyyi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *poyyi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a drinking glass, then the Telugu for a spoon, then say *poyyi* again

Before you move on

What does పొయ్యి mean? (“A stove”.) Say it once more.

113.2 కొవ్వొత్తి (kovvotti) — a candle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a spoon, then the Telugu for a stove.

Greet the afternoon and the night: శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం, శుభ రాత్రి.

You’ll want to know: కొవ్వొత్తి

కొవ్వొత్తి — *kovvotti* — “a candle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kovvotti*
- *Say it:* *kovvotti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kovvotti*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a spoon, then the Telugu for a stove, then say *kovvotti* again

Before you move on

What does కొవ్వొత్తి mean? (“A candle”.) Say it once more.

113.3 అగ్గిపెట్టె (aggipette) — a matchbox

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a stove, then the Telugu for a candle.

You'll want to know: అగ్గిపెట్టె

అగ్గిపెట్టె — *aggipette* — “a matchbox”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aggipette*
- *Say it: aggipette*, once more
- *Say it: say aggipette*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a stove, then the Telugu for a candle, then say aggipette again*

Before you move on

What does అగ్గిపెట్టె mean? (“A matchbox”.) Say it once more.

113.4 బొమ్మ (bomma) — a doll; a picture

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a candle, then the Telugu for a matchbox.

You'll want to know: బొమ్మ

బొమ్మ — *bomma* — “a doll; a picture”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bomma*
- *Say it: bomma*, once more
- *Say it: say bomma*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a candle, then the Telugu for a matchbox, then say *bomma* again

Before you move on

What does బొమ్మ mean? (“A doll; a picture”.) Say it once more.

113.5 బంతి (banti) — a ball

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a matchbox, then the Telugu for a doll; a picture.

You’ll want to know: బంతి

బంతి — *banti* — “a ball”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *banti*
- *Say it:* *banti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *banti*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a matchbox, then the Telugu for a doll; a picture, then say *banti* again

Before you move on

What does బంతి mean? (“A ball”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 114

Kite, Shirt, Sari, Dhoti, Sandals

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a kite, a shirt, a sari, a dhoti and sandals.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 114: I can say a kite, a shirt, a sari, a dhoti and sandals.

114.1 గాలిపటం (gālipaṭam) — a kite

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a doll; a picture, then the Telugu for a ball.

You'll want to know: గాలిపటం

గాలిపటం — *gālipaṭam* — “a kite”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gālipaṭam*
- *Say it: gālipaṭam*, once more
- *Say it: say gālipaṭam*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a doll; a picture, then the Telugu for a ball, then say *gālipaṭaṇi* again

Before you move on

What does గాలిపటం mean? (“A kite”.) Say it once more.

114.2 చొక్కా (cokkā) — a shirt

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a ball, then the Telugu for a kite.

You’ll want to know: చొక్కా

చొక్కా — *cokkā* — “a shirt”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cokkā*
- *Say it:* *cokkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cokkā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a ball, then the Telugu for a kite, then say *cokkā* again

Before you move on

What does చొక్కా mean? (“A shirt”.) Say it once more.

114.3 చీర (cīra) — a sari

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a kite, then the Telugu for a shirt.

You'll want to know: చీర

చీర — *cīra* — “a sari”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cīra*
- *Say it: cīra*, once more
- *Say it: say cīra*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a kite, then the Telugu for a shirt, then say cīra again*

Before you move on

What does చీర mean? (“A sari”.) Say it once more.

114.4 పంచె (pañce) — a dhoti

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a shirt, then the Telugu for a sari.

You'll want to know: పంచె

పంచె — *pañce* — “a dhoti”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pañce*
- *Say it: pañce*, once more
- *Say it: say pañce*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a shirt, then the Telugu for a sari, then say *pañce* again

Before you move on

What does పంచె mean? (“A dhoti”). Say it once more.

114.5 చెప్పులు (ceppulu) — sandals

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a sari, then the Telugu for a dhoti.

You’ll want to know: చెప్పులు

చెప్పులు — *ceppulu* — “sandals”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ceppulu*
- *Say it:* *ceppulu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ceppulu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a sari, then the Telugu for a dhoti, then say *ceppulu* again

Before you move on

What does చెప్పులు mean? (“Sandals”). Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Cap, Ring, Bangles, Curry, Dal

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a cap, a ring, bangles, a curry and dal.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 115: I can say a cap, a ring, bangles, a curry and dal.

115.1 టాపి (ṭōpī) — a cap, a hat

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a dhoti, then the Telugu for sandals.

You'll want to know: టాపి

టాపి — ṭōpī — “a cap, a hat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭōpī
- Say it: ṭōpī, once more
- Say it: say ṭōpī

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a dhoti, then the Telugu for sandals, then say *ṭōpī* again

Before you move on

What does టోపీ mean? (“A cap, a hat”.) Say it once more.

115.2 ఉంగరం (uṅgaram) — a ring

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sandals, then the Telugu for a cap.

You’ll want to know: ఉంగరం

ఉంగరం — *uṅgaram* — “a ring”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uṅgaram*
- *Say it:* *uṅgaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṅgaram*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for sandals, then the Telugu for a cap, then say *uṅgaram* again

Before you move on

What does ఉంగరం mean? (“A ring”.) Say it once more.

115.3 గాజులు (gājulu) — bangles

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a cap, then the Telugu for a ring.

You'll want to know: గాజులు

గాజులు — *gājulu* — “bangles”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gājulu*
- *Say it: gājulu*, once more
- *Say it: say gājulu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a cap, then the Telugu for a ring, then say gājulu again*

Before you move on

What does గాజులు mean? (“Bangles”.) Say it once more.

115.4 కూర (kūra) — a curry

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a ring, then the Telugu for bangles.

You'll want to know: కూర

కూర — *kūra* — “a curry”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūra*
- *Say it: kūra*, once more
- *Say it: say kūra*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a ring, then the Telugu for bangles, then say *kūra* again

Before you move on

What does కూర mean? (“A curry”.) Say it once more.

115.5 పప్పు (pappu) — dal, lentils

Before the new one: say the Telugu for bangles, then the Telugu for a curry.

You’ll want to know: పప్పు

పప్పు — *pappu* — “dal, lentils”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pappu*
- *Say it:* *pappu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pappu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for bangles, then the Telugu for a curry, then say *pappu* again

Before you move on

What does పప్పు mean? (“Dal, lentils”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 116

Sambar, Rasam, Egg, Fish, Meat

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sambar, rasam, an egg, a fish and meat.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 116: I can say sambar, rasam, an egg, a fish and meat.

116.1 సాంబారు (sāmbāru) — sambar

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a curry, then the Telugu for dal.

You'll want to know: సాంబారు

సాంబారు — *sāmbāru* — “sambar”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāmbāru*
- *Say it: sāmbāru*, once more
- *Say it: say sāmbāru*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a curry, then the Telugu for dal, then say *sāmbāru* again

Before you move on

What does సాంబారు mean? (“Sambar”.) Say it once more.

116.2 రసం (rasam) — rasam

Before the new one: say the Telugu for dal, then the Telugu for sambar.

You’ll want to know: రసం

రసం — *rasam* — “rasam”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rasam*
- *Say it: rasam*, once more
- *Say it: say rasam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for dal, then the Telugu for sambar, then say *rasam* again

Before you move on

What does రసం mean? (“Rasam”.) Say it once more.

116.3 గుడ్డు (guḍḍu) — an egg

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sambar, then the Telugu for rasam.

You'll want to know: గుడ్డు

గుడ్డు — *guḍḍu* — “an egg”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: guḍḍu*
- *Say it: guḍḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say guḍḍu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for sambar, then the Telugu for rasam, then say guḍḍu again*

Before you move on

What does గుడ్డు mean? (“An egg”.) Say it once more.

116.4 చేప (cēpa) — a fish

Before the new one: say the Telugu for rasam, then the Telugu for an egg.

You'll want to know: చేప

చేప — *cēpa* — “a fish”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cēpa*
- *Say it: cēpa*, once more
- *Say it: say cēpa*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for rasam, then the Telugu for an egg, then say *cēpa* again

Before you move on

What does చేప mean? (“A fish”.) Say it once more.

116.5 మాంసం (māṁsaṁ) — meat

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an egg, then the Telugu for a fish.

You’ll want to know: మాంసం

మాంసం — *māṁsaṁ* — “meat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māṁsaṁ*
- *Say it:* *māṁsaṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māṁsaṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an egg, then the Telugu for a fish, then say *māṁsaṁ* again

Before you move on

What does మాంసం mean? (“Meat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 117

Vegetables, Banana, Mango, Coconut, Onion

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say vegetables, a banana, a mango, coconut and an onion.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 117: I can say vegetables, a banana, a mango, coconut and an onion.

117.1 కూరగాయలు (kūragāyalu) — vegetables

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a fish, then the Telugu for meat.

You'll want to know: కూరగాయలు

కూరగాయలు — *kūragāyalu* — “vegetables”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kūragāyalu*
- Say it: *kūragāyalu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kūragāyala*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a fish, then the Telugu for meat, then say *kūragāyala* again

Before you move on

What does కూరగాయలు mean? (“Vegetables”.) Say it once more.

117.2 అరటిపండు (araṭipaṇḍu) — a banana

Before the new one: say the Telugu for meat, then the Telugu for vegetables.

You’ll want to know: అరటిపండు

అరటిపండు — *araṭipaṇḍu* — “a banana”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *araṭipaṇḍu*
- *Say it:* *araṭipaṇḍu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *araṭipaṇḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for meat, then the Telugu for vegetables, then say *araṭipaṇḍu* again

Before you move on

What does అరటిపండు mean? (“A banana”.) Say it once more.

117.3 మామిడిపండు (māmiḍipaṇḍu) — a mango

Before the new one: say the Telugu for vegetables, then the Telugu for a banana.

You'll want to know: మామిడిపండు

మామిడిపండు — *māmidipaṇḍu* — “a mango”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: māmidipaṇḍu*
- *Say it: māmidipaṇḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say māmidipaṇḍu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for vegetables, then the Telugu for a banana, then say māmidipaṇḍu again*

Before you move on

What does మామిడిపండు mean? (“A mango”.) Say it once more.

117.4 కొబ్బరి (kobbari) — coconut

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a banana, then the Telugu for a mango.

You'll want to know: కొబ్బరి

కొబ్బరి — *kobbari* — “coconut”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kobbari*
- *Say it: kobbari*, once more
- *Say it: say kobbari*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a banana, then the Telugu for a mango, then say *kobbari* again

Before you move on

What does కొబ్బరి mean? (“Coconut”.) Say it once more.

117.5 ఉల్లిపాయ (ullipāya) — an onion

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a mango, then the Telugu for coconut.

You’ll want to know: ఉల్లిపాయ

ఉల్లిపాయ — *ullipāya* — “an onion”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ullipāya*
- *Say it:* *ullipāya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ullipāya*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a mango, then the Telugu for coconut, then say *ullipāya* again

Before you move on

What does ఉల్లిపాయ mean? (“An onion”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Tomato, Potato, Aubergine, Ginger, Garlic

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a tomato, a potato, an aubergine, ginger and garlic.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 118: I can say a tomato, a potato, an aubergine, ginger and garlic.

118.1 టమాటా (ṭamāṭā) — a tomato

Before the new one: say the Telugu for coconut, then the Telugu for an onion.

You'll want to know: టమాటా

టమాటా — ṭamāṭā — “a tomato”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭamāṭā
- Say it: ṭamāṭā, once more

- *Say it:* say *ṭamāṭā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for coconut, then the Telugu for an onion, then say *ṭamāṭā* again

Before you move on

What does టమాటా mean? (“A tomato”.) Say it once more.

118.2 బంగాళాదుంప (baṅgālādumpa) — a potato

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an onion, then the Telugu for a tomato.

You’ll want to know: బంగాళాదుంప

బంగాళాదుంప — *baṅgālādumpa* — “a potato”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *baṅgālādumpa*
- *Say it:* *baṅgālādumpa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baṅgālādumpa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an onion, then the Telugu for a tomato, then say *baṅgālādumpa* again

Before you move on

What does బంగాళాదుంప mean? (“A potato”.) Say it once more.

118.3 వంకాయ (vaṅkāya) — an aubergine

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a tomato, then the Telugu for a potato.

You'll want to know: వంకాయ

వంకాయ — *vaṅkāya* — “an aubergine”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaṅkāya*
- *Say it: vaṅkāya*, once more
- *Say it: say vaṅkāya*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a tomato, then the Telugu for a potato, then say vaṅkāya again*

Before you move on

What does వంకాయ mean? (“An aubergine”.) Say it once more.

118.4 అల్లం (allam) — ginger

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a potato, then the Telugu for an aubergine.

You'll want to know: అల్లం

అల్లం — *allam* — “ginger”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: allam*
- *Say it: allam*, once more
- *Say it: say allam*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a potato, then the Telugu for an aubergine, then say *allami* again

Before you move on

What does అల్లం mean? (“Ginger.”) Say it once more.

118.5 వెల్లుల్లి (vellulli) — garlic

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an aubergine, then the Telugu for ginger.

You’ll want to know: వెల్లుల్లి

వెల్లుల్లి — *vellulli* — “garlic”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vellulli*
- *Say it: vellulli*, once more
- *Say it: say vellulli*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an aubergine, then the Telugu for ginger, then say *vellulli* again

Before you move on

What does వెల్లుల్లి mean? (“Garlic.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Honey, Idli, Dosa, Vada, Coffee

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say honey, an idli, a dosa, a vada and coffee.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 119: I can say honey, an idli, a dosa, a vada and coffee.

119.1 తేనె (tēne) — honey

Before the new one: say the Telugu for ginger, then the Telugu for garlic.

You'll want to know: తేనె

తేనె — *tēne* — “honey”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tēne*
- *Say it: tēne*, once more
- *Say it: say tēne*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for ginger, then the Telugu for garlic, then say *tēne* again

Before you move on

What does తేనె mean? (“Honey”.) Say it once more.

119.2 ఇడ్లీ (idli) — an idli

Before the new one: say the Telugu for garlic, then the Telugu for honey.

You’ll want to know: ఇడ్లీ

ఇడ్లీ — *idli* — “an idli”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *idli*
- *Say it:* *idli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *idli*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for garlic, then the Telugu for honey, then say *idli* again

Before you move on

What does ఇడ్లీ mean? (“An idli”.) Say it once more.

119.3 దోశ (dōsa) — a dosa

Before the new one: say the Telugu for honey, then the Telugu for an idli.

You'll want to know: దోశ

దోశ — *dōsa* — “a dosa”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōsa*
- *Say it: dōsa*, once more
- *Say it: say dōsa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for honey, then the Telugu for an idli, then say *dōsa* again

Before you move on

What does దోశ mean? (“A dosa”.) Say it once more.

119.4 వడ (vaḍa) — a vada

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an idli, then the Telugu for a dosa.

You'll want to know: వడ

వడ — *vaḍa* — “a vada”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaḍa*
- *Say it: vaḍa*, once more
- *Say it: say vaḍa*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an idli, then the Telugu for a dosa, then say *vada* again

Before you move on

What does వడ mean? (“A vada”.) Say it once more.

119.5 కాఫీ (kāphī) — coffee

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a dosa, then the Telugu for a vada.

You’ll want to know: కాఫీ

కాఫీ — *kāphī* — “coffee”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kāphī*
- *Say it:* *kāphī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāphī*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a dosa, then the Telugu for a vada, then say *kāphī* again

Before you move on

What does కాఫీ mean? (“Coffee”.) Say it once more.

119.6 The house and things you carry — a first pass

Say the words for a vada and coffee.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a lock, a key, a rope, a nail, scissors
- a comb, soap, a towel, glasses, a clock
- a bag, a pen, paper, a drinking glass, a spoon
- a stove, a candle, a matchbox, a doll; a picture, a ball
- a kite, a shirt, a sari, a dhoti, sandals

Before you move on

A lock? (తాళం, *tāḷam*.) A key? (తాళంచెవి, *tāḷanicevi*.) A rope? (తాడు, *tāḍu*.) A nail? (మేకు, *mēku*.) Scissors? (కత్తెర, *katterā*.) A comb? (దువ్వెన, *duvvena*.) Soap? (సబ్బు, *sabbu*.) A towel? (తువ్వాలు, *tuvvālu*.) Glasses? (కళ్ళజోడు, *kaḷḷajōḍu*.) A clock? (గడియారం, *gaḍiyāram*.) A bag? (సంచి, *sañci*.) A pen? (కలం, *kalam*.) Paper? (కాగితం, *kāgitam*.) A drinking glass? (గ్లాసు, *glāsu*.) A spoon? (చెంచా, *cemcā*.) A stove? (పొయ్యి, *poyyi*.) A candle? (కొవ్వొత్తి, *kovvotti*.) A matchbox? (అగ్గిపెట్టె, *aggipette*.) A doll; a picture? (బొమ్మ, *bomma*.) A ball? (బంతి, *banti*.) A kite? (గాలిపటం, *gālipaṭam*.) A shirt? (చొక్కా, *cokkā*.) A sari? (చీర, *cīra*.) A dhoti? (పంచె, *pañce*.) Sandals? (చెప్పులు, *ceppulu*.)

119.7 Clothes and food — a second pass

Say the words for a cap and a ring.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a cap, a ring, bangles, a curry, dal
- sambar, rasam, an egg, a fish, meat
- vegetables, a banana, a mango, coconut, an onion
- a tomato, a potato, an aubergine, ginger, garlic
- honey, an idli, a dosa, a vada, coffee

Before you move on

A cap? (టోపీ, *ṭōpī*.) A ring? (ఉంగరం, *uṅgarami*.) Bangles? (గాజాలు, *gājalu*.) A curry? (కూర, *kūra*.) Dal? (పప్పు, *pappu*.) Sambar? (సాంబారు, *sāmbāru*.) Rasam? (రసం, *rasami*.) An egg? (గుడ్డు, *guḍḍu*.) A fish? (చేప, *cēpa*.) Meat? (మాంసం, *māṁsam*.) Vegetables? (కూరగాయలు, *kūragāyalu*.) A banana? (అరటిపండు, *araṭipaṇḍu*.) A mango? (మామిడిపండు, *māmiḍipaṇḍu*.) Coconut? (కొబ్బరి, *kobbari*.) An onion? (ఉల్లిపాయ, *ullipāya*.) A tomato? (టమాటా, *ṭamāṭā*.) A potato? (బంగాళాదుంప, *baṅgālādumpa*.) An aubergine? (వంకాయ, *vaṅkāya*.) Ginger? (అల్లం, *allam*.) Garlic? (వెల్లుల్లి, *vellulli*.) Honey? (తేనె, *tēne*.) An idli? (ఇడ్లీ, *iḍlī*.) A dosa? (దోశ, *dōsa*.) A vada? (వడ, *vaḍa*.) Coffee? (కాఫీ, *kāphī*.)

Chapter 120

Sea, Lake, Forest, Leaf, Soil

Modes:  voice (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the sea, a lake, a forest, a leaf and soil.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 120: I can say the sea, a lake, a forest, a leaf and soil.

120.1 సముద్రం (samudram) — the sea

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a vada, then the Telugu for coffee.

You'll want to know: సముద్రం

సముద్రం — *samudram* — “the sea”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samudram*
- *Say it: samudram*, once more
- *Say it: say samudram*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a vada, then the Telugu for coffee, then say *samudrami* again

Before you move on

What does సముద్రం mean? (“The sea”.) Say it once more.

120.2 సరస్సు (sarassu) — a lake

Before the new one: say the Telugu for coffee, then the Telugu for the sea.

You’ll want to know: సరస్సు

సరస్సు — *sarassu* — “a lake”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sarassu*
- *Say it:* *sarassu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sarassu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for coffee, then the Telugu for the sea, then say *sarassu* again

Before you move on

What does సరస్సు mean? (“A lake”.) Say it once more.

120.3 అడవి (aḍavi) — a forest

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the sea, then the Telugu for a lake.

You'll want to know: అడవి

అడవి — *aḍavi* — “a forest”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aḍavi*
- *Say it: aḍavi*, once more
- *Say it: say aḍavi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for the sea, then the Telugu for a lake, then say aḍavi again*

Before you move on

What does అడవి mean? (“A forest”.) Say it once more.

120.4 ఆకు (*āku*) — a leaf

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lake, then the Telugu for a forest.

You'll want to know: ఆకు

ఆకు — *āku* — “a leaf”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āku*
- *Say it: āku*, once more
- *Say it: say āku*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a lake, then the Telugu for a forest, then say *āku* again

Before you move on

What does అకు mean? (“A leaf”.) Say it once more.

120.5 మట్టి (maṭṭi) — soil, earth

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a forest, then the Telugu for a leaf.

You’ll want to know: మట్టి

మట్టి — *maṭṭi* — “soil, earth”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maṭṭi*
- *Say it:* *maṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a forest, then the Telugu for a leaf, then say *maṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does మట్టి mean? (“Soil, earth”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Thunder, Lightning, Storm, Wave, Hill

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say thunder, lightning, a storm, a wave and a hill.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 121: I can say thunder, lightning, a storm, a wave and a hill.

121.1 ఉరుము (urumu) — thunder

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a leaf, then the Telugu for soil.

You'll want to know: ఉరుము

ఉరుము — *urumu* — “thunder”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *urumu*
- Say it: *urumu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *urumu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a leaf, then the Telugu for soil, then say *urumu* again

Before you move on

What does ఉరుము mean? (“Thunder”.) Say it once more.

121.2 మెరుపు (merupu) — lightning

Before the new one: say the Telugu for soil, then the Telugu for thunder.

You’ll want to know: మెరుపు

మెరుపు — *merupu* — “lightning”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *merupu*
- *Say it:* *merupu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *merupu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for soil, then the Telugu for thunder, then say *merupu* again

Before you move on

What does మెరుపు mean? (“Lightning”.) Say it once more.

121.3 తుపాను (tupānu) — a storm

Before the new one: say the Telugu for thunder, then the Telugu for lightning.

Name the seasons: వసంత ఋతువు, వేసవి, వానాకాలం, శీతాకాలం.

You'll want to know: తుపాను

తుపాను — *tupānu* — “a storm”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tupānu*
- *Say it: tupānu*, once more
- *Say it: say tupānu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for thunder, then the Telugu for lightning, then say tupānu again*

Before you move on

What does తుపాను mean? (“A storm”.) Say it once more.

121.4 అల (ala) — a wave

Before the new one: say the Telugu for lightning, then the Telugu for a storm.

You'll want to know: అల

అల — *ala* — “a wave”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ala*
- *Say it: ala*, once more
- *Say it: say ala*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for lightning, then the Telugu for a storm, then say *ala* again

Before you move on

What does అల mean? (“A wave”.) Say it once more.

121.5 కొండ (koṇḍa) — a hill, a mountain

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a storm, then the Telugu for a wave.

You’ll want to know: కొండ

కొండ — *koṇḍa* — “a hill, a mountain”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* koṇḍa
- *Say it:* koṇḍa, once more
- *Say it:* say koṇḍa
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a storm, then the Telugu for a wave, then say koṇḍa again

Before you move on

What does కొండ mean? (“A hill, a mountain”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 122

Waterfall, Island, Cow, Horse, Elephant

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a waterfall, an island, a cow, a horse and an elephant.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 122: I can say a waterfall, an island, a cow, a horse and an elephant.

122.1 జలపాతం (jalapātam) — a waterfall

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a wave, then the Telugu for a hill.

You'll want to know: జలపాతం

జలపాతం — *jalapātam* — “a waterfall”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *jalapātam*
- Say it: *jalapātam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *jalapātami*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a wave, then the Telugu for a hill, then say *jalapātami* again

Before you move on

What does జలపాతం mean? (“A waterfall”.) Say it once more.

122.2 దీవి (dīvi) — an island

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a hill, then the Telugu for a waterfall.

You’ll want to know: దీవి

దీవి — *dīvi* — “an island”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dīvi*
- *Say it:* *dīvi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dīvi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a hill, then the Telugu for a waterfall, then say *dīvi* again

Before you move on

What does దీవి mean? (“An island”.) Say it once more.

122.3 ఆవు (āvu) — a cow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a waterfall, then the Telugu for an island.

You'll want to know: ఆవు

ఆవు — *āvu* — “a cow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āvu*
- *Say it: āvu*, once more
- *Say it: say āvu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a waterfall, then the Telugu for an island, then say āvu again*

Before you move on

What does ఆవు mean? (“A cow”.) Say it once more.

122.4 గుర్రం (*gurram*) — a horse

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an island, then the Telugu for a cow.

You'll want to know: గుర్రం

గుర్రం — *gurram* — “a horse”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gurram*
- *Say it: gurram*, once more
- *Say it: say gurram*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an island, then the Telugu for a cow, then say *gurraṇi* again

Before you move on

What does గుర్రం mean? (“A horse”.) Say it once more.

122.5 ఏనుగు (ēnugu) — an elephant

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a cow, then the Telugu for a horse.

You’ll want to know: ఏనుగు

ఏనుగు — *ēnugu* — “an elephant”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēnugu*
- *Say it:* *ēnugu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēnugu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a cow, then the Telugu for a horse, then say *ēnugu* again

Before you move on

What does ఏనుగు mean? (“An elephant”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 123

Tiger, Lion, Bear, Monkey, Rabbit

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a tiger, a lion, a bear, a monkey and a rabbit.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 123: I can say a tiger, a lion, a bear, a monkey and a rabbit.

123.1 పులి (puli) — a tiger

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a horse, then the Telugu for an elephant.

You'll want to know: పులి

పులి — *puli* — “a tiger”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puli*
- *Say it: puli*, once more
- *Say it: say puli*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a horse, then the Telugu for an elephant, then say *puli* again

Before you move on

What does పులి mean? (“A tiger”.) Say it once more.

123.2 సింహం (simham̐) — a lion

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an elephant, then the Telugu for a tiger.

You’ll want to know: సింహం

సింహం — *simhami* — “a lion”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *simhami*
- *Say it*: *simhami*, once more
- *Say it*: say *simhami*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for an elephant, then the Telugu for a tiger, then say *simhami* again

Before you move on

What does సింహం mean? (“A lion”.) Say it once more.

123.3 ఎలుగుబంటి (elugubaṇṭi) — a bear

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a tiger, then the Telugu for a lion.

You'll want to know: ఎలుగుబంటి

ఎలుగుబంటి — *elugubaṇṭi* — “a bear”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: elugubaṇṭi*
- *Say it: elugubaṇṭi*, once more
- *Say it: say elugubaṇṭi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a tiger, then the Telugu for a lion, then say elugubaṇṭi again*

Before you move on

What does ఎలుగుబంటి mean? (“A bear”.) Say it once more.

123.4 కోతి (kōti) — a monkey

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lion, then the Telugu for a bear.

You'll want to know: కోతి

కోతి — *kōti* — “a monkey”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōti*
- *Say it: kōti*, once more
- *Say it: say kōti*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a lion, then the Telugu for a bear, then say *kōti* again

Before you move on

What does కోతి mean? (“A monkey”.) Say it once more.

123.5 కుందేలు (kundēlu) — a rabbit

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bear, then the Telugu for a monkey.

You’ll want to know: కుందేలు

కుందేలు — *kundēlu* — “a rabbit”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kundēlu*
- *Say it:* *kundēlu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kundēlu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bear, then the Telugu for a monkey, then say *kundēlu* again

Before you move on

What does కుందేలు mean? (“A rabbit”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 124

Deer, Fox, Snake, Tortoise, Parrot

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a deer, a fox, a snake, a tortoise and a parrot.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 124: I can say a deer, a fox, a snake, a tortoise and a parrot.

124.1 జింక (jiṅka) — a deer

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a monkey, then the Telugu for a rabbit.

You'll want to know: జింక

జింక — *jiṅka* — “a deer”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiṅka*
- *Say it: jiṅka*, once more
- *Say it: say jiṅka*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a monkey, then the Telugu for a rabbit, then say *jinka* again

Before you move on

What does జింక mean? (“A deer”.) Say it once more.

124.2 నక్క (nakka) — a fox

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a rabbit, then the Telugu for a deer.

You’ll want to know: నక్క

నక్క — *nakka* — “a fox”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nakka*
- *Say it:* *nakka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakka*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a rabbit, then the Telugu for a deer, then say *nakka* again

Before you move on

What does నక్క mean? (“A fox”.) Say it once more.

124.3 పాము (pāmu) — a snake

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a deer, then the Telugu for a fox.

You'll want to know: పాము

పాము — *pāmu* — “a snake”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāmu*
- *Say it: pāmu*, once more
- *Say it: say pāmu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a deer, then the Telugu for a fox, then say pāmu again*

Before you move on

What does పాము mean? (“A snake”.) Say it once more.

124.4 తాబేలు (tābēlu) — a tortoise

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a fox, then the Telugu for a snake.

You'll want to know: తాబేలు

తాబేలు — *tābēlu* — “a tortoise”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tābēlu*
- *Say it: tābēlu*, once more
- *Say it: say tābēlu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a fox, then the Telugu for a snake, then say *tābēlu* again

Before you move on

What does తాబేలు mean? (“A tortoise”.) Say it once more.

124.5 చిలక (cilaka) — a parrot

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a snake, then the Telugu for a tortoise.

You’ll want to know: చిలక

చిలక — *cilaka* — “a parrot”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cilaka*
- *Say it:* *cilaka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cilaka*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a snake, then the Telugu for a tortoise, then say *cilaka* again

Before you move on

What does చిలక mean? (“A parrot”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Pigeon, Owl, Peacock, Butterfly, Crow

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a pigeon, an owl, a peacock, a butterfly and a crow.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 125: I can say a pigeon, an owl, a peacock, a butterfly and a crow.

125.1 పావురం (pāvuram) — a pigeon

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a tortoise, then the Telugu for a parrot.

You'll want to know: పావురం

పావురం — *pāvuram* — “a pigeon”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *pāvuram*
- Say it: *pāvuram*, once more

- *Say it:* say *pāvuram*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a tortoise, then the Telugu for a parrot, then say *pāvuram* again

Before you move on

What does పావురం mean? (“A pigeon”.) Say it once more.

125.2 గుడ్లగూబ (guḍlagūba) — an owl

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a parrot, then the Telugu for a pigeon.

You’ll want to know: గుడ్లగూబ

గుడ్లగూబ — *guḍlagūba* — “an owl”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *guḍlagūba*
- *Say it:* *guḍlagūba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *guḍlagūba*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a parrot, then the Telugu for a pigeon, then say *guḍlagūba* again

Before you move on

What does గుడ్లగూబ mean? (“An owl”.) Say it once more.

125.3 నెమలి (nemali) — a peacock

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a pigeon, then the Telugu for an owl.

You'll want to know: నెమలి

నెమలి — *nemali* — “a peacock”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nemali*
- *Say it: nemali*, once more
- *Say it: say nemali*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a pigeon, then the Telugu for an owl, then say nemali again*

Before you move on

What does నెమలి mean? (“A peacock”.) Say it once more.

125.4 సీతాకోకచిలుక (sītākōkacilaka) — a butterfly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an owl, then the Telugu for a peacock.

You'll want to know: సీతాకోకచిలుక

సీతాకోకచిలుక — *sītākōkacilaka* — “a butterfly”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sītākōkacilaka*
- *Say it: sītākōkacilaka*, once more
- *Say it: say sītākōkacilaka*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an owl, then the Telugu for a peacock, then say *sītākōkacilaka* again

Before you move on

What does సీతాకోకచిలుక mean? (“A butterfly”.) Say it once more.

125.5 కాకి (kāki) — a crow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a peacock, then the Telugu for a butterfly.

You’ll want to know: కాకి

కాకి — *kāki* — “a crow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kāki*
- *Say it:* *kāki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāki*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a peacock, then the Telugu for a butterfly, then say *kāki* again

Before you move on

What does కాకి mean? (“A crow”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 126

Duck, Pig, Donkey, Camel, Face

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a duck, a pig, a donkey, a camel and the face.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 126: I can say a duck, a pig, a donkey, a camel and the face.

126.1 బాతు (bātu) — a duck

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a butterfly, then the Telugu for a crow.

You'll want to know: బాతు

బాతు — *bātu* — “a duck”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bātu*
- *Say it: bātu, once more*
- *Say it: say bātu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a butterfly, then the Telugu for a crow, then say *bātu* again

Before you move on

What does బాతు mean? (“A duck”.) Say it once more.

126.2 పంది (pandi) — a pig

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a crow, then the Telugu for a duck.

You’ll want to know: పంది

పంది — *pandi* — “a pig”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pandi*
- *Say it:* *pandi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pandi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a crow, then the Telugu for a duck, then say *pandi* again

Before you move on

What does పంది mean? (“A pig”.) Say it once more.

126.3 గాడిద (gāḍida) — a donkey

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a duck, then the Telugu for a pig.

You'll want to know: గాడిద

గాడిద — *gāḍida* — “a donkey”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāḍida*
- *Say it: gāḍida*, once more
- *Say it: say gāḍida*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a duck, then the Telugu for a pig, then say gāḍida again*

Before you move on

What does గాడిద mean? (“A donkey”.) Say it once more.

126.4 ఒంటె (oṇṭe) — a camel

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a pig, then the Telugu for a donkey.

You'll want to know: ఒంటె

ఒంటె — *oṇṭe* — “a camel”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oṇṭe*
- *Say it: oṇṭe*, once more
- *Say it: say oṇṭe*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a pig, then the Telugu for a donkey, then say *onṭe* again

Before you move on

What does ఒంటె mean? (“A camel.”) Say it once more.

126.5 ముఖం (mukham) — the face

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a donkey, then the Telugu for a camel.

You’ll want to know: ముఖం

ముఖం — *mukham* — “the face”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mukham*
- *Say it: mukham*, once more
- *Say it: say mukham*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a donkey, then the Telugu for a camel, then say *mukham* again

Before you move on

What does ముఖం mean? (“The face.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

Tongue, Knee, Shoulder, Eyebrow, Cheek

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the tongue, a knee, a shoulder, an eyebrow and a cheek.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 127: I can say the tongue, a knee, a shoulder, an eyebrow and a cheek.

127.1 నాలుక (nāluka) — the tongue

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a camel, then the Telugu for the face.

You'll want to know: నాలుక

నాలుక — *nāluka* — “the tongue”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāluka*
- *Say it: nāluka, once more*

- *Say it:* say *nāluka*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a camel, then the Telugu for the face, then say *nāluka* again

Before you move on

What does నాలుక mean? (“The tongue”.) Say it once more.

127.2 మోకాలు (mōkālu) — a knee

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the face, then the Telugu for the tongue.

You’ll want to know: మోకాలు

మోకాలు — *mōkālu* — “a knee”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mōkālu*
- *Say it:* *mōkālu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mōkālu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for the face, then the Telugu for the tongue, then say *mōkālu* again

Before you move on

What does మోకాలు mean? (“A knee”.) Say it once more.

127.3 భుజం (bhujam) — a shoulder

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the tongue, then the Telugu for a knee.

You'll want to know: భుజం

భుజం — *bhujani* — “a shoulder”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhujani*
- *Say it: bhujani*, once more
- *Say it: say bhujani*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for the tongue, then the Telugu for a knee, then say bhujani again*

Before you move on

What does భుజం mean? (“A shoulder”.) Say it once more.

127.4 కనుబొమ్మ (kanubomma) — an eyebrow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a knee, then the Telugu for a shoulder.

You'll want to know: కనుబొమ్మ

కనుబొమ్మ — *kanubomma* — “an eyebrow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kanubomma*
- *Say it: kanubomma*, once more
- *Say it: say kanubomma*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a knee, then the Telugu for a shoulder, then say *kanubomma* again

Before you move on

What does కనుబొమ్మ mean? (“An eyebrow”.) Say it once more.

127.5 బుగ్గ (bugga) — a cheek

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a shoulder, then the Telugu for an eyebrow.

You’ll want to know: బుగ్గ

బుగ్గ — *bugga* — “a cheek”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *bugga*
- *Say it*: *bugga*, once more
- *Say it*: say *bugga*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a shoulder, then the Telugu for an eyebrow, then say *bugga* again

Before you move on

What does బుగ్గ mean? (“A cheek”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 128

Chin, Wrist, Elbow, Skin, Blood

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the chin, a wrist, an elbow, the skin and blood.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can say the chin, a wrist, an elbow, the skin and blood.

128.1 గడ్డం (gaḍḍam) — the chin; a beard

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an eyebrow, then the Telugu for a cheek.

You'll want to know: గడ్డం

గడ్డం — *gaḍḍam* — “the chin; a beard”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaḍḍam*
- *Say it: gaḍḍam*, once more
- *Say it: say gaḍḍam*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for an eyebrow, then the Telugu for a cheek, then say *gaḍḍam* again

Before you move on

What does గడ్డం mean? (“The chin; a beard.”) Say it once more.

128.2 మణికట్టు (maṇikaṭṭu) — a wrist

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a cheek, then the Telugu for the chin; a beard.

You’ll want to know: మణికట్టు

మణికట్టు — *maṇikaṭṭu* — “a wrist”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *maṇikaṭṭu*
- *Say it*: *maṇikaṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it*: say *maṇikaṭṭu*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a cheek, then the Telugu for the chin; a beard, then say *maṇikaṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does మణికట్టు mean? (“A wrist.”) Say it once more.

128.3 మోచేయి (mōcēyi) — an elbow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the chin; a beard, then the Telugu for a wrist.

You'll want to know: మోచేయి

మోచేయి — *mōcēyi* — “an elbow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mōcēyi*
- *Say it: mōcēyi*, once more
- *Say it: say mōcēyi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for the chin; a beard, then the Telugu for a wrist, then say mōcēyi again*

Before you move on

What does మోచేయి mean? (“An elbow”.) Say it once more.

128.4 చర్మం (carmanṁ) — the skin

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a wrist, then the Telugu for an elbow.

You'll want to know: చర్మం

చర్మం — *carmanṁ* — “the skin”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: carmanṁ*
- *Say it: carmanṁ*, once more
- *Say it: say carmanṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a wrist, then the Telugu for an elbow, then say *carmam* again

Before you move on

What does చర్మం mean? (“The skin”.) Say it once more.

128.5 రక్తం (raktam) — blood

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an elbow, then the Telugu for the skin.

You’ll want to know: రక్తం

రక్తం — *raktam* — “blood”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *raktam*
- *Say it:* *raktam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raktam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an elbow, then the Telugu for the skin, then say *raktam* again

Before you move on

What does రక్తం mean? (“Blood”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 129

Window curtain, Clay pot, Water pot, Cupboard, Table

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a window curtain, a clay pot, a water pot, a cupboard and a table.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can say a window curtain, a clay pot, a water pot, a cupboard and a table.

129.1 కిటికీతెర (kiṭikītera) — a window curtain

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the skin, then the Telugu for blood.

You'll want to know: కిటికీతెర

కిటికీతెర — *kiṭikītera* — “a window curtain”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kiṭikītera*
- Say it: *kiṭikītera*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kitikitera*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for the skin, then the Telugu for blood, then say *kitikitera* again

Before you move on

What does కిటికీతెర mean? (“A window curtain.”) Say it once more.

129.2 చట్టి (caṭṭi) — a clay pot

Before the new one: say the Telugu for blood, then the Telugu for a window curtain.

You’ll want to know: చట్టి

చట్టి — *caṭṭi* — “a clay pot”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *caṭṭi*
- *Say it:* *caṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for blood, then the Telugu for a window curtain, then say *caṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does చట్టి mean? (“A clay pot.”) Say it once more.

129.3 బిందె (bindē) — a water pot

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a window curtain, then the Telugu for a clay pot.

You'll want to know: బిందె

బిందె — *bindē* — “a water pot”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bindē*
- *Say it: bindē*, once more
- *Say it: say bindē*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a window curtain, then the Telugu for a clay pot, then say bindē again*

Before you move on

What does బిందె mean? (“A water pot”.) Say it once more.

129.4 బీరువా (bīruvā) — a cupboard

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a clay pot, then the Telugu for a water pot.

You'll want to know: బీరువా

బీరువా — *bīruvā* — “a cupboard”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīruvā*
- *Say it: bīruvā*, once more
- *Say it: say bīruvā*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a clay pot, then the Telugu for a water pot, then say *bīruvā* again

Before you move on

What does బీరువా mean? (“A cupboard”.) Say it once more.

129.5 టేబుల్ (ṭēbul) — a table

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a water pot, then the Telugu for a cupboard.

You’ll want to know: టేబుల్

టేబుల్ — *ṭēbul* — “a table”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ṭēbul*
- *Say it:* *ṭēbul*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭēbul*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a water pot, then the Telugu for a cupboard, then say *ṭēbul* again

Before you move on

What does టేబుల్ mean? (“A table”.) Say it once more.

129.6 Food and nature — a first pass

Say the words for a cupboard and a table.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the sea, a lake, a forest, a leaf, soil
- thunder, lightning, a storm, a wave, a hill
- a waterfall, an island, a cow, a horse, an elephant
- a tiger, a lion, a bear, a monkey, a rabbit
- a deer, a fox, a snake, a tortoise, a parrot

Before you move on

The sea? (సముద్రం, *samudrami.*) A lake? (సరస్సు, *sarassu.*) A forest? (అడవి, *aḍavi.*) A leaf? (ఆకు, *āku.*) Soil? (మట్టి, *maṭṭi.*) Thunder? (ఉరుము, *urumu.*) Lightning? (మెరుపు, *merupu.*) A storm? (తుపాను, *tupānu.*) A wave? (అల, *ala.*) A hill? (కొండ, *koṇḍa.*) A waterfall? (జలపాతం, *jalapātami.*) An island? (దీవి, *dīvi.*) A cow? (ఆవు, *āvu.*) A horse? (గుర్రం, *gurrami.*) An elephant? (ఏనుగు, *ēnugu.*) A tiger? (పులి, *puli.*) A lion? (సింహం, *siṁhani.*) A bear? (ఎలుగుబంటి, *elugubaṇṭi.*) A monkey? (కోతి, *kōti.*) A rabbit? (కుందేలు, *kundēlu.*) A deer? (జింక, *jinka.*) A fox? (నక్క, *nakka.*) A snake? (పాము, *pāmu.*) A tortoise? (తాబేలు, *tābēlu.*) A parrot? (చిలక, *cilaka.*)

129.7 Nature and animals — a second pass

Say the words for a pigeon and an owl.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a pigeon, an owl, a peacock, a butterfly, a crow
- a duck, a pig, a donkey, a camel, the face
- the tongue, a knee, a shoulder, an eyebrow, a cheek
- the chin; a beard, a wrist, an elbow, the skin, blood
- a window curtain, a clay pot, a water pot, a cupboard, a table

Before you move on

A pigeon? (పావురం, *pāvuram*.) An owl? (గుడ్డగూబ, *guḍlagūba*.) A peacock? (నెమలి, *nemali*.) A butterfly? (సీతాకోకచిలుక, *sītākōkacilaka*.) A crow? (కాకి, *kāki*.) A duck? (బాతు, *bātu*.) A pig? (పంది, *pandi*.) A donkey? (గాడిద, *gāḍida*.) A camel? (ఒంటె, *oṇṭe*.) The face? (ముఖం, *mukham*.) The tongue? (నాలుక, *nāluka*.) A knee? (మోకాలు, *mōkālu*.) A shoulder? (భుజం, *bhujam*.) An eyebrow? (కనుబొమ్మ, *kanubomma*.) A cheek? (బుగ్గ, *bugga*.) The chin; a beard? (గడ్డం, *gaḍḍam*.) A wrist? (మణికట్టు, *maṇikaṭṭu*.) An elbow? (మోచేయి, *mōcēyi*.) The skin? (చర్మం, *carmam*.) Blood? (రక్తం, *raktam*.) A window curtain? (కిటికీతెర, *kiṭikītera*.) A clay pot? (చట్టి, *caṭṭi*.) A water pot? (బిందె, *bindē*.) A cupboard? (బీరువా, *bīruvā*.) A table? (టేబుల్, *ṭēbul*.)

Chapter 130

Television, Computer, Phone, Ticket, Paisa

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a television, a computer, a phone, a ticket and a paisa.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can say a television, a computer, a phone, a ticket and a paisa.

130.1 టీవీ (ṭīvī) — a television

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a cupboard, then the Telugu for a table.

You'll want to know: టీవీ

టీవీ — ṭīvī — “a television”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭīvī
- Say it: ṭīvī, once more

- *Say it:* say *ṭivī*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a cupboard, then the Telugu for a table, then say *ṭivī* again

Before you move on

What does టీవీ mean? (“A television”.) Say it once more.

130.2 కంప్యూటర్ (kampyūṭar) — a computer

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a table, then the Telugu for a television.

You’ll want to know: కంప్యూటర్

కంప్యూటర్ — *kampyūṭar* — “a computer”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kampyūṭar*
- *Say it:* *kampyūṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kampyūṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a table, then the Telugu for a television, then say *kampyūṭar* again

Before you move on

What does కంప్యూటర్ mean? (“A computer”.) Say it once more.

130.3 ఫోను (phōnu) — a phone

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a television, then the Telugu for a computer.

You'll want to know: ఫోను

ఫోను — *phōnu* — “a phone”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phōnu*
- *Say it: phōnu*, once more
- *Say it: say phōnu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a television, then the Telugu for a computer, then say phōnu again*

Before you move on

What does ఫోను mean? (“A phone”.) Say it once more.

130.4 టిక్కెట్టు (ṭikkeṭṭu) — a ticket

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a computer, then the Telugu for a phone.

Count on with -వ: పదవ, then పదకొండవ.

You'll want to know: టిక్కెట్టు

టిక్కెట్టు — *ṭikkeṭṭu* — “a ticket”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭikkeṭṭu*
- *Say it: ṭikkeṭṭu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *ṭikkēṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a computer, then the Telugu for a phone, then say *ṭikkēṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does టిక్కెట్టు mean? (“A ticket”.) Say it once more.

130.5 పైసా (paisā) — a paisa, small change

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a phone, then the Telugu for a ticket.

Count ఒకటి to పది, and hear how nearly every one ends in *-u*.

You’ll want to know: పైసా

పైసా — *paisā* — “a paisa, small change”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *paisā*
- *Say it:* *paisā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paisā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a phone, then the Telugu for a ticket, then say *paisā* again

Before you move on

What does పైసా mean? (“A paisa, small change”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 131

Rupee, Bottle, Long skirt, Pocket, Belt

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a rupee, a bottle, a long skirt, a pocket and a belt.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can say a rupee, a bottle, a long skirt, a pocket and a belt.

131.1 రూపాయి (rūpāyi) — a rupee

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a ticket, then the Telugu for a paisa.

You'll want to know: రూపాయి

రూపాయి — *rūpāyi* — “a rupee”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *rūpāyi*
- Say it: *rūpāyi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *rūpāyi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a ticket, then the Telugu for a paisa, then say *rūpāyi* again

Before you move on

What does రూపాయి mean? (“A rupee”.) Say it once more.

131.2 బాటిలు (bāṭilu) — a bottle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a paisa, then the Telugu for a rupee.

You’ll want to know: బాటిలు

బాటిలు — *bāṭilu* — “a bottle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bāṭilu*
- *Say it:* *bāṭilu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāṭilu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a paisa, then the Telugu for a rupee, then say *bāṭilu* again

Before you move on

What does బాటిలు mean? (“A bottle”.) Say it once more.

131.3 లాంగ్ (laṅgā) — a long skirt

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a rupee, then the Telugu for a bottle.

You'll want to know: లంగ

లంగ — *laṅgā* — “a long skirt”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laṅgā*
- *Say it: laṅgā*, once more
- *Say it: say laṅgā*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a rupee, then the Telugu for a bottle, then say laṅgā again*

Before you move on

What does లంగ mean? (“A long skirt”.) Say it once more.

131.4 జేబు (jēbu) — a pocket

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bottle, then the Telugu for a long skirt.

You'll want to know: జేబు

జేబు — *jēbu* — “a pocket”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jēbu*
- *Say it: jēbu*, once more
- *Say it: say jēbu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bottle, then the Telugu for a long skirt, then say *jēbu* again

Before you move on

What does జేబు mean? (“A pocket.”) Say it once more.

131.5 బెల్టు (beltu) — a belt

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a long skirt, then the Telugu for a pocket.

You’ll want to know: బెల్టు

బెల్టు — *beltu* — “a belt”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beltu*
- *Say it:* *beltu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beltu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a long skirt, then the Telugu for a pocket, then say *beltu* again

Before you move on

What does బెల్టు mean? (“A belt.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

Socks, Coat, Dhoti, Blouse, Lotus

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say socks, a coat, a dhoti, a blouse and a lotus.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can say socks, a coat, a dhoti, a blouse and a lotus.

132.1 సాక్సు (sāksu) — socks

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a pocket, then the Telugu for a belt.

You'll want to know: సాక్సు

సాక్సు — *sāksu* — “socks”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāksu*
- *Say it: sāksu, once more*
- *Say it: say sāksu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a pocket, then the Telugu for a belt, then say *sāksu* again

Before you move on

What does సాక్సు mean? (“Socks”.) Say it once more.

132.2 కోటు (kōṭu) — a coat

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a belt, then the Telugu for socks.

You’ll want to know: కోటు

కోటు — *kōṭu* — “a coat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kōṭu*
- *Say it:* *kōṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kōṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a belt, then the Telugu for socks, then say *kōṭu* again

Before you move on

What does కోటు mean? (“A coat”.) Say it once more.

132.3 ధోతి (dhōti) — a dhoti

Before the new one: say the Telugu for socks, then the Telugu for a coat.

You'll want to know: ధోతి

ధోతి — *dhōti* — “a dhoti”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhōti*
- *Say it: dhōti*, once more
- *Say it: say dhōti*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for socks, then the Telugu for a coat, then say dhōti again*

Before you move on

What does ధోతి mean? (“A dhoti”.) Say it once more.

132.4 జాకెట్టు (jākeṭṭu) — a blouse

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a coat, then the Telugu for a dhoti.

You'll want to know: జాకెట్టు

జాకెట్టు — *jākeṭṭu* — “a blouse”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jākeṭṭu*
- *Say it: jākeṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it: say jākeṭṭu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a coat, then the Telugu for a dhoti, then say *jāketṭu* again

Before you move on

What does జాకెట్టు mean? (“A blouse”.) Say it once more.

132.5 తామరపువ్వు (tāmarapuvvu) — a lotus

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a dhoti, then the Telugu for a blouse.

You’ll want to know: తామరపువ్వు

తామరపువ్వు — *tāmarapuvvu* — “a lotus”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tāmarapuvvu*
- *Say it:* *tāmarapuvvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tāmarapuvvu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a dhoti, then the Telugu for a blouse, then say *tāmarapuvvu* again

Before you move on

What does తామరపువ్వు mean? (“A lotus”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 133

Clothes, Moustache, Tears, Boat, Train

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say clothes, a moustache, tears, a boat and a train.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can say clothes, a moustache, tears, a boat and a train.

133.1 గుడ్డలు (guḍḍalu) — clothes, cloth

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a blouse, then the Telugu for a lotus.

You'll want to know: గుడ్డలు

గుడ్డలు — *guḍḍalu* — “clothes, cloth”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *guḍḍalu*
- Say it: *guḍḍalu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *guḍḍalu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a blouse, then the Telugu for a lotus, then say *guḍḍalu* again

Before you move on

What does గుడ్డలు mean? (“Clothes, cloth”.) Say it once more.

133.2 మీసాలు (mīsālu) — a moustache

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lotus, then the Telugu for clothes.

You’ll want to know: మీసాలు

మీసాలు — *mīsālu* — “a moustache”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mīsālu*
- *Say it:* *mīsālu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mīsālu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a lotus, then the Telugu for clothes, then say *mīsālu* again

Before you move on

What does మీసాలు mean? (“A moustache”.) Say it once more.

133.3 కంటినీరు (kaṇṭinīru) — tears

Before the new one: say the Telugu for clothes, then the Telugu for a moustache.

You'll want to know: కంటినీరు

కంటినీరు — *kaṇṭinīru* — “tears”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇṭinīru*
- *Say it: kaṇṭinīru*, once more
- *Say it: say kaṇṭinīru*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for clothes, then the Telugu for a moustache, then say kaṇṭinīru again*

Before you move on

What does కంటినీరు mean? (“Tears”.) Say it once more.

133.4 పడవ (paḍava) — a boat

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a moustache, then the Telugu for tears.

You'll want to know: పడవ

పడవ — *paḍava* — “a boat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paḍava*
- *Say it: paḍava*, once more
- *Say it: say paḍava*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a moustache, then the Telugu for tears, then say *paḍava* again

Before you move on

What does పడవ mean? (“A boat”.) Say it once more.

133.5 రైలు (railu) — a train

Before the new one: say the Telugu for tears, then the Telugu for a boat.

You’ll want to know: రైలు

రైలు — *railu* — “a train”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *railu*
- *Say it:* *railu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *railu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for tears, then the Telugu for a boat, then say *railu* again

Before you move on

What does రైలు mean? (“A train”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

Car, Bicycle, Aeroplane, Grain, Wheat

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a car, a bicycle, an aeroplane, grain and wheat.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can say a car, a bicycle, an aeroplane, grain and wheat.

134.1 కారు (kāru) — a car

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a boat, then the Telugu for a train.

You'll want to know: కారు

కారు — *kāru* — “a car”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kāru*
- Say it: *kāru*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kāru*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a boat, then the Telugu for a train, then say *kāru* again

Before you move on

What does కారు mean? (“A car”.) Say it once more.

134.2 సైకిలు (sāikilu) — a bicycle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a train, then the Telugu for a car.

You’ll want to know: సైకిలు

సైకిలు — *sāikilu* — “a bicycle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sāikilu*
- *Say it:* *sāikilu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāikilu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a train, then the Telugu for a car, then say *sāikilu* again

Before you move on

What does సైకిలు mean? (“A bicycle”.) Say it once more.

134.3 విమానం (vimānam) — an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a car, then the Telugu for a bicycle.

You'll want to know: విమానం

విమానం — *vimānaṁ* — “an aeroplane”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vimānaṁ*
- *Say it: vimānaṁ*, once more
- *Say it: say vimānaṁ*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a car, then the Telugu for a bicycle, then say vimānaṁ again*

Before you move on

What does విమానం mean? (“An aeroplane”.) Say it once more.

134.4 ధాన్యం (dhānyam) — grain

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bicycle, then the Telugu for an aeroplane.

You'll want to know: ధాన్యం

ధాన్యం — *dhānyam* — “grain”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhānyam*
- *Say it: dhānyam*, once more
- *Say it: say dhānyam*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bicycle, then the Telugu for an aeroplane, then say *dhānyani* again

Before you move on

What does ధాన్యం mean? (“Grain”.) Say it once more.

134.5 గోధుమలు (gōdhumalu) — wheat

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an aeroplane, then the Telugu for grain.

You’ll want to know: గోధుమలు

గోధుమలు — *gōdhumalu* — “wheat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gōdhumalu*
- *Say it:* *gōdhumalu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gōdhumalu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an aeroplane, then the Telugu for grain, then say *gōdhumalu* again

Before you move on

What does గోధుమలు mean? (“Wheat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 135

Black pepper, Cumin, Tamarind, Lemon, Grapes

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say black pepper, cumin, tamarind, a lemon and grapes.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can say black pepper, cumin, tamarind, a lemon and grapes.

135.1 మిరియాలు (miriyālu) — black pepper

Before the new one: say the Telugu for grain, then the Telugu for wheat.

You'll want to know: మిరియాలు

మిరియాలు — *miriyālu* — “black pepper”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *miriyālu*
- Say it: *miriyālu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *miriyālu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for grain, then the Telugu for wheat, then say *miriyālu* again

Before you move on

What does మిరియాలు mean? (“Black pepper”.) Say it once more.

135.2 జీలకర్ర (jīlakarra) — cumin

Before the new one: say the Telugu for wheat, then the Telugu for black pepper.

You’ll want to know: జీలకర్ర

జీలకర్ర — *jīlakarra* — “cumin”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jīlakarra*
- *Say it:* *jīlakarra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jīlakarra*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for wheat, then the Telugu for black pepper, then say *jīlakarra* again

Before you move on

What does జీలకర్ర mean? (“Cumin”.) Say it once more.

135.3 చింతపండు (cintapaṇḍu) — tamarind

Before the new one: say the Telugu for black pepper, then the Telugu for cumin.

You'll want to know: చింతపండు

చింతపండు — *cintapaṇḍu* — “tamarind”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cintapaṇḍu*
- *Say it: cintapaṇḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say cintapaṇḍu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for black pepper, then the Telugu for cumin, then say cintapaṇḍu again*

Before you move on

What does చింతపండు mean? (“Tamarind”.) Say it once more.

135.4 నిమ్మకాయ (nimmakāya) — a lemon

Before the new one: say the Telugu for cumin, then the Telugu for tamarind.

You'll want to know: నిమ్మకాయ

నిమ్మకాయ — *nimmakāya* — “a lemon”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nimmakāya*
- *Say it: nimmakāya*, once more
- *Say it: say nimmakāya*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for cumin, then the Telugu for tamarind, then say *nimmakāya* again

Before you move on

What does నిమ్మకాయ mean? (“A lemon”.) Say it once more.

135.5 ద్రాక్ష (drākṣa) — grapes

Before the new one: say the Telugu for tamarind, then the Telugu for a lemon.

You’ll want to know: ద్రాక్ష

ద్రాక్ష — *drākṣa* — “grapes”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *drākṣa*
- *Say it:* *drākṣa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *drākṣa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for tamarind, then the Telugu for a lemon, then say *drākṣa* again

Before you move on

What does ద్రాక్ష mean? (“Grapes”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 136

Guava, Sugar, Tall, Short, Heavy

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a guava, sugar, tall, short and heavy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can say a guava, sugar, tall, short and heavy.

136.1 జామపండు (jāmapaṇḍu) — a guava

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lemon, then the Telugu for grapes.

You'll want to know: జామపండు

జామపండు — jāmapaṇḍu — “a guava”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: jāmapaṇḍu
- Say it: jāmapaṇḍu, once more
- Say it: say jāmapaṇḍu

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a lemon, then the Telugu for grapes, then say *jāmapaṇḍu* again

Before you move on

What does జామపండు mean? (“A guava”.) Say it once more.

136.2 పంచదార (pañcadāra) — sugar

Before the new one: say the Telugu for grapes, then the Telugu for a guava.

You’ll want to know: పంచదార

పంచదార — *pañcadāra* — “sugar”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pañcadāra*
- *Say it:* *pañcadāra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pañcadāra*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for grapes, then the Telugu for a guava, then say *pañcadāra* again

Before you move on

What does పంచదార mean? (“Sugar”.) Say it once more.

136.3 పొడవు (poḍavu) — tall, long

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a guava, then the Telugu for sugar.

An adjective goes before the noun and does not change: పాత పుస్తకం, కొత్త పుస్తకం.

You'll want to know: పొడవు

పొడవు — *poḍavu* — “tall, long”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poḍavu*
- *Say it: poḍavu*, once more
- *Say it: say poḍavu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a guava, then the Telugu for sugar, then say poḍavu again*

Before you move on

What does పొడవు mean? (“Tall, long”.) Say it once more.

136.4 పొట్టి (poṭṭi) — short

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sugar, then the Telugu for tall.

You'll want to know: పొట్టి

పొట్టి — *poṭṭi* — “short”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṭṭi*
- *Say it: poṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it: say poṭṭi*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for sugar, then the Telugu for tall, then say *potṭi* again

Before you move on

What does పొట్టి mean? (“Short”.) Say it once more.

136.5 బరువు (baruvu) — heavy

Before the new one: say the Telugu for tall, then the Telugu for short.

You’ll want to know: బరువు

బరువు — *baruvu* — “heavy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *baruvu*
- *Say it:* *baruvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baruvu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for tall, then the Telugu for short, then say *baruvu* again

Before you move on

What does బరువు mean? (“Heavy”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

Light, Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say light, soft, hard, clean and dirty.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can say light, soft, hard, clean and dirty.

137.1 తేలిక (tēlika) — light (in weight)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for short, then the Telugu for heavy.

You'll want to know: తేలిక

తేలిక — *tēlika* — “light (in weight)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tēlika*
- *Say it: tēlika, once more*
- *Say it: say tēlika*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for short, then the Telugu for heavy, then say *tēlika* again

Before you move on

What does తేలిక mean? (“Light (in weight)”). Say it once more.

137.2 మెత్తని (mettani) — soft

Before the new one: say the Telugu for heavy, then the Telugu for light.

You’ll want to know: మెత్తని

మెత్తని — *mettani* — “soft”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mettani*
- *Say it:* *mettani*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mettani*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for heavy, then the Telugu for light, then say *mettani* again

Before you move on

What does మెత్తని mean? (“Soft”). Say it once more.

137.3 గట్టి (gaṭṭi) — hard

Before the new one: say the Telugu for light, then the Telugu for soft.

You'll want to know: గట్టి

గట్టి — *gaṭṭi* — “hard”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaṭṭi*
- *Say it: gaṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it: say gaṭṭi*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for light, then the Telugu for soft, then say gaṭṭi again*

Before you move on

What does గట్టి mean? (“Hard”.) Say it once more.

137.4 శుభ్రం (śubhram) — clean

Before the new one: say the Telugu for soft, then the Telugu for hard.

You'll want to know: శుభ్రం

శుభ్రం — *śubhram* — “clean”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śubhram*
- *Say it: śubhram*, once more
- *Say it: say śubhram*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for soft, then the Telugu for hard, then say *śubhrami* again

Before you move on

What does శుభ్రం mean? (“Clean.”) Say it once more.

137.5 మురికి (murikī) — dirty

Before the new one: say the Telugu for hard, then the Telugu for clean.

You’ll want to know: మురికి

మురికి — *murikī* — “dirty”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *murikī*
- *Say it:* *murikī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *murikī*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for hard, then the Telugu for clean, then say *murikī* again

Before you move on

What does మురికి mean? (“Dirty.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

Fast, Beautiful, Deep, Wide, Narrow

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say fast, beautiful, deep, wide and narrow.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say fast, beautiful, deep, wide and narrow.

138.1 వేగం (vēgam) — fast; speed

Before the new one: say the Telugu for clean, then the Telugu for dirty.

You'll want to know: వేగం

వేగం — *vēgam* — “fast; speed”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *vēgam*
- Say it: *vēgam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *vēgam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for clean, then the Telugu for dirty, then say *vēgam* again

Before you move on

What does వేగం mean? (“Fast; speed.”) Say it once more.

138.2 అందమైన (andamaina) — beautiful

Before the new one: say the Telugu for dirty, then the Telugu for fast; speed.

An adjective goes before the noun and does not change: పాత పుస్తకం, కొత్త పుస్తకం.

You’ll want to know: అందమైన

అందమైన — *andamaina* — “beautiful”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *andamaina*
- *Say it:* *andamaina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *andamaina*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for dirty, then the Telugu for fast; speed, then say *andamaina* again

Before you move on

What does అందమైన mean? (“Beautiful.”) Say it once more.

138.3 లోతు (lōtu) — deep

Before the new one: say the Telugu for fast; speed, then the Telugu for beautiful.

You'll want to know: లోతు

లోతు — *lōtu* — “deep”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lōtu*
- *Say it: lōtu*, once more
- *Say it: say lōtu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for fast; speed, then the Telugu for beautiful, then say lōtu again*

Before you move on

What does లోతు mean? (“Deep”.) Say it once more.

138.4 వెడల్పు (vedalpu) — wide

Before the new one: say the Telugu for beautiful, then the Telugu for deep.

You'll want to know: వెడల్పు

వెడల్పు — *vedalpu* — “wide”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vedalpu*
- *Say it: vedalpu*, once more
- *Say it: say vedalpu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for beautiful, then the Telugu for deep, then say vedalpu again*

Before you move on

What does వెడల్పు mean? (“Wide”.) Say it once more.

138.5 ఇరుకు (iruku) — narrow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for deep, then the Telugu for wide.

You’ll want to know: ఇరుకు

ఇరుకు — *iruku* — “narrow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iruku*
- *Say it: iruku*, once more
- *Say it: say iruku*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for deep, then the Telugu for wide, then say iruku again*

Before you move on

What does ఇరుకు mean? (“Narrow”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 139

Wet, Dry, Poor, Old, Famous

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say wet, dry, poor, old and famous.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can say wet, dry, poor, old and famous.

139.1 తడి (taḍi) — wet

Before the new one: say the Telugu for wide, then the Telugu for narrow.

You'll want to know: తడి

తడి — *taḍi* — “wet”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taḍi*
- *Say it: taḍi*, once more
- *Say it: say taḍi*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for wide, then the Telugu for narrow, then say *taḍi* again

Before you move on

What does తడి mean? (“Wet”.) Say it once more.

139.2 పొడి (poḍi) — dry

Before the new one: say the Telugu for narrow, then the Telugu for wet.

You’ll want to know: పొడి

పొడి — *poḍi* — “dry”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *poḍi*
- *Say it:* *poḍi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for narrow, then the Telugu for wet, then say *poḍi* again

Before you move on

What does పొడి mean? (“Dry”.) Say it once more.

139.3 పేద (pēda) — poor

Before the new one: say the Telugu for wet, then the Telugu for dry.

You'll want to know: పేద

పేద — *pēda* — “poor”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pēda*
- *Say it: pēda*, once more
- *Say it: say pēda*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for wet, then the Telugu for dry, then say pēda again*

Before you move on

What does పేద mean? (“Poor”.) Say it once more.

139.4 ముసలి (musali) — old (of people)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for dry, then the Telugu for poor.

Say తాత and అమ్మమ్మ, grandfather and grandmother.

You'll want to know: ముసలి

ముసలి — *musali* — “old (of people)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: musali*
- *Say it: musali*, once more

- *Say it:* say *musali*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for dry, then the Telugu for poor, then say *musali* again

Before you move on

What does ముసలి mean? (“Old (of people)”). Say it once more.

139.5 ప్రసిద్ధ (prasiddha) — famous

Before the new one: say the Telugu for poor, then the Telugu for old.

You’ll want to know: ప్రసిద్ధ

ప్రసిద్ధ — *prasiddha* — “famous”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *prasiddha*
- *Say it:* *prasiddha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prasiddha*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for poor, then the Telugu for old, then say *prasiddha* again

Before you move on

What does ప్రసిద్ధ mean? (“Famous”). Say it once more.

139.6 Animals, the body and more things — a first pass

Say the words for old and famous.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a television, a computer, a phone, a ticket, a paisa
- a rupee, a bottle, a long skirt, a pocket, a belt
- socks, a coat, a dhoti, a blouse, a lotus
- clothes, a moustache, tears, a boat, a train
- a car, a bicycle, an aeroplane, grain, wheat

Before you move on

A television? (టీవీ, *tīvī*.) A computer? (కంప్యూటర్, *kampyūtar*.) A phone? (ఫోను, *phōnu*.) A ticket? (టిక్కెట్టు, *ṭikkeṭṭu*.) A paisa? (పైసా, *paisā*.) A rupee? (రూపాయి, *rūpāyi*.) A bottle? (బాటిలు, *bāṭilu*.) A long skirt? (లంగా, *laṅgā*.) A pocket? (జేబు, *jēbu*.) A belt? (బెల్టు, *belṭu*.) Socks? (సాక్సు, *sāksu*.) A coat? (కోటు, *kōṭu*.) A dhoti? (ధోతి, *dhōti*.) A blouse? (జాకెట్టు, *jākeṭṭu*.) A lotus? (తామరపువ్వు, *tāmarapuvvu*.) Clothes? (గుడ్డలు, *guḍḍalu*.) A moustache? (మీసాలు, *mīsālu*.) Tears? (కంటినీరు, *kaṇṭinīru*.) A boat? (పడవ, *paḍava*.) A train? (రైలు, *railu*.) A car? (కారు, *kāru*.) A bicycle? (సైకిలు, *sāikilu*.) An aeroplane? (విమానం, *vimānaṁ*.) Grain? (ధాన్యం, *dhānyaṁ*.) Wheat? (గోధుమలు, *gōdhumalu*.)

139.7 Describing words — a second pass

Say the words for black pepper and cumin.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- black pepper, cumin, tamarind, a lemon, grapes
- a guava, sugar, tall, short, heavy
- light, soft, hard, clean, dirty
- fast; speed, beautiful, deep, wide, narrow
- wet, dry, poor, old, famous

Before you move on

Black pepper? (మిరియాలు, *miriyālu*.) Cumin? (జీలకర్ర, *jīlakarra*.)
 Tamarind? (చింతపండు, *cintapaṇḍu*.) A lemon? (నిమ్మకాయ, *nimmakāya*.)
 Grapes? (ద్రాక్ష, *drākṣa*.) A guava? (జామపండు, *jāmapaṇḍu*.)
 Sugar? (పంచదార, *pañcadāra*.) Tall? (పొడవు, *poḍavu*.)
 Short? (పొట్టి, *poṭṭi*.) Heavy? (బరువు, *baruvu*.) Light? (తేలిక, *tēlika*.)
 Soft? (మెత్తని, *mettani*.) Hard? (గట్టి, *gaṭṭi*.) Clean? (శుభ్రం, *śubhram*.)
 Dirty? (మురికి, *muriki*.) Fast; speed? (వేగం, *vēgam*.) Beautiful?
 (అందమైన, *andamaina*.) Deep? (లోతు, *lōtu*.) Wide? (వెడల్పు, *veḍalpu*.)
 Narrow? (ఇరుకు, *iruku*.) Wet? (తడి, *taḍi*.) Dry? (పొడి, *poḍi*.)
 Poor? (పేద, *pēda*.) Old? (ముసలి, *musali*.) Famous? (ప్రసిద్ధ, *prasiddha*.)

Chapter 140

Safe, Lie, Grey, Golden, Spoiled

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say safe, a lie, grey, golden and spoiled.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say safe, a lie, grey, golden and spoiled.

140.1 సురక్షితం (surakṣitam) — safe

Before the new one: say the Telugu for old (of people), then the Telugu for famous.

You'll want to know: సురక్షితం

సురక్షితం — *surakṣitam* — “safe”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *surakṣitam*
- Say it: *surakṣitam*, once more
- Say it: say *surakṣitam*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for old (of people), then the Telugu for famous, then say *surakṣitam* again

Before you move on

What does సురక్షితం mean? (“Safe”.) Say it once more.

140.2 అబద్ధం (abaddham) — a lie; untrue

Before the new one: say the Telugu for famous, then the Telugu for safe.

You’ll want to know: అబద్ధం

అబద్ధం — *abaddham* — “a lie; untrue”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *abaddham*
- *Say it*: *abaddham*, once more
- *Say it*: say *abaddham*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for famous, then the Telugu for safe, then say *abaddham* again

Before you move on

What does అబద్ధం mean? (“A lie; untrue”.) Say it once more.

140.3 బూడిద (būḍida) — grey; ash

Before the new one: say the Telugu for safe, then the Telugu for a lie; untrue.

You'll want to know: బూడిద

బూడిద — *būdida* — “grey; ash”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: būdida*
- *Say it: būdida*, once more
- *Say it: say būdida*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for safe, then the Telugu for a lie; untrue, then say būdida again*

Before you move on

What does బూడిద mean? (“Grey; ash”.) Say it once more.

140.4 బంగారు (baṅgāru) — golden

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lie; untrue, then the Telugu for grey; ash.

You'll want to know: బంగారు

బంగారు — *baṅgāru* — “golden”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baṅgāru*
- *Say it: baṅgāru*, once more
- *Say it: say baṅgāru*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a lie; untrue, then the Telugu for grey; ash, then say *baṅgāru* again

Before you move on

What does బంగారు mean? (“Golden”.) Say it once more.

140.5 పాడైన (pāḍaina) — spoiled

Before the new one: say the Telugu for grey; ash, then the Telugu for golden.

You’ll want to know: పాడైన

పాడైన — *pāḍaina* — “spoiled”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pāḍaina*
- *Say it:* *pāḍaina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāḍaina*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for grey; ash, then the Telugu for golden, then say *pāḍaina* again

Before you move on

What does పాడైన mean? (“Spoiled”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 141

Sweet, Bitter-tasting, Spicy, Courage, Lazy

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sweet, bitter-tasting, spicy, courage and lazy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can say sweet, bitter-tasting, spicy, courage and lazy.

141.1 తీయని (tīyani) — sweet (of taste)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for golden, then the Telugu for spoiled.

You'll want to know: తీయని

తీయని — *tīyani* — “sweet (of taste)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tīyani*
- Say it: *tīyani*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tīyani*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for golden, then the Telugu for spoiled, then say *tīyani* again

Before you move on

What does తీయని mean? (“Sweet (of taste)”). Say it once more.

141.2 చేదైన (cēdaina) — bitter-tasting

Before the new one: say the Telugu for spoiled, then the Telugu for sweet.

You’ll want to know: చేదైన

చేదైన — *cēdaina* — “bitter-tasting”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cēdaina*
- *Say it:* *cēdaina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cēdaina*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for spoiled, then the Telugu for sweet, then say *cēdaina* again

Before you move on

What does చేదైన mean? (“Bitter-tasting”). Say it once more.

141.3 కారమైన (kāramaina) — spicy

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sweet, then the Telugu for bitter-tasting.

You'll want to know: కారమైన

కారమైన — *kāramaina* — “spicy”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāramaina*
- *Say it: kāramaina*, once more
- *Say it: say kāramaina*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for sweet, then the Telugu for bitter-tasting, then say kāramaina again*

Before you move on

What does కారమైన mean? (“Spicy”.) Say it once more.

141.4 ధైర్యం (dhairyam) — courage; brave

Before the new one: say the Telugu for bitter-tasting, then the Telugu for spicy.

You'll want to know: ధైర్యం

ధైర్యం — *dhairyam* — “courage; brave”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhairyam*
- *Say it: dhairyam*, once more
- *Say it: say dhairyam*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for bitter-tasting, then the Telugu for spicy, then say *dhairyam* again

Before you move on

What does ధైర్యం mean? (“Courage; brave”.) Say it once more.

141.5 సోమరి (sōmari) — lazy

Before the new one: say the Telugu for spicy, then the Telugu for courage; brave.

You’ll want to know: సోమరి

సోమరి — *sōmari* — “lazy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sōmari*
- *Say it:* *sōmari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sōmari*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for spicy, then the Telugu for courage; brave, then say *sōmari* again

Before you move on

What does సోమరి mean? (“Lazy”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 142

Hard-working, Clever, Terrible, Black, White

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say hard-working, clever, terrible, black and white.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can say hard-working, clever, terrible, black and white.

142.1 కష్టపడే (kaṣṭapaḍē) — hard-working

Before the new one: say the Telugu for courage; brave, then the Telugu for lazy.

You'll want to know: కష్టపడే

కష్టపడే — *kaṣṭapaḍē* — “hard-working”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kaṣṭapaḍē*
- Say it: *kaṣṭapaḍē*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kaṣṭapaḍē*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for courage; brave, then the Telugu for lazy, then say *kaṣṭapaḍē* again

Before you move on

What does కష్టపడే mean? (“Hard-working”.) Say it once more.

142.2 తెలివైన (telivaina) — clever

Before the new one: say the Telugu for lazy, then the Telugu for hard-working.

Read aloud as one run: ఇది తలుపు. దీపం ఇక్కడ ఉంది.

You’ll want to know: తెలివైన

తెలివైన — *telivaina* — “clever”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *telivaina*
- *Say it:* *telivaina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *telivaina*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for lazy, then the Telugu for hard-working, then say *telivaina* again

Before you move on

What does తెలివైన mean? (“Clever”.) Say it once more.

142.3 భయంకరమైన (bhayaṅkaramaina) — terrible, dreadful

Before the new one: say the Telugu for hard-working, then the Telugu for clever.

You'll want to know: భయంకరమైన

భయంకరమైన — *bhayaṅkaramaina* — “terrible, dreadful”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhayaṅkaramaina*
- *Say it: bhayaṅkaramaina, once more*
- *Say it: say bhayaṅkaramaina*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for hard-working, then the Telugu for clever, then say bhayaṅkaramaina again*

Before you move on

What does భయంకరమైన mean? (“Terrible, dreadful”.) Say it once more.

142.4 నల్లని (nallani) — black, dark

Before the new one: say the Telugu for clever, then the Telugu for terrible.

You'll want to know: నల్లని

నల్లని — *nallani* — “black, dark”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nallani*
- *Say it: nallani*, once more
- *Say it: say nallani*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for clever, then the Telugu for terrible, then say *nallani* again

Before you move on

What does నల్లని mean? (“Black, dark”.) Say it once more.

142.5 తెల్లని (tellani) — white, bright

Before the new one: say the Telugu for terrible, then the Telugu for black.

You’ll want to know: తెల్లని

తెల్లని — *tellani* — “white, bright”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tellani*
- *Say it: tellani*, once more
- *Say it: say tellani*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for terrible, then the Telugu for black, then say *tellani* again

Before you move on

What does తెల్లని mean? (“White, bright”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 143

Red, To fly, To run, To sleep, To get up

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say red, to fly, to run, to sleep and to get up.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can say red, to fly, to run, to sleep and to get up.

143.1 ఎర్రటి (errati) — red, reddish

Before the new one: say the Telugu for black, then the Telugu for white.

You'll want to know: ఎర్రటి

ఎర్రటి — *errati* — “red, reddish”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *errati*
- Say it: *errati*, once more

- *Say it:* say *errati*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for black, then the Telugu for white, then say *errati* again

Before you move on

What does ఎర్రటి mean? (“Red, reddish”.) Say it once more.

143.2 ఎగురు (egiru) — to fly

Before the new one: say the Telugu for white, then the Telugu for red.

You’ll want to know: ఎగురు

ఎగురు — *egiru* — “to fly”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *egiru*
- *Say it:* *egiru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *egiru*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for white, then the Telugu for red, then say *egiru* again

Before you move on

What does ఎగురు mean? (“To fly”.) Say it once more.

143.3 పరిగెత్తు (parigettu) — to run

Before the new one: say the Telugu for red, then the Telugu for to fly.

You'll want to know: పరిగెత్తు

పరిగెత్తు — *parigettu* — “to run”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parigettu*
- *Say it: parigettu*, once more
- *Say it: say parigettu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for red, then the Telugu for to fly, then say parigettu again*

Before you move on

What does పరిగెత్తు mean? (“To run”.) Say it once more.

143.4 నిద్రపో (nidrapō) — to sleep

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to fly, then the Telugu for to run.

You'll want to know: నిద్రపో

నిద్రపో — *nidrapō* — “to sleep”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nidrapō*
- *Say it: nidrapō*, once more
- *Say it: say nidrapō*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to fly, then the Telugu for to run, then say *nidrapō* again

Before you move on

What does నిద్రపో mean? (“To sleep”.) Say it once more.

143.5 లేచు (lēcu) — to get up

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to run, then the Telugu for to sleep.

Say eight commands, one breath each: రా, ఇవ్వు, కూర్చో, నిల్చో, ఆలకించు, చూడు, మాట్లాడు, రాయి.

You’ll want to know: లేచు

లేచు — *lēcu* — “to get up”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *lēcu*
- *Say it:* *lēcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lēcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to run, then the Telugu for to sleep, then say *lēcu* again

Before you move on

What does లేచు mean? (“To get up”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 144

To cook, To cut, To break, To send, To look for

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to cook, to cut, to break, to send and to look for.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say to cook, to cut, to break, to send and to look for.

144.1 వండు (vaṇḍu) — to cook

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to sleep, then the Telugu for to get up.

You'll want to know: వండు

వండు — *vaṇḍu* — “to cook”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaṇḍu*
- *Say it: vaṇḍu, once more*

- *Say it:* say *vaṇḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to sleep, then the Telugu for to get up, then say *vaṇḍu* again

Before you move on

What does వండు mean? (“To cook”.) Say it once more.

144.2 కోయ (kōyu) — to cut

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to get up, then the Telugu for to cook.

You’ll want to know: కోయ

కోయ — *kōyu* — “to cut”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kōyu*
- *Say it:* *kōyu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kōyu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to get up, then the Telugu for to cook, then say *kōyu* again

Before you move on

What does కోయ mean? (“To cut”.) Say it once more.

144.3 పగలగొట్టు (pagalagoṭṭu) — to break

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to cook, then the Telugu for to cut.

You'll want to know: పగలగొట్టు

పగలగొట్టు — *pagalagoṭṭu* — “to break”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pagalagoṭṭu*
- *Say it: pagalagoṭṭu, once more*
- *Say it: say pagalagoṭṭu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to cook, then the Telugu for to cut, then say pagalagoṭṭu again*

Before you move on

What does పగలగొట్టు mean? (“To break”.) Say it once more.

144.4 పంపు (pampu) — to send

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to cut, then the Telugu for to break.

You'll want to know: పంపు

పంపు — *pampu* — “to send”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pumpu*
- *Say it: pumpu, once more*
- *Say it: say pumpu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to cut, then the Telugu for to break, then say *pampu* again

Before you move on

What does పంపు mean? (“To send”.) Say it once more.

144.5 వెతుకు (vetuku) — to look for

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to break, then the Telugu for to send.

You’ll want to know: వెతుకు

వెతుకు — *vetuku* — “to look for”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vetuku*
- *Say it:* *vetuku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vetuku*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to break, then the Telugu for to send, then say *vetuku* again

Before you move on

What does వెతుకు mean? (“To look for”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

To learn, To teach, To forget, To jump, To get down

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to learn, to teach, to forget, to jump and to get down.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can say to learn, to teach, to forget, to jump and to get down.

145.1 నేర్చుకో (nērcukō) — to learn

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to send, then the Telugu for to look for.

You'll want to know: నేర్చుకో

నేర్చుకో — *nērcukō* — “to learn”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *nērcukō*
- Say it: *nērcukō*, once more

- *Say it:* say *nērcukō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to send, then the Telugu for to look for, then say *nērcukō* again

Before you move on

What does నేర్చుకో mean? (“To learn”.) Say it once more.

145.2 నేర్పు (nērpū) — to teach

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to look for, then the Telugu for to learn.

You’ll want to know: నేర్పు

నేర్పు — *nērpū* — “to teach”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nērpū*
- *Say it:* *nērpū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nērpū*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to look for, then the Telugu for to learn, then say *nērpū* again

Before you move on

What does నేర్పు mean? (“To teach”.) Say it once more.

145.3 మరచిపో (maracipō) — to forget

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to learn, then the Telugu for to teach.

You'll want to know: మరచిపో

మరచిపో — *maracipō* — “to forget”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maracipō*
- *Say it: maracipō*, once more
- *Say it: say maracipō*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to learn, then the Telugu for to teach, then say maracipō again*

Before you move on

What does మరచిపో mean? (“To forget.”) Say it once more.

145.4 దూకు (dūku) — to jump

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to teach, then the Telugu for to forget.

You'll want to know: దూకు

దూకు — *dūku* — “to jump”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dūku*
- *Say it: dūku*, once more
- *Say it: say dūku*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to teach, then the Telugu for to forget, then say *dūku* again

Before you move on

What does దూకు mean? (“To jump”.) Say it once more.

145.5 దిగు (digu) — to get down, to get off

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to forget, then the Telugu for to jump.

You’ll want to know: దిగు

దిగు — *digu* — “to get down, to get off”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *digu*
- *Say it:* *digu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *digu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to forget, then the Telugu for to jump, then say *digu* again

Before you move on

What does దిగు mean? (“To get down, to get off”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

To reach, To put on, To call, To count, To wash

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to reach, to put on, to call, to count and to wash.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can say to reach, to put on, to call, to count and to wash.

146.1 చేరు (cēru) — to reach, to join

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to jump, then the Telugu for to get down.

You'll want to know: చేరు

చేరు — *cēru* — “to reach, to join”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *cēru*
- Say it: *cēru*, once more

- *Say it:* say *cēru*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to jump, then the Telugu for to get down, then say *cēru* again

Before you move on

What does చేరు mean? (“To reach, to join”.) Say it once more.

146.2 వేసుకో (vēsukō) — to put on (clothes)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to get down, then the Telugu for to reach.

You’ll want to know: వేసుకో

వేసుకో — *vēsukō* — “to put on (clothes)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vēsukō*
- *Say it:* *vēsukō*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vēsukō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to get down, then the Telugu for to reach, then say *vēsukō* again

Before you move on

What does వేసుకో mean? (“To put on (clothes)”.) Say it once more.

146.3 పిలుచు (pilucu) — to call

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to reach, then the Telugu for to put on.

You'll want to know: పిలుచు

పిలుచు — *pilucu* — “to call”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pilucu*
- *Say it: pilucu*, once more
- *Say it: say pilucu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to reach, then the Telugu for to put on, then say *pilucu* again

Before you move on

What does పిలుచు mean? (“To call”.) Say it once more.

146.4 లెక్కపెట్టు (lekkapeṭṭu) — to count

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to put on, then the Telugu for to call.

Count on with -వ: పదవ, then పదకొండవ.

You'll want to know: లెక్కపెట్టు

లెక్కపెట్టు — *lekkapeṭṭu* — “to count”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lekkapeṭṭu*
- *Say it: lekkapeṭṭu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *lekkapeṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to put on, then the Telugu for to call, then say *lekkapeṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does లెక్కపెట్టు mean? (“To count”.) Say it once more.

146.5 కడుగు (kaḍugu) — to wash

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to call, then the Telugu for to count.

You’ll want to know: కడుగు

కడుగు — *kaḍugu* — “to wash”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaḍugu*
- *Say it:* *kaḍugu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaḍugu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to call, then the Telugu for to count, then say *kaḍugu* again

Before you move on

What does కడుగు mean? (“To wash”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 147

To wipe, To tie, To sew, To win, To hide

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to wipe, to tie, to sew, to win and to hide.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 147: I can say to wipe, to tie, to sew, to win and to hide.

147.1 తుడుచు (tuḍucu) — to wipe

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to count, then the Telugu for to wash.

You'll want to know: తుడుచు

తుడుచు — *tuḍucu* — “to wipe”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tuḍucu*
- Say it: *tuḍucu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tuducu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to count, then the Telugu for to wash, then say *tuducu* again

Before you move on

What does తుడుచు mean? (“To wipe”.) Say it once more.

147.2 కట్టు (kaṭṭu) — to tie, to build

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to wash, then the Telugu for to wipe.

You’ll want to know: కట్టు

కట్టు — *kaṭṭu* — “to tie, to build”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaṭṭu*
- *Say it:* *kaṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to wash, then the Telugu for to wipe, then say *kaṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does కట్టు mean? (“To tie, to build”.) Say it once more.

147.3 కుట్టు (kuṭṭu) — to sew

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to wipe, then the Telugu for to tie.

You'll want to know: కుట్టు

కుట్టు — *kuṭṭu* — “to sew”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṭṭu*
- *Say it: kuṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it: say kuṭṭu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to wipe, then the Telugu for to tie, then say kuṭṭu again*

Before you move on

What does కుట్టు mean? (“To sew”.) Say it once more.

147.4 గెలుచు (gelucu) — to win

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to tie, then the Telugu for to sew.

You'll want to know: గెలుచు

గెలుచు — *gelucu* — “to win”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gelucu*
- *Say it: gelucu*, once more
- *Say it: say gelucu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to tie, then the Telugu for to sew, then say *gelucu* again

Before you move on

What does గెలుచు mean? (“To win”.) Say it once more.

147.5 దాచు (dācu) — to hide

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to sew, then the Telugu for to win.

You’ll want to know: దాచు

దాచు — *dācu* — “to hide”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dācu*
- *Say it:* *dācu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dācu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to sew, then the Telugu for to win, then say *dācu* again

Before you move on

What does దాచు mean? (“To hide”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 148

To protect, To burn, To put out, To sing, To sell

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to protect, to burn, to put out, to sing and to sell.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 148: I can say to protect, to burn, to put out, to sing and to sell.

148.1 కాపాడు (kāpāḍu) — to protect, to save

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to win, then the Telugu for to hide.

You'll want to know: కాపాడు

కాపాడు — *kāpāḍu* — “to protect, to save”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kāpāḍu*
- Say it: *kāpāḍu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kāpāḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to win, then the Telugu for to hide, then say *kāpāḍu* again

Before you move on

What does కాపాడు mean? (“To protect, to save”.) Say it once more.

148.2 కాల్చు (kālcu) — to burn

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to hide, then the Telugu for to protect.

You’ll want to know: కాల్చు

కాల్చు — *kālcu* — “to burn”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kālcu*
- *Say it:* *kālcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kālcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to hide, then the Telugu for to protect, then say *kālcu* again

Before you move on

What does కాల్చు mean? (“To burn”.) Say it once more.

148.3 ఆర్పు (ārpu) — to put out

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to protect, then the Telugu for to burn.

You'll want to know: ఆర్పు

ఆర్పు — *āṛpu* — “to put out”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āṛpu*
- *Say it: āṛpu*, once more
- *Say it: say āṛpu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to protect, then the Telugu for to burn, then say āṛpu again*

Before you move on

What does ఆర్పు mean? (“To put out”.) Say it once more.

148.4 పాడు (*pāḍu*) — to sing

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to burn, then the Telugu for to put out.

You'll want to know: పాడు

పాడు — *pāḍu* — “to sing”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāḍu*
- *Say it: pāḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say pāḍu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to burn, then the Telugu for to put out, then say *pāḍu* again

Before you move on

What does పాడు mean? (“To sing”.) Say it once more.

148.5 అమ్ము (ammu) — to sell

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to put out, then the Telugu for to sing.

You’ll want to know: అమ్ము

అమ్ము — *ammu* — “to sell”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ammu*
- *Say it:* *ammu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ammu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to put out, then the Telugu for to sing, then say *ammu* again

Before you move on

What does అమ్ము mean? (“To sell”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 149

To walk, To close, To open, To drink, To cry

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to walk, to close, to open, to drink and to cry.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 149: I can say to walk, to close, to open, to drink and to cry.

149.1 నడచు (naḍucu) — to walk

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to sing, then the Telugu for to sell.

You'll want to know: నడచు

నడచు — *naḍucu* — “to walk”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *naḍucu*
- Say it: *naḍucu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *naḍucu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to sing, then the Telugu for to sell, then say *naḍucu* again

Before you move on

What does నడుచు mean? (“To walk”.) Say it once more.

149.2 మూయు (mūyu) — to close

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to sell, then the Telugu for to walk.

You’ll want to know: మూయు

మూయు — *mūyu* — “to close”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mūyu*
- *Say it:* *mūyu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūyu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to sell, then the Telugu for to walk, then say *mūyu* again

Before you move on

What does మూయు mean? (“To close”.) Say it once more.

149.3 తెరువు (teruvu) — to open

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to walk, then the Telugu for to close.

You'll want to know: తెరువు

తెరువు — *teruvu* — “to open”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: teruvu*
- *Say it: teruvu*, once more
- *Say it: say teruvu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to walk, then the Telugu for to close, then say teruvu again*

Before you move on

What does తెరువు mean? (“To open”.) Say it once more.

149.4 తారు (tāgu) — to drink

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to close, then the Telugu for to open.

You'll want to know: తారు

తారు — *tāgu* — “to drink”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāgu*
- *Say it: tāgu*, once more
- *Say it: say tāgu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to close, then the Telugu for to open, then say *tāgu* again

Before you move on

What does తారు mean? (“To drink.”) Say it once more.

149.5 ఏడ్చు (ēḍcu) — to cry

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to open, then the Telugu for to drink.

You’ll want to know: ఏడ్చు

ఏడ్చు — *ēḍcu* — “to cry”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēḍcu*
- *Say it:* *ēḍcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēḍcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to open, then the Telugu for to drink, then say *ēḍcu* again

Before you move on

What does ఏడ్చు mean? (“To cry.”) Say it once more.

149.6 Describing words and verbs — a first pass

Say the words for to drink and to cry.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- safe, a lie; untrue, grey; ash, golden, spoiled
- sweet, bitter-tasting, spicy, courage; brave, lazy
- hard-working, clever, terrible, black, white
- red, to fly, to run, to sleep, to get up
- to cook, to cut, to break, to send, to look for

Before you move on

Safe? (సురక్షితం, *surakṣitam.*) A lie; untrue? (అబద్ధం, *abaddham.*) Grey; ash? (బూడిద, *būdida.*) Golden? (బంగారు, *baṅgāru.*) Spoiled? (పాడైన, *pādaina.*) Sweet? (తీయని, *tīyani.*) Bitter-tasting? (చేదైన, *cēdaina.*) Spicy? (కారమైన, *kāramaina.*) Courage; brave? (ధైర్యం, *dhairyam.*) Lazy? (సోమరి, *sōmari.*) Hard-working? (కష్టపడే, *kaṣṭapaḍē.*) Clever? (తెలివైన, *telivaina.*) Terrible? (భయంకరమైన, *bhayāṅkaramaina.*) Black? (నల్లని, *nallani.*) White? (తెల్లని, *tellani.*) Red? (ఎర్రటి, *errati.*) To fly? (ఎగురు, *egiru.*) To run? (పరిగెత్తు, *parigettu.*) To sleep? (నిద్రపో, *nidrapō.*) To get up? (లేచు, *lēcu.*) To cook? (వండు, *vaṇḍu.*) To cut? (కోయు, *kōyu.*) To break? (పగలగొట్టు, *pagalagotttu.*) To send? (పంపు, *pampu.*) To look for? (వెతుకు, *vetuku.*)

149.7 Verbs — a second pass

Say the words for to learn and to teach.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to learn, to teach, to forget, to jump, to get down
- to reach, to put on, to call, to count, to wash
- to wipe, to tie, to sew, to win, to hide

- to protect, to burn, to put out, to sing, to sell
- to walk, to close, to open, to drink, to cry

Before you move on

To learn? (నేర్చుకో, *nērcukō*.) To teach? (నేర్పు, *nērpū*.) To forget? (మరచిపో, *maracipō*.) To jump? (దూకు, *dūku*.) To get down? (దిగు, *digu*.) To reach? (చేరు, *cēru*.) To put on? (వేసుకో, *vēsukō*.) To call? (పిలుచు, *pilucu*.) To count? (లెక్కపెట్టు, *lekkapettū*.) To wash? (కడుగు, *kaḍugu*.) To wipe? (తుడుచు, *tuḍucu*.) To tie? (కట్టు, *kaṭṭu*.) To sew? (కుట్టు, *kutṭu*.) To win? (గెలుచు, *gelucu*.) To hide? (దాచు, *dācu*.) To protect? (కాపాడు, *kāpāḍu*.) To burn? (కాల్చు, *kālcu*.) To put out? (ఆర్పు, *ārpu*.) To sing? (పాడు, *pāḍu*.) To sell? (అమ్ము, *ammu*.) To walk? (నడుచు, *naḍucu*.) To close? (మూయు, *mūyu*.) To open? (తెరువు, *teruvu*.) To drink? (తాగు, *tāgu*.) To cry? (ఏడ్చు, *ēḍcu*.)

Chapter 150

A Word for Literature — Then the Letter Inside It

Modes:  voice (1)  pen (1)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the Telugu word for literature, recognise the rare letter inside it, and write that letter in a source-backed order.

Take జ from the already-known word వాఙ్మయం and write its five movements in three pen-down runs.

150.1 వాఙ్మయం (vāṇmayam) — literature, the whole body of expression in words

You already know పుస్తకం, a book, and you have held a short passage without translating every word. This lesson names the larger body that books and spoken works belong to.

You’ll want to know: వాఙ్మయం

వాఙ్మయం — *vāṇmayam* — “literature”, or more broadly, expression made of words.

Say it in three gentle pieces: *vāṇ* · *ma* · *yam*. The first piece ends with the velar nasal heard in English *sing*. The spelling keeps that sound as జ్ before మ: వా-జ్-మ-యం.

The word came through Sanskrit: *vāc* is speech, and *maya* means made of or filled with. A single పుస్తకం is one book; వాఙ్మయం is the world of words that books, speeches, and other verbal works make together.

What you've built

One book, then the wider field it can belong to. The unusual spelling has had a meaning before it becomes a handwriting exercise.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vāṇi · ma · yam*, slowly
- *Say it:* *vāṇimayam*, as one word
- *Read it:* పుస్తకం · వాఙ్మయం — one book, then literature
- *Find:* the small జ్ immediately before మ

Before you move on

What does వాఙ్మయం mean? (“Literature; the wider body of expression in words.”) Say it once more.

150.2 జ — the quiet letter inside వాఙ్మయం

Say వాఙ్మయం once. What does it mean? (“Literature; the wider body of expression in words.”)

Now slow the first two pieces: *vāṇi · ma*. The letter between them is today's whole task.

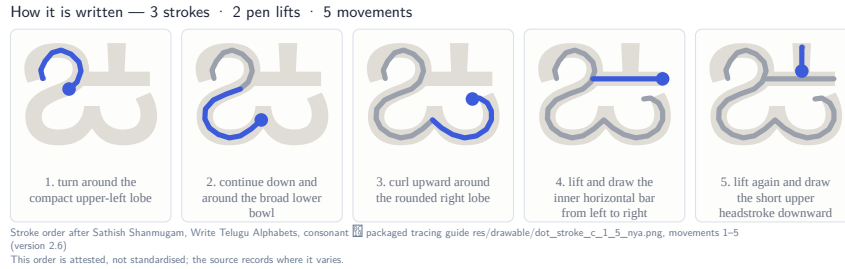
Script you'll notice: జ

జ — *ṇa*.

It is the velar nasal: the sound at the end of English *sing*. In వాఙ్మయం, the vowel is suppressed, so జ్ leans into the following మ. The base letter you will write is జ.

This is an uncommon letter in modern Telugu words. That is why the book waited until it had given you a real word that needs it.

Writing: జ — five small movements



How జ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movements 1–3 stay joined: turn around the compact upper-left lobe, continue around the broad lower bowl, then curl up through the right lobe. Lift for the inner horizontal bar. Lift once more for the short downward headstroke.

The numbered route is one attested school-style order; Telugu handwriting can vary. Keep the three pen-down runs clear rather than racing the shape.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* జ once, following the five numbered movements
- *Copy:* జ twice without tracing
- *Find:* జ్ inside వాఙ్మయం
- *Say it:* vāṇmayam as you finish

Before you move on

Which letter is this — జ? What sound does it carry? (*ṇa.*) Which word gave it to you? (వాఙ్మయం.)

Chapter 151

A Word for Shade — Then Its First Letter

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a Telugu word for shade or shadow, recognise its uncommon first letter, and write that letter in a source-backed order.

Take ఛ from the already-known word ఛాయ and write its five movements in two pen-down runs.

151.1 ఛాయ (chāya) — shade, shadow

Point once to the rare ఙ you met in వాఙ్మయం. Now imagine the cool patch beneath a tree. This lesson gives that patch a name, using the familiar య at the end and a different uncommon letter at the beginning.

You’ll want to know: ఛాయ

ఛాయ — *chāya* — “shade” or “shadow”.

Say it in two gentle pieces: *chā* · *ya*. The first sound is an airy **ch**; the second is the familiar య sound. Read the word as ఛ-య.

ఛాయ is a learned word with a wider range than one dark shape. In literary or careful language it can also name a reflected image or a tinge of colour. Keep the first meaning small today: shade or shadow.

What you've built

A useful image comes before an unfamiliar letter. You can say the whole word before the next lesson asks your hand to take its first shape apart.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chā · ya*, slowly
- *Say it:* *chāya*, as one word
- *Read it:* ఛాయ — shade or shadow
- *Find:* the familiar య at the end

Before you move on

What does ఛాయ mean? (“Shade” or “shadow.”) Say it once more.

151.2 ఛ — the airy first letter in ఛాయ

Say ఛాయ once. What does it mean? (“Shade” or “shadow.”)

Now slow the first piece: *chā*. The base letter carrying that airy **ch** is today's whole task.

Script you'll notice: ఛ

ఛ — *cha*.

In ఛాయ, the long ా sign turns the base sound into ఛా. Remove that vowel sign and the base letter is ఛ.

This aspirated letter is uncommon in everyday Telugu vocabulary. That is why the book gave you ఛాయ before asking you to practise the shape.

Writing: ఛ — five movements, two runs

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements



How ఛ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movements 1–4 stay joined: draw the short upper bar, turn around the left bowl, sweep around the broad outer bowl, and continue through the upper flourish. Lift once. Movement 5 draws the separate stem downward below the middle.

The numbered route is one attested school-style order; Telugu handwriting can vary. Keep the two pen-down runs distinct and let the long curves stay round.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ఛ once, following the five numbered movements
- *Copy:* ఛ twice without tracing
- *Build:* ఛ + ా = ఛా
- *Read it:* ఛాయ

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ఛ? What word gave it to you? (ఛాయ.)

151.3 ఛాయ — meaning and shape together

Picture the cool patch beneath a tree. Say the Telugu word for it. (ఛాయ.)

Your turn

Read ఛాయ once. Cover it, then write only its first base letter: ఛ.

Now uncover the word and check two things: the broad curved body and the short separate stem beneath it. Add the long ఌ sign only after the base letter is steady.

- *Write it:* ఛ once from memory
- *Build:* ఛ + ఌ + య = ఛాయ
- *Say it:* “shade or shadow”

Before you move on

What does ఛాయ mean, and which base letter begins it? (“Shade” or “shadow”; ఛ.)

Chapter 152

A Word for a Stream — Then Its First Letter

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a Telugu word for a stream, recognise its uncommon first letter, and write that letter in a source-backed order.

Take ఝ from the already-known word ఝరి and write its five movements in five pen-down runs.

152.1 ఝరి (jhari) — a stream

What did వాఙ్మయం name? (“Literature.”) Now find the familiar ఠ at the end of today’s word: ఠ carries the short ॑ sign. Picture a narrow stream moving down a hillside. This lesson gives that stream a name before it asks you to study the uncommon first letter.

You’ll want to know: ఝరి

ఝరి — *jhari* — “a stream” or “mountain stream”.

Say it in two gentle pieces: *jha* · *ri*. Read the word as ఝ-రి. The first sound is a breathy **jh**; the second piece is the familiar ఠ.

ఝరి is an authentic learned or literary word shared with Sanskrit. It is not an everyday word you must force into conversation. Keep its concrete image today: a stream running down a slope.

What you've built

Meaning comes first. You can recognise and say the whole word before the next lesson asks your hand to take its first shape apart.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jha · ri*, slowly
- *Say it:* *jhari*, as one word
- *Read it:* ఝరి — a stream
- *Find:* the familiar ఠ at the end

Before you move on

What does ఝరి mean? (“A stream” or “mountain stream.”) Say it once more.

152.2 ఝ — the breathy first letter in ఝరి

One gentle look back first: వాఙ్మయం means “literature,” and its uncommon letter is ఙ. Point to ఙ without copying it. Today you will keep that shape distinct from a different uncommon letter.

Now say ఝరి once. What does it mean? (“A stream” or “mountain stream.”)

Now slow the first piece: *jha*. That breathy **jh** base letter is today's whole task.

Script you'll notice: ఝ

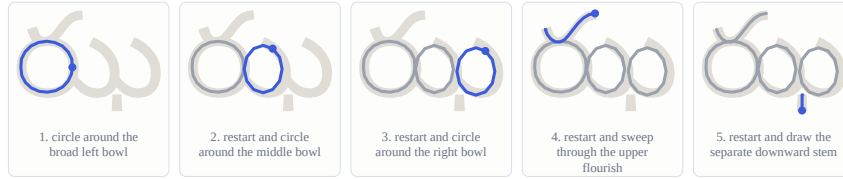
ఝ — *jha*.

In ఝరి, the first base letter is ఝ. The rest, ఠ, is already familiar. Read the whole word in two pieces: ఝ-ఠ.

This aspirated letter is uncommon in everyday Telugu vocabulary. That is why the book gave you the authentic word ఝరి before asking you to practise the shape.

Writing: ఝ — five movements, five runs

How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sathish Shanmugam, Write Telugu Alphabets, consonant ఝ packaged tracing guide res/drawable/dot_stroke_c_2_4_zha.png, movements 1–5 (version 2.6)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ఝ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the filmstrip slowly. Movement 1 circles the broad left bowl. Lift. Movement 2 circles the middle bowl. Lift again. Movement 3 circles the right bowl. Movement 4 sweeps through the separate upper flourish. Movement 5 draws the separate stem downward below the middle.

The numbered route is one attested school-style order; Telugu handwriting can vary. Keep all five pen-down runs distinct and let the three bowls stay round.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ఝ once, following the five numbered movements
- *Copy:* ఝ twice without tracing
- *Build:* ఝ + ఠ = ఝఠ
- *Read it:* ఝఠ

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ఝ? What word gave it to you? (ఝఠ.)

152.3 ఝఠ — meaning and shape together

Picture a stream running down a hillside. Say the Telugu word for it. (ఝఠ.)

Your turn

Look once at ఝరి, then cover it. Use only the picture of a stream as your cue and write the whole word from memory.

Now uncover the model and check both the whole word and its first base letter. Circle ఝ. Check its three rounded bowls, upper flourish, and separate downward stem; keep the five pen-down runs distinct.

- *Write it:* ఝరి once from the picture cue
- *Circle:* the first base letter ఝ
- *Say it:* “a stream”

Before you move on

Without looking back, write the Telugu word for “a stream,” then circle its first base letter. (ఝరి; circle ఝ.)

Chapter 153

Nobody, Never, Nowhere, Anyone, Anything

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🖐️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what is not so, and ask yes-or-no questions.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 153: I can say what is not so, and ask yes-or-no questions.

153.1 ఎవరూ (evarū) — nobody (with a negative verb)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for shade, then the Telugu for a stream.

You'll want to know: ఎవరూ

ఎవరూ — *evarū* — “nobody (with a negative verb)”. Telugu negates a past verb with లేదు (*lēdu*) joined onto it: ఎవరూ రాలేదు — *evarū rālēdu* — “Nobody came.” To say something is not a thing, it uses కాదు (*kādu*): ఇది నా ఇల్లు కాదు — *idi nā illu kādu* — “This is not my house.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *evārū*
- *Say it:* *evārū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *evārū*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for shade, then the Telugu for a stream, then say *evārū* again

Before you move on

What does ఎవరూ mean? (“Nobody (with a negative verb)”). Say it once more.

153.2 ఎప్పుడూ (eppuḍū) — never (with a negative verb); always

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a stream, then the Telugu for nobody.

You’ll want to know: ఎప్పుడూ

ఎప్పుడూ — *eppuḍū* — “never (with a negative verb); always”. నేను ఎప్పుడూ మాంసం తినను — *nēnu eppuḍū māṁsam tinanu* — “I never eat meat.”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eppuḍū*
- *Say it:* *eppuḍū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eppuḍū*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a stream, then the Telugu for nobody, then say *eppuḍū* again

Before you move on

What does ఎప్పుడూ mean? (“Never (with a negative verb); always”.)
Say it once more.

153.3 ఎక్కడా (ekkaḍā) — nowhere, not anywhere (with a negative verb)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for nobody, then the Telugu
for never.

You’ll want to know: ఎక్కడా

ఎక్కడా — *ekkaḍā* — “nowhere, not anywhere (with a negative verb)”. నాకు ఆ
పుస్తకం ఎక్కడా దొరకలేదు — *nāku ā pustakam ekaḍā dorakalēdu* — “I couldn’t
find that book anywhere.”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *ekkaḍā*
- Say it: *ekkaḍā*, once more
- Say it: say *ekkaḍā*
- Recall: say the Telugu for nobody, then the Telugu for never, then
say *ekkaḍā* again

Before you move on

What does ఎక్కడా mean? (“Nowhere, not anywhere (with a negative
verb)”.) Say it once more.

153.4 ఎవరైనా (evarainā) — anyone, someone

Before the new one: say the Telugu for never, then the Telugu
for nowhere.

You'll want to know: ఎవరైనా

ఎవరైనా — *evarainā* — “anyone, someone”. A yes-or-no question ends in -అ (-ā): ఉన్నారు becomes ఉన్నారా. అక్కడ ఎవరైనా ఉన్నారా? — *akkaḍa evarainā unnārā?* — “Is anyone there?”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *evarainā*
- Say it: *evarainā*, once more
- Say it: say *evarainā*
- Recall: say the Telugu for never, then the Telugu for nowhere, then say *evarainā* again

Before you move on

What does ఎవరైనా mean? (“Anyone, someone”.) Say it once more.

153.5 ఏమైనా (*ēmainā*) — anything, something

Before the new one: say the Telugu for nowhere, then the Telugu for anyone.

You'll want to know: ఏమైనా

ఏమైనా — *ēmainā* — “anything, something”. మీకు ఏమైనా కావాలా? — *mīku ēmainā kāvālā?* — “Do you need anything?” Read two words again: చాయ (*chāya*, shade) is written with చ, and ఝరి (*jhari*, a stream) with ఝ.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēmainā*
- *Say it:* *ēmainā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēmainā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for nowhere, then the Telugu for anyone, then say *ēmainā* again

Before you move on

What does ఏమైనా mean? (“Anything, something”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 154

Recently, Already, Last, Once, To Spend (Time)

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what happened, and when: recently, already, last year.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 154: I can say what happened, and when: recently, already, last year.

154.1 ఇటీవల (iṭīvala) — recently

Before the new one: say the Telugu for anyone, then the Telugu for anything.

You'll want to know: ఇటీవల

ఇటీవల — *iṭīvala* — “recently”. Telugu’s past for “I” ends in -అను (-ānu): నేను ఇటీవల ఒక పుస్తకం చదివాను — *nēnu iṭīvala oka pustakam cadvānu* — “I recently read a book.”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *iṭīvala*

- *Say it:* *iṭṭivala*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṭṭivala*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for anyone, then the Telugu for anything, then say *iṭṭivala* again

Before you move on

What does ఇటీవల mean? (“Recently”.) Say it once more.

154.2 ఇప్పటికే (ippaṭikē) — already

Before the new one: say the Telugu for anything, then the Telugu for recently.

You’ll want to know: ఇప్పటికే

ఇప్పటికే — *ippaṭikē* — “already”. నేను ఇప్పటికే భోజనం చేశాను — *nēnu ippaṭikē bhōjanani cēśānu* — “I have already eaten.”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ippaṭikē*
- *Say it:* *ippaṭikē*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ippaṭikē*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for anything, then the Telugu for recently, then say *ippaṭikē* again

Before you move on

What does ఇప్పటికే mean? (“Already”.) Say it once more.

154.3 గత (gata) — last, previous

Before the new one: say the Telugu for recently, then the Telugu for already.

You'll want to know: గత

గత — *gata* — “last, previous”. గత సంవత్సరం నేను హైదరాబాద్ వెళ్ళాను — *gata samivatsarami nēnu haidarābād vellānu* — “Last year I went to Hyderabad.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gata*
- *Say it: gata, once more*
- *Say it: say gata*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for recently, then the Telugu for already, then say gata again*

Before you move on

What does గత mean? (“Last, previous”.) Say it once more.

154.4 ఒకసారి (okasāri) — once, one time

Before the new one: say the Telugu for already, then the Telugu for last.

You'll want to know: ఒకసారి

ఒకసారి — *okasāri* — “once, one time”. నేను ఒకసారి చెన్నై వెళ్ళాను — *nēnu okasāri cennai vellānu* — “I went to Chennai once.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: okasāri*
- *Say it: okasāri*, once more
- *Say it: say okasāri*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for already, then the Telugu for last, then say okasāri again*

Before you move on

What does ఒకసారి mean? (“Once, one time”.) Say it once more.

154.5 గడుపు (gaḍupu) — to spend (time)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for last, then the Telugu for once.

You’ll want to know: గడుపు

గడుపు — *gaḍupu* — “to spend (time)”. Said of time: నేను సెలవులను గ్రామంలో గడిపాను — *nēnu selavulanu grāmamilō gaḍipānu* — “I spent the holidays in the village.”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaḍupu*
- *Say it: gaḍupu*, once more
- *Say it: say gaḍupu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for last, then the Telugu for once, then say gaḍupu again*

Before you move on

What does గడుపు mean? (“To spend (time)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 155

Next, From Now On, the Future, To Hope, To Look Forward To

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what will happen, and when: next week, from now on, and what I hope for.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 155: I can say what will happen, and when: next week, from now on, and what I hope for.

155.1 వచ్చే (vaccē) — next, coming

Before the new one: say the Telugu for once, then the Telugu for to spend.

You'll want to know: వచ్చే

వచ్చే — *vaccē* — “next, coming”. The future for “I” ends in -తాను (-*tānu*): వచ్చే వారం నేను విజయవాడ వెళ్తాను — *vaccē vāram nēnu vijayavāḍa vēltānu* — “Next week I will go to Vijayawada.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *vaccē*

- *Say it: vaccē*, once more
- *Say it: say vaccē*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for once, then the Telugu for to spend, then say vaccē again*

Before you move on

What does వచ్చే mean? (“Next, coming”.) Say it once more.

155.2 ఇకపై (ikapai) — from now on

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to spend, then the Telugu for next.

You’ll want to know: ఇకపై

ఇకపై — *ikapai* — “from now on”. ఇకపై నేను త్వరగా లేస్తాను — *ikapai nēnu tvaragā lēstānu* — “From now on I will get up early.”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ikapai*
- *Say it: ikapai*, once more
- *Say it: say ikapai*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to spend, then the Telugu for next, then say ikapai again*

Before you move on

What does ఇకపై mean? (“From now on”.) Say it once more.

155.3 భవిష్యత్తు (bhaviṣyattu) — the future

Before the new one: say the Telugu for next, then the Telugu for from now on.

You'll want to know: భవిష్యత్తు

భవిష్యత్తు — *bhaviṣyattu* — “the future”. భవిష్యత్తులో నేను ఉపాధ్యాయుడిని అవుతాను — *bhaviṣyattulō nēnu upādhyāyudini avutānu* — “In the future I will become a teacher.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhaviṣyattu*
- *Say it: bhaviṣyattu, once more*
- *Say it: say bhaviṣyattu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for next, then the Telugu for from now on, then say bhaviṣyattu again*

Before you move on

What does భవిష్యత్తు mean? (“The future”.) Say it once more.

155.4 ఆశించు (āśiñcu) — to hope, to expect

Before the new one: say the Telugu for from now on, then the Telugu for the future.

You'll want to know: ఆశించు

ఆశించు — *āśiñcu* — “to hope, to expect”. మీరు బాగున్నారని ఆశిస్తున్నాను — *mīru bāgunnārani āśistunnānu* — “I hope you are well.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āśiñcu*
- *Say it: āśiñcu*, once more
- *Say it: say āśiñcu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for from now on, then the Telugu for the future, then say āśiñcu again*

Before you move on

What does ఆశించు mean? (“To hope, to expect”.) Say it once more.

155.5 ఎదురుచూడు (edurucūḍu) — to look forward to, to wait for

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the future, then the Telugu for to hope.

You'll want to know: ఎదురుచూడు

ఎదురుచూడు — *edurucūḍu* — “to look forward to, to wait for”. నేను మీ ఉత్తరం కోసం ఎదురుచూస్తున్నాను — *nēnu mī uttarāṁ kōsaṁ edurucūstunnānu* — “I am looking forward to your letter.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: edurucūḍu*
- *Say it: edurucūḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say edurucūḍu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for the future, then the Telugu for to hope, then say *edurucūḍu* again

Before you move on

What does ఎదురుచూడు mean? (“To look forward to, to wait for”.)
Say it once more.

Chapter 156

A Timetable, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Receipt

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read a timetable, a notice, an advert and a receipt, and act on what they say.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 156: I can read a timetable, a notice, an advert and a receipt, and act on what they say.

156.1 కాలపట్టిక (kālapaṭṭika) — a timetable

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to hope, then the Telugu for to look forward to.

You'll want to know: కాలపట్టిక

కాలపట్టిక — *kālapaṭṭika* — “a timetable”. Read the board: బస్సు: ఉదయం ఎనిమిది గంటలు — *bassu: udayam enimidi gaṇṭalu* — “Bus: 8 a.m.” The bus leaves at eight, so be there before eight.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kālapaṭṭika*

- *Say it:* *kālapattika*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kālapattika*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to hope, then the Telugu for to look forward to, then say *kālapattika* again

Before you move on

What does కాలపట్టిక mean? (“A timetable”.) Say it once more.

156.2 సూచన (sūcana) — an instruction, a note (on a sign)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to look forward to, then the Telugu for a timetable.

You’ll want to know: సూచన

సూచన — *sūcana* — “an instruction, a note (on a sign)”. Read the notice: ఇవాళ దుకాణం మూసి ఉంది — *ivāḷa dukāṇaṁ mūsi undi* — “The shop is closed today.” Come back on another day.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sūcana*
- *Say it:* *sūcana*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sūcana*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to look forward to, then the Telugu for a timetable, then say *sūcana* again

Before you move on

What does సూచన mean? (“An instruction, a note (on a sign)”.) Say it once more.

156.3 అద్దె (adde) — rent

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a timetable, then the Telugu for an instruction.

You'll want to know: అద్దె

అద్దె — *adde* — “rent”. The money you pay to live in a house: ఇంటి అద్దె — *inti adde* — “the rent for the house”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: adde*
- *Say it: adde*, once more
- *Say it: say adde*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a timetable, then the Telugu for an instruction, then say adde again*

Before you move on

What does అద్దె mean? (“Rent”.) Say it once more.

156.4 ప్రకటన (prakaṭana) — an advertisement, an announcement

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an instruction, then the Telugu for rent.

You'll want to know: ప్రకటన

ప్రకటన — *prakaṭana* — “an advertisement, an announcement”. Read the advert: ఇల్లు అద్దెకు ఉంది — *illu addeku undi* — “House for rent.”

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prakāṭana*
- *Say it: prakāṭana, once more*
- *Say it: say prakāṭana*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for an instruction, then the Telugu for rent, then say prakāṭana again*

Before you move on

What does ప్రకటన mean? (“An advertisement, an announcement”.)
Say it once more.

156.5 రసీదు (rasīdu) — a receipt

Before the new one: say the Telugu for rent, then the Telugu for an advertisement.

You'll want to know: రసీదు

రసీదు — *rasīdu* — “a receipt”. Ask for it when you pay: రసీదు ఇస్తారా? — *rasīdu istārā?* — “Could you give me the receipt?” Read two words again: చాయ (chāya, shade) is written with చ, and ఝరి (*jhari*, a stream) with ఝ.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rasīdu*
- *Say it: rasīdu, once more*
- *Say it: say rasīdu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for rent, then the Telugu for an advertisement, then say *rasīdu* again

Before you move on

What does రసీదు mean? (“A receipt”.) Say it once more.

156.6 Saying no and looking back — a first pass

Say the words for an advertisement and a receipt.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nobody, never, nowhere, anyone, anything
- recently, already, last, once, to spend

Before you move on

Nobody? (ఎవరూ, *evarū.*) Never? (ఎప్పుడూ, *eppuḍū.*) Nowhere? (ఎక్కడా, *ekkaḍā.*) Anyone? (ఎవరైనా, *evarainā.*) Anything? (ఏమైనా, *ēmainā.*) Recently? (ఇటీవల, *iṭīvala.*) Already? (ఇప్పటికే, *ippaṭikē.*) Last? (గత, *gata.*) Once? (ఒకసారి, *okasāri.*) To spend? (గడుపు, *gaḍupu.*)

156.7 Looking ahead and reading signs — a second pass

Say the words for next and from now on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- next, from now on, the future, to hope, to look forward to
- a timetable, an instruction, rent, an advertisement, a receipt

Before you move on

Next? (వచ్చే, *vaccē*.) From now on? (ఇకపై, *ikapai*.) The future? (భవిష్యత్తు, *bhaviṣyattu*.) To hope? (ఆశించు, *āśiñcu*.) To look forward to? (ఎదురుచూడు, *edurucūḍu*.) A timetable? (కాలపట్టిక, *kālapattika*.) An instruction? (సూచన, *sūcana*.) Rent? (అద్దె, *adde*.) An advertisement? (ప్రకటన, *prakaṭana*.) A receipt? (రసీదు, *rasīdu*.)

Chapter 157

To pay, To fry, To boil, To mix, To grind

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to pay, to fry, to boil, to mix and to grind.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 157: I can say to pay, to fry, to boil, to mix and to grind.

157.1 చెల్లించు (cellĩncu) — to pay

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an advertisement, then the Telugu for a receipt.

You'll want to know: చెల్లించు

చెల్లించు — *cellĩncu* — “to pay”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *cellĩncu*
- Say it: *cellĩncu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *cellĩncu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an advertisement, then the Telugu for a receipt, then say *cellĩncu* again

Before you move on

What does చెల్లించు mean? (“To pay.”) Say it once more.

157.2 వేయించు (*vēyiñcu*) — to fry, to roast

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a receipt, then the Telugu for to pay.

You’ll want to know: వేయించు

వేయించు — *vēyiñcu* — “to fry, to roast”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vēyiñcu*
- *Say it:* *vēyiñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vēyiñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a receipt, then the Telugu for to pay, then say *vēyiñcu* again

Before you move on

What does వేయించు mean? (“To fry, to roast.”) Say it once more.

157.3 ఉడికించు (*udikiñcu*) — to boil (food), to simmer

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to pay, then the Telugu for to fry.

You'll want to know: ఉడికించు

ఉడికించు — *udikiñcu* — “to boil (food), to simmer”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: udikiñcu*
- *Say it: udikiñcu*, once more
- *Say it: say udikiñcu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to pay, then the Telugu for to fry, then say udikiñcu again*

Before you move on

What does ఉడికించు mean? (“To boil (food), to simmer”.) Say it once more.

157.4 కలుపు (kalupu) — to mix, to stir in

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to fry, then the Telugu for to boil.

You'll want to know: కలుపు

కలుపు — *kalupu* — “to mix, to stir in”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalupu*
- *Say it: kalupu*, once more
- *Say it: say kalupu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to fry, then the Telugu for to boil, then say *kalupu* again

Before you move on

What does కలుపు mean? (“To mix, to stir in”.) Say it once more.

157.5 రుబ్బు (rubbu) — to grind (wet batter)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to boil, then the Telugu for to mix.

You’ll want to know: రుబ్బు

రుబ్బు — *rubbu* — “to grind (wet batter)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rubbu*
- *Say it:* *rubbu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rubbu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to boil, then the Telugu for to mix, then say *rubbu* again

Before you move on

What does రుబ్బు mean? (“To grind (wet batter)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 158

To hurry, To brush, To change, To take off, To measure

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to hurry, to brush, to change, to take off and to measure.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say to hurry, to brush, to change, to take off and to measure.

158.1 తొందరపడు (tondarapaḍu) — to hurry

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to mix, then the Telugu for to grind.

You'll want to know: తొందరపడు

తొందరపడు — *tondarapaḍu* — “to hurry”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tondarapaḍu*
- Say it: *tondarapaḍu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tondarapaḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to mix, then the Telugu for to grind, then say *tondarapaḍu* again

Before you move on

What does తొందరపడు mean? (“To hurry.”) Say it once more.

158.2 తోము (tōmu) — to brush (teeth), to scour (pots)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to grind, then the Telugu for to hurry.

You’ll want to know: తోము

తోము — *tōmu* — “to brush (teeth), to scour (pots)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tōmu*
- *Say it:* *tōmu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōmu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to grind, then the Telugu for to hurry, then say *tōmu* again

Before you move on

What does తోము mean? (“To brush (teeth), to scour (pots)”.) Say it once more.

158.3 మార్పు (mārcu) — to change

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to hurry, then the Telugu for to brush.

You'll want to know: మార్పు

మార్పు — *mārcu* — “to change”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mārcu*
- *Say it: mārcu, once more*
- *Say it: say mārcu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to hurry, then the Telugu for to brush, then say mārcu again*

Before you move on

What does మార్పు mean? (“To change”.) Say it once more.

158.4 విప్పు (vippu) — to take off, to untie

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to brush, then the Telugu for to change.

You'll want to know: విప్పు

విప్పు — *vippu* — “to take off, to untie”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vippu*
- *Say it: vippu*, once more
- *Say it: say vippu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to brush, then the Telugu for to change, then say vippu again*

Before you move on

What does విప్పు mean? (“To take off, to untie”.) Say it once more.

158.5 కొలుచు (kolucu) — to measure

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to change, then the Telugu for to take off.

You’ll want to know: కొలుచు

కొలుచు — *kolucu* — “to measure”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kolucu*
- *Say it: kolucu*, once more
- *Say it: say kolucu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to change, then the Telugu for to take off, then say kolucu again*

Before you move on

What does కొలుచు mean? (“To measure”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

To squeeze, To soak, To repair, To throw away, To lose

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to squeeze, to soak, to repair, to throw away and to lose.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can say to squeeze, to soak, to repair, to throw away and to lose.

159.1 పిండు (piṇḍu) — to squeeze

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to take off, then the Telugu for to measure.

You'll want to know: పిండు

పిండు — *piṇḍu* — “to squeeze”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *piṇḍu*
- Say it: *piṇḍu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *piṇḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to take off, then the Telugu for to measure, then say *piṇḍu* again

Before you move on

What does పిండు mean? (“To squeeze”.) Say it once more.

159.2 నానబెట్టు (nānabetṭu) — to soak

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to measure, then the Telugu for to squeeze.

You’ll want to know: నానబెట్టు

నానబెట్టు — *nānabetṭu* — “to soak”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nānabetṭu*
- *Say it:* *nānabetṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nānabetṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to measure, then the Telugu for to squeeze, then say *nānabetṭu* again

Before you move on

What does నానబెట్టు mean? (“To soak”.) Say it once more.

159.3 బాగుచేయు (bāgucēyu) — to repair, to mend

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to squeeze, then the Telugu for to soak.

You'll want to know: బాగుచేయు

బాగుచేయు — *bāgucēyu* — “to repair, to mend”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāgucēyu*
- *Say it: bāgucēyu*, once more
- *Say it: say bāgucēyu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to squeeze, then the Telugu for to soak, then say bāgucēyu again*

Before you move on

What does బాగుచేయు mean? (“To repair, to mend”.) Say it once more.

159.4 పారేయు (pārēyu) — to throw away

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to soak, then the Telugu for to repair.

You'll want to know: పారేయు

పారేయు — *pārēyu* — “to throw away”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pārēyu*
- *Say it: pārēyu*, once more
- *Say it: say pārēyu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to soak, then the Telugu for to repair, then say *pārēyu* again

Before you move on

What does పారేయు mean? (“To throw away”.) Say it once more.

159.5 పోగొట్టుకో (pōgoṭṭukō) — to lose (something)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to repair, then the Telugu for to throw away.

You’ll want to know: పోగొట్టుకో

పోగొట్టుకో — *pōgoṭṭukō* — “to lose (something)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pōgoṭṭukō*
- *Say it:* *pōgoṭṭukō*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōgoṭṭukō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to repair, then the Telugu for to throw away, then say *pōgoṭṭukō* again

Before you move on

What does పోగొట్టుకో mean? (“To lose (something)”) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

To earn, To explain, To translate, To remember, To agree

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to earn, to explain, to translate, to remember and to agree.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can say to earn, to explain, to translate, to remember and to agree.

160.1 సంపాదించు (sampādiñcu) — to earn

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to throw away, then the Telugu for to lose.

You'll want to know: సంపాదించు

సంపాదించు — *sampādiñcu* — “to earn”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *sampādiñcu*
- Say it: *sampādiñcu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *sampādiñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to throw away, then the Telugu for to lose, then say *sampādiñcu* again

Before you move on

What does సంపాదించు mean? (“To earn”.) Say it once more.

160.2 వివరించు (vivariñcu) — to explain

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to lose, then the Telugu for to earn.

You’ll want to know: వివరించు

వివరించు — *vivariñcu* — “to explain”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vivariñcu*
- *Say it:* *vivariñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vivariñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to lose, then the Telugu for to earn, then say *vivariñcu* again

Before you move on

What does వివరించు mean? (“To explain”.) Say it once more.

160.3 అనువదించు (anuvadiñcu) — to translate

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to earn, then the Telugu for to explain.

You'll want to know: అనువదించు

అనువదించు — *anuvadiñcu* — “to translate”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anuvadiñcu*
- *Say it: anuvadiñcu*, once more
- *Say it: say anuvadiñcu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to earn, then the Telugu for to explain, then say anuvadiñcu again*

Before you move on

What does అనువదించు mean? (“To translate”.) Say it once more.

160.4 గుర్తుపెట్టుకో (gurtupeṭṭukō) — to remember, to keep in mind

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to explain, then the Telugu for to translate.

You'll want to know: గుర్తుపెట్టుకో

గుర్తుపెట్టుకో — *gurtupeṭṭukō* — “to remember, to keep in mind”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gurtupeṭṭukō*
- *Say it: gurtupeṭṭukō*, once more

- *Say it:* say *gurtupeṭṭukō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to explain, then the Telugu for to translate, then say *gurtupeṭṭukō* again

Before you move on

What does గుర్తుపెట్టుకో mean? (“To remember, to keep in mind”.)
Say it once more.

160.5 ఒప్పుకో (oppukō) — to agree, to accept

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to translate, then the Telugu for to remember.

You’ll want to know: ఒప్పుకో

ఒప్పుకో — *oppukō* — “to agree, to accept”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *oppukō*
- *Say it:* *oppukō*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oppukō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to translate, then the Telugu for to remember, then say *oppukō* again

Before you move on

What does ఒప్పుకో mean? (“To agree, to accept”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 161

To dance, To celebrate, To greet, To feel shy, To be surprised

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to dance, to celebrate, to greet, to feel shy and to be surprised.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can say to dance, to celebrate, to greet, to feel shy and to be surprised.

161.1 నాట్యం చేయు (nāṭyam cēyu) — to dance

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to remember, then the Telugu for to agree.

You'll want to know: నాట్యం చేయు

నాట్యం చేయు — *nāṭyam cēyu* — “to dance”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *nāṭyam cēyu*
- Say it: *nāṭyam cēyu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *nāṭyaṁ cēyu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to remember, then the Telugu for to agree, then say *nāṭyaṁ cēyu* again

Before you move on

What does నాట్యం చేయు mean? (“To dance”.) Say it once more.

161.2 జరుపుకో (jarupukō) — to celebrate (a festival or occasion)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to agree, then the Telugu for to dance.

You’ll want to know: జరుపుకో

జరుపుకో — *jarupukō* — “to celebrate (a festival or occasion)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jarupukō*
- *Say it:* *jarupukō*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jarupukō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to agree, then the Telugu for to dance, then say *jarupukō* again

Before you move on

What does జరుపుకో mean? (“To celebrate (a festival or occasion)”.) Say it once more.

161.3 పలకరించు (palakariñcu) — to greet

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to dance, then the Telugu for to celebrate.

You'll want to know: పలకరించు

పలకరించు — *palakariñcu* — “to greet”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: palakariñcu*
- *Say it: palakariñcu*, once more
- *Say it: say palakariñcu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to dance, then the Telugu for to celebrate, then say palakariñcu again*

Before you move on

What does పలకరించు mean? (“To greet”.) Say it once more.

161.4 సిగ్గుపడు (siggupaḍu) — to feel shy, to be bashful

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to celebrate, then the Telugu for to greet.

You'll want to know: సిగ్గుపడు

సిగ్గుపడు — *siggupaḍu* — “to feel shy, to be bashful”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *siggupaḍu*
- *Say it:* *siggupaḍu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *siggupaḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to celebrate, then the Telugu for to greet, then say *siggupaḍu* again

Before you move on

What does సిగ్గుపడు mean? (“To feel shy, to be bashful”.) Say it once more.

161.5 ఆశ్చర్యపోవు (āścaryapōvu) — to be surprised, to be amazed

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to greet, then the Telugu for to feel shy.

You’ll want to know: ఆశ్చర్యపోవు

ఆశ్చర్యపోవు — *āścaryapōvu* — “to be surprised, to be amazed”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āścaryapōvu*
- *Say it:* *āścaryapōvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āścaryapōvu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to greet, then the Telugu for to feel shy, then say *āścaryapōvu* again

Before you move on

What does ఆశ్చర్యపోవు mean? (“To be surprised, to be amazed”.)
Say it once more.

Chapter 162

To kiss, To hug, To tease, To praise, To describe

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to kiss, to hug, to tease, to praise and to describe.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say to kiss, to hug, to tease, to praise and to describe.

162.1 ముద్దుపెట్టు (muddupeṭṭu) — to kiss

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to feel shy, then the Telugu for to be surprised.

You'll want to know: ముద్దుపెట్టు

ముద్దుపెట్టు — *muddupeṭṭu* — “to kiss”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *muddupeṭṭu*
- Say it: *muddupeṭṭu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *muddupetṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to feel shy, then the Telugu for to be surprised, then say *muddupetṭu* again

Before you move on

What does ముద్దుపెట్టు mean? (“To kiss”.) Say it once more.

162.2 కౌగిలించు (kaugiliñcu) — to hug, to embrace

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to be surprised, then the Telugu for to kiss.

You’ll want to know: కౌగిలించు

కౌగిలించు — *kaugiliñcu* — “to hug, to embrace”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaugiliñcu*
- *Say it:* *kaugiliñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaugiliñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to be surprised, then the Telugu for to kiss, then say *kaugiliñcu* again

Before you move on

What does కౌగిలించు mean? (“To hug, to embrace”.) Say it once more.

162.3 ఆటపట్టించు (āṭapaṭṭiñcu) — to tease

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to kiss, then the Telugu for to hug.

You'll want to know: ఆటపట్టించు

ఆటపట్టించు — *āṭapattin̄cu* — “to tease”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āṭapattin̄cu*
- *Say it: āṭapattin̄cu*, once more
- *Say it: say āṭapattin̄cu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to kiss, then the Telugu for to hug, then say āṭapattin̄cu again*

Before you move on

What does ఆటపట్టించు mean? (“To tease”.) Say it once more.

162.4 పొగడు (pogaḍu) — to praise

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to hug, then the Telugu for to tease.

You'll want to know: పొగడు

పొగడు — *pogaḍu* — “to praise”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pogaḍu*
- *Say it: pogaḍu*, once more
- *Say it: say pogaḍu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to hug, then the Telugu for to tease, then say *pogaḍu* again

Before you move on

What does పొగడు mean? (“To praise.”) Say it once more.

162.5 వర్ణించు (varṇiṇcu) — to describe

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to tease, then the Telugu for to praise.

You’ll want to know: వర్ణించు

వర్ణించు — *varṇiṇcu* — “to describe”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *varṇiṇcu*
- *Say it:* *varṇiṇcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *varṇiṇcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to tease, then the Telugu for to praise, then say *varṇiṇcu* again

Before you move on

What does వర్ణించు mean? (“To describe.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

To suspect, To realize, To pay attention to, To compete, To kick

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to suspect, to realize, to pay attention to, to compete and to kick.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can say to suspect, to realize, to pay attention to, to compete and to kick.

163.1 అనుమానించు (anumāniñcu) — to suspect, to doubt

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to praise, then the Telugu for to describe.

You'll want to know: అనుమానించు

అనుమానించు — *anumāniñcu* — “to suspect, to doubt”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *anumāniñcu*
- Say it: *anumāniñcu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *anumāniñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to praise, then the Telugu for to describe, then say *anumāniñcu* again

Before you move on

What does అనుమానించు mean? (“To suspect, to doubt”.) Say it once more.

163.2 గ్రహించు (grahiñcu) — to realize, to grasp

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to describe, then the Telugu for to suspect.

You’ll want to know: గ్రహించు

గ్రహించు — *grahiñcu* — “to realize, to grasp”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *grahiñcu*
- *Say it:* *grahiñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grahiñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to describe, then the Telugu for to suspect, then say *grahiñcu* again

Before you move on

What does గ్రహించు mean? (“To realize, to grasp”.) Say it once more.

163.3 పట్టించుకో (paṭṭiñcukō) — to pay attention to, to care about

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to suspect, then the Telugu for to realize.

You'll want to know: పట్టించుకో

పట్టించుకో — *paṭṭiñcukō* — “to pay attention to, to care about”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭṭiñcukō*
- *Say it: paṭṭiñcukō, once more*
- *Say it: say paṭṭiñcukō*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to suspect, then the Telugu for to realize, then say paṭṭiñcukō again*

Before you move on

What does పట్టించుకో mean? (“To pay attention to, to care about”.)
Say it once more.

163.4 పోటీపడు (pōṭīpaḍu) — to compete

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to realize, then the Telugu for to pay attention to.

You'll want to know: పోటీపడు

పోటీపడు — *pōṭīpaḍu* — “to compete”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pōṭipadu*
- *Say it:* *pōṭipadu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōṭipadu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to realize, then the Telugu for to pay attention to, then say *pōṭipadu* again

Before you move on

What does పోటీపడు mean? (“To compete”.) Say it once more.

163.5 తన్ను (tannu) — to kick

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to pay attention to, then the Telugu for to compete.

You’ll want to know: తన్ను

తన్ను — *tannu* — “to kick”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tannu*
- *Say it:* *tannu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tannu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to pay attention to, then the Telugu for to compete, then say *tannu* again

Before you move on

What does తన్ను mean? (“To kick”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 164

To grate, To strain, To dip, To tear, To wrap

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to grate, to strain, to dip, to tear and to wrap.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can say to grate, to strain, to dip, to tear and to wrap.

164.1 తురుము (turumu) — to grate

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to compete, then the Telugu for to kick.

You'll want to know: తురుము

తురుము — *turumu* — “to grate”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *turumu*
- Say it: *turumu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *turumu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to compete, then the Telugu for to kick, then say *turumu* again

Before you move on

What does తురుము mean? (“To grate”.) Say it once more.

164.2 వడకట్టు (vaḍakaṭṭu) — to strain, to filter

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to kick, then the Telugu for to grate.

You’ll want to know: వడకట్టు

వడకట్టు — *vaḍakaṭṭu* — “to strain, to filter”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vaḍakaṭṭu*
- *Say it:* *vaḍakaṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaḍakaṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to kick, then the Telugu for to grate, then say *vaḍakaṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does వడకట్టు mean? (“To strain, to filter”.) Say it once more.

164.3 ముంచు (muñcu) — to dip, to soak in

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to grate, then the Telugu for to strain.

You'll want to know: ముంచు

ముంచు — *muñcu* — “to dip, to soak in”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muñcu*
- *Say it: muñcu*, once more
- *Say it: say muñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to grate, then the Telugu for to strain, then say *muñcu* again

Before you move on

What does ముంచు mean? (“To dip, to soak in”.) Say it once more.

164.4 చింపు (cimpu) — to tear

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to strain, then the Telugu for to dip.

You'll want to know: చింపు

చింపు — *cimpu* — “to tear”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cimpu*
- *Say it: cimpu*, once more
- *Say it: say cimpu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to strain, then the Telugu for to dip, then say *cimpu* again

Before you move on

What does చింపు mean? (“To tear”.) Say it once more.

164.5 చుట్టు (cutṭu) — to wrap, to roll up

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to dip, then the Telugu for to tear.

You’ll want to know: చుట్టు

చుట్టు — *cutṭu* — “to wrap, to roll up”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cutṭu*
- *Say it:* *cutṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cutṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to dip, then the Telugu for to tear, then say *cutṭu* again

Before you move on

What does చుట్టు mean? (“To wrap, to roll up”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

To spill, To shave, To tighten, To prick, To knit

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to spill, to shave, to tighten, to prick and to knit.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can say to spill, to shave, to tighten, to prick and to knit.

165.1 చిందు (cindu) — to spill

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to tear, then the Telugu for to wrap.

You'll want to know: చిందు

చిందు — *cindu* — “to spill”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *cindu*
- Say it: *cindu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *cindu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to tear, then the Telugu for to wrap, then say *cindu* again

Before you move on

What does చిందు mean? (“To spill”.) Say it once more.

165.2 గొరుగు (gorugu) — to shave

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to wrap, then the Telugu for to spill.

You’ll want to know: గొరుగు

గొరుగు — *gorugu* — “to shave”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gorugu*
- *Say it:* *gorugu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gorugu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to wrap, then the Telugu for to spill, then say *gorugu* again

Before you move on

What does గొరుగు mean? (“To shave”.) Say it once more.

165.3 బిగించు (bigiñcu) — to tighten

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to spill, then the Telugu for to shave.

You'll want to know: బిరించు

బిరించు — *biriñcu* — “to tighten”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: biriñcu*
- *Say it: biriñcu*, once more
- *Say it: say biriñcu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to spill, then the Telugu for to shave, then say biriñcu again*

Before you move on

What does బిరించు mean? (“To tighten”.) Say it once more.

165.4 గుచ్చు (*guccu*) — to prick, to string (flowers)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to shave, then the Telugu for to tighten.

You'll want to know: గుచ్చు

గుచ్చు — *guccu* — “to prick, to string (flowers)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: guccu*
- *Say it: guccu*, once more
- *Say it: say guccu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to shave, then the Telugu for to tighten, then say *guccu* again

Before you move on

What does గుచ్చు mean? (“To prick, to string (flowers).”) Say it once more.

165.5 అల్లు (allu) — to knit, to weave

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to tighten, then the Telugu for to prick.

You’ll want to know: అల్లు

అల్లు — *allu* — “to knit, to weave”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *allu*
- *Say it:* *allu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *allu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to tighten, then the Telugu for to prick, then say *allu* again

Before you move on

What does అల్లు mean? (“To knit, to weave.”) Say it once more.

165.6 Words from chapters 157-160 — a first pass

Say the words for to prick and to knit.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to pay, to fry, to boil, to mix, to grind
- to hurry, to brush, to change, to take off, to measure
- to squeeze, to soak, to repair, to throw away, to lose
- to earn, to explain, to translate, to remember, to agree

Before you move on

To pay? (చెల్లించు, *cellin̄cu.*) To fry? (వేయించు, *vēyin̄cu.*) To boil? (ఉడికించు, *uḍikiñcu.*) To mix? (కలుపు, *kalupu.*) To grind? (రుబ్బు, *rubbu.*) To hurry? (తొందరపడు, *tondarapaḍu.*) To brush? (తోము, *tōmu.*) To change? (మార్పు, *mārcu.*) To take off? (విప్పు, *vippu.*) To measure? (కొలుచు, *kolucu.*) To squeeze? (పిండు, *piṇḍu.*) To soak? (నానబెట్టు, *nānabeṭṭu.*) To repair? (బాగుచేయు, *bāgucēyu.*) To throw away? (పారేయు, *pārēyu.*) To lose? (పోగొట్టుకో, *pōgotṭukō.*) To earn? (సంపాదించు, *sampādiñcu.*) To explain? (వివరించు, *vivarin̄cu.*) To translate? (అనువదించు, *anuvadiñcu.*) To remember? (గుర్తుపెట్టుకో, *gurtupeṭṭukō.*) To agree? (ఒప్పుకో, *oppukō.*)

165.7 Words from chapters 161-165 — a second pass

Say the words for to dance and to celebrate.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to dance, to celebrate, to greet, to feel shy, to be surprised
- to kiss, to hug, to tease, to praise, to describe
- to suspect, to realize, to pay attention to, to compete, to kick
- to grate, to strain, to dip, to tear, to wrap
- to spill, to shave, to tighten, to prick, to knit

Before you move on

To dance? (నాట్యం చేయు, *nāṭyam cēyu.*) To celebrate? (జరుపుకో, *jarupukō.*) To greet? (పలకరించు, *palakarĩncu.*) To feel shy? (సిగ్గుపడు, *siggupadu.*) To be surprised? (ఆశ్చర్యపోవు, *āścaryapōvu.*) To kiss? (ముద్దుపెట్టు, *muddupetṭu.*) To hug? (కొరిలించు, *kaugiliĩncu.*) To tease? (ఆటపట్టించు, *āṭapattĩncu.*) To praise? (పొగడు, *pogaḍu.*) To describe? (వర్ణించు, *varṇĩncu.*) To suspect? (అనుమానించు, *anumāniĩncu.*) To realize? (గ్రహించు, *grahiĩncu.*) To pay attention to? (పట్టించుకో, *pattĩncukō.*) To compete? (పోటీపడు, *pōṭīpadu.*) To kick? (తన్ను, *tannu.*) To grate? (తురుము, *turumu.*) To strain? (వడకట్టు, *vaḍakattṭu.*) To dip? (ముంచు, *muĩncu.*) To tear? (చింపు, *cimpu.*) To wrap? (చుట్టు, *cuttṭu.*) To spill? (చిందు, *cindu.*) To shave? (గొరుగు, *gorugu.*) To tighten? (బిగించు, *bigĩncu.*) To prick? (గుచ్చు, *guccu.*) To knit? (అల్లు, *allu.*)

Chapter 166

To continue, To observe, To correct, To mutter, To separate

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to continue, to observe, to correct, to mutter and to separate.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can say to continue, to observe, to correct, to mutter and to separate.

166.1 కొనసాగు (konasāgu) — to continue

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to prick, then the Telugu for to knit.

You'll want to know: కొనసాగు

కొనసాగు — *konasāgu* — “to continue”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *konasāgu*
- Say it: *konasāgu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *konasāgu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to prick, then the Telugu for to knit, then say *konasāgu* again

Before you move on

What does కొనసాగు mean? (“To continue”.) Say it once more.

166.2 పాటించు (pāṭiñcu) — to observe, to follow (rules)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to knit, then the Telugu for to continue.

You’ll want to know: పాటించు

పాటించు — *pāṭiñcu* — “to observe, to follow (rules)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pāṭiñcu*
- *Say it:* *pāṭiñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṭiñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to knit, then the Telugu for to continue, then say *pāṭiñcu* again

Before you move on

What does పాటించు mean? (“To observe, to follow (rules)”.) Say it once more.

166.3 దిద్దు (diddu) — to correct (written work)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to continue, then the Telugu for to observe.

You'll want to know: దిద్దు

దిద్దు — *diddu* — “to correct (written work)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diddu*
- *Say it: diddu*, once more
- *Say it: say diddu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to continue, then the Telugu for to observe, then say *diddu* again

Before you move on

What does దిద్దు mean? (“To correct (written work)”). Say it once more.

166.4 గొణుగు (goṇugu) — to mutter, to grumble

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to observe, then the Telugu for to correct.

You'll want to know: గొణుగు

గొణుగు — *goṇugu* — “to mutter, to grumble”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: goṇugu*
- *Say it: goṇugu, once more*
- *Say it: say goṇugu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to observe, then the Telugu for to correct, then say goṇugu again*

Before you move on

What does గొణుగు mean? (“To mutter, to grumble.”) Say it once more.

166.5 విడిపోవు (viḍipōvu) — to separate, to part

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to correct, then the Telugu for to mutter.

You’ll want to know: విడిపోవు

విడిపోవు — *viḍipōvu* — “to separate, to part”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viḍipōvu*
- *Say it: viḍipōvu, once more*
- *Say it: say viḍipōvu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for to correct, then the Telugu for to mutter, then say viḍipōvu again*

Before you move on

What does విడిపోవు mean? (“To separate, to part”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 167

Headache, Diarrhoea, Tablet, Sweat, Swelling

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a headache, diarrhoea, a tablet, sweat and a swelling.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can say a headache, diarrhoea, a tablet, sweat and a swelling.

167.1 తలనొప్పి (talanoppi) — a headache

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to mutter, then the Telugu for to separate.

You'll want to know: తలనొప్పి

తలనొప్పి — *talanoppi* — “a headache”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *talanoppi*
- Say it: *talanoppi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *talanoṇṇi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to mutter, then the Telugu for to separate, then say *talanoṇṇi* again

Before you move on

What does తలనొప్పి mean? (“A headache”.) Say it once more.

167.2 విరేచనాలు (virēcanālu) — diarrhoea

Before the new one: say the Telugu for to separate, then the Telugu for a headache.

You’ll want to know: విరేచనాలు

విరేచనాలు — *virēcanālu* — “diarrhoea”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *virēcanālu*
- *Say it:* *virēcanālu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *virēcanālu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for to separate, then the Telugu for a headache, then say *virēcanālu* again

Before you move on

What does విరేచనాలు mean? (“Diarrhoea”.) Say it once more.

167.3 మాత్ర (mātra) — a tablet, a pill

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a headache, then the Telugu for diarrhoea.

You'll want to know: మాత్ర

మాత్ర — *mātra* — “a tablet, a pill”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mātra*
- *Say it: mātra*, once more
- *Say it: say mātra*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a headache, then the Telugu for diarrhoea, then say mātra again*

Before you move on

What does మాత్ర mean? (“A tablet, a pill”.) Say it once more.

167.4 చెమట (cemaṭa) — sweat

Before the new one: say the Telugu for diarrhoea, then the Telugu for a tablet.

You'll want to know: చెమట

చెమట — *cemaṭa* — “sweat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cemaṭa*
- *Say it: cemaṭa*, once more
- *Say it: say cemaṭa*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for diarrhoea, then the Telugu for a tablet, then say *cemaṭa* again

Before you move on

What does చెమట mean? (“Sweat”.) Say it once more.

167.5 వాపు (vāpu) — a swelling

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a tablet, then the Telugu for sweat.

You’ll want to know: వాపు

వాపు — *vāpu* — “a swelling”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vāpu*
- *Say it:* *vāpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāpu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a tablet, then the Telugu for sweat, then say *vāpu* again

Before you move on

What does వాపు mean? (“A swelling”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 168

Jealousy, Pride, Enthusiasm, Peace, Patience

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say jealousy, pride, enthusiasm, peace and patience.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can say jealousy, pride, enthusiasm, peace and patience.

168.1 అసూయ (asūya) — jealousy

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sweat, then the Telugu for a swelling.

You'll want to know: అసూయ

అసూయ — *asūya* — “jealousy”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *asūya*
- Say it: *asūya*, once more

- *Say it:* say *asūya*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for sweat, then the Telugu for a swelling, then say *asūya* again

Before you move on

What does అసూయ mean? (“Jealousy”.) Say it once more.

168.2 గర్వం (garvam) — pride

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a swelling, then the Telugu for jealousy.

You’ll want to know: గర్వం

గర్వం — *garvam* — “pride”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *garvam*
- *Say it:* *garvam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *garvam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a swelling, then the Telugu for jealousy, then say *garvam* again

Before you move on

What does గర్వం mean? (“Pride”.) Say it once more.

168.3 ఉత్సాహం (utsāham) — enthusiasm, excitement

Before the new one: say the Telugu for jealousy, then the Telugu for pride.

You'll want to know: ఉత్సాహం

ఉత్సాహం — *utsāham* — “enthusiasm, excitement”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: utsāham*
- *Say it: utsāham*, once more
- *Say it: say utsāham*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for jealousy, then the Telugu for pride, then say utsāham again*

Before you move on

What does ఉత్సాహం mean? (“Enthusiasm, excitement”.) Say it once more.

168.4 శాంతి (śānti) — peace, calm

Before the new one: say the Telugu for pride, then the Telugu for enthusiasm.

You'll want to know: శాంతి

శాంతి — *śānti* — “peace, calm”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śānti*
- *Say it: śānti*, once more
- *Say it: say śānti*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for pride, then the Telugu for enthusiasm, then say *śānti* again

Before you move on

What does శాంతి mean? (“Peace, calm”.) Say it once more.

168.5 సహనం (sahanam) — patience

Before the new one: say the Telugu for enthusiasm, then the Telugu for peace.

You’ll want to know: సహనం

సహనం — *sahanam* — “patience”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sahanam*
- *Say it:* *sahanam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sahanam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for enthusiasm, then the Telugu for peace, then say *sahanam* again

Before you move on

What does సహనం mean? (“Patience”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

Sore, Blister, Rash, Scar, Sprain

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a sore, a blister, a rash, a scar and a sprain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can say a sore, a blister, a rash, a scar and a sprain.

169.1 పుండు (puṇḍu) — a sore, an ulcer

Before the new one: say the Telugu for peace, then the Telugu for patience.

You'll want to know: పుండు

పుండు — *puṇḍu* — “a sore, an ulcer”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *puṇḍu*
- Say it: *puṇḍu*, once more
- Say it: say *puṇḍu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for peace, then the Telugu for patience, then say *punḍu* again

Before you move on

What does పుండు mean? (“A sore, an ulcer”.) Say it once more.

169.2 బొబ్బ (bobba) — a blister

Before the new one: say the Telugu for patience, then the Telugu for a sore.

You’ll want to know: బొబ్బ

బొబ్బ — *bobba* — “a blister”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bobba*
- *Say it:* *bobba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bobba*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for patience, then the Telugu for a sore, then say *bobba* again

Before you move on

What does బొబ్బ mean? (“A blister”.) Say it once more.

169.3 దద్దుర్లు (daddurlu) — a rash

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a sore, then the Telugu for a blister.

You'll want to know: దద్దుర్లు

దద్దుర్లు — *daddurlu* — “a rash”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: daddurlu*
- *Say it: daddurlu*, once more
- *Say it: say daddurlu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a sore, then the Telugu for a blister, then say daddurlu again*

Before you move on

What does దద్దుర్లు mean? (“A rash”.) Say it once more.

169.4 మచ్చ (macca) — a scar, a spot

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a blister, then the Telugu for a rash.

You'll want to know: మచ్చ

మచ్చ — *macca* — “a scar, a spot”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: macca*
- *Say it: macca*, once more
- *Say it: say macca*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a blister, then the Telugu for a rash, then say *macca* again

Before you move on

What does మచ్చ mean? (“A scar, a spot”.) Say it once more.

169.5 బెణుకు (beṇuku) — a sprain

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a rash, then the Telugu for a scar.

You’ll want to know: బెణుకు

బెణుకు — *beṇuku* — “a sprain”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beṇuku*
- *Say it:* *beṇuku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beṇuku*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a rash, then the Telugu for a scar, then say *beṇuku* again

Before you move on

What does బెణుకు mean? (“A sprain”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 170

Time, Sometimes, Often, Date, Weekend

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say time, sometimes, often, a date and a weekend.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can say time, sometimes, often, a date and a weekend.

170.1 సమయం (samayam) — time

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a scar, then the Telugu for a sprain.

You'll want to know: సమయం

సమయం — *samayam* — “time”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *samayam*
- Say it: *samayam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *samayam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a scar, then the Telugu for a sprain, then say *samayam* again

Before you move on

What does సమయం mean? (“Time”.) Say it once more.

170.2 అప్పుడప్పుడు (appuḍappuḍu) — sometimes

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a sprain, then the Telugu for time.

You’ll want to know: అప్పుడప్పుడు

అప్పుడప్పుడు — *appuḍappuḍu* — “sometimes”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *appuḍappuḍu*
- *Say it:* *appuḍappuḍu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *appuḍappuḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a sprain, then the Telugu for time, then say *appuḍappuḍu* again

Before you move on

What does అప్పుడప్పుడు mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

170.3 తరచుగా (taracugā) — often

Before the new one: say the Telugu for time, then the Telugu for sometimes.

You'll want to know: తరచుగా

తరచుగా — *taracugā* — “often”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taracugā*
- *Say it: taracugā*, once more
- *Say it: say taracugā*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for time, then the Telugu for sometimes, then say taracugā again*

Before you move on

What does తరచుగా mean? (“Often”.) Say it once more.

170.4 తేదీ (tēdī) — a date

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sometimes, then the Telugu for often.

You'll want to know: తేదీ

తేదీ — *tēdī* — “a date”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tēdī*
- *Say it: tēdī*, once more
- *Say it: say tēdī*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for sometimes, then the Telugu for often, then say *tēdī* again

Before you move on

What does తేదీ mean? (“A date”). Say it once more.

170.5 వారాంతం (vārāntam) — a weekend

Before the new one: say the Telugu for often, then the Telugu for a date.

You’ll want to know: వారాంతం

వారాంతం — *vārāntam* — “a weekend”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vārāntam*
- *Say it:* *vārāntam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vārāntam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for often, then the Telugu for a date, then say *vārāntam* again

Before you move on

What does వారాంతం mean? (“A weekend”). Say it once more.

Chapter 171

Sunset, Every day, Usually, Rarely, Constantly

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sunset, every day, usually, rarely and constantly.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can say sunset, every day, usually, rarely and constantly.

171.1 సూర్యాస్తమయం (sūryāstamayam) — sunset

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a date, then the Telugu for a weekend.

You'll want to know: సూర్యాస్తమయం

సూర్యాస్తమయం — *sūryāstamayam* — “sunset”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *sūryāstamayam*
- Say it: *sūryāstamayam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *sūryāstamayamī*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a date, then the Telugu for a weekend, then say *sūryāstamayamī* again

Before you move on

What does సూర్యాస్తమయం mean? (“Sunset”.) Say it once more.

171.2 ప్రతిరోజు (pratirōju) — every day

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a weekend, then the Telugu for sunset.

You’ll want to know: ప్రతిరోజు

ప్రతిరోజు — *pratirōju* — “every day”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pratirōju*
- *Say it:* *pratirōju*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pratirōju*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a weekend, then the Telugu for sunset, then say *pratirōju* again

Before you move on

What does ప్రతిరోజు mean? (“Every day”.) Say it once more.

171.3 సాధారణంగా (sādhāraṇaṅgā) — usually, generally

Before the new one: say the Telugu for sunset, then the Telugu for every day.

You'll want to know: సాధారణంగా

సాధారణంగా — *sādhāraṇaṅgā* — “usually, generally”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sādhāraṇaṅgā*
- *Say it: sādhāraṇaṅgā*, once more
- *Say it: say sādhāraṇaṅgā*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for sunset, then the Telugu for every day, then say sādhāraṇaṅgā again*

Before you move on

What does సాధారణంగా mean? (“Usually, generally”.) Say it once more.

171.4 అరుదుగా (arudugā) — rarely

Before the new one: say the Telugu for every day, then the Telugu for usually.

You'll want to know: అరుదుగా

అరుదుగా — *arudugā* — “rarely”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arudugā*
- *Say it: arudugā*, once more
- *Say it: say arudugā*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for every day, then the Telugu for usually, then say *arudugā* again

Before you move on

What does అరుదుగా mean? (“Rarely.”) Say it once more.

171.5 నిరంతరం (nirantaram) — constantly, continuously

Before the new one: say the Telugu for usually, then the Telugu for rarely.

You’ll want to know: నిరంతరం

నిరంతరం — *nirantaram* — “constantly, continuously”. Read two words again: ఛాయ (chāya, shade) is written with ఛ, and ఝరి (jhari, a stream) with ఝ.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nirantaram*
- *Say it:* *nirantaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nirantaram*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for usually, then the Telugu for rarely, then say *nirantaram* again

Before you move on

What does నిరంతరం mean? (“Constantly, continuously.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

Youth, Old age, Meanwhile, Every year, Forever

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say youth, old age, meanwhile, every year and forever.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say youth, old age, meanwhile, every year and forever.

172.1 యవ్వనం (yavvanam) — youth

Before the new one: say the Telugu for rarely, then the Telugu for constantly.

You'll want to know: యవ్వనం

యవ్వనం — *yavvanam* — “youth”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *yavvanam*
- Say it: *yavvanam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *yavvanam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for rarely, then the Telugu for constantly, then say *yavvanam* again

Before you move on

What does యవ్వనం mean? (“Youth”.) Say it once more.

172.2 వృద్ధాప్యం (vṛddhāpyam) — old age

Before the new one: say the Telugu for constantly, then the Telugu for youth.

You’ll want to know: వృద్ధాప్యం

వృద్ధాప్యం — *vṛddhāpyam* — “old age”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vṛddhāpyam*
- *Say it:* *vṛddhāpyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vṛddhāpyam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for constantly, then the Telugu for youth, then say *vṛddhāpyam* again

Before you move on

What does వృద్ధాప్యం mean? (“Old age”.) Say it once more.

172.3 ఇంతలో (intalō) — meanwhile

Before the new one: say the Telugu for youth, then the Telugu for old age.

You'll want to know: ఇంతలో

ఇంతలో — *intalō* — “meanwhile”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *intalō*
- *Say it:* *intalō*, once more
- *Say it:* say *intalō*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for youth, then the Telugu for old age, then say *intalō* again

Before you move on

What does ఇంతలో mean? (“Meanwhile”.) Say it once more.

172.4 ఏటా (*ēṭā*) — every year, annually

Before the new one: say the Telugu for old age, then the Telugu for meanwhile.

You'll want to know: ఏటా

ఏటా — *ēṭā* — “every year, annually”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēṭā*
- *Say it:* *ēṭā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēṭā*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for old age, then the Telugu for meanwhile, then say *ēṭā* again

Before you move on

What does ఏటా mean? (“Every year, annually”.) Say it once more.

172.5 ఎప్పటికీ (eppaṭikī) — forever

Before the new one: say the Telugu for meanwhile, then the Telugu for every year.

You’ll want to know: ఎప్పటికీ

ఎప్పటికీ — *eppaṭikī* — “forever”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eppaṭikī*
- *Say it:* *eppaṭikī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eppaṭikī*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for meanwhile, then the Telugu for every year, then say *eppaṭikī* again

Before you move on

What does ఎప్పటికీ mean? (“Forever”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 173

Veranda, Backyard, Restaurant, Beside, Post office

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a veranda, a backyard, a restaurant, beside and a post office.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can say a veranda, a backyard, a restaurant, beside and a post office.

173.1 వరండా (varaṇḍā) — a veranda

Before the new one: say the Telugu for every year, then the Telugu for forever.

You'll want to know: వరండా

వరండా — *varaṇḍā* — “a veranda”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *varaṇḍā*
- Say it: *varaṇḍā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *varaṇḍā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for every year, then the Telugu for forever, then say *varaṇḍā* again

Before you move on

What does వరండా mean? (“A veranda”.) Say it once more.

173.2 పెరడు (*peraḍu*) — a backyard

Before the new one: say the Telugu for forever, then the Telugu for a veranda.

You’ll want to know: పెరడు

పెరడు — *peraḍu* — “a backyard”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *peraḍu*
- *Say it:* *peraḍu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peraḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for forever, then the Telugu for a veranda, then say *peraḍu* again

Before you move on

What does పెరడు mean? (“A backyard”.) Say it once more.

173.3 హోటలు (*hōṭalu*) — a restaurant, an eating house

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a veranda, then the Telugu for a backyard.

You'll want to know: హోటలు

హోటలు — *hōṭalu* — “a restaurant, an eating house”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hōṭalu*
- *Say it: hōṭalu*, once more
- *Say it: say hōṭalu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a veranda, then the Telugu for a backyard, then say hōṭalu again*

Before you move on

What does హోటలు mean? (“A restaurant, an eating house”.) Say it once more.

173.4 పక్కన (pakkana) — beside, next to

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a backyard, then the Telugu for a restaurant.

You'll want to know: పక్కన

పక్కన — *pakkana* — “beside, next to”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakkana*
- *Say it: pakkana*, once more
- *Say it: say pakkana*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a backyard, then the Telugu for a restaurant, then say *pakkana* again

Before you move on

What does పక్కన mean? (“Beside, next to”.) Say it once more.

173.5 పోస్టాఫీసు (pōṣṭāphīsu) — a post office

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a restaurant, then the Telugu for beside.

You’ll want to know: పోస్టాఫీసు

పోస్టాఫీసు — *pōṣṭāphīsu* — “a post office”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pōṣṭāphīsu*
- *Say it:* *pōṣṭāphīsu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōṣṭāphīsu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a restaurant, then the Telugu for beside, then say *pōṣṭāphīsu* again

Before you move on

What does పోస్టాఫీసు mean? (“A post office”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 174

On the other side, That way, This way, Cave, Valley

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say on the other side, that way, this way, a cave and a valley.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can say on the other side, that way, this way, a cave and a valley.

174.1 అవతల (avatala) — on the other side, beyond

Before the new one: say the Telugu for beside, then the Telugu for a post office.

You'll want to know: అవతల

అవతల — *avatala* — “on the other side, beyond”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *avatala*
- Say it: *avatala*, once more

- *Say it:* say *avatala*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for beside, then the Telugu for a post office, then say *avatala* again

Before you move on

What does అవతల mean? (“On the other side, beyond”.) Say it once more.

174.2 అటు (aṭu) — that way, in that direction

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a post office, then the Telugu for on the other side.

You’ll want to know: అటు

అటు — *aṭu* — “that way, in that direction”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aṭu*
- *Say it:* *aṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a post office, then the Telugu for on the other side, then say *aṭu* again

Before you move on

What does అటు mean? (“That way, in that direction”.) Say it once more.

174.3 ఇటు (iṭu) — this way, in this direction

Before the new one: say the Telugu for on the other side, then the Telugu for that way.

You'll want to know: ఇటు

ఇటు — *itu* — “this way, in this direction”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: itu*
- *Say it: itu*, once more
- *Say it: say itu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for on the other side, then the Telugu for that way, then say itu again*

Before you move on

What does ఇటు mean? (“This way, in this direction”.) Say it once more.

174.4 గుహ (guha) — a cave

Before the new one: say the Telugu for that way, then the Telugu for this way.

You'll want to know: గుహ

గుహ — *guha* — “a cave”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: guha*
- *Say it: guha*, once more
- *Say it: say guha*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for that way, then the Telugu for this way, then say *guha* again

Before you move on

What does గుహ mean? (“A cave”.) Say it once more.

174.5 లోయ (lōya) — a valley

Before the new one: say the Telugu for this way, then the Telugu for a cave.

You’ll want to know: లోయ

లోయ — *lōya* — “a valley”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *lōya*
- *Say it:* *lōya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lōya*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for this way, then the Telugu for a cave, then say *lōya* again

Before you move on

What does లోయ mean? (“A valley”.) Say it once more.

174.6 Words from chapters 166-169 — a first pass

Say the words for a cave and a valley.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to continue, to observe, to correct, to mutter, to separate
- a headache, diarrhoea, a tablet, sweat, a swelling
- jealousy, pride, enthusiasm, peace, patience
- a sore, a blister, a rash, a scar, a sprain

Before you move on

To continue? (కొనసాగు, *konasāgu*.) To observe? (పాటించు, *pāṭiñcu*.)
 To correct? (దిద్దు, *diddu*.) To mutter? (గొణుగు, *goṇugu*.) To
 separate? (విడిపోవు, *viḍipōvu*.) A headache? (తలనొప్పి, *talanoṇṇi*.)
 Diarrhoea? (విరేచనాలు, *virēcanālu*.) A tablet? (మాత్ర, *mātra*.)
 Sweat? (చెమట, *cemaṭa*.) A swelling? (వాపు, *vāpu*.) Jealousy?
 (అసూయ, *asūya*.) Pride? (గర్వం, *garvaṁ*.) Enthusiasm? (ఉత్సాహం,
utsāhaṁ.) Peace? (శాంతి, *śānti*.) Patience? (సహనం, *sahanam*.) A
 sore? (పుండు, *punḍu*.) A blister? (బొబ్బ, *bobba*.) A rash? (దద్దుర్లు,
daddurlu.) A scar? (మచ్చ, *macca*.) A sprain? (బెణుకు, *beṇuku*.)

174.7 Words from chapters 170-174 — a second pass

Say the words for time and sometimes.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- time, sometimes, often, a date, a weekend
- sunset, every day, usually, rarely, constantly
- youth, old age, meanwhile, every year, forever
- a veranda, a backyard, a restaurant, beside, a post office
- on the other side, that way, this way, a cave, a valley

Before you move on

Time? (సమయం, *samayam*.) Sometimes? (అప్పుడప్పుడు, *appuḍappuḍu*.) Often? (తరచుగా, *taracugā*.) A date? (తేదీ, *tēdī*.) A weekend? (వారాంతం, *vārāntam*.) Sunset? (సూర్యాస్తమయం, *sūryāstamayam*.) Every day? (ప్రతిరోజు, *pratiroju*.) Usually? (సాధారణంగా, *sādhāraṇaṅgā*.) Rarely? (అరుదుగా, *arudugā*.) Constantly? (నిరంతరం, *nirantaram*.) Youth? (యవ్వనం, *yavvanam*.) Old age? (వృద్ధాప్యం, *vṛddhāpyam*.) Meanwhile? (ఇంతలో, *intalō*.) Every year? (ఏటా, *ēṭā*.) Forever? (ఎప్పటికీ, *eppaṭikī*.) A veranda? (వరండా, *varaṇḍā*.) A backyard? (పెరడు, *peraḍu*.) A restaurant? (హోటలు, *hōṭalu*.) Beside? (పక్కన, *pakkana*.) A post office? (పోస్టాఫీసు, *pōstāphīsu*.) On the other side? (అవతల, *avatala*.) That way? (అటు, *aṭu*.) This way? (ఇటు, *iṭu*.) A cave? (గుహ, *guha*.) A valley? (లోయ, *lōya*.)

Chapter 175

Crowd, World, Earthquake, Dust, Smoke

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a crowd, the world, an earthquake, dust and smoke.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can say a crowd, the world, an earthquake, dust and smoke.

175.1 గుంపు (gumpu) — a crowd

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a cave, then the Telugu for a valley.

You'll want to know: గుంపు

గుంపు — *gumpu* — “a crowd”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *gumpu*
- Say it: *gumpu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *gumpu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a cave, then the Telugu for a valley, then say *gumpu* again

Before you move on

What does గుంపు mean? (“A crowd”.) Say it once more.

175.2 ప్రపంచం (prapañcam) — the world

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a valley, then the Telugu for a crowd.

You’ll want to know: ప్రపంచం

ప్రపంచం — *prapañcam* — “the world”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *prapañcam*
- *Say it:* *prapañcam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prapañcam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a valley, then the Telugu for a crowd, then say *prapañcam* again

Before you move on

What does ప్రపంచం mean? (“The world”.) Say it once more.

175.3 భూకంపం (bhūkampam) — an earthquake

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a crowd, then the Telugu for the world.

You'll want to know: భూకంపం

భూకంపం — *bhūkampam* — “an earthquake”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhūkampam*
- *Say it: bhūkampam*, once more
- *Say it: say bhūkampam*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a crowd, then the Telugu for the world, then say bhūkampam again*

Before you move on

What does భూకంపం mean? (“An earthquake”.) Say it once more.

175.4 దుమ్ము (dummu) — dust

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the world, then the Telugu for an earthquake.

You'll want to know: దుమ్ము

దుమ్ము — *dummu* — “dust”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dummu*
- *Say it: dummu*, once more
- *Say it: say dummu*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for the world, then the Telugu for an earthquake, then say *dummu* again

Before you move on

What does దుమ్ము mean? (“Dust”.) Say it once more.

175.5 పొగ (poga) — smoke

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an earthquake, then the Telugu for dust.

You’ll want to know: పొగ

పొగ — *poga* — “smoke”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *poga*
- *Say it*: *poga*, once more
- *Say it*: say *poga*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for an earthquake, then the Telugu for dust, then say *poga* again

Before you move on

What does పొగ mean? (“Smoke”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 176

Otherwise, Even so, Through, About, Without

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say otherwise, even so, through, about and without.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can say otherwise, even so, through, about and without.

176.1 లేకపోతే (lēkapōtē) — otherwise, or else

Before the new one: say the Telugu for dust, then the Telugu for smoke.

You'll want to know: లేకపోతే

లేకపోతే — *lēkapōtē* — “otherwise, or else”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *lēkapōtē*
- Say it: *lēkapōtē*, once more

- *Say it:* say *lēkapōtē*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for dust, then the Telugu for smoke, then say *lēkapōtē* again

Before you move on

What does లేకపోతే mean? (“Otherwise, or else”.) Say it once more.

176.2 అయినా (*ayinā*) — even so, still

Before the new one: say the Telugu for smoke, then the Telugu for otherwise.

You’ll want to know: అయినా

అయినా — *ayinā* — “even so, still”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ayinā*
- *Say it:* *ayinā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ayinā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for smoke, then the Telugu for otherwise, then say *ayinā* again

Before you move on

What does అయినా mean? (“Even so, still”.) Say it once more.

176.3 ద్వారా (*dvārā*) — through, by means of

Before the new one: say the Telugu for otherwise, then the Telugu for even so.

You'll want to know: ద్వారా

ద్వారా — *dvārā* — “through, by means of”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dvārā*
- *Say it: dvārā*, once more
- *Say it: say dvārā*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for otherwise, then the Telugu for even so, then say dvārā again*

Before you move on

What does ద్వారా mean? (“Through, by means of”.) Say it once more.

176.4 గురించి (guriñci) — about, concerning

Before the new one: say the Telugu for even so, then the Telugu for through.

You'll want to know: గురించి

గురించి — *guriñci* — “about, concerning”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: guriñci*
- *Say it: guriñci*, once more
- *Say it: say guriñci*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for even so, then the Telugu for through, then say *guriñci* again

Before you move on

What does గురించి mean? (“About, concerning”.) Say it once more.

176.5 లేకుండా (lēkuṇḍā) — without

Before the new one: say the Telugu for through, then the Telugu for about.

You’ll want to know: లేకుండా

లేకుండా — *lēkuṇḍā* — “without”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *lēkuṇḍā*
- *Say it:* *lēkuṇḍā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lēkuṇḍā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for through, then the Telugu for about, then say *lēkuṇḍā* again

Before you move on

What does లేకుండా mean? (“Without”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

If by chance, Instead of, According to, Actually, Anyway

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say if by chance, instead of, according to, actually and anyway.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can say if by chance, instead of, according to, actually and anyway.

177.1 ఒకవేళ (okavēḷa) — if by chance, in case

Before the new one: say the Telugu for about, then the Telugu for without.

You'll want to know: ఒకవేళ

ఒకవేళ — *okavēḷa* — “if by chance, in case”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *okavēḷa*
- Say it: *okavēḷa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *okavēla*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for about, then the Telugu for without, then say *okavēla* again

Before you move on

What does ఒకవేళ mean? (“If by chance, in case”.) Say it once more.

177.2 బదులు (badulu) — instead of

Before the new one: say the Telugu for without, then the Telugu for if by chance.

You’ll want to know: బదులు

బదులు — *badulu* — “instead of”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *badulu*
- *Say it:* *badulu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *badulu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for without, then the Telugu for if by chance, then say *badulu* again

Before you move on

What does బదులు mean? (“Instead of”.) Say it once more.

177.3 ప్రకారం (prakāram) — according to

Before the new one: say the Telugu for if by chance, then the Telugu for instead of.

You'll want to know: ప్రకారం

ప్రకారం — *prakāraṁ* — “according to”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prakāraṁ*
- *Say it: prakāraṁ*, once more
- *Say it: say prakāraṁ*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for if by chance, then the Telugu for instead of, then say prakāraṁ again*

Before you move on

What does ప్రకారం mean? (“According to”.) Say it once more.

177.4 అసలు (asalu) — actually; (not) at all

Before the new one: say the Telugu for instead of, then the Telugu for according to.

You'll want to know: అసలు

అసలు — *asalu* — “actually; (not) at all”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: asalu*
- *Say it: asalu*, once more
- *Say it: say asalu*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for instead of, then the Telugu for according to, then say *asalu* again

Before you move on

What does అసలు mean? (“Actually; (not) at all”.) Say it once more.

177.5 ఏదేమైనా (*ēdēmainā*) — anyway, in any case

Before the new one: say the Telugu for according to, then the Telugu for actually.

You’ll want to know: ఏదేమైనా

ఏదేమైనా — *ēdēmainā* — “anyway, in any case”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *ēdēmainā*
- *Say it*: *ēdēmainā*, once more
- *Say it*: say *ēdēmainā*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for according to, then the Telugu for actually, then say *ēdēmainā* again

Before you move on

What does ఏదేమైనా mean? (“Anyway, in any case”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

On purpose, By mistake, Never mind, Condition, Excuse

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say on purpose, by mistake, never mind, a condition and an excuse.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say on purpose, by mistake, never mind, a condition and an excuse.

178.1 కావాలని (kāvālani) — on purpose, deliberately

Before the new one: say the Telugu for actually, then the Telugu for anyway.

You'll want to know: కావాలని

కావాలని — *kāvālani* — “on purpose, deliberately”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kāvālani*
- Say it: *kāvālani*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kāvalāni*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for actually, then the Telugu for anyway, then say *kāvalāni* again

Before you move on

What does కావాలని mean? (“On purpose, deliberately”.) Say it once more.

178.2 పొరపాటున (porapāṭuna) — by mistake, accidentally

Before the new one: say the Telugu for anyway, then the Telugu for on purpose.

You’ll want to know: పొరపాటున

పొరపాటున — *porapāṭuna* — “by mistake, accidentally”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *porapāṭuna*
- *Say it:* *porapāṭuna*, once more
- *Say it:* say *porapāṭuna*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for anyway, then the Telugu for on purpose, then say *porapāṭuna* again

Before you move on

What does పొరపాటున mean? (“By mistake, accidentally”.) Say it once more.

178.3 పోనీ (pōnī) — never mind; let it be

Before the new one: say the Telugu for on purpose, then the Telugu for by mistake.

You'll want to know: పోనీ

పోనీ — *pōnī* — “never mind; let it be”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pōnī*
- *Say it: pōnī, once more*
- *Say it: say pōnī*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for on purpose, then the Telugu for by mistake, then say pōnī again*

Before you move on

What does పోనీ mean? (“Never mind; let it be”.) Say it once more.

178.4 షరతు (ṣaratu) — a condition

Before the new one: say the Telugu for by mistake, then the Telugu for never mind.

You'll want to know: షరతు

షరతు — *ṣaratu* — “a condition”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ṣaratu*
- *Say it:* *ṣaratu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṣaratu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for by mistake, then the Telugu for never mind, then say *ṣaratu* again

Before you move on

What does పరతు mean? (“A condition”.) Say it once more.

178.5 సాకు (sāku) — an excuse, a pretext

Before the new one: say the Telugu for never mind, then the Telugu for a condition.

You’ll want to know: సాకు

సాకు — *sāku* — “an excuse, a pretext”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sāku*
- *Say it:* *sāku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāku*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for never mind, then the Telugu for a condition, then say *sāku* again

Before you move on

What does సాకు mean? (“An excuse, a pretext”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 179

Delicious, Bland, Fresh, Expensive, Cheap

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say delicious, bland, fresh, expensive and cheap.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can say delicious, bland, fresh, expensive and cheap.

179.1 కమ్మని (kammani) — delicious, tasty

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a condition, then the Telugu for an excuse.

You'll want to know: కమ్మని

కమ్మని — *kammani* — “delicious, tasty”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kammani*
- Say it: *kammani*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kammani*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a condition, then the Telugu for an excuse, then say *kammani* again

Before you move on

What does కమ్మని mean? (“Delicious, tasty”.) Say it once more.

179.2 చప్పని (cappani) — bland, tasteless

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an excuse, then the Telugu for delicious.

You’ll want to know: చప్పని

చప్పని — *cappani* — “bland, tasteless”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cappani*
- *Say it:* *cappani*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cappani*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an excuse, then the Telugu for delicious, then say *cappani* again

Before you move on

What does చప్పని mean? (“Bland, tasteless”.) Say it once more.

179.3 తాజా (tājā) — fresh

Before the new one: say the Telugu for delicious, then the Telugu for bland.

You'll want to know: తాజా

తాజా — *tājā* — “fresh”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tājā*
- *Say it: tājā*, once more
- *Say it: say tājā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for delicious, then the Telugu for bland, then say *tājā* again

Before you move on

What does తాజా mean? (“Fresh”.) Say it once more.

179.4 ఖరీదైన (kharīdaina) — expensive

Before the new one: say the Telugu for bland, then the Telugu for fresh.

You'll want to know: ఖరీదైన

ఖరీదైన — *kharīdaina* — “expensive”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kharīdaina*
- *Say it: kharīdaina*, once more
- *Say it: say kharīdaina*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for bland, then the Telugu for fresh, then say *kharīdaina* again

Before you move on

What does ఖరీదైన mean? (“Expensive”.) Say it once more.

179.5 చౌక (cauka) — cheap

Before the new one: say the Telugu for fresh, then the Telugu for expensive.

You’ll want to know: చౌక

చౌక — *cauka* — “cheap”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cauka*
- *Say it:* *cauka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cauka*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for fresh, then the Telugu for expensive, then say *cauka* again

Before you move on

What does చౌక mean? (“Cheap”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

Main, Total, Every, Pink, Orange

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say main, total, every, pink and orange.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can say main, total, every, pink and orange.

180.1 ప్రధాన (pradhāna) — main, chief

Before the new one: say the Telugu for expensive, then the Telugu for cheap.

You'll want to know: ప్రధాన

ప్రధాన — *pradhāna* — “main, chief”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *pradhāna*
- Say it: *pradhāna*, once more
- Say it: say *pradhāna*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for expensive, then the Telugu for cheap, then say *pradhāna* again

Before you move on

What does ప్రధాన mean? (“Main, chief”.) Say it once more.

180.2 మొత్తం (mottam) — total, whole; the total

Before the new one: say the Telugu for cheap, then the Telugu for main.

You’ll want to know: మొత్తం

మొత్తం — *mottam* — “total, whole; the total”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mottam*
- *Say it:* *mottam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mottam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for cheap, then the Telugu for main, then say *mottam* again

Before you move on

What does మొత్తం mean? (“Total, whole; the total”.) Say it once more.

180.3 ప్రతి (prati) — every, each

Before the new one: say the Telugu for main, then the Telugu for total.

You'll want to know: ప్రతి

ప్రతి — *prati* — “every, each”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prati*
- *Say it: prati*, once more
- *Say it: say prati*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for main, then the Telugu for total, then say prati again*

Before you move on

What does ప్రతి mean? (“Every, each”.) Say it once more.

180.4 గులాబీ రంగు (*gulābī raṅgu*) — pink

Before the new one: say the Telugu for total, then the Telugu for every.

You'll want to know: గులాబీ రంగు

గులాబీ రంగు — *gulābī raṅgu* — “pink”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gulābī raṅgu*
- *Say it: gulābī raṅgu*, once more
- *Say it: say gulābī raṅgu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for total, then the Telugu for every, then say *gulābī raṅgu* again

Before you move on

What does గులాబీ రంగు mean? (“Pink”.) Say it once more.

180.5 నారింజ రంగు (nāriṅja raṅgu) — orange (colour)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for every, then the Telugu for pink.

You’ll want to know: నారింజ రంగు

నారింజ రంగు — *nāriṅja raṅgu* — “orange (colour)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nāriṅja raṅgu*
- *Say it:* *nāriṅja raṅgu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāriṅja raṅgu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for every, then the Telugu for pink, then say *nāriṅja raṅgu* again

Before you move on

What does నారింజ రంగు mean? (“Orange (colour)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

Great, Smell, Interesting, Wonderful, Ordinary

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say great, a smell, interesting, wonderful and ordinary.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can say great, a smell, interesting, wonderful and ordinary.

181.1 గొప్ప (goppa) — great, eminent

Before the new one: say the Telugu for pink, then the Telugu for orange.

You'll want to know: గొప్ప

గొప్ప — *goppa* — “great, eminent”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *goppa*
- Say it: *goppa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *goppa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for pink, then the Telugu for orange, then say *goppa* again

Before you move on

What does గొప్ప mean? (“Great, eminent”.) Say it once more.

181.2 వాసన (vāsana) — a smell

Before the new one: say the Telugu for orange, then the Telugu for great.

You’ll want to know: వాసన

వాసన — *vāsana* — “a smell”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vāsana*
- *Say it:* *vāsana*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāsana*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for orange, then the Telugu for great, then say *vāsana* again

Before you move on

What does వాసన mean? (“A smell”.) Say it once more.

181.3 ఆసక్తికరమైన (āsaktikaramaina) — interesting

Before the new one: say the Telugu for great, then the Telugu for a smell.

You'll want to know: ఆసక్తికరమైన

ఆసక్తికరమైన — *āsaktikaramaina* — “interesting”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āsaktikaramaina*
- *Say it: āsaktikaramaina*, once more
- *Say it: say āsaktikaramaina*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for great, then the Telugu for a smell, then say āsaktikaramaina again*

Before you move on

What does ఆసక్తికరమైన mean? (“Interesting”.) Say it once more.

181.4 అద్భుతమైన (adbhutamaina) — wonderful, amazing

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a smell, then the Telugu for interesting.

You'll want to know: అద్భుతమైన

అద్భుతమైన — *adbhutamaina* — “wonderful, amazing”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: adbhutamaina*
- *Say it: adbhutamaina*, once more

- *Say it:* say *adbhutamaina*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a smell, then the Telugu for interesting, then say *adbhutamaina* again

Before you move on

What does అద్భుతమైన mean? (“Wonderful, amazing”.) Say it once more.

181.5 మామూలు (māmūlu) — ordinary, usual

Before the new one: say the Telugu for interesting, then the Telugu for wonderful.

You’ll want to know: మామూలు

మామూలు — *māmūlu* — “ordinary, usual”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māmūlu*
- *Say it:* *māmūlu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māmūlu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for interesting, then the Telugu for wonderful, then say *māmūlu* again

Before you move on

What does మామూలు mean? (“Ordinary, usual”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 182

Silence, Durable, Fake, Plain, Extra

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say silence, durable, fake, plain and extra.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can say silence, durable, fake, plain and extra.

182.1 నిశ్శబ్దం (niśśabdam) — silence; quiet

Before the new one: say the Telugu for wonderful, then the Telugu for ordinary.

You'll want to know: నిశ్శబ్దం

నిశ్శబ్దం — *niśśabdam* — “silence; quiet”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *niśśabdam*
- Say it: *niśśabdam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *niśśabdam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for wonderful, then the Telugu for ordinary, then say *niśśabdam* again

Before you move on

What does నిశ్శబ్దం mean? (“Silence; quiet”.) Say it once more.

182.2 మన్నికైన (mannikaina) — durable, long-lasting

Before the new one: say the Telugu for ordinary, then the Telugu for silence.

You’ll want to know: మన్నికైన

మన్నికైన — *mannikaina* — “durable, long-lasting”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mannikaina*
- *Say it:* *mannikaina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mannikaina*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for ordinary, then the Telugu for silence, then say *mannikaina* again

Before you move on

What does మన్నికైన mean? (“Durable, long-lasting”.) Say it once more.

182.3 నకిలీ (nakilī) — fake, counterfeit

Before the new one: say the Telugu for silence, then the Telugu for durable.

You'll want to know: నకిలీ

నకిలీ — *nakilī* — “fake, counterfeit”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nakilī*
- *Say it: nakilī*, once more
- *Say it: say nakilī*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for silence, then the Telugu for durable, then say nakilī again*

Before you move on

What does నకిలీ mean? (“Fake, counterfeit”.) Say it once more.

182.4 సాదా (sādā) — plain, simple

Before the new one: say the Telugu for durable, then the Telugu for fake.

You'll want to know: సాదా

సాదా — *sādā* — “plain, simple”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sādā*
- *Say it:* *sādā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sādā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for durable, then the Telugu for fake, then say *sādā* again

Before you move on

What does సాదా mean? (“Plain, simple”.) Say it once more.

182.5 అదనపు (adanapu) — extra, additional

Before the new one: say the Telugu for fake, then the Telugu for plain.

You’ll want to know: అదనపు

అదనపు — *adanapu* — “extra, additional”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *adanapu*
- *Say it:* *adanapu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *adanapu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for fake, then the Telugu for plain, then say *adanapu* again

Before you move on

What does అదనపు mean? (“Extra, additional”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 183

Kitchen, Bedroom, Bucket, Lid, Frying pan

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a kitchen, a bedroom, a bucket, a lid and a frying pan.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can say a kitchen, a bedroom, a bucket, a lid and a frying pan.

183.1 వంటగది (vaṇṭagadi) — a kitchen

Before the new one: say the Telugu for plain, then the Telugu for extra.

You'll want to know: వంటగది

వంటగది — *vaṇṭagadi* — “a kitchen”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaṇṭagadi*
- *Say it: vaṇṭagadi, once more*

- *Say it:* say *vaṇṭagadi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for plain, then the Telugu for extra, then say *vaṇṭagadi* again

Before you move on

What does వంటగది mean? (“A kitchen”.) Say it once more.

183.2 పడకగది (paḍakagadi) — a bedroom

Before the new one: say the Telugu for extra, then the Telugu for a kitchen.

You’ll want to know: పడకగది

పడకగది — *paḍakagadi* — “a bedroom”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *paḍakagadi*
- *Say it:* *paḍakagadi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paḍakagadi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for extra, then the Telugu for a kitchen, then say *paḍakagadi* again

Before you move on

What does పడకగది mean? (“A bedroom”.) Say it once more.

183.3 బాల్చీ (bālcī) — a bucket

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a kitchen, then the Telugu for a bedroom.

You'll want to know: బాల్చీ

బాల్చీ — *bālcī* — “a bucket”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bālcī*
- *Say it: bālcī*, once more
- *Say it: say bālcī*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a kitchen, then the Telugu for a bedroom, then say bālcī again*

Before you move on

What does బాల్చీ mean? (“A bucket”.) Say it once more.

183.4 మూత (mūta) — a lid

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bedroom, then the Telugu for a bucket.

You'll want to know: మూత

మూత — *mūta* — “a lid”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūta*
- *Say it: mūta*, once more
- *Say it: say mūta*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bedroom, then the Telugu for a bucket, then say *mūta* again

Before you move on

What does మూత mean? (“A lid”.) Say it once more.

183.5 బాణలి (bāṇali) — a frying pan, a wok

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bucket, then the Telugu for a lid.

You’ll want to know: బాణలి

బాణలి — *bāṇali* — “a frying pan, a wok”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bāṇali*
- *Say it:* *bāṇali*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāṇali*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bucket, then the Telugu for a lid, then say *bāṇali* again

Before you move on

What does బాణలి mean? (“A frying pan, a wok”.) Say it once more.

183.6 Words from chapters 175-178 — a first pass

Say the words for a lid and a frying pan.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a crowd, the world, an earthquake, dust, smoke
- otherwise, even so, through, about, without
- if by chance, instead of, according to, actually, anyway
- on purpose, by mistake, never mind, a condition, an excuse

Before you move on

A crowd? (గుంపు, *gumpu*.) The world? (ప్రపంచం, *prapañcam*.) An earthquake? (భూకంపం, *bhūkampam*.) Dust? (దుమ్ము, *dummu*.) Smoke? (పొగ, *poga*.) Otherwise? (లేకపోతే, *lēkapōtē*.) Even so? (అయినా, *ayinā*.) Through? (ద్వారా, *dvārā*.) About? (గురించి, *guriñci*.) Without? (లేకుండా, *lēkuṇḍā*.) If by chance? (ఒకవేళ, *okavēḷa*.) Instead of? (బదులు, *badulu*.) According to? (ప్రకారం, *prakāram*.) Actually? (అసలు, *asalu*.) Anyway? (ఏదేమైనా, *ēdēmainā*.) On purpose? (కావాలని, *kāvālani*.) By mistake? (పొరపాటున, *porapāṭuna*.) Never mind? (పోనీ, *pōnī*.) A condition? (షరతు, *ṣaratu*.) An excuse? (సాకు, *sāku*.)

183.7 Words from chapters 179-183 — a second pass

Say the words for delicious and bland.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- delicious, bland, fresh, expensive, cheap
- main, total, every, pink, orange
- great, a smell, interesting, wonderful, ordinary
- silence, durable, fake, plain, extra
- a kitchen, a bedroom, a bucket, a lid, a frying pan

Before you move on

Delicious? (కమ్మని, *kammani*.) Bland? (చప్పని, *cappani*.) Fresh? (తాజా, *tājā*.) Expensive? (ఖరీదైన, *kharīdaina*.) Cheap? (చౌక, *cauka*.) Main? (ప్రధాన, *pradhāna*.) Total? (మొత్తం, *mottani*.) Every? (ప్రతి, *prati*.) Pink? (గులాబీ రంగు, *gulābī raṅgu*.) Orange? (నారింజ రంగు, *nāriṅja raṅgu*.) Great? (గొప్ప, *goppa*.) A smell? (వాసన, *vāsana*.) Interesting? (ఆసక్తికరమైన, *āsaktikaramaina*.) Wonderful? (అద్భుతమైన, *adbhutamaina*.) Ordinary? (మామూలు, *māmūlu*.) Silence? (నిశ్శబ్దం, *niśśabdani*.) Durable? (మన్నికైన, *mannikaina*.) Fake? (నకిలీ, *nakilī*.) Plain? (సాదా, *sādā*.) Extra? (అదనపు, *adanapu*.) A kitchen? (వంటగది, *vaṇṭagadi*.) A bedroom? (పడకగది, *paḍakagadi*.) A bucket? (బాల్చీ, *bālcī*.) A lid? (మూత, *mūta*.) A frying pan? (బాణలి, *bāṇali*.)

Chapter 184

Butter, Chutney, Sweet milk pudding, Cucumber, Okra

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say butter, a chutney, a sweet milk pudding, a cucumber and okra.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can say butter, a chutney, a sweet milk pudding, a cucumber and okra.

184.1 వెన్న (venna) — butter

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lid, then the Telugu for a frying pan.

You'll want to know: వెన్న

వెన్న — *venna* — “butter”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *venna*
- Say it: *venna*, once more

- *Say it:* say *venna*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a lid, then the Telugu for a frying pan, then say *venna* again

Before you move on

What does వెన్న mean? (“Butter”.) Say it once more.

184.2 పచ్చడి (paccāḍi) — a chutney, a pickle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a frying pan, then the Telugu for butter.

You’ll want to know: పచ్చడి

పచ్చడి — *paccāḍi* — “a chutney, a pickle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *paccāḍi*
- *Say it:* *paccāḍi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paccāḍi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a frying pan, then the Telugu for butter, then say *paccāḍi* again

Before you move on

What does పచ్చడి mean? (“A chutney, a pickle”.) Say it once more.

184.3 పాయసం (pāyasam) — a sweet milk pudding

Before the new one: say the Telugu for butter, then the Telugu for a chutney.

You'll want to know: పాయసం

పాయసం — *pāyasam* — “a sweet milk pudding”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāyasam*
- *Say it: pāyasam*, once more
- *Say it: say pāyasam*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for butter, then the Telugu for a chutney, then say pāyasam again*

Before you move on

What does పాయసం mean? (“A sweet milk pudding”.) Say it once more.

184.4 దోసకాయ (dōsakāya) — a cucumber

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a chutney, then the Telugu for a sweet milk pudding.

You'll want to know: దోసకాయ

దోసకాయ — *dōsakāya* — “a cucumber”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōsakāya*
- *Say it: dōsakāya*, once more
- *Say it: say dōsakāya*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a chutney, then the Telugu for a sweet milk pudding, then say *dōsakāya* again

Before you move on

What does దోసకాయ mean? (“A cucumber”.) Say it once more.

184.5 బెండకాయ (beṇḍakāya) — okra, lady’s finger

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a sweet milk pudding, then the Telugu for a cucumber.

You’ll want to know: బెండకాయ

బెండకాయ — *beṇḍakāya* — “okra, lady’s finger”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beṇḍakāya*
- *Say it:* *beṇḍakāya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beṇḍakāya*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a sweet milk pudding, then the Telugu for a cucumber, then say *beṇḍakāya* again

Before you move on

What does బెండకాయ mean? (“Okra, lady’s finger”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

Envelope, Postage stamp, Parcel, Post, Pencil

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an envelope, a postage stamp, a parcel, the post and a pencil.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say an envelope, a postage stamp, a parcel, the post and a pencil.

185.1 కవరు (kavaru) — an envelope

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a cucumber, then the Telugu for okra.

You'll want to know: కవరు

కవరు — *kavaru* — “an envelope”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kavaru*
- *Say it: kavaru, once more*

- *Say it:* say *kavaru*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a cucumber, then the Telugu for okra, then say *kavaru* again

Before you move on

What does కవరు mean? (“An envelope”.) Say it once more.

185.2 స్టాంపు (ṣṭāmpu) — a postage stamp

Before the new one: say the Telugu for okra, then the Telugu for an envelope.

You’ll want to know: స్టాంపు

స్టాంపు — *ṣṭāmpu* — “a postage stamp”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ṣṭāmpu*
- *Say it:* *ṣṭāmpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṣṭāmpu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for okra, then the Telugu for an envelope, then say *ṣṭāmpu* again

Before you move on

What does స్టాంపు mean? (“A postage stamp”.) Say it once more.

185.3 పార్సెలు (pārselu) — a parcel

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an envelope, then the Telugu for a postage stamp.

You'll want to know: పార్సెలు

పార్సెలు — *pārselu* — “a parcel”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pārselu*
- *Say it: pārselu*, once more
- *Say it: say pārselu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for an envelope, then the Telugu for a postage stamp, then say pārselu again*

Before you move on

What does పార్సెలు mean? (“A parcel”.) Say it once more.

185.4 తపాలా (tapālā) — the post, mail

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a postage stamp, then the Telugu for a parcel.

You'll want to know: తపాలా

తపాలా — *tapālā* — “the post, mail”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tapālā*
- *Say it: tapālā*, once more
- *Say it: say tapālā*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a postage stamp, then the Telugu for a parcel, then say *tapālā* again

Before you move on

What does తపాలా mean? (“The post, mail”.) Say it once more.

185.5 పెన్సిలు (pensilu) — a pencil

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a parcel, then the Telugu for the post.

You’ll want to know: పెన్సిలు

పెన్సిలు — *pensilu* — “a pencil”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pensilu*
- *Say it: pensilu*, once more
- *Say it: say pensilu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a parcel, then the Telugu for the post, then say *pensilu* again

Before you move on

What does పెన్సిలు mean? (“A pencil”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

Grandson, Granddaughter, Parents, Twins, Baby

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a grandson, a granddaughter, parents, twins and a baby.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can say a grandson, a granddaughter, parents, twins and a baby.

186.1 మనవాడు (manavaḍu) — a grandson

Before the new one: say the Telugu for the post, then the Telugu for a pencil.

You'll want to know: మనవాడు

మనవాడు — *manavaḍu* — “a grandson”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *manavaḍu*
- Say it: *manavaḍu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *manavaḍu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for the post, then the Telugu for a pencil, then say *manavaḍu* again

Before you move on

What does మనవాడు mean? (“A grandson”.) Say it once more.

186.2 మనవరాలు (manavarālu) — a granddaughter

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a pencil, then the Telugu for a grandson.

You’ll want to know: మనవరాలు

మనవరాలు — *manavarālu* — “a granddaughter”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *manavarālu*
- *Say it:* *manavarālu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manavarālu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a pencil, then the Telugu for a grandson, then say *manavarālu* again

Before you move on

What does మనవరాలు mean? (“A granddaughter”.) Say it once more.

186.3 తల్లిదండ్రులు (tallidaṇḍrulu) — parents

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a grandson, then the Telugu for a granddaughter.

You'll want to know: తల్లిదండ్రులు

తల్లిదండ్రులు — *tallidaṇḍrulu* — “parents”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tallidaṇḍrulu*
- *Say it: tallidaṇḍrulu*, once more
- *Say it: say tallidaṇḍrulu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a grandson, then the Telugu for a granddaughter, then say tallidaṇḍrulu again*

Before you move on

What does తల్లిదండ్రులు mean? (“Parents”.) Say it once more.

186.4 కవలలు (kavalalu) — twins

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a granddaughter, then the Telugu for parents.

You'll want to know: కవలలు

కవలలు — *kavalalu* — “twins”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kavalalu*
- *Say it: kavalalu*, once more
- *Say it: say kavalalu*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a granddaughter, then the Telugu for parents, then say *kavalalu* again

Before you move on

What does కవలలు mean? (“Twins”.) Say it once more.

186.5 పాప (pāpa) — a baby, a little one

Before the new one: say the Telugu for parents, then the Telugu for twins.

You’ll want to know: పాప

పాప — *pāpa* — “a baby, a little one”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pāpa*
- *Say it:* *pāpa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāpa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for parents, then the Telugu for twins, then say *pāpa* again

Before you move on

What does పాప mean? (“A baby, a little one”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

Bee, Lizard, Insect, Sparrow, Koel

Modes:  voice (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bee, a lizard, an insect, a sparrow and a koel.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can say a bee, a lizard, an insect, a sparrow and a koel.

187.1 తేనెటీగ (tēneṭīga) — a bee

Before the new one: say the Telugu for twins, then the Telugu for a baby.

You'll want to know: తేనెటీగ

తేనెటీగ — *tēneṭīga* — “a bee”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tēneṭīga*
- Say it: *tēneṭīga*, once more
- Say it: say *tēneṭīga*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for twins, then the Telugu for a baby, then say *tēnetiga* again

Before you move on

What does తేనెటీగ mean? (“A bee”.) Say it once more.

187.2 బల్లి (balli) — a lizard, a gecko

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a baby, then the Telugu for a bee.

You’ll want to know: బల్లి

బల్లి — *balli* — “a lizard, a gecko”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *balli*
- *Say it:* *balli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *balli*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a baby, then the Telugu for a bee, then say *balli* again

Before you move on

What does బల్లి mean? (“A lizard, a gecko”.) Say it once more.

187.3 పురుగు (purugu) — an insect, a worm

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bee, then the Telugu for a lizard.

You'll want to know: పురుగు

పురుగు — *purugu* — “an insect, a worm”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: purugu*
- *Say it: purugu, once more*
- *Say it: say purugu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a bee, then the Telugu for a lizard, then say purugu again*

Before you move on

What does పురుగు mean? (“An insect, a worm”.) Say it once more.

187.4 పిచ్చుక (piccuka) — a sparrow

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a lizard, then the Telugu for an insect.

You'll want to know: పిచ్చుక

పిచ్చుక — *piccuka* — “a sparrow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: piccuka*
- *Say it: piccuka, once more*
- *Say it: say piccuka*

- *Recall*: say the Telugu for a lizard, then the Telugu for an insect, then say *piccuka* again

Before you move on

What does పిచ్చుక mean? (“A sparrow.”) Say it once more.

187.5 కోకిల (kōkila) — a koel, the Indian cuckoo

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an insect, then the Telugu for a sparrow.

You’ll want to know: కోకిల

కోకిల — *kōkila* — “a koel, the Indian cuckoo”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *kōkila*
- *Say it*: *kōkila*, once more
- *Say it*: say *kōkila*
- *Recall*: say the Telugu for an insect, then the Telugu for a sparrow, then say *kōkila* again

Before you move on

What does కోకిల mean? (“A koel, the Indian cuckoo.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 188

Prasadam, Rice-flour sweets, Festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, Bindi, Henna

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say prasadam, rice-flour sweets, a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, a bindi and henna.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say prasadam, rice-flour sweets, a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, a bindi and henna.

188.1 ప్రసాదం (prasādam) — prasadam, food offered to a deity and shared

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a sparrow, then the Telugu for a koel.

You'll want to know: ప్రసాదం

ప్రసాదం — *prasādam* — “prasadam, food offered to a deity and shared”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prasādam*
- *Say it: prasādam*, once more
- *Say it: say prasādam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a sparrow, then the Telugu for a koel, then say *prasādam* again

Before you move on

What does ప్రసాదం mean? (“Prasadam, food offered to a deity and shared”.) Say it once more.

188.2 అరిసెలు (ariselu) — rice-flour sweets; made with jaggery at Sankranti

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a koel, then the Telugu for prasadam.

You’ll want to know: అరిసెలు

అరిసెలు — *ariselu* — “rice-flour sweets; made with jaggery at Sankranti”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ariselu*
- *Say it: ariselu*, once more
- *Say it: say ariselu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a koel, then the Telugu for prasadam, then say *ariselu* again

Before you move on

What does అరిసెలు mean? (“Rice-flour sweets; made with jaggery at Sankranti”.) Say it once more.

188.3 తోరణం (tōraṇam) — a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway

Before the new one: say the Telugu for prasadam, then the Telugu for rice-flour sweets.

You’ll want to know: తోరణం

తోరణం — *tōraṇam* — “a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōraṇam*
- *Say it: tōraṇam*, once more
- *Say it: say tōraṇam*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for prasadam, then the Telugu for rice-flour sweets, then say tōraṇam again*

Before you move on

What does తోరణం mean? (“A festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway”.) Say it once more.

188.4 బొట్టు (boṭṭu) — a bindi, a dot worn on the forehead

Before the new one: say the Telugu for rice-flour sweets, then the Telugu for a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway.

You'll want to know: బొట్టు

బొట్టు — *boṭṭu* — “a bindi, a dot worn on the forehead”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: boṭṭu*
- *Say it: boṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it: say boṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for rice-flour sweets, then the Telugu for a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, then say *boṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does బొట్టు mean? (“A bindi, a dot worn on the forehead”.)
Say it once more.

188.5 గోరింటాకు (gōriṇṭāku) — henna

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, then the Telugu for a bindi.

You'll want to know: గోరింటాకు

గోరింటాకు — *gōriṇṭāku* — “henna”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōriṇṭāku*
- *Say it: gōriṇṭāku*, once more
- *Say it: say gōriṇṭāku*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, then the Telugu for a bindi, then say *gōrinṭāku* again

Before you move on

What does గోరింటాకు mean? (“Henna”). Say it once more.

Chapter 189

Competition, Winner, Medal, Hobby, Novel

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a competition, a winner, a medal, a hobby and a novel.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say a competition, a winner, a medal, a hobby and a novel.

189.1 పోటీ (pōṭī) — a competition, a match

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a bindi, then the Telugu for henna.

You'll want to know: పోటీ

పోటీ — pōṭī — “a competition, a match”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: pōṭī
- Say it: pōṭī, once more

- *Say it:* say *pōṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a bindi, then the Telugu for henna, then say *pōṭi* again

Before you move on

What does పోటీ mean? (“A competition, a match”.) Say it once more.

189.2 విజేత (vijēta) — a winner

Before the new one: say the Telugu for henna, then the Telugu for a competition.

You’ll want to know: విజేత

విజేత — *vijēta* — “a winner”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vijēta*
- *Say it:* *vijēta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vijēta*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for henna, then the Telugu for a competition, then say *vijēta* again

Before you move on

What does విజేత mean? (“A winner”.) Say it once more.

189.3 పతకం (patakam) — a medal

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a competition, then the Telugu for a winner.

You'll want to know: పతకం

పతకం — *patakani* — “a medal”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patakani*
- *Say it: patakani*, once more
- *Say it: say patakani*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a competition, then the Telugu for a winner, then say patakani again*

Before you move on

What does పతకం mean? (“A medal”.) Say it once more.

189.4 అభిరుచి (abhiruci) — a hobby; taste

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a winner, then the Telugu for a medal.

You'll want to know: అభిరుచి

అభిరుచి — *abhiruci* — “a hobby; taste”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: abhiruci*
- *Say it: abhiruci*, once more
- *Say it: say abhiruci*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a winner, then the Telugu for a medal, then say *abhiruci* again

Before you move on

What does అభిరుచి mean? (“A hobby; taste”.) Say it once more.

189.5 నవల (navala) — a novel

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a medal, then the Telugu for a hobby.

You’ll want to know: నవల

నవల — *navala* — “a novel”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *navala*
- *Say it:* *navala*, once more
- *Say it:* say *navala*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a medal, then the Telugu for a hobby, then say *navala* again

Before you move on

What does నవల mean? (“A novel”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

Electricity, Machine, Sofa, Swing, Carpet

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say electricity, a machine, a sofa, a swing and a carpet.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can say electricity, a machine, a sofa, a swing and a carpet.

190.1 కరెంటు (kareṇṭu) — electricity, power

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a hobby, then the Telugu for a novel.

You'll want to know: కరెంటు

కరెంటు — *kareṇṭu* — “electricity, power”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kareṇṭu*
- Say it: *kareṇṭu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kareṇṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a hobby, then the Telugu for a novel, then say *kareṇṭu* again

Before you move on

What does కరెంటు mean? (“Electricity, power”.) Say it once more.

190.2 యంత్రం (yantram) — a machine

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a novel, then the Telugu for electricity.

You’ll want to know: యంత్రం

యంత్రం — *yantram* — “a machine”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yantram*
- *Say it:* *yantram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yantram*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a novel, then the Telugu for electricity, then say *yantram* again

Before you move on

What does యంత్రం mean? (“A machine”.) Say it once more.

190.3 సోఫా (sōphā) — a sofa

Before the new one: say the Telugu for electricity, then the Telugu for a machine.

You'll want to know: సోఫా

సోఫా — *sōphā* — “a sofa”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sōphā*
- *Say it: sōphā*, once more
- *Say it: say sōphā*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for electricity, then the Telugu for a machine, then say sōphā again*

Before you move on

What does సోఫా mean? (“A sofa”.) Say it once more.

190.4 ఉయ్యాల (uyyāla) — a swing; a cradle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a machine, then the Telugu for a sofa.

You'll want to know: ఉయ్యాల

ఉయ్యాల — *uyyāla* — “a swing; a cradle”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uyyāla*
- *Say it: uyyāla*, once more
- *Say it: say uyyāla*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a machine, then the Telugu for a sofa, then say *uyyāla* again

Before you move on

What does ఉయ్యాల mean? (“A swing; a cradle”.) Say it once more.

190.5 తివాచీ (tivācī) — a carpet, a rug

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a sofa, then the Telugu for a swing.

You’ll want to know: తివాచీ

తివాచీ — *tivācī* — “a carpet, a rug”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tivācī*
- *Say it:* *tivācī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tivācī*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a sofa, then the Telugu for a swing, then say *tivācī* again

Before you move on

What does తివాచీ mean? (“A carpet, a rug”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 191

Rubber, Light bulb, Firewood, Net, Weighing scale

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say rubber, a light bulb, firewood, a net and a weighing scale.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say rubber, a light bulb, firewood, a net and a weighing scale.

191.1 రబ్బరు (rabbaru) — rubber; an eraser

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a swing, then the Telugu for a carpet.

You'll want to know: రబ్బరు

రబ్బరు — *rabbaru* — “rubber; an eraser”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *rabbaru*
- Say it: *rabbaru*, once more

- *Say it:* say *rabbaru*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a swing, then the Telugu for a carpet, then say *rabbaru* again

Before you move on

What does రబ్బరు mean? (“Rubber; an eraser”.) Say it once more.

191.2 బల్బు (balbu) — a light bulb

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a carpet, then the Telugu for rubber.

You’ll want to know: బల్బు

బల్బు — *balbu* — “a light bulb”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *balbu*
- *Say it:* *balbu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *balbu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a carpet, then the Telugu for rubber, then say *balbu* again

Before you move on

What does బల్బు mean? (“A light bulb”.) Say it once more.

191.3 కట్టెలు (kaṭṭelu) — firewood

Before the new one: say the Telugu for rubber, then the Telugu for a light bulb.

You'll want to know: కట్టెలు

కట్టెలు — *kaṭṭelu* — “firewood”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭṭelu*
- *Say it: kaṭṭelu*, once more
- *Say it: say kaṭṭelu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for rubber, then the Telugu for a light bulb, then say *kaṭṭelu* again

Before you move on

What does కట్టెలు mean? (“Firewood”.) Say it once more.

191.4 వల (vala) — a net

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a light bulb, then the Telugu for firewood.

You'll want to know: వల

వల — *vala* — “a net”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vala*
- *Say it: vala*, once more
- *Say it: say vala*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a light bulb, then the Telugu for firewood, then say *vala* again

Before you move on

What does వల mean? (“A net”.) Say it once more.

191.5 త్రాసు (trāsu) — a weighing scale

Before the new one: say the Telugu for firewood, then the Telugu for a net.

You’ll want to know: త్రాసు

త్రాసు — *trāsu* — “a weighing scale”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *trāsu*
- *Say it:* *trāsu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trāsu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for firewood, then the Telugu for a net, then say *trāsu* again

Before you move on

What does త్రాసు mean? (“A weighing scale”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 192

Wick, Latch, Paintbrush, Necklace, Braid

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a wick, a latch, a paintbrush, a necklace and a braid.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can say a wick, a latch, a paintbrush, a necklace and a braid.

192.1 వత్తి (vatti) — a wick

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a net, then the Telugu for a weighing scale.

You'll want to know: వత్తి

వత్తి — *vatti* — “a wick”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vatti*
- *Say it: vatti*, once more

- *Say it:* say *vatti*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a net, then the Telugu for a weighing scale, then say *vatti* again

Before you move on

What does వత్తి mean? (“A wick”.) Say it once more.

192.2 గొళ్ళెం (golḷem) — a latch, a bolt

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a weighing scale, then the Telugu for a wick.

You’ll want to know: గొళ్ళెం

గొళ్ళెం — *golḷem* — “a latch, a bolt”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *golḷeni*
- *Say it:* *golḷem*, once more
- *Say it:* say *golḷem*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a weighing scale, then the Telugu for a wick, then say *golḷem* again

Before you move on

What does గొళ్ళెం mean? (“A latch, a bolt”.) Say it once more.

192.3 కుంచె (kuñce) — a paintbrush

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a wick, then the Telugu for a latch.

You'll want to know: కుంచె

కుంచె — *kuñce* — “a paintbrush”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuñce*
- *Say it: kuñce*, once more
- *Say it: say kuñce*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a wick, then the Telugu for a latch, then say kuñce again*

Before you move on

What does కుంచె mean? (“A paintbrush”.) Say it once more.

192.4 హారం (hāraṁ) — a necklace

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a latch, then the Telugu for a paintbrush.

You'll want to know: హారం

హారం — *hāraṁ* — “a necklace”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hāraṁ*
- *Say it: hāraṁ*, once more
- *Say it: say hāraṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a latch, then the Telugu for a paintbrush, then say *hārami* again

Before you move on

What does హారం mean? (“A necklace”.) Say it once more.

192.5 జడ (jaḍa) — a braid, a plait (of hair)

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a paintbrush, then the Telugu for a necklace.

You’ll want to know: జడ

జడ — *jaḍa* — “a braid, a plait (of hair)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jaḍa*
- *Say it:* *jaḍa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jaḍa*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a paintbrush, then the Telugu for a necklace, then say *jaḍa* again

Before you move on

What does జడ mean? (“A braid, a plait (of hair)”.) Say it once more.

192.6 Words from chapters 184-187 — a first pass

Say the words for a necklace and a braid.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- butter, a chutney, a sweet milk pudding, a cucumber, okra
- an envelope, a postage stamp, a parcel, the post, a pencil
- a grandson, a granddaughter, parents, twins, a baby
- a bee, a lizard, an insect, a sparrow, a koel

Before you move on

Butter? (వెన్న, *venna*.) A chutney? (పచ్చడి, *paccadi*.) A sweet milk pudding? (పాయసం, *pāyasam*.) A cucumber? (దోసకాయ, *dōsakāya*.) Okra? (బెండకాయ, *beṇḍakāya*.) An envelope? (కవరు, *kavaru*.) A postage stamp? (స్టాంపు, *stāmpu*.) A parcel? (పార్సెలు, *pārselu*.) The post? (తపాలా, *tapālā*.) A pencil? (పెన్సిలు, *pensilu*.) A grandson? (మనవడు, *manavaḍu*.) A granddaughter? (మనవరాలు, *manavarālu*.) Parents? (తల్లిదండ్రులు, *tallidaṇḍrulu*.) Twins? (కవలలు, *kavalalu*.) A baby? (పాప, *pāpa*.) A bee? (తేనెటీగ, *tēneṭīga*.) A lizard? (బల్లి, *balli*.) An insect? (పురుగు, *purugu*.) A sparrow? (పిచ్చుక, *piccuka*.) A koel? (కోకిల, *kōkila*.)

192.7 Words from chapters 188-192 — a second pass

Say the words for prasadam and rice-flour sweets.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- prasadam, rice-flour sweets, a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, a bindi, henna
- a competition, a winner, a medal, a hobby, a novel
- electricity, a machine, a sofa, a swing, a carpet
- rubber, a light bulb, firewood, a net, a weighing scale
- a wick, a latch, a paintbrush, a necklace, a braid

Before you move on

Prasadam? (ప్రసాదం, *prasādam.*) Rice-flour sweets? (అరిసెలు, *ariselu.*) A festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway? (తోరణం, *tōraṇam.*) A bindi? (బొట్టు, *boṭṭu.*) Henna? (గోరింటాకు, *gōriṇṭāku.*) A competition? (పోటీ, *pōṭi.*) A winner? (విజేత, *vijēta.*) A medal? (పతకం, *patakani.*) A hobby? (అభిరుచి, *abhiruci.*) A novel? (నవల, *navala.*) Electricity? (కరెంటు, *kareṇṭu.*) A machine? (యంత్రం, *yantram.*) A sofa? (సోఫా, *sōphā.*) A swing? (ఉయ్యాల, *uyyāla.*) A carpet? (తివాచీ, *tivācī.*) Rubber? (రబ్బరు, *rabbaru.*) A light bulb? (బల్బు, *balbu.*) Firewood? (కట్టెలు, *kaṭṭelu.*) A net? (వల, *vala.*) A weighing scale? (త్రాసు, *trāsu.*) A wick? (వత్తి, *vatti.*) A latch? (గొళ్ళెం, *golḷem.*) A paintbrush? (కుంచె, *kuñce.*) A necklace? (హారం, *hāram.*) A braid? (జడ, *jaḍa.*)

Chapter 193

Line, Circle, Square, Triangle, Wheel

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a line, a circle, a square, a triangle and a wheel.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can say a line, a circle, a square, a triangle and a wheel.

193.1 గీత (gīta) — a line

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a necklace, then the Telugu for a braid.

You'll want to know: గీత

గీత — *gīta* — “a line”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *gīta*
- Say it: *gīta*, once more

- *Say it:* say *gīta*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a necklace, then the Telugu for a braid, then say *gīta* again

Before you move on

What does గీత mean? (“A line”.) Say it once more.

193.2 వృత్తం (vṛttam) — a circle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a braid, then the Telugu for a line.

You’ll want to know: వృత్తం

వృత్తం — *vṛttam* — “a circle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vṛttam*
- *Say it:* *vṛttam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vṛttam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a braid, then the Telugu for a line, then say *vṛttam* again

Before you move on

What does వృత్తం mean? (“A circle”.) Say it once more.

193.3 చతురస్రం (caturasram) — a square

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a line, then the Telugu for a circle.

You'll want to know: చతురస్రం

చతురస్రం — *caturasrami* — “a square”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caturasrami*
- *Say it: caturasrami*, once more
- *Say it: say caturasrami*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a line, then the Telugu for a circle, then say caturasrami again*

Before you move on

What does చతురస్రం mean? (“A square”.) Say it once more.

193.4 త్రిభుజం (tribhujam) — a triangle

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a circle, then the Telugu for a square.

You'll want to know: త్రిభుజం

త్రిభుజం — *tribhujam* — “a triangle”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tribhujam*
- *Say it: tribhujam*, once more
- *Say it: say tribhujam*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a circle, then the Telugu for a square, then say *tribhujani* again

Before you move on

What does త్రిభుజం mean? (“A triangle”.) Say it once more.

193.5 చక్రం (cakram) — a wheel

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a square, then the Telugu for a triangle.

You’ll want to know: చక్రం

చక్రం — *cakram* — “a wheel”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cakram*
- *Say it: cakram*, once more
- *Say it: say cakram*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a square, then the Telugu for a triangle, then say *cakram* again

Before you move on

What does చక్రం mean? (“A wheel”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 194

Housework, Domestic helper, Tailor, Trader, Coin

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say housework, a domestic helper, a tailor, a trader and a coin.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can say housework, a domestic helper, a tailor, a trader and a coin.

194.1 ఇంటిపని (inṭipani) — housework

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a triangle, then the Telugu for a wheel.

You'll want to know: ఇంటిపని

ఇంటిపని — *inṭipani* — “housework”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *inṭipani*
- Say it: *inṭipani*, once more

- *Say it:* say *inṭipani*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a triangle, then the Telugu for a wheel, then say *inṭipani* again

Before you move on

What does ఇంటిపని mean? (“Housework”.) Say it once more.

194.2 పనిమనిషి (panimaniṣi) — a domestic helper

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a wheel, then the Telugu for housework.

You’ll want to know: పనిమనిషి

పనిమనిషి — *panimaniṣi* — “a domestic helper”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *panimaniṣi*
- *Say it:* *panimaniṣi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *panimaniṣi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a wheel, then the Telugu for housework, then say *panimaniṣi* again

Before you move on

What does పనిమనిషి mean? (“A domestic helper”.) Say it once more.

194.3 దర్జీ (darjī) — a tailor

Before the new one: say the Telugu for housework, then the Telugu for a domestic helper.

You'll want to know: దర్జీ

దర్జీ — *darjī* — “a tailor”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: darjī*
- *Say it: darjī*, once more
- *Say it: say darjī*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for housework, then the Telugu for a domestic helper, then say darjī again*

Before you move on

What does దర్జీ mean? (“A tailor”.) Say it once more.

194.4 వ్యాపారి (vyāpāri) — a trader, a merchant

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a domestic helper, then the Telugu for a tailor.

You'll want to know: వ్యాపారి

వ్యాపారి — *vyāpāri* — “a trader, a merchant”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vyāpāri*
- *Say it: vyāpāri*, once more
- *Say it: say vyāpāri*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a domestic helper, then the Telugu for a tailor, then say *vyāpāri* again

Before you move on

What does వ్యాపారి mean? (“A trader, a merchant”.) Say it once more.

194.5 నాణెం (nāṇem) — a coin

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a tailor, then the Telugu for a trader.

You’ll want to know: నాణెం

నాణెం — *nāṇem* — “a coin”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nāṇem*
- *Say it:* *nāṇem*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāṇem*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a tailor, then the Telugu for a trader, then say *nāṇem* again

Before you move on

What does నాణెం mean? (“A coin”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

Officer, Clerk, Manager, Colleague, Meeting

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an officer, a clerk, a manager, a colleague and a meeting.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can say an officer, a clerk, a manager, a colleague and a meeting.

195.1 అధికారి (adhikāri) — an officer, an official

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a trader, then the Telugu for a coin.

You'll want to know: అధికారి

అధికారి — *adhikāri* — “an officer, an official”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *adhikāri*
- Say it: *adhikāri*, once more

- *Say it:* say *adhikāri*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a trader, then the Telugu for a coin, then say *adhikāri* again

Before you move on

What does అధికారి mean? (“An officer, an official”.) Say it once more.

195.2 గుమాస్తా (gumāstā) — a clerk

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a coin, then the Telugu for an officer.

You’ll want to know: గుమాస్తా

గుమాస్తా — *gumāstā* — “a clerk”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gumāstā*
- *Say it:* *gumāstā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gumāstā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a coin, then the Telugu for an officer, then say *gumāstā* again

Before you move on

What does గుమాస్తా mean? (“A clerk”.) Say it once more.

195.3 మేనేజరు (mēnējāru) — a manager

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an officer, then the Telugu for a clerk.

You'll want to know: మేనేజరు

మేనేజరు — *mēnējāru* — “a manager”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēnējāru*
- *Say it: mēnējāru*, once more
- *Say it: say mēnējāru*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for an officer, then the Telugu for a clerk, then say mēnējāru again*

Before you move on

What does మేనేజరు mean? (“A manager”.) Say it once more.

195.4 సహోద్యోగి (sahōdyōgi) — a colleague

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a clerk, then the Telugu for a manager.

You'll want to know: సహోద్యోగి

సహోద్యోగి — *sahōdyōgi* — “a colleague”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sahōdyōgi*
- *Say it: sahōdyōgi*, once more
- *Say it: say sahōdyōgi*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a clerk, then the Telugu for a manager, then say *sahōdyōgi* again

Before you move on

What does సహోద్యోగి mean? (“A colleague”.) Say it once more.

195.5 సమావేశం (samāvēśam) — a meeting

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a manager, then the Telugu for a colleague.

You’ll want to know: సమావేశం

సమావేశం — *samāvēśam* — “a meeting”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *samāvēśam*
- *Say it:* *samāvēśam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samāvēśam*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a manager, then the Telugu for a colleague, then say *samāvēśam* again

Before you move on

What does సమావేశం mean? (“A meeting”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

Fee, Fine, Deadline, Responsibility, Application

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a fee, a fine, a deadline, a responsibility and an application.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can say a fee, a fine, a deadline, a responsibility and an application.

196.1 ఫీజు (phīju) — a fee

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a colleague, then the Telugu for a meeting.

You'll want to know: ఫీజు

ఫీజు — *phīju* — “a fee”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *phīju*
- Say it: *phīju*, once more

- *Say it:* say *phīju*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a colleague, then the Telugu for a meeting, then say *phīju* again

Before you move on

What does ఫీజు mean? (“A fee”.) Say it once more.

196.2 జరిమానా (*jarimānā*) — a fine, a penalty

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a meeting, then the Telugu for a fee.

You’ll want to know: జరిమానా

జరిమానా — *jarimānā* — “a fine, a penalty”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jarimānā*
- *Say it:* *jarimānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jarimānā*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a meeting, then the Telugu for a fee, then say *jarimānā* again

Before you move on

What does జరిమానా mean? (“A fine, a penalty”.) Say it once more.

196.3 గడువు (*gaḍuvu*) — a deadline, a time limit

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a fee, then the Telugu for a fine.

You'll want to know: గడువు

గడువు — *gaḍuvu* — “a deadline, a time limit”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaḍuvu*
- *Say it: gaḍuvu*, once more
- *Say it: say gaḍuvu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a fee, then the Telugu for a fine, then say gaḍuvu again*

Before you move on

What does గడువు mean? (“A deadline, a time limit”.) Say it once more.

196.4 బాధ్యత (bādhyata) — a responsibility, a duty

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a fine, then the Telugu for a deadline.

You'll want to know: బాధ్యత

బాధ్యత — *bādhyata* — “a responsibility, a duty”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bādhyata*
- *Say it: bādhyata*, once more

- *Say it:* say *bādhya*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a fine, then the Telugu for a deadline, then say *bādhya* again

Before you move on

What does బాధ్యత mean? (“A responsibility, a duty.”) Say it once more.

196.5 దరఖాస్తు (darakhāstu) — an application

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a deadline, then the Telugu for a responsibility.

You’ll want to know: దరఖాస్తు

దరఖాస్తు — *darakhāstu* — “an application”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *darakhāstu*
- *Say it:* *darakhāstu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *darakhāstu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a deadline, then the Telugu for a responsibility, then say *darakhāstu* again

Before you move on

What does దరఖాస్తు mean? (“An application.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

Carpenter, Writer, Problem, Solution, Opinion

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a carpenter, a writer, a problem, a solution and an opinion.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can say a carpenter, a writer, a problem, a solution and an opinion.

197.1 వడ్డంగి (vaḍraṅgi) — a carpenter

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a responsibility, then the Telugu for an application.

You'll want to know: వడ్డంగి

వడ్డంగి — *vaḍraṅgi* — “a carpenter”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *vaḍraṅgi*
- Say it: *vaḍraṅgi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *vaḍraṅgi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a responsibility, then the Telugu for an application, then say *vaḍraṅgi* again

Before you move on

What does వడ్రంగి mean? (“A carpenter”). Say it once more.

197.2 రచయిత (racayita) — a writer, an author

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an application, then the Telugu for a carpenter.

You’ll want to know: రచయిత

రచయిత — *racayita* — “a writer, an author”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *racayita*
- *Say it:* *racayita*, once more
- *Say it:* say *racayita*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an application, then the Telugu for a carpenter, then say *racayita* again

Before you move on

What does రచయిత mean? (“A writer, an author”). Say it once more.

197.3 సమస్య (samasya) — a problem

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a carpenter, then the Telugu for a writer.

You'll want to know: సమస్య

సమస్య — *samasya* — “a problem”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samasya*
- *Say it: samasya*, once more
- *Say it: say samasya*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for a carpenter, then the Telugu for a writer, then say samasya again*

Before you move on

What does సమస్య mean? (“A problem”.) Say it once more.

197.4 పరిష్కారం (pariṣkāraṁ) — a solution

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a writer, then the Telugu for a problem.

You'll want to know: పరిష్కారం

పరిష్కారం — *pariṣkāraṁ* — “a solution”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pariṣkāraṁ*
- *Say it: pariṣkāraṁ*, once more
- *Say it: say pariṣkāraṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a writer, then the Telugu for a problem, then say *pariṣkāraṇi* again

Before you move on

What does పరిష్కారం mean? (“A solution”.) Say it once more.

197.5 అభిప్రాయం (abhiprāyaṁ) — an opinion

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a problem, then the Telugu for a solution.

You’ll want to know: అభిప్రాయం

అభిప్రాయం — *abhiprāyaṁ* — “an opinion”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *abhiprāyaṁ*
- *Say it:* *abhiprāyaṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *abhiprāyaṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a problem, then the Telugu for a solution, then say *abhiprāyaṁ* again

Before you move on

What does అభిప్రాయం mean? (“An opinion”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

Tuition, Interview, Work shift, Uniform, Staff

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say tuition, an interview, a work shift, a uniform and staff.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can say tuition, an interview, a work shift, a uniform and staff.

198.1 ట్యూషను (ṭyūṣanu) — tuition, coaching

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a solution, then the Telugu for an opinion.

You'll want to know: ట్యూషను

ట్యూషను — ṭyūṣanu — “tuition, coaching”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭyūṣanu
- Say it: ṭyūṣanu, once more

- *Say it:* say *tyūṣanu*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a solution, then the Telugu for an opinion, then say *tyūṣanu* again

Before you move on

What does ట్యూషను mean? (“Tuition, coaching”.) Say it once more.

198.2 ఇంటర్వ్యూ (inṭarvyū) — an interview

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an opinion, then the Telugu for tuition.

You’ll want to know: ఇంటర్వ్యూ

ఇంటర్వ్యూ — *inṭarvyū* — “an interview”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *inṭarvyū*
- *Say it:* *inṭarvyū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inṭarvyū*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an opinion, then the Telugu for tuition, then say *inṭarvyū* again

Before you move on

What does ఇంటర్వ్యూ mean? (“An interview”.) Say it once more.

198.3 షిఫ్టు (ṣiphṭu) — a work shift

Before the new one: say the Telugu for tuition, then the Telugu for an interview.

You'll want to know: షిఫ్టు

షిఫ్టు — *ṣiphtu* — “a work shift”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṣiphtu*
- *Say it: ṣiphtu*, once more
- *Say it: say ṣiphtu*
- *Recall: say the Telugu for tuition, then the Telugu for an interview, then say ṣiphtu again*

Before you move on

What does షిఫ్టు mean? (“A work shift”.) Say it once more.

198.4 యూనిఫారం (yūniphāraṁ) — a uniform

Before the new one: say the Telugu for an interview, then the Telugu for a work shift.

You'll want to know: యూనిఫారం

యూనిఫారం — *yūniphāraṁ* — “a uniform”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yūniphāraṁ*
- *Say it: yūniphāraṁ*, once more
- *Say it: say yūniphāraṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Telugu for an interview, then the Telugu for a work shift, then say *yūniphāraṁ* again

Before you move on

What does యూనిఫారం mean? (“A uniform”.) Say it once more.

198.5 సిబ్బంది (sibbandi) — staff

Before the new one: say the Telugu for a work shift, then the Telugu for a uniform.

You’ll want to know: సిబ్బంది

సిబ్బంది — *sibbandi* — “staff”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sibbandi*
- *Say it: sibbandi*, once more
- *Say it: say sibbandi*
- *Recall:* say the Telugu for a work shift, then the Telugu for a uniform, then say *sibbandi* again

Before you move on

What does సిబ్బంది mean? (“Staff”.) Say it once more.

198.6 Words from chapters 193-195 — a first pass

Say the words for a uniform and staff.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a line, a circle, a square, a triangle, a wheel
- housework, a domestic helper, a tailor, a trader, a coin
- an officer, a clerk, a manager, a colleague, a meeting

Before you move on

A line? (గీత, *gīta*.) A circle? (వృత్తం, *vṛttam*.) A square? (చతురస్రం, *caturasram*.) A triangle? (త్రిభుజం, *tribhujam*.) A wheel? (చక్రం, *cakram*.) Housework? (ఇంటిపని, *iṇṭipani*.) A domestic helper? (పనిమనిషి, *panimanishi*.) A tailor? (దర్జీ, *darjī*.) A trader? (వ్యాపారి, *vyāpāri*.) A coin? (నాణెం, *nāṇem*.) An officer? (అధికారి, *adhikāri*.) A clerk? (గుమాస్తా, *gumāstā*.) A manager? (మేనేజరు, *mēnējara*.) A colleague? (సహోద్యోగి, *sahōdyōgi*.) A meeting? (సమావేశం, *samāvēśam*.)

198.7 Words from chapters 196-198 — a second pass

Say the words for a fee and a fine.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a fee, a fine, a deadline, a responsibility, an application
- a carpenter, a writer, a problem, a solution, an opinion
- tuition, an interview, a work shift, a uniform, staff

Before you move on

A fee? (ఫీజు, *phīju*.) A fine? (జరిమానా, *jarimānā*.) A deadline? (గడువు, *gaḍuvu*.) A responsibility? (బాధ్యత, *bādhyaata*.) An application? (దరఖాస్తు, *darakhāstu*.) A carpenter? (వడ్డంగి, *vaḍraṅgi*.)

A writer? (రచయిత, *racayita*.) A problem? (సమస్య, *samasya*.) A solution? (పరిష్కారం, *pariṣkāraṁ*.) An opinion? (అభిప్రాయం, *abhiprāyaṁ*.) Tuition? (ట్యూషను, *tyūṣanu*.) An interview? (ఇంటర్వ్యూ, *inṭarvyū*.) A work shift? (షిఫ్టు, *ṣiphtu*.) A uniform? (యునిఫారం, *yūniphāraṁ*.) Staff? (సిబ్బంది, *sibbandi*.)

The Telugu script — a reference

A **reference**, not a chapter — a place to look things up. You are *not* meant to read this before the lessons: the lessons teach reading through real words, introducing each letter as a word needs it. This page just gathers the system in one spot.

How the Telugu script works (the three facts the lessons teach)

1. **Consonants carry a built-in “a”.** క = “ka,” మ = “ma,” ర = “ra.” (Many wear the *talakattu*, a small check-mark hat.) You never write the short *a*.
2. **A vowel sign changes that built-in vowel.** Attached to a consonant it gives కా = k̄ā · కి = k̄i · కీ = k̄ī · కు = k̄u · కూ = k̄ū · కె = k̄e · కే = k̄ē · కొ = k̄o · కో = k̄ō. The signs themselves are ా ā · ి i · ి̄ ī · ఁ u · ం ū · ం̄ ē · ం̄ ē · ం̄ o · ం̄ ō.
3. **A *virama* (్) strips the vowel, and the bare consonant stacks below the next as a conjunct.** న్ + క → స్క (ska), న్ + య → న్య (nya). A dot anusvāra (ం) adds a final nasal.

Independent vowels (word-initial)

అ a · ఆ ā · ఇ i · ఈ ī · ఉ u · ఊ ū · ఎ e · ఏ ē · ఐ ai · ఒ o · ఓ ō · ఔ au.

Worth flagging

- **Aspiration is written.** క k / ఖ kh, గ g / ఘ gh, ద d / ఢ dh — the “h” is a real puff. Like Kannada and unlike Tamil, Telugu keeps separate letters for the Sanskrit aspirates and voiced stops, because it borrowed so many Sanskrit words.
- **Round, looping forms.** Telugu and Kannada are script-sisters, shaped for palm-leaf writing; the two look far more alike than either does to Tamil.
- **“The Italian of the East.”** Telugu words tend to end in vowels, giving the language an open, musical flow.

Telugu in the Dravidian family

Dravidian is a family entirely separate from Indo-European (English, Latin, Sanskrit). Telugu shares grammar and native vocabulary with Tamil, Kannada, and Malayalam — but, like Kannada and unlike Tamil, it borrowed **heavily** from Sanskrit. It also shows the family is not uniform: where its sisters say “no” with a word from the root *il-* (*illai* / *illa*), Telugu uses its own *lēdu* / *kādu*. The lessons trace, word by word, what is home-grown and what is borrowed.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

-కు *-ku*

the dative suffix -ku, 'to / for' — and the idea of stacking
Introduced in Chapter 6.

అబద్ధం *abaddham*

a lie; untrue
Introduced in Chapter 140.

అబ్బాయి *abbāyi*

a boy; a son
Introduced in Chapter 88.

అభినందనలు *abhinandanalu*

congratulations, compliments
Introduced in Chapter 99.

అభిప్రాయం *abhiprāyam*

an opinion
Introduced in Chapter 197.

అభిరుచి *abhiruci*

a hobby; taste
Introduced in Chapter 189.

అదనపు *adanapu*

extra, additional
Introduced in Chapter 182.

అడవి *aḍavi*

a forest
Introduced in Chapter 120.

అద్భుతమైన *adbhutamaina*

wonderful, amazing
Introduced in Chapter 181.

అద్దం *addam*

a mirror

Introduced in Chapter 62.

అద్దె *adde*

rent

Introduced in Chapter 156.

అదే *adē*

that's the one, the same

Introduced in Chapter 98.

అధికారి *adhikāri*

an officer, an official

Introduced in Chapter 195.

అది *adi*

that one — the thing over there

Introduced in Chapter 41.

అడుగు *adugu*

to ask — a native verb none of the three literary sisters share, and the clue to which branch of Dravidian Telugu actually sits on

Introduced in Chapter 34.

ఆగండి *āgaṇḍi*

please wait; please stop

Introduced in Chapter 86.

అగ్గిపెట్టె *aggipette*

a matchbox

Introduced in Chapter 113.

ఆహ్వానం *āhvānam*

an invitation

Introduced in Chapter 99.

ఐదవ *aīdava*

fifth — where the vowel that goes is a diphthong's tail

Introduced in Chapter 81.

ఆకలి *ākali*

hunger

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ఆకాశం *ākāśam*

the sky

Introduced in Chapter 53.

అక్కడ *akkada*

there — where I am not

Introduced in Chapter 41.

ఆకు *āku*

a leaf

Introduced in Chapter 120.

అల *ala*

a wave

Introduced in Chapter 121.

అలాగా *alāgā*

is that so? I see

Introduced in Chapter 87.

అలాగే *alāgē*

just so, alright then

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ఆలకించు *ālakiñcu*

listen

Introduced in Chapter 44.

అలసట *alasata*

tiredness

Introduced in Chapter 84.

అల్లం *allani*

ginger

Introduced in Chapter 118.

అల్లు *allu*

to knit, to weave

Introduced in Chapter 165.

అల్లుడు *alludu*

a son-in-law

Introduced in Chapter 71.

అమ్మమ్మ *ammamma*

grandmother, the mother's mother

Introduced in Chapter 45.

అమ్మాయి *ammāyi*

a girl; a daughter

Introduced in Chapter 88.

అమ్ము *ammu*

to sell

Introduced in Chapter 148.

ఆనందం *ānandani*

delight, joy

Introduced in Chapter 99.

అందమైన *andamaina*

beautiful

Introduced in Chapter 138.

ఆందోళన *āndōḷana*

anxiety, worry

Introduced in Chapter 97.

అందుకే *andukē*

that is exactly why

Introduced in Chapter 109.

అందువల్ల *anduvalla*

therefore

Introduced in Chapter 108.

అంగడి *aṅgaḍi*

a shop

Introduced in Chapter 72.

అని *ani*

that (reporting what was said or thought)

Introduced in Chapter 80.

అంతే *antē*

that's all; that's just it

Introduced in Chapter 58.

అనుకో *anukō*

to think — literally “say it to yourself”, built from the family’s say-verb plus the ending that turns a verb back on its own doer

Introduced in Chapter 33.

అనుమానించు *anumāniñcu*

to suspect, to doubt

Introduced in Chapter 163.

అనుమతి *anumati*

permission

Introduced in Chapter 65.

అనువదించు *anuvadiñcu*

to translate

Introduced in Chapter 160.

అప్పుడప్పుడు *appuḍappuḍu*

sometimes

Introduced in Chapter 170.

అరటిపండు *araṭipaṇḍu*

a banana

Introduced in Chapter 117.

ఆరవ *ārava*

sixth — the shortest of the ten

Introduced in Chapter 82.

అరిసెలు *ariselu*

rice-flour sweets; made with jaggery at Sankranti
Introduced in Chapter 188.

ఆరోగ్యం *ārōgyam*

health

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ఆర్పు *ārpu*

to put out

Introduced in Chapter 148.

అర్థం చేసుకో *artham cēsukō*

to understand — “make the meaning your own”, a Sanskrit noun on the native
do-verb with the ending that hands the action back to you

Introduced in Chapter 33.

అర్థం కాలేదు *artham kālēdu*

I did not understand

Introduced in Chapter 78.

ఆరు ఏడు ఎనిమిది తొమ్మిది పది *āru ēḍu enimidi tommidi padi*

six to ten — where Telugu wanders furthest from its Dravidian cousins

Introduced in Chapter 7.

అరుదుగా *arudugā*

rarely

Introduced in Chapter 171.

అరుపు *arupu*

a shout

Introduced in Chapter 68.

ఆశ *āśa*

hope

Introduced in Chapter 107.

ఆసక్తికరమైన *āsaktikaramaina*

interesting

Introduced in Chapter 181.

అసలు *asalu*

actually; (not) at all

Introduced in Chapter 177.

ఆశ్చర్యపోవు *āścaryapōvu*

to be surprised, to be amazed

Introduced in Chapter 161.

ఆశించు *āśiñcu*

to hope, to expect

Introduced in Chapter 155.

ఆశీర్వాదం *āśīrvādam*

a blessing

Introduced in Chapter 51.

ఆస్తి *āsti*

property

Introduced in Chapter 106.

ఆసుపత్రి *āsupatri*

a hospital

Introduced in Chapter 92.

అసూయ *asūya*

jealousy

Introduced in Chapter 168.

అతను *atanu*

he (and ఆమె, she)

Introduced in Chapter 79.

ఆటపట్టించు *āṭapattin̄cu*

to tease

Introduced in Chapter 162.

అతిథి *atithi*

a guest

Introduced in Chapter 48.

అత్త *atta*

an aunt; a mother-in-law

Introduced in Chapter 71.

అటు *aṭu*

that way, in that direction

Introduced in Chapter 174.

అవకాశం *avakāśam*

a chance, an opportunity

Introduced in Chapter 106.

అవసరం *avasaram*

need, necessity

Introduced in Chapter 94.

అవతల *avatala*

on the other side, beyond

Introduced in Chapter 174.

ఆవు *āvu*

a cow

Introduced in Chapter 122.

అవునా *avunā*

is it so?

Introduced in Chapter 78.

అవును *avunu*

yes (avunu)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

అయినా *ayinā*

even so, still

Introduced in Chapter 176.

అయితే *ayitē*

in that case

Introduced in Chapter 64.

బాధ *bādha*

sorrow, distress

Introduced in Chapter 85.

బాధ్యత *bādhyata*

a responsibility, a duty

Introduced in Chapter 196.

బడి *baḍi*

a school

Introduced in Chapter 103.

బదులు *badulu*

instead of

Introduced in Chapter 177.

బాగా *bāgā*

well, fine — and the reply “నేను బాగున్నాను”

Introduced in Chapter 3.

బాగుచేయు *bāgucēyu*

to repair, to mend

Introduced in Chapter 159.

బాగున్నారా? *bāgunnārā?*

are you well?

Introduced in Chapter 91.

బహుమతి *bahumati*

a gift, a prize

Introduced in Chapter 99.

బహుశా *bahuśā*

probably, perhaps

Introduced in Chapter 87.

బలం *balani*

strength

Introduced in Chapter 106.

బల్బు *balbu*

a light bulb

Introduced in Chapter 191.

బాల్చీ *bālcī*

a bucket

Introduced in Chapter 183.

బల్లి *balli*

a lizard, a gecko

Introduced in Chapter 187.

బాణలి *bāṇali*

a frying pan, a wok

Introduced in Chapter 183.

బంధువు *bandhuvu*

a relative

Introduced in Chapter 88.

బంగాళాదుంప *baṅgālādumpa*

a potato

Introduced in Chapter 118.

బంగారు *baṅgāru*

golden

Introduced in Chapter 140.

బంతి *banti*

a ball

Introduced in Chapter 113.

బరువు *baruvu*

heavy

Introduced in Chapter 136.

బస్సు *bassu*

a bus

Introduced in Chapter 105.

బాట *bāṭa*

a path, a way

Introduced in Chapter 55.

బాటిలు *bāṭilu*

a bottle

Introduced in Chapter 131.

బట్ట *baṭṭa*

cloth

Introduced in Chapter 46.

బాతు *bātu*

a duck

Introduced in Chapter 126.

బావ *bāva*

a brother-in-law; a male cousin

Introduced in Chapter 71.

బయలుదేరు *bayaludēru*

to set out, to start off
Introduced in Chapter 50.

బయట *bayata*

outside
Introduced in Chapter 101.

బెల్టు *beltu*

a belt
Introduced in Chapter 131.

బెండకాయ *beṇḍakāya*

okra, lady's finger
Introduced in Chapter 184.

బెణుకు *beṇuku*

a sprain
Introduced in Chapter 169.

బేరం *bērami*

a bargain, haggling
Introduced in Chapter 72.

భారతదేశం *Bhāratadēśam*

India
Introduced in Chapter 77.

భర్త *bharta*

husband
Introduced in Chapter 45.

భార్య *bhārya*

wife
Introduced in Chapter 45.

భాష *bhāṣa*

a language
Introduced in Chapter 89.

భవిష్యత్తు *bhaviṣyattu*

the future
Introduced in Chapter 155.

భయం *bhayam*

fear
Introduced in Chapter 85.

భయంకరమైన *bhayaṅkaramaina*

terrible, dreadful
Introduced in Chapter 142.

భోజనం *bhōjanam*

a meal — the polite Sanskrit noun Chapter 32 already named and never taught,
finally given its own lesson
Introduced in Chapter 40.

భోంచేశారా? *bhōñcēśārā?*

have you eaten?

Introduced in Chapter 91.

భుజం *bhujam*

a shoulder

Introduced in Chapter 127.

భూకంపం *bhūkampam*

an earthquake

Introduced in Chapter 175.

బిగించు *bigin̄cu*

to tighten

Introduced in Chapter 165.

బిందె *bindē*

a water pot

Introduced in Chapter 129.

బీరువా *bīruvā*

a cupboard

Introduced in Chapter 129.

బొబ్బ *bobba*

a blister

Introduced in Chapter 169.

బొమ్మ *bomma*

a doll; a picture

Introduced in Chapter 113.

బొట్టు *boṭṭu*

a bindi, a dot worn on the forehead

Introduced in Chapter 188.

బూడిద *būdida*

grey; ash

Introduced in Chapter 140.

బుగ్గ *bugga*

a cheek

Introduced in Chapter 127.

బురద *burada*

mud

Introduced in Chapter 59.

బుట్ట *buṭṭa*

a basket

Introduced in Chapter 56.

బ్యాంకు *byāṅku*

a bank

Introduced in Chapter 103.

చదువు *caduvu*

to read — and, with no second word, to study; the same form is the noun for an education, and its middle vowel moves as the endings change
Introduced in Chapter 33.

చైత్రం వైశాఖం జ్యేష్ఠం ఆషాఢం శ్రావణం భాద్రపదం ఆశ్వయుజం కార్తీకం మార్గశిరం
పుష్యం మాఘం ఫాల్గుణం *Caitrani Vaiśākham Jyēṣṭham Āṣāḍham Śrāvaṇam*
Bhādrapadam Āśvayujam Kārtikam Mārgaśīram Puṣyam Māgham
Phālgunaṁ

the twelve lunisolar months — matching Kannada and Hindi's shared pan-Indian calendar, completing the split with Tamil/Malayalam's own solar systems
Introduced in Chapter 16.

చక్కెర *cakkerā*

sugar

Introduced in Chapter 61.

చక్రం *cakram*

a wheel

Introduced in Chapter 193.

చాలా మంచి *cālā manci*

very good

Introduced in Chapter 76.

చాలా రోజులైంది *cālā rōjulaiindi*

it has been a long time

Introduced in Chapter 91.

చలి *cali*

cold, the cold

Introduced in Chapter 85.

చాలు *cālu*

enough, that will do

Introduced in Chapter 49.

చంద్రుడు *candrudu*

the moon

Introduced in Chapter 53.

చాప *cāpa*

a mat

Introduced in Chapter 56.

చప్పని *cappani*

bland, tasteless

Introduced in Chapter 179.

చర్మం *carman*

the skin

Introduced in Chapter 128.

చట్టి *catti*

a clay pot

Introduced in Chapter 129.

చతురస్రం *caturasram*

a square

Introduced in Chapter 193.

చౌక *cauka*

cheap

Introduced in Chapter 179.

చేదైన *cēdaina*

bitter-tasting

Introduced in Chapter 141.

చెడ్డ *ceḍḍa*

bad

Introduced in Chapter 76.

చేదు *cēdu*

bitter, bitterness

Introduced in Chapter 73.

చెల్లించు *cellin̄cu*

to pay

Introduced in Chapter 157.

చెమట *cemaṭa*

sweat

Introduced in Chapter 167.

చెంచా *cemcā*

a spoon

Introduced in Chapter 112.

చేప *cēpa*

a fish

Introduced in Chapter 116.

చెప్పులు *ceppulu*

sandals

Introduced in Chapter 114.

చేరు *cēru*

to reach, to join

Introduced in Chapter 146.

చెరువు *ceruvu*

a village tank, a reservoir

Introduced in Chapter 55.

చెట్టు *ceṭṭu*

a tree

Introduced in Chapter 54.

చెవి *cevi*

ear — native Dravidian, matching Tamil's own form closely
Introduced in Chapter 37.

ఛాయ *chāya*

shade; shadow

Introduced in Chapter 151.

చిలక *cilaka*

a parrot

Introduced in Chapter 124.

చీమ *cīma*

an ant

Introduced in Chapter 60.

చింపు *cimpu*

to tear

Introduced in Chapter 164.

చిందు *cindu*

to spill

Introduced in Chapter 165.

చిన్న *cinna*

small

Introduced in Chapter 42.

చింతపండు *cintapaṇḍu*

tamarind

Introduced in Chapter 135.

చీపురు *cīpuru*

a broom

Introduced in Chapter 62.

చీర *cīra*

a sari

Introduced in Chapter 114.

చిరునామా *cirunāmā*

an address

Introduced in Chapter 89.

చొక్కా *cokkā*

a shirt

Introduced in Chapter 114.

చూడు *cūḍu*

look

Introduced in Chapter 44.

చూడు *cūḍu*

to see, to look — Telugu's own everyday see-word, and the respectful -అండి
ending that fits any verb stem

Introduced in Chapter 32.

చుక్క *cukka*

a star; a dot

Introduced in Chapter 53.

చూపించండి *cūpiñcaṇḍi*

please show me

Introduced in Chapter 95.

చుట్టు *cuttu*

to wrap, to roll up

Introduced in Chapter 164.

డబ్బు *ḍabbu*

money

Introduced in Chapter 72.

దాచు *dācu*

to hide

Introduced in Chapter 147.

దడ్డుర్లు *daddurlu*

a rash

Introduced in Chapter 169.

దగ్గర *daggara*

near

Introduced in Chapter 100.

దగ్గు *daggu*

a cough

Introduced in Chapter 63.

దాహం *dāhami*

thirst

Introduced in Chapter 84.

దండం *daṇḍani*

a salutation, “my respects”

Introduced in Chapter 51.

డప్పు *ḍappu*

a drum

Introduced in Chapter 4.

దరఖాస్తు *darakhāstu*

an application

Introduced in Chapter 196.

దారం *dārami*

thread

Introduced in Chapter 62.

దర్జీ *darjī*

a tailor

Introduced in Chapter 194.

దయచేసి *dayacēsi*

please (dayacēsi — “having done compassion,” from దయ *daya* “compassion”)
Introduced in Chapter 8.

దయచేసి టీ *dayacēsi ṭī*

tea, please — Telugu’s traditional word for tea travelled by sea, not by the
overland road most of its neighbours took
Introduced in Chapter 39.

దేశం *dēśam*

a country
Introduced in Chapter 77.

ధైర్యం *dhairyam*

courage; brave
Introduced in Chapter 141.

ధాన్యం *dhānyam*

grain
Introduced in Chapter 134.

ధన్యవాదములు *dhanyavādamulu*

thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

ధర *dhara*

a price
Introduced in Chapter 72.

ధోతి *dhōti*

a dhoti
Introduced in Chapter 132.

దిద్దు *diddu*

to correct (written work)
Introduced in Chapter 166.

దిగు *digu*

to get down, to get off
Introduced in Chapter 145.

దిండు *diṇḍu*

a pillow
Introduced in Chapter 109.

దీపం *dīpani*

a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 46.

దీవి *dīvi*

an island
Introduced in Chapter 122.

దోమ *dōma*

a mosquito

Introduced in Chapter 70.

దోశ *dōsa*

a dosa

Introduced in Chapter 119.

దోసకాయ *dōsakāya*

a cucumber

Introduced in Chapter 184.

ద్రాక్ష *drākṣa*

grapes

Introduced in Chapter 135.

దూకు *dūku*

to jump

Introduced in Chapter 145.

దుమ్ము *dummu*

dust

Introduced in Chapter 175.

దుప్పటి *duppaṭi*

a blanket

Introduced in Chapter 109.

దూరం *dūrami*

far; distance

Introduced in Chapter 100.

దువ్వెన *duvvena*

a comb

Introduced in Chapter 111.

ద్వారా *dvārā*

through, by means of

Introduced in Chapter 176.

ఎడమ *eḍama*

left (not right)

Introduced in Chapter 100.

ఏడవ *ēḍava*

seventh — a long vowel that stays long

Introduced in Chapter 82.

ఏడ్చు *ēḍcu*

to cry

Introduced in Chapter 149.

ఏదేమైనా *ēḍēmainā*

anyway, in any case

Introduced in Chapter 177.

ఏడుపు *ēḍupu*

crying, tears

Introduced in Chapter 97.

ఎదురుచూడు *edurucūḍu*

to look forward to, to wait for

Introduced in Chapter 155.

ఎగురు *egiru*

to fly

Introduced in Chapter 143.

ఎక్కడ *ekkaḍa*

where? — asking about a place

Introduced in Chapter 41.

ఎక్కడా *ekkaḍā*

nowhere, not anywhere (with a negative verb)

Introduced in Chapter 153.

ఎక్కడికి? *ekkaḍiki?*

where to?

Introduced in Chapter 91.

ఎక్కువ *ekkuva*

more, a great deal

Introduced in Chapter 58.

ఎలా *elā*

how

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ఎలా అంటారు? *elā aṇṭāru?*

how do you say it?

Introduced in Chapter 95.

ఎల్లుండి *elluṇḍi*

the day after tomorrow

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ఎలుగుబంటి *elugubaṇṭi*

a bear

Introduced in Chapter 123.

ఎలుక *eluka*

a mouse, a rat

Introduced in Chapter 70.

ఏమైనా *ēmainā*

anything, something

Introduced in Chapter 153.

ఏమీ లేదు *ēmī lēdu*

nothing, it's nothing

Introduced in Chapter 98.

ఏమిటి *ēmiṭi*

what

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ఏమో *ēmō*

perhaps, who knows

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ఎముక *emuka*

a bone

Introduced in Chapter 57.

ఎందుకంటే *endukaṇṭē*

because

Introduced in Chapter 74.

ఎందుకు *enduku*

why?

Introduced in Chapter 74.

ఎనిమిదవ *enimidava*

eighth — where the vowel that goes is an i, not a u

Introduced in Chapter 82.

ఏంటి సంగతి? *ēṇṭi saṅgati?*

what's new?

Introduced in Chapter 91.

ఏనుగు *ēnugu*

an elephant

Introduced in Chapter 122.

ఎప్పటికీ *eppaṭiki*

forever

Introduced in Chapter 172.

ఎప్పుడూ *eppuḍū*

never (with a negative verb); always

Introduced in Chapter 153.

ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు? *eppuḍu vastāru?*

when will you come?

Introduced in Chapter 75.

ఎర్రటి *errati*

red, reddish

Introduced in Chapter 143.

ఏటా *ētā*

every year, annually

Introduced in Chapter 172.

ఎవరైనా *evarainā*

anyone, someone

Introduced in Chapter 153.

ఎవరు *evaru*

who? — asking about a person
Introduced in Chapter 41.

ఎవరూ *evarū*

nobody (with a negative verb)
Introduced in Chapter 153.

గడప *gaḍapa*

a threshold
Introduced in Chapter 67.

గడ్డం *gaḍḍam*

the chin; a beard
Introduced in Chapter 128.

గడ్డి *gaḍḍi*

grass
Introduced in Chapter 66.

గాడిద *gāḍida*

a donkey
Introduced in Chapter 126.

గడియారం *gaḍiyāram*

a clock, a watch
Introduced in Chapter 111.

గడుపు *gaḍupu*

to spend (time)
Introduced in Chapter 154.

గడువు *gaḍuvu*

a deadline, a time limit
Introduced in Chapter 196.

గాజులు *gājulu*

bangles
Introduced in Chapter 115.

గాలి *gālī*

wind, air
Introduced in Chapter 59.

గాలిపటం *gālipaṭam*

a kite
Introduced in Chapter 114.

గంట *ganṭa*

hour — matching Kannada and Hindi exactly, the same Sanskrit “bell” word
Introduced in Chapter 18.

గారు *gāru*

the respectful suffix on a name
Introduced in Chapter 79.

గర్వం *garvam*

pride

Introduced in Chapter 168.

గత *gata*

last, previous

Introduced in Chapter 154.

గట్టి *gatti*

hard

Introduced in Chapter 137.

గట్టిగా *gattigā*

loudly; firmly

Introduced in Chapter 86.

గౌరవం *gauravam*

respect

Introduced in Chapter 51.

గాయం *gāyam*

a wound, an injury

Introduced in Chapter 92.

గేదె *gēde*

a buffalo

Introduced in Chapter 60.

గెలుచు *gelucu*

to win

Introduced in Chapter 147.

గిన్నె *ginne*

a cooking vessel, a bowl

Introduced in Chapter 56.

గీత *gīta*

a line

Introduced in Chapter 193.

గ్లాసు *glāsu*

a drinking glass

Introduced in Chapter 112.

గోడ *gōḍa*

a wall

Introduced in Chapter 67.

గొడ్డలి *goḍḍali*

an axe

Introduced in Chapter 69.

గోధుమలు *gōdhumalu*

wheat

Introduced in Chapter 134.

గొడుగు *goḍugu*

an umbrella

Introduced in Chapter 62.

గొళ్ళెం *golḷeni*

a latch, a bolt

Introduced in Chapter 192.

గొంతు *gontu*

a voice

Introduced in Chapter 68.

గొణుగు *goṇugu*

to mutter, to grumble

Introduced in Chapter 166.

గొప్ప *goppa*

great, eminent

Introduced in Chapter 181.

గోరింటాకు *gōriṇṭāku*

henna

Introduced in Chapter 188.

గోరు *gōru*

a fingernail, a claw

Introduced in Chapter 57.

గొరుగు *gorugu*

to shave

Introduced in Chapter 165.

గ్రహించు *grahīṇcu*

to realize, to grasp

Introduced in Chapter 163.

గ్రామం *grāmam*

a village

Introduced in Chapter 55.

గ్రంథాలయం *granthālayam*

a library

Introduced in Chapter 103.

గుచ్చు *guccu*

to prick, to string (flowers)

Introduced in Chapter 165.

గుడ్డలు *guddalu*

clothes, cloth

Introduced in Chapter 133.

గుడ్డు *guddu*

an egg

Introduced in Chapter 116.

గుడి *guḍi*

a temple

Introduced in Chapter 103.

గుడ్లగూబ *guḍlagūba*

an owl

Introduced in Chapter 125.

గుహ *guha*

a cave

Introduced in Chapter 174.

గులాబీ రంగు *gulābī raṅgu*

pink

Introduced in Chapter 180.

గుమాస్తా *gumāstā*

a clerk

Introduced in Chapter 195.

గుంపు *gumpu*

a crowd

Introduced in Chapter 175.

గుండె *guṇḍe*

heart — the everyday native Dravidian word, cognate with Kannada's own native heart-word

Introduced in Chapter 38.

గురించి *guriñci*

about, concerning

Introduced in Chapter 176.

గుర్రం *gurram*

a horse

Introduced in Chapter 122.

గుర్తుపెట్టుకో *gurtupettukō*

to remember, to keep in mind

Introduced in Chapter 160.

గురువు *guruvu*

a teacher

Introduced in Chapter 48.

గుట్ట *gutṭa*

a low hill

Introduced in Chapter 55.

హక్కు *hakku*

a right

Introduced in Chapter 105.

హంస *haṃsa*

a swan

Introduced in Chapter 5.

హారం *hāraṃ*

a necklace

Introduced in Chapter 192.

హాయిగా *hāyigā*

comfortably, pleasantly

Introduced in Chapter 93.

హోటలు *hōṭalu*

a restaurant, an eating house

Introduced in Chapter 173.

హృదయం *hrdayaṃ*

heart — the literary Sanskrit word for the same organ, a genuine Indo-European cousin of English “heart”

Introduced in Chapter 38.

ఇది *idi*

this one — the thing near me

Introduced in Chapter 41.

ఇడ్లీ *idli*

an idli

Introduced in Chapter 119.

ఇకపై *ikapai*

from now on

Introduced in Chapter 155.

ఇక్కడ *ikkada*

here — where I am

Introduced in Chapter 41.

ఇంగ్లీషు *inglīṣu*

English, the language

Introduced in Chapter 89.

ఇంకా *inkā*

still, yet

Introduced in Chapter 64.

ఇంకా లేదు *inkā lēdu*

not yet

Introduced in Chapter 98.

ఇంకోసారి *inkōsāri*

once more, one more time

Introduced in Chapter 86.

ఇంతలో *intalo*

meanwhile

Introduced in Chapter 172.

ఇంటర్వ్యూ *intarvyū*

an interview

Introduced in Chapter 198.

ఇంటికి *intiki*

home, to the house

Introduced in Chapter 90.

ఇంటిపని *intipani*

housework

Introduced in Chapter 194.

ఇంటిపేరు *intipēru*

a surname, the family name

Introduced in Chapter 96.

ఇప్పటికీ *ippatikē*

already

Introduced in Chapter 154.

ఇప్పుడు *ippudu*

now

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ఇరుకు *iruku*

narrow

Introduced in Chapter 138.

ఇసుక *isuka*

sand

Introduced in Chapter 59.

ఇటీవల *itēvala*

recently

Introduced in Chapter 154.

ఇటు *itu*

this way, in this direction

Introduced in Chapter 174.

ఇటుక *ituka*

a brick

Introduced in Chapter 9.

ఇవాళ *ivāḷa*

today

Introduced in Chapter 75.

ఇవ్వు *ivvu*

give

Introduced in Chapter 43.

జడ *jaḍa*

a braid, a plait (of hair)
Introduced in Chapter 192.

జాగ్రత్త *jāgratta*

care, caution
Introduced in Chapter 90.

జాకెట్టు *jāketṭu*

a blouse
Introduced in Chapter 132.

జలపాతం *jalapātami*

a waterfall
Introduced in Chapter 122.

జలుబు *jalubu*

a cold, a runny nose
Introduced in Chapter 92.

జామపండు *jāmapaṇḍu*

a guava
Introduced in Chapter 136.

జరిమానా *jarimānā*

a fine, a penalty
Introduced in Chapter 196.

జరుపుకో *jarupukō*

to celebrate (a festival or occasion)
Introduced in Chapter 161.

జేబు *jēbu*

a pocket
Introduced in Chapter 131.

ఝరి *jhari*

a stream; mountain stream
Introduced in Chapter 152.

జీలకర్ర *jīlakarra*

cumin
Introduced in Chapter 135.

జింక *jinka*

a deer
Introduced in Chapter 124.

జుట్టు *juttu*

hair (of the head)
Introduced in Chapter 47.

జ్వరం *jvaram*

a fever
Introduced in Chapter 84.

కబురు *kaburu*

a message, news

Introduced in Chapter 68.

కడుగు *kaḍugu*

to wash

Introduced in Chapter 146.

కడుపు *kaḍupu*

the stomach, the belly

Introduced in Chapter 47.

కాగితం *kāgitam*

paper

Introduced in Chapter 112.

కాకి *kāki*

a crow

Introduced in Chapter 125.

కల *kala*

a dream

Introduced in Chapter 107.

కలం *kalam*

a pen

Introduced in Chapter 112.

కాలపట్టిక *kālapattika*

a timetable

Introduced in Chapter 156.

కాల్చు *kālcu*

to burn

Introduced in Chapter 148.

కళ్ళజోడు *kallajōḍu*

glasses, spectacles

Introduced in Chapter 111.

కల్లం *kallam*

a threshing floor

Introduced in Chapter 66.

కాలు *kālu*

leg, foot

Introduced in Chapter 47.

కలుపు *kalupu*

to mix, to stir in

Introduced in Chapter 157.

కమ్మని *kammani*

delicious, tasty

Introduced in Chapter 179.

కంప్యూటర్ *kampyūṭar*

a computer

Introduced in Chapter 130.

కానీ *kānī*

but

Introduced in Chapter 74.

కన్ను *kannu*

eye — a word this book has already used once, unglossed, as proof of the family's shared oldest seeing-root

Introduced in Chapter 37.

కంటినీరు *kaṇṭinīru*

tears

Introduced in Chapter 133.

కనుబొమ్మ *kanubomma*

an eyebrow

Introduced in Chapter 127.

కాపాడు *kāpāḍu*

to protect, to save

Introduced in Chapter 148.

కాఫీ *kāphī*

coffee

Introduced in Chapter 119.

కప్ప *kappa*

a frog

Introduced in Chapter 70.

కప్పు *kappu*

a roof

Introduced in Chapter 67.

కారం *kāraṁ*

pungency, heat

Introduced in Chapter 73.

కారమైన *kāramaina*

spicy

Introduced in Chapter 141.

కారణం *kāraṇaṁ*

a reason

Introduced in Chapter 108.

కరెంటు *kareṇṭu*

electricity, power

Introduced in Chapter 190.

కర్క *karra*

a stick

Introduced in Chapter 69.

కారు *kāru*

a car

Introduced in Chapter 134.

కార్యాలయం *kāryālayam*

an office

Introduced in Chapter 104.

కష్టం *kaṣṭam*

difficult; trouble

Introduced in Chapter 76.

కష్టపడే *kaṣṭapaḍē*

hard-working

Introduced in Chapter 142.

కట్టెలు *kaṭṭelu*

firewood

Introduced in Chapter 191.

కత్తెర *katterā*

scissors

Introduced in Chapter 110.

కత్తి *katti*

a knife

Introduced in Chapter 56.

కట్టు *kaṭṭu*

to tie, to build

Introduced in Chapter 147.

కౌగిలించు *kaugiliñcu*

to hug, to embrace

Introduced in Chapter 162.

కావాలా? *kāvālā?*

do you want it?

Introduced in Chapter 94.

కవలలు *kavalalu*

twins

Introduced in Chapter 186.

కావాలని *kāvālanī*

on purpose, deliberately

Introduced in Chapter 178.

కవరు *kavaru*

an envelope

Introduced in Chapter 185.

ఖరీదైన *kharīdaina*

expensive

Introduced in Chapter 179.

కింద *kinda*

below, underneath

Introduced in Chapter 101.

కిటికీ *kitikī*

a window

Introduced in Chapter 67.

కిటికీతెర *kitikītera*

a window curtain

Introduced in Chapter 129.

కొబ్బరి *kobbari*

coconut

Introduced in Chapter 117.

కోడి *kōḍi*

a hen

Introduced in Chapter 60.

కొడుకు *koḍuku*

son — a native Dravidian root that shares its shape with a word already met in this book, and not with the next lesson's word for daughter

Introduced in Chapter 36.

కోకిల *kōkila*

a koel, the Indian cuckoo

Introduced in Chapter 187.

కొలుచు *kolucu*

to measure

Introduced in Chapter 158.

కొమ్మ *komma*

a branch

Introduced in Chapter 54.

కొనసాగు *konasāgu*

to continue

Introduced in Chapter 166.

కొంచెం *koñcem*

a little, a bit

Introduced in Chapter 58.

కొండ *koṇḍa*

a hill, a mountain

Introduced in Chapter 121.

కోపం *kōpaṁ*

anger

Introduced in Chapter 85.

కోరిక *kōrika*

a wish

Introduced in Chapter 107.

కోరు *kōru*

to wish for, to ask for

Introduced in Chapter 108.

కోతి *kōti*

a monkey

Introduced in Chapter 123.

కొత్త *kotta*

new

Introduced in Chapter 42.

కోటు *kōṭu*

a coat

Introduced in Chapter 132.

కొవ్వొత్తి *kovvotti*

a candle

Introduced in Chapter 113.

కోయ *kōyu*

to cut

Introduced in Chapter 144.

కృతజ్ఞత *kṛtajñata*

gratitude

Introduced in Chapter 51.

క్షమాపణ *kṣamāpaṇa*

an apology

Introduced in Chapter 94.

క్షమించండి *kṣamiṁcaṇḍi*

please forgive / sorry (kṣamiṁcaṇḍi — from kṣamiṁcu “to forgive,” Sanskrit kṣamā + respectful -aṇḍi)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

క్షేమం *kṣēmam*

wellbeing, safety

Introduced in Chapter 93.

కూడా *kūdā*

also

Introduced in Chapter 64.

కుడి *kudī*

right (not left)

Introduced in Chapter 100.

కుక్క, పిల్లి *kukka, pilli*

dog and cat — kukka genuinely breaks from its Dravidian cousins’ shared naayi root, debated as onomatopoeic or a Sanskrit loan; pilli most likely closes the ENTIRE arc’s cat-story loop, the probable Dravidian source behind Sanskrit’s biDaala and so Hindi’s billi

Introduced in Chapter 21.

కుంచె *kuñce*

a paintbrush

Introduced in Chapter 192.

కుందేలు *kundēlu*

a rabbit

Introduced in Chapter 123.

కూర *kūra*

a curry

Introduced in Chapter 115.

కూరగాయలు *kūragāyalu*

vegetables

Introduced in Chapter 117.

కుర్చీ *kurcī*

a chair

Introduced in Chapter 52.

కూర్చో *kūrco*

sit

Introduced in Chapter 43.

కుట్టు *kuṭṭu*

to sew

Introduced in Chapter 147.

కుటుంబం *kuṭumbam*

family — the collective word Chapter 12’s parents and siblings never needed, because each of them was already the name of one specific person

Introduced in Chapter 35.

కూతురు *kūturu*

daughter — a second, separate Proto-Dravidian root, cognate across the family with a word for “infant” rather than with Telugu’s own word for son

Introduced in Chapter 36.

లంగా *laṅgā*

a long skirt

Introduced in Chapter 131.

లేచు *lēcu*

to get up

Introduced in Chapter 143.

లేదా *lēdā*

or

Introduced in Chapter 74.

లేదు *lēdu*

no / there isn't (*lēdu*)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

లేకపోతే *lēkapōtē*

otherwise, or else

Introduced in Chapter 176.

లెక్కపెట్టు *lekkapēṭṭu*

to count

Introduced in Chapter 146.

లేకుండా *lēkunḍā*

without

Introduced in Chapter 176.

లోపల *lōpala*

inside

Introduced in Chapter 101.

లోపలికి రండి *lōpaliki raṇḍi*

please come in

Introduced in Chapter 80.

లోతు *lōtu*

deep

Introduced in Chapter 138.

లోయ *lōya*

a valley

Introduced in Chapter 174.

మా *mā*

our (not including you)

Introduced in Chapter 79.

మబ్బు *mabbu*

a cloud

Introduced in Chapter 53.

మచ్చ *macca*

a scar, a spot

Introduced in Chapter 169.

మధ్యాహ్నం *madhyāhnam*

“afternoon” — the same word already met meaning precisely “noon” (TE-C17), confirmed via a directly-fetched source to also cover “the time between noon and evening” in modern usage — the same kind of semantic widening already found for Hindi’s दोपहर and, more thinly, Kannada’s ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ
Introduced in Chapter 28.

మధ్యాహ్నం అర్ధరాత్రి *madhyāhnam ardharātri*

noon (Sanskrit “middle of day,” same as Kannada) and midnight (Sanskrit “HALF of night” — a different root than Kannada’s midnight word)
Introduced in Chapter 17.

మధ్యలో *madhyalō*

in the middle
Introduced in Chapter 102.

మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం *maḷḷi kaluddām*

we’ll meet again
Introduced in Chapter 4.

మలుపు *malupu*

a turn, a bend
Introduced in Chapter 104.

మామ *māma*

an uncle; a father-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 71.

మామిడిపండు *māmidipaṇḍu*

a mango
Introduced in Chapter 117.

మాంసం *māmisam*

meat
Introduced in Chapter 116.

మామూలు *māmūlu*

ordinary, usual
Introduced in Chapter 181.

మనవడు *manavaḍu*

a grandson
Introduced in Chapter 186.

మనవరాలు *manavarālu*

a granddaughter
Introduced in Chapter 186.

మనవి *manavi*

a polite request
Introduced in Chapter 65.

మంచం *mañcam*

a bed

Introduced in Chapter 109.

మంచి *manci*

good

Introduced in Chapter 42.

మంచిది *mancidi*

it is a good one

Introduced in Chapter 76.

మంచు *mañcu*

mist, dew, snow

Introduced in Chapter 59.

మందు *mandu*

medicine

Introduced in Chapter 92.

మణికట్టు *maṇikattu*

a wrist

Introduced in Chapter 128.

మనిషి *maṇiṣi*

a person, a human being

Introduced in Chapter 88.

మన్నికైన *mannikaina*

durable, long-lasting

Introduced in Chapter 182.

మన్నించండి *manniñcaṇḍi*

please pardon me

Introduced in Chapter 94.

మరచిపో *maracipō*

to forget

Introduced in Chapter 145.

మరదలు *maradalu*

a sister-in-law; a female cousin

Introduced in Chapter 71.

మార్పు *mārcu*

to change

Introduced in Chapter 158.

మరియు *mariyu*

and

Introduced in Chapter 74.

మర్యాద *maryāda*

good manners

Introduced in Chapter 65.

మాట్లాడు *māṭlāḍu*

speak

Introduced in Chapter 44.

మాట్లాడు *māṭlāḍu*

to speak

Introduced in Chapter 5.

మాత్ర *mātra*

a tablet, a pill

Introduced in Chapter 167.

మాత్రమే *mātramē*

only

Introduced in Chapter 64.

మట్టి *maṭṭi*

soil, earth

Introduced in Chapter 120.

మెడ *meḍa*

the neck

Introduced in Chapter 57.

మేక *mēka*

a goat

Introduced in Chapter 60.

మేకు *mēku*

a nail (to hammer)

Introduced in Chapter 110.

మెల్లగా *mellagā*

gently, softly, slowly

Introduced in Chapter 95.

మేలు *mēlu*

a good turn, a benefit

Introduced in Chapter 51.

మేనేజరు *mēnējaru*

a manager

Introduced in Chapter 195.

మెరుపు *merupu*

lightning

Introduced in Chapter 121.

మెత్తని *mettani*

soft

Introduced in Chapter 137.

మెట్టు *metṭu*

a step

Introduced in Chapter 67.

మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? *mī pēru ēmiti?*

what's your name?

Introduced in Chapter 2.

మిరప *mirapa*

a chilli

Introduced in Chapter 61.

మిరియాలు *miriyālu*

black pepper

Introduced in Chapter 135.

మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? *mīru elā unnāru?*

how are you? (respectful)

Introduced in Chapter 3.

మీసాలు *mīsālu*

a moustache

Introduced in Chapter 133.

మోచేయి *mōcēyi*

an elbow

Introduced in Chapter 128.

మొదటి *modaṭi*

first — the one ordinal Telugu does not build from a number

Introduced in Chapter 81.

మోకాలు *mōkālu*

a knee

Introduced in Chapter 127.

మొక్క *mokka*

a young plant

Introduced in Chapter 54.

మొత్తం *mottam*

total, whole; the total

Introduced in Chapter 180.

మూడవ *mūdava*

third — the swap on its second number

Introduced in Chapter 81.

ముద్దుపేరు *muddupēru*

a nickname, a pet name

Introduced in Chapter 96.

ముద్దుపెట్టు *muddupettu*

to kiss

Introduced in Chapter 162.

ముగ్గు *muggu*

the rice-flour design drawn at the doorstep

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ముఖం *mukham*

the face

Introduced in Chapter 126.

ముక్కు *mukku*

nose — native Dravidian, but an irregular reflex of its own Proto-Dravidian root, contaminated in shape by the separate word for “face”

Introduced in Chapter 37.

మూల *mūla*

a corner

Introduced in Chapter 104.

ముంచు *muñcu*

to dip, to soak in

Introduced in Chapter 164.

ముందు *mundu*

before, in front

Introduced in Chapter 75.

ముప్పై *muppai*

thirty (and the tens above it)

Introduced in Chapter 77.

మురికి *murikī*

dirty

Introduced in Chapter 137.

ముసలి *musali*

old (of people)

Introduced in Chapter 139.

మూత *mūta*

a lid

Introduced in Chapter 183.

మూయు *mūyu*

to close

Introduced in Chapter 149.

నా *nā*

my

Introduced in Chapter 2.

నా పేరు ... *nā pēru ...*

my name is... (with no “is”)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

నది *nadī*

a river

Introduced in Chapter 55.

నడుచు *naḍucu*

to walk

Introduced in Chapter 149.

నైపుణ్యం *naipunyaṁ*

a skill

Introduced in Chapter 105.

నకిలీ *nakilī*

fake, counterfeit

Introduced in Chapter 182.

నక్క *nakka*

a fox

Introduced in Chapter 124.

నాకు కావాలి *nāku kāvāli*

I want it

Introduced in Chapter 80.

నాకు తెలియదు *nāku teliyadu*

I do not know

Introduced in Chapter 78.

నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం *nāku telugu iṣṭam*

‘I like Telugu’ — a sentence with no verb in it at all, the liker in the dative and the liked thing left standing plain

Introduced in Chapter 34.

నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు *nāku telugu vaccu*

‘I know Telugu’ — literally ‘to me Telugu comes’, with no subject at all

Introduced in Chapter 6.

నల్లని *nallani*

black, dark

Introduced in Chapter 142.

నాలుగవ *nālugaṁ*

fourth — the longest of the ten, and still the same ending

Introduced in Chapter 81.

నాలుక *nāluka*

the tongue

Introduced in Chapter 127.

నలుపు తెలుపు ఎరుపు నీలం *nalupu telupu erupu nīlam*

black, white, red, blue — Telugu’s own basic colors, completing the whole family’s shared blue

Introduced in Chapter 11.

నమస్కారం *namaskāram*

hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a bow”)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

నమస్తే *namastē*

namaste, hello

Introduced in Chapter 99.

నమ్మకం *nammakam*

trust

Introduced in Chapter 65.

నానబెట్టు *nānabetṭu*

to soak

Introduced in Chapter 159.

నాణెం *nāṇem*

a coin

Introduced in Chapter 194.

నాన్న అమ్మ అన్న తమ్ముడు అక్క చెల్లి *nānna amma anna tammudu akka celli*

father, mother, and four age-graded sibling words — Telugu’s own father-word and “younger sister” word, but the same age-first system

Introduced in Chapter 12.

నన్ను *nannu*

me (as the object)

Introduced in Chapter 79.

నారింజ రంగు *nāriṅja raṅgu*

orange (colour)

Introduced in Chapter 180.

నాట్యం చేయు *nāṭyam cēyu*

to dance

Introduced in Chapter 161.

నవల *navala*

a novel

Introduced in Chapter 189.

నవ్వు *navvu*

a laugh, a smile

Introduced in Chapter 97.

నెమలి *nemali*

a peacock

Introduced in Chapter 125.

నెమ్మదిగా *nemmadiḡā*

slowly

Introduced in Chapter 86.

నేను *nēnu*

I

Introduced in Chapter 3.

నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను *nēnu telugu māṭlāḍatānu*

I speak Telugu

Introduced in Chapter 5.

నేర్చుకో *nērcukō*

to learn

Introduced in Chapter 145.

నేర్పు *nērpū*

to teach

Introduced in Chapter 145.

నెయ్యి *neyyi*

ghee

Introduced in Chapter 61.

నీ వయసెంత? *nī vayasenta*

how old are you? — literally “your age how-much?”, matching Kannada’s simple verbless possessive exactly

Introduced in Chapter 19.

నిద్ర *nidra*

sleep

Introduced in Chapter 63.

నిద్రపో *nidrapō*

to sleep

Introduced in Chapter 143.

నిజం *nijam*

true; the truth

Introduced in Chapter 49.

నిజమే *nijamē*

that’s true

Introduced in Chapter 98.

నిజంగా *nijamīgā*

really, truly

Introduced in Chapter 87.

నిలబ్బి *nilcō*

stand

Introduced in Chapter 43.

నీళ్ళు బియ్యం అన్నం *nīḷḷu biyyam annam*

water (matching Tamil/Kannada’s neer/niiru), and rice raw/cooked — completing the family’s water and rice pattern

Introduced in Chapter 15.

నిమ్మకాయ *nimmakāya*

a lemon

Introduced in Chapter 135.

నిన్న *ninna*

yesterday

Introduced in Chapter 75.

నిప్పు *nippu*

fire, a live coal

Introduced in Chapter 59.

నిరంతరం *nirantaram*

constantly, continuously

Introduced in Chapter 171.

నీరసం *nīrasam*

weakness, lethargy

Introduced in Chapter 92.

నిర్ణయించు *nirṇayañcu*

to decide

Introduced in Chapter 108.

నిశ్శబ్దం *niśśabdami*

silence; quiet

Introduced in Chapter 182.

నొప్పి *noppi*

a pain, an ache

Introduced in Chapter 84.

నోరు *nōru*

mouth — the one face-word where Telugu does not obviously match the root its three sisters all share

Introduced in Chapter 37.

నుంచి *nunci*

from

Introduced in Chapter 77.

నూనె *nūne*

oil

Introduced in Chapter 61.

నువ్వు / మీరు *nuvvu / mīru*

you (familiar / respectful)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ఒకసారి *okasārī*

once, one time

Introduced in Chapter 154.

ఒకటి రెండు మూడు నాలుగు ఐదు *okaṭi reṇḍu mūḍu nālugu aidu*

one to five — the Dravidian family numbers, with Telugu’s maverick “one”

Introduced in Chapter 7.

ఒకవేళ *okaveḷa*

if by chance, in case

Introduced in Chapter 177.

ఒక్క నిమిషం *okka nimiṣam*

one minute, a moment

Introduced in Chapter 86.

ఒళ్ళు *ollu*

the body

Introduced in Chapter 93.

ఒంటరిగా *oṇṭarigā*

alone

Introduced in Chapter 97.

ఒంటి *oṇṭe*

a camel

Introduced in Chapter 126.

ఒప్పుకో *oppukō*

to agree, to accept

Introduced in Chapter 160.

పచ్చ, పసుపు *pacca pasupu*

green and yellow — a genuine Telugu doublet pair, both from the same

Proto-Dravidian *pac-* root, unlike Kannada, where the yellow word broke away as a Sanskrit loan

Introduced in Chapter 22.

పచ్చడి *paccaḍi*

a chutney, a pickle

Introduced in Chapter 184.

పాడైన *pāḍaina*

spoiled

Introduced in Chapter 140.

పడకగది *paḍakagadi*

a bedroom

Introduced in Chapter 183.

పదకొండు — ఇరవై *padakoṇḍu — iravai*

11-20 — additive “ten-echo” compounds for the teens; ఇరవై (20) most likely continues the SAME pan-Dravidian “two-tens” pattern as Kannada’s ippattu, though worn down further and less transparent on the surface today

Introduced in Chapter 20.

పదండి *paḍaṇḍi*

let’s go

Introduced in Chapter 90.

పడవ *paḍava*

a boat

Introduced in Chapter 133.

పదవ *padava*

tenth — the ten closed, and the shortest swap of all
Introduced in Chapter 82.

పాడు *pāḍu*

to sing

Introduced in Chapter 148.

పగలగొట్టు *pagalagoṭṭu*

to break

Introduced in Chapter 144.

పైన *paina*

above, on top

Introduced in Chapter 101.

పైసా *paisā*

a paisa, small change

Introduced in Chapter 130.

పక్కన *pakkana*

beside, next to

Introduced in Chapter 173.

పక్షి *pakṣi*

a bird

Introduced in Chapter 60.

పలకరించు *palakarincu*

to greet

Introduced in Chapter 161.

పాలు *pālu*

milk — the same Proto-Dravidian word the whole family shares, with Telugu on the majority side of a regular Kannada sound law

Introduced in Chapter 39.

పంపు *pampu*

to send

Introduced in Chapter 144.

పాము *pāmu*

a snake

Introduced in Chapter 124.

పంచదార *pañcadāra*

sugar

Introduced in Chapter 136.

పంచె *pañce*

a dhoti

Introduced in Chapter 114.

పంది *pandi*

a pig

Introduced in Chapter 126.

పండు *paṇḍu*

a fruit

Introduced in Chapter 46.

పని చేయు *pani cēyu*

to work (lit. “work-do”)

Introduced in Chapter 5.

పనిమనిషి *panimaniṣi*

a domestic helper

Introduced in Chapter 194.

పన్ను *pannu*

a tooth

Introduced in Chapter 47.

పంట *paṇṭa*

a harvest

Introduced in Chapter 66.

పాప *pāpa*

a baby, a little one

Introduced in Chapter 186.

పప్పు *pappu*

dal, lentils

Introduced in Chapter 115.

పార *pāra*

a spade

Introduced in Chapter 69.

పరవాలేదు *paravālēdu*

it's okay / no problem / you're welcome

Introduced in Chapter 3.

పారేయు *pārēyu*

to throw away

Introduced in Chapter 159.

పరిచయం *paricayam*

an introduction, acquaintance

Introduced in Chapter 94.

పరిగెత్తు *parigettu*

to run

Introduced in Chapter 143.

పరికరం *parikaram*

a tool

Introduced in Chapter 106.

పరిష్కారం *pariṣkāraṁ*

a solution

Introduced in Chapter 197.

పార్కు *pārku*

a park

Introduced in Chapter 102.

పార్సెలు *pārselu*

a parcel

Introduced in Chapter 185.

పాట *pāṭa*

a song

Introduced in Chapter 68.

పాత *pāta*

old — of a thing, not of a person

Introduced in Chapter 42.

పతకం *patakani*

a medal

Introduced in Chapter 189.

పాటించు *pāṭiñcu*

to observe, to follow (rules)

Introduced in Chapter 166.

పట్టణం *paṭṭaṇaṁ*

a town

Introduced in Chapter 77.

పట్టించుకో *paṭṭiñcukō*

to pay attention to, to care about

Introduced in Chapter 163.

పావురం *pāvuraṁ*

a pigeon

Introduced in Chapter 125.

పాయసం *pāyasaṁ*

a sweet milk pudding

Introduced in Chapter 184.

పేద *pēda*

poor

Introduced in Chapter 139.

పెదవి *pedavi*

a lip

Introduced in Chapter 57.

పెద్ద *pedda*

big

Introduced in Chapter 42.

పెళ్ళి *peḷḷi*

a wedding, marriage

Introduced in Chapter 89.

పెన్సిలు *pensilu*

a pencil

Introduced in Chapter 185.

పెరడు *peraḍu*

a backyard

Introduced in Chapter 173.

పేరు *pēru*

name

Introduced in Chapter 2.

పెరుగు *perugu*

curd

Introduced in Chapter 61.

పెట్టె *peṭṭe*

a box

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ఫీజు *phīju*

a fee

Introduced in Chapter 196.

ఫోను *phōnu*

a phone

Introduced in Chapter 130.

పిచ్చుక *piccuka*

a sparrow

Introduced in Chapter 187.

పిల్లలు *pillalu*

children

Introduced in Chapter 88.

పిలుచు *pilucu*

to call

Introduced in Chapter 146.

పిండు *piṇḍu*

to squeeze

Introduced in Chapter 159.

పొడవు *poḍavu*

tall, long

Introduced in Chapter 136.

పొడి *podī*

dry

Introduced in Chapter 139.

పొగ *poga*

smoke

Introduced in Chapter 175.

పొగడు *pogaḍu*

to praise

Introduced in Chapter 162.

పోగొట్టుకో *pōgottukō*

to lose (something)

Introduced in Chapter 159.

పొలం *polam*

a field

Introduced in Chapter 66.

పోనీ *pōnī*

never mind; let it be

Introduced in Chapter 178.

పోరపాటున *porapātuna*

by mistake, accidentally

Introduced in Chapter 178.

పోస్టాఫీసు *pōstāphīsu*

a post office

Introduced in Chapter 173.

పోటీ *pōṭī*

a competition, a match

Introduced in Chapter 189.

పోటీపడు *pōṭīpaḍu*

to compete

Introduced in Chapter 163.

పోట్టి *pōṭṭi*

short

Introduced in Chapter 136.

పోయ్యి *poyyi*

a stove

Introduced in Chapter 113.

ప్రధాన *pradhāna*

main, chief

Introduced in Chapter 180.

ప్రకారం *prakāraṇi*

according to

Introduced in Chapter 177.

ప్రకటన *prakaṭana*

an advertisement, an announcement

Introduced in Chapter 156.

ప్రణాళిక *praṇālika*

a plan

Introduced in Chapter 107.

ప్రపంచం *prapañcam*

the world

Introduced in Chapter 175.

ప్రసాదం *prasādam*

prasadam, food offered to a deity and shared

Introduced in Chapter 188.

ప్రసిద్ధ *prasiddha*

famous

Introduced in Chapter 139.

ప్రతి *prati*

every, each

Introduced in Chapter 180.

ప్రతిరోజు *pratirōju*

every day

Introduced in Chapter 171.

ప్రయాణం *prayāṇam*

a journey

Introduced in Chapter 50.

పూలదండ *pūladanḍa*

a flower garland

Introduced in Chapter 52.

పులి *puli*

a tiger

Introduced in Chapter 123.

పులుపు *pulupu*

sour, sourness

Introduced in Chapter 73.

పుండు *punḍu*

a sore, an ulcer

Introduced in Chapter 169.

పురుగు *purugu*

an insect, a worm

Introduced in Chapter 187.

పుస్తకం *pustakam*

a book

Introduced in Chapter 46.

పుట్టినరోజు *puṭṭinarōju*

a birthday

Introduced in Chapter 96.

పువ్వు *puvvu*

a flower

Introduced in Chapter 52.

రా *rā*

come

Introduced in Chapter 43.

రా *rā*

to come — the command is రా, but every ending attaches to వచ్చు instead

Introduced in Chapter 32.

రబ్బరు *rabbaru*

rubber; an eraser

Introduced in Chapter 191.

రచయిత *racayita*

a writer, an author

Introduced in Chapter 197.

రైలు *railu*

a train

Introduced in Chapter 133.

రైతు *raitu*

a farmer

Introduced in Chapter 48.

రక్తం *raktam*

blood

Introduced in Chapter 128.

రంపం *rampam*

a saw

Introduced in Chapter 69.

రసం *rasam*

rasam

Introduced in Chapter 116.

రసీదు *rasīdu*

a receipt

Introduced in Chapter 156.

రాత్రి *rātri*

“night” — the same Sanskrit tatsama word already hiding inside ardharātri;

unlike day’s Persian surprise, night genuinely follows the

Sanskrit-tatsama-as-everyday pattern, matching Kannada

Introduced in Chapter 24.

రాయి *rāyi*

write

Introduced in Chapter 44.

రాయు *rāyu*

to write — an old Dravidian word for drawing a line, still spelled వ్రాయు in books,
and the chapter’s fourth mind-verb
Introduced in Chapter 33.

రెండవ *reṇḍava*

second — and the one swap that makes every ordinal from here to the end
Introduced in Chapter 81.

రేపు కలుద్దాం *rēpu kaluddām*

see you tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 4.

రోడ్డు *rōḍḍu*

a road
Introduced in Chapter 102.

రోగం *rōgam*

a disease
Introduced in Chapter 63.

రోజు *rōju*

“day” — a genuine surprise: Telugu’s everyday word isn’t Sanskrit or native
Dravidian at all, it’s a Persian loanword; దినము, the Sanskrit tatsama form, is the
more formal alternate here — the mirror image of Kannada’s pattern
Introduced in Chapter 23.

రుబ్బు *rubbu*

to grind (wet batter)
Introduced in Chapter 157.

రూపాయి *rūpāyī*

a rupee
Introduced in Chapter 131.

సబ్బు *sabbu*

soap
Introduced in Chapter 111.

శబ్దం *śabdami*

a sound
Introduced in Chapter 68.

సాదా *sādā*

plain, simple
Introduced in Chapter 182.

సాధారణంగా *sādhāraṇaṅgā*

usually, generally
Introduced in Chapter 171.

సహనం *sahanami*

patience
Introduced in Chapter 168.

సహాయం చేయు *sahāyam cēyu*

to help — a Sanskrit noun on the native do-verb, and the noun takes apart into “a going with somebody”

Introduced in Chapter 34.

సహోద్యోగి *sahōdyōgi*

a colleague

Introduced in Chapter 195.

సైకిలు *sāikilu*

a bicycle

Introduced in Chapter 134.

సాక్సు *sāksu*

socks

Introduced in Chapter 132.

సాకు *sāku*

an excuse, a pretext

Introduced in Chapter 178.

సాలీడు *sālīḍu*

a spider

Introduced in Chapter 70.

సామర్థ్యం *sāmarthyam*

ability

Introduced in Chapter 105.

సమస్య *samasya*

a problem

Introduced in Chapter 197.

సమావేశం *samāvēśam*

a meeting

Introduced in Chapter 195.

సమయం *samayam*

time

Introduced in Chapter 170.

సాంబారు *sāmbāru*

sambar

Introduced in Chapter 116.

సంపాదించు *sampādiñcu*

to earn

Introduced in Chapter 160.

సముద్రం *samudram*

the sea

Introduced in Chapter 120.

సంవత్సరం *saṁvatsaram*

a year

Introduced in Chapter 75.

సంచి *sañci*

a bag

Introduced in Chapter 112.

సంత *santa*

a market

Introduced in Chapter 103.

సంతకం *santakam*

a signature

Introduced in Chapter 96.

శాంతి *śānti*

peace, calm

Introduced in Chapter 168.

సంతోషం *santōṣam*

joy / pleased to meet you

Introduced in Chapter 2.

సంతోషంగా *santōṣamigā*

happily, gladly

Introduced in Chapter 93.

సరస్సు *sarassu*

a lake

Introduced in Chapter 120.

షరతు *ṣaratu*

a condition

Introduced in Chapter 178.

సరే *sarē*

okay / alright (sarē)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

సరిగ్గా *sariggā*

exactly, properly

Introduced in Chapter 87.

సరిపోతుంది *saripōtundi*

that will do, it is enough

Introduced in Chapter 98.

సాయంత్రం *sāyantram*

“evening” (sāyantram) — Sanskrit tatsama from సాయం (sāyam, “in the evening”)

+ a “-tana” time-adjective suffix; సాయం itself traces to PIE *seh₁-* (“long, lasting”), the SAME root as Latin’s *sērus* — attested as the root of French *soir* and Italian *sera* — a genuine distant cognate across two completely different Indo-European branches

Introduced in Chapter 27.

సెలవు *selavu*

leave, a holiday

Introduced in Chapter 90.

సిబ్బంది *sibbandi*

staff

Introduced in Chapter 198.

సిగ్గుపడు *siggupadu*

to feel shy, to be bashful

Introduced in Chapter 161.

సింహం *simham*

a lion

Introduced in Chapter 123.

షిఫ్టు *siphṭu*

a work shift

Introduced in Chapter 198.

సీతాకోకచిలుక *sītākōkacilaka*

a butterfly

Introduced in Chapter 125.

స్నేహితుడి *snēhituḍi*

the friend's

Introduced in Chapter 79.

స్నేహితుడు *snēhitudu*

friend — the everyday Sanskrit-derived word, with Telugu's own DEDR-attested alternative named beside it

Introduced in Chapter 35.

సోమరి *sōmari*

lazy

Introduced in Chapter 141.

సోమవారం మంగళవారం బుధవారం గురువారం శుక్రవారం శనివారం

ఆదివారం *Somavāram Maṅgalavāram Budhavāram Guruvāram Śukravāram*

Śanivāram Ādivāram

the seven weekdays — Sanskritic like Hindi, but Sunday means “the FIRST day,” not “Sun's day”

Introduced in Chapter 10.

సోఫా *sōphā*

a sofa

Introduced in Chapter 190.

స్టాంపు *ṣṭāmpu*

a postage stamp

Introduced in Chapter 185.

స్టేషన్ *stēṣan*

a station

Introduced in Chapter 105.

శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం *śubha madhyāhnam*

“good afternoon” (*śubha madhyāhnam*), built on the widened “noon” word rather than the classical later-afternoon term

Introduced in Chapter 31.

శుభ రాత్రి *śubha rātri*

“good night” — the standard Sanskrit-tatsama translation (*rātri* already met, *śubha* new); some sources describe everyday speakers often code-switching to English “good night” instead

Introduced in Chapter 25.

శుభ సాయంత్రం *śubha sāyantram*

“good evening” (*śubha sāyantram*) — pairs with సాయంత్రం (TE-C27, the word with the striking Latin *sērus*/French *soir* cognate); unlike GREETING-MORNING’s single, dramatic “displaced by English” source, TWO independently-fetched sources agree this one is genuinely, commonly used in both formal and casual speech, with నమస్కారం as a time-independent alternative rather than a replacement

Introduced in Chapter 30.

శుభాకాంక్షలు *śubhākāṅkṣalu*

congratulations, good wishes

Introduced in Chapter 80.

శుభోదయం *śubhodayam*

“good morning” (*subhodayam*) — శుభ + ఉదయం, the traditional phrase; one directly-fetched source (a Telugu-learning blog, the same low-authority genre already found overstated for Hindi/Kannada) claims it’s archaic, displaced by English “good morning” — treat with real skepticism, not as confirmed;

నమస్కారం remains a safer everyday-greeting bet regardless

Introduced in Chapter 29.

శుభ్రం *śubhram*

clean

Introduced in Chapter 137.

సూచన *sūcana*

an instruction, a note (on a sign)

Introduced in Chapter 156.

సూది *sūdi*

a needle

Introduced in Chapter 62.

సుఖం *sukham*

comfort, ease

Introduced in Chapter 93.

సులభం *sulabham*

easy

Introduced in Chapter 76.

సురక్షితం *surakṣitam*

safe

Introduced in Chapter 140.

సూర్యాస్తమయం *sūryāstamayam*

sunset

Introduced in Chapter 171.

సూర్యుడు *sūryudu*

the sun

Introduced in Chapter 53.

సుత్తి *sutti*

a hammer

Introduced in Chapter 69.

స్వాగతం *svāgatam*

a welcome

Introduced in Chapter 65.

తాబేలు *tābēlu*

a tortoise

Introduced in Chapter 124.

తడి *tadī*

wet

Introduced in Chapter 139.

తాడు *tādu*

a rope

Introduced in Chapter 110.

తాగు *tāgu*

to drink

Introduced in Chapter 149.

తాజా *tājā*

fresh

Introduced in Chapter 179.

తక్కువ *takkuva*

less, too little

Introduced in Chapter 58.

తల చెయ్యి *tala ceyyi*

head (matching its cousins) and hand (the SAME Dravidian root as the others, transformed almost past recognition)

Introduced in Chapter 13.

తాళం *tālam*

a lock

Introduced in Chapter 110.

తాళంచెవి *tālamicevi*

a key

Introduced in Chapter 110.

తలనొప్పి *talanooppi*

a headache

Introduced in Chapter 167.

తల్లిదండ్రులు *tallidaṇḍrulu*

parents

Introduced in Chapter 186.

తలుపు *talupu*

a door

Introduced in Chapter 52.

తామరపువ్వు *tāmarapuvvu*

a lotus

Introduced in Chapter 132.

టమాటా *ṭamāṭā*

a tomato

Introduced in Chapter 118.

తన్ను *tannu*

to kick

Introduced in Chapter 163.

తపాలా *tapālā*

the post, mail

Introduced in Chapter 185.

తప్పకుండా *tappakuṇḍā*

certainly, without fail

Introduced in Chapter 49.

తప్పు *tappu*

a mistake; wrong

Introduced in Chapter 87.

తరచుగా *taracugā*

often

Introduced in Chapter 170.

తరువాత *taruvāta*

after that, later

Introduced in Chapter 64.

తాత *tāta*

grandfather

Introduced in Chapter 45.

టేబుల్ *tēbul*

a table

Introduced in Chapter 129.

తేదీ *tēdī*

a date

Introduced in Chapter 170.

తేలిక *tēlika*

light (in weight)

Introduced in Chapter 137.

తెలివైన *telivaina*

clever

Introduced in Chapter 142.

తెల్లని *tellani*

white, bright

Introduced in Chapter 142.

తెలుగులో *telugulō*

in Telugu

Introduced in Chapter 95.

తెలుసా *telusā*

do you know?

Introduced in Chapter 78.

తెలుసు *telusu*

it is known — the verb that carries no person at all, so the knower rides in the dative

Introduced in Chapter 32.

తేనె *tēne*

honey

Introduced in Chapter 119.

తేనెటీగ *tēnetīga*

a bee

Introduced in Chapter 187.

తెర *tera*

a curtain, a screen

Introduced in Chapter 109.

తెరువు *teruvu*

to open

Introduced in Chapter 149.

టిక్కెట్టు *tikkettu*

a ticket

Introduced in Chapter 130.

తిన్నగా *tinnagā*

straight ahead

Introduced in Chapter 100.

తిను *tinu*

to eat — the inherited Dravidian root Telugu kept as its plain everyday verb, with the mealtime nouns borrowed from Sanskrit

Introduced in Chapter 32.

తీపి *tīpī*

sweet, sweetness

Introduced in Chapter 73.

తీరం *tīraṁ*

a shore, a coast

Introduced in Chapter 104.

తీసుకో *tīsukō*

to take — తీయు, “to pull out”, wearing the same -కో as the last chapter’s two mind-verbs, so taking is pulling something out for yourself

Introduced in Chapter 34.

తివాచీ *tivācī*

a carpet, a rug

Introduced in Chapter 190.

టీవీ *tīvī*

a television

Introduced in Chapter 130.

తీయని *tīyani*

sweet (of taste)

Introduced in Chapter 141.

తొమ్మిదవ *tommidava*

ninth — the doubled consonant survives the swap

Introduced in Chapter 82.

తోము *tōmu*

to brush (teeth), to scour (pots)

Introduced in Chapter 158.

తొందరపడు *tondarapaḍu*

to hurry

Introduced in Chapter 158.

టోపీ *ṭopī*

a cap, a hat

Introduced in Chapter 115.

తోరణం *tōraṇaṁ*

a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway

Introduced in Chapter 188.

తోట *tōṭa*

a garden

Introduced in Chapter 104.

త్రాసు *trāsu*

a weighing scale

Introduced in Chapter 191.

త్రిభుజం *tribhujam*

a triangle

Introduced in Chapter 193.

తుడుచు *tuḍucu*

to wipe

Introduced in Chapter 147.

తుకం *tūkam*

weight

Introduced in Chapter 72.

తుపాను *tupānu*

a storm

Introduced in Chapter 121.

తురుము *turumu*

to grate

Introduced in Chapter 164.

తువ్వాలు *tuvvālu*

a towel

Introduced in Chapter 111.

త్వరగా *tvaragā*

quickly, soon

Introduced in Chapter 90.

ట్యూషను *tyūṣanu*

tuition, coaching

Introduced in Chapter 198.

ఉదయం *udayam*

“morning” (*udayam*) — Sanskrit tatsama from *udaya* (“rise”) + Telugu -*mu*, Telugu’s most general everyday word, though genuine native competitors (*poddu/podduna*, *vēkuva*) also do real everyday work; unlike Kannada, where the same Sanskrit root (*udaya*) shows up ONLY inside the greeting *śubhōdaya*, Telugu’s everyday noun and its greeting-root are the SAME word

Introduced in Chapter 26.

ఉద్దేశం *uddēśam*

an intention

Introduced in Chapter 107.

ఉడికించు *uḍikiñcu*

to boil (food), to simmer

Introduced in Chapter 157.

ఉడుత *uḍuta*

a squirrel

Introduced in Chapter 70.

ఉద్యోగం *udyōgaṁ*

a job

Introduced in Chapter 89.

ఉల్లిపాయ *ullipāya*

an onion

Introduced in Chapter 117.

ఉండు *uṇḍu*

to be, to exist, to stay — and the negative Telugu has to fetch from a different verb

Introduced in Chapter 32.

ఉండు *uṇḍu*

to be, to stay, to live

Introduced in Chapter 5.

ఉంగరం *uṅgaram*

a ring

Introduced in Chapter 115.

ఉన్నారా *unnārā*

is he or she there?

Introduced in Chapter 78.

ఉప్పు *uppu*

salt

Introduced in Chapter 46.

ఉరుము *urumu*

thunder

Introduced in Chapter 121.

ఉత్సాహం *utsāhaṁ*

enthusiasm, excitement

Introduced in Chapter 168.

ఉయ్యాల *uyyāla*

a swing; a cradle

Introduced in Chapter 190.

వచ్చే *vaccē*

next, coming

Introduced in Chapter 155.

వడ *vaḍa*

a vada

Introduced in Chapter 119.

వడకట్టు *vaḍakattu*

to strain, to filter

Introduced in Chapter 164.

వద్దు *vaddu*

no, I don't want it

Introduced in Chapter 58.

వడ్డంగి *vaḍraṅgi*

a carpenter

Introduced in Chapter 197.

వగరు *vagaru*

astringent

Introduced in Chapter 73.

వైద్యుడు *vaidyudu*

a doctor, a physician

Introduced in Chapter 48.

వల *vala*

a net

Introduced in Chapter 191.

వల్ల *valla*

because of

Introduced in Chapter 108.

వండు *vaṇḍu*

to cook

Introduced in Chapter 144.

వంకాయ *vaṅkāya*

an aubergine

Introduced in Chapter 118.

వాఙ్మయం *vāṅmayam*

literature; the whole body of expression in words

Introduced in Chapter 150.

వంటగది *vaṇṭagadi*

a kitchen

Introduced in Chapter 183.

వంతెన *vantena*

a bridge

Introduced in Chapter 102.

వాపు *vāpu*

a swelling

Introduced in Chapter 167.

వరండా *varaṇḍā*

a veranda

Introduced in Chapter 173.

వారాంతం *vārāntam*

a weekend

Introduced in Chapter 170.

వరి *vari*

paddy, rice still in the field

Introduced in Chapter 66.

వర్ణించు *varṇiñcu*

to describe

Introduced in Chapter 162.

వాసన *vāsana*

a smell

Introduced in Chapter 181.

వసంత ఋతువు వేసవి వానాకాలం శీతాకాలం *vasanta ṛtuvu vēsavi vānākālam śītākālam*

spring, summer, monsoon, winter — completing the Dravidian pattern of native heat/rain words plus Sanskrit spring

Introduced in Chapter 14.

వాతావరణం *vātāvaraṇam*

weather/atmosphere — a PURE Sanskrit compound, unlike Kannada's Persian+Sanskrit hybrid: vata (“air/wind”) + avarana (“covering”)

Introduced in Chapter 20.

వత్తి *vatti*

a wick

Introduced in Chapter 192.

వయసు *vayasu*

age

Introduced in Chapter 96.

వెడల్పు *veḍalpu*

wide

Introduced in Chapter 138.

వేడి *vēḍi*

heat; hot

Introduced in Chapter 85.

వేగం *vēgam*

fast; speed

Introduced in Chapter 138.

వెళ్ళవచ్చు *vellavaccu*

you may go

Introduced in Chapter 80.

వెళ్ళి వస్తాను *velli vastānu*

goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

వెళ్ళొస్తాను *vellostānu*

I'll go and come back — the everyday goodbye
Introduced in Chapter 50.

వెళ్ళు *vellu*

to go (and vaccu, to come)
Introduced in Chapter 4.

వెళ్ళు *vellu*

to go — with one tense-piece covering both “I go” and “I will go”, and “right now” built out of the be-verb
Introduced in Chapter 32.

వెల్లుల్లి *vellulli*

garlic
Introduced in Chapter 118.

వేలు *vēlu*

a finger
Introduced in Chapter 47.

వెనక *venaka*

behind
Introduced in Chapter 101.

వెన్న *venna*

butter
Introduced in Chapter 184.

వేరు *vēru*

a root
Introduced in Chapter 54.

వేసుకో *vēsukō*

to put on (clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 146.

వెతుకు *vetuku*

to look for
Introduced in Chapter 144.

వేయించు *vēyiñcu*

to fry, to roast
Introduced in Chapter 157.

విచారం *vicārami*

regret, sorrow
Introduced in Chapter 97.

వీధి *vidhi*

a street
Introduced in Chapter 102.

- విడిపోవు *vidipōvu*
to separate, to part
Introduced in Chapter 166.
- విద్యార్థి *vidyārthi*
a student
Introduced in Chapter 48.
- విజేత *viḷēta*
a winner
Introduced in Chapter 189.
- విమానం *vimānam*
an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 134.
- వినిపించలేదు *vinipiñcalēdu*
I could not hear it
Introduced in Chapter 95.
- విప్పు *vippu*
to take off, to untie
Introduced in Chapter 158.
- వీపు *vīpu*
the back
Introduced in Chapter 57.
- విరేచనాలు *virēcanālu*
diarrhoea
Introduced in Chapter 167.
- విశ్రాంతి *viśrānti*
rest
Introduced in Chapter 84.
- విత్తనం *vittanam*
a seed
Introduced in Chapter 54.
- వివరించు *vivariñcu*
to explain
Introduced in Chapter 160.
- వృద్ధాప్యం *vṛddhāpyam*
old age
Introduced in Chapter 172.
- వృత్తం *vṛttam*
a circle
Introduced in Chapter 193.
- వ్యాపారి *vyāpāri*
a trader, a merchant
Introduced in Chapter 194.

యజమాని *yajamāni*

an owner

Introduced in Chapter 106.

యంత్రం *yantram*

a machine

Introduced in Chapter 190.

యవ్వనం *yavvanam*

youth

Introduced in Chapter 172.

యూనిఫారం *yūniphāram*

a uniform

Introduced in Chapter 198.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 31

31.1 శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం — *register and evidence*

Do both sources claim subha madhyahnam is less common?

Chapter 83

83.1 (*reading*) — *six words, read down as well as along*

Which word is the lamp?

83.2 (*reading*) — *six lines, and no word for is*

What English word has no Telugu equivalent in these lines?

83.3 (*reading*) — *the first passage*

Who is not in the room?

Chapter 150

150.1 వాఙ్మయం (*vāṇmayam*) — *literature, the whole body of expression in words*

What Telugu word names literature or the wider body of expression in words?

150.2 జ — *the quiet letter inside వాఙ్మయం*

Which base letter is hidden in the cluster జ్ఞ?

Chapter 151

151.1 ఛాయ (*chāya*) — *shade, shadow*

What Telugu word can mean shade or shadow?

151.2 ఛ — *the airy first letter in ఛాయ*

Which base letter begins ఛాయ?

151.3 ఛాయ — *meaning and shape together*

Write the first base letter of ఛాయ, then say what the whole word means.

Chapter 152

152.1 ఝరి (*jhari*) — *a stream*

What Telugu word can mean a stream or mountain stream?

152.2 ఝ — *the breathy first letter in ఝరి*

Which base letter begins ఝరి?

152.3 ఝరి — *meaning and shape together*

From the picture cue of a stream, write the whole Telugu word, circle its first base letter, and give the meaning.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 31

31.1 శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం — *register and evidence*

Answer: no

Also accepted: no they do not; only one source does

Chapter 83

83.1 (*reading*) — *six words, read down as well as along*

Answer: deepam

Also accepted: దీపం; lamp

83.2 (*reading*) — *six lines, and no word for is*

Answer: is

Also accepted: to be; the verb is

83.3 (*reading*) — *the first passage*

Answer: the farmer

Also accepted: రైతు; farmer

Chapter 150

150.1 వాఙ్మయం (*vāṇmayam*) — *literature, the whole body of expression in words*

Answer: వాఙ్మయం

Also accepted: vangmayam; vāṇmayam

150.2 జ — *the quiet letter inside వాఙ్మయం*

Answer: జ

Also accepted: nga; ña

Chapter 151

151.1 ఛాయ (*chāya*) — *shade, shadow*

Answer: ఛాయ

Also accepted: chaya; chāya; chhaya; chhāya

151.2 ఛ — *the airy first letter in ఛాయ*

Answer: ఛ

Also accepted: cha; chha

151.3 ఛాయ — *meaning and shape together*

Answer: ఛ — shade or shadow

Also accepted: ఛ, shade; ఛ, shadow; cha, shade; chha, shadow

Chapter 152

152.1 ఝరి (*jhari*) — *a stream*

Answer: ఝరి

Also accepted: jhari

152.2 ఝ — *the breathy first letter in ఝరి*

Answer: ఝ

Also accepted: jha

152.3 ఝరి — *meaning and shape together*

Answer: ఝరి — a stream; first letter ఝ

Also accepted: ఝరి, stream, ఝ; jhari, stream, jha; ఝరి, mountain stream, ఝ

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

0–9

11-20 — additive “ten-echo” compounds for the teens; ఇరవై (20) most likely continues the SAME pan-Dravidian “two-tens” pattern as Kannada’s ippattu, though worn down further and less transparent on the surface today పదకొండు — ఇరవై (padakonḍu — iravai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 20, p. 187

A

a baby, a little one పాప (pāpa)
Chapter 186, p. 1007
a backyard పెరడు (peraḍu)
Chapter 173, p. 951
a bag సంచి (sañci)
Chapter 112, p. 685
a ball బంతి (banti)
Chapter 113, p. 689
a banana అరటిపండు (araṭipaṇḍu)
Chapter 117, p. 705
a bank బ్యాంకు (byāṅku)
Chapter 103, p. 647
a bargain, haggling బేరం (bēraṁ)
Chapter 72, p. 465
a basket బుట్ట (buṭṭa)
Chapter 56, p. 369

a bear ఎలుగుబంటి (elugubaṇṭi)

Chapter 123, p. 731

a bed మంచం (maṇcam)

Chapter 109, p. 671

a bedroom పడకగది (paḍakagadi)

Chapter 183, p. 993

a bee తేనెటీగ (tēneṭīga)

Chapter 187, p. 1011

a belt బెల్టు (beltu)

Chapter 131, p. 765

a bicycle సైకిలు (sāikilu)

Chapter 134, p. 777

a bindi, a dot worn on the forehead బొట్టు (boṭṭu)

Chapter 188, p. 1015

a bird పక్షి (pakṣi)

Chapter 60, p. 393

a birthday పుట్టినరోజు (puṭṭinarōju)

Chapter 96, p. 611

a blanket దుప్పటి (duppaṭi)

Chapter 109, p. 671

a blessing ఆశీర్వాదం (āśīrvādam)

Chapter 51, p. 335

a blister బొబ్బ (bobba)

Chapter 169, p. 935

a blouse జాకెట్టు (jākeṭṭu)

Chapter 132, p. 769

a boat పడవ (paḍava)

Chapter 133, p. 773

a bone ఎముక (emuka)

Chapter 57, p. 375

a book పుస్తకం (pustakam)

Chapter 46, p. 305

a bottle బాటిలు (bāṭilu)

Chapter 131, p. 765

a box పెట్టె (peṭṭe)

Chapter 56, p. 369

a boy; a son అబ్బాయి (abbāyi)

Chapter 88, p. 563

a braid, a plait (of hair) జడ (jaḍa)

Chapter 192, p. 1033

a branch కొమ్మ (komma)

Chapter 54, p. 357

a brick ఇటుక (iṭuka)

Chapter 9, p. 121

- a bridge** వంతెన (vantena)
Chapter 102, p. 643
- a broom** చీపురు (cīpuru)
Chapter 62, p. 405
- a brother-in-law; a male cousin** బావ (bāva)
Chapter 71, p. 459
- a bucket** బాల్చీ (bālcī)
Chapter 183, p. 993
- a buffalo** గేదె (gēde)
Chapter 60, p. 393
- a bus** బస్సు (bassu)
Chapter 105, p. 655
- a butterfly** సీతాకోకచిలుక (sītākōkacilaka)
Chapter 125, p. 739
- a camel** ఒంటె (oṇṭe)
Chapter 126, p. 743
- a candle** కొవ్వొత్తి (kovvotti)
Chapter 113, p. 689
- a cap, a hat** టోపీ (ṭōpī)
Chapter 115, p. 697
- a car** కారు (kāru)
Chapter 134, p. 777
- a carpenter** వడ్డంగి (vaḍraṅgi)
Chapter 197, p. 1055
- a carpet, a rug** తివాచీ (tivācī)
Chapter 190, p. 1025
- a cave** గుహ (guha)
Chapter 174, p. 955
- a chair** కుర్చీ (kurcī)
Chapter 52, p. 345
- a chance, an opportunity** అవకాశం (avakāśam)
Chapter 106, p. 659
- a cheek** బుగ్గ (bugga)
Chapter 127, p. 747
- a chilli** మిరప (mirapa)
Chapter 61, p. 399
- a chutney, a pickle** పచ్చడి (paccāḍi)
Chapter 184, p. 999
- a circle** వృత్తం (vṛttam)
Chapter 193, p. 1039
- a clay pot** చట్టి (caṭṭi)
Chapter 129, p. 755

- a clerk** గుమాస్తా (gumāstā)
Chapter 195, p. 1047
- a clock, a watch** గడియారం (gaḍiyāraṁ)
Chapter 111, p. 681
- a cloud** మబ్బు (mabbu)
Chapter 53, p. 351
- a coat** కోటు (kōṭu)
Chapter 132, p. 769
- a coin** నాణెం (nāṇem)
Chapter 194, p. 1043
- a cold, a runny nose** జలుబు (jalubu)
Chapter 92, p. 587
- a colleague** సహోద్యోగి (sahōdyōgi)
Chapter 195, p. 1047
- a comb** దువ్వెన (duvvena)
Chapter 111, p. 681
- a competition, a match** పోటీ (pōṭī)
Chapter 189, p. 1021
- a computer** కంప్యూటర్ (kampyūṭar)
Chapter 130, p. 761
- a condition** షరతు (ṣaratu)
Chapter 178, p. 973
- a cooking vessel, a bowl** గిన్నె (ginne)
Chapter 56, p. 369
- a corner** మూల (mūla)
Chapter 104, p. 651
- a cough** దగ్గు (daggu)
Chapter 63, p. 411
- a country** దేశం (dēśam)
Chapter 77, p. 495
- a cow** ఆవు (āvu)
Chapter 122, p. 727
- a crow** కాకి (kāki)
Chapter 125, p. 739
- a crowd** గుంపు (gumpu)
Chapter 175, p. 961
- a cucumber** దోసకాయ (dōsakāya)
Chapter 184, p. 999
- a cupboard** బీరువా (bīruvā)
Chapter 129, p. 755
- a curry** కూర (kūra)
Chapter 115, p. 697

a curtain, a screen తెర (tera)

Chapter 109, p. 671

a date తేదీ (tēdī)

Chapter 170, p. 939

a deadline, a time limit గడువు (gaḍuvu)

Chapter 196, p. 1051

a deer జింక (jiṅka)

Chapter 124, p. 735

a dhoti ధోతి (dhōti)

Chapter 132, p. 769

a dhoti పంచె (pañce)

Chapter 114, p. 693

a disease రోగం (rōgam)

Chapter 63, p. 411

a doctor, a physician వైద్యుడు (vaidyudu)

Chapter 48, p. 317

a doll; a picture బొమ్మ (bomma)

Chapter 113, p. 689

a domestic helper పనిమనిషి (panimaniṣi)

Chapter 194, p. 1043

a donkey గాడిద (gāḍida)

Chapter 126, p. 743

a door తలుపు (talupu)

Chapter 52, p. 345

a dosa దోశ (dōsa)

Chapter 119, p. 713

a dream కల (kala)

Chapter 107, p. 663

a drinking glass గ్లాసు (glāsu)

Chapter 112, p. 685

a drum డప్పు (ḍappu)

Chapter 4, p. 59

a duck బాతు (bātu)

Chapter 126, p. 743

a farmer రైతు (raitu)

Chapter 48, p. 317

a fee ఫీజు (phīju)

Chapter 196, p. 1051

a festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway తోరణం (tōraṇam)

Chapter 188, p. 1015

a fever జ్వరం (jvaram)

Chapter 84, p. 539

a field పొలం (polam)

Chapter 66, p. 429

- a fine, a penalty** జరిమానా (jarimānā)
Chapter 196, p. 1051
- a finger** వేలు (vēlu)
Chapter 47, p. 311
- a fingernail, a claw** గోరు (gōru)
Chapter 57, p. 375
- a fish** చేప (cēpa)
Chapter 116, p. 701
- a flower** పువ్వు (puvvu)
Chapter 52, p. 345
- a flower garland** పూలదండ (pūladaṇḍa)
Chapter 52, p. 345
- a forest** అడవి (aḍavi)
Chapter 120, p. 719
- a fox** నక్క (nakka)
Chapter 124, p. 735
- a frog** కప్ప (kappa)
Chapter 70, p. 453
- a fruit** పండు (paṇḍu)
Chapter 46, p. 305
- a frying pan, a wok** బాణలి (bāṇali)
Chapter 183, p. 993
- a garden** తోట (tōṭa)
Chapter 104, p. 651
- a gift, a prize** బహుమతి (bahumati)
Chapter 99, p. 629
- a girl; a daughter** అమ్మాయి (ammāyi)
Chapter 88, p. 563
- a goat** మేక (mēka)
Chapter 60, p. 393
- a good turn, a benefit** మేలు (mēlu)
Chapter 51, p. 335
- a granddaughter** మనవరాలు (manavarālu)
Chapter 186, p. 1007
- a grandson** మనవాడు (manavaḍu)
Chapter 186, p. 1007
- a guava** జామపండు (jāmapaṇḍu)
Chapter 136, p. 785
- a guest** అతిథి (atithi)
Chapter 48, p. 317
- a hammer** సుత్తి (sutti)
Chapter 69, p. 447
- a harvest** పంట (paṇṭa)
Chapter 66, p. 429

- a headache** తలనొప్పి (talanoppi)
Chapter 167, p. 927
- a hen** కోడి (kōḍi)
Chapter 60, p. 393
- a hill, a mountain** కొండ (koṇḍa)
Chapter 121, p. 723
- a hobby; taste** అభిరుచి (abhiruci)
Chapter 189, p. 1021
- a horse** గుర్రం (gurraṁ)
Chapter 122, p. 727
- a hospital** ఆసుపత్రి (āsupatri)
Chapter 92, p. 587
- a job** ఉద్యోగం (udyōgaṁ)
Chapter 89, p. 569
- a journey** ప్రయాణం (prayāṇaṁ)
Chapter 50, p. 329
- a key** తాళంచెవి (tāḷaṁcevi)
Chapter 110, p. 677
- a kitchen** వంటగది (vaṇṭagadi)
Chapter 183, p. 993
- a kite** గాలిపటం (gālipaṭaṁ)
Chapter 114, p. 693
- a knee** మోకాలు (mōkālu)
Chapter 127, p. 747
- a knife** కత్తి (katti)
Chapter 56, p. 369
- a koel, the Indian cuckoo** కోకిల (kōkila)
Chapter 187, p. 1011
- a lake** సరస్సు (sarassu)
Chapter 120, p. 719
- a lamp** దీపం (dīpaṁ)
Chapter 46, p. 305
- a language** భాష (bhāṣa)
Chapter 89, p. 569
- a latch, a bolt** గొళ్ళెం (golḷeṁ)
Chapter 192, p. 1033
- a laugh, a smile** నవ్వు (navvu)
Chapter 97, p. 617
- a leaf** ఆకు (āku)
Chapter 120, p. 719
- a lemon** నిమ్మకాయ (nimmakāya)
Chapter 135, p. 781
- a library** గ్రంథాలయం (granthālayaṁ)
Chapter 103, p. 647

a lid మూత (mūta)

Chapter 183, p. 993

a lie; untrue అబద్ధం (abaddham)

Chapter 140, p. 803

a light bulb బల్బు (balbu)

Chapter 191, p. 1029

a line గీత (gīta)

Chapter 193, p. 1039

a lion సింహం (siṃham)

Chapter 123, p. 731

a lip పెదవి (pedavi)

Chapter 57, p. 375

a little, a bit కొంచెం (koñcem)

Chapter 58, p. 381

a lizard, a gecko బల్లి (balli)

Chapter 187, p. 1011

a lock తాళం (tāḷam)

Chapter 110, p. 677

a long skirt లంగా (laṅgā)

Chapter 131, p. 765

a lotus తామరపువ్వు (tāmarapuvvu)

Chapter 132, p. 769

a low hill గుట్ట (guṭṭa)

Chapter 55, p. 363

a machine యంత్రం (yantram)

Chapter 190, p. 1025

a manager మేనేజరు (mēnējaru)

Chapter 195, p. 1047

a mango మామిడిపండు (māmiḍipaṇḍu)

Chapter 117, p. 705

a market సంత (santa)

Chapter 103, p. 647

a mat చాప (cāpa)

Chapter 56, p. 369

a matchbox అగ్గిపెట్టె (aggipeṭṭe)

Chapter 113, p. 689

A Meal

chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 277

**a meal — the polite Sanskrit noun Chapter 32 already named
and never taught, finally given its own lesson** భోజనం (bhōjanam)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 277

a medal పతకం (patakam)

Chapter 189, p. 1021

- a meeting సమావేశం** (samāvēśam)
Chapter 195, p. 1047
- a message, news కబురు** (kaburu)
Chapter 68, p. 441
- a mirror అద్దం** (addam)
Chapter 62, p. 405
- a mistake; wrong తప్పు** (tappu)
Chapter 87, p. 557
- a monkey కోతి** (kōti)
Chapter 123, p. 731
- a mosquito దోమ** (dōma)
Chapter 70, p. 453
- a mouse, a rat ఎలుక** (eluka)
Chapter 70, p. 453
- a moustache మీసాలు** (mīsālu)
Chapter 133, p. 773
- a nail (to hammer) మేకు** (mēku)
Chapter 110, p. 677
- a necklace హారం** (hāram)
Chapter 192, p. 1033
- a needle సూది** (sūdi)
Chapter 62, p. 405
- a net వల** (vala)
Chapter 191, p. 1029
- a nickname, a pet name ముద్దుపేరు** (muddupēru)
Chapter 96, p. 611
- a novel నవల** (navala)
Chapter 189, p. 1021
- a pain, an ache నొప్పి** (noppi)
Chapter 84, p. 539
- a paintbrush కుంచె** (kuñce)
Chapter 192, p. 1033
- a paisa, small change పైసా** (paisā)
Chapter 130, p. 761
- a parcel పార్సెలు** (pārselu)
Chapter 185, p. 1003
- a park పార్కు** (pārku)
Chapter 102, p. 643
- a parrot చిలక** (cilaka)
Chapter 124, p. 735
- a path, a way బాట** (bāṭa)
Chapter 55, p. 363
- a peacock నెమలి** (nemali)
Chapter 125, p. 739

- a pen** కలం (kalam)
Chapter 112, p. 685
- a pencil** పెన్సిలు (pensilu)
Chapter 185, p. 1003
- a person, a human being** మనిషి (maniṣi)
Chapter 88, p. 563
- a phone** ఫోను (phōnu)
Chapter 130, p. 761
- a pig** పంది (pandi)
Chapter 126, p. 743
- a pigeon** పావురం (pāvuram)
Chapter 125, p. 739
- a pillow** దిండు (diṇḍu)
Chapter 109, p. 671
- a plan** ప్రణాళిక (praṇālika)
Chapter 107, p. 663
- a pocket** జేబు (jēbu)
Chapter 131, p. 765
- a polite request** మనవి (manavi)
Chapter 65, p. 423
- a post office** పోస్టాఫీసు (pōstāphīsu)
Chapter 173, p. 951
- a postage stamp** స్టాంపు (stāmpu)
Chapter 185, p. 1003
- a potato** బంగాళాదుంప (baṅgālādumpa)
Chapter 118, p. 709
- a price** ధర (dhara)
Chapter 72, p. 465
- a problem** సమస్య (samasya)
Chapter 197, p. 1055
- a rabbit** కుందేలు (kundēlu)
Chapter 123, p. 731
- a rash** దద్దుర్లు (daddurlu)
Chapter 169, p. 935
- a reason** కారణం (kāraṇam)
Chapter 108, p. 667
- a receipt** రసీదు (rasīdu)
Chapter 156, p. 875
- a relative** బంధువు (bandhuvu)
Chapter 88, p. 563
- a responsibility, a duty** బాధ్యత (bādhyata)
Chapter 196, p. 1051
- a restaurant, an eating house** హోటలు (hōṭalu)
Chapter 173, p. 951

a right హక్కు (hakku)

Chapter 105, p. 655

a ring ఉంగరం (uṅgaram)

Chapter 115, p. 697

a river నది (nadi)

Chapter 55, p. 363

a road రోడ్డు (rōḍḍu)

Chapter 102, p. 643

a roof కప్పు (kappu)

Chapter 67, p. 435

a root వేరు (vēru)

Chapter 54, p. 357

a rope తాడు (tāḍu)

Chapter 110, p. 677

a rupee రూపాయి (rūpāyi)

Chapter 131, p. 765

a salutation, “my respects” దండం (daṇḍam)

Chapter 51, p. 335

a sari చీర (cīra)

Chapter 114, p. 693

a saw రంపం (rampam)

Chapter 69, p. 447

a scar, a spot మచ్చ (macca)

Chapter 169, p. 935

a school బడి (baḍi)

Chapter 103, p. 647

a seed విత్తనం (vittanam)

Chapter 54, p. 357

a shirt చొక్కా (cokkā)

Chapter 114, p. 693

a shop అంగడి (aṅgaḍi)

Chapter 72, p. 465

a shore, a coast తీరం (tīram)

Chapter 104, p. 651

a shoulder భుజం (bhujam)

Chapter 127, p. 747

a shout అరుపు (arupu)

Chapter 68, p. 441

్ం — **a sign, not a letter**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21

a signature సంతకం (santakam)

Chapter 96, p. 611

a sister-in-law; a female cousin మరదలు (maradalu)

Chapter 71, p. 459

- a skill** నైపుణ్యం (naipuṇyam)
Chapter 105, p. 655
- a smell** వాసన (vāsana)
Chapter 181, p. 985
- a snake** పాము (pāmu)
Chapter 124, p. 735
- a sofa** సోఫా (sōphā)
Chapter 190, p. 1025
- a solution** పరిష్కారం (pariṣkāraṁ)
Chapter 197, p. 1055
- a son-in-law** అల్లుడు (alluḍu)
Chapter 71, p. 459
- a song** పాట (pāṭa)
Chapter 68, p. 441
- a sore, an ulcer** పుండు (puṇḍu)
Chapter 169, p. 935
- a sound** శబ్దం (śabdāṁ)
Chapter 68, p. 441
- a spade** పార (pāra)
Chapter 69, p. 447
- a sparrow** పిచ్చుక (piccuka)
Chapter 187, p. 1011
- a spider** సాలీడు (sālīḍu)
Chapter 70, p. 453
- a spoon** చెంచా (cemcā)
Chapter 112, p. 685
- a sprain** బెణుకు (beṇuku)
Chapter 169, p. 935
- a square** చతురస్రం (caturasraṁ)
Chapter 193, p. 1039
- a squirrel** ఉడుత (uḍuta)
Chapter 70, p. 453
- a star; a dot** చుక్క (cukka)
Chapter 53, p. 351
- a station** స్టేషన్ (stēṣan)
Chapter 105, p. 655
- a step** మెట్టు (meṭṭu)
Chapter 67, p. 435
- a stick** కర్ర (karra)
Chapter 69, p. 447
- a storm** తుపాను (tupānu)
Chapter 121, p. 723
- a stove** పొయ్యి (poyyi)
Chapter 113, p. 689

- a stream; mountain stream** ఝరి (jhari)
Chapter 152, p. 853
- a street** వీధి (vīdhi)
Chapter 102, p. 643
- a student** విద్యార్థి (vidyārthi)
Chapter 48, p. 317
- a surname, the family name** ఇంటిపేరు (iṇṭipēru)
Chapter 96, p. 611
- a swan** హంస (haṁsa)
Chapter 5, p. 71
- a sweet milk pudding** పాయసం (pāyasam)
Chapter 184, p. 999
- a swelling** వాపు (vāpu)
Chapter 167, p. 927
- a swing; a cradle** ఉయ్యాల (uyyāla)
Chapter 190, p. 1025
- a table** టేబుల్ (ṭēbul)
Chapter 129, p. 755
- a tablet, a pill** మాత్ర (mātra)
Chapter 167, p. 927
- a tailor** దర్జీ (darjī)
Chapter 194, p. 1043
- a teacher** గురువు (guruvu)
Chapter 48, p. 317
- a television** టీవీ (ṭīvī)
Chapter 130, p. 761
- a temple** గుడి (guḍi)
Chapter 103, p. 647
- a threshing floor** కల్లం (kallam)
Chapter 66, p. 429
- a threshold** గడప (gaḍapa)
Chapter 67, p. 435
- a ticket** టిక్కెట్టు (ṭikkēṭṭu)
Chapter 130, p. 761
- a tiger** పులి (puli)
Chapter 123, p. 731
- a timetable** కాలపట్టిక (kālapaṭṭika)
Chapter 156, p. 875
- A Timetable, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Receipt**
chapter topic; Chapter 156, p. 875
- a tomato** టమాటా (ṭamāṭā)
Chapter 118, p. 709
- a tool** పరికరం (parikaram)
Chapter 106, p. 659

- a tooth** పన్ను (pannu)
Chapter 47, p. 311
- a tortoise** తాబేలు (tābēlu)
Chapter 124, p. 735
- a towel** తువ్వాలు (tuvvālu)
Chapter 111, p. 681
- a town** పట్టణం (paṭṭaṇaṁ)
Chapter 77, p. 495
- a trader, a merchant** వ్యాపారి (vyāpāri)
Chapter 194, p. 1043
- a train** రైలు (railu)
Chapter 133, p. 773
- a tree** చెట్టు (ceṭṭu)
Chapter 54, p. 357
- a triangle** త్రిభుజం (tribhujam)
Chapter 193, p. 1039
- a turn, a bend** మలుపు (malupu)
Chapter 104, p. 651
- a uniform** యూనిఫారం (yūniphāram)
Chapter 198, p. 1059
- a vada** వడ (vaḍa)
Chapter 119, p. 713
- a valley** లోయ (lōya)
Chapter 174, p. 955
- a veranda** వరండా (varaṇḍā)
Chapter 173, p. 951
- a village** గ్రామం (grāmam)
Chapter 55, p. 363
- a village tank, a reservoir** చెరువు (ceruvu)
Chapter 55, p. 363
- a voice** గొంతు (gontu)
Chapter 68, p. 441
- a wall** గోడ (gōḍa)
Chapter 67, p. 435
- a water pot** బిందె (bindē)
Chapter 129, p. 755
- a waterfall** జలపాతం (jalapātam)
Chapter 122, p. 727
- a wave** అల (ala)
Chapter 121, p. 723
- a wedding, marriage** పెళ్ళి (pelli)
Chapter 89, p. 569
- a weekend** వారాంతం (vārāntam)
Chapter 170, p. 939

- a weighing scale** త్రాసు (trāsu)
Chapter 191, p. 1029
- a welcome** స్వాగతం (svāgatam)
Chapter 65, p. 423
- a wheel** చక్రం (cakram)
Chapter 193, p. 1039
- a wick** వత్తి (vatti)
Chapter 192, p. 1033
- a window** కిటికీ (kiṭikī)
Chapter 67, p. 435
- a window curtain** కిటికీతెర (kiṭikītera)
Chapter 129, p. 755
- a winner** విజేత (vijēta)
Chapter 189, p. 1021
- a wish** కోరిక (kōrika)
Chapter 107, p. 663
- A Word for a Stream — Then Its First Letter**
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 853
- A Word for Literature — Then the Letter Inside It**
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 845
- A Word for Shade — Then Its First Letter**
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 849
- a work shift** షిఫ్టు (ṣiphtu)
Chapter 198, p. 1059
- a wound, an injury** గాయం (gāyam)
Chapter 92, p. 587
- a wrist** మణికట్టు (maṇikaṭṭu)
Chapter 128, p. 751
- a writer, an author** రచయిత (racayita)
Chapter 197, p. 1055
- a year** సంవత్సరం (saṁvatsaram)
Chapter 75, p. 483
- a young plant** మొక్క (mokka)
Chapter 54, p. 357
- ability** సామర్థ్యం (sāmarthyam)
Chapter 105, p. 655
- about, concerning** గురించి (guriñci)
Chapter 176, p. 965
- About Yourself**
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 569
- Above, Below, Inside, Outside, Behind**
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 639
- above, on top** పైన (paina)
Chapter 101, p. 639

according to ప్రకారం (prakāraṁ)

Chapter 177, p. 969

actually; (not) at all అసలు (asalu)

Chapter 177, p. 969

after that, later తరువాత (taruvāta)

Chapter 64, p. 417

Afternoon

chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 215

“afternoon” — the same word already met meaning precisely

“noon” (TE-C17), confirmed via a directly-fetched source to also

cover “the time between noon and evening” in modern usage —

the same kind of semantic widening already found for Hindi’s

दोपहर and, more thinly, Kannada’s

ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನం (madhyāhnam)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 215

age వయసు (vayasu)

Chapter 96, p. 611

alone ఒంటరిగా (oṇṭarigā)

Chapter 97, p. 617

already ఇప్పటికే (ippaṭikē)

Chapter 154, p. 863

also కూడా (kūdā)

Chapter 64, p. 417

an address చిరునామా (cirunāmā)

Chapter 89, p. 569

an advertisement, an announcement ప్రకటన (prakaṭana)

Chapter 156, p. 875

an aeroplane విమానం (vimānaṁ)

Chapter 134, p. 777

an ant చీమ (cīma)

Chapter 60, p. 393

an apology క్షమాపణ (kṣamāpaṇa)

Chapter 94, p. 599

an application దరఖాస్తు (darakhāstu)

Chapter 196, p. 1051

an aubergine వంకాయ (vaṅkāya)

Chapter 118, p. 709

an aunt; a mother-in-law అత్త (atta)

Chapter 71, p. 459

an axe గొడ్డలి (goḍḍali)

Chapter 69, p. 447

an earthquake భూకంపం (bhūkampaṁ)

Chapter 175, p. 961

- an egg** గుడ్డు (guḍḍu)
Chapter 116, p. 701
- an elbow** మోచేయి (mōcēyi)
Chapter 128, p. 751
- an elephant** ఏనుగు (ēnugu)
Chapter 122, p. 727
- an envelope** కవరు (kavaru)
Chapter 185, p. 1003
- an excuse, a pretext** సాకు (sāku)
Chapter 178, p. 973
- an eyebrow** కనుబొమ్మ (kanubomma)
Chapter 127, p. 747
- an idli** ఇడ్లీ (idli)
Chapter 119, p. 713
- an insect, a worm** పురుగు (purugu)
Chapter 187, p. 1011
- an instruction, a note (on a sign)** సూచన (sūcana)
Chapter 156, p. 875
- an intention** ఉద్దేశం (uddēśam)
Chapter 107, p. 663
- an interview** ఇంటర్వ్యూ (iṇṭarvyū)
Chapter 198, p. 1059
- an introduction, acquaintance** పరిచయం (paricayam)
Chapter 94, p. 599
- an invitation** ఆహ్వానం (āhvānam)
Chapter 99, p. 629
- an island** దీవి (dīvi)
Chapter 122, p. 727
- an office** కార్యాలయం (kāryālayam)
Chapter 104, p. 651
- an officer, an official** అధికారి (adhikāri)
Chapter 195, p. 1047
- an onion** ఉల్లిపాయ (ullipāya)
Chapter 117, p. 705
- an opinion** అభిప్రాయం (abhiprāyam)
Chapter 197, p. 1055
- an owl** గుడ్లగూబ (guḍlagūba)
Chapter 125, p. 739
- an owner** యజమాని (yajamāni)
Chapter 106, p. 659
- an umbrella** గొడుగు (goḍugu)
Chapter 62, p. 405
- an uncle; a father-in-law** మామ (māma)
Chapter 71, p. 459

and మరియు (mariyu)

Chapter 74, p. 477

And, But, Or

chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 477

anger కోపం (kōpani)

Chapter 85, p. 545

Animals

chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 393

Answering With More Than Yes

chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 323

anxiety, worry ఆందోళన (āndōḷana)

Chapter 97, p. 617

anyone, someone ఎవరైనా (evarainā)

Chapter 153, p. 857

anything, something ఏమైనా (ēmainā)

Chapter 153, p. 857

anyway, in any case ఏదేమైనా (ēdēmainā)

Chapter 177, p. 969

are you well? బాగున్నారా? (bāgunnārā?)

Chapter 91, p. 581

Asking Someone's Age

chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 185

astringent వగరు (vagaru)

Chapter 73, p. 471

At the Doctor

chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 587

B

bad చెడ్డ (ceḍḍa)

Chapter 76, p. 489

Bag, Pen, Paper, Drinking glass, Spoon

chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 685

bangles గాజులు (gājulu)

Chapter 115, p. 697

beautiful అందమైన (andamaina)

Chapter 138, p. 793

because ఎందుకంటే (endukaṇṭē)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 74, p. 477

because of వల్ల (valla)

Chapter 108, p. 667

Bee, Lizard, Insect, Sparrow, Koel

chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1011

before, in front ముందు (mundu)

Chapter 75, p. 483

before the noun, unchanged — five words, one rule

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 42, p. 287

behind వెనక (venaka)

Chapter 101, p. 639

below, underneath కింద (kinda)

Chapter 101, p. 639

beside, next to పక్కన (pakkana)

Chapter 173, p. 951

big పెద్ద (pedda)

Chapter 42, p. 287

bitter, bitterness చేదు (cēdu)

Chapter 73, p. 471

bitter-tasting చేదైన (cēdaina)

Chapter 141, p. 807

black, dark నల్లని (nallani)

Chapter 142, p. 811

black pepper మిరియాలు (miriyālu)

Chapter 135, p. 781

Black pepper, Cumin, Tamarind, Lemon, Grapes

chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 781

black, white, red, blue — Telugu's own basic colors, completing

the whole family's shared blue నలుపు తెలుపు ఎరుపు నీలం (nalupu

telupu erupu nīlam)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 11, p. 137

bland, tasteless చప్పని (cappani)

Chapter 179, p. 977

blood రక్తం (raktam)

Chapter 128, p. 751

but కానీ (kānī)

Chapter 74, p. 477

butter వెన్న (venna)

Chapter 184, p. 999

Butter, Chutney, Sweet milk pudding, Cucumber, Okra

chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 999

by mistake, accidentally పొరపాటున (porapāṭuna)

Chapter 178, p. 973

C

Cap, Ring, Bangles, Curry, Dal

chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 697

- Car, Bicycle, Aeroplane, Grain, Wheat**
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 777
- care, caution** జాగ్రత్త (jāgratta)
Chapter 90, p. 575
- Carpenter, Writer, Problem, Solution, Opinion**
chapter topic; Chapter 197, p. 1055
- Case Endings and Dative Subjects**
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 91
- certainly, without fail** తప్పకుండా (tappakuṇḍā)
Chapter 49, p. 323
- Chance, Tool, Property, Owner, Strength**
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 659
- cheap** చౌక (cauka)
Chapter 179, p. 977
- children** పిల్లలు (pillalu)
Chapter 88, p. 563
- Chin, Wrist, Elbow, Skin, Blood**
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 751
- clean** శుభ్రం (śubhram)
Chapter 137, p. 789
- clever** తెలివైన (telivaina)
Chapter 142, p. 811
- cloth** బట్ట (baṭṭa)
Chapter 46, p. 305
- clothes, cloth** గుడ్డలు (guḍḍalu)
Chapter 133, p. 773
- Clothes, Moustache, Tears, Boat, Train**
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 773
- coconut** కొబ్బరి (kobbari)
Chapter 117, p. 705
- coffee** కాఫీ (kāphī)
Chapter 119, p. 713
- Cold, Hot, and How You Feel**
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 545
- cold, the cold** చలి (cali)
Chapter 85, p. 545
- Comb, Soap, Towel, Glasses, Clock**
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 681
- come** రా (rā)
Chapter 43, p. 293
- comfort, ease** సుఖం (sukhami)
Chapter 93, p. 593
- comfortably, pleasantly** హాయిగా (hāyigā)
Chapter 93, p. 593

Competition, Winner, Medal, Hobby, Novel

chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1021

congratulations, compliments అభినందనలు (abhinandanalu)

Chapter 99, p. 629

congratulations, good wishes శుభాకాంక్షలు (śubhākāṅkṣalu)

Chapter 80, p. 513

constantly, continuously నిరంతరం (nirantaram)

Chapter 171, p. 943

Counting in Order

chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 519

courage; brave ధైర్యం (dhairyam)

Chapter 141, p. 807

Courtesy Words

chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 335

Crowd, World, Earthquake, Dust, Smoke

chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 961

crying, tears ఏడుపు (ēḍupu)

Chapter 97, p. 617

cumin జీలకర్ర (jīlakarra)

Chapter 135, p. 781

curd పెరుగు (perugu)

Chapter 61, p. 399

D**dal, lentils పప్పు (pappu)**

Chapter 115, p. 697

daughter — a second, separate Proto-Dravidian root, cognate**across the family with a word for “infant” rather than with****Telugu’s own word for son కూతురు (kūturu)**

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 257

Day

chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 197

“day” — a genuine surprise: Telugu’s everyday word isn’t**Sanskrit or native Dravidian at all, it’s a Persian loanword;****దినము, the Sanskrit tatsama form, is the more formal alternate****here — the mirror image of Kannada’s pattern రోజు (rōju)**

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 23, p. 197

Days of the Week

chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 127

deep లోతు (lōtu)

Chapter 138, p. 793

Deer, Fox, Snake, Tortoise, Parrot

chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 735

Delicious, Bland, Fresh, Expensive, Cheap

chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 977

delicious, tasty కమ్మని (kammani)

Chapter 179, p. 977

delight, joy ఆనందం (ānandam)

Chapter 99, p. 629

Describing Things

chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 287

diarrhoea విరేచనాలు (virēcanālu)

Chapter 167, p. 927

difficult; trouble కష్టం (kaṣṭam)

Chapter 76, p. 489

dirty మురికి (muriki)

Chapter 137, p. 789

do you know? తెలుసా (telusā)

Chapter 78, p. 501

do you want it? కావాలా? (kāvālā?)

Chapter 94, p. 599

Dog and Cat

chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 191

dog and cat — kukka genuinely breaks from its Dravidian cousins' shared naayi root, debated as onomatopoeic or a Sanskrit loan; pilli most likely closes the ENTIRE arc's cat-story loop, the probable Dravidian source behind Sanskrit's biDaala and so Hindi's billi కుక్క, పిల్లి (kukka, pilli)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 191

dry పొడి (poḍi)

Chapter 139, p. 797

Duck, Pig, Donkey, Camel, Face

chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 743

durable, long-lasting మన్నికైన (mannikaina)

Chapter 182, p. 989

dust దుమ్ము (dummu)

Chapter 175, p. 961

E

ear — native Dravidian, matching Tamil's own form

closely చెవి (cevi)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 261

easy సులభం (sulabham)

Chapter 76, p. 489

eighth — where the vowel that goes is an i, not a

u ఎనిమిదవ (enimidava)

Chapter 82, p. 527

Electricity, Machine, Sofa, Swing, Carpet

chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1025

electricity, power కరెంటు (kareṇṭu)

Chapter 190, p. 1025

English, the language ఇంగ్లీషు (iṅḡlīṣu)

Chapter 89, p. 569

enough, that will do చాలు (cālu)

Chapter 49, p. 323

enthusiasm, excitement ఉత్సాహం (utsāham)

Chapter 168, p. 931

Envelope, Postage stamp, Parcel, Post, Pencil

chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1003

even so, still అయినా (ayinā)

Chapter 176, p. 965

Evening

chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 213

“evening” (sāyantram) — Sanskrit tatsama from సాయం (sāyam, “in the evening”) + a “-tana” time-adjective suffix; సాయం itself traces to PIE *seh₁-* (“long, lasting”), the SAME root as Latin’s *sērus* — attested as the root of French *soir* and Italian *sera* — a genuine distant cognate across two completely different

Indo-European branches సాయంత్రం (sāyantram)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 213

every day ప్రతిరోజు (pratirōju)

Chapter 171, p. 943

every, each ప్రతి (prati)

Chapter 180, p. 981

every year, annually ఏటా (ēṭā)

Chapter 172, p. 947

exactly, properly సరిగ్గా (sariggā)

Chapter 87, p. 557

expensive ఖరీదైన (kharīdaina)

Chapter 179, p. 977

extra, additional అదనపు (adanapu)

Chapter 182, p. 989

eye — a word this book has already used once, unglossed, as

proof of the family’s shared oldest seeing-root కన్ను (kannu)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 261

F

fake, counterfeit నకిలీ (nakilī)

Chapter 182, p. 989

Family

chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 141

Family and Friends

chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 253

family — the collective word Chapter 12’s parents and siblings never needed, because each of them was already the name of one specific person కుటుంబం (kuṭumbam)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 253

famous ప్రసిద్ధ (prasiddha)

Chapter 139, p. 797

far; distance దూరం (dūram)

Chapter 100, p. 635

Farewells

chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 59

Fast, Beautiful, Deep, Wide, Narrow

chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 793

fast; speed వేగం (vēgam)

Chapter 138, p. 793

father, mother, and four age-graded sibling words — Telugu’s own father-word and “younger sister” word, but the same age-first system నాన్న అమ్మ అన్న తమ్ముడు అక్క చెల్లి (nānna amma anna tammuḍu akka celli)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141

fear భయం (bhayam)

Chapter 85, p. 545

Fee, Fine, Deadline, Responsibility, Application

chapter topic; Chapter 196, p. 1051

fifth — where the vowel that goes is a diphthong’s

tail ఐదవ (aidava)

Chapter 81, p. 519

fire, a live coal నిప్పు (nippu)

Chapter 59, p. 387

firewood కట్టెలు (kaṭṭelu)

Chapter 191, p. 1029

first — the one ordinal Telugu does not build from a number మొదటి (modaṭi)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 519

forever ఎప్పటికీ (eppaṭiki)

Chapter 172, p. 947

Four Core Colours

chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 137

Four Verbs Between People

chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 245

Four Verbs of the Mind

chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 235

Four Words on the Face

chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 261

fourth — the longest of the ten, and still the same**ending నాలుగవ (nālugaṇa)**

Chapter 81, p. 519

fresh తాజా (tājā)

Chapter 179, p. 977

friend — the everyday Sanskrit-derived word, with Telugu's own**DEDR-attested alternative named beside it స్నేహితుడు (snēhituḍu)**

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 253

from నుంచి (nunci)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 77, p. 495

from now on ఇకపై (ikapai)

Chapter 155, p. 869

G**garlic వెల్లుల్లి (vellulli)**

Chapter 118, p. 709

gently, softly, slowly మెల్లగా (mellagā)

Chapter 95, p. 605

ghee నెయ్యి (neyyi)

Chapter 61, p. 399

ginger అల్లం (allam)

Chapter 118, p. 709

give ఇవ్వ (ivvu)

Chapter 43, p. 293

glasses, spectacles కళ్ళజోడు (kaḷḷajōḍu)

Chapter 111, p. 681

golden బంగారు (baṅgāru)

Chapter 140, p. 803

good మంచి (manci)

Chapter 42, p. 287

Good Afternoon

chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 221

“good afternoon” (śubha madhyāhnam), built on the widened
 “noon” word rather than the classical later-afternoon term శుభ
 మధ్యాహ్నం (śubha madhyāhnam)

Chapter 31, p. 221

Good Evening

chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 219

“good evening” (śubha sāyantram) — pairs with సాయంత్రం
 (TE-C27, the word with the striking Latin sērus/French soir
 cognate); unlike GREETING-MORNING’s single, dramatic
 “displaced by English” source, TWO independently-fetched
 sources agree this one is genuinely, commonly used in both
 formal and casual speech, with నమస్కారం as a time-independent
 alternative rather than a replacement శుభ సాయంత్రం (śubha
 sāyantram)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 219

good manners మర్యాద (maryāda)

Chapter 65, p. 423

Good Morning

chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 217

“good morning” (subhodayam) — శుభ + ఉదయం, the traditional
 phrase; one directly-fetched source (a Telugu-learning blog, the
 same low-authority genre already found overstated for Hindi/
 Kannada) claims it’s archaic, displaced by English “good
 morning” — treat with real skepticism, not as confirmed;
 నమస్కారం remains a safer everyday-greeting bet
 regardless శుభోదయం (śubhodayam)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 29, p. 217

Good Night

chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 205

“good night” — the standard Sanskrit-tatsama translation (rātri
 already met, śubha new); some sources describe everyday
 speakers often code-switching to English “good night”

instead శుభ రాత్రి (śubha rātri)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 25, p. 205

goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”) వెళ్ళి వస్తాను (velli vastānu)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 59

grain ధాన్యం (dhānyam)

Chapter 134, p. 777

grandfather తాత (tāta)

Chapter 45, p. 301

grandmother, the mother’s mother అమ్మమ్మ (ammamma)

Chapter 45, p. 301

Grandparents, and the Married Pair

chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 301

Grandson, Granddaughter, Parents, Twins, Baby

chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1007

grapes ద్రాక్ష (drākṣa)

Chapter 135, p. 781

grass గడ్డి (gaḍḍi)

Chapter 66, p. 429

gratitude కృతజ్ఞత (kṛtajñata)

Chapter 51, p. 335

great, eminent గొప్ప (goppa)

Chapter 181, p. 985

Great, Smell, Interesting, Wonderful, Ordinary

chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 985

Green and Yellow

chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 195

green and yellow — a genuine Telugu doublet pair, both from the same Proto-Dravidian *pac-* root, unlike *Kannada*, where the *yellow* word broke away as a *Sanskrit* loan పచ్చ, పసుపు (pacca pasupu)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 195

Greetings

chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

Greetings People Actually Say

chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 581

grey; ash బూడిద (būḍida)

Chapter 140, p. 803

Guava, Sugar, Tall, Short, Heavy

chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 785

H**hair (of the head)** జుట్టు (juṭṭu)

Chapter 47, p. 311

happily, gladly సంతోషంగా (santōṣaṅgā)

Chapter 93, p. 593

hard గట్టి (gaṭṭi)

Chapter 137, p. 789

hard-working కష్టపడే (kaṣṭapaḍē)

Chapter 142, p. 811

Hard-working, Clever, Terrible, Black, White

chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 811

have you eaten? భోంచేశారా? (bhōñcēsārā?)

Chapter 91, p. 581

he (and ఆమె, she) అతను (atanu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 79, p. 507

He, She, and Whose

chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 507

Head and Hand

chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 147

head (matching its cousins) and hand (the SAME Dravidian root as the others, transformed almost past recognition) తల

తెయ్యి (tala ceyyi)

Chapter 13, p. 147

Headache, Diarrhoea, Tablet, Sweat, Swelling

chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 927

health ఆరోగ్యం (ārōgyam)

Chapter 63, p. 411

heart — the everyday native Dravidian word, cognate with

Kannada’s own native heart-word గుండె (guṇḍe)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 267

heart — the literary Sanskrit word for the same organ, a genuine

Indo-European cousin of English “heart” హృదయం (hṛdayam)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 267

heat; hot వేడి (vēḍi)

Chapter 85, p. 545

heavy బరువు (baruvu)

Chapter 136, p. 785

hello / greetings (namaskāram — “a making of a

bow”) నమస్కారం (namaskāram)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

henna గోరింటాకు (gōriṇṭāku)

Chapter 188, p. 1015

here — where I am ఇక్కడ (ikkaḍa)

Chapter 41, p. 281

home, to the house ఇంటికి (iṇṭiki)

Chapter 90, p. 575

honey తేనె (tēne)

Chapter 119, p. 713

Honey, Idli, Dosa, Vada, Coffee

chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 713

hope ఆశ (āśa)

Chapter 107, p. 663

hour — matching Kannada and Hindi exactly, the same Sanskrit

“bell” word గంట (ganṭa)

explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 18, p. 177

housework ఇంటిపని (iṇṭipani)

Chapter 194, p. 1043

Housework, Domestic helper, Tailor, Trader, Coin

chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1043

how ఎలా (elā)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43

How Are You?

chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 43

how are you? (respectful) మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? (mīru elā unnāru?)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43

How Do You Say It?

chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 605

how do you say it? ఎలా అంటారు? (elā aṇṭāru?)

Chapter 95, p. 605

how old are you? — literally “your age how-much?”, matching

Kannada’s simple verbless possessive exactly నీ వయసెంత? (nī

vayasenta)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 185

hunger ఆకలి (ākali)

Chapter 63, p. 411

Hunger, Sleep and Health

chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 411

husband భర్త (bharta)

Chapter 45, p. 301

I

I నేను (nēnu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43

i- / a- / e- — six words, one machine

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 41, p. 281

I could not hear it వినిపించలేదు (vinipiñcalēdu)

Chapter 95, p. 605

I did not understand అర్థం కాలేదు (artham kālēdu)

Chapter 78, p. 501

I do not know నాకు తెలియదు (nāku teliyadu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 78, p. 501

‘I know Telugu’ — literally ‘to me Telugu comes’, with no

subject at all నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు (nāku telugu vaccu)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 91

'I like Telugu' — a sentence with no verb in it at all, the liker in the dative and the liked thing left standing plain నాకు తెలుగు

ఇష్టం (nāku telugu iṣṭam)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 245

I'll go and come back — the everyday

goodbye వెళ్ళొస్తాను (vellōstānu)

Chapter 50, p. 329

I speak Telugu నేను తెలుగు మాట్లాడతాను (nēnu telugu māṭṭlāḍatānu)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 71

I want it నాకు కావాలి (nāku kāvāli)

Chapter 80, p. 513

if by chance, in case ఒకవేళ (okavēḷa)

Chapter 177, p. 969

If by chance, Instead of, According to, Actually, Anyway

chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 969

in Telugu తెలుగులో (telugulō)

Chapter 95, p. 605

in that case అయితే (ayitē)

Chapter 64, p. 417

In the House

chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 369

In the Kitchen

chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 399

in the middle మధ్యలో (madhyalō)

Chapter 102, p. 643

In the middle, Street, Road, Bridge, Park

chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 643

India భారతదేశం (Bhāratadeśam)

Chapter 77, p. 495

inside లోపల (lōpala)

Chapter 101, p. 639

instead of బదులు (badulu)

Chapter 177, p. 969

interesting ఆసక్తికరమైన (āsaktikaramaina)

Chapter 181, p. 985

Introducing Yourself

chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 21

is he or she there? ఉన్నారా (unnārā)

Chapter 78, p. 501

is it so? అవునా (avunā)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 78, p. 501

is that so? I see అలాగా (alāgā)

Chapter 87, p. 557

it has been a long time చాలా రోజులైంది (cālā rōjulaindi)

Chapter 91, p. 581

it is a good one మంచిది (mancidi)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 76, p. 489

it is known — the verb that carries no person at all, so the

knower rides in the dative తెలుసు (telusu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 32, p. 225

it's okay / no problem / you're welcome పరవాలేదు (paravālēdu)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43

J

jealousy అసూయ (asūya)

Chapter 168, p. 931

Jealousy, Pride, Enthusiasm, Peace, Patience

chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 931

joy / pleased to meet you సంతోషం (santōṣam)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

just so, alright then అలాగే (alāgē)

Chapter 49, p. 323

K

Keeping Well

chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 593

Kitchen, Bedroom, Bucket, Lid, Frying pan

chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 993

Kite, Shirt, Sari, Dhoti, Sandals

chapter topic; Chapter 114, p. 693

L

last, previous గత (gata)

Chapter 154, p. 863

Laughing, Crying, Worrying

chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 617

lazy సోమరి (sōmari)

Chapter 141, p. 807

leave, a holiday సెలవు (selavu)

Chapter 90, p. 575

left (not right) ఎడమ (eḍama)

Chapter 100, p. 635

- leg, foot** కాలు (kālu)
Chapter 47, p. 311
- less, too little** తక్కువ (takkuva)
Chapter 58, p. 381
- let's go** పదండి (padaṇḍi)
Chapter 90, p. 575
- light (in weight)** తేలిక (tēlika)
Chapter 137, p. 789
- Light, Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty**
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 789
- lightning** మెరుపు (merupu)
Chapter 121, p. 723
- Line, Circle, Square, Triangle, Wheel**
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1039
- listen** ఆలకించు (ālakiṁcu)
Chapter 44, p. 297
- literature; the whole body of expression in words** వాఙ్మయం (vāṁmayam)
Chapter 150, p. 845
- Lock, Key, Rope, Nail, Scissors**
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 677
- look** చూడు (cūḍu)
Chapter 44, p. 297
- loudly; firmly** గట్టిగా (gaṭṭiga)
Chapter 86, p. 551

M

- main, chief** ప్రధాన (pradhāna)
Chapter 180, p. 981
- Main, Total, Every, Pink, Orange**
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 981
- me (as the object)** నన్ను (nannu)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 79, p. 507
- meanwhile** ఇంతలో (intalō)
Chapter 172, p. 947
- meat** మాంసం (māṁsam)
Chapter 116, p. 701
- medicine** మందు (mandu)
Chapter 92, p. 587
- milk — the same Proto-Dravidian word the whole family shares, with Telugu on the majority side of a regular Kannada sound law** పాలు (pālu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 271

mist, dew, snow మంచు (mañcu)

Chapter 59, p. 387

money డబ్బు (ḍabbu)

Chapter 72, p. 465

more, a great deal ఎక్కువ (ekkuva)

Chapter 58, p. 381

More Everyday Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 293

More Good Manners

chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 423

More of the Body

chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 375

More Short Replies

chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 381

Morning

chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 209

“morning” (udayam) — Sanskrit tatsama from udaya (“rise”) +

Telugu -mu, Telugu’s most general everyday word, though genuine native competitors (poddu/podduna, vēkuva) also do real everyday work; unlike Kannada, where the same Sanskrit root (udaya) shows up ONLY inside the greeting śubhōdaya, Telugu’s everyday noun and its greeting-root are the SAME

word ఉదయం (udayam)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 26, p. 209

mouth — the one face-word where Telugu does not obviously

match the root its three sisters all share నోరు (nōru)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 261

mud బురద (burada)

Chapter 59, p. 387

my నా (nā)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

my name is... (with no “is”) నా పేరు ... (nā pēru ...)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

N

namaste, hello నమస్తే (namastē)

Chapter 99, p. 629

name పేరు (pēru)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

Names, Ages, Birthdays

chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 611

Naming Who Someone Is

chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 317

narrow ఇరుకు (iruku)

Chapter 138, p. 793

near దగ్గర (daggara)

Chapter 100, p. 635

need, necessity అవసరం (avasaram)

Chapter 94, p. 599

never mind; let it be పోనీ (pōnī)

Chapter 178, p. 973

never (with a negative verb); always ఎప్పుడూ (eppuḍū)

Chapter 153, p. 857

new కొత్త (kotta)

Chapter 42, p. 287

next, coming వచ్చే (vaccē)

Chapter 155, p. 869

Next, From Now On, the Future, To Hope, To Look Forward To

chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 869

Night

chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 201

“night” — the same Sanskrit tatsama word already hiding inside ardharātri; unlike day’s Persian surprise, night genuinely follows the Sanskrit-tatsama-as-everyday pattern, matching**Kannada** రాత్రి (rātri)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 201

ninth — the doubled consonant survives the**swap** తొమ్మిదవ (tommidava)

Chapter 82, p. 527

no, I don’t want it వద్దు (vaddu)

Chapter 58, p. 381

no / there isn’t (lēdu) లేదు (lēdu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

Nobody, Never, Nowhere, Anyone, Anything

chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 857

nobody (with a negative verb) ఎవరూ (evarū)

Chapter 153, p. 857

Noon and Midnight

chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 167

noon (Sanskrit “middle of day,” same as Kannada) and midnight (Sanskrit “HALF of night” — a different root than Kannada’s**midnight word)** మధ్యాహ్నం అర్ధరాత్రి (madhyāhnam ardharātri)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 167

- nose** — native Dravidian, but an irregular reflex of its own
**Proto-Dravidian root, contaminated in shape by the separate
word for “face” ముక్కు (mukku)**
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 261
- not yet ఇంకా లేదు (inkā lēdu)**
Chapter 98, p. 623
- nothing, it’s nothing ఏమీ లేదు (ēmī lēdu)**
Chapter 98, p. 623
- Nothing, Not Yet, That Will Do**
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 623
- now ఇప్పుడు (ippuḍu)**
Chapter 50, p. 329
- nowhere, not anywhere (with a negative verb) ఎక్కడా (ekkaḍā)**
Chapter 153, p. 857
- Numbers 11–20 and Weather**
chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 187
- Numbers One to Ten**
chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 101

O

- Offers, Apologies, Introductions**
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 599
- Officer, Clerk, Manager, Colleague, Meeting**
chapter topic; Chapter 195, p. 1047
- often తరచుగా (taracugā)**
Chapter 170, p. 939
- oil నూనె (nūne)**
Chapter 61, p. 399
- okay / alright (sarē) సరే (sarē)**
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
- okra, lady’s finger బెండకాయ (beṇḍakāya)**
Chapter 184, p. 999
- old age వృద్ధాప్యం (vṛddhāpyam)**
Chapter 172, p. 947
- old — of a thing, not of a person పాత (pāta)**
Chapter 42, p. 287
- old (of people) ముసలి (musali)**
Chapter 139, p. 797
- On purpose, By mistake, Never mind, Condition, Excuse**
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 973
- on purpose, deliberately కావాలని (kāvālanī)**
Chapter 178, p. 973

on the other side, beyond అవతల (avatala)

Chapter 174, p. 955

On the other side, That way, This way, Cave, Valley

chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 955

On the Way Out

chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 575

once more, one more time ఇంకోసారి (in̄kōsāri)

Chapter 86, p. 551

once, one time ఒకసారి (okasāri)

Chapter 154, p. 863

ృ — **one character, met inside a word you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 39, p. 271

ౌ — **one character, met inside a word you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 51, p. 335

౐ — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ీ — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ి — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21

ీ — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21

ి — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21

ొ — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21

ౌ — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 101

ై — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 11, p. 137

ీ — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 15, p. 157

ై — **one character, met inside words you already say**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 16, p. 161

one minute, a moment ఒక్క నిమిషం (okka nimīṣam)

Chapter 86, p. 551

one to five — the Dravidian family numbers, with Telugu’s

maverick “one” ఒకటి రెండు మూడు నాలుగు ఐదు (okaṭi reṇḍu mūḍu

nālugu aidu)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 101

only మాత్రమే (mātramē)

Chapter 64, p. 417

or లేదా (lēdā)

Chapter 74, p. 477

orange (colour) నారింజ రంగు (nāriṁja raṅgu)

Chapter 180, p. 981

ordinary, usual మామూలు (māmūlu)

Chapter 181, p. 985

Otherwise, Even so, Through, About, Without

chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 965

otherwise, or else లేకపోతే (lēkapōtē)

Chapter 176, p. 965

our (not including you) మా (mā)

Chapter 79, p. 507

outside బయట (bayāṭa)

Chapter 101, p. 639

P

paddy, rice still in the field వరి (vari)

Chapter 66, p. 429

paper కాగితం (kāgitam)

Chapter 112, p. 685

parents తల్లిదండ్రులు (tallidaṇḍrulu)

Chapter 186, p. 1007

patience సహనం (sahanam)

Chapter 168, p. 931

peace, calm శాంతి (śānti)

Chapter 168, p. 931

perhaps, who knows ఏమో (ēmō)

Chapter 49, p. 323

permission అనుమతి (anumati)

Chapter 65, p. 423

Pigeon, Owl, Peacock, Butterfly, Crow

chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 739

pink గులాబీ రంగు (gulābī raṅgu)

Chapter 180, p. 981

plain, simple సాదా (sādā)

Chapter 182, p. 989

Please

chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 115

please come in లోపలికి రండి (lōpaliki raṇḍi)

Chapter 80, p. 513

please (dayacēsi — “having done compassion,” from దయ daya

“compassion”) దయచేసి (dayacēsi)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 115

please forgive / sorry (kṣamiñcaṇḍi — from kṣamiñcu “to forgive,” Sanskrit kṣamā + respectful

-aṇḍi) క్షమించండి (kṣamiñcaṇḍi)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 121

please pardon me మన్నించండి (manniñcaṇḍi)

Chapter 94, p. 599

please show me చూపించండి (cūpiñcaṇḍi)

Chapter 95, p. 605

please wait; please stop ఆగండి (āgaṇḍi)

Chapter 86, p. 551

Pointing, and Asking

chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 281

poor పేద (pēda)

Chapter 139, p. 797

prasadam, food offered to a deity and shared ప్రసాదం (prasādam)

Chapter 188, p. 1015

Prasadam, Rice-flour sweets, Festoon of mango leaves hung over a doorway, Bindi, Henna

chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1015

pride గర్వం (garvam)

Chapter 168, p. 931

probably, perhaps బహుశా (bahusā)

Chapter 87, p. 557

property ఆస్తి (āsti)

Chapter 106, p. 659

pungency, heat కారం (kāram)

Chapter 73, p. 471

Q

quickly, soon త్వరగా (tvaragā)

Chapter 90, p. 575

R

rarely అరుదుగా (arudugā)

Chapter 171, p. 943

rasam రసం (rasam)

Chapter 116, p. 701

Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Passage

chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 535

really, truly నిజంగా (nijaṃgā)

Chapter 87, p. 557

recently ఇటీవల (iṭīvala)

Chapter 154, p. 863

Recently, Already, Last, Once, To Spend (Time)

chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 863

red, reddish ఎర్రటి (errāṭi)

Chapter 143, p. 815

Red, To fly, To run, To sleep, To get up

chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 815

regret, sorrow విచారం (vicāram)

Chapter 97, p. 617

rent అద్దె (adde)

Chapter 156, p. 875

respect గౌరవం (gauravam)

Chapter 51, p. 335

rest విశ్రాంతి (viśrānti)

Chapter 84, p. 539

rice-flour sweets; made with jaggery at Sankranti అరిసెలు (ariselu)

Chapter 188, p. 1015

Right, Left, Straight ahead, Near, Far

chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 635

right (not left) కుడి (kuḍi)

Chapter 100, p. 635

Right, Wrong, Maybe

chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 557

River and Road

chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 363

rubber; an eraser రబ్బరు (rabbaru)

Chapter 191, p. 1029

Rubber, Light bulb, Firewood, Net, Weighing scale

chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1029

Rupee, Bottle, Long skirt, Pocket, Belt

chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 765

S

safe సురక్షితం (surakṣitam)

Chapter 140, p. 803

Safe, Lie, Grey, Golden, Spoiled

chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 803

salt ఉప్పు (uppu)

Chapter 46, p. 305

sambar సాంబారు (sāmbāru)

Chapter 116, p. 701

Sambar, Rasam, Egg, Fish, Meat

chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 701

sand ఇసుక (isuka)

Chapter 59, p. 387

sandals చెప్పులు (ceppulu)

Chapter 114, p. 693

scissors కత్తెర (katterā)

Chapter 110, p. 677

Sea, Lake, Forest, Leaf, Soil

chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 719

Seasons

chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 151

second — and the one swap that makes every ordinal from here to the end రెండవ (reṇḍava)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 81, p. 519

see you tomorrow రేపు కలుద్దాం (rēpu kaluddām)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 59

seventh — a long vowel that stays long ఏడవ (ēḍava)

Chapter 82, p. 527

shade; shadow ఛాయ (chāya)

Chapter 151, p. 849

Shore, Office, Garden, Corner, Turn

chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 651

short పొట్టి (poṭṭi)

Chapter 136, p. 785

Silence, Durable, Fake, Plain, Extra

chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 989

silence; quiet నిశబ్దం (niśśabdāṁ)

Chapter 182, p. 989

sit కూర్చో (kūrcō)

Chapter 43, p. 293

six to ten — where Telugu wanders furthest from its Dravidian

cousins ఆరు ఏడు ఎనిమిది తొమ్మిది పది (āru ēḍu enimidi tommidi padi)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 7, p. 101

sixth — the shortest of the ten ఆరవ (ārava)

Chapter 82, p. 527

Sixth to Eleventh

chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 527

sleep నిద్ర (nidra)

Chapter 63, p. 411

Slower, Please

chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 551

slowly నెమ్మదిగా (nemmadigā)

Chapter 86, p. 551

small చిన్న (cinna)

Chapter 42, p. 287

Small Creatures

chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 453

smoke పొగ (poga)

Chapter 175, p. 961

soap సబ్బు (sabbu)

Chapter 111, p. 681

socks సాక్సు (sāksu)

Chapter 132, p. 769

Socks, Coat, Dhoti, Blouse, Lotus

chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 769

soft మెత్తని (mettani)

Chapter 137, p. 789

soil, earth మట్టి (maṭṭi)

Chapter 120, p. 719

sometimes అప్పుడప్పుడు (appuḍappuḍu)

Chapter 170, p. 939

son — a native Dravidian root that shares its shape with a word already met in this book, and not with the next lesson's word for daughter కొడుకు (koḍuku)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 257

Son and Daughter, Two Different Roots

chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 257

Sore, Blister, Rash, Scar, Sprain

chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 935

sorrow, distress బాధ (bādha)

Chapter 85, p. 545

Sorry

chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 121

Sound and Voice

chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 441

sour, sourness పులుపు (pulupu)

Chapter 73, p. 471

speak మాట్లాడు (māṭlāḍu)

Chapter 44, p. 297

spicy కారమైన (kāramaina)

Chapter 141, p. 807

spoiled పాడైన (pāḍaina)

Chapter 140, p. 803

spring, summer, monsoon, winter — completing the Dravidian pattern of native heat/rain words plus Sanskrit spring వసంత ఋతువు వేసవి వానాకాలం శీతాకాలం (vasanta ṛtuvu vēsavi vānākālam śītākālam)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 14, p. 151

staff సిబ్బంది (sibbandi)

Chapter 198, p. 1059

stand నిల్వో (nilcō)

Chapter 43, p. 293

Station, Bus, Ability, Skill, Right

chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 655

still, yet ఇంకా (iṅkā)

Chapter 64, p. 417

Stove, Candle, Matchbox, Doll, Ball

chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 689

straight ahead తిన్నగా (tinnagā)

Chapter 100, p. 635

strength బలం (balaṁ)

Chapter 106, p. 659

sugar చక్కెర (cakkera)

Chapter 61, p. 399

sugar పంచదార (pañcadāra)

Chapter 136, p. 785

sunset సూర్యాస్తమయం (sūryāstamayaṁ)

Chapter 171, p. 943

Sunset, Every day, Usually, Rarely, Constantly

chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 943

sweat చెమట (cemaṭa)

Chapter 167, p. 927

Sweet, Bitter-tasting, Spicy, Courage, Lazy

chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 807

sweet (of taste) తీయని (tīyani)

Chapter 141, p. 807

sweet, sweetness తీపి (tīpi)

Chapter 73, p. 471

T

Taking Your Leave

chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 329

tall, long పొడవు (poḍavu)

Chapter 136, p. 785

tamarind చింతపండు (cintapaṇḍu)

Chapter 135, p. 781

Tastes

chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 471

Tea and Milk, Two Roads

chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 271

tea, please — Telugu’s traditional word for tea travelled by sea, not by the overland road most of its neighbours took దయచేసి

టీ (dayacēsi ṭī)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 271

tears కంటినీరు (kaṇṭinīru)

Chapter 133, p. 773

Television, Computer, Phone, Ticket, Paisa

chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 761

Telling Time

chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 177

Temple, School, Library, Bank, Market

chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 647

tenth — the ten closed, and the shortest swap of all పదవ (padava)

Chapter 82, p. 527

terrible, dreadful భయంకరమైన (bhayaṅkaramaina)

Chapter 142, p. 811

thank you (dhanyavādamulu — “utterances of ‘worthy’”) ధన్యవాదములు (dhanyavādamulu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

that is exactly why అందుకే (andukē)

Chapter 109, p. 671

That is exactly why, Bed, Pillow, Blanket, Curtain

chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 671

that one — the thing over there అది (adi)

Chapter 41, p. 281

that (reporting what was said or thought) అని (ani)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 80, p. 513

that’s all; that’s just it అంతే (antē)

Chapter 58, p. 381

that’s the one, the same అదే (adē)

Chapter 98, p. 623

that’s true నిజమే (nijamē)

Chapter 98, p. 623

that way, in that direction అటు (aṭu)

Chapter 174, p. 955

that will do, it is enough సరిపోతుంది (saripōtundi)

Chapter 98, p. 623

the back వీపు (vīpu)

Chapter 57, p. 375

the body ఒళ్ళు (oḷḷu)

Chapter 93, p. 593

the chin; a beard గడ్డం (gaḍḍam)

Chapter 128, p. 751

The Core Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 225

the dative suffix -ku, 'to / for' — and the idea of stacking -కు (-ku)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 6, p. 91

the day after tomorrow ఎల్లుండి (elluṇḍi)

Chapter 50, p. 329

the face ముఖం (mukham)

Chapter 126, p. 743

The Field

chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 429

The First Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 71

the friend's స్నేహితుడి (snēhituḍi)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 79, p. 507

the future భవిష్యత్తు (bhaviṣyattu)

Chapter 155, p. 869

The Heart, Two Ways

chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 267

The House Itself

chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 435

The Leg and the Tooth

chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 311

The Market

chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 465

the moon చంద్రుడు (candruḍu)

Chapter 53, p. 351

the neck మెడ (meḍa)

Chapter 57, p. 375

The People Around You

chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 563

the post, mail తపాలా (tapālā)

Chapter 185, p. 1003

the respectful suffix on a name గారు (gāru)

Chapter 79, p. 507

the rice-flour design drawn at the doorstep ముగ్గు (muggu)

Chapter 52, p. 345

the sea సముద్రం (samudram)

Chapter 120, p. 719

the seven weekdays — Sanskritic like Hindi, but Sunday means

“the FIRST day,” not “Sun’s day” సోమవారం మంగళవారం బుధవారం

గురువారం శుక్రవారం శనివారం ఆదివారం (Somavāram Maṅgalavāram

Budhavāram Guruvāram Śukravāram Śanivāram Ādivāram)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 127

ౌ — **the short one of the pair**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 101

the skin చర్మం (carmam)

Chapter 128, p. 751

The Sky

chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 351

the sky ఆకాశం (ākāśam)

Chapter 53, p. 351

the stomach, the belly కడుపు (kaḍupu)

Chapter 47, p. 311

the sun సూర్యుడు (sūryuḍu)

Chapter 53, p. 351

the tongue నాలుక (nāluka)

Chapter 127, p. 747

The Traditional Months

chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 161

The Tree

chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 357

the twelve lunisolar months — matching Kannada and Hindi’s

shared pan-Indian calendar, completing the split with Tamil/

Malayalam’s own solar systems చైత్రం వైశాఖం జ్యేష్ఠం ఆషాఢం శ్రావణం

భాద్రపదం ఆశ్వయుజం కార్తీకం మార్గశిరం పుష్యం మాఘం ఫాల్గుణం (Caitram

Vaiśākham Jyēṣṭham Āṣāḍham Śrāvaṇam Bhādrapadam Āśvayujam

Kārtikam Mārgaśiram Puṣyam Māgham Phālgunam)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 161

The Wider Family

chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 459

the world ప్రపంచం (prapañcam)

Chapter 175, p. 961

there — **where I am not** అక్కడ (akkāḍa)

Chapter 41, p. 281

therefore అందువల్ల (anduvalla)

Chapter 108, p. 667

Things People Make

chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 405

Things You Ask For

chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 305

third — the swap on its second number మూడవ (mūdava)

Chapter 81, p. 519

thirst దాహం (dāham)

Chapter 84, p. 539

thirty (and the tens above it) ముప్పై (muppai)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 77, p. 495

this one — the thing near me ఇది (idi)

Chapter 41, p. 281

this way, in this direction ఇటు (iṭu)

Chapter 174, p. 955

thread దారం (dāram)

Chapter 62, p. 405

through, by means of ద్వారా (dvārā)

Chapter 176, p. 965

thunder ఉరుము (urumu)

Chapter 121, p. 723

Thunder, Lightning, Storm, Wave, Hill

chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 723

Tiger, Lion, Bear, Monkey, Rabbit

chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 731

time సమయం (samayaṁ)

Chapter 170, p. 939

Time, Sometimes, Often, Date, Weekend

chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 939

tiredness అలసట (alasaṭa)

Chapter 84, p. 539

to agree, to accept ఒప్పుకో (oppukō)

Chapter 160, p. 893

**to ask — a native verb none of the three literary sisters share,
and the clue to which branch of Dravidian Telugu actually sits
on అడుగు** (aḍugu)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 245

to be surprised, to be amazed ఆశ్చర్యపోవు (āścaryapōvu)

Chapter 161, p. 897

**to be, to exist, to stay — and the negative Telugu has to fetch
from a different verb ఉండు** (uṇḍu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 32, p. 225

to be, to stay, to live ఉండు (uṇḍu)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 71

to boil (food), to simmer ఉడికించు (uḍikiṅcu)

Chapter 157, p. 881

to break పగలగొట్టు (pagalagoṭṭu)

Chapter 144, p. 819

to brush (teeth), to scour (pots) తోము (tōmu)

Chapter 158, p. 885

to burn కాల్చు (kālcu)

Chapter 148, p. 835

to call పిలుచు (pilucu)

Chapter 146, p. 827

to celebrate (a festival or occasion) జరుపుకో (jarupukō)

Chapter 161, p. 897

to change మార్చు (mārcu)

Chapter 158, p. 885

to close మూయు (mūyu)

Chapter 149, p. 839

to come — the command is రా, but every ending attaches to వచ్చు

instead రా (rā)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 32, p. 225

to compete పోటీపడు (pōṭīpaḍu)

Chapter 163, p. 907

to continue కొనసాగు (konasāgu)

Chapter 166, p. 921

To continue, To observe, To correct, To mutter, To separate

chapter topic; Chapter 166, p. 921

to cook వండు (vaṇḍu)

Chapter 144, p. 819

To cook, To cut, To break, To send, To look for

chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 819

to correct (written work) దిద్దు (diddu)

Chapter 166, p. 921

to count లెక్కపెట్టు (lekkapeṭṭu)

Chapter 146, p. 827

to cry ఏడ్చు (ēḍcu)

Chapter 149, p. 839

to cut కోయు (kōyu)

Chapter 144, p. 819

to dance నాట్యం చేయు (nāṭyaṁ cēyu)

Chapter 161, p. 897

To dance, To celebrate, To greet, To feel shy, To be surprised

chapter topic; Chapter 161, p. 897

to decide నిర్ణయించు (nirṇayiṁcu)

Chapter 108, p. 667

to describe వర్ణించు (varṇiṁcu)

Chapter 162, p. 903

to dip, to soak in ముంచు (muṁcu)

Chapter 164, p. 911

to drink తాగు (tāgu)

Chapter 149, p. 839

to earn సంపాదించు (sampādiñcu)

Chapter 160, p. 893

To earn, To explain, To translate, To remember, To agree

chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 893

to eat — the inherited Dravidian root Telugu kept as its plain everyday verb, with the mealtime nouns borrowed from

Sanskrit తిను (tinu)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 225

to explain వివరించు (vivariñcu)

Chapter 160, p. 893

to feel shy, to be bashful సిగ్గుపడు (siggupaḍu)

Chapter 161, p. 897

to fly ఎగురు (egiru)

Chapter 143, p. 815

to forget మరచిపో (maracipō)

Chapter 145, p. 823

to fry, to roast వేయించు (vēyiñcu)

Chapter 157, p. 881

to get down, to get off దిగు (digu)

Chapter 145, p. 823

to get up లేచు (lēcu)

Chapter 143, p. 815

to go (and vaccu, to come) వెళ్ళు (vellu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 59

to go — with one tense-piece covering both “I go” and “I will go”, and “right now” built out of the be-verb వెళ్ళు (vellu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 32, p. 225

to grate తురుము (turumu)

Chapter 164, p. 911

To grate, To strain, To dip, To tear, To wrap

chapter topic; Chapter 164, p. 911

to greet పలకరించు (palakariñcu)

Chapter 161, p. 897

to grind (wet batter) రుబ్బు (rubbu)

Chapter 157, p. 881

to help — a Sanskrit noun on the native do-verb, and the noun takes apart into “a going with somebody” సహాయం చేయు (sahāyam cēyu)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 34, p. 245

to hide దాచు (dācu)

Chapter 147, p. 831

- to hope, to expect** ఆశించు (āśiñcu)
Chapter 155, p. 869
- to hug, to embrace** కౌగిలించు (kaugiliñcu)
Chapter 162, p. 903
- to hurry** తొందరపడు (tondarapaḍu)
Chapter 158, p. 885
- To hurry, To brush, To change, To take off, To measure**
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 885
- to jump** దూకు (dūku)
Chapter 145, p. 823
- to kick** తన్ను (tannu)
Chapter 163, p. 907
- to kiss** ముద్దుపెట్టు (muddupeṭṭu)
Chapter 162, p. 903
- To kiss, To hug, To tease, To praise, To describe**
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 903
- to knit, to weave** అల్లు (allu)
Chapter 165, p. 915
- to learn** నేర్చుకో (nērcukō)
Chapter 145, p. 823
- To learn, To teach, To forget, To jump, To get down**
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 823
- to look for** వెతుకు (vetuku)
Chapter 144, p. 819
- to look forward to, to wait for** ఎదురుచూడు (edurucūḍu)
Chapter 155, p. 869
- to lose (something)** పోగొట్టుకో (pōgoṭṭukō)
Chapter 159, p. 889
- to measure** కొలుచు (kolucu)
Chapter 158, p. 885
- to mix, to stir in** కలుపు (kalupu)
Chapter 157, p. 881
- to mutter, to grumble** గొణుగు (goṇugu)
Chapter 166, p. 921
- to observe, to follow (rules)** పాటించు (pāṭiñcu)
Chapter 166, p. 921
- to open** తెరువు (teruvu)
Chapter 149, p. 839
- to pay** చెల్లించు (celliñcu)
Chapter 157, p. 881
- to pay attention to, to care about** పట్టించుకో (paṭṭiñcukō)
Chapter 163, p. 907
- To pay, To fry, To boil, To mix, To grind**
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 881

to praise పొగడు (pogaḍu)

Chapter 162, p. 903

to prick, to string (flowers) గుచ్చు (guccu)

Chapter 165, p. 915

To protect, To burn, To put out, To sing, To sell

chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 835

to protect, to save కాపాడు (kāpāḍu)

Chapter 148, p. 835

to put on (clothes) వేసుకో (vēsukō)

Chapter 146, p. 827

to put out ఆర్పు (ārpu)

Chapter 148, p. 835

to reach, to join చేరు (cēru)

Chapter 146, p. 827

To reach, To put on, To call, To count, To wash

chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 827

to read — and, with no second word, to study; the same form is the noun for an education, and its middle vowel moves as the

endings change చదువు (caduvu)

explicit focus: script, grammar; Chapter 33, p. 235

to realize, to grasp గ్రహించు (grahiñcu)

Chapter 163, p. 907

to remember, to keep in mind గుర్తుపెట్టుకో (gurtupeṭṭukō)

Chapter 160, p. 893

to repair, to mend బాగుచేయు (bāgucēyu)

Chapter 159, p. 889

to run పరిగెత్తు (parigettu)

Chapter 143, p. 815

to see, to look — Telugu's own everyday see-word, and the respectful -అండి ending that fits any verb stem చూడు (cūḍu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 32, p. 225

to sell అమ్ము (ammu)

Chapter 148, p. 835

to send పంపు (pampu)

Chapter 144, p. 819

to separate, to part విడిపోవు (viḍipōvu)

Chapter 166, p. 921

to set out, to start off బయలుదేరు (bayaludēru)

Chapter 50, p. 329

to sew కుట్టు (kuṭṭu)

Chapter 147, p. 831

to shave గొరుగు (gorugu)

Chapter 165, p. 915

to sing పాడు (pāḍu)

Chapter 148, p. 835

to sleep నిద్రపో (nidrapō)

Chapter 143, p. 815

to soak నానబెట్టు (nānabeṭṭu)

Chapter 159, p. 889

to speak మాట్లాడు (māṭlāḍu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 71

to spend (time) గడుపు (gaḍupu)

Chapter 154, p. 863

to spill చిందు (cindu)

Chapter 165, p. 915

To spill, To shave, To tighten, To prick, To knit

chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 915

to squeeze పిండు (piṇḍu)

Chapter 159, p. 889

To squeeze, To soak, To repair, To throw away, To lose

chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 889

to strain, to filter వడకట్టు (vaḍakaṭṭu)

Chapter 164, p. 911

to suspect, to doubt అనుమానించు (anumāniñcu)

Chapter 163, p. 907

To suspect, To realize, To pay attention to, To compete, To kick

chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 907

to take off, to untie విప్పు (vippu)

Chapter 158, p. 885

to take — తీయు, “to pull out”, wearing the same -కో as the last chapter’s two mind-verbs, so taking is pulling something out for yourself తీసుకో (tīsukō)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 245

to teach నేర్పు (nēpu)

Chapter 145, p. 823

to tear చింపు (cimpu)

Chapter 164, p. 911

to tease ఆటపట్టించు (āṭapaṭṭiñcu)

Chapter 162, p. 903

to think — literally “say it to yourself”, built from the family’s say-verb plus the ending that turns a verb back on its own

doer అనుకో (anukō)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 235

to throw away పారేయు (pārēyu)

Chapter 159, p. 889

to tie, to build కట్టు (kaṭṭu)

Chapter 147, p. 831

to tighten బిగించు (bigiñcu)

Chapter 165, p. 915

to translate అనువదించు (anuvadiñcu)

Chapter 160, p. 893

to understand — “make the meaning your own”, a Sanskrit noun on the native do-verb with the ending that hands the action back

to you అర్థం చేసుకో (artham cēsukō)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 235

to walk నడుచు (naḍucu)

Chapter 149, p. 839

To walk, To close, To open, To drink, To cry

chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 839

to wash కడుగు (kaḍugu)

Chapter 146, p. 827

to win గెలుచు (gelucu)

Chapter 147, p. 831

to wipe తుడుచు (tuḍucu)

Chapter 147, p. 831

To wipe, To tie, To sew, To win, To hide

chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 831

to wish for, to ask for కోరు (kōru)

Chapter 108, p. 667

To wish for, To decide, Reason, Therefore, Because of

chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 667

to work (lit. “work-do”) పని చేయు (pani cēyu)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 71

to wrap, to roll up చుట్టు (cuṭṭu)

Chapter 164, p. 911

to write — an old Dravidian word for drawing a line, still spelled

వ్రాయు in books, and the chapter’s fourth mind-verb రాయు (rāyu)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 235

today ఇవాళ (ivāḷa)

Chapter 75, p. 483

Today, Yesterday, When

chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 483

Tomato, Potato, Aubergine, Ginger, Garlic

chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 709

Tongue, Knee, Shoulder, Eyebrow, Cheek

chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 747

Tools

chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 447

total, whole; the total మొత్తం (mottani)

Chapter 180, p. 981

true; the truth నిజం (nijam)

Chapter 49, p. 323

trust నమ్మకం (nammakam)

Chapter 65, p. 423

tuition, coaching ట్యూషను (tyūṣanu)

Chapter 198, p. 1059

Tuition, Interview, Work shift, Uniform, Staff

chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1059

twins కవలలు (kavalalu)

Chapter 186, p. 1007

U

usually, generally సాధారణంగా (sādhāraṇaṅgā)

Chapter 171, p. 943

V

vegetables కూరగాయలు (kūragāyalu)

Chapter 117, p. 705

Vegetables, Banana, Mango, Coconut, Onion

chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 705

Veranda, Backyard, Restaurant, Beside, Post office

chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 951

Verbs of Seeing and Saying

chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 297

very good చాలా మంచి (cālā manci)

Chapter 76, p. 489

Very Good, Very Bad

chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 489

W

Wanting, Allowing, Wishing

chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 513

Water and Rice

chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 157

**water (matching Tamil/Kannada's neer/niiru), and rice raw/
cooked — completing the family's water and rice pattern** నీళ్లు

బియ్యం అన్నం (nīllu biyyam annam)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 157

Waterfall, Island, Cow, Horse, Elephant

chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 727

we'll meet again మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం (maḷḷi kaluddām)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 59

weakness, lethargy నీరసం (nīrasam)

Chapter 92, p. 587

Weather and Ground

chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 387

weather/atmosphere — a PURE Sanskrit compound, unlike Kannada's Persian+Sanskrit hybrid: vata (“air/wind”) +**avarana (“covering”) వాతావరణం (vātāvaraṇam)**

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 187

weight తూకం (tūkam)

Chapter 72, p. 465

Welcomes, Gifts, Invitations

chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 629

Welcoming a Guest

chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 345

well, fine — and the reply “నేను బాగున్నాను” బాగా (bāgā)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43

wellbeing, safety క్షేమం (kṣēmam)

Chapter 93, p. 593

wet తడి (taḍi)

Chapter 139, p. 797

Wet, Dry, Poor, Old, Famous

chapter topic; Chapter 139, p. 797

what ఏమిటి (ēmiṭi)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

what's new? ఏంటి సంగతి? (ēṇṭi saṅgati?)

Chapter 91, p. 581

what's your name? మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? (mī pēru ēmiṭi?)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

wheat గోధుమలు (gōdhumalu)

Chapter 134, p. 777

when will you come? ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు? (eppuḍu vastāru?)

Chapter 75, p. 483

When You Are Not Well

chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 539

where? — asking about a place ఎక్కడ (ekkaḍa)

Chapter 41, p. 281

where to? ఎక్కడికి? (ekkaḍiki?)

Chapter 91, p. 581

Where You Are From

chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 495

white, bright తెల్లని (tellani)

Chapter 142, p. 811

who? — asking about a person ఎవరు (evaru)

Chapter 41, p. 281

why? ఎందుకు (enduku)

Chapter 74, p. 477

Wick, Latch, Paintbrush, Necklace, Braid

chapter topic; Chapter 192, p. 1033

wide వెడల్పు (veḍalpu)

Chapter 138, p. 793

wife భార్య (bhārya)

Chapter 45, p. 301

wind, air గాలి (gāli)

Chapter 59, p. 387

Window curtain, Clay pot, Water pot, Cupboard, Table

chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 755

Wish, Hope, Dream, Intention, Plan

chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 663

without లేకుండా (lēkuṇḍā)

Chapter 176, p. 965

wonderful, amazing అద్భుతమైన (adbhutamaina)

Chapter 181, p. 985

Words That Join an Answer

chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 417

write రాయ (rāyi)

Chapter 44, p. 297

Y**yes (avunu) అవును** (avunu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

Yes or No, and I Do Not Know

chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 501

yesterday నిన్న (ninna)

Chapter 75, p. 483

you (familiar / respectful) నువ్వు / మీరు (nuvvu / mīru)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

you may go వెళ్ళవచ్చు (veḷḷavaccu)

Chapter 80, p. 513

youth యవ్వనం (yavvanam)

Chapter 172, p. 947

Youth, Old age, Meanwhile, Every year, Forever
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 947

Other

- అ — **the vowel you have been saying since the first page**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
- ఆ — **the long one, beside the short one that needs no sign**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 101
- ఇ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 9, p. 121
- ఉ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 43
- ఋ — **one character, met inside a word you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 26, p. 209
- ఎ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 21, p. 191
- ఏ — **the sign you know, as a letter**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21
- ఐ — **one letter for a vowel that moves**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 101
- ఒ — **the sign from a page ago, standing alone**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 101
- క — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
- ఖ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 16, p. 161
- గ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 14, p. 151
- ఘ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 17, p. 167
- జ — **the quiet letter inside వాఙ్మయం**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 150, p. 845
- చ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 115
- ఛ — **the airy first letter in ఛాయ**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 151, p. 849
- జ్జ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 24, p. 201
- ఝ — **the breathy first letter in ఝరి**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 152, p. 853
- ఞ • ఱ — **from the sound, with nothing to copy**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 51, p. 335

- ఇ — **one character, met inside a word you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 51, p. 335
- ట — **the curled t, in the question from this chapter**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21
- ఠ — **the curled t, with the breath let out**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 17, p. 167
- ఁడి (-aṇḍi) — **where Telugu actually keeps “please”**
grammar topic; explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 8, p. 115
- డ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 4, p. 59
- ఢ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 18, p. 177
- ణ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 23, p. 197
- త — **copy it where it lives**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- త — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- త — **the letter from the sound**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- త — **write it with the model covered**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- ధ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 33, p. 235
- ద — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 141
- ధ — **the character the thank-you word opens with**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
- న — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21
- ప — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 4, p. 59
- పదకొండప (padakoṇḍava) — **the ending does not stop at ten**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 82, p. 527
- ఫ — **ఫ, with the breath let out**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 17, p. 167
- బ — **the letter your answer starts with**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 43
- భ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 25, p. 205
- మ — **one character, and it is in the first word of the book**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
- య — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 91

- ౪ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 43
- ఁ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 127
- ళ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 18, p. 177
- వ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 147
- శ — **the third s, and the last one**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 127
- శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం — **register and evidence**
culture and usage topic; explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 31, p. 221
- ష — **the second of the s letters**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- స — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- హ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- ౦ — **the Telugu numeral for 0**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 91
- ౧ — **the Telugu numeral for 1**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21
- ౨ — **the Telugu numeral for 2**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 21
- ౩ — **the Telugu numeral for 3**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 43
- ౪ — **the Telugu numeral for 4**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 43
- ౫ — **the Telugu numeral for 5**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 43
- ౬ — **the Telugu numeral for 6**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 4, p. 59
- ౭ — **the Telugu numeral for 7**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 4, p. 59
- ౮ — **the Telugu numeral for 8**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 71
- ౯ — **the Telugu numeral for 9**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 71